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Replies to initial questions raised by Legislative Council Members in examining the Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27

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CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2262)

Head: (28) Civil Aviation Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Air Traffic Engineering Services

Controlling Officer: Director-General of Civil Aviation (Victor LIU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Civil Aviation Department will work with the Transport and Logistics Bureau in taking forward initiatives in relation to the development of low-altitude economy (LAE), specifically the study and planning for low-altitude infrastructures and unmanned aircraft system (UAS) traffic management system. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the staff establishment and the details of the expenditure to be involved in taking forward initiatives in relation to the development of LAE;
2. as trial projects such as UAS traffic management system, multiple applications/users shared-platforms, cross-boundary routes and passenger-carrying flying aircraft are expected to be rolled out in phases from the first half of this year while the Government is also actively exploring with the Mainland to commence trial flights on cross-boundary low-altitude logistics, please provide the implementation timetable and the expenditure to be involved; and
3. whether consideration will be given to conducting a quantitative analysis of the socio-economic benefits generated by low-altitude infrastructures and the associated industries, as well as exploring revenue models for airspace operation, so as to attract more infrastructure investment and unleash the development potential of LAE?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Siu-hung (LegCo internal reference no.: 4)

Reply:

1. The Civil Aviation Department (CAD) has established the following permanent posts to take forward the initiatives in relation to the development of low-altitude economy (LAE), including the work related to the implementation of Regulatory Sandbox (Sandbox) projects:

Rank	No. of posts
Senior Operations Officer (Aviation Administration)	1
Operations Officer (Aviation Administration)	1
Operations Officer (Airworthiness)	1
Assistant Operations Officer (Aviation Administration)	1
Senior Electronics Engineer	1
Electronics Engineer/Assistant Electronics Engineer	2
Total:	7

The salary provision (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary) for the 7 posts above in 2026-27 is $7.74 million. In addition, the CAD has retained a time-limited post of 1 Administrative Officer Staff Grade B (D3) as well as time-limited posts of 1 Chief Executive Officer and 1 Senior Executive Officer from 2025-26 to 2026-27 to undertake various work related to enhancing Hong Kong's status as an international aviation hub following the commissioning of the Three-Runway System, supporting the development of LAE in Hong Kong and enhancing the overall administrative governance of the CAD. The salary provision (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary) for the 3 posts above in 2026-27 is $5.8 million. On the other hand, the Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB) has created 3 time-limited posts (1 Senior Engineer, 1 Engineer/Assistant Engineer and 1 Senior Executive Officer) from 2025-26 to 2029-30 to support the enhancement of Hong Kong's status as an international aviation hub and take forward the development of LAE. The salary provision (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary) for the 3 posts above in 2026-27 is $3.76 million. At present, besides the abovementioned posts, the TLB and the CAD will continue to utilise their existing resources to undertake the work related to the development of LAE.

2. In November 2025, the Government rolled out the advanced LAE Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ (Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$) pilot projects, covering unmanned aircraft system traffic management system demonstrations, unconventional aircraft, cross-boundary applications, multiple applications/users shared-platform and other application scenarios with higher technical complexity. The application period for the pilot projects closed on 28 February 2026. The response from the industry was overwhelming, with multiple applications received for each application scenario. The Working Group on Developing Low-altitude Economy (WG) is examining the applications in detail, aiming to roll out the pilot projects progressively for testing from the first half of this year. At present, the TLB and the CAD will continue to utilise their existing resources to implement the Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ pilot projects and other related work.

3. The WG will draft the Action Plan on Developing Low-Altitude Economy this year, with a view to building an internationally competitive LAE ecosystem and propelling Hong Kong as an Asia-Pacific hub for innovative low-altitude applications. The Government will make reference to the experience gathered from Sandbox and Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ projects, relevant data as well as the technical studies to formulate appropriate infrastructure, related supporting facilities, standards as well as laws and regulations for low-altitude flying activities in the long run. Relevant studies and planning are still underway.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2007)

Head: (28) Civil Aviation Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air Traffic Management

Controlling Officer: Director-General of Civil Aviation (Victor LIU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is estimated that the number of aircraft movements in Hong Kong will reach 430 000 in 2026-27, an increase of 8.7% over 2025-26. The workload of air traffic management is expected to be heavier. The provision for air traffic management in 2026-27 increases by 6.2%, mainly due to salary increment and increased expenditure for filling vacancies in 2025-26. At the same time, 8 posts will be reduced. In this connection, would the Government inform this Committee of:

1. the percentage of salary increment on average;

2. the amount of and the reasons for the additional provision for full-year effect of vacancies filled in 2025-26; and

3. the reasons for reducing 8 posts despite an increase in aircraft movements, and the proportion of the number of staff affected in relation to the total staff.

Asked by: Hon FOK Kai-kong, Kenneth (LegCo internal reference no.: 23)

Reply:

1. For officers of the Civil Aviation Department (CAD) granted with an increment on their respective rank scales, the percentage of salary increment is about 1.05% on average.

2. The CAD commits to recruit and train more air traffic control staff to take up new posts and fill vacancies, so as to meet air traffic services demand and support the Three-Runway System operations. On Programme (3) Air Traffic Management, the estimate for 2026-27 is $37.4 million (6.2%) higher than the revised estimate for 2025-26. This is mainly due to the increased provision for salary increment and full-year effect of vacancies filled in 2025-26, partly offset by savings in operating expenses.

3. The Government has strictly controlled the civil service establishment. Since 2021-22, it has implemented the zero-growth policy in the overall civil service establishment, with the overall establishment controlled at a level not exceeding that as at end-March

2021. To tie in with the Government's Productivity Enhancement Programme and in order to optimise the use of manpower resources, the civil service establishment will be reduced by 2% each in 2026-27 and 2027-28. The CAD will continue to re-prioritise and re-deploy its work, streamline work processes and capitalise on technology solutions through adoption of management measures and digitalisation, with a view to enhancing efficiency and continue to deliver high-quality public services while the civil service is being streamlined.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0576)

Head: (28) Civil Aviation Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational expenses

Programme: (-) Not Specified

Controlling Officer: Director-General of Civil Aviation (Victor LIU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is shown in the document that the total estimate of the Civil Aviation Department (CAD) for 2026-27 is similar to that of the last financial year. The total estimate is $1.4688 billion, representing a slight decrease of 0.5% against the original estimate for 2025-26 (or an increase of 0.9% over the revised estimate). Meanwhile, the number of non-directorate posts on the establishment will be reduced from 908 to 892, a net decrease of 16 non-directorate posts (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary value). On the premise of ensuring proper use of public fund without affecting service efficiency, will the CAD inform this Committee of the following:

(a) How does the CAD explain that the overall expenditure does not decrease in proportion to the reduction in posts?

(b) Are the savings in staff costs fully offset by other expenditure items (such as salary increment, replacement of ageing equipment, etc.)? Please provide a detailed analysis and data to illustrate the impact of each factor on the budget changes.

Asked by: Hon NG Kam-wah, Webster (LegCo internal reference no.: 23)

Reply:

In line with the Government's overall initiative to reduce the size of the civil service establishment, the Civil Aviation Department (CAD) will reduce 16 non-directorate posts in 2026-27. Meanwhile, the CAD will continue to recruit staff to fill existing/anticipated vacancies in order to provide a safe, efficient and sustainable air transportation system and to support the Three-Runway System operations. As a result, personal emoluments and personnel-related expenditures for 2026-27 are $93.44 million (11.4%) higher than the revised estimate for 2025-26. This increase is offset by the savings from personal emoluments resulting from the reduction of posts. In addition, due to the increased requirement for replacement of ageing equipment and system, as well as the reduced operating expenses resulting from enhanced management measures to improve efficiency, the relevant estimates for 2026-27 represent an increase of $3.07 million (39.4%) and a decrease of $82.69 million (13.2%) respectively over the revised estimates for 2025-26. For the above reasons,

the CAD’s estimate for 2026-27 totalled $1.4688 billion, representing an increase of $13.82 million (0.9%) over the revised estimate for 2025-26.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0577)

Head: (28) Civil Aviation Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational expenses

Programme: (-) Not Specified

Controlling Officer: Director-General of Civil Aviation (Victor LIU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

A comparison of the estimates for 2026-27 with the revised estimates for 2025-26 across various programmes reveals significant difference in changes (for example, Programme (1) Flight Standards increases by 10.2% while Programme (4) Air Traffic Engineering Services decreases by 8.9%). Please explain in detail the specific reasons for the substantial increase or decrease in provision for each Programme. In particular for Programme (4) which shows the largest reduction in provision, will such reduction affect the maintenance and upgrading plans for the air navigation service equipment and thus pose potential risks to aviation safety and efficiency?

Asked by: Hon NG Kam-wah, Webster (LegCo internal reference no.: 24)

Reply:

The Civil Aviation Department (CAD) is committed to a safe, efficient and sustainable air transportation system and regularly reviews its operations, improves its services and flexibly deploys resources to enhance efficiency and ensure aviation safety.

Regarding Programmes (1) Flight Standards, (2) Airport Standards, (3) Air Traffic Management and (5) Air Services and Safety Management, the estimates for 2026-27 are higher than the revised estimates for 2025-26 by 3.2% to 10.2%. This is mainly due to the increased provision for salary increment and full-year effect of vacancies filled in 2025-26. On the other hand, the CAD reduces its operating expenses through enhanced utilisation of manpower resources, adoption of management measures and digitalisation, and streamlining of work processes and operations. On the estimate for 2026-27 for Programme (4) Air Traffic Engineering Services, the provision increased due to the abovementioned reasons and replacement of ageing equipment and system. However, the CAD continues its enhancement measures, which include refining management measures with contractors to enhance operational efficiency and service standards, bringing about savings in operational expenses that offset the increased provision under this Programme. This results in an 8.9% reduction in the estimate for 2026-27 as compared to the revised estimate for 2025-26. As regards Programme (6) Air Passenger Departure Tax Administration, the provision for 2026-27 is the same as the revised estimate for 2025-26.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 Reply Serial No.

TLB005

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0578)

Head: (28) Civil Aviation Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Flight Standards, (4) Air Traffic Engineering Services and (5) Air Services and Safety Management

Controlling Officer: Director-General of Civil Aviation (Victor LIU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned under Programmes (1), (4) and (5) that the Government will take forward initiatives in relation to the development of low-altitude economy, including the implementation of regulatory sandbox pilot projects and the study for unmanned aircraft system traffic management system.

a) How much provision in the 2026-27 Budget is specifically earmarked for the aforementioned projects and studies in relation to low-altitude economy?

b) How does the Department assess the cost-effectiveness of these pilot projects and infrastructure studies? Are there any key performance indicators in place to gauge their effectiveness (e.g. the number of new services facilitated, improvement made in airspace utilisation, etc.)?

Asked by: Hon NG Kam-wah, Webster (LegCo internal reference no.: 26)

Reply:

a) In 2026-27, the Civil Aviation Department (CAD) will continue to utilise its existing resources to implement the Regulatory Sandbox (Sandbox) and Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ (Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$) pilot projects as well as to study the unmanned aircraft system traffic management system. The CAD will continuously review the implementation progress of such work.

b) The Government announced the first batch of 38 Sandbox projects in March 2025. Currently, among the 38 pilot projects on the list, 32 have commenced testing within designated flight routes. Certain application scenarios that are relatively mature, involve lower risks and do not involve areas with high volumes of people or vehicles have been regularised (e.g. the use of unmanned aircraft for façade cleaning, and inspection of power lines and railway infrastructure).

In November 2025, the Government rolled out the advanced low-altitude economy (LAE) Sandbox χ pilot projects, covering unmanned aircraft system traffic management system demonstrations, unconventional aircraft, cross-boundary applications, multiple applications/users shared-platform and other application scenarios with higher technical complexity. The application period for the pilot projects closed on 28 February 2026. The response from the industry was overwhelming, with multiple applications received for each application scenario. The Working Group on Developing Low-altitude Economy is examining the applications in detail, aiming to roll out the pilot projects progressively for testing from the first half of this year.

The Government will make reference to the experience gathered from Sandbox and Sandbox χ projects, relevant data as well as the technical studies to formulate appropriate infrastructure, related supporting facilities, standards as well as laws and regulations for low-altitude flying activities in the long run. Relevant studies and planning are still underway. The Government will continue to carefully assess the demand and resource allocation, including ensuring the cost-effectiveness of the relevant arrangements.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0579)

Head: (28) Civil Aviation Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (-) Not Specified

Controlling Officer: Director-General of Civil Aviation (Victor LIU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

A number of performance indicators (e.g. the target working days for processing various types of applications and inspection frequencies) are set out in the document. Most of these indicators stay unchanged between 2024 and 2026 and are planned to remain so in 2026.

a) Against the background of overall staffing reduction, how does the Civil Aviation Department (CAD) ensure that all established performance targets can be met consistently? Are there any measures in place to prioritise services or enhance service efficiency?

b) Certain indicators (such as the number of local/overseas flight crew examination papers processed under Programme (1)) are estimated to lower significantly in 2026, with the reasons cited as "moderation of pilot recruitment exercises" and "relocation of training to Hong Kong". Has the CAD assessed the impact of this trend on the long-term human resource development of the local aviation sector? Will it lead to structural changes in the demand for related regulatory and examination personnel?

Asked by: Hon NG Kam-wah, Webster (LegCo internal reference no.: 27)

Reply:

Under the Government's overall initiative to reduce the size of the civil service establishment, the Civil Aviation Department (CAD) will continue to re-prioritise and re-deploy its work, streamline work processes and capitalise on technology solutions through adoption of management measures and digitalisation, with a view to enhancing efficiency. In so doing, the CAD can continue to deliver high-quality public services while the civil service is being streamlined. With the objective of promoting and supporting the development of the Hong Kong aviation industry and maintaining Hong Kong's status as an international aviation hub, the CAD will continue to maintain close liaison with local airlines to understand the industry's needs and make timely planning accordingly. Local airlines have been recruiting additional pilots continuously in the past few years. As these pilots are gradually completing their training and assessments and entering into service, the recruitment of pilots for local airlines

will gradually moderate. However, it is expected that the number of pilot in Hong Kong will remain generally stable in 2026.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2204)

Head: (28) Civil Aviation Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Flight Standards

Controlling Officer: Director-General of Civil Aviation (Victor LIU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

As regards the progress of the low-altitude economy (LAE) regulatory sandbox projects, will the Government inform this Committee:

1. of the government expenditure incurred for the 32 projects that have conducted trials along their designated routes under the first cohort of the Regulatory Sandbox;
2. whether the progress of the LAE regulatory sandbox projects is in line with the Government's expectation; whether there has been any delay; if so, of the reasons therefor;
3. given that the projects launched under the first cohort of Regulatory Sandbox cover a wide range of fields and application scenarios, including emergency and rescue, logistics and distribution, maintenance and safety inspection, surveillance and low-altitude infrastructure, whether the Government will draw up a concrete timetable for formulating rules and procedures for various industries to apply for formal commercial operations under LAE; and
4. as it is mentioned in the Budget Speech that trial projects such as unmanned aircraft system traffic management system, multiple applications/users shared-platforms, cross-boundary routes and passenger-carrying flying aircraft will be rolled out in phases from the first half of this year, and that the Government is also actively exploring with the Mainland to commerce trial flights on cross-boundary logistics, of the details and specific estimated expenditure on each of these applications and cross-boundary logistics trial flights, as well as the specific coordination work and schedule?

Asked by: Hon QUAT Elizabeth (LegCo internal reference no.: 18)

Reply:

1. The General Conditions of the Regulatory Sandbox (Sandbox) stipulate that any costs in preparing the applications and conducting the trials will be borne by the pilot project applicants through their self-arranged financial and/or other funding sources. At present, the Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB) and the Civil Aviation Department (CAD) will continue to utilise their existing resources to implement the Sandbox and

Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ (Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$) projects, as well as other work related to the development of low-altitude economy (LAE).

2. & 4.

The Government announced the first batch of 38 Sandbox projects in March 2025. Currently, among the 38 pilot projects on the list, 32 have commenced testing within designated flight routes. Certain application scenarios that are relatively mature, involve lower risks and do not involve areas with high volumes of people or vehicles have been regularised (e.g. the use of unmanned aircraft for façade cleaning, and inspection of power lines and railway infrastructure).

In November 2025, the Government rolled out the advanced LAE Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ pilot projects, covering unmanned aircraft system traffic management system demonstrations, unconventional aircraft, cross-boundary applications, multiple applications/users shared-platform and other application scenarios with higher technical complexity. The application period for the pilot projects closed on 28 February 2026. The response from the industry was overwhelming, with multiple applications received for each application scenario. The Working Group on Developing Low-altitude Economy (WG) is examining the applications in detail, aiming to roll out the pilot projects progressively for testing from the first half of this year. At present, the TLB and the CAD will continue to utilise their existing resources to undertake the work related to Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ projects.

To sum up, the work related to Sandbox and Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ projects is progressing in an orderly manner, enabling the Government to collect data to validate the feasibility of various application scenarios.

3. The WG will draft the Action Plan on Developing Low-Altitude Economy this year, with a view to building an internationally competitive LAE ecosystem and propelling Hong Kong as an Asia-Pacific hub for innovative low-altitude applications. The Government will make reference to the experience gathered from Sandbox and Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ projects, relevant data as well as the technical studies to formulate appropriate infrastructure, related supporting facilities, standards as well as laws and regulations for low-altitude flying activities in the long run. Relevant studies and planning are still underway.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0226)

Head: (28) Civil Aviation Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air Traffic Management

Controlling Officer: Director-General of Civil Aviation (Victor LIU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

In Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27, it is stated that the Civil Aviation Department (CAD) will recruit and train more air traffic control (ATC) staff to meet air traffic services demand and support the Three-Runway System (3RS) operations. What are the staffing establishment, expenditure, and scope of work involved? Are the relevant posts permanent or temporary?

Asked by: Hon YAO Cho-fai, Andrew (LegCo internal reference no.: 38)

Reply:

To meet the growth in air traffic volume brought about by the 3RS operations and the increasing demand for air traffic services, the Civil Aviation Department (CAD) will recruit and train more ATC staff to fill new posts and existing/anticipated vacancies. In 2026-27, the CAD will continue to recruit staff, with plans to hire about 25 Air Traffic Control Officers (ATCOs) III / Student Air Traffic Control Officers. Newly recruited ATCOs will receive relevant ATC training as required and in accordance with induction arrangements, including theories and practical exercises in the simulators and on-the-job training in the real operational environment under the supervision of qualified controllers. Upon successful completion of all relevant required training and assessments, these officers will be deployed to their positions. These are permanent posts. The total staff cost of these posts in terms of notional annual mid-point salary value is about $14.45 million.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2738)

Head: (42) Electrical and Mechanical Services Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Mechanical Installations Safety

Controlling Officer: Director of Electrical and Mechanical Services (POON Kwok-ying)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the Registration Scheme for Vehicle Maintenance, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) The below information on the Voluntary Registration Scheme for Vehicle Maintenance Workshops in each of the recent 2 years and this year to date (with the yearly figures set out in table form):
   (i) the number of vehicle maintenance workshops (VMWs) newly registered and those with registration renewed, broken down by maintenance service scope (i.e. internal combustion engine vehicle, electric vehicle (elementary), electric vehicle (low voltage), and electric vehicle (high voltage));
   (ii) the total number of registered VMWs and its percentage in the overall number of VMWs in Hong Kong;
   (iii) the number of inspections of registered VMWs conducted by Government staff;
   (iv) the number of complaint cases against registered VMWs received; and
   (v) the number of cases in which a VMW's registration was revoked due to proven serious non-compliance.

(2) The below information on the Voluntary Registration Scheme for Vehicle Mechanics in each of the recent 2 years and this year to date since its launch (with the yearly figures set out in table form):
   (i) the number of vehicle mechanics (VMs) newly registered and those with registration renewed, broken down by registration class;
   (ii) the total number of registered VMs;
   (iii) the number of complaint cases against registered VMs received; and
   (iv) the number of cases in which a mechanic's registration was revoked due to proven serious non-compliance.

(3) It is mentioned in the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 that the Government will "examine the feasibility and formulate proposals on introducing a mandatory registration scheme for vehicle mechanics and vehicle maintenance workshops". What is the Government's direction of study and its progress at present?

Will the Government consider setting an implementation timetable; if so, what are the details; if not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon CHAU Siu-chung (LegCo internal reference no.: 30)

Reply:

(1) Voluntary Registration Scheme for Vehicle Maintenance Workshops (VRSVMW)

(i) The registration of a vehicle maintenance workshop (VMW) is valid for 3 years. Currently, the service scope of registered vehicle maintenance workshops (RVMWs) is divided into 4 categories: internal combustion engine vehicle (IC), internal combustion engine vehicle and electric vehicle (elementary) (IC & EVE), internal combustion engine vehicle and electric vehicle (low voltage) (IC & EVL), and internal combustion engine vehicle and electric vehicle (high voltage) (IC & EVH). In each of the recent 2 years and the first 2 months this year, the numbers of VMWs with valid registration, and those with their registration renewed and those newly registered, broken down by maintenance service scope are tabulated as follows:

Year	(A) Number of VMWs with valid registration	(B) Number of VMWs with registration renewed and those newly registered (by maintenance service scope)				Total number of RVMWs (A+B)
		IC	IC & EVE	IC & EVL	IC & EVH	
2024	1 381	462	5	67	8	1 923
2025	1 146	575	16	73	11	1 821
2026 (As at February)	1 781	23	2	5	0	1 811

(ii) As at February 2026, the number of RVMWs was 1 811, accounting for about 81% of the total number of VMWs (2 228).

(iii) In the recent 2 years and the first 2 months this year, the number of inspections of RVMWs conducted by the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department (EMSD) is tabulated as follows[1]:

Year	Number of inspections of RVMWs
2024	1 974
2025	1 838
2026 (As at February)	128

[1] Other departments will also inspect VMWs in accordance with their respective scope of work.

(iv) In the recent 2 years and the first 2 months this year, the number of complaint cases involving RVMWs received by the EMSD is as follows:

Year	Number of complaint cases involving RVMWs
2024	1
2025	1
2026 (As at February)	0

(v) In the recent 2 years and the first 2 months this year, the number of cases in which a VMW's registration was revoked due to proven serious non-compliance is as follows:

Year	Number of cases in which a VMW's registration was revoked
2024	0
2025	4
2026 (As at February)	1

(2) Voluntary Registration Scheme for Vehicle Mechanics (VRSVM)

(i) The registration of a vehicle mechanic (VM) is valid for 3 years. Mechanics may choose to register for multiple maintenance service classes, covering mechanical, electrical, body repair, body painting, motorcycle maintenance, tyre work, battery (24V) work, lubrication work, car accessories work, air-conditioning work and body building work. In the recent 2 years and the first 2 months this year, the numbers of VMs with registration renewed and those newly registered, broken down by maintenance service class are tabulated in the **Annex;** and the total numbers of VMs with valid registration, those with registration renewed and those newly registered are tabulated as follows:

Year	(A) Number of VMs with valid registration	(B) Number of VMs with registration renewed and those newly registered	Total number of registered vehicle mechanics (RVMs) (A+B)
2024	5 363	2 035	7 398
2025	5 530	1 889	7 419
2026 (As at February)	7 123	242	7 365

(ii) As at February 2026, the number of RVMs was 7 365.

(iii) In the recent 2 years and the first 2 months this year, the number of complaint cases involving RVMs received by the EMSD is as follows:

Year	Number of complaint cases involving RVMs
2024	1
2025	0
2026 (As at February)	0

(iv) In the recent 2 years and the first 2 months this year, there was no record of cases in which a VM's registration was revoked due to proven serious non-compliance.

(3) The Government is drawing on the practices of other jurisdictions to progressively refine the existing registration arrangements for electric vehicle maintenance services under the VRSVM and VRSVMW, at the same time exploring ways to implement a mandatory registration scheme, which will also involve a study on the amendment of relevant legislation. In addition, the Government will maintain close collaboration with the Vehicle Maintenance Technical Advisory Committee (VMTAC) to support the vehicle maintenance industry in keeping pace with the times and attracting new talent to the industry, in a bid to ensure the sustainable and healthy development of the trade, and minimise policy impact on the trade and practitioners. Comprising members from sectors like industry organisations, professional bodies and training institutes, the VMTAC provides the Government with appropriate and professional advice. The Government will announce the proposed plan and timetable for the mandatory registration scheme in due course.

Annex

The numbers of VMs with registration renewed and those newly registered,
broken down by maintenance service class
in the recent 2 years and the first 2 months this year

Year	Numbers of VMs with registration renewed and those newly registered (by maintenance service class)										
	Mechanical	Electrical	Body repair	Body painting	Motorcycle maintenance	Tyre work	Battery (24V) work	Lubrication work	Car accessories work	Air-conditioning work	Body building work
2024	1 775	394	213	97	52	121	123	139	163	71	7
2025	1 425	273	154	58	43	56	59	88	86	42	3
2026 (As at February)	167	31	16	14	4	4	3	7	7	2	1

Remark: Mechanics may choose to register for multiple maintenance service classes

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0974)

Head: (42) Electrical and Mechanical Services Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Mechanical Installations Safety

Controlling Officer: Director of Electrical and Mechanical Services (POON Kwok-ying)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Electrical and Mechanical Services Department is responsible for monitoring the safety performance of electrical and mechanical (E&M) systems of the railway service provided by the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL). In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of:

1. the total expenditures for monitoring the E&M safety of the MTRCL's railway systems in the past 3 years, with a breakdown of the expenditure by category;

2. the number of safety hazards identified in the MTR network and the total number of improvement notices issued in relation to the safety issues of the MTRCL in each of the past 3 years; and

3. whether the Government will consider increasing expenditure on the regulation of the MTRCL in the light of the numerous incidents that have occurred in the MTR network in recent years to reduce their occurrence; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons?

Asked by: Hon CHEUNG Pui-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 19)

Reply:

1. The Railways Branch (RB) of the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department (EMSD), in accordance with relevant ordinances on railway safety, is responsible for regulating and monitoring the safe operation of railway systems, including those operated by the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL), the Automated People Mover at the Hong Kong International Airport operated by the Airport Authority Hong Kong, the tramway system operated by the Hong Kong Tramways Limited and the peak tramway system operated by the Peak Tramways Company Limited.

   The total expenditures of the RB of the EMSD in the past 3 years are set out in the following table:

	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26 (Estimate)
Salaries	71.8	75.5	71.4
Other operating expenses	15.3	16.3	16.3
Total expenditure ($ million)	87.1	91.8*	87.7^

* The increase in the total expenditure in 2024-25 compared with that in 2023-24 was mainly due to the 2024-25 civil service pay adjustment and an increase in salary expenses for staff on pre-retirement leave.

^ The decrease in the estimated total expenditure in 2025-26 was mainly due to a reduction in salary expenses for staff on pre-retirement leave.

2. The EMSD always adopts a "risk-based" approach to inspections, which involve inspecting, checking and assessing areas that may pose a higher risk to the safe operation of the railway based on past records. These include regular inspections, surprise checks and incident investigations. The EMSD will also conduct the "comprehensive and direct assessment" exercises, which involve taking the initiative to audit the assets and safety management systems of MTRCL's operating railway lines, with a view to identifying potential problems at an early stage. If any problems or areas for improvement are identified during inspections and audits, the EMSD will immediately request the MTRCL to follow up and make improvement recommendations, and will monitor the progress of the MTRCL in implementing the improvement recommendations.

   In the past 3 years, the EMSD identified a total of 226 items that required follow-up actions during the "comprehensive and direct assessment" exercises. Besides, 6 items that required immediate follow-up were identified during the audits in 2025, mainly involving the maintenance of electrical systems and overhead lines. The EMSD immediately required the MTRCL to take follow-up action and proposed 11 improvement recommendations. Currently, the 6 items have been properly addressed to ensure railway safety, and the relevant improvement recommendations are being gradually implemented.

3. In 2025, the MTRCL operated more than 1.85 million train trips on its heavy rail network, making an average of over 4.7 million passenger trips every day. The level of both train service delivery and passenger journeys on time was maintained at a high standard of 99.9%. In 2025, there were 83 incidents of service disruption of 8 minutes or above due to factors under the MTRCL's control, a figure lower than that in 2024 (89 incidents). Nevertheless, the Government attaches great importance to every incident and will require the MTRCL to conduct thorough investigations to identify the causes, and to implement improvement measures to prevent occurrence of similar incidents, thereby ensuring safe and reliable railway operation. As the statutory regulatory authority on railway safety, the EMSD carries out railway safety regulatory work in accordance with the Mass Transit Railway Ordinance (Cap. 556), the Mass Transit Railway Regulations (Cap. 556A) and other relevant legislation. Apart from conducting investigations after incidents, the EMSD has adopted a more proactive, comprehensive and preventive auditing approach to establish a regulatory regime for major railway systems. This includes identifying at an early stage potential system defects and safety hazards in the railway system that may lead to railway incidents through the "comprehensive and direct assessment" exercises, thereby nipping problems

in the bud. In addition, the EMSD will enhance the long-term railway safety of projects by conducting the "project safety review" process in new railway projects.

The RB of the EMSD is led by 1 Assistant Director/Railways, who oversees 4 divisions headed by 4 Chief Engineers (CE) responsible for railway safety regulatory work. Of the 4 CE posts, 2 are time-limited posts created in 2021 and were granted approval in 2025 for an extension of 5 years until 2030 to strengthen the regular and continuous safety regulation of railway services. The EMSD will continue to utilise existing resources to step up the review of the major railway systems of the MTRCL's operating lines, and apply innovative technologies to enhance its capabilities in monitoring the railway services and asset maintenance performance, thereby ensuring railway safety.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3028)

Head: (42) Electrical and Mechanical Services Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Mechanical Installations Safety

Controlling Officer: Director of Electrical and Mechanical Services (POON Kwok-ying)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding manpower and workshops for vehicle maintenance, will the Government inform this Committee of:

(1) the current total number of vehicle mechanics (VMs) in Hong Kong and, among them, the number and proportion of VMs participating in the Voluntary Registration Scheme for Vehicle Mechanics (VRSVM);
(2) the numbers of VMs who have attained qualifications in electric vehicle (EV) maintenance service scope at the elementary, low voltage and high voltage levels to date, given that the Government has added such service scope to the VRSVM;
(3) the current total number of vehicle maintenance workshops (VMWs) in Hong Kong and, among them, the number and proportion of VMWs participating in the Voluntary Registration Scheme for Vehicle Maintenance Workshops (VRSVMW); the current number of registered EV maintenance workshops, with a breakdown by the workshop level;
(4) whether the Government will make the voluntary registration systems for VMs and VMWs mandatory to better ensure maintenance safety, given that there are views reflecting that EV maintenance involves substantial electrical and mechanical operations; if so, the details; if not, the reasons; and
(5) whether the Government has assessed the numbers of EV mechanics and workshops required for Hong Kong in the next 5 years, as the demand for EV maintenance is expected to rise continuously in the future given the increasing number of EVs?

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 16)

Reply:

(1) As at February 2026, the number of registered vehicle mechanics (RVMs) was 7 365, accounting for about 79% of the total number of vehicle mechanics (VMs) (9 338).

(2) As at February 2026, a total of 1 302 RVMs successfully attained qualifications in electric vehicle (EV) maintenance service scope, including 270 EV (elementary) (EVE) mechanics, 387 EV (low voltage) (EVL) mechanics and 645 EV (high voltage) (EVH) mechanics.

(3) As at February 2026, the number of registered vehicle maintenance workshops (RVMWs) was 1 811, accounting for about 81% of the total number of vehicle maintenance workshops (VMWs) (2 228). A total of 146 RVMWs successfully registered the additional EV maintenance service scope, including 21 EVE Workshops, 106 EVL Workshops and 19 EVH Workshops .

(4) Drawing on the practices of other jurisdictions, the Government continuously enriches the EV maintenance service registration arrangements under the existing Voluntary Registration Scheme for Vehicle Mechanics and Voluntary Registration Scheme for Vehicle Maintenance Workshops (collectively known as the voluntary registration schemes), in order to align with market development. At the same time, the Government is exploring ways to implement a mandatory registration scheme, which also involves a study on the amendments to relevant legislation. Additionally, the Government works closely with the Vehicle Maintenance Technical Advisory Committee (VMTAC) to support the vehicle maintenance industry in keeping pace with the times and attracting new talent to the industry, in a bid to ensure the sustainable and healthy development of the trade. Comprising members from sectors like industry organisations, professional bodies and training institutes, the VMTAC provides the Government with appropriate and professional advice. The Government will announce the proposed plan and timetable for the mandatory registration scheme in due course.

(5) As the market demand for EV maintenance rises, the Government and the VMTAC are encouraging more VMs to receive EV maintenance training to enhance their skills and register voluntarily. Currently, the VMTAC has recognised a total of 10 EV maintenance training courses offered by 6 institutes and colleges. It is expected that they can meet the growing demand for training in the market, while more VMs and VMWs will attain the qualifications for EV maintenance. The Government and the VMTAC will closely monitor the situation in the trade to continuously make appropriate plans and support industry development.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3187)

Head: (42) Electrical and Mechanical Services Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (2) Mechanical Installations Safety

Controlling Officer: Director of Electrical and Mechanical Services (POON Kwok-ying)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 under Programme (2) in the Controlling Officer's Report of the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department (EMSD) include monitoring the safety performance of railway service provided by the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL). In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of:

(a) the number of service disruption incidents on various railway lines of the MTRCL in the past 3 years and, for each incident, the date and time, the affected sections, the causes, the duration between detection of the incident and completion of the recovery work, the longest headway during the period of limited service (if applicable), the estimated number of passengers affected, and the amounts required to be set aside under the Service Performance Rebate (set out in table format);

(b) the number of escalator and lift failures at each MTR station in the past 3 years and, for each failure, the date and time, the causes, whether there were any persons injured, and the duration for which the service of the lifts/escalators concerned was suspended;

(c) the number of escalator and lift replacement projects conducted by the MTRCL in the past 3 years and planned for 2026 as scheduled, and for each project, the location, the commencement date and the completion date;

(d) the staffing establishment, the salaries, and the operating and equipment expenses involved in monitoring the MTRCL's safety by the Railways Branch of the EMSD in 2024-25 and the estimated figures for 2026-27; and how the EMSD ensures that the monitoring work of the MTRCL's safety will not be affected, given that the estimated provision for this programme in 2026-27 will be drastically reduced by 37% to $647 million, compared to the revised estimate for 2025-26;

(e) the respective numbers of inspections conducted at the MTRCL and issues identified by the EMSD in 2025; and the follow-up measures taken by the EMSD in respect of the issues identified during the inspections; and

(f) whether the EMSD has kept records of the MTRCL's maintenance expenditure, and the respective numbers of maintenance staff employed by the MTRCL on a long-term basis, contract basis, outsourced basis, and substitute basis in the past 3 years; and how the EMSD ensures the professionalism of outsourced and substitute workers to prevent varying quality of maintenance that indirectly increases the likelihood of incidents?

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 38)

Reply:

(a) In 2025, the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) operated more than 1.85 million train trips on its heavy rail network, making an average of over 4.7 million passenger trips every day. The level of both train service delivery and passenger journeys on-time was maintained at a high standard of 99.9%. The number of incidents resulting in service disruption due to factors under the MTRCL's control, the causes and the amounts set aside by the MTRCL under the enhanced Service Performance Rebate arrangement in the past 3 years are set out in **Annex 1**. As for the number of passengers affected by each of the service disruption incidents, the MTRCL does not keep the relevant statistical data.

(b) The details of lift and escalator incidents reported by the MTRCL to the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department (EMSD) in accordance with the Lifts and Escalators Ordinance (LEO) in the past 3 years are set out in the following table:

Equipment	Date	Location	Cause of failure	Number of persons injured
Escalator	7 June 2023	Kowloon Tong Station	Emergency stop of an escalator due to poor contact in the control circuit, resulting in passenger injuries	1
	15 October 2023	Yau Ma Tei Station	Emergency stop of an escalator due to poor contact in the control circuit, resulting in passenger injuries	1
	4 May 2024	Tuen Mun Station	Smouldering of a component in the escalator's braking device due to poor adjustment of such device	0
	22 February 2025	HKU Station	Steel wires protruding from the surface of an escalator handrail, scratching a	1

			passenger's right hand while holding the handrail	
	29 July 2025	Fanling Station	Unsynchronised handrail and steps of an escalator due to insufficient tension in its handrail belt, resulting in passenger injuries	1
Lift	28 September 2025	Jordan Station	Passenger entrapment in a lift due to malfunction of an electrical component	0

Note: Under the LEO, responsible persons for lifts or escalators are required to report incidents involving major component failures of lifts or escalators to the EMSD. As for other minor components failures, such as those arising from improper use by passengers or by external objects, the registered contractors will record the incidents in their log-book and need not report them to the EMSD.

The duration for which the service of a lift or escalator is suspended due to a failure is not a required item for submission under the LEO, and thus the EMSD does not maintain such information.

(c) According to the information provided by the MTRCL, replacement projects for 26 escalators and 34 lifts across 32 stations on the Tsuen Wan Line, Kwun Tong Line, Island Line, and the Airport Express / Tung Chung Line were conducted between 2023 and 2025. The replacement project for each escalator or lift generally takes 6 to 8 months. As at the end of 2025, about 90% of these replacement projects were completed. The MTRCL plans to further replace 8 escalators and 3 lifts across 5 stations on the Kwun Tong Line, Tseung Kwan O Line, Tuen Ma Line, and Disneyland Resort Line in 2026.

(d) In Programme (2) – Mechanical Installations Safety, the provisions for 2026-27 is around $380 million (about 37%) lower than the revised estimate for 2025-26. This is mainly due to the decreased cash flow requirement of around $380 million for the Lift Modernisation Subsidy Scheme following the completion of granting approval for the majority of applicants by 2025-26.

The Railways Branch (RB) of the EMSD, in accordance with relevant ordinances on railway safety, is responsible for regulating and monitoring the safe operation of railway systems, including those operated by the MTRCL, the Automated People Mover at the Hong Kong International Airport operated by the Airport Authority Hong Kong, the tramway system operated by the Hong Kong Tramways Limited and the peak tramway system operated by the Peak Tramways Company Limited. The establishment of the RB of the EMSD in 2024-25 and 2025-26, and its estimated staffing establishment in 2026-27 are set out below:

Rank	2024-25	2025-26	2026-27 (Estimate)
Assistant Director	1	1	1
Chief Engineer	4*	4*	4*
Senior Engineer	15	15	15
Engineer	28	28	28
Inspector	4	4	4

* 2 Chief Engineer posts, which are time-limited directorate posts created in July 2021, were granted approval in 2025 for an extension of 5 years until 2030.

The total expenditure of the RB of the EMSD in 2024-25, and its estimated total expenditures in 2025-26 and 2026-27 are set out in the following table:

	2024-25	2025-26 (Estimate)	2026-27 (Estimate)
Salaries	75.5	71.4	71.4
Other operating expenses	16.3	16.3	12.5
Expenditure ($ million)	91.8	87.7^	83.9*

^ The decrease in the estimated total expenditure in 2025-26 was mainly due to a reduction in salary expenses for staff on pre-retirement leave.

* The decrease in the estimated total expenditure in 2026-27 is mainly due to a reduction in the required provision for operating expenses.

The RB of the EMSD will continue to utilise existing resources to review the major railway systems of the MTRCL's operating lines on an on-going basis, and apply innovative technologies to enhance its capabilities in monitoring the railway services and asset maintenance performance, thereby ensuring railway safety.

(e) In 2025, the EMSD conducted 499 inspections of railway facilities/systems, including 463 inspections of the MTRCL. The EMSD always adopts a "risk-based" approach to inspections, which involve inspecting, checking and assessing areas that may pose a higher risk to the safe operation of the railway based on past records. These include regular inspections, surprise checks and incident investigations. The EMSD will also conduct the "comprehensive and direct assessment" exercises, which involve taking the initiative to audit the assets and safety management systems of MTRCL's operating railway lines, with a view to identifying potential problems at an early stage. The EMSD made 86 improvement recommendations on 52 items that required follow-up actions to the MTRCL during the "comprehensive and direct assessment" exercises in 2025.

If any problems or areas for improvement are identified during inspections and audits, the EMSD will immediately request the MTRCL to follow up and make improvement recommendations, and will monitor the progress of the MTRCL in implementing the improvement recommendations through regular meetings and on-site inspections.

(f) The MTRCL has all along adopted a maintenance regime that meets international standards, and made its human resources arrangements based on maintenance needs.

Currently, the MTRCL's outsourced work primarily involves processes that are relatively repetitive and less technically demanding. Additionally, the MTRCL will arrange for qualified outsourced personnel possessing the necessary licences or registration to perform relevant work in accordance with statutory and regulatory requirements. These workers from contractors are required to undergo specific maintenance procedures and standard training provided by the MTRCL, and shall follow the same procedures and guidelines as MTRCL staff when carrying out maintenance work. Besides, MTRCL internal staff shall take charge of supervising the contractors to ensure that the maintenance work performed by outsourced workers and term workers complies with the safety and quality standards set by the MTRCL. The EMSD is responsible for regulating the safety of railway operations. Regardless of whether the railway systems and equipment are maintained by the MTRCL or its outsourced contractors, the EMSD will monitor them based on the same standards.

According to the information provided by the MTRCL, the establishment of maintenance staff for the MTRCL's heavy rail and light rail systems in the past 3 years (as at 31 December of each year) was 5 839 (2023), 6 261 (2024) and 6 356 (2025) respectively.

The MTRCL will also temporarily fill staff vacancies through various arrangements, including arranging term workers to assist in maintenance work under the supervision of MTRCL staff. The actual numbers of term workers engaged in the past 3 years (as at 31 December of each year) were 432 (2023), 424 (2024) and 433 (2025) respectively.

The MTRCL has not provided a breakdown of its maintenance expenditure.

Annex 1

Numbers of Incidents Resulting in Service Disruption of 8 Minutes or Above due to Factors under the MTRCL's Control

Kwun Tong Line

Year	Number	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) Note 3
				Half an hour or less Note 1		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure Note 2	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	17	17	0	15	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	2
2024	12	11	1	10	1	1	0	0	0	0	0	1
2025	4	3	1	3	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Tsuen Wan Line

Year	Number	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) Note 3
				Half an hour or less Note 1		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure Note 2	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	8	8	0	7	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	1
2024	10	10	0	9	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	1
2025	11	11	0	11	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Island Line

Year	Number	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) Note 3
				Half an hour or less Note 1		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure Note 2	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	5	5	0	4	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	1
2024	10	8	2	7	2	1	0	0	0	0	0	1
2025	5	5	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Tseung Kwan O Line

Year	Number	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) Note 3
				Half an hour or less Note 1		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure Note 2	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	6	6	0	4	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	3
2024	12	10	2	10	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2025	10	10	0	9	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	19.2

South Island Line

Year	Number	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) Note 3
				Half an hour or less Note 1		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure Note 2	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	1	1	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2024	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2025	4	4	0	3	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	1

East Rail Line

Year	Number	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) Note 3
				Half an hour or less Note 1		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure Note 2	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	13	13	0	13	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2024	11	11	0	11	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2025	12	11	1	9	1	2	0	0	0	0	0	2

Tuen Ma Line

Year	Number	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) Note 3
				Half an hour or less Note 1		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure Note 2	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	18	18	0	18	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2024	6	6	0	5	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	1
2025	10	10	0	7	0	3	0	0	0	0	0	3

Tung Chung Line

Year	Number	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) Note 3
				Half an hour or less Note 1		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure Note 2	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	10	8	2	7	2	1	0	0	0	0	0	1
2024	11	10	1	9	1	1	0	0	0	0	0	1.2
2025	6	6	0	4	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	2

Disneyland Resort Line

Year	Number	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) Note 3
				Half an hour or less Note 1		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure Note 2	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2024	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2025	1	1	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Airport Express

Year	Number	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) Note 3
				Half an hour or less Note 1		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure Note 2	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	5	4	1	4	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2024	7	7	0	7	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2025	9	7	2	7	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Light Rail

Year	Number	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) Note 3
				Half an hour or less Note 1		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure Note 2	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	18	14	4	13	2	1	1	0	0	0	1	17
2024	10	9	1	9	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2025	11	8	3	8	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Note 1： According to the existing railway incident reporting mechanism, the MTRCL is required to notify the Transport Department (TD) within 8 minutes of any railway incident which has caused train service disruption of 8 minutes or is expected to cause disruption of 8 minutes or more. For service disruption of less than 8 minutes, the impact on passengers is comparatively minimal and the MTRCL is not required to notify the TD. Hence, the TD does not have the number of incidents with service disruption of less than 8 minutes.

Note 2： Equipment failure includes station equipment failure, infrastructure failure, rolling stock failure, etc.

Note 3： After the review of 2023 Fare Adjustment Mechanism, there is an increase in the amount to be set aside for incidents that cause disruptions of more than 3 hours and the maximum amount to be set aside per incident, as well as an introduction of a peak hour multiplier under the Service Performance Rebate.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1492)

Head: (42) Electrical and Mechanical Services Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Mechanical Installations Safety

Controlling Officer: Director of Electrical and Mechanical Services (POON Kwok-ying)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

In recent years, the railway systems in Hong Kong have experienced frequent failures, including signalling faults, equipment damage and power issues; any reduction in inspections may exacerbate existing hazards. However, as set out under Indicators, the estimated number of inspections for railway facilities/systems in 2026 is 485, representing a decrease of 14 compared to 499 in 2025. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

a) What was the distribution of the MTR lines or stations inspected in 2025? Will it be the same in 2026? If no, what are the details?

b) In how many of the 499 inspections in 2025 were actual problems identified? What were the major problems and how were they followed up?

c) Will the reduction in the number of inspections in 2026 increase the risks arising from the above problems, such as escalating into more serious incidents, or causing derailments or collisions during peak hours, thereby threatening passenger safety? If yes, are there any remedial or preventive measures in place? If no, what are the reasons?

d) Regarding the 4 requests proposed by the Chief Executive last year to prevent incidents in the MTR system, how has the Department strengthened collaboration with or assistance to the MTR Corporation Limited in enhancing overall safety standards and risk monitoring and assessment capabilities? What are the details?

Asked by: Hon TANG Ming-sum, Michelle (LegCo internal reference no.: 35)

Reply:

In 2025, the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) operated more than 1.85 million train trips on its heavy rail network, making an average of over 4.7 million passenger trips every day. The level of both train service delivery and passenger journeys on time was maintained at a high standard of 99.9%. In 2025, there were 83 incidents of service disruption of 8 minutes or above due to factors under the MTRCL's control, a figure lower than that in 2024

(89 incidents). Nevertheless, the Government attaches great importance to every incident and will require the MTRCL to conduct thorough investigations to identify the causes, and to implement improvement measures to prevent occurrence of similar incidents, thereby ensuring safe and reliable railway operation. Our reply to various parts of the question is as follows:

a) and b) The Railways Branch of the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department (EMSD) always adopts a "risk-based" approach to inspections, which involve inspecting, checking and assessing areas that may pose a higher risk to the safe operation of the railway based on past records. These include regular inspections, surprise checks and incident investigations. The EMSD will also conduct the "comprehensive and direct assessment" exercises, which involve taking the initiative to audit the assets and safety management systems of MTRCL's operating railway lines, with a view to identifying potential problems at an early stage. In 2025, the EMSD conducted 499 inspections of railway facilities/systems, including 463 inspections of the MTRCL covering trains, power supply system, permanent way, signalling system, station facilities and maintenance depot on various railway lines, and the new railway projects. The number of inspections is tabulated by railway line below. The EMSD will schedule inspections based on the latest risk assessment results, and adjust inspection routes and facilities to be inspected in a timely manner.

Railway line	**Island Line**	**Kwun Tong Line**	**Tsuen Wan Line**	**Tseung Kwan O Line**	**East Rail Line**	**Tuen Ma Line**	**Airport Express Line/ Tung Chung Line/ Disneyland Resort Line**	**Light Rail Line**	**South Island Line**	**High Speed Rail Line**	**New railway project**
Number of inspections	32	39	78	34	58	39	43	26	24	53	37

In 2025, the problems identified by the EMSD during inspections and audits involved equipment failure, human error and a lack of proper maintenance procedures. Among these, during the "comprehensive and direct assessment" exercises, a total of 52 items that required follow-up actions were identified across MTRCL's operating lines, 6 of which required immediate follow-up, mainly involving the maintenance of electrical systems and overhead lines. The EMSD immediately required the MTRCL to take follow-up action and proposed 11 improvement recommendations. Currently, these 6 items have been properly addressed to ensure railway safety, and the relevant improvement recommendations are being gradually implemented.

c) The number of inspections for railway facilities/systems in 2025 (499 inspections) was relatively higher than that in the previous 2 years (478 and 455 inspections in 2023 and 2024 respectively). This was due to additional inspections required following 3 major railway incidents that occurred in February, April and May 2025. If these additional inspections are excluded, the estimated number of inspections for 2026 (485 inspections) will be generally comparable to that in 2025. Should an increase in the risks associated with systems and equipment on individual lines be detected, the EMSD will timely adjust the inspection strategy, including increasing

the frequency of inspections on relevant lines, expanding the scope of checks, and conducting more in-depth reviews of specific facilities, for early identification of potential problems and immediate follow-up to prevent incidents.

d) As the statutory regulatory authority on railway safety, the EMSD has been closely monitoring the safety of MTRCL's railway systems and has urged the MTRCL to address potential issues before they arise by improving the safety standards of its railway systems. At the Government's request, the MTRCL formulated a follow-up plan on incident prevention and handling in June 2025. The plan covers an immediate one-off targeted and special inspection of critical assets and a series of mid- to long-term measures. They include strengthening the monitoring and risk management of railway assets to enhance the overall resilience of the railway network; formulating contingency plans for extreme scenarios, and reinforcing drills and training with different scenarios to strengthen the decision-making and execution capabilities of MTR staff during incidents; and enhancing arrangements for free shuttle bus services during incidents, strengthening information dissemination, such as updates on incident recovery progress and suggestions on alternative routes, to facilitate the public in journey planning according to the latest situation, and rallying community support for affected passengers. The Government has kept a close eye on the progress, implementation and effectiveness of various follow-up actions taken by the MTRCL.

Regarding short-term measures, the MTRCL has completed the one-off special inspection of critical assets, including overhead lines and signalling points, and rectified the issues identified. To enhance readiness to manage incidents of scale, the MTRCL has established a drill management system to standardise the procedures for formulating drill plans and the mechanisms for post-drill assessment. The first mega joint community drill was successfully held on the Tseung Kwan O Line in December 2025. During the drill, the EMSD incorporated scenarios involving equipment failure to strengthen emergency response training of frontline staff, and provided improvement recommendations on the spot. Such drills will be held regularly to continuously enhance the MTRCL's emergency response capabilities. As for the application of innovation and technology (I&T), the MTRCL has deployed technologies on some of the railway lines to monitor in real time the health conditions of systems, including trains, overhead lines, permanent way and signalling points. The EMSD is actively supervising and guiding the MTRCL to accelerate the application of I&T to achieve data-driven asset management and strengthen risk prediction and mitigation.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0262)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Capital Projects

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

In recent years, the construction industry in Hong Kong has faced a contraction in workload. The construction sector's unemployment rate hits a record high. The Government announced that the latest unemployment rate has reached a high of 6.9%, the highest among all industries in Hong Kong. Although the Budget indicated an increase of the estimated expenditures on capital works in 2026-27 to approximately $128 billion, this is far from enough to offset the overall decline in project quantity.

1. The current progress of the following projects and list the commencement schedules and anticipated completion dates;

a. Northern Metropolis Highway Project;

b. Route 11 (section between Yuen Long and North Lantau) project, especially Tsing Lung Bridge;

c. Tuen Mun Bypass project;

d. Widening of Yuen Long Highway (section between Lam Tei and Tong Yan San Tsuen);

e. Improvement of Lion Rock Tunnel; and

2. The investigation, design works and construction of the Hillside Escalator and Elevator System (HEL) Projects.
   Please list the item names under the Projects, their implementation schedules and completion dates respectively.

Asked by: Hon BOK Kwok-ming, Aaron (LegCo internal reference no.: 31)

Reply:

1. The implementation progress is tabulated as follows:

	Project	Project progress, schedule and anticipated completion date
a.	The Northern Metropolis Highway (NMH)	The Highways Department (HyD) is pressing ahead with the investigation studies on the NMH. Under the "holistic planning and staged implementation strategy", priority is given to the NMH (San Tin Section), with the targets to have it technically ready for tendering the main construction works next year and strive for commissioning by 2036. As for the other road sections, the Government will formulate a more specific schedule taking into account factors such as traffic demands of New Development Areas, existing and on-going transport infrastructure projects, overall cost effectiveness, public resource arrangements etc.
b.	Route 11 (section between Yuen Long and North Lantau)	The HyD is currently conducting investigation studies on the Route 11 project. The project has been gazetted in accordance with the Roads (Works, Use and Compensation) Ordinance (Chapter 370) and relevant works scheme has been authorized. Route 11 will be implemented in stages. Review is being conducted to have the Tsing Lung Bridge, the southern section of the Route 11, to be constructed first, so as to divert traffic from the existing major roads (including Tuen Mun Road (Sham Tseng Section) and Ting Kau Bridge, thereby alleviating traffic congestion.
c.	Tuen Mun Bypass	The HyD is currently conducting investigation studies on the Tuen Mun Bypass project. The project has been gazetted in accordance with the Roads (Works, Use and Compensation) Ordinance (Chapter 370) and relevant works schemes have been authorised to proceed. In order to optimise the project, the HyD is currently seeking opinions from independent experts to review the preliminary design of the Tuen Mun Bypass, including how to optimise the detailed layout of the Middle Ventilation Building and the arrangement of its exhaust outlet, and the Temporary Traffic Arrangements during construction to minimise the impacts on the nearby environment. The Government will constantly review the cost-effectiveness of the project and implement the project in a timely and orderly manner according to the priority and urgency of the project.
d.	Widening of Yuen Long Highway (section between Lam	The HyD invited tenders for the works in December 2025. The project was proposed to be tabled for consultation with the Legislative Council in the second/third quarter in 2026, with the target of completing the works approximately 5

	Project	Project progress, schedule and anticipated completion date
	Tei and Tong Yan San Tsuen)	years upon obtaining funding approval from the Finance Committee.
e.	Improvement of Lion Rock Tunnel	The project is currently under design stage. The Government will continue to review the cost-effectiveness of the project and implement the project in a timely and orderly manner according to priority and urgency.

2. The information of items under the Hillside Escalator Links and Elevator Systems (HEL) Projects that are under construction is tabulated as follows:

Item name	Commencement date	Anticipated completion date
Braemar Hill Pedestrian Link	August 2021	To be completed in stages starting from mid 2026
Pedestrian Walkway System between Hing Shing Road and Tai Wo Hau Road	July 2023	Third quarter of 2026

Regarding the items under the HEL Projects that are under planning, their required construction times depend on the individual condition of each item, such as ground conditions, land ownership, complexity of works etc. The Government will continue to review the cost-effectiveness of projects, prioritise them according to urgency, and implement the relevant projects in a timely and orderly manner. The relevant item implementation progress is as follows:

Item name/proposed alignment	Implementation Progress
From Smithfield along Pokfield Path to Pokfield Road	Advance works for the preliminary technical feasibility study are underway
From Yue Fai Road to Yue Kwong Road	
Pedestrian Link near Chuk Yuen North Estate	Investigation studies and design are underway
Lift and Pedestrian Walkway System at Kung Lok Road	
Pedestrian Link Walkway System between Po Lam Road North and Po Hong Road, Tseung Kwan O	

Item name/proposed alignment	Implementation Progress
From Wood Road to Queen's Road East near St. Joseph's College Primary School	Investigation studies and design are underway
From Sai Wan Ho Street to Holy Cross Church in Sai Wan Ho	
From Healthy Street East to Pak Fuk Road	
From Ching Cheung Road footbridge near Mei Foo MTR Station to Lai King Hill Road near Ching Lai Commercial Centre	
Escalator Link System between Sha Tin Sui Wo Court and MTR Fo Tan Station	
From the footway near Greenview Garden to Sha Tin Tau Road	
From Kwok Shui Road Park to Kwok Shui Road	
From Shek Yam Road near Kam Shek Building to Tai Pak Tin Street	
From Lau Sin Street to Tin Hau Temple Road	Tendering is underway
Lift and Pedestrian Walkway System between Lai King Hill Road and Lai Cho Road, Kwai Chung	
From Wah Sing Street to Castle Peak Road – Kwai Chung Escalator Link System	

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0263)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) District and Maintenance Works

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

1. The Government took over the Tai Lam Tunnel Control Area and Central Kowloon Bypass in 2025. Why did the total areas of maintained roads in 2025 and 2024 only increase by 500 000 square metres?

2. The expenditure on highways maintenance in 2025 is only $1.7 million more than 2024 and only $2.4 million more than 2026. This situation is disproportionate. Please explain the relevant reasons.

3. Did the aforesaid maintenance expenditures include sundry expenses such as electricity charges of street lightings and other mechanical and electrical equipment, water charges etc. Please provide a detailed breakdown.

Asked by: Hon BOK Kwok-ming, Aaron (LegCo internal reference no.: 33)

Reply:

1. The total area of new public roads arising from the takeover of Tai Lam Tunnel Control Area and Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section) is approximately 600 000 square meters. As the road facilities of Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section) have been taken over successively since late December 2025, the update of part of the road maintenance records can only be completed in early 2026. Therefore, the additional road area will be reflected in the 2026 figure.

2. The scope of road maintenance work is vast, including regular inspections, routine maintenance, maintenance of vegetation, emergency repair and maintenance etc. for public roads, structures, ancillary facilities, etc. under the ambit of the Highways Department (HyD). This is to keep the road network in good and safe condition, ensuring the safety of road users. Apart from the expenditures incurred by new roads and relevant facilities upon their handover for HyD's maintenance, the increase in maintenance expenditures is also driven by other factors, such as the condition of existing road facilities, the contract prices of new road maintenance works, salary levels, material costs, etc. Furthermore, the HyD continues to research and introduce more durable

bituminous materials for road paving, aiming to enhance road quality and reduce maintenance frequency in a more cost-effective manner. Therefore, the expenditure on road maintenance by the HyD may not be necessarily in a fixed and direct proportion to the road area.

3. The maintenance expenditure does not include electricity and water charges of street lightings and other mechanical and electrical equipment.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0264)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) District and Maintenance Works

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The expenditure on highways maintenance in 2026 is only $2.4 million more than 2025 ($1,660 million minus $1,657.6 million.). In this case, deep-level rehabilitation and replacement works cannot be conducted.

1. Does the Government have any 5-year plan on "rehabilitation programme for aging infrastructure", similar to the Replacement and Rehabilitation Programme of Water Mains" implemented by the Water Supplies Department or increase the expenditure on highways maintenance significantly?

2. Will additional resources be allocated for the "white-to-black" road resurfacing works, i.e. applying a special bituminous layer on the existing deteriorated (uneven) concrete road surfaces to enhance aesthetics and improve driving safety, quietness and comfort substantially? If yes, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

3. Why did the expenditure on roadside slope works in 2025 drop to $24.5 million? What are the reasons? If it is the result of insufficient resources in 2025, can the difference be recovered in 2026 to avoid any impacts on slope safety?

Asked by: Hon BOK Kwok-ming, Aaron (LegCo internal reference no.: 34)

Reply:

1. Road maintenance works conducted by the Highways Department (HyD) can be generally classified as remedial repair works and planned maintenance works. Remedial repair works are carried out to repair damage identified during road inspections or damage reported or complained by the public, and such works include repairing potholes or repairing damages that may pose an immediate risk to traffic or pedestrians. Planned maintenance works mainly include road resurfacing and reconstruction. These works are usually of a larger scale and more costly, but can enhance road durability. The HyD has in place a regular road inspection mechanism, through which term contractors are engaged to carry out maintenance and repair works for the public roads and ancillary road facilities under its ambit. Expressways carrying high-speed traffic and high traffic are inspected daily, other

trunk roads are inspected every week while ordinary roads are inspected every 1 to 3 months respectively. The HyD's road inspection teams are required to conduct detailed inspections on all road types once every 6 months in order to collect information relating to surface and structural conditions of the road for planning medium to long-term repair works. Also, the HyD will formulate appropriate plans and schedules for repair and maintenance having regard to factors such as wear and tear of the roads, traffic flow and the surrounding environment, as well as the inconvenience that may be caused to the public (such as arranging for temporary traffic diversion measures involved in the repair works), in order to maintain the roads in good condition and safeguarding safety of road users. Under the existing mechanism, the HyD has kept posted of the latest road conditions and have flexibility to arrange appropriate maintenance works in a timely manner, formulate planned road maintenance works in upcoming 3 months to 1 year. At the same time, the HyD is proactively conducting studies on major rehabilitation works for aging public roads and taking into consideration comprehensive assessments on traffic impacts, environmental factors, resource arrangements, application of new material technologies etc, as well as seeking funding approval for the relevant rehabilitation works in a timely manner.

2. The HyD has recently introduced road surface material namely "Ultra-thin Overlay (UTO)" from Chinese Mainland. The bitumen used possesses higher viscosity and elasticity than the highly modified bitumen currently used in Hong Kong and the aggregates used called Diabase which is stronger and have higher abrasion resistant than the commonly used granite. The UTO is suitable for repairing both bituminous and concrete pavements. With a thickness of only about 20 mm, it reduces resource consumption and shortens construction time. The HyD successfully completed on-site trials paving schemes at two locations on Hong Kong Island in December 2025, namely Shing Tai Road in Chai Wan and the Wong Chuk Hang Road Flyover and the trials achieved satisfactory results. With the opening of the Central Kowloon Route (Yau Ma Tei Section), the traffic flow on Lung Cheung Road and Ching Cheung Road has decreased. The HyD is currently formulating appropriate temporary traffic arrangements with relevant departments and planning to launch a pilot scheme in this summer to resurface a 500-metre long road section of concrete pavement on Lung Cheung Road with UTO (i.e. the "White-to-Black" resurfacing works) to enhance driving comfort and road surface conditions. Upon confirming the feasibility of the pilot scheme, the HyD and relevant departments will further review the detailed construction arrangements and phasing arrangement of the subsequent large-scale road resurfacing at Lung Cheung Road and Ching Cheung Road. In the future, the HyD will use this material at appropriate locations according to the actual site conditions and needs to constantly enhance the road surface quality.

3. The actual and estimated expenditures for roadside slope works conducted by the HyD from 2024 to 2026 are tabulated as follows:

	2024 (Actual)	**2025 (Actual)**	**2026 (Estimated)**
Expenditures for roadside slope works	72.9	24.5	71.5

As the large-scale roadside slope works under the current contracts were substantially completed in late 2024 to early 2025 and came into the works maintenance period, the expenditure for 2025 mainly comprises payments for remaining works amount and minor remedial works. Therefore, the actual expenditure for 2025 is lower than 2024. New works contracts will be awarded and large-scale roadside slope works will be carried out in 2026, thus the estimated expenditure for 2026 will be resumed to the level in 2024.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0265)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Technical Services

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

1. The analysis of financial provision for Programme (4) "Technical Services" indicated a significant downward trend, i.e. from $1.125 billion in 2024 to $941.2 million in 2025 and $901.6 million in 2026. What are the reasons? It is inconsistent with the persistent criticism of Hong Kong's uneven road surfaces and our image as an "international city". Also, it is inconsistent with the need for deep-level restoration or replacement of our aging infrastructure.

Asked by: Hon BOK Kwok-ming, Aaron (LegCo internal reference no.: 38)

Reply:

The year-on-year decrease in financial provision for Programme (4) "Technical Services" from 2024-25 to 2026-27 is mainly because the Highways Department (HyD) gradually replaces conventional road lighting with light-emitting diode (LED) lighting as planned. As a result, the number of road lights that require replacement and repairs decreases, lowering the maintenance cost of road lights. Also, the fuel cost adjustments charged by the 2 power companies were reduced during the period, which also lowered the expenditure on electricity for public lighting.

The HyD strives to maintain the safety and usability of the road network and to enhance the quality of road surface. The maintenance works of the public roads and relevant road facilities under the ambit of the HyD are under Programme (2) District and Maintenance Works. The financial provision for Programme (2) increased from $2.322 billion (actual expenditure in 2024-25) to $2.598 billion (revised estimate for 2025-26). The estimate for 2026-27 is further increased to $2.912 billion.

The HyD has in place a regular road inspection mechanism, through which term contractors are engaged to carry out the maintenance and repair works for the public roads and ancillary road facilities within its ambit. Expressways carrying high-speed traffic and high traffic throughput are inspected daily, other trunk roads are inspected every week while ordinary roads are inspected every 1 to 3 months respectively. The HyD's road inspection teams are required to conduct detailed inspections on all road types once every 6 months in order to

collect information relating to surface and structural conditions of the roads for planning medium to long-term repair works. At the same time, the HyD would formulate appropriate plans and schedules for repair and maintenance of roads, taking into account factors such as wear and tear of the roads, traffic flow and the surrounding environment, and considering the inconvenience that may be caused to the public (such as arranging for temporary traffic diversion measures involved in the repair works). This is to maintain the roads in good condition, thereby ensuring the safety of road users. The HyD is currently actively studying the large-scale rehabilitation plans for the aging public roads and carrying out comprehensive assessments on traffic impact, environmental factors, resource arrangements, application of new material technology, etc. The HyD will formulate plans for the relevant rehabilitation projects in a timely manner.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0266)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Capital Projects

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

1. Please provide the detailed construction schedules and estimated expenditures for the following works projects:

a) "Tsing Lung Bridge" - It is because the chronic traffic congestion problem on Tuen Mun Road and Ting Kau Bridge can be improved immediately.

b) "Improvement of Lion Rock Tunnel" - Not only can the daily traffic bottleneck from Shatin to Kowloon be eliminated, but it will also solve the pressing issue of the Lion Rock Tunnel nearing its service life limit after over 50 years in service. As a result, major incidents can be avoided.

c) The "white-to-black" paving works for the road surfaces of Lung Cheung Road/ Ching Cheung Road. It is essential to grasp the traffic opportunities arising from the temporary reduction in traffic flow on these 2 trunk roads after the commissioning of the Central Kowloon Bypass, thereby facilitating the implementation of relevant works.

d) The improvement works for the road surface conditions of the "Aberdeen Tunnel and Canal Road Flyover". It is because the severe damage to the existing road surfaces is a constant public concern.

Asked by: Hon BOK Kwok-ming, Aaron (LegCo internal reference no.: 39)

Reply:

1. The details of the relevant work projects are listed as follows:

a) Tsing Lung Bridge is an important component of the Route 11 project. The Highways Department (HyD) has gazetted the Route 11 project in accordance with the Roads (Works, Use and Compensation) Ordinance (Chapter 370). The relevant scheme has been authorised. The Route 11 project will be implemented in stages. Review is being conducted to have Tsing Lung Bridge, at the southern section of Route 11 to be constructed first so as to divert traffic from the existing major roads (including the Tuen Mun Road

(Sham Tseng Section) and Ting Kau Bridge), thereby alleviating traffic congestion. The Route 11 project is presently in the investigation stage, and the estimated construction cost can only be confirmed upon the completion of the design works.

b) The improvement of Lion Rock Tunnel is currently under design stage and its estimated construction cost will be confirmed upon completion of the design works. The Government will continue to review the cost-effectiveness of the project and implement the project in a timely and orderly manner according to priority and urgency.

c) Lung Cheung Road and Ching Cheung Road are very busy major trunk roads. The HyD has been closely monitoring the road surface conditions in the past and carrying out local repairs on damaged road surface as necessary. However, as repair works on these road sections must generally be completed within a few hours at night, it is very difficult to carry out large-scale concrete pavement repairs that require more time.

With the opening of the Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section), the traffic flow on Lung Cheung Road and Ching Cheung Road has decreased. The HyD is currently formulating appropriate temporary traffic arrangements with relevant departments and planning to launch a pilot scheme in this summer to resurface a 500-metre section of concrete pavement on Lung Cheung Road with a new bituminous material known as “Ultra-thin Overlay (UTO)” (i.e. the "white-to-black" resurfacing works) to enhance driving comfort and road surface conditions. Upon confirming the feasibility of the pilot scheme, the HyD will further review the detailed implementation arrangements for the subsequent large-scale, phased resurfacing of Lung Cheung Road and Ching Cheung Road with relevant departments. The estimated construction cost will be confirmed upon the completion of the review.

d) The HyD is responsible for the maintenance and repair of the public roads and ancillary road facilities under its ambit (including the carriageways of Aberdeen Tunnel and Canal Road Flyover), and has in place a regular road inspection mechanism, through which term contractors are engaged to carry out the relevant works. When damage of road surfaces or ancillary facilities is identified during regular road inspections or reported by the public, the HyD assigns contractors to repair the damage that may pose road safety risks (for instance, accidents may occur when vehicles hit potholes while travelling at high speeds). According to the records of the HyD, all the pothole repair works over the past 3 years have met the HyD’s performance pledge and were completed within 48 hours upon receipt of reports.

At present, the HyD arranges for road inspections and maintenance works from time to time during closure periods of the Aberdeen Tunnel at night time. The HyD also engaged consultants to conduct detailed inspections of the Aberdeen Tunnel in October 2025 to analyse the overall structural conditions of the tunnel. The HyD would arrange for repair works of the next stage based on the inspection results. The estimated construction cost will be confirmed upon the completion of the review.

Furthermore, to enhance the driving comfort and improve the overall appearance conditions of the Canal Road Flyover, the HyD is progressively applying a protective surface coating on the Canal Road Flyover. In order to minimise traffic impact on road users, the relevant works are being implemented in phases. The first phase commenced

in September 2025 and was completed in end December the same year. The second phase of the project is expected to commence in the second quarter of 2026 and will be completed in the first quarter of 2027. The total cost for both phases is approximately $12 million. The HyD will continue to closely monitor the road surface conditions of the Canal Road Flyover and will gradually apply road surface protective coatings at other suitable locations as necessary.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0908)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Railway Development

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the application of the Hong Kong Railway Standards in the MTR Northern Link (NOL) Project and the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu-Qianhai) Project, will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

(1) What are the (i) latest cost estimates, (ii) estimated amount and percentages of savings, (iii) main aspects that contributed the savings (such as civil, electrical and mechanical, signalling, station design, procurement, works acceptance tests, etc.) before and after adopting the Hong Kong Railway Standards for the NOL, the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu-Qianhai), and other new railway projects proposed to adopt the said standard? Please also reply in form of table by project.

(2) Regarding the NOL Spur Line, what are the (i) respective original and latest schedules (design, tendering, construction commencement, testing and commissioning), (ii) specific measures and key assumptions for expediting the works, and (iii) target date for simultaneous commissioning with the Main Line and risk assessments (including approval procedures, land resumptions, cross-boundary coordination, market supply of contractors and coordinating risks between contractors)?

(3) How can the Government ensure that railway safety, quality and performance are not affected while introducing suitable standards from the Chinese Mainland and overseas for local adaptation? These include (i) which departments/independent organisations are responsible for the approval, certification and supervision, (ii) whether third-party safety assessments and auditing mechanisms are in place, and (iii) whether there are irreducible baseline requirements and acceptance standards for key systems (such as signalling, power supply, ventilation and fire safety, evacuation, cybersecurity, etc.).

Asked by: Hon BOK Kwok-ming, Aaron (LegCo internal reference no.: 28)

Reply:

(1) The new Hong Kong Railway Standards promulgated by the Highways Department (HyD) facilitate the use of a broader selection of advanced construction technologies,

construction materials, equipment and railway systems for new railway projects according to individual project circumstances and needs, provide clear technical specifications as the approval basis by the supervisory authorities, and also facilitate the development and optimisation of work processes by the industry, driving the new railway projects of Hong Kong with enhanced speed and efficiency. In particular, the Hong Kong Railway Standards encourage the adoption of innovative construction machinery, technologies and materials (such as larger-scale or wider scale of standardised modular integrated construction, high-strength steel, and ultra-high-performance concrete), as well as advanced equipment and construction specifications (such as the selection, design, construction and control of tunnel boring machines). The cost savings for individual projects will vary depending on actual circumstances including the nature, scale and site condition of the project.

The Hong Kong Railway Standards will first be applied to the Northern Link (NOL) project and the Hong Kong - Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu – Qianhai)(HSWRL), and will be extended to other new railway projects in the future. Regarding the NOL project, the Government is currently reviewing the project estimate provided by the MTRCL. Based on our rough estimation, the adoption of the Hong Kong Railway Standards, coupled with the synergies generated by implementing the NOL Main Line and the NOL Spur Line together, the construction cost is expected to be reduced by about 20% for the NOL project. Moreover, the programme of the NOL Spur Line could be advanced by 2 years, enabling it to be commissioned together with the NOL Main Line by 2034 or earlier. Regarding the Hong Kong section of HSWRL, the investigation and design works have already commenced. We are currently carrying out the design and relevant site investigation works, statutory procedures, financial assessments, etc. During this process, the construction cost of the Hong Kong section of the project will be estimated, realising the benefits of adopting the Hong Kong Railway Standards.

(2) The Government signed the project agreement for Part 1 of NOL project with the MTR Corporation Limited ("MTRCL") in July last year, taking forward the NOL project through a holistic planning and phased implementation strategy, the NOL Spur Line and the NOL Main Line are being taken forward together as one project. The works that are more ready and time-critical are given priority to commence first, while the detailed planning and design as well as statutory procedures for the NOL Spur Line are carried out in parallel. As mentioned above, based on our rough estimation, the adoption of the Hong Kong Railway Standards, coupled with the synergies generated by implementing the NOL Main Line and Spur Line together, the programme of NOL Spur Line will be advanced by two years, allowing it to be commissioned together with the NOL Main Line by 2034 or earlier.

The MTRCL is currently carrying out the detailed planning and design for the NOL Spur Line, including statutory procedures such as environmental impact assessment and railway scheme gazettal. Once the relevant works are substantially completed, the Government and the MTRCL will promptly sign the project agreement for Part 2 of the NOL project to finalise the remaining works and operational arrangements. The timing of key milestones prior to commissioning will be specified in the project agreement. The MTRCL will be required to submit an overall master plan in the project agreement for the Government's monitoring and control of project progress. The MTRCL is also

required to submit risk assessments on the aspects of safety, quality, programme, etc. regularly, and proactively report any major issues/incidents to the Government and make early warnings, and promptly take necessary follow-up actions.

(3) As emphasised in the guidelines of the Hong Kong Railway Standards, the standards have retained the prevailing railway standards in Hong Kong while also introduced suitable railway standards from Chinese Mainland and other parts of the world with adaptation to the local circumstances, as a result of detailed analysis and comparisons on the premise of ensuring railway safety, quality, and performance-based outcomes. The relevant guidelines also indicate that one of the principles of the Hong Kong Railway Standards is to comply with Hong Kong legislation and statutory requirements, including the Buildings Ordinance (Cap. 123), the Fire Services Ordinance (Cap. 95), the Electricity Ordinance (Cap. 406), the Environmental Impact Assessment Ordinance (Cap. 499), etc.

The HyD established the Railway Checking Unit (RCU) by reallocating internal resources to effectively implement the Hong Kong Railway Standards. This dedicated unit is responsible for handling the approval building plans of new railway projects. The RCU is under the Headquarters of the HyD and works separately from teams implementing railway projects (i.e. the Railway Development Office and Northern Metropolis Railway Office) in order to maintain its independence. The RCU will collaborate with relevant departments, including the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department (EMSD), to ensure that building plans meet the requirements for the safe operation of future buildings and railway systems. The standards, design, approval, site supervision, quality, site safety, etc. of the works are subject to the control of the Buildings Ordinance (Cap. 123), which requires to appoint building professionals (including authorised persons, registered engineers and registered geotechnical engineers) and registered contractors (including general building contractors or specialist contractors) to take up the responsibilities and duties under the Buildings Ordinance including obtaining approval and consent for the works.

Besides, the EMSD will implement the Project Safety Review (PSR) process for new railway projects, which involves conducting systematic assessments of long-term operational safety of new railway projects during various stages of projects, such as design, construction, installation, testing, etc. The aim is to identify potential safety hazards in major buildings and electrical and mechanical equipment at an early stage and provide comments, enabling timely follow-up actions by engineering teams and ensuring the long-term operational safety. Before the commissioning of new railway projects, relevant government departments (including the EMSD, Transport Department, Fire Services Department, etc.) must also conduct the “safe and sound” assessment, undergoing a series of rigorous inspections and verification procedures to ensure that the newly constructed railway system is safe and reliable before it can be commissioned.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0909)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Capital Projects

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

In recent years, the construction industry in Hong Kong has faced a contraction in workload. The construction sector's unemployment rate hits a record high. The Government announced that the latest unemployment rate of the construction industry has reached a high of 6.9%, the highest among all industries in Hong Kong. Although the Budget indicated an increase of the estimated expenditure on capital works in 2026-27 to approximately $128 billion, this is far from enough to offset the overall decline in project quantity.

While the number of works projects is dropping constantly, the expenditure on project consultancy also decreases significantly.

1. Among the capital projects under design and construction, the number of those undertaken by consultants has decreased from 279 in 2024 to an estimated number of 212 in 2026. The project expenditure has decreased by nearly $48 billion ($211.813 billion minus $164.036 billion). Please explain the reasons for the significant decrease and explain in detail what projects were removed.

2. The "expenditure in the year on capital projects under design and construction" is also decreasing year by year from $11.3076 billion in 2024 to $5.3746 billion this year, representing less than half of the amount in 2024. What are the relevant reasons?

Asked by: Hon BOK Kwok-ming, Aaron (LegCo internal reference no.: 32)

Reply:

1. Among the capital works projects at the design and construction stages, the numbers of projects undertaken by consultants has dropped. This is mainly due to the completion of the relevant 48 items under the "Universal Accessibilty" Programme in 2025 and 2026. However, the Highways Department's (HyD) estimated expenditure for this programme in 2026-27 still increases compared to 2024-25. In addition to completing the remaining items of the current stage, the HyD would also conduct feasibility studies for items in the next stage of the programme.

As for the major reasons for the decrease in the total project estimates, it is due to the completion of the project "Tuen Mun-Chek Lap Kok Link – construction works" and its account finalisation in 2025-26. Therefore, the approved project estimate of approximately $44.8 billion is no longer included in the total approved project estimates for 2026.

2. Regarding the expenditure on capital works projects at the design and construction stages for this year, the estimated expenditures for projects undertaken by consultants in 2026 decrease compared to the actual expenditures in 2024 and 2025. This is mainly due to the substantial decrease in expenditures as several projects (including the "Central Kowloon Route – Main Works" and the "Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge Hong Kong Boundary Crossing Facilities – Reclamation and Superstructures") have been completed and account finalisations are being progressively completed. Expenditures for other major transport infrastructure projects (such as the Northern Metropolis Highway) under planning remain relatively low before they enter the construction phase.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2304)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Railway Development

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

1. Regarding the capital projects under design and construction entrusted to the railway corporation or other agencies, please list in detail the respective "projects" and their expenditure estimates in 2025 and 2026. Please also list the annual estimated expenditure for at least the next 5 years.

2. Why did the expenditure on the studies and other tasks carried out by consultants drop significantly from $731.5 million in 2025 to $657.6 million? Since a lot of studies and planning works for the Northern Metropolis or the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link will be carried out in the future, why have the study items and expenditures decreased instead of increased?

Asked by: Hon BOK Kwok-ming, Aaron (LegCo internal reference no.: 37)

Reply:

1. The information regarding the capital projects under design and construction entrusted to the railway corporation or agencies by the Highways Department (HyD) are tabulated below:

Projects		**Expenditure ($ million)**	
		2025-26 (Revised Estimate)	**2026-27 (Estimate)**
1	6038TR - West Rail (WR) (phase 1) – Essential Public Infrastructure Works (EPIW) for Tuen Mun section	5.0 (Actual expenditure)	completed
2	6045TR - WR (phase 1) – EPIW for Yuen Long section	1.3 (Actual expenditure)	completed

3	6051TR - Shatin to Central Link (SCL) – design and site investigation	-	1.2
4	6052TR - Hong Kong section of the Guangzhou - Shenzhen - Hong Kong Express Rail Link (XRL) – design and site investigation	-	0.1
5	6053TR - XRL – construction of railway works	3.5	30.3
6	6056TR - South Island Line (East) (SIL(E)) – EPIW	0.4	2.2
7	6057TR - XRL – construction of non-railway works	14.6	30.2
8	6061TR - SCL – construction of railway works – remaining works	505.5	432.5
9	6062TR - SCL – construction of non-railway works – remaining works	114.9	39.3
10	6063TR - SCL – construction of railway works – advance works	-	0.1
11	6064TR - SCL – construction of non-railway works – advance works	-	0.1

The future expenditures for the above railway projects mainly cover the remaining works and contract payments after commissioning. The relevant estimates depend on the progress of the remaining works and the account finalisation of contracts, and will be reflected in the estimated expenditure for future financial years.

2. The Government will, as necessary, engage consultants to assist in new railway projects and Smart and Green Mass Transit System projects, taking into account factors such as their scale, scope, and complexity. The consultancy expenditure varies across projects and fluctuates annually depending on the implementation and progress of the relevant projects. Under the railway development framework, the total estimated expenditure for consultancy studies in 2026 is lower than the actual total amount in 2025. The decrease is mainly due to the completion of 4 studies in 2025. In 2026, 7 studies will continue while 2 new studies will be commenced, the total amount is lower than that of the studies completed in 2025. Overall speaking, both the number and the total amount of the studies in 2026 have decreased compared with 2025.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2305)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational expenses

Programme: (2) District and Maintenance Works, (4) Technical Services

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

There has been a significant decrease in both actual expenditures and approved estimates for electricity (Subhead 272) and highways maintenance (Page 549) under Operational Expenses in 2025-26. The estimates for electricity will decrease further in 2026-27. It is clearly inconsistent with the fact that the Highways Department is carrying out or planning to carry out numerous infrastructure and railway projects, as well as taking over major infrastructure such as the Tai Lam Tunnel and Central Kowloon Bypass during the year. What are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon BOK Kwok-ming, Aaron (LegCo internal reference no.: 40)

Reply:

The Highway Department's (HyD) revised estimate under Subhead 272 Electricity for public lighting in 2025-26 is 10.2% lower than the actual expenditure in 2024-25 and 12.9% lower than the approved estimate in 2025-26. It is mainly due to the decrease in fuel cost adjustments charged by the two power companies and the decrease in electricity consumption resulting from the HyD's constant promotion of energy-saving measures of road facilities. The HyD will in 2026-27 further formulate an energy-saving target of decreasing 2% of electricity expenses. It is expected that expenditure in the aspect of electricity supply will decrease further in 2026-27.

Regarding highway maintenance, the revised estimate for 2025-26 is 4.1% more than the actual expenditure in 2024-25, but 7.7% less than the original estimate for 2025-26. This adjustment is mainly due to changes in the completion dates of certain new road works and relevant projects, resulting in corresponding adjustments to the dates and expenditures for their handover to the HyD for maintenance. The HyD took over major infrastructure projects, such as the Tai Lam Tunnel and the Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section), in 2025. Besides, the HyD has reserved provisions for the required expenditures on electricity supply and highway maintenance for these projects in the approved estimate for 2025-26. However, due to the reduction in fuel cost adjustments, as well as the deferred handover of various road works and relevant projects (including the transport infrastructure in

the Diamond Hill Development Area, the installation of lifts under the Universal Accessibility Programme, and the Wan Chai Development Phase II etc.) for the HyD's maintenance, the revised estimate for 2025-26 has been reduced accordingly.

Subhead 000 Operational expenses and Subhead 272 Electricity for public lighting cover only the recurrent expenditure of the HyD and do not include the expenditure required for carrying out infrastructure and railway works.

- End –

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1719)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) District and Maintenance Works

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Over the past 10 years, it's not less than four number of traffic accidents happened at the North Lantau Highway caused by road works. The matters requiring special attention within this year include the supervision of safety measures for road works. Will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

1) Please provide a breakdown by District Council of the numbers of accidents caused by road works over the past 5 years, the details and whether casualties are involved.

2) Did the Government conduct surprise inspections of the road repair works on expressways to ensure contactors' compliance with the "Code of Practice for the Lighting, Signing and Guarding of Road Works". If yes, what are the numbers of surprise inspections conducted in the past 3 years and the estimated numbers for this year?

3) Does the Government have any improvement plans for the roads with higher traffic accident rates, such as the North Lantau Highway and Lung Cheung Road? If yes, what are the details and the amounts involved?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Hok-fung (LegCo internal reference no.: 30)

Reply:

1) Traffic accidents involve multiple causes. The Transport Department (TD) does not maintain a breakdown for the number of traffic accidents involving road works.

2) When any Government departments and public or private organisations engage their contractors to carry out works on expressways, clear instructions shall be provided to drivers in order to safeguard road users. The relevant persons responsible for the road works shall follow the Code of Practice for the Lighting, Signing and Guarding of Road Works (hereinafter referred to as "COP") to plan carefully and execute properly the temporary traffic arrangements measures. These include the implementation of appropriate lighting, signing, guarding measures etc. (such as traffic cones, barriers, shadow vehicle, etc.) according to the type of works and providing sufficient working

time and space for implementing, maintaining and removing the said measures, with a view to reducing the risk of works area being hit by vehicles and at the same time reminding drivers to pay extra attention to the road works ahead. The temporary traffic arrangement measures throughout the works period shall also obtain prior agreement from relevant traffic management departments.

When Highways Department (HyD) carries out road works on expressways, the HyD would deploy its staff to conduct site inspections for monitoring the progress and quality of works, etc. which includes checking on the temporary traffic arrangements measures implemented by the contractors in accordance with the COP. Similarly, other departments and organisations shall also monitor their works on expressways during the construction stage.

According to Cap. 374G Road Traffic (Traffic Control) Regulations, the Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF) would allocate appropriate resources for inspection of road works based on operational needs, giving instructions to the persons responsible for the road works to rectify the deficiency identified. In addition, the HyD's Audit Inspection Team conducts random audits to the lighting, signing, and guarding measures implemented in association with the excavation works on carried out public roads in accordance with the COP. For any non-compliances identified, the HyD would inform the persons responsible for the relevant road works and request them to rectify the situation promptly. Based on the actual circumstances, the HyD would also take appropriate follow-up actions with the responsible persons for any breaching of relevant regulations. The numbers of audit inspections on expressways in 2023, 2024 and 2025 are 1 028, 1 125 and 1 367 respectively. This inspection strategy is expected to continue in 2026.

3) TD analyses the traffic accident data of traffic accident black spots and other places with a higher traffic accident rate, studies in details whether there are obvious patterns and common causes of accidents, and formulates target-oriented improvement measures. Generally speaking, most traffic accidents are attributed by driver-related factors such as inattentive driving, following too close to the vehicle in front, and changing lanes negligently. To address these issues, the TD constantly collaborates with the HKPF and the Road Safety Council to raise drivers' awareness on road safety through education campaigns and stricter enforcement. The TD and the HKPF will also continue to make the best utilization of new technologies to improve traffic management and enhance road safety.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 Reply Serial No.

TLB024

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3167)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Technical Services

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the "Smart Lighting Management System", will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

1. What were the annual expenditures on the installation of the "Smart Lighting Management System" used by the Government from 2022-23 to date? What is the relevant estimated expenditure for this year?

2. What were the operating expenses for the "Smart Lighting Management System" in each of past 3 years? What are the relevant operating expenses for this year?

3. Please provide a breakdown by the 18 District Council of the numbers of road lights installed with the "Smart Lighting Management System" in various districts since its introduction. What are the estimated numbers of road lights planned for installation in various districts for this and next years?

4. What is the average repair time for road lights currently installed with the "Smart Lighting Management System" upon failure? How has the repair time changed compared to the period prior to the installation of the system?

5. How has the frequency of nighttime patrols for the public lighting network changed for the road lights currently installed with the "Smart Lighting Management System", as compared to the period prior to the implementation of the system?

6. What was the manpower establishment responsible for the management and repair of road lights in each of the past 3 years?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Kapui, Judy (LegCo internal reference no.: 38)

Reply:

1. The annual expenditures incurred by the Highways Department (HyD) for the installation of the "Smart Lighting Management System" from 2022-23 to date are as follows:

	2022-2023 Actual ($ million)	**2023-2024 Actual ($ million)**	**2024-2025 Actual ($ million)**	**2025-2026* Actual ($ million)**	**2026-2027 Estimate ($ million)**
Installation expenditures	11.54	6.30	17.79	20.21	47.07[Note 1]

*As at 12 March 2026

Note 1: The "Smart Lighting Management System" in Kowloon and New Territories are undergoing installation and testing stages. It is anticipated that a larger portion of the relevant expenditures will be settled upon completion of installation works in 2026-27.

2. The operational expenses incurred by the HyD for the "Smart Lighting Management System" in each of the past 3 years and this year are as follows:

	2023-2024 Actual ($ million)	**2024-2025 Actual ($ million)**	**2025-2026* Actual ($ million)**	**2026-2027 Estimate ($ million)**
Operational expenses	3.36	4.48	6.13	12.14[Note 2]

*As at 12 March 2026

Note 2: The "Smart Lighting Management System" in Kowloon and New Territories are expected to gradually commence service in 2026-27. Therefore, there will be an increase in operational expenses.

3. The numbers of road lights installed with the "Smart Lighting Management System" in various districts since its introduction and the estimated numbers of road lights that are planned for installation of the said system in various districts in this year and next year are as follows:

District	Already installed Actual No.*	2026-2027 Estimated No.	2027-2028 Estimated No.
Kwai Tsing	1 600	4 500	-
Tsuen Wan	-	5 100	-
Tuen Mun	7 700	800	-
Yuen Long	500	19 600	-
North District	12 900	500	550
Tai Po	10 400	1 600	-
Sha Tin	11 000	2 000	-
Sai Kung	8 800	1 600	-
Kowloon City	4800	1 000	-
Wong Tai Sin	2 200	600	-
Sham Shui Po	3 500	1 000	-
Kwun Tong	4 900	1 000	-
Yau Tsim Mong	4 400	1 200	-
Central and Western District	5 200	-	-
Eastern District	4 000	-	-
Wan Chai	4 000	-	-
Southern District	4 400	-	-
Islands District	4 400	9 000	-

*As at 12 March 2026

4. In the past, the public lighting network lacked an automatic fault feedback mechanism. The HyD relied solely on manual inspections or public reports to identify malfunctions in the lighting equipment. Upon receiving public reports of streetlight malfunction, the HyD's contractors generally complete rectification for urgent faults involving simple repairs (such as adjustment and replacement of lamps) within 3 hours, while other urgent cases are resolved within 12 hours.

The road lights with the "Smart Lighting Management System" can monitor the conditions of public lighting network by measuring the operating parameters of each lighting equipment in real time. Upon detecting abnormal operating parameters, the system delivers the fault alerts to maintenance personnel for fault investigations and repairs. Overall speaking, the "Smart Lighting Management System" can identify about 90% of road light's faults reported by the public, and repairs of about 30% of faults are completed by contractors before receiving reports from the public.

5. The "Smart Lighting Management System" in Kowloon and New Territories are still undergoing installation stage, while the system in Hong Kong Island is being continuously fine-tuned to optimise the system and improve its stability. When the "Smart Lighting Management System" commences full service, it is anticipated that the number of nighttime patrols for the public lighting network can be reduced by about 50%.

6. The manpower establishment of the HyD responsible for the management and maintenance of road lights in each of the past 3 years are as follows:

	2023-2024	**2024-2025**	**2025-2026**
Staff establishment	116	116	114

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3279)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Capital Projects

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It was mentioned in the "Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27" that the Government would continue to make Hong Kong more "walkable", including supervising the implementation and review of various works projects related to "walkability" improvements (for example the Hillside Escalator Links and Elevator System (HEL), "Universal Accessibility" Programme and pedestrian schemes). In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

1. Which HEL projects are expected to commence or remain under construction? What are the specific provision amounts reserved for them?

2. Did the Government conduct any surveys on the utilisation rates of the completed HEL projects? Will the relevant data be used as a reference for planning future projects of the same type?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Pui-leung (LegCo internal reference no.: 40)

Reply:

1. The details of the Hillside Escalator Links and Elevator System (HEL) projects that are under construction are tabulated below:

Project	**Commencement date**	**Anticipated completion date**	**Approved Project estimate[1] ($ million)**
Braemar Hill Pedestrian Link	August 2021	Staged completion starting from mid-2026	682.6
Pedestrian Walkway System between Hing Shing Road and Tai Wo Hau Road	July 2023	Third quarter of 2026	192.5

Note 1: Money-of-the-day prices

Regarding the HEL projects that are under planning, the Government will continue to review the cost-effectiveness of projects, prioritise them according to urgency, and implement the relevant projects in a timely and orderly manner. The details of the HEL projects expected to commence in 2026-27 are as follows:

Project	**Implementation progress**
Lift and Pedestrian Walkway System between Lau Sin Street and Tin Hau Temple Road	Tendering is underway. The project estimates are yet to be confirmed.
Lift and Pedestrian Walkway System between Lai King Hill Road and Lai Cho Road, Kwai Chung	
Wah Sing Street to Castle Peak Road – Kwai Chung Escalator Link System	

2. The Government constantly attaches great importance to the accessibility in hillside areas and enhances pedestrian connectivity between hillside and downhill areas through the HEL. Under the assessment mechanism[2], the Transport Department conducts independent scoring based on both "social benefits" and "cost-effectiveness" when planning the HEL projects, before carrying out comprehensive considerations. It is to ensure that the projects implemented deliver concrete benefits to local communities and gain recognition, while being cost-effective. The assessment mechanism evaluates the numbers of the HEL's beneficiary by predicting the change in travel patterns and diversions after the commissioning of the proposed HEL, with a view to anticipating the usage of the HEL.

Note 2: An assessment mechanism that the Government reported to and was agreed by the Subcommittee on the Hillside Escalator Links and Elevator Systems of the Legislative Council at the end of 2019.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1948)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Railway Development

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Highways Department established the Northern Metropolis Railways Office (NMRO) to assist in the implementation of railway projects related to the Northern Metropolis. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

1. What are the details of the work undertaken by the NMRO in 2025-26?

2. What are the details of the work anticipated to be undertaken by the NMRO and the implementation timetable of the railway projects in 2026-27?

3. What are the differences and similarities in the functions and the division of work between the NMRO and the other government departments that supervise the railway projects?

4. Please list by rank the numbers of permanent posts and supernumerary posts, and the respective salary expenditures involved for the NMRO and the other government departments that supervise the railway projects.

Rank	No. of permanent posts	Salary Expenditures	No. of supernumerary posts	Salary Expenditures
Directorate				
Professional Grade				
Technical Grade				
General Grade				

5. What is the implementation timetable for the establishment of the Railways Department?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Siu-hung (LegCo internal reference no.: 44)

Reply:

1. and 2. In 2025-26 and 2026-27, the Northern Metropolis Railways Office (NMRO) is mainly responsible for the coordination and implementation of railway projects related to the Northern Metropolis, including Kwu Tung Station, Hung Shui Kiu Station, Northern Link (NOL) project and the Hong Kong section of Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu - Qianhai)(HSWRL).

The construction of the Kwu Tung Station and the Hung Shui Kiu Station of Tuen Ma Line is currently underway, with completion anticipated in 2027 and 2030 respectively. Also, the Government and the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) executed the part 1 of the project agreement of the NOL project, with a view to implementing NOL Main Line and NOL Spur Line as one project under a new mindset and striving for commissioning of both lines together by 2034 or earlier. Meanwhile, the Government vigorously implements the HSWRL. Relevant contractors and operators were previously invited to submit expressions of interest for the Hong Kong section of the HSWRL. The market response was positive, with over 80 expressions of interest received. The Government is currently taking forward the investigation and design works in parallel, with the target of having the Hong Kong section of the HSWRL technically ready for tendering in 2027, followed immediately by detailed design and construction works. The Government strives to complete the construction works in 2034, followed immediately by integrated testing and commissioning to realise the common goal of the two governments to commission the HSWRL in 2035.

3. The development of new railway projects involves both the Highways Department (HyD) and the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department (EMSD). The Railway Development Office (RDO) and the NMRO under the HyD are responsible for planning Hong Kong's railway development and overseeing the implementation of new railway projects. Specifically, the RDO is responsible for carrying out studies and formulating plans for the future development of Hong Kong railway network, and to coordinate and implement other railway projects outside the Northern Metropolis. The NMRO is responsible for coordinating and implementing the railway projects related to the Northern Metropolis. In addition, the Railways Branch under the EMSD is responsible for regulating and monitoring the safe operation of railway systems in accordance with relevant railway safety ordinances.

4. Under the HyD's Head of Expenditure (i.e. Head 60), the manpower establishments and salary expenditures of the NMRO and the RDO as at 1 March 2026 are tabulated below:

Grade	**No. of Permanent posts**	**Salary expenditures ($ million)[Note]**	**No. of time-limited posts**	**Salary expenditures ($ million)[Note]**
Northern Metropolis Railways Office				
Directorate	1	2.10	3	7.10
Professional	26	31.50	22	24.90

Grade	No. of Permanent posts	Salary expenditures ($ million)[Note]	No. of time-limited posts	Salary expenditures ($ million)[Note]
Technical	4	2.40	-	-
General	1	0.30	2	0.80
Railway Development Office				
Directorate	6	14.10	-	-
Professional	69	81.20	24	27.50
Technical	27	15.30	-	-
General	30	14.50	1	1.60

Note in terms of notional annual mid-point salary value.

Under the EMSD's Head of Expenditure (i.e. Head 42), the manpower establishments and salary expenditures of the Railways Branch under the EMSD as at 1 March 2026 are tabulated at the table below. The railway systems regulated and monitored by the Railways Branch under the EMSD include railway systems operated by the MTRCL, the Hong Kong International Airport Automated People Mover operated by the Airport Authority Hong Kong, tramway systems operated by the Hong Kong Tramways Limited and peak tramway system operated by the Peak Tramways Company Limited. The EMSD does not maintain breakdown figures for expenditures of new railway projects.

Rank	No. of Permanent posts	Salary expenditures ($ million)[Note]	No. of time-limited posts	Salary expenditures ($ million)[Note]
Railways Branch				
Directorate	3	6.66	2	4.18
Professional Grade	43	64.73	-	-
Technical Grade	4	4.92	-	-
General Grade	8	2.54	-	-

Note in terms of notional annual mid-point salary value.

5. The Government previously proposed establishing a Railways Department to be the dedicated department responsible for railway planning, implementation and safety regulation by integrating the existing NMRO and RDO under the HyD, as well as the Railways Branch under the EMSD. Since the establishment of a new department involves additional recurring manpower and resource requirements, the Government, under the direction of prudent control of operating expenditures, considers it necessary to reconsider the appropriate timing for establishing the Railways Department.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1739)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Capital Projects

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the pedestrian accessibility of hillside communities (in particular communities with higher proportion of elderly people, such as Chuk Yuen North Estate in Wong Tai Sin) and the planning and resource allocation of hillside escalator link system, will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

(1) Whether a systematic review has been conducted on the pedestrian walkability and barrier-free access facilities of hilly communities across Hong Kong, particularly in districts with a higher proportion of elderly people? Did the Government reserve any specific resources in the 2026-27 Financial Year to initiate or expand systematic studies on accessibility? If yes, what are the details regarding the estimated amount, the geographical scope covered etc.?

(2) Under the "Hillside Escalator Link and Elevator System (HEL) Projects and "Universal Accessibility" (UA) Programme, how many pedestrian link systems or related barrier-free facility projects were implemented by the Government in hilly communities over the past 3 years? Please provide a breakdown by district, specifying the nature of each project (e.g. escalators, lifts, subways, or covered footbridges), the service population demographics (including the proportion of elderly people), the current stage of development (e.g. technical feasibility study/design/funding secured pending commencement/ under construction), and the anticipated completion dates.

(3) Regarding the proposed project of the Pedestrian Link near Chuk Yuen North Estate under the "hillside escalator link system", what are the specific contents of the completed preliminary design and technical feasibility study? What is the estimated construction cost? Will a concrete timetable for the commencement and commissioning of the project be established?

(4) Under the 2026-27 budgetary arrangements, what is the total amount of resources reserved by the Highways Department under Head 60 and the relevant subheads of the Capital Works Reserve Fund for the studies and works aimed at improving accessibility in hilly communities (including hillside escalator/elevator systems and the provision of

barrier-free access facilities at footbridges, elevated walkways, and subways etc.)? Furthermore, will the Government establish clearer indicators to prioritise these projects (such as gradient, distance from railway stations/bus terminus, and the proportion of elderly people etc.), and introduce new tools such as 3D Pedestrian Network analysis to regularly review and publicise the walkability ratings and improvement timelines for various hillside communities?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Wing-kwong (LegCo internal reference no.: 35)

Reply:

(1) and (2)

The Government has long been attaching great importance to the accessibility of communities, enhancing the accessibility of hillside areas and installing barrier-free access facilities at public walkways through Hillside Escalator Links and Elevator Systems (hereinafter "HEL") Projects and "Universal Accessibility" (UA) Programme respectively.

(I) Hillside Escalator Links and Elevator Systems (HEL)

When the Transport Department (TD) plans for the HEL Projects, it follows an assessment mechanism, which was reported by Government to the Subcommittee on Hillside Escalator Links and Elevator Systems of the Legislative Council (LegCo) in end 2019 and was consented by the LegCo Members afterwards, to conduct independent scoring of "social benefits" (considerations include numbers of beneficiaries and target beneficiaries, feasibility of prompt implementation, and effectiveness in providing convenience) and "cost-effectiveness", followed by comprehensive considerations. This is to ensure that apart from being cost-effective, the implemented projects can clearly benefit and are accepted by members of the public.

The HEL Projects completed or commenced by the Government over the past 3 years are tabulated below:

Project name	**Facility**	**No. of people served (elderly aged 65 or above)**	**Progress of works**	**Anticipated completion date**
Lift and Pedestrian Walkway System between Castle Peak Road and Kung Yip Street, Kwai Chung	Lift and Pedestrian Walkway System	17 500 (about 3 600)	Completed in the fourth quarter of 2023	-
Lift and Pedestrian Walkway System between Saddle	Lift and Pedestrian Walkway System	28 000 (about 6 400)	Completed in the third quarter of 2025	-

Project name	Facility	No. of people served (elderly aged 65 or above)	Progress of works	Anticipated completion date
Ridge Garden and Sai Sha Road				
Braemar Hill Pedestrian Link	Lifts and escalators	16 500 (about 4 100)	Under construction	To be completed in stages starting from mid 2026
Pedestrian Walkway System between Hing Shing Road and Tai Wo Hau Road	Escalator Link System	24 000 (about 4 200)	Under construction	Third quarter of 2026
Lift and Pedestrian Walkway System between Lau Sin Street and Tin Hau Temple Road	Lift and Pedestrian Walkway System	6 800 (about 1 500)	Under tendering	First quarter of 2029
Wah Sing Street to Castle Peak Road – Kwai Chung Escalator Link System	Escalator Link System	18 200 (about 4 900)	Under tendering	First quarter of 2029
Lift and Pedestrian Walkway System between Lai King Hill Road and Lai Cho Road, Kwai Chung	Lift and Pedestrian Walkway System	24 000 (about 11 000)	Under tendering	Third quarter of 2029

(II) "Universal Accessibility" (UA) Programme

The Government has been striving to install barrier-free access facilities at public walkways. Since the "Universal Accessibility" (UA) Programme was launched in August 2012, the Government has carried out timely scope extension to proactively install more barrier-free access facilities (i.e. lifts or ramps) at existing public walkways (i.e. public footbridges, elevated walkways and subways) in Hong Kong (including existing walkways located in hillside communities) for the convenient use by the elderly and people in need. During the implementation of the UA Programme, the Highways Department (HyD) would maintain communication with local communities and gather their views on proposed walkways for installing barrier-free access facilities, proposed locations of lifts, construction method, etc. Over the past three years, the Government has implemented 187 items under the UA Programme, covering the installation of lifts

for existing walkways located in hillside communities. Details of some relevant items are tabulated below[1]:

Item name	Facility	Progress of works	Anticipated completion date
Footbridge along Cochrane Street near Tun Wo Lane (Structure No. HF135)	Installation of lifts for existing footbridge	Completed in the fourth quarter of 2023	--
Across Tsui Lam Road near Tsui Lam Community Hall (Structure No. SK01)	Installation of lifts for existing footbridge	Completed in the fourth quarter of 2023	--
Across Ching Hong Road near Cheung Hong Estate Commercial Centre No. 2 (Structure No. K&T01)	Installation of lifts for existing footbridge	Completed in the fourth quarter of 2024	--
Elevated walkway near Fung Ha Road Flyover in Fung Wah Estate across Fei Tsui Road (Structure No. FW01)	Installation of lifts for existing elevated walkway	Completed in the fourth quarter of 2025	--
Across Chun Wah Road near Lok Wah South Estate (Structure No. KS43)	Installation of lifts for existing subway	Completed in the fourth quarter of 2025	--
Across Ching Hong Road near Ching Shing Court (Structure No. NF125)	Installation of lifts for existing footbridge	Completed in the fourth quarter of 2025	--

[1] The UA Programme strives to install barrier-free access facilities (i.e. lifts or ramps) at all public footbridges, elevated walkways and subways in Hong Kong wherever feasible. The service population structure is not the primary reference data for implementation. Therefore, the HyD does not maintain information regarding proportion of elderly population served by each item.

Item name	Facility	Progress of works	Anticipated completion date
Footbridge in Wong Tai Sin District across Chuk Yuen Road connecting Chuk Yuen Plaza and Chuk Yuen Sports Centre (Structure No. CYS03)	Installation of lifts for existing footbridge	Under construction	First quarter of 2027
Subway across Chuk Yuen Road connecting Pang Ching Court and Chuk Yuen South Estate (Structure No. WTS04)	Installation of lifts for existing footbridge	Under construction	First quarter of 2028
Across Chun Wah Road near Jordan Valley Playground (Structure No. KT05)	Installation of lifts for existing footbridge	Under construction	First quarter of 2028
Across Sau Mau Ping Road near Ning Po No.2 College in Shun Tin Estate (Structure No. KT06)	Installation of lifts for existing footbridge	Under construction	First quarter of 2028

The Government would review the need of conducting systematic examination for the walking accessibility and barrier-free access facilities of hillside communities in Hong Kong in a timely manner, and explore whether dedicated resources would be retained for commencing relevant accessibility studies according to the latest policy development.

(3) The Government is currently optimising the preliminary design of "Pedestrian Link near Chuk Yuen North Estate" project, with a view to enhancing the system accessibility and the cost-effectiveness of works. The Government will carry out ground investigation works at relevant locations in first half of 2026 to collect geotechnical data for the detailed design works at next stage. Since the project is still under study and design stage, there is no project cost estimate at present. The Government will constantly review the priority of projects and adjust the implementation progress appropriately in the light of the latest policy development.

(4) (I) <u>Hillside Escalator Links and Elevator Systems (HEL)</u>
The Government estimates that the estimate on HEL Projects in 2026-27 financial year is $218.5 million, which pays for the expenditure on investigation, design and works

under construction within the year. As mentioned above, the Government will follow the stipulated assessment mechanism and clear indicators, constantly review the effectiveness of the assessment mechanism and communicate with various stakeholders when implementing the HEL projects, with a view to ensuring that the relevant projects meet the public needs.

(II) "Universal Accessibility" (UA) Programme

The Government estimates that the works under the UA Programme will require an estimated budget of $1.1233 billion in the 2026-27 financial year to fund investigation study, design and construction costs for that year. As mentioned above, the HyD will continue to communicate with local communities and provide relevant information of various walkways when implementing the UA Programme, with a view to facilitating the District Council and local stakeholders in setting priorities for lift construction after thorough consideration of relevant factors.

The Government would continue to monitor and enhance the pedestrian facilities and accessibility of hillside communities through existing mechanisms.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0313)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) District and Maintenance Works

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Uneveness on footpath surfaces are common owing to daily usage and impacts of weather, causing inconvenience to pedestrians and even posing potential safety concerns. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

(1) Over the past 3 years, what were the numbers of reports or complaints regarding poor quality and conditions of footpath surfaces received by the Government? What were the manpower and expenditures involved in processing cases and conducting site inspections? Please list the relevant information in a table, categorised by the 18 Districts.

(2) Over the past 3 years, what were the respective works items and programmes for footpath surface maintenance and reconstruction implemented by the Government? What were the relevant expenditure breakdowns and works progress? Please list the relevant information in a table, categorised by the 18 Districts.

(3) Was science and technology adopted to effectively monitor the damage on footpath surfaces in the past? If yes, what are the details? If not, will the monitoring of footpath surfaces be optimised in the future?

Asked by: Hon HO King-hong, Adrian Pedro (LegCo internal reference no.: 16)

Reply:

(1) The numbers of complaints received by the Highways Department (HyD) over the past 3 years (i.e. 2023-2025) regarding uneven footpath surfaces in various districts are as follows:

District	2023	2024	2025
Central & Western District	863	1659	1696
Eastern District	639	1034	814
Southern District	320	515	392

District	2023	2024	2025
Wan Chai District	469	675	491
Kowloon City District	258	415	549
Yau Tsim Mong District	1114	1299	1211
Sham Shui Po District	584	475	498
Wong Tai Sin District	158	217	116
Kwun Tong District	319	661	613
Tai Po District	252	259	223
Yuen Long District	699	702	535
Tuen Mun District	360	356	308
North District	374	482	404
Sai Kung District	221	200	179
Sha Tin District	387	542	470
Tsuen Wan District	504	663	537
Kwai Tsing District	334	365	315
Islands District	173	122	122

Upon receipt of complaints regarding uneven footpath surfaces, the HyD's road maintenance section in the corresponding district would deploy its personnel to conduct on-site inspections. The HyD would also assign contractors to carry out the necessary repair works according to the actual footpath surface conditions and provide a timely response to the complainants regarding the follow-up progress. Since these tasks are part of routine footpath maintenance work, the HyD does not maintain separate statistics on the manpower and expenditure involved in handling the cases of uneven footpath surfaces (including on-site inspections).

(2) The HyD conducts regular inspections for footpaths under its ambit and arranges for appropriate repair works in a timely manner, with a view to ensuring the good conditions of footpaths being maintained. Since mid-2024, the HyD has progressively increased the frequency of routine inspections for footpaths under the road maintenance term contracts in various districts. The previous routine inspections (conducted every 1 to 3 months) and detailed inspections (conducted every 6 months) have been integrated into comprehensive inspections, with the frequency increased to once a month. Important footpaths (such as those within Pedestrian Scheme areas) are inspected every 7 days. If damage that may lead to safety problems of footpaths were identified during inspections, or complaints or reports regarding uneven footpath surfaces were received, the HyD would carry out assessments and take prompt and appropriate follow-up actions (such as fencing off the relevant road section, checking nearby footpath surfaces, carrying out repair works, etc.). The HyD would also conduct timely footpath repair and reconstruction works when necessary.

To enhance the safety and serviceability of public footpath network, the HyD has commenced footpath reconstruction works at an extended scale in a total of 80 footpath sections in various districts over the past 3 years. The total project expenditure is approximately $90 million. The relevant project information is as follows:

District	Footpath section	Works progress
Central & Western District	Queensway/Justice Drive, Des Voeux Road West, Man Kwong Street	Completed
	Wing Lok Street between Des Voeux Road West and Bonham Strand, Queensway westbound between Tamar Street and Cotton Tree Drive	Underway
Eastern District	Shau Kei Wan Main Street East, Shau Kei Wan Road, Siu Sai Wan Road near Fu Yee Road, Tin Hau Temple Road	Completed
Southern District	Heung Yip Road, Yip Kan Street/Yip Hing Street/Nam Long Shan Road, Nam Fung Road, Pok Fu Lam Road near Pok Fu Lam Village	Completed
Wan Chai District	Lee Garden Road, Wong Nai Chung Road, Matheson Street between Russell Street and Sharp Street East, Gloucester Road and Hing Fat Street near Victoria Park	Completed
Kowloon City District	To Fuk Road, Bulkeley Street, Forfar Road, Tung Tsing Road	Completed
Yau Tsim Mong Distirct	Salisbury Road/Kowloon Park Drive, Science Museum Road, Granville Road, Hamilton Street between Portland Street and Shanghai Street, Shanghai Street near Waterloo Road, Argyle Street between Luen Wan Street and Peace Avenue	Completed
Sham Shui Po District	Tonkin Street, Hing Wah Street, Lai Chi Kok Road near Exit A of MTR Mei Foo Station, Shun Ning Road between Wing Lung Street and Cheung Fat Street	Completed
Wong Tai Sin District	Wang Tau Hom South Road, Lung Cheung Road (near Temple Mall), Yuk Wah Street and Tsz Wan Shan Road northbound, Lung Cheung Road, Po Kong Village Road and Ying Fung Lane	Completed
Kwun Tong District	Lam Hing Street/Wang Kwun Road/Wang Chiu Road, Hing Tin Street, Yau Tong Road, Sheung Yuet Road between Centre Parc and Shui Hing Centre, Ngau Tau Kok Road between Luen On Street and Hong Ning Road, New Clear Water Bay Road	Completed
Tai Po District	Chong San Road, Fo Shing Road, Ma Wo Road and Ma Chung Road	Completed
	Chui Lok Street	Underway
Yuen Long District	Tin Tsz Road, Tin Shui Path, Town Park Road South, Town Park Road North	Completed
Tuen Mun District	Shek Pai Tau Road, Tsing Chung Koon Road, Tuen Lung Street, Yan Oi Tong Circuit, Tuen Yan Street, Wo Ping Path	Completed
North District	Lung Wan Street, Chi Cheong Road, Wah Ming Road, Po Kin Road between Ping Kong Road and Fan Kam Road	Completed
	Jockey Club Road between Tin Ping Road and Po Wan Road	Underway

District	Footpath section	Works progress
Sai Kung District	Kai King Road, Yuk Nga Lane, Hong Kong Velodrome, Yi Chun Street	Completed
Sha Tin District	Tsuen Nam Road, Sai Sha Road/Ning Tai Road, Yuen Wo Road, Sha Tin Tau Road near Che Kung Temple Sports Centre, Tai Wai Road near Grandway Garden	Completed
Tsuen Wan District	Hau Tei Square, Yuen Tun Circuit, Sha Tsui Road between Tso Kung Street and Moon Lok Dai Ha, Sam Pei Square	Completed
Kwai Tsing District	Wah Yuen Drive, Tsing Luk Street, Hing Shing Road, Nga Ying Chau Street	Completed
Islands District	Chung Shing Street, Tung Chung Waterfront Road	Completed
	Tat Tung Road	Underway

(3) The HyD has been striving to use innovative technologies and digitise workflows in public road maintenance to enhance the efficiency of road maintenance. The HyD has gradually implemented the Road Maintenance Monitoring System (RMMS) since late 2022 to digitalise road (including footpath) inspection and supervision processes, enabling the HyD's personnel to manage road inspections and maintenance works carried out by its road maintenance contractors in a more efficient manner. The system was fully adopted across all road maintenance contracts in 2024. The HyD is now developing the second phase of the RMMS, which will incorporate additional monitoring and management functions, such as automatic alerts or warnings to contractors with unsatisfactory maintenance progress, digitalised checking procedures, etc., to further enhance the efficiency and effectiveness of road maintenance.

- End –

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0314)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) District and Maintenance Works

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the repair and maintenance works and road improvement works of public carriageways and road facilities carried out by the Highways Department, will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

(1) According to the Government's knowledge, what were the numbers of traffic accidents caused by poor carriageway surfaces over the past 3 years?

(2) What were the frequencies, manpower and expenditures for site inspections on busy trunk roads and road sections? Please list the relevant information in a table, categorised by the 18 districts.

(3) As at 2025, is there any information on the progress of adopting more durable and environmental materials to improve road surface conditions? If yes, what were the item and programme details? It not, will relevant studies or trials be commenced in the future?

Asked by: Hon HO King-hong, Adrian Pedro (LegCo internal reference no.: 17)

Reply:

(1) Over the past 3 years, the Highways Department (HyD) did not receive any cases regarding traffic accidents caused by poor carriageway surfaces.

(2) The HyD has in place a regular road inspection mechanism, through which term contractors are engaged to carry out the relevant works. Expressways carrying high-speed traffic and high traffic are inspected daily, other trunk roads are inspected every week while ordinary roads are inspected every 1 to 3 months respectively. When road damage is identified, appropriate repair works would be arranged by contractors in a timely manner.

As at 31 March 2025, the HyD has an establishment of 1 139 staff members under the Programme of District and Maintenance Works, who are tasked with district administration and road maintenance works. Apart from works related to road

maintenance (including regular road inspections), the relevant manpower is also responsible for planning and managing road maintenance programmes and supervising maintenance works, managing the emergency control centres to deal with emergencies such as landslips, washouts and fallen trees, as well as co-ordinating road excavation works carried out by public utilities. Besides, the relevant manpower is required to handle other district administration works, which include providing advice on road matters relating to land sale, public and private sector development plans and provision of access, as well as the implementation of minor road improvement works. There is no separate breakdown of the staff establishment for on-site road surface inspections in respect to the busy trunk roads and road sections.

The road maintenance expenditures of the HyD from 2023 to 2025 are $1.7291 billion, $1.6559 billion and $1.6576 billion respectively. Road inspection is a part of the HyD's overall road maintenance works and the HyD does not maintain a breakdown of figures by districts.

(3) The HyD attaches great importance to the quality of road works and has been continuously researching and introducing more durable bituminous materials for paving, so as to enhance road quality and reduce maintenance frequency and resource consumption. Since 1 April 2025, the HyD has fully adopted "Highly Modified Stone Mastic Asphalt (HMSMA)", a highly modified bituminous material that has better anti-deformation, anti-aging and anti-fatigue performance than the existing bituminous materials, for road paving at suitable locations. For the repair works of high speed road surfaces, the HyD would adopt Highly Modified Friction Course (HMFC) material, which exhibits high permeability and can rapidly drain rain water from road surfaces, thus reducing the opportunities of traffic accidents caused by slippery road surfaces. Also, such material can reduce the noise generated while cars rolling over the road surfaces, creating a quieter road environment. The HyD will continuously research and introduce more durable bituminous material for road paving, thereby enhancing road surface quality and reducing repair frequency, and at the same time creating a better driving environment for drivers.

The HyD has recently introduced road surface material namely "Ultra-thin Overlay (UTO)" from Chinese Mainland. The bitumen used possesses higher viscosity and elasticity than the highly modified bitumen currently used in Hong Kong and the aggregates used called Diabase which is stronger and have higher abrasion resistant than the commonly used granite. The UTO is suitable for repairing both bituminous and concrete pavements. With a thickness of only about 20 mm, it reduces resource consumption and shortens construction time. The HyD successfully completed on-site trials paving schemes at two locations on Hong Kong Island in December 2025, namely Shing Tai Road in Chai Wan and the Wong Chuk Hang Road Flyover and the trials achieved satisfactory results. In future, the HyD will apply this material at suitable locations based on actual site conditions and needs, so as to continuously enhance road surface quality.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2334)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational expenses

Programme: (3) Railway Development

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

1. Regarding the performance indicators for 2026-27, please list the descriptions, total expenditures and expenditure estimates within the year of the following 4 items in a table:

   (i) 9 capital projects under design and construction entrusted to the railway corporation or other agencies; and

   (ii) 9 studies and other tasks carried out by consultants.

2. Please list the 131 transport and planning studies with railway planning input provided by the Highways Department.

3. It was mentioned in the "Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026–27" that the investigation and design for the Smart and Green Mass Transit System in East Kowloon and the Hong Kong Section of Hong Kong – Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu – Qianhai) would be carried out. In the Capital Works Reserve Fund, the estimate for 6067TR and 6070TR for 2026-27 is roughly $48 million and $112 million respectively. What are the purposes of the 2 expenditure items and the progress of the investigation and design works?

4. What are the routes that are "protected for the recommended railway projects and other longer term proposals"? Will land resumption be involved in the progress and the funding application required within the year?

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 32)

Reply:

1. (i) The capital projects under design and construction entrusted to the railway corporation or other agencies by the Highways Department (HyD) are tabulated below:

	Projects		Total project estimate ($ million)	Expenditure estimates in 2026-27 ($ million)
1	6051TR	Shatin to Central Link (SCL) – design and site investigation	2,407.5	1.2
2	6052TR	Hong Kong section of the Guangzhou - Shenzhen - Hong Kong Express Rail Link (XRL) – design and site investigation	2,733.0	0.1
3	6053TR	XRL – construction of railway works	70,070.6	30.3
4	6056TR	South Island Line (East) (SIL(E)) – Essential Public Infrastructure Works (EPIW)	1,213.2	2.2
5	6057TR	XRL – construction of non-railway works	16,015.0	30.2
6	6061TR	SCL – construction of railway works – remaining works	74,130.1	432.5
7	6062TR	SCL – construction of non-railway works –remaining works	7,350.1	39.3
8	6063TR	SCL – construction of railway works – advance works	7,102.6	0.1
9	6064TR	SCL – construction of non-railway works –advance works	1,448.2	0.1

(ii) The 9 studies carried out by consultants are as follows:

	Consultancy studies	Total estimate ($ million)	Expenditure estimates in 2026-27 ($ million)
1	Smart and Green Mass Transit System in East Kowloon - Investigation, Design and Construction	173.8	32.9
2	Hong Kong Section of Hong Kong - Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu - Qianhai) - Investigation, Design and Construction	158.0	54.0

	Consultancy studies	Total estimate ($ million)	Expenditure estimates in 2026-27 ($ million)
3	Shatin to Central Link (SCL) - Monitoring and Verification for Construction, Testing and Commissioning Phase - Investigation	275.6	0.4
4	Shatin to Central Link (SCL) Professional Services in connection with the Service Concession for the Operation of the SCL - Investigation	9.5	0.1
5	Consultancy Services for Risk Assessment in relation to Project Supervision, Monitoring and Checking for Tuen Mun South Extension, Northern Link Phase 1 Kwu Tung Station and Hung Shui Kiu Station Projects - Investigation	10.5	1.8
6	Consultancy Services for Risk Assessment in relation to Project Supervision, Monitoring and Checking for Tung Chung Line Extension, Oyster Bay Station and Airport Railway Extended Overrun Tunnel Projects – Investigation	10.6	1.4
7	Consultancy study on Independent Checking of the Financial Arrangement of Part 2 of the Northern Link Project – Investigation	9.6	5.9
8	Professional Support for Implementation of Building Control Mechanism for Projects of Cross-boundary Railways and Smart and Green Mass Transit Systems – Investigation	6.5	3.6
9	Consultancy study on Independent Checking of the Financial Arrangement of Pak Shek Kok Station – Investigation	To be confirmed (subject to the result of the tendering exercise)	To be confirmed (subject to the result of the tendering exercise)

2. The Highways Department (HyD) provides technical support for the parts that involve railway planning in the planning and engineering studies carried out by various bureaux, departments and organisations. The HyD is anticipated to provide support for 131 studies in 2026. These studies mainly involve the development and infrastructure planning carried out for different districts of Hong Kong, including the planning studies on new development areas, the investigation and engineering studies on new infrastructures, the engineering studies on road improvement, etc. The details are tabulated below:

Relevant bureaux, departments or organisations	No. of study items (Nos.)
Civil Engineering and Development Department	71
Drainage Services Department	9
Highways Department	31
Transport Department	6
Water Supplies Department	3
Others (including the Development Bureau, Innovation, Technology and Industry Bureau, Architectural Services Department, Buildings Department, Electrical and Mechanical Services Department, Planning Department, MTR Corporation Limited, Urban Renewal Authority, etc.)	11

3. Item 6067TR is for carrying out the investigation and design, as well as the relevant site investigation works for the Smart and Green Mass Transit System in East Kowloon. The relevant works commenced in July 2024 after funding approval was obtained from the Finance Committee of the Legislative Council (LegCo). The estimate for the item for 2026-27 is mainly for the relevant consultancy contract's expenditure. The Government plans to invite tenders for the Smart and Green Mass Transit System in East Kowloon in 2026, with the target of commissioning by 2033.

   Item 6070TR covers the investigation and design works, as well as the relevant site investigation works for the Hong Kong Section of Hong Kong - Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu - Qianhai)(HSWRL). Funding was approved from the Finance Committee of the LegCo in June 2025, and the works commenced thereafter. The estimate for the item for 2026-27 is mainly for the payment of the design and the relevant site investigation works, statutory procedures, financial assessments, etc. that are being carried out currently. Our target is to have the Hong Kong Section of the HSWRL with technically ready for tendering in 2027, followed immediately by detailed design and construction works. We strive for completion of the construction works in 2034, followed immediately by integrated testing and commissioning to realise the common goal of the two governments of two places to commission the HSWRL in 2035.

4. Regarding the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026–27 "to undertake route protection of the recommended railway projects and other longer term proposals", the projects involved include the HSWRL, Part 2 of the Northern Link (NOL) project, South Island Line (West), Tseung Kwan O Line Southern Extension, Central Rail Link, Northern Link Eastern Extension, Northeast New Territories Line, etc. It is anticipated that some of the projects above will involve land/stratum resumption.

   Part 2 of the NOL project, South Island Line (West) and Tseung Kwan O Line Southern Extension are planned to be implemented under the ownership approach. Under this framework, the Government grants property development rights to the railway corporation to bridge funding gap of the project. The railway corporation will be responsible for the financing, design, construction, operation and maintenance of the project, and ultimately owns the project. This arrangement does not involve government capital works

expenditure. As for the remaining projects, the Government will examine the implementation and financial arrangement for each railway project on a case-by-case basis, taking into account their construction and operation details, as well as the project's uniqueness and individual circumstances. The detailed arrangements are yet to be confirmed.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2335)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational expenses

Programme: (4) Technical Services

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

1. In Subhead 272 Electricity for public lighting, the revised estimate is roughly $230 million, which has decreased by more than 12% when compared to the approved estimate. What are the reasons for the significant reduction of the revised estimate? Also, what are the reasons for the further 2% reduction in the 2026-27 Budget?

2. Adopting environmentally friendly energy in public facilities promotes the reduction of carbon footprint in Hong Kong. What are the ratios of adopting environmentally friendly energy for the roads and other public facilities under the ambit of the Highways Department (HyD)? What are the main areas for using environmentally friendly energy? Are there any plans to further implement the application of environmentally friendly energy within the year? If yes, what are the details and expenditures? If not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 33)

Reply:

1. Subhead 272 Electricity for public lighting covers the electricity expenditure for all road facilities, including street lighting, traffic signals, lifts and escalators at footbridges and subways, and ventilation equipment at public transport interchanges. The revised estimate for 2025-26 was 12.9% less than the approved estimate, mainly due to the reduction in fuel cost adjustments charged by the two power companies and the Highways Department's (HyD) constant promotion of energy-saving measures for road facilities to reduce electricity consumption. For 2026-27, the HyD has further set an energy-saving target to reduce electricity expenditure by 2%.

2. To continuously promote energy efficiency and renewable energy, the HyD considers the adoption of renewable energy technologies in road and relevant public facility projects wherever reasonably practicable. In recent years, the HyD has installed solar panels and photovoltaic (PV) systems on suitable road structures, such as footbridges, subways, covered walkways, and noise enclosures. These systems convert solar energy into electricity to power various road facilities (including facilities such as lighting, escalators

etc.). The solar panel systems installed on road structures generate a total of approximately 60 000 kWh of energy every year. In 2026-27, the construction expenditure for photovoltaic (PV) systems is approximately $1.7 million. In addition to installations on highway structures, the HyD has also installed PV panels and solar thermal water heating system on the rooftop of the Kai Tak Administration Building under the Central Kowloon Bypass project. They can generate over 20 000 kWh of energy annually.

The HyD will continue to explore other technically and financially feasible options for adopting green energy in road and relevant public facility projects.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0062)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Railway Development

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Comparing with the 2025-26 Budget, the relevant description "to provide technical advice on the planning of the proposed Hong Kong Island West – Hung Shui Kiu Rail Link to support the proposed development of the Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands" was removed from the "Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026–27". Please advise this Committee on the following:

(1) Did the removal of the item description mean that the implementation schedule of the relevant railway has been largely postponed or suspended?

(2) What is the current situation of the overall planning and study of the Hong Kong Island West – Hung Shui Kiu Rail Link? Are there any construction schemes in the absence of the Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands in hand for consideration?

(3) Did the Bureau re-evaluate how to effectively connect the Northern Metropolis and the core business districts on Hong Kong Island in the absence of the said railway project?

Asked by: Hon LAM Siu-lo, Andrew (LegCo internal reference no.: 30)

Reply:

Under the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint, the Government presented a series of transport infrastructure projects relating to the proposed Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands (KYCAI), including the Hong Kong Island West – Hung Shui Kiu Rail Link, in order to connect the Northern Metropolis and the urban area.

As there is currently no concrete timetable for the implementation of the KYCAI reclamation project, the Government will review the arrangements for planning and implementation of the relevant transport infrastructure projects which will involve considering various options in the absence of the KYCAI development, including a detailed study on transport demand, technical feasibility and transport and cost-effectiveness, and will prioritise relevant projects according to urgency and implement them in a timely and orderly manner.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0064)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) District and Maintenance Works

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It was mentioned in the "Matters requiring Special Attention in 2026-27" that the Highways Department (HyD) would strive to make use of innovative technologies and to digitalise the work processes to enhance efficiency. This item has been mentioned in the past few years. Please advise this Committee on the following:

(1) Over the past 3 years, what specific measures of digitalisation the workflows has the HyD implemented in terms of road maintenance and management? What are the actual outcomes of these efficiency-enhancing measures?

(2) In 2026-27, what are the estimated expenditures used for implementing the digitalisation of workflows and application of innovative technologies?

(3) Did the HyD plan to further integrate the Excavation Permit Management System with the data of the Water Supplies Department, Drainage Services Department and other departments etc. to minimise the impacts of repeated road openings on the public?

Asked by: Hon LAM Siu-lo, Andrew (LegCo internal reference no.: 31)

Reply:

(1) The Highways Department (HyD) has been striving to use innovative technologies and digitalise workflows in the maintenance of public road to enhance work efficiency. The measures developed and implemented by the HyD for the application of innovative technologies and digitalization of workflows over the past 3 years are as follows:

At present, the Road Maintenance Monitoring System (RMMS) has been used in all road maintenance contracts. RMMS fully digitalises the monitoring and administrative work of road maintenance. In the past, whenever the HyD's personnel identified defects in road facilities during inspections, they were required to fill in and send the relevant physical form to the contractors upon completion of the inspections. With the RMMS, the personnel can now log on to the system during on-site inspections, capture the information on damaged facilities and notify the contractors through

electronic means, so that contractors can receive the relevant data promptly and arrange for repair works accordingly. After completion of repair works, the contractors can also use RMMS to report the work done and submit maintenance records. The adoption of RMMS can reduce complicated paperwork and transmission time to enhance work efficiency and facilitate the HyD's personnel to monitor the progress of maintenance works which resulting in better record keeping. The HyD is now developing the second phase of RMMS, which will incorporate more monitoring and management functions, such as automatic alerts or warnings to contractors with unsatisfactory maintenance progress, as well as digitalised checking procedures, etc., to further enhance the efficiency and effectiveness of road maintenance. The second phase of the system has been implemented in 7 road maintenance contracts in early 2026 and aims to implement in all road maintenance contracts by mid-2026

Furthermore, the HyD has adopted the Road Defect Detection System (RDDS) to conduct daily road inspections. The system utilises high-definition cameras installed on patrol vehicles to capture images of road conditions and global satellite positioning technology to record the corresponding image locations. It then uses artificial intelligence (AI) technology to automatically identify road surface cracks and discoloured road markings, instead of conducting the visual inspections by road inspectors in the past to ensure that the detection results are objective and accurate. In the past, road inspectors had to conduct visual inspection and measurement on the road surface after road closures, which only covered a few hundred meters of carriageways per day at most. Currently, the contractors can obtain a comprehensive overview of the latest road conditions without the need of road closures. This enables more effective planning of road maintenance and minimises the impacts on traffic. With the full adoption of the RDDS, the average time taken by the contractors from completion of road detection works to submission of the relevant detection reports has been substantially reduced from 48 hours to within 24 hours.

The HyD commenced the RDDS upgrading works in 2025, introducing advanced AI algorithms to significantly enhance the accuracy and processing speed of image recognition. In addition to the existing detection of road cracks and discoloured road markings, the system’s detection function will be expanded to identify faded, deformed, or traffic signs obstructed by vegetation, excessive weed growth, damaged gullies and manhole covers etc. The relevant system upgrading works is expected to be completed in the fourth quarter of 2026.

The HyD has also employed service contractors since 2024 to conduct researches and development on the Road Condition Assessment System (RCAS), which uses patrol vehicles equipped with laser scanning equipment and global satellite positioning technology to drive on a carriageway at normal speed, and can automatically identify and accurately record various types of defects on road surfaces such as potholes, rutting etc. It calculates a Pavement Condition Index for every 100 meters which provides reference to relevant road maintenance personnel to determine the priority of road reconstruction or resurfacing works.

The RCAS can inspect approximately 200 kilometers of carriageways daily. In the past, the road inspectors had to conduct visual inspections and measurements, which only covered a few hundred meters of carriageways per day at most. The RCAS allows

maintenance team to have a more comprehensive overview of the latest road conditions, and enables more efficient resource utilisation for planning road repair works. The RCAS conducts detection and measurement of road defects without road closures which reduces the resources and time required as compared with conventional road inspection method and minimizes the impact on traffic. The HyD will start incorporating the technology into new road maintenance contracts in phases starting from this year.

(2) In 2026-27, the estimated operating expenditure for taking forward workflow digitalisation and innovative technology in public road maintenance under Programme (2) is approximately $11.73 million.

(3) Since 2009, the HyD has launched the web-based Excavation Permit Management System (XPMS) to coordinate and control public road excavation works electronically, replacing the traditional paper-based excavation permit application process. In order to obtain a more comprehensive overview of all proposed excavation works plans for better coordination, thereby reducing repeated road openings and minimising the impact on the public and traffic, the XPMS identifies potential conflicts amongst different proposed road excavation plans based on relevant input data (such as overlapping of excavation areas or in proximity that may lead to conflicts in temporary traffic arrangements) upon registration of proposed road excavation plans by the works proponents. The system then requires the relevant works proponents (such as utility undertakings and government works departments, including the Water Supplies Department, Drainage Services Department, etc.) to communicate and submit coordination reports for further consideration of their applications. Furthermore, the system determines whether proposed road excavations comply with the Road Opening Restriction (where newly constructed carriageways and footpaths are generally prohibited from excavation for 5 years and 1 year respectively) and the Repeated Opening Restriction (which prohibits the same works proponent and other works proponents from re-excavating the same road section within 6 months and 3 months upon completion respectively), so as to reduce impacts of repeated road openings on road users.

Under appropriate circumstances, the HyD would proactively encourage works proponents to group excavations by adopting a common trench approach that meets the needs of all road opening works. Upon all works being completed in an orderly manner, the entire road surface would be reinstated by the last permittee. This approach can strengthen coordination of road excavation works and minimise repeated openings.

Furthermore, following the HyD's optimisation of the XPMS in 2019, the system can automatically identify those applications that require coordination and adjust their works schedules to be staggered by 3 to 6 months from other works proponents. These cases do not involve any violation of the Repeated Opening Restriction but do not adopt common trench approach. To encourage the use of common trench and avoid repeated openings, the HyD may consider rejecting an application if the works proponent fails to provide a reasonable justification for not adopting a common trench.

The HyD is currently considering to develop new programme and interface to facilitate the works proponents to directly download the data of the proposed excavation areas from XPMS and upload them to the Underground Utilities Information System (UUIS) which is being optimised with the assistance of the Lands Department. The UUIS will

display integrated underground utility information within the proposed excavation areas, including water mains, stormwater drains, sewers, gas pipes, electric cables, etc. This allows works proponents to analyse the alignments and depths of underground utilities, thereby facilitating the development of more effective engineering details and construction methodologies, and reducing the impact on the public arising from repeated road openings caused by alignment changes due to unforeseen underground utilities. The aforesaid optimised function of the UUIS is expected to be launched in the first half of 2027.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB034**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0547)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational expenses

Programme: (3) Railway Development

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Highways Department (HyD) has promulgated the establishment of the Railway Checking Unit (RCU) recently in order to expedite the implementation of new railway projects. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

(a) How are the responsibilities divided among the RCU, and the existing Railway Development Office (RDO) and Northern Metropolis Railway Office (NMRO) of the HyD? What are the similarities and differences in the positioning of these departments?

(b) Over the past 3 years and projected for 2026-27, what were the respective grades, ranks, posts and salaries of the staff members, and the operating and equipment expenditures of the RDO and NMRO?

(c) Projected for 2026-27, what are the respective grades, ranks, posts and salaries of the staff members, and the operating and equipment expenditures of the RCU ?

(d) The Government has proposed to establish the Railway Department in order to merge the RDO and NMRO of the HyD with the Railway Branch of the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department so as to strengthen the monitoring of railway projects and safety. However, the "Expenditure Analysis by Head" in both last year's and this year's Government Budgets did not mention the "preparation for the establishment of the Railway Department" and the HyD has established the RCU. Does it mean that the Government has suspended the establishment of the Railway Department? And

(e) Will the HyD consider to include staff members, such as electrical and mechanical engineers in the RCU to lay a solid foundation in construction stage for future railway operational safety?

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 37)

Reply:

(a) The Railway Development Office (RDO) and the Northern Metropolis Railways Office (NMRO) of the Highways Department (HyD) are responsible for the planning of Hong Kong's railway development and overseeing the implementation of new railway projects, of which the RDO is responsible for carrying out studies and formulating plans for future development programme of Hong Kong's railway network, as well as the coordination and implementation of railway projects outside the Northern Metropolis. The NMRO is responsible for the coordination and implementation of the railway projects related to the Northern Metropolis.

In addition, the HyD established the Railway Checking Unit (RCU) by redeploying internal resources to effectively implement the Hong Kong Railway Standards. This dedicated unit is responsible for handling the approval for building plans of new railway projects, conducting centralised and efficient plan processing in line with project schedules, thereby enhancing administrative efficiency. The RCU is under the headquarters of the HyD and works separately from teams implementing railway projects (i.e. the RDO and NMRO) in order to maintain its independence.

(b) The manpower establishment of the RDO and NMRO over the past 3 years and the projection for 2026-27 are as follows:

Year	**Grade**	**No. of posts**	**Salary expenditures ($ million)** [Note]
2026-27 (projected)	Directorate	10	23.30
	Professional	138	161.60
	Technical	31	17.70
	General	34	17.20
2025-26	Directorate	10	23.30
	Professional	141	165.10
	Technical	31	17.70
	General	34	17.20
2024-25	Directorate	11	25.40
	Professional	128	149.70
	Technical	31	17.70
	General	35	17.50
2023-24	Directorate	11	24.00
	Professional	126	138.50
	Technical	31	16.40
	General	35	16.50

Note in terms of notional annual mid-point salary value.

The HyD does not maintain breakdown figures of other daily operational expenses for the RDO and NMRO.

(c) The establishment of the RCU under the headquarters of the HyD in 2026-27 is shown in the table below. The figures are preliminary establishment of the RCU. The HyD would review and adjust the relevant establishment as necessary in response to the implementation progress of different railway projects.

Grade	**No. of post**	**Salary Expenditures ($ million)** [Note]
Professional Grade	8	6.78
Technical Grade	2	0.65
General Grade	1	0.32

Note in terms of notional annual mid-point salary value.

The HyD does not maintain breakdown figures of other daily operational expenditures for the RCU.

(d) The RCU is responsible for approving building plans of new railway projects. The Government previously proposed establishing the Railways Department to integrate the existing NMRO and RDO under the HyD, as well as the Railways Branch under the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department (EMSD). The original proposal does not include the roles of approving building plans of railway projects, i.e. the roles of the RCU.

Since the establishment of a new department involves additional recurring manpower and resource requirements, the Government, under the direction of prudent control of operating expenditures, considers it necessary to reconsider the appropriate timing for establishing the Railways Department.

(e) The RCU is specifically responsible for handling the approval for building plans of new railway projects. Its members include professionals related to construction engineering, such as building surveyors, structural engineers, civil engineers, etc. The RCU collaborates with relevant departments, including the EMSD, to ensure that building plans meet the safety operational needs of buildings and railway systems.

Besides, the EMSD will implement the Project Safety Review process for new railway projects, which involves conducting systematic assessments of long-term operational safety of new railway projects during various stages of projects, such as design, construction, installation, testing, etc. The aim is to identify potential safety hazards in major buildings and electrical and mechanical equipment at an early stage and give comments, enabling timely follow-up actions by the project teams and ensuring the long-term safety of railway operations.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0961)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational expenses

Programme: (3) Railway Development

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Highways Department (HyD) has recently promulgated the Hong Kong Railway Standards, with a view to driving the new railway projects of Hong Kong with enhanced speed and efficiency, and striving for shorter construction times and lower costs. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

(a) Regarding the Hong Kong Railway Standards, what are the (i) cost of consultancy study and (ii) the respective manpower and expenditures on supervising the consultants by the HyD?

(b) The Northern Link will reportedly be the first railway project in Hong Kong that adopts the Hong Kong Railway Standards. It is anticipated that 20% of construction cost can be saved and the completion of the spur line part can be accelerated by at least 2 years. Which works sequences are associated for the savings in cost and time? What new technologies are adopted respectively?

(c) The HyD's planned target for Programme (3) "ensuring timely completion of Part 1 of Northern Link Project by 2034" for 2026 is 10%. What indicators (for example construction costs, volumes of soil involved in construction, working hours, or other factors) are this value based on? Given that the Government is striving to commission the Northern Link Main Line and Spur Line simultaneously in 2034, why didn't the HyD define the same types of indicators for the other parts of Northern Link Main Line and Spur Line?

(d) Additional burden to the Tuen Ma Line, Kam Sheung Road Station in particular, would definitely be incurred upon the commissioning of the Northern Link. Will the Government take the opportunity of the promulgation of the Hong Kong Railway Standards to accelerate the commencement of the Central Rail Link? If yes, what is the schedule? If not, what are the reasons? And

(e) Apart from formulating the Hong Kong Railway Standards on the technical aspects, does the Government have any measures for planning the cultivation and retention of railway talents? If yes, what is the resource allocation? If not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 36)

Reply:

(a) The consultancy fee for the formulation of the Hong Kong Railway Standards is approximately $2.92 million. The Highways Department (HyD) undertook the formulation of the Hong Kong Railway Standards with existing manpower, therefore an itemised breakdown is not available.

(b) The new Hong Kong Railway Standards promulgated by the HyD facilitate the use of a broader selection of advanced construction technologies, construction materials, equipment and railway systems for new railway projects according to individual circumstances and needs, provide clear technical specifications as the approval basis of the supervisory authorities, and also facilitate the development and optimisation of work processes by the industry, driving the new railway projects of Hong Kong with enhanced speed and efficiency. In particular, the Hong Kong Railway Standards encourage the adoption of innovative construction machinery, technologies and materials (such as larger-scale or wider scale of standardised modular integrated construction, high-strength steel, and ultra-high-performance concrete), as well as advanced equipment and construction specifications (such as the selection, design, construction and control of tunnel boring machines). The cost savings for individual projects will vary depending on actual circumstances including the nature, scale and site conditions of the project.

Regarding the Northern Link (NOL) project, the Government is currently reviewing the project estimate provided by the MTRCL. Based on our rough estimation, the adoption of the Hong Kong Railway Standards, coupled with the synergies generated by implementing the NOL Main Line and the NOL Spur Line together, the construction cost is expected to be reduced by about 20% for the NOL project. Moreover, the programme of the NOL Spur Line could be advanced by 2 years, enabling it to be commissioned together with the NOL Main Line by 2034 or earlier.

(c) The expected completion percentage of the NOL project under Programme (3) is calculated based on the cumulative expenditure divided by the total project cost of the relevant project. As for NOL Spur Line and other parts of NOL Main Line, they fall within the scope of the part 2 of the NOL project, which the Government is currently negotiating with the MTRCL regarding the financial arrangement of the subject project agreement. The relevant targets of part 2 of NOL project will be formulated after the project agreement is executed.

(d) The proposed Central Rail Link will connect Kam Tin to Kowloon Tong, strengthening the connectivity between the "Northern Metropolis" and urban areas in Hong Kong and Kowloon. We are preparing for the next stage of implementation for the proposed Central Rail Link, including formulating its implementation mode, financial arrangement, etc., during which the application of the Hong Kong Railway Standards will be taken into account.

(e) The Hong Kong Railway Standards provides unified and clear technical basis and guidance for the design, construction, operation and maintenance of Hong Kong's railway construction. We anticipate that this new standard helps to attract more relevant professionals (such as engineering consultancy firms, contractors, etc.), who are qualified and acquainted with railway standards from Chinese Mainland and other parts of the world, to participate in Hong Kong's railway projects. Also, this new standard helps to promote the application and exchange of innovative technologies, thereby intensifying market competition and exerting a positive impact on fostering and retaining railway talent.

The HyD will continue to make the best use of internal resources to provide trainings on the professional knowledge of railway project development to relevant government professionals and technical staff. Furthermore, the MTRCL has established the MTR Academy to promote talent development and transfer of know-how, supporting Hong Kong's long-term railway development.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2333)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational expenses

Programme: (2) District and Maintenance Works

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Under Programme (2), the Highways Department (HyD) is responsible for the maintenance of all public roads, including highway structures, government road tunnels, road furniture, road drainage and roadside slopes. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

(i) In 2025-26, the revised estimate of $2.5977 billion was $208.4 million (7.4%) less than the original estimate of $2.8061 billion. The estimate of $2.9124 billion for 2026-27 is $314.7 million (12.1%) more than the revised estimate for 2025-26. What are the reasons for the fluctuation of the revised estimate for this year and the estimate for next year when compared to the original estimate of this year?

(ii) In 2026-27, the HyD estimated a net reduction of 30 posts under Programme (2) to 1 107 posts. What are the respective grades, posts and salary expenditures involved in the deletion and retention of posts? How can the HyD ensure that sufficient manpower would be available to cope with the needs of road maintenance?

(iii) Regarding the estimated expenditures in 2026-27, what are the expenditures on salaries, operations and the equipment and materials respectively? What is the ratio of adopting new materials (for example "Highly Modified Stone Mastic Asphalt" HMSMA6 and HMSMA10) in road surfacing materials? and

(iv) Over the past 3 years and projected for 2026-27, what were the actual maintenance expenditures and the estimates respectively for various government tunnels/bridges ?

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 35)

Reply:

(i) The revised estimate for 2025-26 under Programme (2) represents a 7.4% decrease compared to the original estimate, mainly reflects the change in the completion dates of the new road works and relevant projects (including the transport infrastructure of the Diamond Hill Development Area, the retrofitting of lifts under the "Universal

Accessibility" Programme, and the Wan Chai Development Phase II), deferring the handover to the Highways Department (HyD) for maintenance, and a corresponding decrease in the provisions required for workshop services (including electrical and mechanical services, etc.).

The increase in the estimate for 2026-27 mainly reflects the handover of the aforesaid deferred projects and new road works and relevant projects to the HyD for the commencement of maintenance and a corresponding increase in the provision requirements for workshop services.

(ii) In 2026-27, it is expected that 30 posts will be deleted under Programme (2). Their respective grades, posts and salary expenditures (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary value) are tabulated below:

Grade	**Post**	**No. of Deleted Posts**	**Salary Expenditures ($ million)**
Technical Grade	Works Supervisor II	17	5.76
General Grade	Clerical Assistant and Personal Secretary II etc.	6	1.63
	Workman II	4	0.80
	Chainman	3	0.79

Besides, 1 107 posts will be retained under Programme (2) in 2026-27. Their respective grades, posts and salary expenditures (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary value) are tabulated below:

Grade	**Post**	**No. of Posts**	**Salary Expenditures ($ million)**
Professional Grade	Including Government Engineer, Chief Engineer, Senior Engineer, Engineer/Assistant Engineer, Senior Electrical and Mechanical Engineer, Electrical and Mechanical Engineer/ Assistant Electrical and Mechanical Engineer and Land Surveyor/Assistant Land Surveyor	176	196.88
Technical Grade	Including Principal Technical Officer, Senior Technical Officer, Technical Officer/Technical Officer Trainee, Principal Survey Officer, Senior Survey Officer, Survey Officer/Survey Officer Trainee, Chief Technical Officer (Inspector of Works), Senior Inspector of Works, Inspector of Works, Assistant Inspector of Works, Electrical Inspector, Assistant Electrical Inspector, Works	757	380.21

Grade	Post	No. of Posts	Salary Expenditures ($ million)
	Supervisor I, Works Supervisor II and Tracer		
General Grade	Including Executive Officer I, Executive Officer II, Senior Clerical Officer, Clerical Officer, Assistant Clerical Officer, Clerical Assistant, Office Assistant, Personal Secretary I, Personal Secretary II, Supplies Supervisor I, Supplies Supervisor II, Supplies Assistant, Senior Artisan, Artisan, Chainman, Workman II and Motor Driver etc.	174	54.85

The Government has all along been streamlining manpower by using technologies and simplifying workflows. The HyD proactively uses innovative technologies and digitalise workflows in the maintenance of public roads to enhance efficiency. The Road Maintenance Monitory System (RMMS) is currently used in all road maintenance contracts. The system streamlines paperwork and transmission times, thereby enhancing efficiency and facilitating the HyD engineering personnel to monitor the progress of maintenance works. Besides, the HyD has constantly develop and introduce more durable bituminous materials to improve road surface quality and reduce maintenance frequency which enhancing the durability of road surface and reduce maintenance frequency effectively (see paragraph (iii) below for details).

The HyD will continue to explore innovative technologies and research more durable materials, allowing deploying manpower resources more flexibly and to maintain the standards of public road inspections, maintenance, and management levels amidst appropriate adjustments in financial resources and staff establishments, ensuring a safe and smooth travel condition for the public.

(iii) The provision involved in Programme (2) in 2026-27 is $2.9124 billion. The estimated expenditures are as follows:

	Estimate ($ million)
Personal emoluments and personnel related expenditures	754.2
Departmental expenditures (including maintenance materials, workshop services and general departmental expenses)	374.1
Highways maintenance expenditures	1,679.1
Electricity for public lighting expenditures	105.0

Since 1 April 2025, the HyD has fully adopted "Highly Modified Stone Mastic Asphalt (HMSMA)", a highly modified bituminous material that has better anti-deformation, anti-aging and anti-fatigue performance than the existing bituminous materials, for road resurfacing at suitable locations. For the repair works of high speed road surfaces, the HyD would adopt Highly Modified Friction Course material, which exhibits high

permeability and can rapidly drain rain water from road surfaces, thus reducing the opportunities of traffic accidents caused by slippery road surfaces. Also, such material can reduce the noise generated while cars rolling over the road surfaces, creating a quieter road environment. The HyD conducts assessments for road sections prior to works and selects appropriate resurfacing materials based on their characteristics (such as traffic flow, degree of wear and tear, road speed limits, and the surrounding environment). The HyD has not set a specific proportion for the use of different new materials for 2026-27.

(iv) The maintenance expenditures on major government road tunnels in the past 3 years and the estimated maintenance expenditures in 2026-27 under Programme (2) are tabulated below **Note1**. The HyD does not maintain a breakdown of maintenance expenditures for other particular structures (including about 1 500 flyovers and bridges and about 1 600 footbridges and subways).

Name of Tunnel	**Actual expenditures in 2022-23Note2 （$ million）**	**Actual expenditures in 2024-25Note 2 （$ million）**	**Revised estimate in 2025-26 Note 2 （$ million）**	**Estimate iin 2026-27 Note 2 （$ million）**
Lion Rock Tunnel	1.33	0.79	0.93	0.88
Shing Mun Tunnel	0.14	0.19	0.30	0.45
Tseung Kwan O Tunnel	4.07	2.95	0.77	0.77
Tate's Cairn Tunnel	0.47	1.18	1.19	0.55
Science Hill Tunnel	1.52	2.71	7.30	3.81
Airport Tunnel	1.73	0.08	0.33	0.28
Lung Shan Tunnel	0.96	0.73	0.28	0.87
Chueng Shan Tunnel	0.17	0.13	0.16	0.21
Tuen Mun - Chek Lap Kok Tunnel	2.08	1.50	1.97	2.16
Cross Harbour Tunnel	2.31	3.10	3.53	3.50
Western Harbour Tunnel	0.43	2.11	0.69	1.38
Eastern Harbour Crossing	1.00	0.74	0.79	1.14
Aberdeen Tunnel	3.21	3.37	5.28	5.75
Kai Tak Tunnel	1.86	1.32	2.62	1.20
Central-Wan Chai Bypass Tunnel	17.92	6.58	8.50	12.0
Tseung Kwan O – Lam Tin TunnelNote3	-	0.34	0.54	0.62

Name of Tunnel	**Actual expenditures in 2022-23[Note2] （$ million）**	**Actual expenditures in 2024-25[Note 2] （$ million）**	**Revised estimate in 2025-26 [Note 2] （$ million）**	**Estimate iin 2026-27 [Note 2] （$ million）**
Tai Lam Tunnel[Note4]	-	-	0.15	0.17
Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section) [Note5]	-	-	0.80	2.00

Note 1: The annual maintenance expenditure fluctuates in connection with the inspection cycles and actual maintenance needs.

Note 2: The expenditures listed in the table only include the maintenance expenses of "highways maintenance" under Programme (2) District and Maintenance Works, and do not include the expenditures on "workshop services" under Programme (2) or the expenditures under Capital Works Programme. In addition, the expenditures listed in the table do not include the management fees paid to the contractors on management, operation and maintenance, the relevant operation and maintenance expenses for the implementation of "HKeToll", the depreciation expenses of the construction costs of the relevant year, the expenditures on maintenance works of other government departments, etc.

Note 3: The structures and road surfaces of the Tseung Kwan O - Lam Tin Tunnel was handed over to the HyD for maintenance in February 2024.

Note 4: The Tai Lam Tunnel was vested in the Government on 31 May 2025. The HyD is responsible for the maintenance of structure and road surface.

Note 5: Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section) was commissioned on 21 December 2025. The HyD is responsible for the maintenance of structure and road surface.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0116)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Railway Development

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Among the transport infrastructure expenditures reserved for the Northern Metropolis by the Government, what are the budget allocations for the relevant planning works of the "Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Railway" and "Northern Link Spur Line"? Does the budget involve the expenditure requirements for the relevant human resources or consultancy services related to cross-boundary cooperation? Would the current expenditure be affected if there are advancements or delays in these cross-boundary planning and development projects?

Asked by: Hon LAU Chi-pang (LegCo internal reference no.: 13)

Reply:

Regarding the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu – Qianhai) ('HSWRL'), the Finance Committee of the Legislative Council approved a funding of $303.8 million (in money-of-the-day prices) in June 2025 for commencing the investigation and design of the Hong Kong Section. The scope includes support for communication and coordination with the relevant Mainland authorities on different aspects of the HSWRL, including financial arrangements, design standards, cross-boundary patronage forecasts, technical details, operational and maintenance requirements on both sides, the design for interface with the control point in Shenzhen, temporary traffic arrangements for the cross-boundary traffic during station construction in Shenzhen Bay Port, as well as a series of cross-boundary legal matters such as contract procurements and design entrustment arrangements. Should any adjustments to the implementation timetable of the HSWRL are required during the investigation and design stage, it is expected that no additional funding will be required in general case.

The Northern Link (NOL) project is being implemented by the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) under the ownership approach, whereby the MTRCL is responsible for the financing, design, construction, operation, and maintenance of the new railway project, and ultimately owns the railway. On this basis, the planning and design work for the NOL Spur Line is undertaken by the MTRCL and does not involve government funding.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0401)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Capital Projects, (3) Railway Development

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the progress of the following railway and road improvement works, will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

(1) Regarding the Tung Chung Line Extension, what are the latest progress, anticipated completion dates and target commissioning dates of? Will the Government consider to further extend the Tung Chung Line Extension to AsiaWorld-Expo? If yes, what are the details If not, what are the reasons?

(2) Regarding the provision of Pak Shek Kok Station on the East Rail Line, what are the latest progress, anticipated implementation dates and expenditures on the relevant detailed planning and works investigation, estimated construction costs and anticipated commissioning date of the station?

(3) Regarding the two cross-border railway projects, i.e. the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu-Qianhai) and Northern Link Spur Line, what are the latest progress, anticipated implementation dates and expenditures on the detailed planning and works investigation, estimated construction costs and anticipated commissioning dates?

(4) Regarding the Improvement of Lion Rock Tunnel, what are the latest progress, relevant estimated construction costs, submission date of funding application to the Legislative Council and anticipated commissioning date?

Asked by: Hon LEE Tsz-king, Dominic (LegCo internal reference no.: 21)

Reply:

(1) The construction of the major projects of the Tung Chung Line Extension (TUE) was commenced in May 2023. The projects are implementing as scheduled for target commissioning in 2029. The TUE will extend approximately 1.3 km from the existing Tung Chung Station to Tung Chung West and construct a railway station at the west of Yat Tung Estate, as well as constructing a new railway station at Tung Chung East Reclamation Area between Tung Chung Station and Sunny Bay Station, along with an

approximately 1.2 km-long track realignment, to provide railway services for the Tung Chung New Town Extension. Currently, passengers travelling to the AsiaWorld-Expo can take the Airport Express to reach the AsiaWorld-Expo Station. The Government has no plan to extend the TUE project to the AisaWorld-Expo on Airport Island.

(2) The relevant government bureaux/departments are actively following up with the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) on the integrated development at Pak Shek Kok, which would include the building of the Pak Shek Kok Station on the existing East Rail Line, reprovisioning of the Sports Centre of The Education University of Hong Kong (EdUHK) to a site near EdUHK's main campus, and provision of housing and associated facilities by making use of the land freed up from the reprovisioning of the EdUHK Sports Centre together with nearby lands suitable for housing development. The preparation work for the integrated development at Pak Shek Kok is in its final stage. The Government will continue to closely liaise with MTRCL, and will announce the development proposal of the integrated development as early as possible upon completing the internal procedures. Concurrently, the planning of the new railway station is being carried out. The target is to commission the new railway station by 2033.

(3) In accordance with the vision of developing the "Greater Bay Area on the Rail", the Hong Kong Special Administrative Region Government and the Shenzhen Municipal People's Government continue to jointly take forward the two cross-boundary railway projects (the Hong Kong – Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu – Qianhai)(HSWRL) and the Northern Link (NOL) Spur Line) via the "Task Force for Hong Kong-Shenzhen Co-operation on Cross-Boundary Railway Infrastructure" (the Task Force). In order to enhance work coordination of the two places, the "Office for Implementing Cross-boundary Railway Projects" (the Office) and "Legal Group" were established earlier by the governments of the two places under the framework of the Task Force, so as to push forward the investigation, planning and design works, etc. of the two cross-boundary railway projects, as well as study and discuss the legal issues involved in the two projects.

Regarding the HSWRL, the Finance Committee of the Legislative Council approved a funding of $303.8 million (money-of-the-day price) for the Hong Kong Section of the HSWRL in June 2025 for commencing investigation and design works. We are currently carrying out the design and relevant site investigation works, statutory procedures, financial assessments, etc. During this process, the construction cost for the Hong Kong section of the HSWRL will be estimated. We previously invited relevant contractors and operators to submit expressions of interest for the Hong Kong section of the HSWRL. The market response was positive, with over 80 submissions received. Our target is to have the Hong Kong section of the HSWRL with the technical conditions ready for tendering in 2027, followed immediately by detailed design and construction works. We strive for completion of the construction works in 2034, followed immediately by integrated testing and commissioning to realise the common goal of the two governments to commission the HSWRL in 2035.

Regarding the NOL Spur Line, we and the MTRCL executed Part 1 Project Agreement of the NOL project last year, taking forward the NOL Main Line and NOL Spur Line as one project through a holistic planning and phased implementation strategy, thereby

accelerating and enhancing the overall efficiency of the project, advancing the programme of the NOL Spur Line significantly by 2 years and strive for commissioning with the Main Line together by 2034 or earlier. The MTRCL has given priority in commencing the works that are more ready and time-critical, including the progressive commencement of the NOL Main Line works (for example the construction of launching shaft for tunnel boring machine) since October last year. The MTRCL is also conducting the detailed planning and design as well as the statutory procedures for the NOL Spur Line in parallel, including environmental impact assessment and railway scheme gazettal. The project cost will also be estimated during the detailed planning and design process.

(4) Improvement of Lion Rock Tunnel project is currently at design stage. The Government will continue to review the cost-effectiveness of the project and implement the project in a timely and orderly manner according to priority and urgency.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0024)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Capital Projects

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the "Universal Accessibility" Programme (hereinafter referred to as "Programme"), will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

(1) List the item under construction with project name, the original completion dates and the latest estimated completion dates by district. What are the specific reasons if the items are delayed?

(2) What is the average construction duration of the completed items?

(3) How many items were withdrawn and re-tendered resulting from the contractor's issues in the past five years?

(4) The Government has introduced "Modular Integrated Construction" to expedite the progress in recent years. How many items under the Programme in total have adopted this technology as at the end of 2025?

(5) Walkways within the areas of "Tenants Purchase Scheme" estates are currently not incorporated into the Programme. Did the Government plan to review the aforesaid locations for the commencement of works? If yes, what is the schedule? If not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon LEUNG Man-kwong (LegCo internal reference no.: 30)

Reply:

(1) to (3) The Highways Department (HyD) has been pressing ahead with the implementation of a total of 382 items under various phases of the "Universal Accessibility" (UA) Programme. As at the end of February 2026, a total of 272 items were completed, representing approximately 70% of the total items. The average construction duration is about three years. Under the UA Programme, a total of 105 items are currently under construction. Their details are tabulated at **Annex**.

The overall implementation of items under the UA Programme is generally smooth. Over the past five years, nine items were delayed due to the unsatisfactory performance of an individual contractor. The HyD has withdrawn the outstanding lift retrofitting works items under the relevant works contract and included these remaining works, together with other items under the UA Programme, in a new works contract awarded in August 2024, among which five were completed in 2025 and opened for public use. The HyD will strive to complete the remaining four items progressively within this year.

(4) Since the end of 2021, the HyD has awarded a total of three contracts adopting "Modular Integrated Construction" under the UA Programme to install 76 lifts on 53 walkways.

(5) The Government has been installing barrier-free access facilities at public walkways and launched the UA Programme in August 2012 to proactively provide more barrier-free access facilities (i.e. lifts and ramps) to enhance the convenience of the public in using public walkways. In response to public demand, the Government launched a "Special Scheme" in 2019 to retrofit lifts at footbridges, subways and elevated walkways of the following three types of housing estates under the Hong Kong Housing Authority (HA), namely estates under the "Tenants Purchase Scheme" and the "Buy or Rent Option Scheme", and public rental housing estates with properties divested, provided that certain criteria are met. Under the "Special Scheme", there are a total of seven items involving estates under the "Tenants Purchase Scheme", among which one was completed in 2025 and opened for public use.

Annex

Projects currently under construction by district
(as at the end of February 2026)

Structure No.	Location	Anticipated completion date
Central & Western District		
HS22	At the Junction of Pok Fu Lam Road and Smithfield	First quarter of 2027
Eastern District		
HS14	Across Shun Tai Road near Wing Tai Road Garden[1]	Third quarter of 2026
YT01	Across Yiu Hing Road near Ngan Chun House of Tung Chun Court and Yiu Tung Shopping Centre	Second quarter of 2028
WT02	Connecting Wan Tsui Shopping Centre and podium of Yat Tsui House of Wan Tsui Estate	Second quarter of 2027
Southern District		
HKS01	Across Lei Tung Estate Road near Tung Sing House of Lei Tung Estate	First quarter of 2027
LT03	Across Lei Tung Estate Road connecting Lei Tung Commercial Centre Phases 1 and 2 near Tung Sing House of Lei Tung Estate	Second quarter of 2028
Kowloon City		
K64	Across Hung Hom Road near Dyer Avenue錯誤！尚未定義書籤。	Second quarter of 2026
KF111	Across Boundary Street near Embankment Road	Fourth quarter of 2026
KS21	Across Fat Kwong Street near Wo Chung Street	First quarter of 2028
OM01	Across Chung Hau Street near Tun Man House of Oi Man Estate	First quarter of 2027
Sham Shui Po		
SSP01	Across Tai Hang Tung Road near Nam On House of Nam Shan Estate and Tung Fai House of Tai Hang Tung Estate錯誤！尚未定義書籤。	Second quarter of 2026
Wong Tai Sin		
KS7	Across Lung Cheung Road near MTR Choi Hung Station	Fourth quarter of 2028
WTS04	Across Chuk Yuen Road connecting Pang Ching Court and Chuk Yuen South Estate	First quarter of 2028

[1] Items were delayed due to the unsatisfactory performance of an individual contractor. The HyD has withdrawn the outstanding lift retrofitting works items under the relevant works contract and included these remaining works in a new contract awarded in August 2024, together with other items under the UA Programme. The relevant works have already been resumed. These items will be completed progressively within this year.

Structure No.	Location	Anticipated completion date
KF92A	Across Lung Poon Street near Fung Tak Road錯誤！尚未定義書籤。	Fourth quarter of 2026
KF62	Across Fung Tak Road and Po Kong Village Road near Fung Tak Estate	Fourth quarter of 2027
KF77	Across Lung Cheung Road near Hammer Hill Road	Third quarter of 2026
KS14	Across Prince Edward Road East near Kwun Tong Road	Fourth quarter of 2027
WTS01	Across Ngau Chi Wan Street near Fung Chak House of Choi Wan Estate	First quarter of 2027
WTS02	Across New Clear Water Bay Road near Ping Shek Playground	Fourth quarter of 2026
WTS06	Across the Junction of Clear Water Bay Road and Fung Shing Street	First quarter of 2028
TZL01	Across Sheung Fung Street connecting Tsz Lok Estate Phase 1 and Phase 2	Third quarter of 2028
WTH01	Across Fu Mei Street connecting Wang Fai House and Wang Fu House/Wang On House of Wang Tau Hom Estate	First quarter of 2028
CYS03	Across Chuk Yuen Road connecting Chuk Yuen Plaza and Chuk Yuen Sports Centre	First quarter of 2027
Kwun Tong		
K49	Along Lee On Road over New Clear Water Bay Road	First quarter of 2028
KF148	Across Eastern Harbour Crossing Toll Plaza	First quarter of 2027
KS62	Across Choi Wing Road near Choi Tak Shopping Centre	First quarter of 2028
KT01	Across Pik Wan Road connecting Kwong Tin Estate Bus Terminus and Hong Pak Court	Fourth quarter of 2028
KT05	Across Chun Wah Road near Jordan Valley Playground	First quarter of 2028
KT06	Across Sau Mau Ping Road near Ning Po No.2 College in Shun Tin Estate	First quarter of 2028
KWT03	Across Pik Wan Road connecting Kwong Ching House of Kwong Tin Estate and Hong Nga Court	First quarter of 2028
SL04	Across Lee On Road connecting Lee Yip House of Shun Lee Estate and Shun Chi Court	First quarter of 2027
TPN03	Across Tsui Ping Road connecting Tsui Cheung House and Tsui Tsz House of Tsui Ping North Estate	Fourth quarter of 2028
Yuen Long		
NF130	Across Castle Peak Road – Yuen Long and Fung Cheung Road	Second quarter of 2027
NF374	Across Tin Fuk Road near Exit D of MTR Tin Shui Wai Station	Second quarter of 2028

Structure No.	Location	Anticipated completion date
NF143	Across Castle Peak Road – Yuen Long near Yuen Long Tung Shing Lei Road, connecting a bus stop and Pok Oi Hospital	Fourth quarter of 2027
NF307	Across Castle Peak Road – Yuen Long near Fung Nin Road connecting Yuen Long Plaza	Second quarter of 2027
NF341	Across Tin Shui Road and Tin Sau Road	Third quarter of 2027
NF383	Across Wetland Park Road near Tin Shui Road	First quarter of 2028
NF404	Across Long Wo Road connecting Exit G2 of MTR Yuen Long Station and Ng Wo Villages of Shap Pat Heung	Third quarter of 2027
NS223	Across Tin Shing Road and Tin Yan Road near Tin Lung Road	First quarter of 2028
YL01	Across Tin Yiu Road near Tin Shui Wai Police Station and Tin Shing Shopping Centre	Second quarter of 2028
TY02	Across Tin Shing Road near Tin Tsz Light Rail Station	First quarter of 2028
Tuen Mun		
NF98	Across Wu King Road near Siu Hei Court Commercial Centre	First quarter of 2027
NF93	Across Ming Kum Road near King Lok House of Shan King Estate	Fourth quarter of 2026
NF94	Across Ming Kum Road near King Wah House of Shan King Estate	Third quarter of 2027
NF102	Across Wu Shan Road near Lung Mun Road	Third quarter of 2026
NF103	Across Lung Mun Road near Butterfly Light Rail Station	First quarter of 2027
NF161	Across Tuen Mun River Channel, Tuen Mun Road and Castle Peak Road near Fung Tei Light Rail Station	Fourth quarter of 2026
NF169	Across Tsun Wen Road connecting Tai Hing Estate and Tai Hing Sports Complex	First quarter of 2026
NF189	Across Castle Peak Road – Lam Tei near Lam Tei Main Street	First quarter of 2028
NF198	Across Ming Kum Road near Tin King Road	First quarter of 2027
NF231	Across Tuen Mun Heung Sze Wui Road near Hoi Chu Road	Second quarter of 2026
NF232	Across Hoi Wing Road near Sam Shing Light Rail Station	Second quarter of 2026
NF319	Across Castle Peak Road – Lingnan near Tuen Kwai Road	First quarter of 2027
NF410	Across Tuen Ma line near Tuen Mun Hospital Light Rail Station	Fourth quarter of 2027

Structure No.	Location	Anticipated completion date
BF01	Across Tip King Road connecting Butterfly Plaza and Wu Pik House of Wu King Estate	Third quarter of 2027
OT01	Across Yau Oi Road and Tuen Mun Heung Sze Wui Road connecting H.A.N.D.S and Oi Hei House of Yau Oi Estate	Fourth quarter of 2028
OT02	Across Yau Oi Road and Tuen Mun Heung Sze Wui Road connecting Ting Tak House of On Ting Estate and Oi Lim House of Yau Oi Estate	Third quarter of 2028
Sai Kung		
SK02	Across Tsui Lam Road connecting Tsui Lam Shopping Centre and King Ming Court	Second quarter of 2027
NF294	Across Clear Water Bay Road near Pik Uk Correctional Institution	Second quarter of 2027
NS149	Across Po Ning Road near Tseung Kwan O Po Ning Road Health Centre	Fourth quarter of 2026
KM01	Across Ling Kwong Street connecting Kin Ming Estate and Choi Ming Shopping Centre	Fourth quarter of 2028
TL01	Across Tsui Lam Road connecting Tsui Lam Estate Car Park and On Lam House	Fourth quarter of 2027
Tai Po		
NF79	Across Fanling Highway near Tai Wo Village	Fourth quarter of 2026
NS78	Across Tai Po Tai Wo Road near Tai Po Civic Centre	Third quarter of 2027
KF02	Across Plover Cove Road connecting Kwong Fuk Shopping Centre	Third quarter of 2028
KF04	Across Plover Cove Road near Kwong Yan House of Kwong Fuk Estate	First quarter of 2028
North District		
NF304	Across Yat Ming Road near King Shing Court Commercial Complex	Third quarter of 2026
NS50	Across Jockey Club Road near Fu Hing Street	Fourth quarter of 2027
NS113	Across Pak Wo Road and Po Kin Road near Tai Ping Estate	First quarter of 2026
NS120	Across Jockey Club Road and Po Shek Wu Road near Hing Yan Tsuen	Third quarter of 2027
NF228	Across San Wan Road near Fanling Station Road	Third quarter of 2028
CY06	Across existing road connecting Choi Chu House and Choi Wah House of Choi Yuen Estate	First quarter of 2028
Sha Tin		
NF66	Across Tai Po Road – Shatin near Wo Che Estate	Third quarter of 2026

Structure No.	Location	Anticipated completion date
NF299	Across Sai Sha Road near Chung On Estate	First quarter of 2028
NF338	Across On Chun Street near Ma On Shan Park	Fourth quarter of 2026
NF446	Across East Rail Line Track near Chung Ling Lane	Fourth quarter of 2026
NS41	Across Tin Sam Street near Che Kung Miu Road	First quarter of 2027
NS57	Across Chui Tin Street near Che Kung Miu Road	Second quarter of 2027
NS183	Across Ma On Shan Road near Ma On Shan Police Station	Second quarter of 2027
NS286	Across Ma On Shan Road and Hang Tak Street near MTR Tai Shui Hang Station	Second quarter of 2026
ST01	Across Kam Ying Road near Kam Ying Shopping Centre	Third quarter of 2026
ST02	Across Mei Tin Road connecting Mei Chung Court and Mei Shing Court	Third quarter of 2028
HK01	Across Hin Keng Street connecting Hin Keng Shopping Centre	Third quarter of 2028
KY01	Across existing road connecting Kwong Yuen Shopping Centre and Kwong Lam Court	First quarter of 2028
LY01	Across existing road connecting Fook Hoi House of Lek Yuen Estate and Wo Che Estate	Third quarter of 2027
Tsuen Wan		
NF427	Across Hoi On Road near Yau Kom Tau Pier	Fourth quarter of 2027
NF439	Across Castle Peak Road – Tsing Lung Tau near Sea Crest Villa (Phase 3)	First quarter of 2026
NF440	Across Castle Peak Road – Tsing Lung Tau near Sea Crest Villa (Phase 4)	Third quarter of 2028
NF167	Across Tai Chung Road near Sha Tsui Road	First quarter of 2028
NF220	Across Shek Wai Kok Road and Cheung Pei Shan Road	Second quarter of 2028
SWK03	Across Shek Wai Kok Road near Shek Lan House	Fourth quarter of 2028
Kwai Tsing		
NF123	Across Chung Mei Road near Sheung Ko Tan Street	Third quarter of 2027
NF124	Across Chung Mei Road near Cheung Hong Estate	Second quarter of 2027
NF213	Across Fung Shue Wo Road near Tsing Sum Street	Second quarter of 2026

Structure No.	Location	Anticipated completion date
NF225	Across Hing Fong Road and Kwai Foo Road	First quarter of 2027
NF233	Across Hing Fong Road near Kwai Yik Road	Third quarter of 2026
NF275	Across On Chit Street near On Yam Shopping Centre	Third quarter of 2026
NF292	Across Tsing Yi Heung Sze Wui Road near Tsing Yi Divisional Police Station	Third quarter of 2026
K&T03	Across Tsing King Road near On Wu House of Cheung On Estate	Third quarter of 2026
K&T04	Across Kwai Yan Road near Metroplaza	Fourth quarter of 2026
K&T06	Across Tai Pak Tin Street connecting Shek Yam Estate and Shek Yam East Estate	First quarter of 2027
NF214	Across Tsing Luk Street near Tsing Yi Garden	First quarter of 2028
SL16	Across existing road connecting Shek Lei Shopping Centre I, Shek Tai House and Shek On House of Shek Lei (I) Estate	Third quarter of 2028
TWH01	Across Tai Wo Hau Road connecting Tai Wo Hau Shopping Centre and Fu Keung House of Tai Wo Hau Estate	Second quarter of 2027

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2606)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Railway Development

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Paragraph 224 of the Budget Speech mentions that "we are taking forward the Northern Link Main Line and Spur Line at full steam for commissioning simultaneously by 2034 or earlier. We are also actively taking forward the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu-Qianhai) project, with the target of inviting tender for its detailed design and construction next year and commissioning in 2035. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

1. Is there a preliminary budget for the overall construction costs of the Hong Kong section of the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu – Qianhai)? If yes, what are the details?

2. What are the current expenditures for the Northern Link Main Line and Spur Line? Please list the expenditures in detail.

Asked by: Hon LEUNG Mei-fun, Priscilla (LegCo internal reference no.: 7)

Reply:

The Highways Department (HyD) commenced the investigation and design for the Hong Kong section of the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu – Qianhai) in mid-2025. The HyD is carrying out the design and relevant site investigation works, statutory procedures, financial assessments, etc. During this process, the construction cost for the Hong Kong section of the project will be estimated.

The Northern Link (NOL) project (including the NOL Main Line and Spur Line) is being implemented by the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) under the ownership approach via the "Rail-plus-Property" model. Under this framework, the Government will grant property development rights to the MTRCL to bridge the funding gap of the project. The MTRCL is responsible for the financing, design, construction, operation, and maintenance of the new railway projects and will ultimately own the railway. No government capital works funding is involved. The Transport and Logistics Bureau and the MTRCL entered into part 1 of the project agreement of the NOL project in July 2025, which stipulated that the Government

would provide a funding support of $39.05 billion (in money-of-the-day prices) to the MTRCL. As for part 2 of the NOL project, the HyD is currently reviewing the relevant detailed planning and design schemes, and the required funding support will be determined later.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2098)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Capital Projects

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

In 2025, expenditure was not incurred as scheduled on 3 out of 53 capital projects due to "longer time required for account finalisation". Please advise this Committee on the following:

(a) Over the past 3 years, how many capital projects encountered delays in account finalisation each year? Please list the number of projects and the average delay time by year.

(a) What are the main reasons for delays in account finalisation (such as contractual disputes, variations in the quantity of works, delays in document submission by contractors, complicated internal vetting process etc.) ? What measures are in place to accelerate the processing?

(b) Delays in account finalisation may affect the cash flow of contractors, and even impact the business operations of small and medium-sized contractors. Did the Highways Department evaluate the impacts of delays in account finalisation on contractors? If yes, what are the outcomes?

(c) Will the Government include the efficiency of account finalisation in the future performance targets or "Mattes Requiring Special Attention"?

Asked by: Hon WONG Ho-ming, Augustine (LegCo internal reference no.: 75)

Reply:

(a). Over the past 3 years, the numbers of projects that the Highways Department (HyD) required longer time for account finalisation are tabulated below:

Year	Numbers of projects
2023	4
2024	5
2025	3

The aforesaid figures involve 6 public works projects, among which the account finalisation for one project was completed in 2025 and was a year behind schedule. The account finalisaiton of the remaining 5 projects are still underway and thus average delay time cannot be provided.

(b). Among the 6 projects mentioned in the aforesaid paragraph (a), 4 projects are delayed mainly because discussions with contractors on account finalisation were time consuming. In order to complete the finalisation as soon as possible, the HyD has accelerated the assessments of the costs of variations, assessments on claims and processing of payment applications, finalising the accounts as soon as possible in accordance with the contractual mechanism.

For the other 2 projects, the Government reimbursed the designated costs to the developers on a one-off basis upon completion of the construction of the public transport interchanges according to the conditions of land sale and to the satisfaction of the Government. Since the relevant projects do not meet certain conditions, the account finalisation of those projects is still underway.

(c). The HyD conducted regular reviews on the progress of account finalisation of projects and amounts that should be paid to the contractors according to contractual provisions, so as to ensure the account finalisation complies with contract requirements and relevant guidelines. Account finalisation requires longer time mainly because the processing of claim disputes raised by the contractors take time. Upon negotiations and assessments conducted by the HyD and the contractors, it was considered that the delays mentioned in the aforesaid paragraph (a) would not pose any negative impacts on the overall operations of contractors.

(d). The progress of account finalisation is influenced by various factors (including the involvement of contract variations, the number and complexity of claims and disputes raised by contractors, and the progress of negotiations.) Therefore, careful consideration is required as to whether it is appropriate to incorporate account finalisation efficiency into future performance targets or "Matters Requiring Special Attention". The HyD will continue to closely monitor the progress of account finalisation to minimise delays as far as possible.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2104)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Railway Development

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Highways Department measures the completion progress of various railway projects based on the ratio of cumulative expenditure to the total project cost (such as the target of the Tung Chung Line Extension is 54% and the target of the Tuen Mun South Extension is 50%). In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

1. The projects, i.e. the Tung Chung Line Extension, Tuen Mun South Extension, Hung Shui Kiu Station and Oyster Bay Station are anticipated to be completed successively starting from next year. Please provide the latest information on (i) the percentages of overall project progress, (ii) the actual expenditures incurred, and (iii) the surplus or overrun status relative to the approved project estimates of the aforesaid projects as at the end of March 2026.

1. The target of Part I of Northern Link Project (percentage of completion since the commencement of works) in 2026 is 10%. Does this account for the efficiency gains from adopting the new railway standards? If not, when does the Government expect to reflect these benefits and update the performance targets?

Asked by: Hon WONG Ho-ming, Augustine (LegCo internal reference no.: 78)

Reply:

1. As of the end of February 2026, the overall project progress for the Tung Chung Line Extension, Tuen Mun South Extension, Hung Shui Kiu Station and Oyster Bay Station are 44%, 36%, 20% and 35% respectively. The progress of the aforesaid railway projects are all in line with the planned works programme. The Government will continue to monitor the construction progress of the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL).

   The aforesaid railway projects are implemented by the MTRCL under the ownership approach. The MTRCL is responsible for the financing, design, construction, operation, and maintenance of these projects, which do not involve government funding.

2. The new Hong Kong Railway Standards promulgated by the Highways Department (HyD) facilitate the use of a broader selection of advanced construction technologies, construction materials, equipment and railway systems for railway projects depending on individual circumstances and needs, provide clear technical specifications as the approval basis of the supervisory authorities, and also facilitate the formulation and optimisation of work processes by the industry, driving the new railway projects of Hong Kong with enhanced speed and efficiency.

The Northern Link (NOL) Project is of significant scope and complexity. While making every effort to implement the more ready and more urgent works in Part 1 of the Project, we are simultaneously proceeding with the detailed planning and design as well as the statutory procedures for Part 2, which includes the cross-boundary section. The planned completion percentage for Part 1 of the NOL Project in 2026, as stated under Programme (3), is a forecast based on available information. As the Project's design and construction reach a more ready stage, we will have more updated estimates on the benefits brought by the Hong Kong Railway Standards. We will continue to review the latest progress and implementation programme of the NOL Project and reflect them appropriately in future Controlling Officer's Reports.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2369)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) District and Maintenance Works

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The responsibilities of the Highways Department include "implement local road infrastructure works to facilitate and cope with the public and private sector developments". In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

(a) The revised estimate of $2.5977 billion for 2025-26 was 7.4% less than the original estimate of $2.8061 billion. What are the reasons?

(b) Over the past 3 years, what were the respective numbers of local road works conducted in connection with the developments of public bodies (such as public housing projects, government facilities) and the developments of private bodies (such as private residential projects, commercial development projects)? What were the respective total expenditures involved?

Asked by: Hon WONG Ho-ming, Augustine (LegCo internal reference no.: 76)

Reply:

(a) The revised estimate for 2025-26 under Programme (2) represents a 7.4% decrease compared to the original estimate, mainly reflects the change in the completion dates of the new road works and relevant projects (including the transport infrastructure of the Diamond Hill Development Area, the retrofitting of lifts under the Universal Accessibility Programme, and the Wan Chai Development Phase II), deferring the handover to the Highways Department (HyD) for maintenance, and a corresponding decrease in the provisions required for workshop services (including electrical and mechanical services, etc.).

(b) The HyD is responsible for the maintenance of public roads and ancillary road facilities under its ambit. It deploys staff members to conduct regular inspections and arranges for timely repair works. At the same time, the HyD carries out improvement works for local roads upon the recommendation of the Transport Department (TD), optimises road facilities to align with district developments (including housing projects, government facilities, commercial developments etc.), such as providing pedestrian crossings and

bus lay-bys, improving the local road alignments, widening of roads, and strengthening the guardrails etc. Over the past 3 years (from 2023 to 2025), the HyD received a total of approximately 5 025 works requests from the TD for local road improvement projects, involving a total expenditure of $160 million. The HyD does not maintain separate expenditure breakdowns for district road works carried out in response to public sector developments (such as public housing projects and government facilities) and private sector developments (such as private residential projects and commercial developments).

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB044**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0992)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Capital Projects

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the "Universal Accessibility" (UA) Programme, will the Government advise this Committee on the following:

1. What were the items completed, under construction and under tendering under the UA Programme in Kowloon Central over the past year?

2. What were the items completed within schedule and items delayed (years of delay) in Kowloon Central since the implementation of the UA Programme? And

3. What new measures do the Government have to monitor the quality of works and financial situation of the contractors in order to prevent items delays and cost overruns?

Asked by: Hon YANG Wing-kit (LegCo internal reference no.: 20)

Reply:

1. Between March 2025 and February 2026, five items were completed and 11 items were under construction under the "Universal Accessibility" (UA) Programme in Kowloon Central[1]. No items were under tendering. The details are tabulated in table 1 and 2 below:

Table 1: Completed items in Kowloon Central over the past year

Structure No.	Location	Walkway Type	Types of facilities
Kowloon City District			
KF107	Across Shung King Street, Hung Hom South Road and Hung Luen Road near Oi King Street	Footbridge	Lift

[1] According to description of boundaries of Legislative Council Geographical Constituencies, Kowloon Central includes Kowloon City District and north-western part of Wong Tai Sin District.

Structure No.	Location	Walkway Type	Types of facilities
KS9	Across Prince Edward Road West at Kowloon City Interchange	Subway	Lift
KS41	Across Chatham Road North near Winslow Street	Subway	Lift
Northwest of Wong Tai Sin District			
KF73	Across Tung Tau Tsuen Road near Tung Lung Road	Footbridge	Lift
WTS05	Across Tung Tau Tsuen Road near Lung Tat House of Lower Wong Tai Sin Estate	Footbridge	Lift

Table 2: Items in Kowloon Central that are under construction

Structure No.	Location	Walkway Type	Types of facilities
Kowloon City District			
K64	Across Hung Hom Road near Dyer Avenue	Elevated Walkway	Lift
KF111	Across Boundary Street near Embankment Road	Footbridge	Lift
KS21	Across Fat Kwong Street near Wo Chung Street	Subway	Lift
OM01	Across Chung Hau Street near Tun Man House of Oi Man Estate	Subway	Lift
Northwest of Wong Tai Sin District			
KF62	Across Fung Tak Road and Po Kong Village Road near Fung Tak Estate	Footbridge	Lift
KF77	Across Lung Cheung Road near Hammer Hill Road	Footbridge	Lift
KF92A	Across Lung Poon Street near Fung Tak Road	Footbridge	Lift
CYS03	Across Chuk Yuen Road Connecting Chuk Yuen Plaza and Chuk Yuen Sports Centre	Footbridge	Lift
TZL01	Across Sheung Fung Street connecting Tsz Lok Estate Phase 1 and Phase 2	Footbridge	Lift
WTH01	Across Fu Mei Street connecting Wang Fai House and Wang Fu House/Wang On House of Wang Tau Hom Estate	Footbridge	Lift
WTS04	Across Chuk Yuen Road connecting Pang Ching Court and Chuk Yuen South Estate	Footbridge	Lift

The Highways Department (HyD) has been pressing ahead with the implementation of a total of 382 items under various phases of the UA Programme. As at the end of February 2026, a total of 23 items under the Programme in Kowloon Central were completed as scheduled. Except for the four items in Kowloon Central that were delayed for an average of 1.5 years

owing to the unsatisfactory performance of an individual contractor, the implementation of other items in Kowloon Central was generally smooth. The HyD has withdrawn the four relevant items and included these remaining works, together with other items under the UA Programme, in a new works contract awarded in August 2024. The relevant works have already resumed, with one of the items already completed in 2025 and opened for public use. The HyD strives to complete the remaining three items progressively within this year. The details of the items completed as scheduled and delayed items in Kowloon Central are tabulated in table 3 and 4 below:

Table 3: Items in Kowloon Central that are completed as scheduled since the implementation of the UA Programme

Structure No.	Location	Walkway Type	Types of facilities
Kowloon City District			
K14	Pui Ching Road Flyover across Princess Margaret Road	Elevated Walkway	Lift
K21	At Cheong Wan Road between On Wan Road and Hung Hom South Road	Elevated Walkway	Lift
KC01	Across Junction Road near Renfrew Road	Footbridge	Lift
KF6	Across Princess Margaret Road near Wylie Road and Oi Man Estate	Footbridge	Lift
KF25	Across Waterloo Road in Kowloon Tong near Suffolk Road	Footbridge	Lift
KF29	Across Kowloon City Road and San Shan Road	Footbridge	Lift
KF102	Across Hung Hom South Road near Hung Ling Street and Whampoa Street	Footbridge	Lift
KF107	Across Shung King Street, Hung Hom South Road and Hung Luen Road near Oi King Street	Footbridge	Lift
KF106	Across Hung Hom South Road near Hung Hom Road	Footbridge	Lift
KS8	Across Prince Edward Road West near Lion Rock Road	Subway	Lift
KS9	Across Prince Edward Road West at Kowloon City Interchange	Subway	Lift
KS10	Across Prince Edward Road East and Ma Tau Chung Road near Tak Ku Ling Road	Subway	Lift
KS32	Across Ma Tau Chung Road near Olympic Avenue and Kowloon City Interchange	Subway	Lift
KS41	Across Chatham Road North near Winslow Street	Subway	Lift
Northwest of Wong Tai Sin District			
K8	Along Fung Mo Street over Lung Cheung Road	Elevated Walkway	Lift

Structure No.	Location	Walkway Type	Types of facilities
K36	At Po Kong Village Road over Lung Cheung Road	Elevated Walkway	Ramp
KF57	Across Lung Cheung Road near Tin Ma Court	Footbridge	Lift
KF58	Across Lung Cheung Road near Ma Chai Hang Road	Footbridge	Lift
KF76	Across Fung Tak Road and Lung Poon Street	Footbridge	Lift
WTS05	Across Tung Tau Tsuen Road near Lung Tat House of Lower Wong Tai Sin Estate	Footbridge	Lift
KS12	Across Choi Hung Road near Lok Sin Road	Subway	Lift
KS17	Across a slip road from Po Kong Village Road Southbound to Tai Hom Road	Subway	Lift
KS35	Across Prince Edward Road East near San Po Kong Interchange	Subway	Ramp

Table 4: Items in Kowloon Central involving delays since the implementation of the UA Programme

Structure No.	Location	Walkway Type	Types of facilities
Kowloon City District			
K64	Across Hung Hom Road near Dyer Avenue	Elevated Walkway	Lift
Northwest of Wong Tai Sin District			
KF73	Across Tung Tau Tsuen Road near Tung Lung Road[2]	Footbridge	Lift
KF92A	Across Lung Poon Street near Fung Tak Road	Footbridge	Lift
WTS04	Across Chuk Yuen Road connecting Pang Ching Court and Chuk Yuen South Estate (Lift 1)[3]	Footbridge	Lift

2. When engaging contractors for public works projects, the HyD will normally invite the contractors under relevant categories and groups of the List of Approved Contractors for Public Works (the List) to participate in the tender. During the tender assessment, apart from considering the tender prices of the tenderers, their past performance in public works contracts, etc., the financial capability of the tenderer with the highest score and whether

[2] The item "Across Tung Tau Tsuen Road near Tung Lung Road" was delayed owing to the unsatisfactory performance of an individual contractor. After including it in a new works contract awarded in August 2024, the item was completed in 2025 and opened for public use.

[3] The item "Across Chuk Yuen Road connecting Pang Ching Court and Chuk Yuen South Estate" includes the retrofitting of two lifts. Lift 2 under the item is completed as scheduled without delay.

the tender price is reasonable would also be reviewed. This is to ensure that the successful tenderer is fully capable (including financially capable) of completing the works in accordance with the contractual requirements. Only the tenderer who passes the financial vetting and satisfies the relevant financial requirements will be awarded the contract.

In terms of financial capability, the contractors must regularly submit to the Development Bureau (DEVB) the annual audited financial statements and other financial information in accordance with the regulations of the Contractor Management Handbook to prove that their financial capabilities entirely fulfil the relevant financial requirements. If the contractor fails to submit the financial statements/financial information or fulfil the prescribed financial requirements within the specified period, the DEVB can take appropriate regulatory action in accordance with the Contractor Management Handbook, which includes suspending the contractor from tendering for public works, downgrading to a lower category or group, and even removing from the List. Moreover, in order to protect the rights and interests of the Government, the Government would specify in the works contracts that 1% to 2.5% of the contract value paid to the contractors would be deducted as retention money. The retention money would be released to the contractors upon completion of the contract. If the contractor fails to complete the works in compliance with the contract conditions, the Government will deduct an appropriate amount from the retention money to cover the loss according to the contract mechanism, and thus reducing items delays or cost overruns.

The HyD would strictly monitor the progress of the project items during the construction stage to ensure that the contractor would comply with the contract obligation for timely completion of all works. If the works progress is affected by the unsatisfactory performance of the contractor, we will first issue a warning letter to the contractor and urge the contractor to immediately allocate resources to speed up works progress. Besides, the Government will also explore to re-sequence works and other delay recovery measures with the contractor with a view to completing the remaining works as soon as possible. The unsatisfactory performance of the contractor will be reflected in his performance report as well. If the situation continues, the Government will take regulatory action according to the Contractor Management Handbook and relevant guidelines, which includes suspending the contractor from tendering or even removing their names from the List of Approved Contractors for Public Works. The HyD will also recover delay damages resulted from project delays from the contractor in accordance with the contractual requirements and the established mechanisms.

The actual expenditures did not exceed the estimate when the HyD implemented the UA Programme as at the end of February 2026. The HyD would closely monitor the project costs, as well as conduct reviews and follow up regularly to control the costs of works.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2294)

Head: (60) Highways Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Railway Development

Controlling Officer: Director of Highways (YAU Kwok-ting)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The implementation of the Northern Link (NOL) is a major expenditure item among the Northern Metropolis infrastructure. In this connection, please advise this Committee on the following: (1) What is the estimated funding for the construction of the NOL in 2026-27? (2) With the adoption of the Mainland standards for the NOL, what is the estimated cost saving that can be brought to the development of the NOL project?

Asked by: Hon YIM Kong, Erik (LegCo internal reference no.: 10)

Reply:

The Northern Link (NOL) Project is implemented by the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) under the ownership approach via the "Rail-plus-Property" model. Under this model, the Government will grant property development rights to the MTRCL to bridge funding gap of the project. The MTRCL is responsible for the financing, design, construction, operation and maintenance of the new railway projects and will ultimately own the railway. No government funding is involved.

The new Hong Kong Railway Standards promulgated by the Highways Department (HyD) facilitate the use of a broader selection of advanced construction technologies, construction materials, equipment and railway systems for new railway projects, provide clear technical specifications as the approval basis of the supervisory authorities, and also facilitate the development and optimisation of work processes by the industry, driving the new railway projects of Hong Kong with enhanced speed and efficiency, shortening construction time and reducing costs. The cost savings for individual projects vary depending on the actual circumstances, such as the nature, scale, and site conditions of the project. Regarding the NOL project, the Government is currently reviewing the project estimate provided by the MTRCL. Based on our rough estimation, the adoption of the new Hong Kong Railway Standards, coupled with the synergies generated by implementing the NOL Main Line and NOL Spur Line as one project, the construction cost is expected to be reduced by about 20% for the NOL project.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1852)

Head: (100) Marine Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Services to Ships

Controlling Officer: Director of Marine (Mr S.F. WONG)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

To consolidate Hong Kong's premier position in ship registration, the Government will introduce an amendment bill this year to revamp the existing ship registration arrangements, including permitting dual registration arrangement to cater for the diverse operating models of international maritime enterprises. Will the Government inform this Committee of the details? Please advise on the resources to be allocated by the Government and the expected outcomes. (Paragraph 146 of the Budget Speech)

Asked by: Hon CHAN Hiu-fung, Nick (LegCo internal reference no.: 29)

Reply:

To enhance and consolidate the competitiveness of ship registration in Hong Kong, the Government plans to introduce an amendment bill to the Legislative Council in the second half of 2026 to revamp the ship registration system in Hong Kong. The initiative aims to accommodate the diverse operating models of international maritime enterprises and the needs of the maritime industry. The amendment bill will mainly cover four areas, including enhancing flexibility in registration arrangements, strengthening control measures to maintain the quality of the fleet, abolishing obsolete registration procedures, and optimising the handling procedures and charging arrangements of the Government.

According to existing legislation, ships registered abroad are not eligible for registration as Hong Kong flagged ships. To align with the prevailing business model of ship leasing, the amendment bill will propose allowing dual registration under the circumstances of suspension of original registration by shipowners, i.e. demise charter-in registration (viz. allowing ships registered abroad to suspend foreign flag registration and register and operate in Hong Kong under a demise charter) and demise charter-out registration (viz. allowing Hong Kong-registered ships to suspend Hong Kong flag registration and register and operate with foreign flags under a demise charter). When compared with a direct transference of flag, this proposed arrangement will provide shipowners with greater operational flexibility, including flexibility in the nationalities of crew members employed. In addition, this proposed

arrangement will cater for the business model of ship leasing, thereby attracting a wider range of shipowners to register their ships in Hong Kong. Coupled with the local and overseas promotional and publicity efforts by the Government, as well as the new incentive scheme for Hong Kong-registered ships using green maritime fuels announced in the 2026-27 Budget, these measures will create significant competitive edge for Hong Kong in ship registration, enhancing the competitiveness of Hong Kong in the realm.

The implementation of the above measures forms part of the normal duties of the staff concerned and will be undertaken with existing resources. There is no separate breakdown on the manpower and expenditure involved.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1355)

Head: (100) Marine Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Local Services

Controlling Officer: Director of Marine (Mr S.F. WONG)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the management of Public Cargo Working Areas (PCWAs), please inform this Committee of the following:

1. Please set out the following information for each of the 6 PCWAs in the territory in the past 3 financial years:

   (a) the total numbers of berthing spaces, the average annual utilisation rates, as well as the numbers and percentages of vacant berthing spaces of each PCWA;

   (b) the total annual cargo throughput handled by each PCWA; and

   (c) the main types of cargo handled by each PCWA.

2. What are the numbers of inspections conducted by the Government at each PCWA and the manpower expenditures involved in such inspections in the past 3 years?

3. Regarding the New Yau Ma Tei Public Cargo Working Area, what are the numbers of fire incidents occurred in the past 3 years? What are the causes of the incidents, the subsequent follow-up actions and improvement measures?

Asked by: Hon CHENG Wing-shun, Vincent (LegCo internal reference no.: 10)

Reply:

1. The utilisation situations of the Public Cargo Working Areas (PCWAs) in 2023, 2024 and 2025 are as follows:

2023					
PCWA	**Total no. of berthing spaces**	**No. and percentage of berthing spaces in use**	**No. and percentage of vacant berthing spaces**	**Total cargo throughput (tonnes)***	**Types of cargo handled**
Western District	23	20 (87.0%)	3 (13.0%)	376 000	General cargo and containers
Chai Wan	14	12 (85.7%)	2 (14.3%)	302 000	General cargo and containers, sand and aggregates, waste paper, scrap metal
New Yau Ma Tei	29	28 (96.6%)	1 (3.4%)	1 800 000	General cargo and containers, scrap metal
Stonecutters Island	12	12 (100%)	0 (0%)	823 000	General cargo and containers, scrap metal
Rambler Channel	27	27 (100%)	0 (0%)	1 147 000	General cargo and containers, sand and aggregates, waste paper, scrap metal
Tuen Mun	15	15 (100%)	0 (0%)	802 000	General cargo and containers, sand and aggregates, waste paper
			Total:	**5 250 000**	

* Rounded to the nearest thousand

2024					
PCWA	**Total no. of berthing spaces**	**No. and percentage of berthing spaces in use**	**No. and percentage of vacant berthing spaces**	**Total cargo throughput (tonnes)***	**Types of cargo handled**
Western District	23	21 (91.3%)	2 (8.7%)	328 000	General cargo and containers
Chai Wan	14	8 (57.1%)	6 (42.9%)	235 000	General cargo and containers, sand and aggregates, waste paper, scrap metal
New Yau Ma Tei	29	29 (100%)	0 (0%)	1 551 000	General cargo and containers, scrap metal
Stonecutters Island	12	12 (100%)	0 (0%)	515 000	General cargo and containers, scrap metal
Rambler Channel	27	27 (100%)	0 (0%)	984 000	General cargo and containers, sand and aggregates, waste paper, scrap metal
Tuen Mun	15	13 (86.7%)	2 (13.3%)	672 000	General cargo and containers, sand and aggregates, waste paper
			Total:	**4 285 000**	

* Rounded to the nearest thousand

2025					
PCWA	**Total no. of berthing spaces**	**No. and percentage of berthing spaces in use**	**No. and percentage of vacant berthing spaces**	**Total cargo throughput (tonnes)***	**Types of cargo handled**
Western District	23	17 (73.9%)	6 (26.1%)	299 000	General cargo and containers
Chai Wan	14	6 (42.9%)	8 (57.1%)	195 000	General cargo and containers, sand and aggregates, waste paper, scrap metal
New Yau Ma Tei	29	29 (100%)	0 (0%)	1 625 000	General cargo and containers, scrap metal
Stonecutters Island	12	11 (91.7%)	1 (8.3%)	507 000	General cargo and containers, scrap metal
Rambler Channel	27	25 (92.6%)	2 (7.4%)	945 000	General cargo and containers, sand and aggregates, waste paper, scrap metal
Tuen Mun	15	12 (80.0%)	3 (20.0%)	613 000	General cargo and containers, sand and aggregates, waste paper
			Total:	**4 184 000**	

* Rounded to the nearest thousand

2. The Marine Department (MD) deploys staff to conduct on-site inspections at the PCWAs on a daily basis. The management of PCWAs forms part of the normal duties of the staff concerned and is undertaken with existing resources. There is no separate breakdown on the expenditure involved for each PCWA.

3. In 2023, 2024 and 2025, a total of 10 reports of fire involving the New Yau Ma Tei PCWA were received. It is understood that the officers of the Fire Services Department conducted investigations at the fire scenes and found nothing suspicious. The fires were believed to be caused by the mixing of combustible materials with the cargo.

   The Government attaches great importance to the fire safety of the PCWAs and has already, in response to the fire incidents, initiated early termination of 3 Berth Licence Agreements and required all operators to comply with relevant fire safety regulations. Other than publishing fire safety pamphlets, safety guidelines and promotional publications, MD has proactively organised fire safety seminars and training activities, including holding publicity and educational activities in collaboration with relevant government departments, operators of the PCWAs and trade associations, with a view to raising the fire prevention and safety awareness of the industry. MD will continue to work closely with relevant departments and strictly monitor the fire safety conditions of the PCWAs and their adjacent berthing spaces. Should any irregularities be identified, follow-up actions will be taken in a solemn manner.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB048**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1356)

Head: (100) Marine Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Local Services

Controlling Officer: Director of Marine (Mr S.F. WONG)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the management of typhoon shelters, please inform this Committee of the following in the past 3 financial years:

1. the total number of berthing spaces and the average monthly occupancy rate for each typhoon shelter;

2. the highest occupancy of each typhoon shelter and the number of vessels berthed therein, with a breakdown by vessel type, during typhoons or inclement weather;

3. the number of private mooring areas in all typhoon shelters and elsewhere within the limits of Victoria port and the average monthly occupancy rate; and

4. regarding the long-term planning of typhoon shelters, whether the Government will consider conducting a comprehensive review on the occupancy data for the existing 14 typhoon shelters and studying the formulation of corresponding improvement measures (such as adjusting the allocation of berthing spaces) based on the usage and berthing demand of typhoon shelters in various districts; if yes, of the specific timetable and direction of study; if not, of the reasons for that.

Asked by: Hon CHENG Wing-shun, Vincent (LegCo internal reference no.: 11)

Reply:

1 & 2. There are currently 14 typhoon shelters[1] located in different parts of Hong Kong waters, providing a total of 421.6 hectares of berthing space for vessels. As the

[1] The 14 gazetted typhoon shelters are Aberdeen South Typhoon Shelter, Aberdeen West Typhoon Shelter, Causeway Bay Typhoon Shelter, Cheung Chau Typhoon Shelter, Hei Ling Chau Typhoon Shelter, Kwun Tong Typhoon Shelter, New Yau Ma Tei Typhoon Shelter, Rambler Channel Typhoon Shelter, Sam Ka Tsuen Typhoon Shelter, Shau Kei Wan Typhoon Shelter, Shuen Wan Typhoon Shelter, To Kwa Wan Typhoon Shelter, Tuen Mun Typhoon Shelter and Yim Tin Tsai Typhoon Shelter.

typhoon shelters are open for common use by local vessels of different sizes and classes according to their operational needs, the Marine Department (MD) does not set the total number of berthing spaces for each typhoon shelter. MD does not maintain records on occupancy of typhoon shelters in normal days, but keeps track of the highest occupancy of each typhoon shelter during typhoons to ensure that vessels' demand for sheltered spaces during inclement weather could be met. The highest occupancy of typhoon shelters by class of vessels during typhoons in the past 3 years (i.e. 2023 to 2025) is set out at **Annex A**.

3. Among the 14 typhoon shelters in Hong Kong, 7 of them have part of the waters designated as private mooring areas, namely New Yau Ma Tei Typhoon Shelter, Causeway Bay Typhoon Shelter, Sam Ka Tsuen Typhoon Shelter, Aberdeen South Typhoon Shelter, Cheung Chau Typhoon Shelter, Tuen Mun Typhoon Shelter and Hei Ling Chau Typhoon Shelter. Apart from typhoon shelters, there are 8 private mooring areas in the waters within the limits of Victoria Port, namely Ting Kau, Tsing Yi North, Tsuen Wan, Rambler Channel, North of Yau Mai Tei Anchorage, Lai Chi Kok, New Yau Ma Tei Typhoon Shelter (outside breakwater) and To Kwa Wan. According to the records of MD, there are a total of 916 private moorings in the above private mooring areas. As they are private properties, MD does not maintain records on their usage.

4. It is the established policy of the Government to provide sheltered spaces in Hong Kong on a territory-wide basis for local vessels to take refuge during inclement weather. MD carries out regular assessments of the territory-wide supply and demand situation of sheltered spaces in a holistic approach. In general, MD conducts assessments about every 5 years. In the latest round of the Assessment of Typhoon Shelter Space Requirements released in December 2022, it is estimated that the overall territory-wide supply of sheltered spaces for local vessels can adequately meet the demand from 2022 to 2035. The assessment on the overall territory-wide supply and demand of sheltered spaces from 2027 to 2040 has been commenced in the third quarter of 2025, which is expected to be completed between late 2027 and early 2028.

Annex A

Table I – Numbers and Types of Vessels Observed in Typhoon Shelters (TS) in 2023

	Class I			**Class II**						**Class III**		**Class IV**			
	Ferry	Launch	Others	Dumb Steel Lighter	Cargo Vessel	Tug	Dangerous Goods Carrier	Stationary Vessel	Others	Fishing Vessel	P4 Sampan	Pleasure Vessel	River Trade Vessel	Gov't Launch	**Total[4]**
Aberdeen TS#[1]	7	30	16	4	29	3	0	88	52	390	0	697	0	12	1 328
Causeway Bay TS[1]	0	30	0	0	0	0	0	3	30	80	0	205	0	0	348
Cheung Chau TS[2]	1	7	0	0	6	3	0	5	17	97	32	74	0	3	245
Hei Ling Chau TS[3]	0	0	0	30	0	2	0	0	5	0	0	3	0	1	41
Kwun Tong TS[2]	3	5	0	15	0	0	0	0	26	0	0	261	0	4	314
New Yau Ma Tei TS[2]	8	30	0	177	26	37	0	1	24	19	0	134	25	4	485
Rambler Channel TS[2]	0	0	0	5	0	10	0	0	4	20	0	22	50	1	112
Sam Ka Tsuen TS[1]	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	2	7	36	0	42	0	0	92
Shaukeiwan TS[1]	9	8	0	0	8	2	0	23	50	261	0	146	0	2	509
Shuen Wan TS[1]	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	2	44	45	154	0	9	257
To Kwa Wan TS[2]	2	6	0	80	0	18	0	0	11	0	0	6	0	1	124
Tuen Mun TS[2]	0	42	0	86	4	21	5	4	49	123	0	80	13	12	439
Yim Tin Tsai TS[1]	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	15	0	0	15

Note: #Aberdeen South Typhoon Shelter and Aberdeen West Typhoon Shelter
Permitted length: [1] – 30.4 metres, [2] – 50 metres, [3] – 75 metres
[4] – The highest usage of typhoon shelters during typhoons

Table II – Numbers and Types of Vessels Observed in Typhoon Shelters (TS) in 2024

	Class I			**Class II**						**Class III**		**Class IV**			
	Ferry	Launch	Others	Dumb Steel Lighter	Cargo Vessel	Tug	Dangerous Goods Carrier	Stationary Vessel	Others	Fishing Vessel	P4 Sampan	Pleasure Vessel	River Trade Vessel	Gov't Launch	**Total[4]**
Aberdeen TS#[1]	1	31	16	3	11	3	0	88	48	326	0	713	0	8	1 248
Causeway Bay TS[1]	4	15	0	0	0	0	0	3	25	115	0	195	0	0	357
Cheung Chau TS[2]	3	7	0	0	6	3	0	5	13	119	27	50	0	3	236
Hei Ling Chau TS[3]	0	0	0	29	0	2	0	0	4	0	0	3	0	1	39
Kwun Tong TS[2]	3	2	0	22	0	0	0	0	14	0	0	247	0	2	290
New Yau Ma Tei TS[2]	9	45	0	186	12	34	0	1	24	26	0	125	26	4	492
Rambler Channel TS[2]	0	0	0	5	0	6	0	0	5	10	0	25	24	1	76
Sam Ka Tsuen TS[1]	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	2	8	35	0	45	0	0	95
Shaukeiwan TS[1]	6	6	0	0	6	2	0	23	33	183	0	183	0	0	442
Shuen Wan TS[1]	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	48	48	132	0	12	245
To Kwa Wan TS[2]	2	4	0	76	0	14	0	0	8	0	0	2	0	1	107
Tuen Mun TS[2]	0	33	0	62	6	22	0	4	53	121	0	93	13	10	417
Yim Tin Tsai TS[1]	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	8	0	0	8

Note: #Aberdeen South Typhoon Shelter and Aberdeen West Typhoon Shelter
Permitted length: [1] – 30.4 metres, [2] – 50 metres, [3] – 75 metres
[4] – The highest usage of typhoon shelters during typhoons

Table III – Numbers and Types of Vessels Observed in Typhoon Shelters (TS) in 2025

	Class I			**Class II**						**Class III**		**Class IV**			
	Ferry	Launch	Others	Dumb Steel Lighter	Cargo Vessel	Tug	Dangerous Goods Carrier	Stationary Vessel	Others	Fishing Vessel	P4 Sampan	Pleasure Vessel	River Trade Vessel	Gov't Launch	**Total[4]**
Aberdeen TS#[1]	1	31	16	5	11	4	0	88	10	414	0	821	0	8	1 409
Causeway Bay TS[1]	0	28	0	0	0	0	0	3	0	89	0	277	0	0	397
Cheung Chau TS[2]	2	8	0	2	10	2	0	4	0	165	44	63	0	4	304
Hei Ling Chau TS[3]	2	2	0	28	0	2	0	0	6	9	0	5	0	1	55
Kwun Tong TS[2]	6	10	0	26	0	0	0	0	25	0	0	308	0	1	376
New Yau Ma Tei TS[2]	18	22	0	196	11	33	0	1	0	26	0	110	16	5	438
Rambler Channel TS[2]	0	0	0	5	0	6	0	0	5	9	0	30	28	1	84
Sam Ka Tsuen TS[1]	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	2	0	32	0	49	0	0	88
Shaukeiwan TS[1]	6	8	0	0	6	2	0	23	0	199	0	164	0	2	410
Shuen Wan TS[1]	0	8	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	49	46	131	0	12	246
To Kwa Wan TS[2]	1	5	0	90	0	20	0	0	6	0	0	6	0	1	129
Tuen Mun TS[2]	0	38	0	44	16	20	5	4	0	190	0	179	12	7	515
Yim Tin Tsai TS[1]	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	15	0	2	0	0	17

Note: #Aberdeen South Typhoon Shelter and Aberdeen West Typhoon Shelter
Permitted length: [1] – 30.4 metres, [2] – 50 metres, [3] – 75 metres
[4] – The highest usage of typhoon shelters during typhoons

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2239)

Head: (100) Marine Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Port Services
(4) Services to Ships

Controlling Officer: Director of Marine (Mr S.F. WONG)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the various measures of the Government to promote green shipping, including the three-year Green Vessels Registration Incentive Scheme which will be launched in 2026, the three-year Port Dues Incentive Scheme for Green Maritime Fuel-related Vessels, and the ongoing Carbon Intensity Indicator-based green incentive, will the Government advise on the following:

(1) the estimated expenditure on each of the above schemes in 2026-27;

(2) the expected number of vessels benefiting from each scheme;

(3) the relevant staffing involved in the monitoring, checking, system development and construction for implementing the above schemes.

Asked by: Hon CHIU Duncan (LegCo internal reference no.: 15)

Reply:

(1, 2 & 3) The Government will introduce the Green Vessels Registration Incentive Scheme and the Port Dues Incentive Scheme for Green Maritime Fuel-related Vessels for 3 years from 2026 to provide incentive for green vessels registered in Hong Kong and port dues concessions for vessels powered by green fuel as well as those carrying green fuels.

Under the Green Vessels Registration Incentive Scheme, an annual incentive of $60,000 will be provided for each Hong Kong-registered vessel powered by green maritime fuels (including both existing and newly registered vessels), involving an expenditure of about $23.2 million. The scheme will help further promote the green fleet of the Hong Kong Shipping Registry, encourage green transformation of Hong Kong-registered vessels and enhance Hong Kong's competitiveness in the

international maritime arena. The estimated expenditure on the incentive scheme in 2026-27 is $5.5 million. It is expected to attract about 100 new green vessels to register in Hong Kong within the three-year period, accounting for about a quarter of the global number of new green vessels during the same period. Together with the current green maritime fuel-powered vessels, it is estimated that about 170 Hong Kong-registered vessels powered by green maritime fuels will benefit from the scheme by 2028-29. The incentive scheme is undertaken by staff under existing establishment. There is no separate breakdown on the manpower involved.

The Port Dues Incentive Scheme for Green Maritime Fuel-related Vessels will offer a 25% or 50% reduction in port dues to ocean-going vessels powered by, carrying and/or bunkering specified green maritime fuels in Hong Kong for a period of 3 years, involving an expenditure of about $10.7 million. The estimated expenditure on the incentive scheme in 2026-27 is $3.2 million. Such measure will reduce the cost of green maritime fuel bunkering for vessels in Hong Kong, and it is expected to attract over 1 000 relevant vessel calls or bunkering of green maritime fuels in Hong Kong during the three-year period. The above incentive scheme is undertaken by staff under existing establishment. There is no separate breakdown on the manpower involved.

The green incentive was launched on 28 June 2024 for a period of 3 years to encourage green transformation of Hong Kong-registered ships. All Hong Kong-registered ships of 5 000 gross tonnage or above that have attained rating A or B in the Carbon Intensity Indicator formulated by the International Maritime Organization are eligible for the green incentive. Each qualified Hong Kong-registered ship is eligible to receive $20,000 per corresponding year from 2024 to 2026. The estimated expenditure on the green incentive in 2026-27 is $24.32 million. Since the implementation of the incentive in June 2024, as at 28 February 2026, the Marine Department has received a total of 1 529 applications from 984 ships, among which 1 509 applications from 974 ships have been approved. 3 additional contract staff have been employed since 2024 to assist in processing the application of the green incentive.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0927)

Head: (100) Marine Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Local Services

Controlling Officer: Director of Marine (Mr S.F. WONG)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Chief Executive mentioned in the 2025 Policy Address that the Government would develop the yacht economy. The initiatives include provision of additional berths; relaxation of the requirements for visiting yachts and development of a Dynamic Yacht Monitoring System, allowing visiting yachts to anchor at government designated waters and navigate in a safe and orderly manner, without having to reserve berths at privately-operated yacht clubs or piers; and enhancement of the Electronic Business System to allow one-stop, pre-submission of arrival information from visiting yachts for preliminary vetting by relevant departments. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the number of non-Hong Kong yachts entering Hong Kong, the number of berths used in Hong Kong, the average length of stay in Hong Kong and the average number of passengers per yacht in the past 3 years, as well as the top 3 regions of origin of non-Hong Kong yachts visiting Hong Kong;

2. the current progress, set-up cost, annual recurrent expenditure and staffing of the Dynamic Yacht Monitoring System, which is scheduled to be set up within this year according to reports; and

3. whether the Marine Department has considered adopting the "user pays" principle in financing the above Monitoring System; if yes, of the details; if not, of the reasons for that.

Asked by: Hon CHU Lap-wai (LegCo internal reference no.: 101)

Reply:

1. According to the records of the Marine Department (MD), the number of yachts visiting Hong Kong and their average length of stay in Hong Kong in the past 3 years are as follows:

	No. of yachts visiting Hong Kong	Average length of stay in Hong Kong
2023	80	32.7 days
2024	68	35.1 days
2025	84	48.9 days

The top 3 regions of origin of yachts visiting Hong Kong are the Chinese Mainland, Italy and the Philippines. MD does not maintain records of the number of berths used in Hong Kong or the number of passengers per yacht for yachts visiting Hong Kong.

2. MD is actively developing the Dynamic Yacht Monitoring System (the Monitoring System), which is expected to be launched in 2026. The expenditure involved in this item is around $2.7 million, which covers the costs of system design, system implementation services and information technology security-related services. The estimated recurrent expenditure of the system is around $550,000 per year from 2027-28 onwards, which covers the costs of software and system maintenance. The recurrent expenditure will be absorbed by the existing resources of MD. The implementation of the facilitation measures forms part of the normal duties of the staff concerned. There is no separate breakdown on the relevant staff establishment.

3. The Monitoring System is provided as a service under MD's Vessel Traffic Services System. The law does not provide for the collection of fees from vessels for monitoring their movements. However, under the existing marine legislation, in addition to the application fees for Arrival Clearance and Port Clearance, yachts visiting Hong Kong are also required to pay a corresponding fee for permission based on the area of the vessels (in square metres) when applying for permission to navigate in the waters of Hong Kong. With regard to the recovery of service costs associated with the Monitoring System, MD will take this into consideration during the regular fee reviews.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0772)

Head: (100) Marine Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Port Services
(4) Services to Ships

Controlling Officer: Director of Marine (Mr S.F. WONG)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the development of a green maritime fuel bunkering centre, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) The Government stated that it would provide port dues concessions for vessels powered by green fuel as well as those carrying green fuels to attract more vessels to bunker green fuel in Hong Kong. How many vessels had engaged in green fuel bunkering operations in Hong Kong in the past 3 years? What was the number of bunkering operations involved? What are the details of the above port dues concessions?

(2) The Government launched the Green Maritime Fuel Bunkering Incentive Scheme in the middle of last year to encourage pioneer companies to develop green maritime fuel bunkering business in Hong Kong. How many applications have been received and approved under the scheme? What is the amount of incentive involved in the approved applications?

(3) The Government stated that it would take forward a legislative amendment exercise this year to provide more anchorages for green maritime fuel bunkering operations. What are the details including the expected increase in the number of anchorages and the capacity to meet the bunkering demands?

(4) The Government stated that an incentive scheme would be launched for green vessels registered in Hong Kong to encourage green transformation of Hong Kong fleets. What is the current number of green vessels registered in Hong Kong (and their percentage in the total number of Hong Kong-registered vessels)? What are the major differences between the above incentive scheme to be launched and the green incentive launched by the Government in mid-2024?

(5) To assist in the green transformation of Hong Kong-registered vessels, the Government launched the green incentive in mid-2024 to provide incentives for Hong Kong-registered vessels of 5 000 gross tonnage or above attaining rating A or B in the Carbon Intensity Indicator. How many vessels of 5 000 gross tonnage or above are currently registered in Hong Kong? What are the number of vessels that have applied for the above incentive, the number of applications approved and the amount of incentive involved?

(6) Has the Government maintained statistics on the current number of green maritime fuel-related talents in Hong Kong and assessed the number of relevant talents required by Hong Kong in the next 3 years? If yes, what are the details?

(7) It is learnt that the Government has approved 8 suitable training courses on green maritime fuels in the Greater Bay Area as locally recognised courses to allow the in-service maritime practitioners in Hong Kong to take the relevant training courses. Has the Government maintained statistics on the number of practitioners who have taken the relevant courses? If yes, what are the details?

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 26)

Reply:

The Government promulgated the Action Plan on Green Maritime Fuel Bunkering (Action Plan) in November 2024 to develop Hong Kong into a green maritime fuel bunkering centre. We are pressing ahead with various strategic measures including the adoption of a multi-fuel strategy. In 2 months since the promulgation of the Action Plan, the industry has completed the first liquefied natural gas (LNG) bunkering operation at anchorage on 14 February 2025, followed by the first LNG bunkering with simultaneous cargo handling operation at Kwai Tsing Container Terminals (KTCT) on 5 June 2025. This puts Hong Kong on the map of major ports in the world capable of providing regular commercial LNG and biodiesel bunkering services. The Hong Kong port also completed the first methanol bunkering operation at anchorage on 5 March 2026 and the first methanol bunkering with simultaneous cargo handling operation at KTCT on 10 March 2026, which demonstrated that Hong Kong is equipped with methanol bunkering capabilities.

(1)

As at 10 March 2026, a total of 12 ocean-going vessels have completed 20 green maritime fuel bunkering operations in Hong Kong waters. These included 18 LNG bunkering operations and 2 methanol bunkering operations.

To expedite the establishment of Hong Kong as a green maritime fuel bunkering and trading centre, the Marine Department (MD) will introduce the Port Dues Incentive Scheme for Green Maritime Fuel-related Vessels (Port Dues Incentive Scheme) to reduce certain port fees for green maritime fuel-related vessels (relevant vessels), aiming to help lower the cost of transitioning to green maritime fuels and attract more relevant vessels to call at Hong Kong for bunkering.

The Port Dues Incentive Scheme will be effective from 2026 for a period of 3 years. We plan to offer a 25% or 50% port dues incentive to ocean-going vessels powered by, carrying and/or bunkering specified green maritime fuels in Hong Kong. It is expected to attract over 1 000 relevant vessel calls or bunkering of green maritime fuels in Hong Kong during the three-year period, involving a total expenditure of $10.7 million.

(2)

To encourage pioneer companies to provide green maritime fuel bunkering services to ocean-going vessels in Hong Kong, MD launched the Green Maritime Fuel Bunkering Incentive in June 2025. An incentive of $500,000 will be granted for each of the first 2 bunkering operations by the first 2 bunker operators using specified green maritime fuels. As at 6 March 2026, 2 companies have successfully conducted 4 LNG bunkering operations and were each granted an incentive of $1 million. For green methanol bunkering, MD is currently processing 2 applications from 2 companies, each involving an incentive amount of $500,000.

(3)

One of the action measures of the Action Plan is to designate anchorages and sheltered spaces for green maritime fuel bunkering barges. In this connection, MD has reassessed the current port facility layout and proposed to re-plan the port facilities through legislative amendments to promote the long-term development of green maritime fuel bunkering in Hong Kong.

The proposal includes creating new anchorages, converting certain existing anchorages to multi-purpose anchorages in which green maritime fuel bunkering and mooring of bunker barges may take place, and relocating certain anchorages that are close to densely populated areas to reduce their impact on the population in the vicinity. The proposed rearrangement will increase operational flexibility of green maritime fuel bunkering and provide additional sea room for green maritime fuel bunkering operations, up from the existing 645 hectares to 2 877 hectares, thereby ensuring that the Hong Kong Port will have sufficient capabilities to handle the emerging demand of green maritime fuel bunkering. Under the new layout, bunkering vessels supplying different types of fuels may anchor at different dangerous goods anchorages. Certain dangerous goods anchorages will be repurposed to facilitate ocean-going vessels to berth or bunker at the anchorages, thereby enhancing the flexibility of port operations.

(4) & (5)

The green incentive was launched on 28 June 2024 for a period of 3 years to encourage green transformation of Hong Kong-registered vessels. All Hong Kong-registered vessels of 5 000 gross tonnage or above that have attained rating A or B in the Carbon Intensity Indicator formulated by the International Maritime Organization are eligible for the green incentive. Each qualified Hong Kong-registered vessel is eligible to receive $20,000 per corresponding year from 2024 to 2026. As at 28 February 2026, there are 1 826 Hong Kong-registered vessels with gross tonnage of 5 000 or above. MD has received a total of 1 529 applications from 984 vessels, among which 1 509 applications from 974 vessels have been approved. The total amount of incentive granted is $30.18 million.

As for the Green Vessels Registration Incentive Scheme, its aims are to support the transition to green maritime fuels in Hong Kong's maritime industry, attract more green maritime fuel-powered vessels to register in Hong Kong and promote the green fleet of the Hong Kong Shipping Registry (HKSR). The scheme will launch in 2026 to provide an annual incentive of $60,000 for each Hong Kong-registered vessel powered by green maritime fuels (including both existing and newly registered vessels). As at 28 February 2026, there are about 70 Hong Kong-registered vessels that can be powered by green maritime fuels, accounting for about 3.5% of the total number of Hong Kong-registered vessels.

Although the two schemes differ slightly in their positioning and target beneficiaries, both are intended to accelerate green transformation of the Hong Kong fleet and enhance the competitiveness of the HKSR, thereby attracting more green vessels to register in Hong Kong. The Green Vessels Registration Incentive Scheme is expected to attract about 100 new green vessels to register in Hong Kong within the three-year period, accounting for about a quarter of the global number of new green vessels during the same period.

(6) & (7)

Following the promulgation of the Action Plan in November 2024, the Transport and Logistics Bureau and MD have actively implemented measures on training green maritime fuel-related talents. Up to now, MD has recognised 10 mainland training courses on green maritime fuels for enrolment by the in-service maritime practitioners in Hong Kong (such as seafarers). The relevant training institutions have issued a total of 39 certificates of proficiency and 36 endorsements to the in-service maritime practitioners in Hong Kong following their completion of the courses. In addition, the Professional Training and Examination Refund Scheme under the Maritime and Aviation Training Fund launched a subsidiary scheme known as "Train-the-Trainers Support Scheme" in March 2026 to subsidise maritime practitioners in Hong Kong who already possess a certain level of maritime knowledge and qualifications to take the train-the-trainer courses on green maritime fuels following nomination by their employers. Upon completion of the courses, they will serve as trainers in their companies and share essential knowledge and professional skills on green maritime fuels to other colleagues, thereby assisting Hong Kong's shipping companies in providing their staff with training on green maritime fuels, particularly on the safety aspect. Each participant will be refunded 80% of the fees, subject to a maximum of $30,000, after completing the pre-approved course or passing the examination. The local industry may also recruit professionals in green shipping from the "Talent List" under the "General Employment Policy", the "Admission Scheme for Mainland Talents and Professionals" and the "Quality Migrant Admission Scheme" to meet the development needs of the industry.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3259)

Head: (100) Marine Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Local Services

Controlling Officer: Director of Marine (Mr S.F. WONG)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding berthing spaces for pleasure vessels, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) (a) the number of vessels holding a valid licence for Class IV vessels (pleasure vessels) and (b) the number of vessels applying for a new licence for Class IV vessels (pleasure vessels), in each of the past 5 years (as at the end of the respective year), with a breakdown by length of vessels (i.e. (i) less than 36 feet; (ii) from 36 feet to 60 feet; (iii) from 61 feet to 99 feet; (iv) from 100 feet to 199 feet; and (v) 200 feet or above);

(2) the current number and area of berthing spaces available for pleasure vessels; whether any assessment has been conducted to determine if such berthing spaces are sufficient to meet the berthing needs of pleasure vessels; and

(3) the number of arrivals of non-Hong Kong registered pleasure vessels visiting Hong Kong in each of the past 5 years (as at the end of the respective year).

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 37)

Reply:

(1) According to the records of the Marine Department (MD), the numbers of vessels holding a valid licence and applying for a new licence for Class IV vessels (pleasure vessels) in the past 5 years are as follows:

a) Numbers of vessels holding a valid licence for Class IV vessels

	Year				
Length of vessel	**2021**	**2022**	**2023**	**2024**	**2025**
Less than 36 feet	9 182	9 747	9 898	9 682	9 395
From 36 feet to 60.9 feet	1 830	1 874	1 901	1 908	1 892
From 61 feet to 99.9 feet	691	696	689	671	672
From 100 feet to 199.9 feet	64	61	64	64	63
200 feet or above	0	0	1	0	2
Total	11 767	12 378	12 553	12 325	12 024

b) Numbers of vessels applying for a new licence for Class IV vessels

	Year				
Length of vessel	**2021**	**2022**	**2023**	**2024**	**2025**
Less than 36 feet	1 189	1 041	722	407	315
From 36 feet to 60.9 feet	94	99	105	86	87
From 61 feet to 99.9 feet	48	33	23	29	34
From 100 feet to 199.9 feet	6	6	11	4	4
200 feet or above	0	0	0	0	1
Total	1 337	1 179	861	526	441

(2) Under normal weather conditions, local vessels may be anchored at any safe and suitable locations within Hong Kong waters (except for certain areas of waters where anchoring is prohibited), including typhoon shelters and sheltered anchorages, according to their daily business and operational needs provided that no obstruction is made to marine traffic, and no permission from MD is required.

MD carries out assessments of the overall territory-wide supply and demand situation of sheltered spaces on a regular basis. According to the Assessment of Typhoon Shelter Space Requirements released in December 2022 and based on estimates of the general utilisation of berthing spaces by pleasure vessels, as at the end of 2025, the

supply of sheltered spaces for pleasure vessels was 254.1 hectares while the demand was 253.9 hectares, leaving a surplus of sheltered spaces of 0.2 hectares. A new round of assessment has been commenced in the third quarter of 2025 to assess the overall territory-wide supply and demand of sheltered spaces from 2027 to 2040, and is expected to be completed between late 2027 and early 2028.

(3) According to the records of MD, the numbers of arrivals of pleasure vessels visiting Hong Kong in the past 5 years are as follows:

Year	Number of arrivals
2021	37
2022	42
2023	80
2024	68
2025	84

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB053**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0084)

Head: (100) Marine Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Local Services

Controlling Officer: Director of Marine (Mr S.F. WONG)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Under the influence of the external environment, river trade cargo vessel arrivals have been dropping continuously. Due to insufficient cargo throughput, river barges can hardly benefit from the buy-five-get-five-free discount on the one-month Multiple Entry Permit (MEP) offered by the Government. There have been suggestions to adjust the discount to buy-one-get-one-free. According to the Transport and Logistics Bureau, the Action Plan on Maritime and Port Development Strategy was formulated in December 2023 to support the development of the maritime and port industry, which included the action measure of reviewing the permit fees imposed on river trade vessels. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1) statistics on the usage of the buy-five-get-five-free discount on MEP by river trade cargo vessels in the past 3 years (i.e. 2023, 2024 and 2025), including the average monthly number of river trade cargo vessel arrivals and the number of MEPs in use under the discount;

2) regarding the Government's action measure of reviewing the permit fees imposed on river trade vessels, please advise on the expected time for the results to be available and announced; and

3) the manpower resources involved in conducting port formalities for river trade vessels.

Asked by: Hon LEUNG Chun, Jonathan (LegCo internal reference no.: 31)

Reply:

1. In the past 3 years, the average monthly number of river trade cargo vessel arrivals and the annual number of Multiple Entry Permits (MEPs) in use are set out as follows:

Year	Average monthly number of river trade cargo vessel arrivals	Annual number of MEPs issued to river trade cargo vessels
2023	3 622	743*
2024	3 668	5 650
2025	3 521	5 865

*Note: The waiver period of the "Permit to Remain" fees payable by river trade vessels during the COVID-19 pandemic was from 1 November 2019 to 31 October 2023. Since river trade vessels were not required to pay the "Permit to Remain" fees during the waiver period, there was no need for them to apply for MEPs.

2. The Transport and Logistics Bureau formulated the Action Plan on Maritime and Port Development Strategy in December 2023 to support the development of the maritime and port industry. Regarding the action measure of reviewing the permit fees imposed on river trade vessels under the Plan, we have preliminarily completed the review and will announce relevant details in a timely manner.

3. The handling of port formalities for river trade vessels forms part of the normal duties of Marine Department officers. There is no separate breakdown on the manpower involved.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3203)

Head: (100) Marine Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Services to Ships

Controlling Officer: Director of Marine (Mr S.F. WONG)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

To attract more ocean-going vessels to register in Hong Kong, the Government launched an incentive in 2024 for Hong Kong-registered ships attaining Carbon Intensity Indicator rating A or B and introduced the block registration incentive targeting shipowners who register multiple ships with the Hong Kong Shipping Registry within a specified period. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1) the numbers of shipowners and ships that have benefitted from each of the above 2 incentives since their launch, as well as the number of ships newly registered in Hong Kong for obtaining these incentives; and

2) the resources involved in handling ship registration by the Government.

Asked by: Hon LEUNG Chun, Jonathan (LegCo internal reference no.: 38)

Reply:

1) The green incentive was launched on 28 June 2024 for a period of 3 years to encourage green transformation of Hong Kong-registered ships. All Hong Kong-registered ships of 5 000 gross tonnage or above that have attained rating A or B in the Carbon Intensity Indicator formulated by the International Maritime Organization are eligible for the green incentive. Each qualified Hong Kong-registered ship is eligible to receive HK$20,000 per corresponding year from 2024 to 2026. As at 28 February 2026, the Marine Department (MD) has received a total of 1 529 applications from 984 ships, among which 1 509 applications from 974 ships have been approved, involving 750 shipowners and 92 demise charterers. Since the launch of the incentive, 35 newly registered ships have obtained the incentive.

   The block registration incentive was launched on 14 February 2025 to attract more shipowners to register their ships in Hong Kong. Shipowners who register more than 1 eligible ship with the Hong Kong Shipping Registry within 24 months may be provided with a refund of the relevant ship registration fee and the first-year annual

tonnage charge. 1 application may cover ships of different shipowners and may be submitted by a shipowner, ship manager or ship agent. As at 28 February 2026, MD has received a total of 28 applications, involving 87 ships with gross tonnage of about 5.5 million. Among them, 53 ships (with gross tonnage of about 4 million) have completed registration, involving 53 shipowners.

2) The ship registration work is undertaken by the Ship Registration Services Section of MD. As at 28 February 2026, there are 11 staff in the section.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2368)

Head: (100) Marine Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Port Services
(4) Services to Ships

Controlling Officer: Director of Marine (Mr S.F. WONG)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding measures to reinforce Hong Kong's position as an international maritime centre and promote green shipping, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the numbers of applications received and approved under the three-year Carbon Intensity Indicator-based green incentive and the block registration incentive since their launch; and

2. the specific details, eligibility criteria, subsidy amounts and estimated total expenditure of the 2 new three-year schemes to be introduced in 2026 as mentioned in the document, namely the Green Vessels Registration Incentive Scheme and the Port Dues Incentive Scheme for Green Maritime Fuel-related Vessels.

Asked by: Hon WONG Ho-ming, Augustine (LegCo internal reference no.: 73)

Reply:

1. The green incentive was launched on 28 June 2024 to encourage green transformation of the shipping industry. All Hong Kong-registered ships of 5 000 gross tonnage or above that have attained rating A or B in the Carbon Intensity Indicator formulated by the International Maritime Organization are eligible for the green incentive. Each qualified Hong Kong-registered ship is eligible to receive $20,000 per corresponding year from 2024 to 2026. As at 28 February 2026, the Marine Department (MD) has received a total of 1 529 applications, 1 509 of which have been approved.

   The block registration incentive was launched on 14 February 2025 to attract more shipowners to register their ships in Hong Kong. Shipowners who register more than 1 eligible ship with the Hong Kong Shipping Registry within 24 months may be provided with a refund of the relevant ship registration fee and the first-year annual tonnage charge. 1 application may cover ships of different shipowners and may be submitted by a shipowner, ship manager or ship agent. As at 28 February 2026, MD

has received a total of 28 applications, involving 87 ships with gross tonnage of about 5.5 million. Among them, 53 ships (with gross tonnage of about 4 million) have completed registration.

2. The Government will introduce the Green Vessels Registration Incentive Scheme and the Port Dues Incentive Scheme for Green Maritime Fuel-related Vessels for 3 years from mid-2026 to provide incentive for green vessels registered in Hong Kong and port dues concessions for vessels powered by green fuels as well as those carrying green fuels.

Under the Green Vessels Registration Incentive Scheme, an annual incentive of $60,000 will be provided for each Hong Kong-registered vessel powered by green maritime fuels (including both existing and newly registered vessels), involving an expenditure of about $23.2 million. The scheme will help further promote the green fleet of the Hong Kong Shipping Registry, encourage green transformation of Hong Kong-registered vessels and enhance Hong Kong's competitiveness in the international maritime arena. It is expected to attract about 100 new green vessels to register in Hong Kong within the three-year period, accounting for about a quarter of the global number of new green vessels during the same period.

As for the Port Dues Incentive Scheme for Green Maritime Fuel-related Vessels, a 25% or 50% port dues incentive will be offered to ocean-going vessels powered by, carrying and/or bunkering specified green maritime fuels in Hong Kong for a period of 3 years, involving an expenditure of about $10.7 million. Such measure will reduce the cost of green maritime fuel bunkering for vessels in Hong Kong, and it is expected to attract over 1 000 relevant vessel calls or bunkering of green maritime fuels in Hong Kong during the three-year period.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0205)

Head: (100) Marine Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Services to Ships

Controlling Officer: Director of Marine (Mr S.F. WONG)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

There has been a relatively significant drop in the number of Hong Kong-registered vessels and their gross tonnage in recent years. While no significant adjustment has been made to the performance targets and assessment indicators for vessel registration services in 2026-27 as compared with those in the previous year, the relevant estimate has increased by 3.0% as compared with the original estimate in 2025-26. In this connection, please inform this Committee of the following:

(1) statistics on vessels newly registered in and de-registered from Hong Kong in the past year, including the original/new registration places of vessels, types of vessels, types of fuels used, gross tonnage, and the countries or regions of origins of shipowners;

(2) whether the Government will consider using the increased estimate in 2026-27 to set up new regional desks for the Hong Kong Shipping Registry in due course in this financial year; and

(3) whether the 3.0% increase in provision will be sufficient to cope with the promotional activities on vessel registration in the face of increasingly keen competition in the international maritime industry.

Asked by: Hon YIM Kong, Erik (LegCo internal reference no.: 28)

Reply:

(1) According to the records of the Hong Kong Shipping Registry (HKSR), a total of 138 vessels were newly registered under the HKSR with gross tonnage of 8 364 888 in 2025. Among them, 5 can be fuelled by liquefied natural gas or methanol while the remaining ones are powered by traditional fossil fuels. Regarding the origins of the newly registered vessels, newly built vessels accounted for the largest proportion, while the remaining ones originating mainly from registration places such as Liberia, Panama, the Marshall Islands, the People's Republic of China, etc. In terms of vessel types, the newly registered vessels are mainly bulk carriers, container ships and oil tankers, while

some of them are oil/chemical tankers and general dry cargo ships. As for the backgrounds of the shipowners, most newly registered vessels are owned by shipowners from countries or regions such as Hong Kong, China, the People's Republic of China, the Marshall Islands, the British Virgin Islands, Panama, etc.

During the same period, a total of 419 vessels cancelled their registration under the HKSR with gross tonnage of 28 077 220. All of these vessels are powered by traditional fossil fuels. The types of relevant vessels are mainly container ships, bulk carriers and oil tankers, while some of them are oil/chemical tankers, general cargo carriers, etc. The majority of vessels deregistering from Hong Kong are owned by shipowners from countries or regions such as Hong Kong, China, the Marshall Islands, Panama, Singapore, Norway, etc. In addition, with reference to the database subscription information provided by the market, following de-registration from Hong Kong, the vessels mainly switched to registration places such as Singapore, the Marshall Islands, the Bahamas, Panama, Belgium, etc.

(2) To enhance the provision of services in the Middle East region, the HKSR set up a regional desk in Dubai in December 2025, which will, in collaboration with the regional desks set up in London, Shanghai, Singapore, Sydney, San Francisco, Tokyo and Toronto, provide technical support for Hong Kong-registered vessels and their shipping companies more effectively, and provide international shipowners with services related to vessel registration in Hong Kong. We will consider strengthening the provision of relevant services in a timely manner having regard to the actual needs, and there is currently no plan to establish new regional desk in the short run.

(3) The increased provision is mainly for the three-year Green Vessels Registration Incentive Scheme to be launched in June this year, providing an incentive of $60,000 each year during the three-year implementation period for each Hong Kong-registered vessel powered by green maritime fuels (including both existing and newly registered vessels) to encourage green transformation of Hong Kong fleets, thereby attracting more green vessels to register in Hong Kong. We are actively strengthening promotional efforts in Hong Kong, the Chinese Mainland and overseas (including the Middle East and ASEAN regions), while revamping the existing legislation on vessel registration to provide shipowners with greater convenience. Coupled with the existing and newly launched green incentives, these initiatives aim to enhance the international competitiveness of the HKSR.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0919)

Head: (100) Marine Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Local Services

Controlling Officer: Director of Marine (Mr S.F. WONG)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Please provide the following information:

(1) the changes in the annual number of port calls by river barges visiting Hong Kong in the past 3 years;

(2) the items and corresponding amounts of all fees payable by river barges visiting Hong Kong; and

(3) whether the Government has set aside sufficient funds to support local ports in attracting the transshipment of cargo via barges from the Pearl River Delta to Hong Kong; if yes, of the details.

Asked by: Hon YIM Kong, Erik (LegCo internal reference no.: 29)

Reply:

(1) The number of river trade cargo vessels visiting Hong Kong and the corresponding changes in the past 3 years are as follows:

Year	Number of visits to Hong Kong	Annual change
2023	43 467	-10.8%
2024	44 020	+1.3%
2025	42 255	-4.0%

(2) River trade vessels visiting Hong Kong are required to pay the following fees in accordance with the Merchant Shipping (Local Vessels) (Fees) Regulation (Cap. 548J):

A) Arrival Clearance	$58
B) Port Clearance	$58
C) Single-Trip Permit to Remain **<u>or</u>** A permit that may be used for not more than 10 occasions within one monthly period (commonly referred to as a "Multiple Entry Permit")	The fee payable by a vessel is calculated based on its area in square metres. For a vessel where the area is less than 400 square metres, the fee payable is $820; for a vessel where the area is 400 square metres or more, the fee payable is $820 plus $2.2 for each square metre of the difference between the area of the vessel and 400 square metres (rounded up to the next whole number if the difference is not a whole number). Note: If a vessel remains in the waters of Hong Kong for 8 or more consecutive days, the same fees as those specified above shall be payable for the following periods, including (a) each period of 7 consecutive days during that occasion; and (b) the remaining days during that occasion. The fee payable by a vessel is calculated based on its area in square metres. For a vessel where the area is less than 400 square metres, the fee payable is $4,100; for a vessel where the area is 400 square metres or more, the fee payable is $4,100 plus $11 for each square metre of the difference between the area of the vessel and 400 square metres (rounded up to the next whole number if the difference is not a whole number).

(3) The Transport and Logistics Bureau formulated the Action Plan on Maritime and Port Development Strategy in December 2023 to support the development of the maritime and port industry. The Action Plan outlines various action measures to consolidate Hong Kong's status as a regional transhipment hub and international maritime centre, including conducting a review on the permit fees imposed on river trade vessels, with a view to maintaining the port's competitiveness and attractiveness to the industry. We are conducting a review in this regard and will continue to closely monitor the operating situation of the industry, with a view to introducing timely measures to support its development.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB058**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0015)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat: Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the recently published Budget that the Government is pressing ahead with a number of Smart and Green Mass Transit System (SGMTS) projects, including those in the Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen and Yuen Long South New Development Areas (HSK/HT and YLS NDAs), Kai Tak and East Kowloon. In this connection, will the Administration inform this Committee of the following:

1. What are the staffing provision and expenditure estimated to be invested in the above projects in 2026-27?

2. Regarding the projects in the HSK/HT and YLS NDAs, Kai Tak and East Kowloon, when planning the alignments, how will the Administration determine whether to adopt an elevated or at-grade design based on the geographical and traffic flow data analyses? As for the HSK project expected to be tendered this year and the Kai Tak project for which tendering has commenced, what measures or designs has the Administration adopted to ensure that sufficient capacity will be reserved to meet long-term needs?

3. In view of the lessons learned from giving excessive priority to the Light Rail during its construction, which adversely affected the passage of other vehicles, will the Administration incorporate smart traffic measures (such as the dynamic adjustment of green time by using information technology) in the design of junctions for road sections that may adopt at-grade alignment so as to achieve co-ordinated traffic flow between the mass transit systems and other vehicles and prevent recurrence of the same problem? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons? and

4. Regarding the Kai Tak development, apart from constructing the SGMTS there, will the Administration consider planning flyovers and footbridges connecting to Kwun Tong at the Kai Tak Runway Tip so as to improve the external connectivity of the area and prevent the road section concerned from becoming a dead-end road?

Asked by: Hon BOK Kwok-ming, Aaron (LegCo internal reference no.: 1)

Reply:

1. The implementation of the 3 Smart and Green Mass Transit System (SGMTS) projects in the Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen and Yuen Long South New Development Areas (HSK/HT and YLS NDAs), Kai Tak and East Kowloon is undertaken by the existing manpower resources of the Transport and Logistics Bureau, the Highways Department, the Civil Engineering and Development Department and the Transport Department. There is no detailed breakdown of the staffing provision and expenditure involved.

2. In determining whether to adopt an elevated or at-grade design in transit systems, we will take into account a basket of factors in a holistic manner, including the technical requirements for space, alignment gradient and curvature, etc. of the system, the impacts of the system on the environment, existing road traffic and facilities, the time required for implementation, the transport and cost effectiveness, etc. Regarding the SGMTS in Kai Tak and East Kowloon, the 2 projects are located in the developed areas in Kai Tak and the northern uphill areas of Kwun Tong in East Kowloon respectively with dense development. There is only very limited space for the construction of the SGMTS, and the alignments are constrained by the layout of existing buildings and facilities as well. If the 2 projects adopt the at-grade design, it is anticipated that a large area of the existing road surface will be occupied, thus affecting the existing road traffic and potentially reducing the transport effectiveness of the SGMTS. As such, a dedicated and elevated corridor design is proposed in the 2 projects, segregating the SGMTS completely from the road-based traffic along the alignment, so as not to affect other traffic operations and not to be affected by road-based traffic conditions, with a view to providing convenient transport feeder services.

As regards the project in the HSK/HT and YLS NDAs, since a Green Transit Corridor comprising the SGMTS roads, footpaths and cycle tracks has been included in the planning, a green road-based mode can be adopted in the project, thereby minimising environmental impact while saving construction time and costs.

We will require in the tender documents of the 3 projects that the design of the SGMTS (including the carrying capacity of vehicles, fleet size, layout of stations and depots, etc.) must be capable of meeting the long-term transport demand, and that the design layout can allow for sufficient flexibility to accommodate the operational requirements under varying traffic demand conditions.

3. For the SGMTS in the HSK/HT and YLS NDAs, most of the system is planned to operate on dedicated roads, with grade separation arrangements (e.g. provision of elevated sections) proposed at the major and busy road junctions to segregate the SGMTS from the other road-based traffic, so as to achieve a smooth overall traffic flow. As for non-busy roads, it is proposed that the SGMTS will share road junctions with other modes of transport. Through design optimisation and further road capacity assessments, the number of shared road junctions has been minimised. Moreover, the design of the shared junctions has also taken into account the traffic volume arising from future developments, with sufficient capacity reserved. Coupled with the planned Real-time Adaptive Traffic Signal System to enable dynamic allocation of signal time according to the actual vehicular flow and smart traffic management, a smoother overall traffic flow can be achieved.

4. The Government is studying the construction of a sea-crossing bridge over the existing Kwun Tong Typhoon Shelter to directly connect the former Kai Tak runway area and Kwun

Tong, thereby improving the transport connectivity of the former runway area. The study will be conducted in line with the overall planning and transport arrangements of the Kai Tak Development Area.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1774)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in paragraph 137 of the Budget Speech that the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA) is the world's busiest cargo airport. Its cargo throughput exceeded 5 million tonnes last year; and its passenger throughput reached 61 million, marking a year-on-year increase of nearly 15%. Also, the Government will strive to enter into new air services agreements and expand traffic rights with regions demonstrating development potential, such as the Middle East, Central Asia, Africa and South America, so as to further enhance Hong Kong's competitiveness as an international aviation hub. In this connection, please inform this Committee of the following:

1. Regarding the negotiations on new air services agreements and traffic rights expansion, will the Government please give a brief account of the annual quantitative objectives (including new destinations, frequency of services, arrangements concerning fifth/seventh freedom rights and cargo allotment) and the negotiation timetable?

2. Amid changes in international political and economic landscape, trade volume with traditional markets in Europe and America is declining, while emerging markets like economies of the Association of Southeast Asian Nations as well as those in the Middle East and along the Belt and Road (B&R) are on the rise. How will the Government create a favourable environment for more frequent commercial exchanges between Hong Kong and these economies by launching new targeted routes? Will flight service to the United States be reduced to make way for additional services to emerging markets and B&R countries according to the trends in trade volume?

3. In the face of competition from neighbouring airports (especially those in the nearby cities of Guangzhou, Shenzhen and Zhuhai) in terms of capacity enhancement and subsidy provision, how will the Government maintain Hong Kong's differentiation advantages in passenger (in particular business traveller), cargo and transfer services? Has the HKIA put in place any subsidy policies on the launch of flight routes to align with the practice of neighbouring airports? and

4. Upon commissioning of Terminal 2 this May, the HKIA will be better positioned to handle even more passengers. Will the Government set any key performance indicators to drive an increase in the number of visitors, especially business travellers and high value-added overnight visitors?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Chung-yee, Alan (LegCo internal reference no.: 3)

Reply:

1. & 2. The Government will continue to actively participate in international civil aviation conferences and take the initiative to visit aviation partners, targeting to explore with 10 or more aviation partners within 2026 the enhancement of air connectivity (including discussing the establishment of new air services agreements or the expansion of traffic rights), with priority focus on regions with further development potential and new growth areas, such as South America, Central Asia, Africa and the Middle East, so as to support the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA) to further expand its aviation network.

In addition, the Government has been, in conjunction with the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK), strategically attracting local and non-local airlines to develop new destinations and increase flights through outreach efforts, incentive schemes and policy facilitation measures.

3. The AAHK is committed to developing intermodal transport networks so as to enhance the convenience for the transport of passengers and goods in the Guangdong-Hong Kong-Macao Greater Bay Area (GBA) to and from all parts of the world via Hong Kong. Regarding passenger services, the SkyPier Terminal of the AAHK facilitates transit passengers from Macao and the Chinese Mainland to go directly to the restricted area of the HKIA by ferry or transfer coach services, without having to go through Hong Kong immigration clearance, for onward flights to overseas destinations, and vice versa. In addition, the AAHK has set up nearly 40 city terminals at strategic locations in the GBA for passengers to check in in advance, and the automated car parks on the Hong Kong Port Island of the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge Hong Kong Port are being commissioned in phases.

Furthermore, to attract more passengers to transit through Hong Kong, the AAHK partnered with an online travel platform in September 2025 to launch the Free Layover Tour service, which is designed exclusively for transit passengers with a layover of at least 7 hours for free.

As for air cargo, the AAHK is actively taking forward the development of the sea-air intermodal cargo transshipment mode between the HKIA and the GBA, as well as completing the Phase 1 development of the permanent facilities of the HKIA Dongguan Logistics Park in stages, so as to provide a more seamless and convenient international air transport network for cargo in the GBA and to further develop Hong Kong's function as an air cargo transshipment hub.

Regarding subsidies for flight routes, the AAHK launched the Air Network Development Programme (the Programme) in June 2024, which provides financial incentives to encourage airlines to open new routes and increase flight frequencies on the existing routes. To date, the Programme has attracted 36 airlines to open 82 new routes and increase flight frequencies on 14 existing routes. The expenditure for the Programme above is borne by the AAHK and does not involve government expenditure.

4. The AAHK announced in February 2026 that the passenger departure facilities of Terminal 2 are scheduled to commence operations on 27 May 2026. The expanded Terminal 2 will be seamlessly connected to the Airport Express platforms and Terminal 1. It is estimated that approximately 20% of the passengers, i.e. about 8 million passengers, may be diverted by the end of this year.

On the other hand, to attract more business and high value-added visitors to use the HKIA, the Hong Kong Business Aviation Centre unveiled its new terminal last year as phase one of its in-situ expansion project concluded, with the handling capacity doubled to meet the keen demand for business aviation in the GBA and other regions. The second phase expansion will also be completed soon to better meet the diverse demands of the high-end market, including charter flights, pet travel and group tours.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1779)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in paragraph 149 of the Budget Speech that the international maritime industry is undergoing green transformation. Substantial capital investments are needed for building new green vessels or retrofitting existing ones. Hong Kong will leverage its strengths to promote the co-development of financial and maritime centres. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. Professional talents are indispensable to the promotion of green shipping. One of the strategies set out in the Action Plan on Green Maritime Fuel Bunkering as promulgated by the Government in end-2024 is to nurture talents in relation to green maritime fuels. It is expected that 50 talents in relation to green maritime fuels will be trained by early 2026, and at the same time the Government will continue to provide facilitation for relevant talents to come to Hong Kong through different schemes. Please inform this Committee of the current situation of talent training and whether the Government has kept track of the employment situation of relevant talents.

2. How will the Government facilitate connections among financial, shipping and professional services, so as to achieve synergistic effect and organic integration of industries? and

3. Facing the competition from ports and financial centres in the region in respect of green shipping, what is the advantageous positioning of Hong Kong? Regarding talents and compliance capability, what are the details of the Government's cross-departmental training and roadmap for attracting talents?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Chung-yee, Alan (LegCo internal reference no.: 8)

Reply:

1. Since the promulgation of the Action Plan on Green Maritime Fuel Bunkering in November 2024, the Transport and Logistics Bureau and the Marine Department (MD) have been actively implementing measures to nurture talents in relation to green maritime fuels. So far, the MD has approved 10 training courses on green maritime fuels for Hong Kong in-

service maritime practitioners (such as seafarers) to take. To date, the relevant training institutions have issued a total of 39 certificates of competency and 36 endorsements following the completion of training courses. Furthermore, the Professional Training and Examination Refund Scheme under the Maritime and Aviation Training Fund (MATF) will launch a sub-scheme, the Train-the-Trainers Support Scheme, by the end of March. The scheme aims to subsidise maritime practitioners who already possess a certain level of maritime knowledge and qualifications to take instructor training courses on green maritime fuels with nominations by their companies. Upon completion of the courses, they will take on a training role in their companies and teach other staff members the necessary maritime knowledge and professional skills related to green maritime fuels. The eligible persons will be refunded 80% of the course fees after completion of the pre-approved courses or passing the examinations, subject to a cap of $30,000 per applicant. The local industry can make use of the talent lists under the General Employment Policy, the Admission Scheme for Mainland Talents and Professionals and the Quality Migrant Admission Scheme to recruit green maritime talents to meet its short-term development needs.

2. Maritime decarbonisation has been a global trend. In 2023, the International Maritime Organization set the goal of achieving net-zero carbon emissions from international shipping by or around 2050. To progressively achieve these decarbonisation goals, the international maritime industry needs to build new vessels powered by green maritime fuels or retrofit the existing ones and therefore has substantial capital needs. The 2026-27 Budget proposes to promote the co-development of financial and maritime centres to address the substantial capital needs of shipowners in green maritime transformation. Leveraging Hong Kong's strengths of having a premier business environment and a thriving high value-added maritime services industry, coupled with the combined advantages of the 2 centres, we will better facilitate international shipping enterprises' access to Hong Kong's capital market, assist the shipping industry in exploring more diverse funding channels, encourage the financial sector to develop a more diversified range of maritime financial products, and attract and retain international shipping commercial principals (particularly foreign-owned shipowners) to operate in Hong Kong, thereby achieving the goal of developing Hong Kong into the "Global Maritime Capital".

3. As regards green maritime fuel trading, the Chinese Mainland will become the world's largest production base for green maritime fuels. With strong support of the Motherland and leveraging its status as an as an international financial centre, Hong Kong enjoys the advantages of free capital flow and real-time transaction settlement. Coupled with the Government's plan to provide a half-rate tax concession to traders of commodities, including green maritime fuels, Hong Kong can facilitate the global export of green maritime fuels produced on the Chinese Mainland via our trading platform. In terms of talent and compliance capabilities, we will continue to enhance the relevant training schemes under the MATF and further enhance the efficiency, flexibility and precision of talent development, so as to strengthen the local maritime talent and compliance capabilities. We will continue to enhance our collaboration with the Chinese Mainland and international training institutions and introduce new courses to meet and support the development needs of the entire maritime industry from seafaring to the high value-added maritime sectors.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1788)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

In the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27, the Government states that it will continue to oversee the implementation and operation of HKeToll at the government tolled tunnels and Tsing Sha Control Area, as well as monitor the traffic conditions pursuant to the time-varying tolls at the 3 road harbour crossings. Since 2018, the Government has exempted the tunnel tolls for franchised buses and funds have been set up to offset future fare increase. However, there is no similar support at all for other commercial vehicles, and they have to solely bear the operational pressure arising from the toll increase. The existing tunnel tolls are unable to reflect the costs of road use and effectively relieve traffic congestion. This is unfair to the trade. Given the limited road resources in Hong Kong, the Government should no longer increase the burden of the trade by implementing the imbalanced charging system. Also, it should not allow the congestion problem at tunnels to become a long-standing and structural issue. In this connection, please inform this Committee of the following:

1. Will the Government alleviate congestion at tunnels through toll adjustment and traffic management, and announce the specific targets in respect of diverting traffic and alleviating congestion? and

2. Does the Government understand the cost implication of toll fees on the logistics, transport and tourism sectors? If tunnel tolls impose a heavy burden on the operations of relevant sectors, will the Government introduce any support measures to assist them? If so, what are the details?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Chung-yee, Alan (LegCo internal reference no.: 17)

Reply:

When determining the toll levels for government tunnels, the Government will give holistic consideration to 4 key principles, namely traffic management needs, "user-pays", public transport first and efficiency first, as well as other factors including public affordability and the prevailing social circumstances. As the specific circumstances of each government

tunnel are different, such as the geographical location, target users and traffic management needs, the Government needs to weigh various principles and adapts its approach to the prevailing circumstances and local conditions.

As mentioned above, when determining the toll levels for government tunnels, one of the main considerations of the Government is efficiency first. For example, when setting the new tolls for the 3 road harbour crossings (RHCs), the Government simplified the toll structure for commercial vehicles and no longer charge different classes of commercial vehicles for tolls based on their size and weight. Instead, based on the principle of "efficiency first" and taking into account the passenger-carrying efficiency of commercial vehicles in general as well as their economic benefits brought to the community, the Government reduced the tolls for commercial vehicles such as goods vehicles to a level broadly in line with those for private cars, so as to facilitate the operation of the trade. When taking over the Tai Lam Tunnel in 2025, by the same principles, the Government substantially reduced the tolls for commercial vehicles to a level broadly in line with those for private cars, for example, reductions in the tolls for light, medium and heavy goods vehicles range from 33% to 46%, while those for light buses are as high as 66%.

As stated before, when determining the tunnel tolls, another main consideration is traffic management. For example, the primary objective of implementing time-varying tolls is to provide financial incentives by applying different toll rates during peak and non-peak hours, so as to encourage drivers to travel during non-peak periods and in turn ease traffic flow during peak periods. In fact, after the implementation of time-varying tolls the overall congestion at the RHCs has eased. The traffic queues at the Cross-Harbour Tunnel (CHT) and the Eastern Harbour Crossing during peak time slots were generally reduced. Traffic conditions at all 3 RHCs during normal and off-peak hours—which make up nearly 80% of the day—also improved significantly, including at the CHT, which had previously experienced frequent congestion. In addition, non-cross-harbour traffic near the portals of the RHCs was noticeably smoother. Drivers may choose which RHC to use based on their destinations and reduce detours. This helps significantly shorten the journey time for commercial vehicles to cross the harbour, reduce fuel costs and improve operational efficiency. Such traffic diversions have a positive impact on public travelling, transport and logistics, as well as public transport operations.

The Transport Department will continuously monitor the traffic conditions of the tunnels, review the arrangements and levels of tunnel tolls in a timely manner, maintain close communication with the commercial vehicle sector, so as to launch and enhance various measures to support the development of the logistics industry.

As for the Government's measure of exempting franchised bus operators from paying tolls when using government tunnels and control areas since February 2019, it aims to enable the operators to keep the tolls saved in the Toll Exemption Funds (TEF). When an operator applies for a fare increase and the Chief Executive in Council considers that there is a justifiable need to increase the fare, the operator is required to offset the increase by first using the balance in TEF. As such, the TEF is used to lower the magnitude of the fare increase shouldered by passengers and benefit the passengers directly.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1790)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned under the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 that the Bureau will introduce subsidiary legislation in relation to the regulation of ride-hailing services and oversee the implementation of the relevant regulatory regime. In this connection, please inform this Committee of the following:

1. As the Government is currently introducing subsidiary legislation to regulate ride-hailing services, how will it ensure that the platforms' commission systems are fair and transparent? Will the Government require platforms to disclose their commission calculation methods and guarantee a minimum income for drivers?

2. When formulating the regulatory regime for ride-hailing services, will the Government refer to the practices in Chinese Mainland by requiring platforms to store the personal data of Hong Kong users and drivers on servers located locally or under the jurisdiction of Hong Kong law, so as to safeguard national security, protect geographic information and citizens' privacy? It is because international cases have shown that even if data is stored in a third country, foreign governments can still compel access to it on grounds of national security or law enforcement (e.g. the Royal Canadian Mounted Police case). and

3. When formulating the regulatory regime, will the Government require platforms to establish taxable entities in Hong Kong to ensure they pay taxes fairly? Furthermore, will a "fair competition benchmark" be set in areas such as insurance, compliance costs, and pricing models to prevent platforms from using asymmetric cost structures to squeeze the licensed taxi industry? For example, could there be a maximum fare increase of 10% during peak hours and a minimum fare reduction of 10% during off-peak hours? Will taxis and ride-hailing services be allowed to adjust fares within this 10% range to achieve fair competition in pricing power?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Chung-yee, Alan (LegCo internal reference no.: 20)

Reply:

The Road Traffic (Amendment) (Ride-hailing Service) Bill 2025 (the Bill) was passed by the Legislative Council in October 2025. It establishes the legal framework and key principles for regulating ride-hailing services, which include requiring platforms, vehicles, and drivers providing ride-hailing services to obtain appropriate licences/permits and to comply with the relevant licence/permit conditions. Ride-hailing vehicles and taxis have their own strengths and market positioning, and are subject to appropriate regulation based on the nature and mode of their services, providing passengers with diversified travel options.

To ensure that holders of ride-hailing service licences (licensed platforms) have sufficient operational capacity to provide quality ride-hailing services, applicants must be companies registered in Hong Kong and meet certain entry thresholds (such as the applicant's experience in operating a ride-hailing platform, financial capacity, intended investments in Hong Kong for operating a platform, as well as qualifications of the company's directors). In terms of operation, licensed platforms must maintain proper and efficient ride-hailing services, and conduct due diligence to ensure that the vehicles and drivers on their platforms hold valid permits. With regard to fares, licensed platforms may set their own fares in accordance with market conditions, but they are required to inform passengers of the fare arrangement before the start of a journey. The Government has the power to regulate fare arrangements when necessary (for example, in the event of vicious competition in the market). There is no cap on the number of ride-hailing service licences. Platforms may, in accordance with their own operational strategies and business considerations, make different dispatch and commission arrangements to attract drivers to work with them and provide services. Besides, the participation of different platforms and healthy competition help foster competitive pricing and services in the market, providing passengers and tourists with quality and diversified point-to-point transport services, while offering drivers job opportunities with reasonable pay.

In addition, regarding the keeping of data, the Bill also stipulates that licensed platforms must keep and provide the Transport Department (TD) with proper records of operational data. It also empowers the Commissioner for Transport to impose licence conditions on a range of matters (including the collection, transmission, storage and provision of data relating to the passenger transport services provided through the platform, etc.) to ensure data safety and enable the TD to monitor the platforms' services effectively. Furthermore, licensed platforms must also comply with other local legislation, including legal requirements related to taxation and privacy protection.

The Government is now actively advancing the next stage of work and continues to communicate with various stakeholders, with a view to finalising the technical details for regulating ride-hailing services, including the operation modes of platforms, vehicles and drivers (such as the specific data that platforms must keep and the retention period), hardware facilities, etc. The Government will incorporate these technical details into the subsidiary legislation or licence/permit conditions as appropriate.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1796)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in paragraph 72 of the Budget Speech that trial projects, such as unmanned aircraft system traffic management system and passenger-carrying flying aircraft, will be rolled out in phases from the first half of this year by the Government. This lays an important foundation for my earlier proposals to use unmanned aircraft to transport tourists in Hong Kong and collaborate with the tourism industry to develop low-altitude sightseeing. Low-altitude economy (LAE) is an important engine for China's economic growth and, more importantly, a new track for accelerating the empowerment of new quality productive forces. Please inform this Committee of the following:

1. Will the Government consider allocating funds under the $10 billion Innovation and Technology Industry-Oriented Fund (ITIF) to set up a dedicated fund for LAE to support the research and development, trials as well as demonstration and application of LAE projects?

2. In the absence of an LAE dedicated fund to support development, which key parts of the LAE industry chain will the ITIF cover specifically? How will it encourage and assist enterprises in forming a sustainable LAE industry chain, including focused efforts to encourage the application of unmanned aircraft and to provide comprehensive ancillary facilities primarily for the electric vertical take-off and landing (eVTOL) passenger-carrying services and, secondarily, for research and development as well as manufacturing? and

3. How specifically will the ITIF incentivise and encourage the tourism industry to make early investments in and preparations for providing experiential services such as passenger transport services, particularly the establishment of eVTOL sites and facilities? For instance, will subsidies be provided based on the number of take-offs and landings by enterprises so as to alleviate the financial burden of advance infrastructure works on them? What is the target ratio of government financial support to investments by the commercial sector?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Chung-yee, Alan (LegCo internal reference no.: 26)

Reply:

The Innovation and Technology Industry-Oriented Fund (ITIF) aims to give play to the guiding and leveraging roles of government funding, encourage the market to invest in projects in designated innovation and technology industries, and support the development of emerging and future industries of strategic importance.

Any projects (including those related to low-altitude economy (LAE)) that fall within the scope of the target industries of the ITIF and meet the relevant investment criteria may also be considered for investment by the sub-funds under the ITIF. Fund managers will choose suitable projects for investment based on the relevant investment criteria and their professional judgement.

As regards the promotion of trial application of passenger-carrying aircraft, the Government rolled out the advanced LAE "Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$" pilot projects in November 2025 to cover application scenarios that are technically more complex such as unconventional aircraft (including passenger-carrying aircraft and electric vertical take-off and landing aircraft). Application was closed on 28 February 2026. The response from the industry was enthusiastic, with numerous applications received for various application scenarios. The Working Group on Developing Low-altitude Economy is carefully examining the applications, with the aim of progressively rolling out the pilot projects in the first half of this year.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1803)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 that the Administration will work with the Mainland authorities to develop a sustainable aviation fuel (SAF) value chain in the Greater Bay Area. In this connection, please inform this Committee of the following:

1. The Government has earlier announced a target to achieve an SAF consumption ratio of 1% to 2% for flights departing from Hong Kong by 2030. It is known that some airlines have already initiated plans to use SAF. Has the Administration compiled statistics on the latest situation of SAF usage in Hong Kong?

2. It is known that currently SAF is still 3 to 5 times more expensive than conventional fuel. What specific measures does the Administration take to encourage airlines to use SAF so as to achieve the development target above by 2030? and

3. Regarding the development of an SAF value chain, how will the Administration leverage Hong Kong's economies of scale advantages (e.g. procurement quantity, professional services such as financing and insurance, airline usage, etc.) so as to expedite the development of the value chain while bringing benefits to the entire aviation industry in Hong Kong, including reducing usage costs?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Chung-yee, Alan (LegCo internal reference no.: 35)

Reply:

1. The existing aviation fuel infrastructure at the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA) is already capable of receiving, storing and adopting pre-blended sustainable aviation fuel (SAF) by airlines. Between 2022 and 2025, airlines adopted 4 batches of SAF at the HKIA.

2. To support the development of the SAF industry chain and enhance the competitiveness of the HKIA, we have established a target SAF consumption ratio for flights departing from the HKIA. Depending on the progress of developing the relevant industry and supply chain in

the region, as well as the implementation of supporting measures, our target is to achieve an SAF consumption ratio of 1% to 2% by 2030. We and the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) will continue to maintain close communication with the industry and provide necessary support to help achieve the relevant usage target. Specifically, the Transport and Logistics Bureau will collaborate with the Environment and Ecology Bureau (EEB) to study the construction of an SAF blending facility for providing more economical SAF-blended jet fuel in Hong Kong in the long term, thereby boosting the competitiveness of Hong Kong's SAF industry and bolstering the bargaining power of airlines. In addition, the AAHK will launch publicity and promotional campaigns to increase public and corporate awareness and support for SAF.

3. To expedite the application of green technologies and build an influential value chain of new quality productive force, the EEB is liaising with the Guangdong Provincial Government to enable a local enterprise, one of the world's major SAF suppliers, to develop its business in the Greater Bay Area (GBA). The scope of business includes upstream collection of raw materials and setting up of production plants for large-scale production, with a view to promoting development of new energy in the aviation sector.

The EEB will continue to explore and take forward various SAF supply proposals, develop a regional SAF supply chain in the GBA, and capitalise on the Guangdong Province's advantages in terms of used cooking oil resources, production costs, etc., to enhance the overall competitiveness of the SAF industry.

- End -

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CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1804)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat: Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 that the Bureau will continue to take forward the planning and implementation of transport infrastructure projects promulgated under the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint, including railway and road projects. Regarding the system of development rights for properties above railway stations and the protection of public interest:

Since the Government has over the years promoted railway construction through a "Rail plus Property" model, and granted the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) priority development rights for properties above railway stations, society has consistently been concerned about whether this system can ensure the most effective use of public resources and prevent such issues as market monopoly arising from the system's design, and the failure to fully realise land value. Currently, when the Government grants development rights for properties above stations, multiple aspects, including land valuation, project scale, revenue distribution and regulatory arrangements, are all closely related to public interest. In this connection, please inform this Committee of the following:

1. What is the prevailing basis for the Government's system of granting development rights for properties above railway stations? Please provide details of the approval criteria, valuation methods, risk-sharing arrangements, regulatory mechanisms, etc.

2. How does the Government ensure that the MTRCL will not create a market monopoly or weaken competition while enjoying priority development rights? Is there a mechanism for regularly reviewing this system? and

3. Will the Government examine whether the current system still aligns with the principle of maximising public interest, and consider introducing greater transparency and more competitive elements?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Chung-yee, Alan (LegCo internal reference no.: 36)

Reply:

1. Given the huge investment in a railway project, the income generated from transport operations and station commercial business often fails to break even. As such, the Government provides funding support to bridge the funding gap for "financially infeasible" projects (i.e. the present value of all its revenues net of expenditures falls short of the expected return on capital). The "Rail-plus-Property (R+P)" model is one of the effective models for delivering new railway projects. In addition to using the value of property development sites to provide funding support to railway development, this model allows the implementation entity of the railway project to co-ordinate the enabling works of property development and the railway works in order to facilitate project delivery by smoothening the interfaces among the station, depot and property development project. It also makes it more convenient for residents to use the railway and related facilities in future. Besides, the implementation entity will also have the incentive to strive to complete the railway project on schedule and thus enhance the value of the property development as early as possible. Under the R+P model, the Government does not need to use public funds to deliver new railway projects.

According to the R+P model, the Government provides funding support by granting property development rights based on the funding gap of the railway project, while the railway operator will bear the commercial risks associated with the design, construction, operation and maintenance of the new railway. The Government has no obligation to provide any further funding support to the railway operator even if the future revenue of the new railway project is lower than expected.

Currently, for railway projects such as the Tung Chung Line Extension project, the Tuen Mun South Extension project, the Kwu Tung Station project, the Hung Shui Kiu Station project and Part 1 of the Northern Link project, funding support to bridge the funding gap will take the form of an agreed fixed lump sum amount to be deducted from the full market value land premium of the property development sites. The full market value land premium (from which the fixed lump sum amount agreed by both sides will be deducted) will be assessed on a "with-railway" basis nearer the time of disposal of the property development sites. The MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) will bear all the commercial risks arising from market fluctuations and rail operations. In taking forward new railway projects, both the Government and the MTRCL will conduct assessments to determine the financial feasibility of the projects. Before the Government signs the project agreement with the MTRCL, the relevant financial arrangements for the project (including the granting of the property development sites for funding support) have to be subject to stringent scrutiny and are thoroughly considered to be justified in the public interest, and be approved by the Executive Council. The MTRCL is also required to comply with and act in accordance with the land lease terms and relevant statutory provisions when developing properties.

2. & 3. The MTRCL has all long provided Hong Kong with a highly reliable railway service, earning widespread international acclaim. However, when developing new independent railway lines, the Government will, where appropriate, consider introducing operators other than the MTRCL to encourage competition and innovation. In this regard, we plan to take forward the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu – Qianhai) project, as well as the Smart and Green Mass Transit System projects in East Kowloon, Kai Tak and the Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen New Development Area through open tender, so as to encourage local, Chinese Mainland and foreign investors to participate in the delivery of these projects.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1805)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 that the Government will continue to take forward the planning and implementation of transport infrastructure projects promulgated under the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint including railway and road projects. As far as the property development rights of future railway projects and policy review direction are concerned, given the Government's efforts to take forward the Northern Metropolis, Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands and planning for new railway projects, there will be a large number of property development projects over future stations, representing an enormous potential supply of land and housing. Is the existing "Rail-plus-Property development" model still applicable in the future? Should the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) continue to enjoy the priority right to property development? How will the Government strike a balance among key policy issues such as railway construction, housing supply and fiscal sustainability? In this connection, please advise this Committee of:

1. whether the Government will holistically review the existing "Rail-plus-Property development" model when planning for new railway projects, including examining whether the priority right to property development enjoyed by the MTRCL should be redefined;

2. whether the Government will consider introducing other models such as open tender, profit sharing and Government-led development for improved competition and increased income for the Government to ensure that the land value can be best realised for benefits of the public; and

3. whether the Government will consider transferring 50% of its interests in MTRCL's property development projects to a "Land and Housing Development Fund" with a view to supporting the long-term land and housing development, thereby reducing living costs for the public, increasing the living area per capita, as well as bridging the gap between rich and poor through expediting the public housing construction and turnover.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Chung-yee, Alan (LegCo internal reference no.: 37)

Reply:

1. & 2. The Government has all along been examining the implementation and financial arrangements of each railway project taking into account the construction and operation details as well as the distinctive characteristics and specific circumstances of each railway project, and will consider leveraging market forces to take forward a project. The "Rail-plus-Property (R+P)" model is one of the effective models for delivering new railway projects. In addition to using the value of property development sites to provide funding support to railway development that the society needs, this model allows the implementation entity of the railway project to co-ordinate the enabling works of property development and the railway works in order to facilitate project delivery by smoothening the interfaces among the station, depot and property development project. It also makes it more convenient for residents to use the railway and related facilities in future. Besides, the implementation entity will also have the incentive to strive to complete the railway project on schedule and thus enhance the value of the property development as early as possible. Under the R+P model, the Government does not need to use public funds to deliver new railway projects.

Since 2023, a revised R+P model has been adopted in new railway projects. Funding support to bridge the funding gap will take the form of an agreed fixed lump sum amount to be deducted from the full market value land premium of the property development sites. The land premium (from which the fixed lump sum amount will be deducted) will be assessed on a "with-railway" basis nearer the time of execution of land grant initiated by the railway operator. Compared with the previous arrangements under which the railway operator had to pay full market premium (on a green field basis) to the Government and bridge the funding gap through funding support from the property development project, the revised model provides sufficient funding support and certainty while requiring fewer property development sites for providing funding support.

Apart from the R+P model, the Government does not rule out the adoption of other suitable implementation models, for example, when an individual project may not have the conditions for adopting the R+P model. In fact, there were railway projects taken forward using other approaches previously.

When developing new independent railway lines, the Government will, where appropriate, consider using the open tender process to encourage competition and innovation. We plan to take forward the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu – Qianhai) project, as well as the Smart and Green Mass Transit System (SGMTS) projects in East Kowloon, Kai Tak and the Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen New Development Area through open tender, so as to encourage local, Chinese Mainland and foreign investors to participate in the tender process.

3. Pursuant to section 3 of the Public Finance Ordinance (Cap. 2), the cash dividends received by the Government from the MTR Corporation Limited shall form part of the general revenue. Such revenue will be used in various policy areas on the general public. The Government will consider resource utilisation as a whole for appropriate allocation. In fact, the Government and the Hong Kong Housing Authority have also provided substantial resources to support large-scale land development and public housing construction in recent years.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB067**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3194)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat: Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 that the Transport Department will continue to support the implementation of the "Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles" (Southbound Travel Scheme). There is a growing trend of Hong Kong residents "travelling north" to spend their weekends in Mainland cities, with the average daily vehicular flow of the "Northbound Travel for Hong Kong Vehicles" (Northbound Travel Scheme), which targets the middle-class and high-spending groups, reaching 8 600 in 2025. This has dealt a severe blow to the local food and beverage (F&B) and retail sectors, leading to widespread closure of restaurants and shops. Among them, many long-established businesses are struggling to survive. Shopping areas near the border are deserted like a ghost town, with businesses operating at a loss all year round. In contrast, the average daily vehicular flow of the Southbound Travel Scheme is only 100. This violates the globally-accepted "principle of reciprocity" for cross-boundary quotas and fails to assist the relevant industries. Please inform this Committee of the following:

1. Regarding this severely unequal quota arrangement, the Guangdong Provincial Government primarily takes economic factors into consideration. Conversely, will the Government, while taking road safety into account for quota allocation, also prioritise measures to support the local economy as the most critical consideration with a view to resurrecting the ailing F&B and retail sectors? If not, what are the reasons?

2. Given that the F&B and retail sectors are hanging by a thread, has the Government considered relaxing the current daily quota for the Southbound Travel Scheme from 100 to 8 600 vehicles? What is the timetable for the review?

3. Vehicle owners intending to visit Hong Kong via the Southbound Travel Scheme face restrictions on quotas, dates, time slots, etc., and are confined to travel via the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (HZMB) Control Point. This will create a vicious cycle – vehicle owners have difficulties in selecting suitable dates and time slots to drive to Hong Kong, and hence their willingness to visit the city is further dampened. Will the Government consider

extending the relevant arrangements (such as dates, time slots and quotas) to other land boundary control points? If not, what are the reasons?

4. Currently, vehicle owners travelling to the Mainland via the HZMB on weekdays (Tuesdays and Wednesdays) under the Northbound Travel Scheme are exempt from making bookings via the relevant website before departure. When will such arrangement be extended to vehicle owners travelling under the Southbound Travel Scheme according to the "principle of reciprocity"? If there is no such arrangement, what are the reasons? and

5. According to the official data last year, the population of Shenzhen is about 7 times that of Zhuhai, and its GDP is about 8.5 times that of Zhuhai. This shows that Shenzhen's potential to generate higher economic value far exceeds that of Zhuhai. Yet, why is the Southbound Travel Scheme only open to Guangdong vehicle owners entering Hong Kong via the HZMB Control Point, without considering that fact that Shenzhen vehicle owners can generate significantly higher economic value compared with their Zhuhai counterparts? Please inform this Committee whether more Shenzhen control points will be opened under the Southbound Travel Scheme to facilitate Shenzhen vehicle owners driving to Hong Kong? If there is no such plan, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Chung-yee, Alan (LegCo internal reference no.: 38)

Reply:

The Hong Kong Special Administrative Region Government has been committed to working with the Guangdong authorities on taking forward various cross-boundary transport measures to facilitate the connection among cities in the Guangdong-Hong Kong-Macao Greater Bay Area (GBA). The "Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles" (Southbound Travel Scheme) is a mutual arrangement with the "Northbound Travel for Hong Kong Vehicles" (Northbound Travel Scheme), both of which can add extra impetus to the integration and development of the GBA and promote the mutual engagement of residents in Guangdong and Hong Kong. In addition, visitors with higher spending power from the Southbound Travel Scheme can also create opportunities for various sectors in Hong Kong, including the tourism, retail, and food and beverage sectors, thereby driving Hong Kong's economic growth.

Following the successful implementation of the Northbound Travel Scheme in July 2023, traffic on the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (HZMB) has been increasing continuously. Building on this foundation, both Guangdong and Hong Kong actively took forward and officially launched the Southbound Travel Scheme at the end of 2025, opening up a new way for Mainland residents to travel to Hong Kong. Under the arrangements of the Southbound Travel Scheme, eligible private vehicles from Guangdong can apply to travel to Hong Kong via the HZMB through innovative and simple procedures. After parking their vehicles at the automated car parks on the Hong Kong Port Island of the HZMB (port car parks), the drivers and passengers can transfer to a flight via the Hong Kong International Airport using the "Park & Fly" service, or enter and visit Hong Kong by local transport using the "Park & Visit" service to be launched later, which all help enhance Hong Kong's status as an international aviation hub. Alternatively, they may self-drive and enter the urban area via the HZMB without the need to obtain regular quotas (entry into the urban area).

Currently, the port car parks provide 1 800 parking spaces, and a maximum of about 2 800 parking spaces will be provided with the full operation of the 2 port car parks, coupled with the 100 daily booking quotas for entry into the urban area.

The Southbound Travel Scheme has been taken forward in an orderly manner through the strategies of ensuring safety, effective diversion, well-equipped supporting facilities and streamlined application, and the overall operation is smooth. We are accumulating implementation experience and closely monitoring the progress, including the operation of the control points, the traffic of nearby roads, the adaptability of users and the public, the enhancement of supporting facilities, etc., and will continue to review and discuss with the Guangdong authorities to increase the quota in an orderly manner. Furthermore, we plan to progressively expand the scope of the scheme from the current 4 cities in the Guangdong Province (namely Guangzhou, Zhuhai, Zhongshan and Jiangmen) to other Guangdong cities after 6 months of implementation, with a view to taking forward the Southbound Travel Scheme in a prudent and manageable manner. We will announce the relevant arrangements in due course.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2179)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the transport infrastructure development in Pak Shek Kok and its surrounding areas, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. Please provide data on the growth in the actual working population and resident population in the area in the past 3 years.

2. What mechanism has the Administration put in place to regularly review and adjust the service frequencies, operating hours and routes of the bus and minibus services in the light of the population growth in Pak Shek Kok and the expansion progress of the Science Park?

3. What specific improvement plans are formulated to address the issue of infrequent transport services in the area during non-peak hours and weekends? and

4. What is the current works progress of the Pak Shek Kok Station of the East Rail line, which is expected to be completed by 2033? Is there any room for expediting the progress? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Hak-kan (LegCo internal reference no.: 27)

Reply:

Our reply in consultation with the Innovation, Technology and Industry Bureau, the Development Bureau, the Census and Statistics Department (C&SD) and the relevant departments is as follows:

1. According to the information provided by the C&SD, the findings of the 2021 Population Census show that the population of the Pak Shek Kok area at the time was 15 705. The Pak Shek Kok area comprises the Hong Kong Science Park (Science Park) to the north east of Tolo Highway and the adjacent Pak Shek Kok residential clusters. The C&SD is currently conducting the 2026 Population Census to collect the latest data on population distribution. In addition, according to the information provided by the Hong Kong Science and Technology

Parks Corporation, the working population of the Science Park in January 2026 was about 20 000 people.

2. & 3. There are currently 27 franchised bus routes and 10 green minibus routes providing services in the area around Pak Shek Kok and the Science Park for travelling to and from other locations in the Tai Po area, as well as other areas across the territory, including Sha Tin, North District, Tseung Kwan O, Tsuen Wan, Tuen Mun, Yuen Long, Yau Tsim Mong, Kwun Tong, Wan Chai, the airport, etc.

The Transport Department (TD) has maintained communication with the relevant departments regarding the progress of development and infrastructure provision as well as the latest planning for Pak Shek Kok and the Science Park, and closely monitors the public transport demand in these areas. The TD will work with public transport operators to adjust or enhance the public transport services in the Pak Shek Kok area as appropriate, including adjusting the frequencies, operating hours and routes of the existing services or introducing new services as needed. Taking into account the views of the Tai Po District Council, the TD has enhanced the public transport services in the area around Pak Shek Kok and the Science Park on numerous occasions over the past 2 years.

4. The Government announced in the 2021 Policy Address that studies would be carried out on the construction of the Pak Shek Kok Station on the East Rail Line and a comprehensive development in nearby areas. The Government also invited the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) to carry out the studies. Subsequently, the Government further announced in the 2022 Policy Address that it would examine the target of commissioning the Pak Shek Kok Station by 2033 or earlier. The Pak Shek Kok comprehensive development project includes not only the addition of 1 railway station to the East Rail Line, but also the relocation of the university sports facilities, so as to unleash adjoining land for residential development and provide financing for the whole project. Since the announcement of the above development, stakeholders including local residents, the Science Park and its innovation and technology personnel, etc. generally hope for early construction and commissioning of the new railway station. The preparatory work for the Pak Shek Kok comprehensive development project is now in the final stages. The Government will continue to maintain close liaison with the MTRCL and announce the overall proposals for the development project as early as possible upon completion of the internal procedures.

The construction works of the proposed new railway station have to be carried out on the existing East Rail Line, which poses certain challenges. According to the preliminary assessment by the MTRCL, works for the new railway station will include the construction of station platforms, adjustment of existing overhead line and power supply equipment, trackworks and crossover tracks, electrical and mechanical systems, installation of platform screen doors, as well as trackside testing and commissioning. A substantial portion of the works can only be carried out during non-traffic hours at night after the end of the existing railway service, and it is necessary to ensure resumption of normal operation of the East Rail Line on time. In parallel, the MTRCL also needs to take into account the regular railway maintenance and other concurrent projects along the East Rail Line, and co-ordinate the train dispatching work. Consequently, the time available for construction is very limited, only about 2 hours during the non-traffic hours every night. In addition, since there are many residential buildings in the Pak Shek Kok area, works carried out at night must comply with

relevant statutory environmental protection requirements and adopt appropriate construction methods to reduce the nuisance to residents.

Taking into account the relevant technical constraints and the experiences from other projects of constructing new railway stations on operating railway lines, our current target is to commission the new railway station by 2033 or earlier. During the detailed design as well as the construction stages, we will request the MTRCL to actively explore and consider adoption of new construction technologies, such as Modular Integrated Construction (MiC) and Design for Manufacture and Assembly (DfMA), to expedite the progress of works as much as practicable.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2180)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the construction of the Kwong Fuk Bridge in Tai Po, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

The idea of constructing the proposed Kwong Fuk Vehicular Bridge was put forward over 20 years ago, why has it not yet entered the committee stage of the Finance Committee of the Legislative Council? What are the major technical or planning challenges that hinder the implementation of the project?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Hak-kan (LegCo internal reference no.: 28)

Reply:

The Highways Department is conducting studies and assessments on the technical aspects of the Tai Po Kwong Fuk Vehicular Bridge project, including the connection of the vehicular bridge with existing road networks on both sides of the river, and the impact of the vehicular bridge on the drainage capacity of Lam Tsuen River. The Government will continuously review the cost-effectiveness of works projects and take into account the urgency and priority of the relevant projects so as to take them forward in a timely and orderly manner.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1569)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The "Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles" Scheme (Southbound Travel Scheme) officially launched on 23 December 2025, with 100 daily quotas in the initial stage, allowing eligible private vehicles from Guangdong to enter the urban area in Hong Kong directly via the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge and stay in Hong Kong for up to 3 days. Please advise on the following regarding the Southbound Travel Scheme since its launch:

1. What are the respective numbers of applications and approved cases?

2. Does the Administration keep statistics on the effectiveness of the Southbound Travel Scheme to boost Hong Kong's economy? Please illustrate with specific figures.

3. What is the situation regarding vehicles under the Southbound Travel Scheme violating the traffic laws in Hong Kong? How many of these cases result in warning, formal conviction or other actions respectively? Please tabulate the information broken down by type of offence. and

4. How does the Administration follow up with the Mainland drivers who have violated the traffic laws in Hong Kong? Please provide specific details.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.: 28)

Reply:

1. The "Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles" Scheme (Southbound Travel Scheme) (entry into the urban area) accepts applications from eligible private vehicles from Guangdong from 9 December 2025 onwards. The Transport Department (TD) will vet the applications referred by the Mainland authorities and issue the electronic International Circulation Permit (the Permit) to successful applicants. Guangdong vehicles issued with the Permit may make bookings for entering Hong Kong via the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (HZMB) and stay for up to 3 days per visit.

As at the end of February 2026, the TD received a total of around 4 200 applications and issued over 3 500 Permits in total, with approximately 700 remaining cases still being processed.

2. The Southbound Travel Scheme and the "Northbound Travel for Hong Kong Vehicles" Scheme (Northbound Travel Scheme) complement each other and are important measures to promote the integration and development of the Guangdong-Hong Kong-Macao Greater Bay Area. Not only can both schemes deepen the mutual engagement of residents in Guangdong and Hong Kong, provide Mainland visitors with more convenient and flexible options to travel to Hong Kong, facilitate the flow of personnel and talent, and encourage new visitor groups, including individuals and families with higher spending power, to self-drive to Hong Kong for sightseeing, doing business, attending exhibitions or meetings, using professional services, and enjoying leisure and dining, thereby benefitting residents and numerous industries in Hong Kong, but also open up new collaboration opportunities for enterprises in Guangdong and Hong Kong. According to the information provided by the Customs and Excise Department, around 90% of the vehicles stayed in Hong Kong for 1 to 2 days in February 2026. Moreover, the "Park & Fly" service provided at the automated car park on the Hong Kong Port Island of the HZMB also helps enhance Hong Kong's position as an international aviation hub and provide Mainland visitors with more travel options. It is expected that the Southbound Travel Scheme will support the development of various industries in Hong Kong such as tourism and logistics, and enhance bilateral trading and investment between the 2 places.

3. & 4. The Government has been committed to combating traffic offences on the roads in Hong Kong to ensure road safety through publicity, education and law enforcement. If vehicles from Guangdong are found to have violated the traffic laws in Hong Kong, the Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF) will handle the cases in accordance with the laws and procedures in Hong Kong. These violations are isolated cases and they have already been handled or are being followed up.

Depending on the specific circumstances of each case, the governments of Guangdong and Hong Kong will also take measures as appropriate in accordance with the management measures for port car parks and entry into the urban area, which include considering suspending or revoking the eligibility of the relevant vehicles under the Southbound Travel Scheme.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3151)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

To further promote the connectivity of infrastructure within the Greater Bay Area, the Government is working with the Shenzhen authorities through the Task Force for Hong Kong-Shenzhen Co-operation on Cross-Boundary Railway Infrastructure to take forward 2 cross-boundary projects, namely the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu-Qianhai) and the Northern Link Spur Line.

What progress has been made on the 2 projects above by the 2 sides since the establishment of the Task Force and what are the latest developments? Apart from these projects, what new projects are planned for the future?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.: 41)

Reply:

In accordance with the vision of jointly developing the "Greater Bay Area on the Rail", the governments of Hong Kong and Shenzhen established the Task Force for Hong Kong-Shenzhen Co-operation on Cross-Boundary Railway Infrastructure (the Task Force) in 2021 to jointly take forward the 2 cross-boundary railway projects, namely the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu-Qianhai) (HSWRL) and the Northern Link (NOL) Spur Line projects. Since the establishment of the Task Force, the government of the 2 places have been working closely to actively plan and take forward the 2 cross-boundary railway projects mentioned above. There is no other project at the present stage.

The Task Force deliberated the findings of the first stage study of the HSWRL in 2022, and the findings of the second stage study of the HSWRL as well as the implementation arrangement of the NOL Spur Line in 2024. To strengthen the coordination between the 2 places, the 2 governments established the Office for Implementing Cross-Boundary Railway Projects and the Legal Group under the framework of the Task Force in end 2024 to take forward the investigation, planning and design of the cross-boundary railway projects, as well as to study and discuss the legal issues involved in the 2 projects.

For the HSWRL, the 2 governments agreed to take forward the project according to the "parallel construction, unified operation" approach, under which Hong Kong and Shenzhen will first simultaneously carry out the design and construction of the Hong Kong section and the Shenzhen section respectively, and subsequently engage a single operator for unified operation and procurement of railway systems for the entire line, so as to enhance the cost-effectiveness as well as operational efficiency and flexibility of the project. To enhance the convenience of border crossing and travel experience, and fully leverage the attractiveness and efficiency of the cross-boundary railway, Hong Kong and Shenzhen agreed to co-locate the immigration and customs facilities in Shenzhen, with no immigration and customs facilities in Hong Kong.

The Hong Kong Special Administrative Region (HKSAR) Government obtained approval from the Finance Committee of the Legislative Council in June last year for commencing the investigation and design for the Hong Kong section of the HSWRL, while the Shenzhen Municipal Government concurrently commenced the study of engineering feasibility for the Shenzhen section of the project. The HKSAR Government is now conducting the design and associated site investigation works, as well as the statutory procedures and financial assessments, etc. Earlier, invitations were also sent to relevant contractors and operators to submit expressions of interest for the Hong Kong section of the HSWRL project, which was met with good market response, receiving over 80 submissions. Our target is to have the Hong Kong section technically ready for tendering in 2027 so as to commence the detailed design and construction works promptly and strive for completion of construction works in 2034, which will be followed immediately by integrated testing and commissioning to realise the common goal of the governments of Hong Kong and Shenzhen to commission the HSWRL in 2035.

As for the NOL Spur Line, the government of the 2 places have agreed to engage the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) to undertake the operation, and the project will connect to the new Huanggang Port in future. The HKSAR Government executed the Part 1 Project Agreement with the MTRCL for the NOL Project last year, taking forward the NOL Spur Line in combination with the NOL Main Line as 1 project through a holistic planning and phased implementation strategy, which enabled more expeditious and efficient delivery of the whole project and substantially brought forward the timetable of the Spur Line to strive for simultaneous commissioning with the Main Line by 2034 or earlier, which was 2 years earlier than what was originally envisaged. The MTRCL prioritised the commencement of the more mature and imminent works of the NOL Project, and concurrently carried out the detailed planning and design as well as the statutory procedures for the NOL Spur Line, which include conducting environmental impact assessments and preparing for the gazettal procedures for the railway scheme. The government of the 2 places are continuing to liaise on the detailed arrangements of the design, construction, operation, etc. of the Shenzhen section of the NOL Spur Line.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3275)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Administration states that it will continue to improve the intermodal operations and to facilitate the flow of goods and logistics information in the Greater Bay Area. Please advise on the following:

1. What progress has been made last year in extending the arrangements under the Air Transhipment Cargo Exemption Scheme to other intermodal cargo-transhipment modes by the Administration? What benefits has this brought? and

2. Please provide details of the various types of intermodal operations in Hong Kong in the past 3 years and in the current year. Please also set out the economic benefits brought by each type of intermodal operations, including the number of passengers using sea-air intermodal transhipment, the traffic volume of land-air intermodal transhipment and the approximate time reduced.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.: 43)

Reply:

1. To enhance Hong Kong's competitiveness as an international aviation hub, an international maritime centre and an international logistics hub, the Chief Executive announced in the 2024 Policy Address that the Government will examine the extension of the arrangements under the Air Transhipment Cargo Exemption Scheme (the Scheme) to other intermodal cargo-transhipment modes. Following examination with other departments, the Transport and Logistics Bureau is exploring the possibility of extending the arrangements under the Scheme currently applicable to the air-air transhipment mode to other sea transhipment and sea-air transhipment modes. The Government aims to introduce a bill into the Legislative Council within this year to extend the relevant arrangements to other sea transhipment and sea-air transhipment modes. According to the estimation by the industry, the proposed new measures will bring an additional 500 000 containers to the Hong Kong Port each year.

2. The Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) is committed to developing intermodal transport networks so as to enhance the convenience for the transport of passengers and goods in the Guangdong-Hong Kong-Macao Greater Bay Area (GBA) to and from all parts of the world via Hong Kong. Regarding passenger services, the AAHK operates ferry services between 9 ports in the GBA and the SkyPier Terminal of the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA). According to the information provided by the AAHK, the numbers of passengers who have used the ferry services in the past 3 years are tabulated below:

Year	Number of passengers ('000)
2025	720
2024	680
2023	470

Note: The number of passengers in 2025 is provisional and the actual figure is yet to be verified by the airlines.

In addition, the AAHK started to provide transfer coach services between the SkyPier Terminal and the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (HZMB) Macao Port and Zhuhai Port in August and December 2023 respectively, and in parallel launched the "Fly-Via-Zhuhai-HK" direct passenger service in December 2023 to facilitate transit passengers from the Mainland and Macao to go to the HKIA via the HZMB for onward flights to overseas destinations, and vice versa. According to the information provided by the AAHK, the numbers of passengers who have used the transfer coach services services in the past 3 years are tabulated below:

Year	Number of passengers ('000)
2025	300
2024	240
2023	30

Note 1: The number of passengers in 2025 is provisional and the actual figure is yet to be verified by the airlines.
Note 2: The number of passengers in 2023 refers to the figure after the commencement of the relevant services, i.e. from August to December.

Furthermore, the AAHK also arranges coach or limousine services connecting the HKIA and the GBA cities (including city terminals). According to the information provided by the AAHK, the numbers of passengers travelling between the HKIA and the Mainland or Macao using the coach or limousine services by the AAHK's land-based cross-boundary operators in the past 3 years are tabulated below:

Year	Number of passengers ('000)
2025	870
2024	750
2023	510

Note: The number of passengers in 2025 is provisional and the actual figure is yet to be verified by the airlines.

In addition to the above direct transport services to and from the HKIA arranged by the AAHK, passengers travelling to and from the Mainland can also take other means of transport to enter and leave Hong Kong (such as the Express Rail Link (XRL), cross-boundary coaches,

etc.) and travel to other parts of the world via the HKIA. The AAHK is committed to providing facilitation to the relevant cross-boundary travellers through various measures, such as setting up city terminals in the GBA cities for travellers to check in in advance, providing luggage check-in service at the West Kowloon Station of the XRL, etc.

Meanwhile, the AAHK launched the "Park & Fly" service at the automated car parks on the Hong Kong Port Island in November 2025 for non-commercial private cars from Guangdong and Macao to come to Hong Kong via the HZMB for onward flights.

As for air cargo, the AAHK is working with Dongguan to press ahead with the innovative development of the sea-air intermodal cargo transhipment mode, so that Mainland export cargo can arrive at the HKIA seamlessly for direct transhipment to overseas destinations through Hong Kong's international aviation network, and the reverse process can also be applied to import cargo. The AAHK launched a pilot scheme of the sea-air intermodal cargo transhipment mode by utilising the temporary facilities in Dongguan and the HKIA at the end of 2021 and established the full set of export and import operation procedures in April and December 2023 respectively. As at February 2026, a total of 30 airlines and 143 freight forwarders participated in the pilot scheme. Since April 2023, over 60 000 tonnes of cargo, with a value of more than HK$60 billion, have been handled. This sea-air intermodal cargo transhipment model will benefit from the transhipment cargo exemption mentioned in Part 1 above.

To further develop sea-air intermodal cargo transhipment, the AAHK is completing the permanent facilities of Phase 1 the HKIA Dongguan Logistics Park in stages, with the target of commissioning the logistics park in the first half of 2027, gradually bringing its cargo handling capacity to 1 million tonnes per annum. It is expected that, upon the full commissioning of the logistics park, the operating cost of cargo transport can be reduced by about half and cargo handling time can be saved by about one-third.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3276)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Administration states that it will actively develop the modern logistics industry, with cold-chain logistics being a part of the high value-added logistics industry. Please advise on the following:

1. How has the Administration supported the industry in advancing the application of technology in cold-chain logistics in recent years? What are the specific details? How do the relevant measures bring economic benefits to Hong Kong? and

2. How has the cold-chain logistics industry been further advanced over the past year and what are the plans for the future?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.: 44)

Reply:

The Government promulgated the Action Plan on Modern Logistics Development in 2023, in which a number of strategies and action measures have been proposed to develop Hong Kong into a sustainable international smart logistics hub focusing on high-value goods and the e-commerce market. In particular, Hong Kong has all along been enjoying an edge in handling high-value goods, including cold-chain cargoes, as evidenced by the large quantity of Chilean cherries supplied to Southern China through the Kwai Tsing Container Terminals via the "Chilean Cherry Express" annually. Leveraging our strengths in this area and focusing on developing high-value goods transhipment, such as cold-chain cargoes, is precisely one of the new growth areas of the logistics industry in Hong Kong.

In this connection, the Government has been committed to supporting the industry in acquiring advanced technology and professional certifications in handling fresh and temperature-controlled cargoes. On the one hand, the logistics industry can obtain matching funds from the Government through the Pilot Subsidy Scheme for Third-party Logistics Service Providers (the Pilot Scheme) to acquire technology applications related to cold-chain logistics. For instance, a logistics enterprise has acquired mobile refrigerated containers

equipped with wireless charging functions and associated Internet of Things (IoT) management system for real-time monitoring of the temperatures of cold-chain cargoes and the operation status of such equipment, with centralised management through a data platform to enhance its capability and operational efficiency in handling cold chain cargoes, by utilising funding from the Pilot Scheme. On the other hand, the Government also provides funding through the Professional Training on Smart and Green Logistics Scheme to encourage practitioners in the logistics industry to receive training related to modern and smart logistics, including cold-chain logistics, so as to further support the industry to advance the application of smart logistics technologies, including those related to cold-chain logistics. The existing courses cover elements such as knowledge, key technologies and practical operations related to cold-chain logistics.

Moreover, the Government also actively enhances cargo clearance efficiency and officially launched the "Air-Land Fresh Lane" in September 2025. Through innovative customs clearance modes and the application of technology, transhipment of fresh products (including fruits, as well as chilled and live seafood) via the Hong Kong International Airport and the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge with full-chain real-time monitoring can now be achieved, thereby substantially streamlining the clearance procedures for cargo transhipment via Hong Kong and further promoting the development of cold-chain logistics in Hong Kong. Looking ahead, the Government will actively expand the food types covered by the arrangements in a progressive manner and extend its scope to Macao, so as to develop Hong Kong into a cold-chain logistics hub in the Greater Bay Area.

The Government also actively increases the supply of sites suitable for modern logistics development, including cold-chain logistics. In this connection, the Government will dispose of 3 logistics sites in the vicinity of the Kwai Tsing Container Terminals in an orderly manner, taking into account the market situation. Moreover, the Government has reserved 32 hectares of land in the Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen New Development Area for developing a modern logistics cluster. The findings of the relevant planning study were announced in January this year, which set the "enterprise-oriented" development direction and designate 4 focused logistics fields, including high-value goods logistics that encompasses cold-chain logistics. The Government plans to invite expressions of interest from the industry for the development of the first site in the modern logistics cluster this year, and will draw up the relevant land lease terms and development mode after taking into account the industry's interest to ensure that they will keep pace with the development needs of the modern logistics industry.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3277)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

What are the numbers of transit flights in Hong Kong in the past 3 years? What are the passenger volumes and economic benefits generated respectively?

How does the Administration plan to further develop Hong Kong's function as an air transit hub in future?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.: 45)

Reply:

According to the information provided by the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK), the numbers of passengers transferring and transiting by air through the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA) between 2023 and 2025 are tabulated below:

Year	No. of transfer and transit passengers (thousand)
2023	8 040
2024	11 410
2025	16 300 Note

Note: The number of passengers in 2025 is provisional and the actual figure is yet to be verified by the airlines.

Regarding the enhancement of Hong Kong's function as an air transit hub, the Government will continue to actively participate in international civil aviation conferences and take the initiative to visit aviation partners, targeting to explore with 10 or more aviation partners within 2026 the enhancement of air connectivity (including discussing the establishment of new air services agreements or the expansion of traffic rights), with priority focus on regions with further development potential and new growth areas, such as South America, Central Asia, Africa and the Middle East, so as to support the HKIA to further expand its aviation network. The relevant work is undertaken by the existing staff.

The AAHK is committed to providing efficient and convenient transfer services to passengers from around the world. Measures include offering the HKIA Connects service to transfer passengers, which allows passengers whose connecting airline has no check-in service available in the restricted area to complete their onward flight and baggage check-in procedures without going through immigration and customs clearance.

In the meantime, the AAHK partnered with an online travel platform in September 2025 to launch the Free Layover Tour service, which is designed exclusively for transit passengers with a layover of at least 7 hours. Since its launch, over 5 000 passengers have joined.

The services above are undertaken by the AAHK and do not involve government expenditure.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1851)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Government has attached great importance to the development of low-altitude economy (LAE) in recent years. Does the Government currently have any plans to set key performance indicators for the LAE, such as the number of trial routes, the number of commercial operations, related employment and the amount of investment, so as to assess the cost-effectiveness of the work?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Hiu-fung, Nick (LegCo internal reference no.: 28)

Reply:

The Working Group on Developing Low-altitude Economy will draft the Action Plan on Developing Low-altitude Economy this year, so as to build an internationally competitive low-altitude economy ecosystem and position Hong Kong as the Asia-Pacific hub for innovative low-altitude applications. The Government will make reference to the experience and data of the Regulatory Sandbox and Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ projects and the relevant technical studies for the formulation of appropriate infrastructure, related supporting facilities as well as standard rules and practices for low-altitude flying activities in the long run. The relevant studies and planning are still underway.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1720)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Government will introduce legislative amendments for the wearing of helmets by cyclists this year. Will the Government advise on the following:

1) What is the legislative intent behind this? Given that requiring cyclists to wear helmets is one of the ways to provide a safe environment for road users, will the Secretary for Transport and Logistics concurrently require cyclists to acquire basic road knowledge before riding on the roads? If so, what is the estimated cost involved? and

2) Has the Government assessed the proportion of regular cyclists who wear safety helmets that meet international standards? Has the Government conducted surprise inspections in the past? If so, what is the amount of manpower involved?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Hok-fung (LegCo internal reference no.: 32)

Reply:

The Government's policy is to, where road safety considerations and circumstances permit, foster a "bicycle-friendly environment". To this end, we will construct cycle tracks and related ancillary facilities in new development areas and new towns and continuously improve the existing facilities, with a view to facilitating the public to use bicycles for recreational or short-distance commuting purposes, thereby reducing the use of mechanised transport. Nevertheless, given the generally heavy traffic in urban areas, due to road safety considerations, the Government does not encourage the public to use bicycles as a mode of transport in urban areas.

To enhance cycling safety and promote a responsible cycling attitude, the Government has drawn on the regulatory experiences of other places and taken into account various local factors, formulating strategies on education, publicity and law enforcement, etc. in a holistic manner. In this regard, the Transport Department has been working closely with the Hong Kong Police Force and the Road Safety Council to enhance cyclists' safety awareness and understanding of the relevant laws and regulations through various channels, including

announcement of public interest on television and radio broadcast, the website of the Cycling Information Centre, other promotional publications, etc. Besides, the Road Users' Code provides the public with the relevant road knowledge, legal requirements and the offences related to cycling, encourages them to use personal protective gears (including bicycle helmets) and promotes mutual respect among road users. The expenditure involved in the relevant work is absorbed by the existing provision.

The Government does not have the relevant figures on the number of cyclists who wear helmets. However, research shows that wearing helmets can effectively protect cyclists and reduce the risk of head injuries in traffic accidents. Furthermore, data shows that nearly 60% of cyclists who died or suffered serious injuries in traffic accidents over the past 5 years were not wearing helmets. The Government is carefully examining the regulations for enhancing the safety of cyclists and will listen to the views of various stakeholders in the community, with a view to building consensus and putting forward a proposal for legislative amendments in due course.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2347)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat: Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Pilot Subsidy Scheme for Third-party Logistics Service Providers (the Pilot Scheme) was officially launched on 12 October 2020 to encourage the adoption of technology by the logistics sector for enhancing efficiency and productivity. The Pilot Scheme also covers the purchase of screening equipment, including X-ray machines and Explosive Trace Detection equipment under the Regulated Air Cargo Screening Facilities accepted by the Civil Aviation Department. Will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) What are the respective amounts of subsidy received by successful enterprise applicants under the Pilot Scheme in the past 3 years?

(2) What is the average approval time for each application in the past 3 years? Is there room for shortening the approval process and will a ceiling be set on the approval time? and

(3) Given that the Pilot Scheme is open for application all year round until the allocation of $300 million is exhausted, what is the remaining balance of the allocation to date?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Pok-chi (LegCo internal reference no.: 28)

Reply:

To encourage the logistics industry to enhance productivity and operational efficiency through application of technology, the Government launched the Pilot Subsidy Scheme for Third-party Logistics Service Providers (the Pilot Scheme) with an injection of $300 million in October 2020. Following the increase in the subsidy ratio of the Pilot Scheme to 2 (Government) to 1 (applicant) in January 2023, the Government enhanced the Pilot Scheme further in February 2024, with the funding ceiling increased from $1 million to $2 million per applicant enterprise and the scope of funding extended to cover training and Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) technology-related implementation services, including consultancy services.

As at February 2026, a total of 307 applications have been approved under the Pilot Scheme, involving subsidies of about $188.3 million. The number of applications approved and the amount of funding involved in the past 3 financial years are as follows:

	Number of applications approved	Funding amount ($ million)
2023-24	44	27.82
2024-25	41	24.35
2025-26 *(as at the end of February 2026)*	22	17.78

The committee responsible for assessing applications takes into account a number of factors during the assessment process, including the eligibility of applicant enterprises under the Pilot Scheme, the relevance of the proposed projects to the business of the applicant enterprises as well as the budget and implementation details of projects, etc. The actual processing time for each application varies depending on whether the information submitted by the applicant enterprise is complete and clear, and whether additional information is required.

Currently, the remaining balance of the Pilot Scheme is around $111.7 million. The Government will continue to closely monitor the implementation progress of the Pilot Scheme and enhance it as necessary in a timely manner, taking into account factors such as market development situation, feedback and suggestions from the industry, in a holistic manner, so as to ensure that it will address the needs of the industry.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2348)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

With a view to helping the logistics sector to nurture more professional talents and to encourage in-service practitioners to equip themselves with up-to-date knowledge to support the industry to upgrade and transform itself towards the direction of green and smart logistics, the Hong Kong Special Administrative Region Government launched the Professional Training on Smart and Green Logistics Scheme (PTSGLS) on 8 January 2024 under the Maritime and Aviation Training Fund (MATF). Will the Administration inform this Committee of the following:

(1) The overall commitment for the MATF is $500 million. What is the accumulated total expenditure to date? What percentage of that amount is allocated to the expenditure for the PTSGLS (including advance funding to the secretariat and the actual reimbursements for course fees)?

(2) How many applications from course participants have been approved each year since the launch of the PTSGLS and what is the total amount granted? and

(3) If the number of applications is lower than expected, will the Administration step up publicity or increase the funding cap per applicant?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Pok-chi (LegCo internal reference no.: 29)

Reply:

The Maritime and Aviation Training Fund (MATF) came into operation on 1 April 2014, with 15 incentive schemes and a commitment of $100 million, aiming to continue and expand the various maritime- and aviation-related schemes and scholarships under the MATF at the time, and to launch new initiatives to support manpower training in the relevant industries. Following an injection of $200 million from the Government in 2019, the total commitment for the MATF increased to $300 million for sustaining, enhancing and supporting the operation of the MATF as well as optimising its incentive schemes, so as to provide continued support for talent development in Hong Kong's maritime and aviation industries.

Subsequently, the MATF received an additional injection of $200 million from the Government in 2023, with the total commitment increased to $500 million. Apart from continuously optimising the incentive and promotion schemes, the MATF has also enhanced talent training in the logistics industry and launched a new Maritime Services Traineeship Scheme (the Traineeship Scheme), which aims to incentivise participating companies to provide traineeship for young people who aspire to a career in maritime law. Meanwhile, local, Chinese Mainland and overseas promotions in respect of Hong Kong's advantages as an international maritime centre as well as an aviation and logistics hub were also stepped up with the injection. The scope of funding under the MATF continued to expand in 2025. Apart from extending the Traineeship Scheme to marine insurance, the coverage of promotion activities was also expanded to include local seminars, meetings, workshops and overseas professional exchange activities. As at 28 February 2026, the total commitment for the MATF was $500 million and the accumulated expenditure is around $281 million, with a breakdown by sector roughly as follows: maritime (65%), aviation (31%) and logistics (4%). Overall, the aim of the MATF is to build up in due course a vibrant, diversified and competitive pool of professionals and technical personnel to sustain and enhance the Government's support for the manpower development and promotion of the maritime, aviation and logistics industries, as well as to support the long-term development of the relevant industries.

To diversify course options for logistics industry practitioners, with effect from 4 October 2024, PTSGLS has been enhanced to include courses that operate on a self-financing basis. Moreover, to streamline the administrative procedures of PTSGLS, eligible logistics practitioners may select courses suitable for enhancing their knowledge in smart and green logistics from a list of pre-approved courses under the Scheme and, upon satisfactory completion of the pre-approved courses, apply to PTSGLS for reimbursement of up to 80% of the course fees, subject to a cap of $30,000 per applicant.

As at the end of February 2026, 23 courses have been included in the list of pre-approved courses, with a total of 75 practitioners having completed the courses and applied to the secretariat for reimbursement, involving subsidies of about $370,000 in total. Given that on the one hand, course providers may begin enrolling students only after their courses have been approved as pre-approved courses, and on the other hand, students may submit their reimbursement applications within 4 months after completing the courses, the figures above only reflect the number of practitioners who have completed their applications for reimbursement. They do not include those who have enrolled in, are currently taking or have completed the courses but have not yet applied to the secretariat for reimbursement.

The Transport and Logistics Bureau will closely monitor the operation and effectiveness of PTSGLS and conduct reviews in a timely manner, so as to ensure that it will meet the needs of the logistics industry and effectively promote its sustainable development.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1884)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 that the Transport and Logistics Bureau will continue to oversee the implementation of various enhanced measures to combat illegal carriage of passengers by motor vehicles for hire or reward. In this connection, will the Administration inform this Committee of the following: What are the respective figures on law enforcement, prosecution and conviction concerning the illegal carriage of passengers by motor vehicles for hire or reward, as well as the number of cross-boundary vehicles involved in the past 5 years? Furthermore, the Road Traffic (Amendment) (Ride-hailing Service) Bill 2025 was passed after the Third Reading and the Administration has indicated that subsidiary legislation will be introduced in the first half of this year to address matters such as the number of ride-hailing vehicle permits to be issued. Will the Administration provide information on the specific legislative timetable? As for the number of permits to be issued, will reference be made to the experiences of other regions so that the number issued is at least greater than the current number of 18 163 taxi licences in Hong Kong? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Pui-leung (LegCo internal reference no.: 26)

Reply:

Regarding the enhanced measures to combat illegal carriage of passengers by motor vehicles for hire or reward, the figures on law enforcement by the Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF) in the past 5 years are tabulated below:

Year	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Law enforcement figure	19	26	33	47	118

In the law enforcement operations by the HKPF in 2024, there were a total of 19 cases involving cross-boundary vehicles travelling between Guangdong and Hong Kong, while

there were no cases involving cross-boundary vehicles in 2023 and 2025. The HKPF does not keep information on the other figures requested in the question.

Meanwhile, to provide passengers requiring personalised point-to-point public transport services with more safe and legally compliant options, the Government has established a legal framework and key principles for regulating ride-hailing services through the Road Traffic (Amendment) (Ride-hailing Service) Bill 2025 passed by the Legislative Council in October 2025, which include requiring platforms, vehicles, and drivers providing ride-hailing services to obtain appropriate licences/permits and comply with the relevant licence/permit conditions, as well as imposing overall control on the number of ride-hailing vehicles.

The Government is now actively advancing the next stage of work and will continue to communicate with various stakeholders, with a view to finalising the technical details for regulating ride-hailing services (including the number of ride-hailing vehicle permits) and incorporating them into the subsidiary legislation or licence/permit conditions as appropriate. In deciding on the number of ride-hailing vehicle permits, the Government will balance various factors, including the public travel needs and experiences, the carrying capacity of the road network, the ecosystem of the public transport system, experiences from other places, as well as the healthy and sustainable development of the overall personalised point-to-point transport service industry. The Government plans to submit the relevant subsidiary legislation to the Legislative Council for scrutiny in the first half of 2026.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1885)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (700) General Non-recurrent

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

To offer the young generation an opportunity to have an early exposure to the wide spectrum of career opportunities in the maritime and aviation sectors so as to encourage them to join the 2 sectors after graduation, the Government established the Maritime and Aviation Internship Scheme (the Scheme) in 2014 to invite companies in the maritime and aviation sectors to offer internship places. In this connection, will the Administration inform this Committee of the following:

1. What are the respective numbers of beneficiaries in the maritime and aviation sectors as well as the amounts of subsidy under the Scheme in the past 5 years? What is the budget earmarked for the Scheme this year?

2. Regarding the number of participants under the Scheme, the Administration has indicated that new indicators will be adopted from 2026 onwards. As such, the estimated numbers of participants under the Scheme are 130 for the maritime industry and 375 for the aviation industry in 2026. Why does the Administration adopt new indicators and what are the details of the new indicators? and

3. Has the Administration assessed the number of participants under the Scheme who have subsequently joined the 2 sectors after graduation, as well as the effectiveness of the Scheme? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Pui-leung (LegCo internal reference no.: 27)

Reply:

1. To offer the young generation an opportunity to have an early exposure to the wide spectrum of career opportunities in the maritime and aviation sectors so as to encourage them to join the 2 sectors after graduation, the Government established the Maritime and Aviation Internship Scheme (the Scheme) in 2014 to invite companies in the maritime and aviation sectors to offer internship places. The numbers of beneficiaries in the maritime and aviation sectors and the amounts of subsidy under the Scheme in the past 5 years are tabulated below:

Maritime	**2021-22**	**2022-23**	**2023-24**	**2024-25**	**2025-26 (as at the end of February 2026)**
(a) No. of beneficiaries	196	206	135	154	133
(b) Amount of subsidy ($'000)	2,950	3,350	2,260	2,300	2,130

Aviation	**2021-22**	**2022-23**	**2023-24**	**2024-25**	**2025-26 (as at the end of February 2026)**
(a) No. of beneficiaries	162	276	264	361	348
(b) Amount of subsidy ($'000)	1,920	3,550	3,180	4,950	5,220

The budgets for the maritime and aviation sectors under the Scheme in 2026-27 are $29.12 million and $16.4 million respectively.

2. To assess the effectiveness of the Scheme more effectively, we will introduce the number of participants as a performance indicator from 2026-27 onwards. Based on the data from the past 5 years, the number of participants under the Scheme has remained stable. We estimate that the numbers of participants in 2026 will be 130 (for the maritime industry) and 375 (for the aviation industry).

3. The Scheme has been well-received by the sectors over the years with a positive response and a stable number of participants. Upon completion of the internships, the participants may choose to continue their studies or enter the workforce. The industry-related skills and experiences gained during the internships will help them better understand the wide spectrum of career opportunities as well as the operations and developments in the sectors, and enable them to know clearly their own interests and aspirations to join the sectors at an earlier stage.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1886)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (700) General Non-recurrent

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The HKSAR Government launched the "Maritime Services Traineeship Scheme – Marine Insurance" (the Scheme) on 18 November 2025, aiming to incentivise insurance companies and insurance broker firms with marine insurance business (applicants) to provide traineeship for those who aspire a career in marine insurance (trainees), with a view to nurturing more home-grown marine insurers/brokers and enhancing Hong Kong's high value-added maritime services. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of: the details of applicants and trainees who have participated in the Scheme so far, including their respective numbers, the amount of subsidies disbursed, the names of participating companies, and whether the trainees are full-time trainees or full-time employees of the insurance companies/broker firms, broken down by Training Mode (A) Rotational Training for Multiple Trainees and Training Mode (B) Dedicated Training for an Individual Trainee; and the provision budgeted for the Scheme in 2026-27 under the Maritime and Aviation Training Fund?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Pui-leung (LegCo internal reference no.: 28)

Reply:

The Maritime Services Traineeship Scheme – Marine Insurance (the Scheme) was launched on 18 November 2025, aiming to incentivise insurance companies and insurance broker firms with marine insurance business to provide traineeship for those who aspire a career in marine insurance, with a view to nurturing more home-grown marine insurers/brokers and enhancing Hong Kong's high value-added maritime services. The Scheme provides a maximum of 15 quotas per year. Based on the maximum amount of $480,000 in subsidy for each quota per year, the budget for the Scheme is $7.2 million per year.

The secretariat has received enquiries about the Scheme and application details from a number of insurance companies and insurance broker firms. As at 20 March 2026, a total of 5 applications have been received, which are all undergoing the approval process.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1887)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses
(700) General Non-recurrent

Programme: (1) Director of Bureau's Office
(2) Land and Waterborne Transport
(3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The estimate of the amount required in 2026-27 for the salaries and expenses of the Transport and Logistics Bureau is $441,661,000. This represents an increase of $30,071,000 over the revised estimate for 2025-26. The establishment of the Bureau as at 31 March 2026 was 210 posts. It is expected that there will be a net decrease of 7 posts in 2026-27. Will the Administration inform this Committee of the following: what are the details of the posts proposed to be added and the total expenditure involved, as well as the details of the posts proposed to be deleted and the total savings achieved? Furthermore, what are the main uses and details of the increase of $30,071,000 over the revised estimate for 2025-26?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Pui-leung (LegCo internal reference no.: 29)

Reply:

There will be a net decrease of 7 posts in the Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB) in 2026-27. The details are as follows:

Rank	No. of posts reduced	Notional annual mid-point salary ($million)
Engineer/Assistant Engineer	1	3.7
Senior Executive Officer	1	
Executive Officer II	1	
Assistant Clerical Officer	1	
Clerical Assistant	2	
Workman II	1	
Total:	**7**	

The TLB's provision for 2026-27 is about $30.07 million higher than the revised estimate for 2025-26. It is mainly due to the increased provision for conducting a feasibility study on the development of a site in Tsing Yi South for the storage of green maritime fuels and increased cash flow requirement for the Pilot Subsidy Scheme for Third-party Logistics Service Providers.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1937)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the development of low-altitude economy (LAE), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. It is mentioned in the Transport Strategy Blueprint that the Action Plan on Developing Low-Altitude Economy will be formulated. What are the staff establishment, the details of expenditure and implementation timetable involved?

2. Will the Action Plan on Developing Low-Altitude Economy set clear key performance indicators for, including but not limited to (i) the number of infrastructure facilities; (ii) projects of cross-boundary applications; (iii) the type and number of unconventional aircraft; (iv) the relevant talent list, the number of and training for talents; (v) the number of local start-ups, etc. If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

3. Has provision been earmarked for setting up an LAE demonstration zone in the Northern Metropolis and developing the "software infrastructure" and "hardware infrastructure" involved in LAE?

4. What are the specific targets and expenditures for promoting the integration of LAE with the Greater Bay Area in the next financial year? Will an inter-departmental working Group on Guangdong, Hong Kong and Macao cross-boundary LAE be established? and

5. Will consideration be given to setting up a "dedicated LAE fund" to motivate the market to increase investment in research and development and build an internationally competitive low-altitude ecosystem so that Hong Kong will leverage its role as an important bridge and window for "going out" and "bringing in"?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Siu-hung (LegCo internal reference no.: 5)

Reply:

1. & 2. The Working Group on Developing Low-altitude Economy will draft the Action Plan on Developing Low-altitude Economy this year, so as to build an internationally competitive

low-altitude economy (LAE) ecosystem and position Hong Kong as the Asia-Pacific hub for innovative low-altitude applications. The relevant work is mainly undertaken by the existing resources and manpower at present.

The Government will make reference to the experience and data of the Regulatory Sandbox and Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ projects and the relevant technical studies for the formulation of appropriate infrastructure, related supporting facilities as well as standard rules and practices for low-altitude flying activities in the long run. The relevant studies and planning are still underway.

3. New large-scale land development projects such as the new development areas in the Northern Metropolis can provide a large amount of land and space, which should be able to cope with the land and space requirements of LAE-related facilities. In terms of town planning, LAE-related facilities and uses (such as vertiports and charging facilities) can generally be accommodated under the permitted uses of the relevant zoning or their ancillary uses. In other words, these new development regions should be able to accommodate the land or infrastructure requirements for the promotion of LAE.

4. The Working Group is actively liaising with the relevant Chinese Mainland authorities and is having discussions on issues such as the planning of cross-boundary air routes and cargo clearance arrangements. The aim is to commence trial flight projects as soon as possible, thereby laying a foundation for establishing a LAE corridor in the Greater Bay Area.

The relevant work is mainly undertaken by the existing resources at present.

5. The Government has all along been supporting research and development (R&D) in different technology areas through the Innovation and Technology Fund (ITF), under which various funding schemes support local universities, R&D centres and enterprises to conduct R&D work related to LAE. To promote the development of the innovation and technology (I&T) industry, the Government encourages enterprises (including those in LAE-related industries) to set up R&D centres and new smart production lines in Hong Kong, with a view to promoting the development of the real economy. As at October 2025, the ITF has supported 14 projects directly related to LAE, involving a total funding amount of around $28 million.

Furthermore, the Innovation and Technology Venture Fund (ITVF) aims to encourage and facilitate venture capital investments in local I&T start-ups, thereby supporting these enterprises to establish business operations and conduct R&D work in Hong Kong. Enterprises in LAE-related industries which meet the eligibility criteria can also benefit from the ITVF.

The Government will continue to maintain close communication with local universities and research institutions to explore support measures of different forms in a timely manner, thereby fostering the sustainable development of scientific research in LAE.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1949)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the planning or implementation of a number of road projects in Hong Kong, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. For each road infrastructure project, what are the (i) expected/commencement date; (ii) target completion date; (iii) total road length and cost per kilometre; (iv) design capacity; (v) estimated expenditure; (vi) approved project estimate; (vii) investigation, design and construction study (if applicable); and (viii) supplementary provision/cost overrun (if applicable) respectively?

Road Infrastructure	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)
Trunk Road T2 and Cha Kwo Ling Tunnel								
Central Kowloon Route								
Trunk Road T4 in Sha Tin								
Improvement works at Tsuen Tsing Interchange								
Dualling of Hiram's Highway from Marina Cove to Sai Kung Town								
Tuen Mun Bypass								
Extension works to Lung Fu Road and Hoi Wing Road in Tuen Mun								
Route 11 (section between Yuen Long and North Lantau)								
Tsing Yi – Lantau Link								
Widening of Yuen Long Highway (section between Lam Tei and Tong Yan San Tsuen)								
Improvement of Lion Rock Tunnel								
Widening of T6 Bridge of Tate's Cairn Highway								
Improvement works of Fanling Highway (between Pak Shek Au Interchange and Po Shek Wu Road Interchange)								
Fanling Bypass (Western Section)								
Widening of Tsuen Wan Road								
Hong Kong Island West – Northeast Lantau Link								
Road P1 (Tai Ho – Sunny Bay Section), Lautau								
Northern Metropolis Highway (San Tin Section)								
Tseung Kwan O – Yau Tong Tunnel								
Northern Metropolis Highway (Tin Shui Wai, Kwu Tung and New Territories North New Town Sections)								
Sha Tin Bypass								

2. What are the manpower, staff establishment and expenditure involved in the implementation and monitoring of the above road infrastructure projects by government departments? How do government departments ensure that the works will be implemented and completed on schedule? and

3. Has a set of performance indicators in respect of the safety, quality, programme and cost control been developed for road infrastructure projects? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Siu-hung (LegCo internal reference no.: 45)

Reply:

1. The requested information on the projects that have been commissioned or under construction is tabulated below:

	Commencement Date	**Target Completion / Commissioning Date**	**Total Road Length (kilometres) (see Note 1)**	**Design Capacity (pcu/hr) (see Note 2)**	**Approved Project Estimate (APE) of Construction Projects ($ million) (see Note 3)**	**APE of Studies/ Design ($ million) (see Note 3)**
Central Kowloon Route	December 2017	commissioned in December 2025	approximately 4.7	5 400	42,363.9	206.9 (detailed design and site investigation)
Trunk Road T2 and Cha Kwo Ling Tunnel	November 2019	2026	approximately 3.4	3 600	16,017.0	133.6 (investigation and design)
Improvement works at Tsuen Tsing Interchange	April 2024	2027	approximately 0.8	N/A	581.4	N/A
Trunk Road T4 in Sha Tin	August 2024	2030	approximately 2.3	3 600	6,810.0	34.7 (detailed design and site investigation)
Dualling of Hiram's Highway from Marina Cove to Sai Kung Town	December 2024 (detailed design and advance construction works) February 2026 (construction works)	2032	approximately 4.6	3 000	2,748.9	N/A

For projects in planning stage, their estimated project cost would be ascertained upon completion of the investigation and design work. The Government will continuously review the cost-effectiveness of works projects and take into account the urgency and priority of the relevant projects so as to take them forward in a timely and orderly manner. The estimated total road length, design capacity and APE of the studies/design of the relevant projects are tabulated below:

	Estimated Total Road Length (kilometres) (see Note 1)	**Design Capacity (pcu/hr) (see Note 2)**	**APE of Studies/ Design ($ million) (see Note 3)**
Northern Metropolis Highway (San Tin Section)	approximately 9	under review	688.3 (investigation study)
Northern Metropolis Highway (Tin Shui Wai, Kwu Tung and New Territories North New Town Sections)	approximately 15	under review	
Route 11 (section between Yuen Long and North Lantau)	approximately 15	under review	319.0 (investigation study)
Tuen Mun Bypass	approximately 10	under review	N/A
Tsing Yi – Lantau Link	approximately 6.9	under review	695.0 (investigation study and detailed design)
Widening of Yuen Long Highway (section between Lam Tei and Tong Yan San Tsuen)	approximately 3	under review	N/A
Extension works to Lung Fu Road and Hoi Wing Road in Tuen Mun	approximately 2.1	under review	N/A
Widening of Tsuen Wan Road and the associated junction improvement works	approximately 1.7	under review	N/A
Improvement of Lion Rock Tunnel	approximately 1.4	5 400	240.7 (first stage design and site investigation)
Widening of T6 Bridge of Tate's Cairn Highway	approximately 0.7	under review	N/A
Tseung Kwan O – Yau Tong Tunnel	approximately 3.5	under review	N/A
Sha Tin Bypass	approximately 15	under review	N/A

In consultation with the Development Bureau, information on the Hong Kong Island West – Northeast Lantau Link and the Road P1 (Tai Ho – Sunny Bay Section), Lantau under planning, as well as the Improvement Works of Fanling Highway (between Pak Shek Au Interchange and Po Shek Wu Road Interchange) and the Fanling Bypass (Western Section) under construction is provided below:

	Estimated Total Road Length (kilometres) (see Note 1)	Design Capacity (pcu/hr) (see Note 2)	APE of Studies/Design ($ million) (see Note 3)	APE of Construction Projects ($ million) (see Note 3)
Hong Kong Island West – Northeast Lantau Link	approximately 13	under review	see Note 4	N/A
Road P1 (Tai Ho – Sunny Bay Section), Lantau	approximately 9.5	under review	130.2 (investigation study, preliminary design and site investigation)	N/A
Improvement Works of Fanling Highway (between Pak Shek Au Interchange and Po Shek Wu Road Interchange)	approximately 4	8 200	see Note 5	see Note 6
Fanling Bypass (Western Section)	approximately 2	1 250	see Note 5	see Note 6

Note 1: Since the works included in each project vary and some projects may also involve non-road construction works, such as reprovisioning of the affected facilities and improvement works (such as landscaping and slope improvement works) in addition to road construction works, it is therefore not appropriate to make comparison on the cost per kilometre.

Note 2: Passenger car unit/hour (pcu/hr) is a unit for measuring traffic flow in equivalent number of private cars as design basis. For example, a pcu value of 1.0 is assigned to private cars and taxis. Heavy vehicles (such as goods vehicles or buses) are usually assigned with higher pcu values because of larger sizes and lower travelling speed.

Note 3: Only Category A works projects are included. Currently, the actual expenditures of the relevant projects do not exceed the budget at the study/design and construction stages.

Note 4: The engineering feasibility study of the Hong Kong Island West – Northeast Lantau Link is part of Project Item No. 5768CL – Studies related to Artificial Islands in the Central Waters (with APE of $550.4 million).

Note 5: The Improvement Works of Fanling Highway (between Pak Shek Au Interchange and Po Shek Wu Road Interchange) and the detailed design and site investigation of the Fanling Bypass (Western Section) are part of Project Item No. 7835CL – Remaining phase of site formation and engineering infrastructure works at Kwu Tung North new development area and Fanling North new development area – detailed design and site investigation (with APE of $764.5 million).

Note 6: The Improvement Works of Fanling Highway (between Pak Shek Au Interchange and Po Shek Wu Road Interchange) and the construction works of the Fanling Bypass (Western Section) are part of Project Item No. 7828CL – Remaining phase of site formation and engineering infrastructure works at Kwu Tung North New Development Area and Fanling North New Development Area – Construction (with APE of $30.1679 billion). The Improvement Works of Fanling Highway (between Pak Shek Au Interchange and Po Shek Wu Road Interchange) commenced in August 2024 and is scheduled for completion in 2031, while the construction works of the Fanling Bypass (Western Section) commenced in December 2025 and is scheduled for completion in 2031.

2. The work involved in the above road infrastructure projects is undertaken by the existing manpower resources of the relevant policy bureaux and government departments. There is no detailed breakdown of the manpower and salary expenses involved. Based on the latest planning information and progress of all the major transport infrastructure projects under construction and planning, the Government will take a holistic approach in considering the delivery programme of the transport infrastructure projects under planning, take forward the projects in an orderly manner and closely monitor the works progress, so as to meet the transport and logistics demands arising from long-term developments.

3. The Government has all along put in place a stringent audit and monitoring mechanism for the safety, quality, programme and cost control of road infrastructure projects, and will review its effectiveness on a regular basis. For road infrastructure projects at the planning stage, government departments will make reference to guidelines stipulated in, including but not limited to, the Transport Planning and Design Manual of the Transport Department and the Structures Design Manual for Highways and Railways of the Highways Department to ensure that the project design complies with the relevant safety standards. As for road infrastructure projects at the construction stage, government departments will stipulate the specific requirements on safety, quality and programme in the public works contracts and ensure that the contractors fulfil the relevant contractual requirements.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2261)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Transport and Logistics Bureau oversees the work of the Civil Aviation Department on taking forward initiatives in relation to the development of low-altitude economy (LAE), including the implementation of Regulatory Sandbox (Sandbox) projects, etc. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. What are the respective administrative costs and staffing provision for the implementation of the 2 stages of Sandbox projects?

2. Please list in tabular form the implementation details of all the first cohort LAE Sandbox projects, and specify which projects have entered the actual operation stage.

3. Regarding the first cohort of Sandbox projects, are the costs involved at different stages from application, trials to actual operation borne solely by the applicants? Has public fund been used? If so, what are the details? and

4. The Government has stated that it would make reference to the experience and data of the Sandbox pilot projects and the relevant technical studies for the formulation of appropriate infrastructure, related supporting facilities as well as standard rules and practices for low-altitude flying activities in the long run. What are the latest progress, expenditure and assessment details of the demand and resource allocation for the relevant studies and planning?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Siu-hung (LegCo internal reference no.: 3)

Reply:

1. The Civil Aviation Department (CAD) has established the following permanent posts to take forward the initiatives in relation to the development of low-altitude economy (LAE), including the work related to the implementation of Regulatory Sandbox projects:

Rank	**No. of posts**
Senior Operations Officer (Aviation Administration)	1
Operations Officer (Aviation Administration)	1
Operations Officer (Airworthiness)	1
Assistant Operations Officer (Aviation Administration)	1
Senior Electronics Engineer	1
Electronics Engineer/Assistant Electronics Engineer	2
Total:	**7**

The salary provision (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary) for the 7 posts above in 2026-27 is $7.74 million. In addition, the CAD has retained a time-limited post of 1 Administrative Officer Staff Grade B (D3), as well as time-limited posts of 1 Chief Executive Officer and 1 Senior Executive Officer from 2025-26 to 2026-27 to undertake various work related to enhancing Hong Kong's status as an international aviation hub following the commissioning of the Three-Runway System, supporting the development of LAE in Hong Kong and enhancing the overall administrative governance of the CAD. The salary provision (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary) for the 3 posts above in 2026-27 is $5.8 million. The Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB), on the other hand, has created 3 time-limited posts (1 Senior Engineer, 1 Engineer/Assistant Engineer and 1 Senior Executive Officer) from 2025-26 to 2029-30 to support the enhancement of Hong Kong's status as an international aviation hub and to take forward the development of LAE. The salary provision (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary) for the 3 posts above in 2026-27 is $3.76 million.

Currently, apart from the posts above, the TLB and the CAD will continue to use the existing resources to implement the Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ projects and other relevant work.

2. The Government announced the first batch of 38 Regulatory Sandbox projects in March 2025. Currently, 32 of these pilot projects have commenced within designated flight routes. Certain application scenarios that are relatively mature, involve lower risks and do not involve high volumes of people or vehicles in the area have been regularised (such as the use of unmanned aircraft for façade cleaning, inspection of power lines and railway infrastructure). Details of the projects are set out at the **Annex**.

3. The general conditions of the LAE Regulatory Sandbox stipulate that any costs in preparing the applications and conducting the trials will be borne by the project applicants through their self-arranged financial and/or other funding sources.

4. The Working Group on Developing Low-altitude Economy will draft the Action Plan on Developing Low-altitude Economy this year, so as to build an internationally competitive LAE ecosystem and position Hong Kong as the Asia-Pacific hub for innovative low-altitude applications. The relevant work is mainly undertaken by the existing resources and manpower at present.

The Government will make reference to the experience and data of the Regulatory Sandbox and Regulatory Sandbox π projects and the relevant technical studies for the formulation of appropriate infrastructure, related supporting facilities as well as standard rules and practices for low-altitude flying activities in the long run. The relevant studies and planning are still underway and the Government will continue to carefully assess the demand for and allocation of relevant resources.

Annex

Details of the Implemented LAE Regulatory Sandbox Projects (as at the end of February 2026)

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
1	Kangaroo Limited (Shenzhen Meituan Low Altitude Logistics Technology Co., Ltd.)	Drone delivery	1) Between Hong Kong Science Park (HKSP) and Tai Po Waterfront Park 2) Between HKSP and Ting Kok Village, Tai Po	Scope of trials being extended
2	CLP Power Hong Kong	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Sai Wan, Sai Kung 2) Shing Mun Country Park 3) Ngau Tam Mei, Yuen Long (near Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works) 4) Lei Muk Shue to Lai Chi Kok	Operationalised
3	Lands Department	Surveillance	1) Tso Wo Hang, Sai Kung 2) Shap Sze Heung, Sai Kung 3) Cheung Shue Tan, Tai Po	Operationalised
4	Highways Department	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Tunnel Road, Tseung Kwan O 2) Cross Bay Link, Tseung Kwan O 3) Tate's Cairn Highway	Operationalised
5	Civil Engineering and Development Department	Infrastructure surveillance	Tai Mong Tsai, Sai Kung	Operationalised
6	POI Corporation Limited (Hong Kong Science and Technology Parks Corporation)	Building cleaning	HKSP	Operationalised
7	Geosys Hong Kong Limited ((i) Development Bureau; and (ii) FLYCAMHK.com)	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Mui Tsz Lam 2) Kowloon Reservoir 3) Chai Wan 4) Plover Cove Reservoir 5) Hung Shui Kiu 6) High Island Reservoir 7) Shau Kei Wan	Operationalised

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
			8) Chai Wan 9) Kam Tin River 10) Fanling 11) Sheung Shui Sewage Treatment Works 12) Ha Tsuen	
8	Traffic Control Technology (Hong Kong) Company Limited ((i) MTR Corporation Limited; and (ii) Traffic Control Technology (Shenzhen) Company Limited)	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Inside tunnel from Exhibition Centre Station to Admiralty Station 2) Sheung Shui Station	Operationalised
9	OWOWWW Creative (Hong Kong) Company Limited (Shenzhen HighGreat Innovation Technology Development Company Limited)	Drone show system	Cyberport	Operationalised
10	Aerovision Technology Limited ((i) China Merchants Godown, Wharf, & Transportation Co., Ltd.; (ii) The Hong Kong Polytechnic University (PolyU); (iii) Flight Pro Drone Solutions Limited; and (iv) Hong Kong Model Engineering Club Limited)	System/ infrastructure	China Merchants Wharf Pier	Operationalised
11	Fire Services Department	Emergency / search and rescue	1) Fire and Ambulance Services Academy 2) Pre-defined rural areas	Operationalised
12	Fame Faith Limited ((i) S.F. Express (Hong Kong) Limited; and (ii) Hospital Authority (St. John Hospital))	Drone delivery	Cyberport to Cheung Chau	In progress
13	Future Yixin Aviation Technology Limited ((i) Yixin Smart Technology Co. Ltd; and	Drone delivery	Between Pak Shek Kok Promenade and Tai Po Waterfront Pier	In progress

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
	(ii) Easy Mobile Logistics Hong Kong Limited)			
14	Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited ((i) Civil Aid Service; (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited; and (iv) Town Formation Limited)	Emergency / search and rescue/ facilities surveillance	Civil Aid Service Tai Tan Camp	Operationalised
15	DAMODA UAV (HK) Company Limited (Shenzhen DAMODA Intelligent Control Technology Co., Ltd.)	Drone show system	China Merchants Wharf Pier	Operationalised
16	Correctional Services Department (Electrical and Mechanical Services Department)	Infrastructure surveillance	Tong Fuk Correctional Institution	Operationalised
17	The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST) (China UniCom (Hong Kong) Innovation Research Institute Limited)	Others	HKUST campus	In progress
18	SUPTC Digital Technology (Hong Kong) Limited and PolyU ((i) Gleneagles Hospital Hong Kong; (ii) Hong Kong Broadband Network Enterprise Solutions; and (iii) AutosystemHK.ai)	Drone delivery	PolyU campus	In progress
19	United Airspace Management Limited ((i) DNT FPV Drone Association Hong Kong, China; and (ii) Raspect Intelligence Inspection Limited)	Drone delivery	Lau Fau Shan	In progress
20	Godo Innovation Technology (Hong Kong) Limited (China State Construction Engineering (Hong Kong) Limited)	Security patrol	Anderson Road Quarry Site construction site	Operationalised

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
21	Hong Kong Professional Unmanned Aerial Vehicles Association Ltd (Edko Films Ltd.)	Aerial photography	Fanling Hok Tau	Operationalised
22	Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited ((i) Agriculture, Fisheries and Conservation Department; (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited; and (iv) Town Formation Limited)	Enforcement	Kat O	Operationalised
23	5G nuMultimedia Limited (DAMODA UAV (HK) Company Limited)	Drone livestreaming system	Cyberport	Operationalised
24	Hong Kong Logistics and Supply Chain MultiTech R&D Centre (Sunray Science and Technology Co. Ltd.)	Systems/ infrastructure	Cyberport	Operationalised
25	Fire Services Department	Emergency / search and rescue	Fire and Ambulance Services Academy	Operationalised
26	Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited ((i) Environmental Protection Department; (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited; (iv) DAMODA UAV (HK) Company Limited; and (v) Shenzhen Feiliu Yunxiang Technology Co Ltd.)	Air quality surveillance	Peng Chau	Operationalised
27	Hong Kong Centre for Logistics Robotics Limited (Electrical and Mechanical Services Department)	Security patrol	Wo Hop Shek Public Cemetery	In progress
28	Alpha AI Technology Limited ((i) HKT Limited; (ii) U Resonance Limited; (iii) Hong Kong Cyberport Management Company Limited;	Building inspection	Cyberport	Operationalised

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
	(iv) Hong Kong Science & Technology Parks Corporation; (v) Auki Labs Limited; and (vi) Ricoh Hong Kong Limited)			
29	China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited ((i) Hospital Authority (Princess Margaret Hospital); (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) Hangzhou Songba Logistics Technology Co., Ltd.; (iv) Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited; and (v) The University of Hong Kong)	Signal testing	Princess Margaret Hospital	In progress
30	China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited ((i) Auxiliary Medical Service; (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) POI Corporation Limited; and (iv) Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited)	Surveillance	Tolo Harbour Cycling Track	Operationalised
31	UAS Limited ((i) Jadason Technology Limited; (ii) Dynasty Premium Chartered Surveying Group; (iii) JOUAV Automation Tech. Co. Ltd.; and (iv) Aerovision Technology Limited)	Aerial survey	Yiu Lian Dockyards, Tsing Yi	Operationalised
32	TIRAIN (HK) Limited (Lands Department)	Aerial survey	Po Toi Island	Operationalised

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0661)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the implementation of the "Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles" Scheme (Southbound Travel Scheme), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) The following information on Mainland vehicles under the Southbound Travel Scheme in Hong Kong since the implementation of the scheme: the number of cases of traffic accidents or incidents, the number of cases of traffic offences with a breakdown by type of offences, as well as the number of cases of violation of management rules in relation to port car parks or entry into the urban area;

(2) Among the cases of offences or violations mentioned in item (1) above, what are the respective numbers of cases in which the authorities issued warning letters or reminder messages to the applicants of the vehicles concerned, notified the relevant departments in the Guangdong Province and suspended or revoked their eligibility under the scheme? and

(3) Will the Administration hold discussions with the relevant departments in the Guangdong Province about extending the scheme to other cities in the Guangdong Province and increasing the number of daily quotas for application within this year? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon CHAU Siu-chung (LegCo internal reference no.: 14)

Reply:

(1) & (2) The Government has always attached great importance to ensuring road and driving safety. To this end, the Transport Department continues to provide information and carry out publicity and education work for drivers under the "Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles" Scheme (Southbound Travel Scheme) through different channels, including releasing videos on Hong Kong driving rules at the Mainland inspection centres and social media to introduce Hong Kong's traffic rules, traffic signs and road markings, as well as points to note while driving. Publicity leaflets have also been distributed to remind

Guangdong drivers of the differences between Mainland and Hong Kong road designs, traffic rules and facilities.

If vehicles from Guangdong are found to have violated the road traffic laws in Hong Kong, the Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF) will handle the cases in accordance with the laws and procedures in Hong Kong. These violations are isolated cases and they have already been handled or are being followed up.

Depending on the specific circumstances of each case, the governments of Guangdong and Hong Kong will also take corresponding measures in accordance with the management measures for port car parks and entry into the urban area, which include considering suspending or revoking the eligibility of the relevant vehicles under the Southbound Travel Scheme. Since its launch, no vehicles have their eligibility under the scheme suspended or revoked. However, in the early stages of implementation, there were 4 Guangdong vehicles that entered the urban area were found to be not complying with the relevant guidelines of the TD (such as activation of autonomous driving and illegal modification of vehicles). The TD has suspended the eligibility of the relevant vehicles for travel bookings, requested the relevant vehicle owners to make rectifications, and notified the relevant Guangdong departments of the cases.

(3) The Southbound Travel Scheme has commenced operation since the end of 2025. It is open to applications from 4 cities, namely Guangzhou, Zhuhai, Zhongshan and Jiangmen in its initial stage, with 100 daily booking quotas for entry into the urban area and each Guangdong vehicle is allowed to stay for up to 3 days. Since its launch, the overall operation of the scheme has been orderly and smooth. The Government is accumulating implementation experience and closely monitoring the progress, including the operation of the control points, the traffic of nearby roads, the adaptability of users and the public, the enhancement of supporting facilities, etc., and will continue to review and discuss with the Guangdong authorities to increase the quota in an orderly manner. Furthermore, we plan to progressively expand the scope of the scheme from the current 4 cities in the Guangdong Province to other Guangdong cities after 6 months of implementation, with a view to taking forward the Southbound Travel Scheme in a prudent and manageable manner. We will announce the relevant arrangements in due course.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1597)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

As mentioned in the 2026-27 Budget, "we are focusing on training both serving and newly recruited aviation personnel. The Hong Kong International Aviation Academy (HKIAA) will, in partnership with the Chinese University of Hong Kong (CUHK), launch a new Master of Science in Aviation Management programme this year. The Academy has also, in collaboration with an overseas aeronautic services company, established the Aircraft Engineering Training Centre to offer a range of professional training courses on aircraft maintenance, aircraft parts processing and certification." Moreover, the Academy (established by the Airport Authority Hong Kong) is implementing relevant measures to develop Hong Kong into an aircraft parts processing and trading centre in Asia. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) What are the total expenditure and actual expense incurred by the HKIAA for the training of serving and newly recruited aviation personnel, provision of professional training courses on aviation management and aircraft maintenance, construction of facilities and relevant co-operation projects in the past 5 years?

(2) What are the specific initiatives to be put in place regarding the HKIAA 's collaboration with the CUHK in launching a new Master of Science in Aviation Management programme, establishment of the Aircraft Engineering Training Centre with an overseas aeronautic services company and offering of a range of professional training courses on aircraft maintenance, aircraft parts processing and certification in 2026-27? What are the estimated total expenditure and itemised budget involved? and

(3) What are the expected outcomes of the above training initiatives in terms of planned numbers of student places, target numbers of trainees, expected numbers of graduates of various courses/persons completing the courses in 2026-27? How will the initiatives complement the development of Hong Kong as an international aviation hub and an aircraft parts processing and trading centre? What indicators will be used by the Government to assess the effectiveness? Will the Government give a report to this Committee on a regular basis?

Asked by: Hon CHEN Chung-nin, Rock (LegCo internal reference no.: 7)

Reply:

The Hong Kong International Aviation Academy (HKIAA) was established by the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) in 2016 to nurture practitioners and professionals in the aviation industry, thereby supporting the sustainable development of the local and regional aviation industry.

The HKIAA signed a Memorandum of Understanding with Elior Asia Holdings Ltd, a subsidiary of a leading overseas aeronautic services company Elior Group SA, in June 2025. They jointly established the Aircraft Engineering Training Centre in December of the same year to offer a series of professional training courses in aircraft maintenance and aircraft parts processing and certification, with a view to nurturing local professionals in aircraft maintenance, engineering and asset management. The training centre has launched its first trial course, with 11 students all being local in-service aviation maintenance engineering technicians, and more courses will be rolled out progressively in the second quarter this year.

The HKIAA also continues to actively expand collaborations with renowned local and international institutions to offer more academic courses in aviation. These include the Advanced Master in Aviation Safety Management programme offered in collaboration with the Ecole Nationale de l'Aviation Civile (ENAC), as well as the Bachelor of Science in Aviation Management programme offered jointly with the Coventry University in the United Kingdom. Both programmes officially commenced in September and October 2025 respectively. In addition, the HKIAA will, in partnership with the Chinese University of Hong Kong (CUHK), launch a Master of Science in Aviation Management programme, which combines the HKIAA's international accreditation and the CUHK's strengths in aviation research, so as to nurture more aviation professionals for Hong Kong, the Chinese Mainland and other regions. The course will officially commence in September 2026, with about 60 places expected to be provided. In the coming year, the HKIAA will continue to update, enhance and expand its training courses in response to the industry needs, with a view to nurturing more talents for the aviation industry.

The relevant work is undertaken by the AAHK and the HKIAA and does not involve government expenditure.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1387)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the launching and subsequent expenditures of the Port Community System (PCS), will the Government advise on the following:

(1) Since the official launch of the PCS this year, what is the number of enterprises registered to use it so far?

(2) For the subsequent operation, continuous optimisation and upgrading, marketing promotion and technical support of the PCS, what are the estimated expenditures for 2026-27 and the next 3 years respectively? and

(3) What efficiency improvements does the Administration expect from the PCS in terms of data sharing, enhancing port efficiency, implementing cross-boundary One-Data-Multiple-Declarations, etc.?

Asked by: Hon CHIU Duncan (LegCo internal reference no.: 14)

Reply:

The Port Community System (PCS) is an important digital infrastructure for the transition of the Hong Kong Port into a digitalised smart port, aiming to enable the flow and sharing of information in the maritime, port and logistics industries. The installation of the PCS was completed at the end of 2025 and it has officially been rolled out since mid-January 2026. As at the end of February 2026, over 4 000 enterprises have registered to use the PCS.

Regarding the subsequent expenditures of the PCS, the development and installation of the PCS are considered non-recurrent expenditures. In March 2025, the Finance Committee of the Legislative Council approved funding of around $215.08 million for the installation of the PCS in the 4 years between 2025-26 and 2028-29. In 2026-27, the PCS is still in the implementation and optimisation stage, which covers system implementation, cloud services, information technology security, user training and contingency. The expenditure is used for the continuous optimisation of the PCS' functions, data connection and integration testing,

enhancing network security protection, and the provision of technical support and training for industry stakeholders. The non-recurrent expenditure for 2027-28 will mainly be used for the continuous optimisation and upgrading of the PCS, expansion of functional modules, as well as interfacing with more application programmes of the industries' systems. The non-recurrent expenditure for 2028-29 will mainly be used for the consolidation and enhancement of the PCS, as well as preparation for the PCS to transition to regular operation from 2029-30 onwards.

As an important digital infrastructure for the transition of the Hong Kong Port into a digitalised smart port, the PCS helps connect Hong Kong's industry stakeholders, facilitate Hong Kong's connection with the Chinese Mainland and international shipping community, as well as facilitate trade and capital flows. Locally, the PCS will use maritime transport as the foundation and link up Hong Kong's sea, land, and air cargo transport information. Combined with the city's comprehensive multimodal transport network, the PCS will enable a fully transparent cargo delivery process, promote rapid and accurate logistics operations, and provide innovative opportunities and new impetus for businesses. In terms of connecting with the Chinese Mainland and international shipping community, the PCS will connect with Chinese Mainland customs to offer import and export declaration statuses. It will also create conditions for Hong Kong to connect with other ports and global shipping business data platforms, thus positioning local industries closely to the core of the shipping digital ecosystem. In addition, the PCS uses blockchain technology to record cargo flows, which can reflect trade and capital flows. The resulting information transparency and reliability has been proven by banks to be able to reduce financing costs and create new opportunities for Hong Kong's trade financing business in the long run, thereby enhancing Hong Kong's status as an international maritime, trade, and financial centre.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2240)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the Budget Speech that 32 projects in the first cohort of the Low-altitude Economy (LAE) Regulatory Sandbox have conducted trials along their designated routes, and that some have already been implemented. Meanwhile, the Government will, from the first half of this year, roll out trial projects in phases, such as unmanned aircraft system traffic management system and multiple applications/users shared-platforms. In this connection:

1. What are the Government's expenditures and staff establishment involved in supporting the Regulatory Sandbox projects in the past year?

2. Please list in tabular form the Regulatory Sandbox projects that have i) conducted trials and ii) already been implemented. and

3. In its forthcoming Action Plan on Developing Low-Altitude Economy, will the Government set clear performance indicators covering the expected numbers of unmanned aircraft routes or projects to be launched and LAE-related enterprises to be attracted or nurtured, the relevant talent training targets, as well as the projected target share of the LAE industrial chain in the gross domestic product? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon CHIU Duncan (LegCo internal reference no.: 23)

Reply:

1. The Civil Aviation Department (CAD) has established the following permanent posts to take forward the initiatives in relation to the development of low-altitude economy (LAE), including the work related to the implementation of Regulatory Sandbox projects:

Rank	**No. of posts**
Senior Operations Officer (Aviation Administration)	1
Operations Officer (Aviation Administration)	1

Rank	No. of posts
Operations Officer (Airworthiness)	1
Assistant Operations Officer (Aviation Administration)	1
Senior Electronics Engineer	1
Electronics Engineer/Assistant Electronics Engineer	2
Total:	**7**

The salary provision (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary) for the 7 posts above in 2026-27 is $7.74 million. In addition, the CAD has retained a time-limited post of 1 Administrative Officer Staff Grade B (D3), as well as time-limited posts of 1 Chief Executive Officer and 1 Senior Executive Officer from 2025-26 to 2026-27 to undertake various work related to enhancing Hong Kong's status as an international aviation hub following the commissioning of the Three-Runway System, supporting the development of LAE in Hong Kong and enhancing the overall administrative governance of the CAD. The salary provision (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary) for the 3 posts above in 2026-27 is $5.8 million. The Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB), on the other hand, has created 3 time-limited posts (1 Senior Engineer, 1 Engineer/Assistant Engineer and 1 Senior Executive Officer) from 2025-26 to 2029-30 to support the enhancement of Hong Kong's status as an international aviation hub and to take forward the development of LAE. The salary provision (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary) for the 3 posts above in 2026-27 is $3.76 million.

Currently, apart from the posts above, the TLB and the CAD will continue to use the existing resources to implement the Regulatory Sandbox χ projects and other relevant work.

2. The Government announced the first batch of 38 Regulatory Sandbox projects in March 2025. Currently, 32 of these pilot projects have commenced within designated flight routes. Certain application scenarios that are relatively mature, involve lower risks and do not involve high volumes of people or vehicles in the area have been regularised (such as the use of unmanned aircraft for façade cleaning, inspection of power lines and railway infrastructure). Details of the projects are set out at the **Annex**.

3. The Working Group on Developing Low-altitude Economy will draft the Action Plan on Developing Low-altitude Economy this year, so as to build an internationally competitive LAE ecosystem and positioning Hong Kong as the Asia-Pacific hub for innovative low-altitude applications. The Government will make reference to the experience and data of the LAE Regulatory Sandbox and Regulatory Sandbox χ projects and the relevant technical studies for the formulation of appropriate infrastructure, related supporting facilities as well as standard rules and practices for low-altitude flying activities in the long run. The relevant studies and planning are still underway.

Annex

Details of the Implemented LAE Regulatory Sandbox Projects (as at the end of February 2026)

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
1	Kangaroo Limited (Shenzhen Meituan Low Altitude Logistics Technology Co., Ltd.)	Drone delivery	1) Between Hong Kong Science Park (HKSP) and Tai Po Waterfront Park 2) Between HKSP and Ting Kok Village, Tai Po	Scope of trials being expanded
2	CLP Power Hong Kong	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Sai Wan, Sai Kung 2) Shing Mun Country Park 3) Ngau Tam Mei, Yuen Long (near Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works) 4) Lei Muk Shue to Lai Chi Kok	Operationalised
3	Lands Department	Surveillance	1) Tso Wo Hang, Sai Kung 2) Shap Sze Heung, Sai Kung 3) Cheung Shue Tan, Tai Po	Operationalised
4	Highways Department	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Tunnel Road, Tseung Kwan O 2) Cross Bay Link, Tseung Kwan O 3) Tate's Cairn Highway	Operationalised
5	Civil Engineering and Development Department	Infrastructure surveillance	Tai Mong Tsai, Sai Kung	Operationalised
6	POI Corporation Limited (Hong Kong Science and Technology Parks Corporation)	Building cleaning	HKSP	Operationalised
7	Geosys Hong Kong Limited ((i) Development Bureau; and (ii) FLYCAMHK.com)	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Mui Tsz Lam 2) Kowloon Reservoir 3) Chai Wan 4) Plover Cove Reservoir 5) Hung Shui Kiu 6) High Island Reservoir 7) Shau Kei Wan 8) Chai Wan	Operationalised

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
			9) Kam Tin River 10) Fanling 11) Sheung Shui Sewage Treatment Works 12) Ha Tsuen	
8	Traffic Control Technology (Hong Kong) Company Limited ((i) MTR Corporation Limited; and (ii) Traffic Control Technology (Shenzhen) Company Limited)	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Inside tunnel from Exhibition Centre Station to Admiralty Station 2) Sheung Shui Station	Operationalised
9	OWOWWW Creative (Hong Kong) Company Limited (Shenzhen HighGreat Innovation Technology Development Company Limited)	Drone show system	Cyberport	Operationalised
10	Aerovision Technology Limited ((i) China Merchants Godown, Wharf, & Transportation Co., Ltd.; (ii) The Hong Kong Polytechnic University (PolyU); (iii) Flight Pro Drone Solutions Limited; and (iv) Hong Kong Model Engineering Club Limited)	System/ infrastructure	China Merchants Wharf Pier	Operationalised
11	Fire Services Department	Emergency / search and rescue	1) Fire and Ambulance Services Academy 2) Pre-defined rural areas	Operationalised
12	Fame Faith Limited ((i) S.F. Express (Hong Kong) Limited; and (ii) Hospital Authority (St. John Hospital))	Drone delivery	Cyberport to Cheung Chau	In progress
13	Future Yixin Aviation Technology Limited ((i) Yixin Smart Technology Co. Ltd; and (ii) Easy Mobile Logistics Hong Kong Limited)	Drone delivery	Between Pak Shek Kok Promenade and Tai Po Waterfront Pier	In progress
14	Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited ((i) Civil Aid Service;	Emergency / search and rescue / facilities surveillance	Civil Aid Service Tai Tan Camp	Operationalised

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
	(ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited; and (iv) Town Formation Limited)			
15	DAMODA UAV (HK) Company Limited (Shenzhen DAMODA Intelligent Control Technology Co., Ltd.)	Drone show system	China Merchants Wharf Pier	Operationalised
16	Correctional Services Department (Electrical and Mechanical Services Department)	Infrastructure surveillance	Tong Fuk Correctional Institution	Operationalised
17	The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST) (China UniCom (Hong Kong) Innovation Research Institute Limited)	Others	HKUST campus	In progress
18	SUPTC Digital Technology (Hong Kong) Limited and PolyU ((i) Gleneagles Hospital Hong Kong; (ii) Hong Kong Broadband Network Enterprise Solutions; and (iii) AutosystemHK.ai)	Drone delivery	PolyU campus	In progress
19	United Airspace Management Limited ((i) DNT FPV Drone Association Hong Kong, China; and (ii) Raspect Intelligence Inspection Limited)	Drone delivery	Lau Fau Shan	In progress
20	Godo Innovation Technology (Hong Kong) Limited (China State Construction Engineering (Hong Kong) Limited)	Security patrol	Anderson Road Quarry Site construction site	Operationalised
21	Hong Kong Professional Unmanned Aerial Vehicles Association Ltd (Edko Films Ltd.)	Aerial photography	Fanling Hok Tau	Operationalised
22	Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited ((i) Agriculture, Fisheries and Conservation Department; (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance;	Enforcement	Kat O	Operationalised

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
	(iii) China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited; and (iv) Town Formation Limited)			
23	5G nuMultimedia Limited (DAMODA UAV (HK) Company Limited)	Drone livestreaming system	Cyberport	Operationalised
24	Hong Kong Logistics and Supply Chain MultiTech R&D Centre (Sunray Science and Technology Co. Ltd.)	Systems/ infrastructure	Cyberport	Operationalised
25	Fire Services Department	Emergency / search and rescue	Fire and Ambulance Services Academy	Operationalised
26	Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited ((i) Environmental Protection Department; (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited; (iv) DAMODA UAV (HK) Company Limited; and (v) Shenzhen Feiliu Yunxiang Technology Co Ltd.)	Air quality surveillance	Peng Chau	Operationalised
27	Hong Kong Centre for Logistics Robotics Limited (Electrical and Mechanical Services Department)	Security patrol	Wo Hop Shek Public Cemetery	In progress
28	Alpha AI Technology Limited ((i) HKT Limited; (ii) U Resonance Limited; (iii) Hong Kong Cyberport Management Company Limited; (iv) Hong Kong Science & Technology Parks Corporation; (v) Auki Labs Limited; and (vi) Ricoh Hong Kong Limited)	Building inspection	Cyberport	Operationalised
29	China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited ((i) Hospital Authority (Princess Margaret Hospital); (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) Hangzhou Songba Logistics Technology Co., Ltd.; (iv) Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited; and	Signal testing	Princess Margaret Hospital	In progress

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
	(v) The University of Hong Kong)			
30	China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited ((i) Auxiliary Medical Service; (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) POI Corporation Limited; and (iv) Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited)	Surveillance	Tolo Harbour Cycling Track	Operationalised
31	UAS Limited ((i) Jadason Technology Limited; (ii) Dynasty Premium Chartered Surveying Group; (iii) JOUAV Automation Tech. Co. Ltd.; and (iv) Aerovision Technology Limited)	Aerial survey	Yiu Lian Dockyards, Tsing Yi	Operationalised
32	TIRAIN (HK) Limited (Lands Department)	Aerial survey	Po Toi Island	Operationalised

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1290)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

During 2026-27, the Transport and Logistics Bureau will continue to review the fare adjustment arrangement for franchised buses. In this connection, will the Administration inform this Committee of the following:

(a) What are the specific details?

(b) What are the years and the rates of increase respectively for the last 5 fare increases for each mode of public transport in Hong Kong? and

(c) What are the percentages of increase for the last 5 fare increases for each mode of public transport in Hong Kong? How does it compare with the Composite Consumer Price Index of the same year?

Asked by: Hon CHONG Ho-fung (LegCo internal reference no.: 22)

Reply:

(a) Under the existing Fare Adjustment Arrangement for Franchised Buses, the Government will take into account a basket of factors in assessing bus fare adjustments, such as changes in operating costs, revenue and return of franchised bus operators, public acceptability and affordability, the quality and quantity of service provided, the outcome of the supportable fare adjustment rate formula, etc., while there is also a need to provide franchised bus operators with a reasonable rate of return. The fare adjustment arrangement commenced in 2006 and underwent reviews afterwards, which generally concluded that the fare adjustment arrangement has basically been operating smoothly and managed to achieve a suitable balance between financial sustainability on the one hand and public acceptability on the other. We will continuously review the fare adjustment arrangement, including examining whether there is room for improvement regarding the elements above.

(b) & (c) The dates of the previous 5 occasions of fare adjustment, the respective rates of adjustment and the changes in the Composite Consumer Price Index (CCPI) in the

corresponding periods in respect of the public transport modes of the Mass Transit Railway (MTR), franchised bus, green minibus (GMB), taxi, franchised ferry and licensed ferry, and tram are provided in the following tables:

(A) MTR

Effective Date	Fare Adjustment Rate(Note 1)	Change in CCPI from the Date of Preceding Fare Increase
30 June 2018	3.14%	4.4%
30 June 2019	3.3%	3.2%
27 June 2021	-1.85%	1.6%
25 June 2023	2.3%	5.5%
30 June 2024	3.09%	1.4%

Notes:

1. The relevant figures are the overall fare adjustment rates, which are equal to the weighted average figures by which all adjustments to individual fares are taken together. The Fare Adjustment Mechanism of the MTR adopts a direct-drive formula that adjusts fares in accordance with figures released by the Government, and is applicable to all Controlled Fares of the MTR Corporation Limited, including:

(a) adult, elderly, student and child fares on all MTR railway lines (excluding the Airport Express and the High Speed Rail but including the discounted fares provided to Airport workers);

(b) East Rail Line First Class Premium; and

(c) all Light Rail and MTR Bus fares.

(B) Franchised Bus

Franchise	Effective Date	Weighted Average Rate of Fare Increase	Change in CCPI from the Date of Preceding Fare Increase
Citybus Limited (Franchise for the Urban and New Territories bus network) (CTB (Urban and New Territories)) (Note 1)	8 June 2008	2.0%	-4.6%
	20 January 2019	7.0%(Note 2)	34.5%
	4 April 2021 2 January 2022	Phase one: 8.5% Phase two: 3.2%	4.1%
	18 June 2023	4.9%(Note 2,3)	3.1%
	5 January 2025	7.5%	2.8%
Citybus Limited (Franchise for the Airport and North Lantau Bus Network) (CTB(F2)) (Note 4)	18 June 2023	4.2%(Note 2)	47.1%(Note 5)
The Kowloon Motor Bus Company (1933) Limited (KMB)	6 July 2014	3.9%	5.6%
	20 January 2019	Jointly-operated cross-harbour routes under CTB (Hong Kong Island and Cross-Harbour) and NWFB's fare increase only:	10.5%

Franchise	Effective Date	Weighted Average Rate of Fare Increase	Change in CCPI from the Date of Preceding Fare Increase
		KMB/CTB (Hong Kong Island and Cross-Harbour) routes: 7.0% KMB/NWFB routes: 5.6%	
	4 April 2021	Solely operated routes: 5.8% (Note 2,6)	15.0% (Note 7)
	18 June 2023	3.9%(Note 2,3)	3.1%
	5 January 2025	4.3%(Note 2,3)	2.8%
Long Win Bus Company Limited (LW) (Note 8)	8 June 2008	4.5%	-2.3%(Note 5)
	15 May 2011	3.2%	7.3%
	18 June 2023	4.2%(Note 2)	34.6%
New Lantao Bus Co. (1973) Limited	1 April 1998	9.0%	12.5%
	8 June 2008	7.2%	-6.1%
	4 April 2021	9.8%	40.0%
	18 June 2023	7.0%	3.1%
	5 January 2025	6.5%	2.8%
New World First Bus Services Limited (NWFB) (Note 1)	22 April 2001	2.4%	-9.2%(Note 5)
	8 June 2008	5.0%	3.6%
	20 January 2019	5.6%(Note 2)	34.5%
	4 April 2021 2 January 2022	Phase one: 8.5% Phase two: 3.2%	4.1%
	18 June 2023	4.9%(Note 2,3)	3.1%

Notes:

1. As decided by the Chief Executive in Council, the franchises of New World First Bus Services Limited (NWFB) and Citybus Limited (Franchise for Hong Kong Island and Cross-Harbour bus network) (CTB (Hong Kong Island and Cross-Harbour)) were merged and covered by a new ten-year franchise (i.e. CTB (Urban and New Territories)) commencing on 1 July 2023.
2. The overall actual weighted average rate of fare increase shouldered by the passengers taking into account the mitigating effect from the Franchised Bus Toll Exemption Funds.
3. The overall weighted average rate of fare increase of the solely operated routes and the jointly-operated cross-harbour routes.
4. Since the establishment of the franchise in June 1997, CTB(F2) has increased its fares only once.
5. As it was the first occasion of fare increase since the establishment of the franchises concerned, the cumulative rate of change in CCPI is calculated from the establishment of the franchises of CTB(F2), LW and NWFB in 1997, 1997 and 1998 respectively.
6. When CTB(Hong Kong Island and Cross-Harbour) and NWFB fares were increased in two phases, by 8.5% on 4 April 2021 and 3.2% on 2 January 2022, the fares of KMB's cross-harbour routes jointly operated with CTB(Hong Kong Island and Cross-Harbour)/NWFB were also increased by the same rates.

7. The cumulative rate of change in CCPI is calculated from the date of fare increase of KMB on 6 July 2014 because the fare increase on 20 January 2019 only involved its cross-harbour routes jointly operated with CTB(Hong Kong Island and Cross-Harbour)/NWFB.
8. Since the establishment of the franchise in June 1997, LW has increased its fares only 3 times.

(C) GMB[(Note 1)]

Year	Number of GMB Routes with Fare Adjustment Implemented	Range of Fare Increase Rates Approved
2021	126	3.6% - 11.5%
2022	275	1.9% - 25.0%
2023	157	3.8% - 50.0%[(Note 2)]
2024	258	1.7% - 17.6%
2025	158	1.3% - 50.0%[(Note 2)]

Notes:
1. There are numerous GMB packages and fare increase applications. We currently do not keep information on the change in CCPI from the date of preceding fare increase for each application and therefore cannot provide a comparison between the rate of increase and the change in CCPI.
2. The relatively high rate of fare increase relates to the section fares of overnight GMB routes/individual routes.

(D) Taxi

Effective Date	Average Fare Adjustment Rate			Change in CCPI from the Date of Preceding Fare Increase
	Urban	New Territories	Lantau	
10 July 2011	5.2%	8.2%	4.1%	7.9%
8 December 2013	7.1%	9.0%	8.8%	10.5%
9 April 2017	10.0%	11.2%	8.6%	9.3%
17 July 2022	11.5%	13.0%	13.8%	9.3%
14 July 2024	8.9%	9.6%	10.9%	4.7%

(E) Franchised Ferry

Franchised Ferry Service (Note 1)	Effective Date	Fare Adjustment Level	Change in CCPI from the Date of Preceding Fare Increase
Tsim Sha Tsui - Central	29 March 2009 1 January 2010	Phase one: 4.5% - 17.6% Phase two: 8.7% - 20.0%	-1.2% [(Note 2)]
	24 June 2012	13.3% - 16.7%	10.6%
	15 July 2017	8.0% - 10.7%	16.5%
	9 February 2021	13.5% - 18.5%	7.1%
	3 April 2023	53.8% - 56.3%	3.7%

Franchised Ferry Service (Note 1)	Effective Date	Fare Adjustment Level	Change in CCPI from the Date of Preceding Fare Increase
Tsim Sha Tsui - Wan Chai	29 March 2009 1 January 2010	Phase one: 4.5% - 13.6% Phase two: 8.7% - 20.0%	-1.2% (Note 2)
	24 June 2012	13.3%	10.6%
	15 July 2017	8.0% - 8.8%	16.5%
	9 February 2021	13.5% - 18.5%	7.1%
	3 April 2023	54.8% - 56.3%	3.7%

Notes:
1. Rate of fare adjustment for adult single ticket.
2. The figures refer to changes in CCPI from the date of preceding fare increase (i.e. 1997) following Phase two of fare adjustments.

(F) Licensed Ferry

Licensed Ferry Service	Effective Date	Fare Adjustment Level (Note 1)	Change in CCPI from the Date of Preceding Fare Increase
Cheung Chau - Central	1 July 2014	4.8% - 5.4%	13.0%
	1 July 2017	2.6% - 4.3%	7.0%
	1 April 2021	4.4% - 4.9%	7.5%
	24 September 2023	3.8% - 4.2%	3.7%
	1 April 2026	12.4% - 12.8%	4.2% (as at January 2026)
Mui Wo - Central	1 April 2014	4.8% - 5.4%	13.0%
	1 April 2017	3.1% - 4.7%	7.8%
	1 April 2021	4.4% - 5.0%	7.7%
	24 September 2023	3.6% - 4.1%	3.7%
	1 April 2026	12.5% - 12.6%(Note 2)	4.2% (as at January 2026)
Inter-Islands (between Peng Chau, Mui Wo, Chi Ma Wan and Cheung Chau)	1 July 2014	4.9%	13.0%
	1 July 2017	4.7%	7.0%
	1 April 2021	4.5%	7.5%
	24 September 2023	3.6%	3.7%
	1 April 2026	12.4%	4.2% (as at January 2026)
Yung Shue Wan - Central	1 July 2014	6.2% - 6.3%	13.0%
	1 July 2017	4.1% - 4.2%	7.0%

Licensed Ferry Service	Effective Date	Fare Adjustment Level (Note 1)	Change in CCPI from the Date of Preceding Fare Increase
	1 April 2021	4.5% - 4.9%	7.5%
	24 September 2023	18.8% - 18.9%	3.7%
	1 April 2026	12.7%	4.2% (as at January 2026)
Sok Kwu Wan - Central	1 July 2014	6.1% - 6.4%	13.0%
	1 July 2017	4.0% - 4.8%	7.0%
	1 April 2021	4.8% - 5.0%	7.5%
	24 September 2023	19.0% - 19.1%	3.7%
	1 April 2026	12.4%	4.2% (as at January 2026)
Peng Chau - Central	1 July 2014	5.8% - 6.3%	13.0%
	1 July 2017	3.9% - 4.1%	7.0%
	1 April 2021	4.4% - 4.8%	7.5%
	24 September 2023	18.8% - 19.3%	3.7%
	1 April 2026	12.3% - 12.7%(Note 2)	4.2% (as at January 2026)
Discovery Bay - Central	12 June 2011	9.0% - 11.5%	8.6%
	12 May 2013	8.8% - 10.3%	7.8%
	6 July 2014	4.1% - 8.2%	4.7%
	10 August 2018	4.7% - 19.6%	9.6%
	11 August 2024	14.0% - 21.3%	11.1%
Sai Wan Ho - Kwun Tong (Note 4)	1 November 2009	14.6%	-(Note 3)
	11 January 2013	9.1%	13.5%
	4 January 2015	50.0%	8.8%
Sai Wan Ho - Sam Ka Tsuen (Note 4)	1 November 2009	14.6%	-(Note 3)
	11 January 2013	9.1%	13.5%
	4 January 2015	50.0%	8.8%
North Point - Hung Hom	1 April 2011	22.2%	-(Note 3)
	1 April 2014	18.2%	13.0%
	1 April 2017	15.4%	7.8%
	1 April 2021	13.3%	7.4%
	22 October 2023	17.6%	4.8%
North Point - Kowloon City	1 April 2011	22.2%	-(Note 3)
	1 April 2014	18.2%	13.0%
	1 April 2017	15.4%	7.8%
	1 April 2021	13.3%	7.4%

Licensed Ferry Service	Effective Date	Fare Adjustment Level (Note 1)	Change in CCPI from the Date of Preceding Fare Increase
	22 October 2023	17.6%	4.8%
North Point - Kwun Tong -Kai Tak (Note 4)	26 March 2017	20.0%	-(Note 3)
	1 September 2019	16.7%	6.7%
	3 September 2023	18.6%	5.3%
Central - Hung Hom (Note 5)	3 September 2023	18.9%	-
Ma Wan - Central	25 July 2010	7.3%	-(Note 3)
	24 July 2011	6.8%	8.0%
	14 September 2014	8.5% - 11.8%	13.8%
	8 May 2016	4.9% - 9.8%	3.8%
	5 March 2023	12.6% - 33.3%	13.5%
Ma Wan - Tsuen Wan	10 January 2010	25.0%	-(Note 3)
	25 July 2010	16.2%	-1.4%
	24 July 2011	14.0%	8.0%
	14 September 2014	11.0%	13.8%
	8 May 2016	4.1% - 8.1%	3.8%
Aberdeen - Pak Kok Tsuen - Yung Shue Wan (Note 4)	27 September 2015	8.6%	-(Note 3)
	7 October 2018	10.5%	7.2%
Aberdeen - Mo Tat - Sok Kwu Wan (Note 4)	3 June 2012	19.6%	-(Note 3)
	1 June 2015	9.1%	11.1%
	1 January 2020	3.9% - 4.2%	9.1%
	21 September 2025	19.4% - 20.8%	10.8%
Tuen Mun - Tung Chung - Sha Lo Wan - Tai O (Note 4)	26 January 2020	8.0%	- (Note 3)
"North Point - Kwun Tong" Dangerous Goods Vehicular Ferry Service	4 January 2020	7.1% - 8.4%	13.3%
	26 August 2022	15.0% - 15.6%	5.0%
	2 September 2023	60.0%	2.1%
	28 January 2024	20.2% - 31.0%	0.9%
	12 April 2025	20.0%	1.8%
Discovery Bay - Peng Chau/Trappist Monastery (Note 6)	19 January 2025	20.0%	5.2%

Notes:
1. Rate of fare adjustment for adult single ticket except for the "North Point - Kwun Tong" dangerous goods vehicular ferry service where it is the fare adjustment rate for each vehicle by vehicle type.
2. The relevant routes have switched entirely to be run by fast vessels and the single journey fares have been consolidated. The single journey fares for both ordinary ferry services and fast ferry services have become uniform and are lower than the then fares for fast ferry services.
3. Given that fare adjustment records before 2008 are not readily available, there is no information on the change in CCPI.
4. Fare adjustment records before 2008 are not readily available.
5. The "Central - Hung Hom ferry route" commenced service on 28 June 2020. The fare of the route has been adjusted less than 5 times since service commencement.
6. The "Discovery Bay - Peng Chau/Trappist Monastery" route was switched from kaito service to licensed ferry service on 7 July 2023. The fare of the licensed route has been adjusted less than 5 times.

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Effective Date	Fare Adjustment Level (Note 1)	Change in CCPI from the Date of Preceding Fare Increase
21 March 1998	25.0%	5.9%
7 June 2011	15.0%	2.2%
2 July 2018	13.0%	23.6%
11 July 2022	15.4%	6.6%
12 May 2025	10.0%	4.7%

Notes:
1. Rate of adjustment for fare for persons aged 12 or above.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1292)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Government officially launched the "Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles" (Southbound Travel Scheme) in 2025, with 100 quotas allocated for Guangdong vehicles to enter the urban area. In this connection, will the Administration inform this Committee of the following:

(a) What is the number of Mainland visitors travelling to Hong Kong through the Southbound Travel Scheme?

(b) Has the Administration considered extending the Southbound Travel Scheme to other cities in the Guangdong Province? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

(c) Will the Administration consider setting up a "special quota system" to allow more southbound vehicles to park on Lantau Island before transferring to public transport to enter the urban area, so that more quotas will be provided under Hong Kong's geographical constraints of limited road space while having too many vehicles? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons? and

(d) Has the Administration earmarked funding for the construction of additional public car parks on the Lantau Island? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon CHONG Ho-fung (LegCo internal reference no.: 24)

Reply:

Under the arrangements of the "Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles" (Southbound Travel Scheme), eligible private vehicles from Guangdong can apply to travel to Hong Kong via the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (HZMB) through innovative and simple procedures. After parking their vehicles at the automated car parks on the Hong Kong Port Island of the HZMB (port car parks), the drivers and passengers can transfer to a flight via Hong Kong International Airport using the "Park & Fly" service, or enter and visit Hong Kong by local transport using the "Park & Visit" service to be launched later, which all help

enhance Hong Kong's status as an international aviation hub. Alternatively, they may self-drive and enter the urban area via the HZMB without the need to obtain regular quotas (entry into the urban area).

In its initial stage, the Southbound Travel Scheme is open to applications from 4 cities, namely Guangzhou, Zhuhai, Zhongshan and Jiangmen. Currently, the port car parks provide 1 800 parking spaces for the "Park & Fly" service and, together with the 100 daily booking quotas for entry into the urban area, the overall operation is smooth. As at the end of February 2026, the number of bookings for parking at the port car parks is close to 3 000, while the cumulative number of travel bookings for vehicles for entry into the urban area is around 2 500. The Government does not have a breakdown of the number of Mainland visitors travelling to Hong Kong under the cross-boundary driving schemes.

We will strive to launch the "Park & Visit" service at the port car parks as soon as possible to offer visitors another option to travel to Hong Kong. We will also continue to exercise proper control on the total number of vehicles permitted for entry into the urban area, divert traffic and enhance the supporting facilities. In addition, we will develop tourist parking guides to facilitate southbound visitors o combine self-driving with public transport, select their itineraries and routes, and encourage them to travel to various districts across the territory, instead of just concentrating in certain locations. We are accumulating implementation experience and closely monitoring the progress, including the operation of the control points, the traffic of nearby roads, the adaptability of users and the public, the enhancement of supporting facilities, etc., and will continue to review and discuss with the Guangdong authorities to increase the quota in an orderly manner. Furthermore, we plan to progressively expand the scope of the scheme from the current 4 cities in the Guangdong Province to other Guangdong cities after 6 months of implementation, with a view to taking forward the Southbound Travel Scheme in a prudent and manageable manner. We will announce the relevant arrangements in due course.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1294)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

During 2026-27, the Transport and Logistics Bureau will continue to take forward the planning and implementation of transport infrastructure projects promulgated under the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint including railway projects. In this connection, will the Administration inform this Committee of the following:

(a) Will the Administration make reference to the railway projects of the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) in the Mainland and adopt the public-private partnership model, under which the Government will be responsible for civil engineering works while the MTRCL will take up the works such as power supply, signalling, tracks, etc. so as to solve the financing problem? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons? and

(b) The Government has stated that the policy of bond issuance is only for infrastructure investment. Will the Administration issue bonds to raise dedicated funds for constructing a railway from Hung Shui Kiu to Sunny Bay? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon CHONG Ho-fung (LegCo internal reference no.: 26)

Reply:

(a) All along, the Government would consider the implementation and financial arrangements of each railway project taking into account the construction and operation details as well as the distinctiveness and individual circumstances of that railway project, and will also consider utilising market resources to take forward a project. In taking forward new railway projects, the Government and the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) will assess and confirm the financial viability of the projects before entering into project agreements for implementation.

There are merits in having one single entity to co-ordinate and implement railway projects in a holistic manner. Doing so could ensure that the design details and the construction arrangements of different aspects of the projects are compatible with each other. This also helps reasonably balance the cost-effectiveness of the engineering design, meeting practical

requirements while maintaining cost-efficiency and avoiding over-design. If part of the railway project works is to be split into a public works project, we need to consider how to properly handle the interfaces between the works undertaken by the Government and those undertaken by the railway company, which may not be able to enhance implementation efficiency or save time. Consideration should also be given to the financial burden of the Government. The proposal should be considered carefully.

On the other hand, we will review with the MTRCL the various aspects of new railway projects in respect of planning, design and construction, etc. to explore room for enhancing and streamlining the procedures, with a view to saving manpower requirements of the project teams and lowering the costs as far as possible. Meanwhile, we encourage the MTRCL to actively embrace new technologies and techniques from the Chinese Mainland and overseas and to explore the application of different strategic cost-control measures to railway projects to improve speed and efficiency, so as to expedite project implementation while lowering project costs and ultimately enhance the financial viability of the projects. In addition, the Government promulgated the Hong Kong Railway Standards in February this year, which helps to leverage and introduce the extensive experience and world-leading technologies in railway construction of our nation, as well as the recognised standards in other parts of the world, with a view to driving the new railway projects of Hong Kong with enhanced speed and efficiency, and striving for shorter construction period and lower costs. In taking forward railway projects, there is room for the MTRCL to raise funds through appropriate channels and means to meet its liquidity needs. The Government will continue to liaise with the management of the MTRCL in this regard.

(b) In the planning under the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint, the Government has displayed a series of transport infrastructure projects related to the proposed Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands, including the Hong Kong Island West – Hung Shui Kiu Rail Link. As there is no concrete implementation timetable for the reclamation works of the Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands at the present stage, the Government will review the planning and implementation arrangements for the related transport infrastructure projects, under which the Government will consider different options in the absence of the Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands development, including their transport demand, technical feasibility as well as the transport and cost-effectiveness, and will take forward the relevant projects in a timely and orderly manner with due consideration of its urgency and priority.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0409)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA) and the industry launched the Free Layover Tour Service (the Service) last year to offer free city tours to transit passengers at the HKIA, allowing them to deeply experience the urban charm and cultural landscape of Hong Kong in just half a day. Will the Administration inform this Committee of the following:

1. What is the expenditure involved in the Service?

2. What are the number of passengers joining the Service as well as the respective numbers of passengers taking the 3 free routes (heritage citywalk, nature discovery and night arts journeys) each month since the launch of the Service? and

3. Will further efforts be made to enhance the promotion of the Service in the coming year? If so, what are the plans? Furthermore, will the number of routes in the Service be increased depending on the situation?

Asked by: Hon CHOW Ho-ding, Holden (LegCo internal reference no.: 35)

Reply:

The Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) partnered with an online travel platform in September 2025 to launch the Free Layover Tour Service (the Service), which is designed exclusively for transit passengers with a layover of at least 7 hours. The Service is undertaken by the AAHK and do not involve government expenditure.

The Service enables passengers to sightsee in Hong Kong, experience the city's distinctive culture and visit iconic attractions during their layovers. Eligible passengers may pre-book the Service online or register on-site at the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA) upon arrival. The 3 routes offer a total of 60 quotas daily. Since its launch, over 5 000 passengers have joined.

The AAHK will continue to maintain close co-operation with travel platforms, airlines and the Hong Kong Tourism Board to enhance the promotion of the Service in overseas markets and attract more passengers to transit through Hong Kong, thereby further consolidating the HKIA's position as a leading international aviation hub. At the same time, the AAHK will promote the Service through various social media platforms, utilise the digital platforms in different markets, and introduce the Service to overseas travellers through key opinion leaders and content creators in a more attractive and targeted manner.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0800)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Airport Authority Hong Kong is committed to attracting, nurturing and retaining quality talents through the implementation of the Management Trainee Programme, the Graduate Engineer Programme, the IT Trainee Programme and the Summer Internship Programme. Will the Administration inform this Committee of the following:

1. What are the respective numbers of students enrolled in the 4 programmes in the past 3 years (2025, 2024 and 2023)?

2. What are the percentages of graduates from the three-year Management Trainee Programme in 2022, 2021 and 2020 who have subsequently joined the local aviation industry?

3. What are the percentages of graduates from the two-year IT Trainee Programme in 2023, 2022 and 2021 who have subsequently joined the local aviation industry?

4. For the Graduate Engineer Programme, what are the percentages of graduates from the two-year programme of the building services/electrical/electronic/mechanical engineering streams in 2024, 2023 and 2021 who have subsequently joined the relevant industries?

5. For the Graduate Engineer Programme, what are the percentages of graduates from the three-year programme of the civil engineering stream in 2022, 2021 and 2020 who have subsequently joined the local aviation industry?

6. What are the percentages of graduates from the eight-week Summer Internship Programme in the past 3 years (2025, 2024 and 2023) who have subsequently joined the local aviation industry? and

7. What are the operating expenditures of the 4 programmes in the past 3 years (2025, 2024 and 2023) and the estimated figure this year?

Asked by: Hon CHOW Ho-ding, Holden (LegCo internal reference no.: 31)

Reply:

The Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) is committed to attracting, nurturing and retaining quality talents. To attract young talents, the AAHK has introduced the Management Trainee Programme, the Graduate Engineer Programme, the IT Trainee Programme and the Summer Internship Programme to provide young people with hands-on assignments, group projects and training opportunities for more exposure to various facets of airport operation, so as to widen their horizons and enhance their leadership competences, thereby supporting the daily operation of the AAHK and the long-term development of the Hong Kong International Airport. According to the information provided by the AAHK, the numbers of participants in the 4 programmes between 2023 and 2025 are tabulated below:

	Management Trainee Programme	Graduate Engineer Programme	IT Trainee Programme (Note)	Summer Internship Programme
2023	5	8	-	88
2024	10	6	-	107
2025	10	10	5	93

Note: The IT Trainee Programme was launched in 2025.

The programmes are part of the AAHK's regular recruitment exercises and do not involve government expenditure.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0802)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

To address acute manpower shortage in aviation industry, the Government launched the Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector – Aviation Industry (the Scheme) in July 2023 to allow aviation-related companies with direct contractual relationship with the Airport Authority Hong Kong to import workers, on the premise of safeguarding the employment of local workers. Will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. What are the numbers of imported workers of the 10 designated job types under the Scheme and the numbers of vacancies in each job type in the past 3 years (2025, 2024 and 2023)?

2. What are the proportions of local employees and imported workers of the 10 designated job types in the past 3 years (2025, 2024 and 2023)? and

3. Will re-employment measures (such as arrangement on flexible working hours) be implemented to encourage more retired pilots, maintenance engineers, etc. to re-enter the profession as consultants or on a part-time basis, with a view to enhancing the attractiveness of re-employment?

Asked by: Hon CHOW Ho-ding, Holden (LegCo internal reference no.: 38)

Reply:

The Government launched the Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector – Aviation Industry (the Scheme) in July 2023 to allow licensees, franchisees or holders of operating permits issued by the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) to apply for labour importation to fill vacancies for frontline non-supervisory jobs under 10 designated job types at the airport, on the premise of safeguarding the employment of local workers, with a quota ceiling of 6 300. According to the requirements of the Scheme, employers are required to maintain the 2:1 manning ratio of full-time local employees to imported labour.

After 3 rounds of applications, all 6 300 quotas have been granted, covering all 10 job types under the Scheme. As at December 2025, among the quotas used, a total of 5 210 imported

workers have arrived to work in Hong Kong through the Scheme. Please refer to the table below for details.

Job type	No. of workers having arrived to work in Hong Kong		
	August to December 2023	2024	2025
1. Passenger Services Officer	54	1 278	320
2. Ramp Services Agent	59	726	135
3. Cabin Worker	10	545	332
4. Aircraft Maintenance Mechanic/ Technician	0	29	23
5. Tractor Driver	31	386	66
6. Warehouse Operator/ Cargo Hander	3	226	53
7. Equipment/Loader Operator	27	261	126
8. Customer Services Agent	9	166	72
9. Aircraft Tug Driver	4	25	13
10. Maintenance Technician	4	120	107
Total	**201**	**3 762**	**1 247**

The AAHK and the airport community have been utilising various approaches to recruit talent and fill vacancies. They will continue to conduct local recruitment activities to promote the development prospects and employment opportunities of the aviation industry. They will also actively enhance the working environment and welfare of practitioners to retain talent. To reduce the manpower pressure in the long term, the AAHK also implements technology and smart techniques in airport services. The relevant work does not involve government expenditure.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2211)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Based on the vision of the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) for community investment, a feasibility study was conducted in 2015 to identify the needs of neighbouring communities, and to develop pilot project ideas that focus on people development. The EXTRA MILE project was rolled out in early 2018 as a collective platform for the AAHK and participating business partners to attract and retain talents for the airport community by investing in, and unleashing the potential of, 3 specific target groups. The 3 pilot programmes launched in 2018 were "Working Holiday@Lantau", "The Pioneer" and "EduCare", for the 3 target groups of working youth, non-Chinese speakers and airport staff with children. Will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. What are the respective numbers of participants in the 3 pilot programmes in the past 3 years (2025, 2024 and 2023)?

2. What are the operating expenditures of the 3 pilot programmes in the past 3 years (2025, 2024 and 2023) and this year? and

3. How will the effectiveness of the 3 pilot programmes be evaluated? Will key performance indicators be set for the evaluation of the effectiveness of the 3 pilot programmes?

Asked by: Hon CHOW Ho-ding, Holden (LegCo internal reference no.: 36)

Reply:

The Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) is committed to attracting, nurturing and retaining quality talents. To recruit and retain talents, the AAHK launched 3 pilot programmes under the EXTRA MILE project in 2018, namely "Working Holiday@Lantau", "The Pioneer" and "EduCare", so as to provide job opportunities at the airport for the working youth and non-Chinese speakers, as well as after-school support services for children of airport staff. According to the information provided by the AAHK, the numbers of participants in the pilot programmes in 2023, 2024 and 2025 are 138, 118 and 101

respectively. The programmes are undertaken by the AAHK and do not involve government expenditure.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2384)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Hong Kong Special Administrative Region Government aims to revamp the image of modern logistics industry as "Smart, Innovative, High-end" to attract the younger generation to join the industry and promote the strength of Hong Kong as an international premier logistics hub to both local and overseas companies. To this end, the Logistics Promotion Funding Scheme (LPFS) was launched under the Maritime and Aviation Training Fund (MATF) on 8 January 2024 to support and encourage organisations and professional bodies to organise promotional campaigns on the theme of modern and smart logistics. Will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. Given the total commitment of $500 million under the MATF, what is the accumulated total expenditure to date? What percentage of that expenditure has been allocated to the LPFS?

2. What is the yearly breakdown in relation to the number of participants, associated costs and total annual funding since the inception of the LPFS? and

3. Considering that only 6 projects have been approved annually since the LPFS's inception, does the Government consider this meeting expectations? If not, will it enhance publicity or introduce new initiatives to attract organisations or professional bodies to organise promotional campaigns and apply for funding?

Asked by: Hon CHOW Ho-ding, Holden (LegCo internal reference no.: 32)

Reply:

The Maritime and Aviation Training Fund (MATF) came into operation on 1 April 2014, with 15 incentive schemes and a commitment of $100 million, aiming to sustain and expand various maritime- and aviation-related schemes and scholarships under the MATF at the time, and to launch new initiatives to support manpower training in the relevant industries. Following an injection of $200 million from the Government in 2019, the total commitment for the MATF increased to $300 million for sustaining, enhancing and supporting the

operation of the MATF as well as optimising its incentive schemes, so as to provide continued support for talent development in Hong Kong's maritime and aviation industries.

Subsequently, the MATF received an additional injection of $200 million from the Government in 2023, with the total commitment increased to $500 million. Apart from continuously optimising the incentive and promotion schemes, the MATF has also enhanced talent training in the logistics industry and launched a new Maritime Services Traineeship Scheme (the Traineeship Scheme), which aims to incentivise participating companies to provide traineeship for young people who aspire to a career in maritime law. Meanwhile, local, Chinese Mainland and overseas promotions in respect of Hong Kong's advantages as an international maritime centre as well as an aviation and logistics hub were also stepped up with the injection. The scope of funding under the MATF continued to expand in 2025. Apart from extending the Traineeship Scheme to marine insurance, the coverage of promotion activities was also expanded to include local seminars, meetings, workshops and overseas professional exchange activities. As at 28 February 2026, the total commitment for the MATF was $500 million and the accumulated expenditure was around $281 million, with a breakdown by sector roughly as follows: maritime (65%), aviation (31%) and logistics (4%).

In the Action Plan on Modern Logistics Development promulgated in 2023, the Government proposes to revamp the image of modern logistics industry as "Smart, Innovative, High-end" and promote the innovation of the industry, with a view to attracting more young people to join the industry and inject new impetus into the logistics sector. To this end, the Government launched the Logistics Promotion Funding Scheme (LPFS) in January 2024 to provide sponsorship for local promotional campaigns and activities with focus on modern and smart logistics organised by logistics-related organisations and professional bodies.

Since its launch in 2024, 15 promotional campaigns have been approved under the LPFS, with funding of about $9.77 million. Details of all approved projects have been uploaded to the LPFS website.

In 2024-25, a total of 5 promotional campaigns were implemented, including a logistics datathon for overseas and local tertiary and secondary school students; a forum related to Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) in logistics; a modern logistics short film competition for secondary school students; a TV programme promoting the modern logistics industry in Hong Kong; and an annual logistics award recognising young talents in the logistics industry. The total number of participants in the related physical events was around 550, while the TV programme recorded a viewership of over 46 million.

In 2025-26, a total of 10 promotional campaigns were implemented, including the production of teaching resource packages on the logistics industry for secondary and primary school students and the associated promotional activities; a job shadowing programme for senior secondary school students; an inter-school logistics competition incorporating training workshops and simulation exercises; and a logistics technology exhibition, etc. Among them, 8 campaigns have been successfully completed with a total of around 1 904 participants, while the remaining 2 are still ongoing.

To ensure the proper use of public funds and maximise the effectiveness of the LPFS, the Hong Kong Logistics Development Council (LOGSCOUNCIL) takes into account a number of factors during the assessment process, including the distinctive features and anticipated

impact of a campaign; whether its concept and target beneficiaries overlap with those of other approved campaigns; the reasonableness of the budget and implementation details; applicant organisations' experience and performance in organising similar promotional campaigns in the past, etc.

The Government will continue to collaborate with LOGSCOUNCIL, industry organisations, tertiary institutions and training institutions to take forward a wider variety of promotional campaigns and step up publicity, so as to encourage more organisations to apply for funding. Meanwhile, the Government will also continuously review the effectiveness of the LPFS and refine it as necessary in a timely manner to ensure that it will effectively achieve the objectives of promoting modern logistics industry and nurturing logistics talents.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2645)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Internship Scheme on Modern Logistics (the Scheme) is an initiative subsidised by the Maritime and Aviation Training Fund (MATF). The objective is to provide sponsorship for logistics companies to offer internship placements to full time students, so as to enable them to better appreciate the development prospects of and the career opportunities in the field of modern logistics and supply chain management, with a view to encouraging them to join the logistics industry after graduation. The Scheme provides sponsorship of up to 75% of each intern's monthly honorarium (capped at HK$7,500 per intern per month) for a maximum period of 3 months to eligible logistics companies to offer internship placements to full-time students undertaking undergraduate or sub-degree or diploma programmes in tertiary or training institutions in or outside Hong Kong. Will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. With a total commitment of $500 million, what is the amount of accumulated total expenditure of the MATF so far? What is the percentage of expenditure allocated to the Scheme?

2. Since the launch of the Scheme, what are the number of sponsored logistics companies, number of interns, categories of study programmes, sponsorship amount for each approved project and total sponsorship amount for each year? and

3. Will the cap of the monthly sponsorship for each intern be raised to increase the incentive and hence attract more students to take up related internship?

Asked by: Hon CHOW Ho-ding, Holden (LegCo internal reference no.: 33)

Reply:

The Maritime and Aviation Training Fund (MATF) came into operation on 1 April 2014, with 15 incentive schemes and a commitment of $100 million, aiming to continue and expand the various maritime- and aviation-related schemes and scholarships under the MATF at the time, and to launch new initiatives to support manpower training in the relevant industries.

Following an injection of $200 million from the Government in 2019, the total commitment for the MATF increased to $300 million for sustaining, enhancing and supporting the operation of the MATF as well as optimising its incentive schemes, so as to provide continued support for talent development in Hong Kong's maritime and aviation industries.

Subsequently, the MATF received an additional injection of $200 million from the Government in 2023, with the total commitment increased to $500 million. Apart from continuously optimising the incentive and promotion schemes, the MATF has also enhanced talent training in the logistics industry and launched a new Maritime Services Traineeship Scheme (the Traineeship Scheme), which aims to incentivise participating companies to provide traineeship for young people who aspire to a career in maritime law. Meanwhile, local, Chinese Mainland and overseas promotion in respect of Hong Kong's advantages as an international maritime centre as well as an aviation and logistics hub was also stepped up with the injection. The scope of funding under the MATF continued to expand in 2025. Apart from extending the Traineeship Scheme to marine insurance, the coverage of promotion activities was also expanded to include local seminars, meetings, workshops and overseas professional exchange activities. As at 28 February 2026, the total commitment for the MATF is $500 million and the accumulated expenditure is around $281 million, with a breakdown by sector roughly as follows: maritime (65%), aviation (31%) and logistics (4%). Overall, the aim of the MATF is to build up in due course a vibrant, diversified and competitive pool of professionals and technical personnel to sustain and enhance the Government's support for the manpower development and promotion of the maritime, aviation and logistics industries, as well as to support the long-term development of the relevant industries.

The Internship Scheme on Modern Logistics (the Internship Scheme) is one of the initiatives subsidised by the MATF, aiming to enhance the previous summer internship programme delivered under the Hong Kong Logistics Development Council. The Internship Scheme accepts full-time students (including students who are in the final year of their study) undertaking undergraduate or sub-degree or diploma programmes in any tertiary or training institutions in or outside Hong Kong. Most of the students participating in the internship are currently undertaking undergraduate programmes. The Government will reimburse participating companies for up to 75% of each intern's monthly honorarium (capped at HK$7,500 per intern per month) for a maximum period of 3 months. Each participating company can employ 10 interns at most in each financial year. As at the end of February 2026, the funding expenditure for the Internship Scheme is around $1.99 million, with 125 persons in 20 participating companies benefitted.

The Transport and Logistics Bureau will closely monitor the operation and effectiveness of the Internship Scheme and review the relevant funding arrangement in a timely manner, so as to ensure that it will meet the needs of the logistics industry and effectively promote its sustainable development.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0926)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the work to draw more high value-added overnight visitors, step up marketing efforts in source markets with potential and proactively promote the hosting of a wider range of conferences, exhibitions and incentive travel events in Hong Kong, please advise on the following:

The Airport Authority Hong Kong promulgated the expanded Airport City development blueprint in 2024, which includes the development of a yacht bay to provide more than 500 yacht berths. What are the staffing provision and the estimated expenditure? What is the latest progress?

Asked by: Hon CHU Lap-wai (LegCo internal reference no.: 51)

Reply:

The Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) continues to actively take forward various projects to develop Airport City SKYTOPIA. Among them, the yacht bay project will provide more than 500 berths, including berths that can accommodate superyachts over 80 metres in length, together with ancillary facilities and water recreation areas. The provision of various yacht tourism amenities is expected to attract high value-added visitors. The AAHK will invite expressions of interest for the development of the yacht bay and its ancillary facilities in 2026, with phased completion expected starting from 2028. The project is undertaken by the AAHK and does not involve government expenditure.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1862)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in paragraph 149 of the Budget that the authorities will "promote the co-development of financial and maritime centres". Will the Government inform this Committee of the relevant policies and financial provision?

Asked by: Hon CHUNG Ki-fung, Tommy (LegCo internal reference no.: 4)

Reply:

Maritime decarbonisation has been a global trend. The International Maritime Organization has set the goal of achieving net-zero carbon emissions from international shipping by or around 2050. To progressively achieve these decarbonisation goals, the global shipping industry is facing increasing pressure to undergo green transformation. Looking ahead, the need for building new vessels powered by green maritime fuels or retrofitting the existing ones will be substantial and sustained.

Hong Kong is both an international maritime centre and an international financial centre. In response to the wave of green transformation in the global shipping industry, the 2026-27 Budget proposes to promote the co-development of financial and maritime centres to address the substantial capital needs of shipowners in green maritime transformation. Leveraging Hong Kong's strengths of having a premier business environment and a thriving high value-added maritime services industry, coupled with the combined advantages of the 2 centres, we will better facilitate international shipping enterprises' access to Hong Kong's capital market, assist the shipping industry in exploring more diverse funding channels, and encourage the financial sector to develop a more diversified range of maritime financial products. This will transform the power of financial markets into a driving force to attract shipping enterprises to choose Hong Kong as their business base, thereby developing Hong Kong into the "Global Maritime Capital". The Government will work with the Hong Kong Maritime and Port Development Board and the relevant industry stakeholders to explore, facilitate and promote the co-development of the financial and maritime industries, with a view to maximising the synergy between the 2 centres.

The work to take forward the relevant policies will be undertaken by the existing manpower and resources.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1863)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in paragraph 150 of the Budget that the Government is planning to amend the legislation to "extend the current arrangements under the Air Transhipment Cargo Exemption Scheme to other sea transhipment and sea-air transhipment modes". Will consideration be given to extending the relevant arrangements to the transhipment carried by river trade vessel?

Asked by: Hon CHUNG Ki-fung, Tommy (LegCo internal reference no.: 5)

Reply:

To enhance Hong Kong's competitiveness as an international aviation hub, an international maritime centre and an international logistics hub, the Chief Executive announced in the 2024 Policy Address that the Government would examine the extension of the arrangements under the Air Transhipment Cargo Exemption Scheme (the Scheme) to other intermodal cargo-transhipment modes. Following examination with other departments, the Transport and Logistics Bureau is exploring the possibility of extending the arrangements under the Scheme currently applicable to the air-to-air transhipment mode to sea-to-sea transhipment and sea-to-air transhipment modes.

For the sea-to-sea transhipment mode, the arrangements will be applicable to cargoes that are transhipped at the Kwai Tsing Container Terminals (KTCTs) and remain within the premises of the KTCTs throughout the process. As for the sea-to-air transhipment mode, the arrangements will be applicable to cargoes transported by sea from the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA) to the HKIA Dongguan Logistics Park, as well as cargo transported in the reverse direction. Cargoes carried by river trade vessels will also be covered by the extended arrangements under the Scheme, provided that they meet the conditions above.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1225)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in Paragraph 140 of the Budget Speech that the authorities will develop Hong Kong into the first aircraft parts processing and trading centre in Asia, and the Airport Authority Hong Kong is pressing ahead with a leading overseas aircraft services company to provide professional services such as aircraft dismantling and parts recycling in Hong Kong. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. What are the details of land area, scale, manpower, etc. related to the professional services such as aircraft dismantling and parts recycling, and the estimated numbers of aircrafts or parts that can be processed each year?

2. Apart from the aforesaid services company, has the Government engaged in negotiations with other companies providing relevant services in order to attract more enterprises dealing with aircraft dismantling and parts recycling to establish a presence in Hong Kong, with a view to expanding the scale and network of such services in Hong Kong? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

3. Does the Government have a timetable and roadmap for establishing Hong Kong as the first aircraft parts processing and trading centre in Asia, and will the Government align the developmental plans on this front with the progress of home-developed aircrafts going global? and

4. What are the estimated resources and manpower involved in the Government's work to develop Hong Kong into the first aircraft parts processing and trading centre in Asia?

Asked by: Hon FAN Chun-wah, Andrew (LegCo internal reference no.: 5)

Reply:

The Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) is pressing ahead with a leading overseas aeronautic services company, Elior Group SA, to provide professional services such as aircraft dismantling and parts recycling in Hong Kong. To this end, the Hong Kong

International Aviation Academy (HKIAA) signed a Memorandum of Understanding with Elior Asia Holdings Ltd, a subsidiary of that company, in June 2025, and jointly established the Aircraft Engineering Training Centre in December of the same year to offer a range of professional training courses on aircraft maintenance, aircraft parts processing and certification, with a view to nurturing local professionals in aircraft maintenance, engineering and asset management. The training centre has launched its first trial course, and more courses will be rolled out progressively in the second quarter this year. It is anticipated that 300 training places will be provided within this year and the enrolment will be expanded progressively to include non-serving aviation maintenance engineering technicians. The work is undertaken by the HKIAA and the relevant aeronautic services company and does not involve government expenditure. The above initiative will help develop Hong Kong into the first aircraft parts processing and trading centre in Asia and enhance Hong Kong's position as an international aviation hub, thereby supporting the aviation development of our country as well as the Asian region as a whole.

The Government will continue to work with the AAHK to provide assistance to companies interested in operating in the relevant industries in Hong Kong, with a view to expanding the scale of these industries in Hong Kong. The relevant work is undertaken by the existing staff and no breakdown of the expenditure involved is available.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1247)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

As regards "the work to develop the Hong Kong International Aviation Academy (HKIAA) into the aviation training hub for Hong Kong and the region" mentioned under the Programme, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. What are the number of persons enrolling on the HKIAA's programmes, the total number of persons admitted and the number of Secondary 6 school leavers among them in each of the past 2 years?

2. What is the number of persons completing the HKIAA's programmes in the past two years? Has the Government conducted any pathway surveys to learn about their employment situation and have they taken up aviation-related jobs? If so, what are the details?

3. What are the Government's current measures to promote the HKIAA's programmes among young people and students in Hong Kong? In particular, what are the numbers of school talks held and schools involved? and

4. Will the Government expand the scale of the HKIAA and the variety of its programmes, with a view to increasing the pool of talent for the local aviation sector and developing into an aviation training hub? If so, what are the details? Will the HKIAA introduce dual-track programmes and other modes of study in future to attract more young people to pursue careers in the aviation sector?

Asked by: Hon FAN Chun-wah, Andrew (LegCo internal reference no.: 35)

Reply:

The Hong Kong International Aviation Academy (HKIAA) was established by the Airport Authority Hong Kong in 2016 to nurture practitioners and professionals in the aviation industry, thereby supporting the sustainable development of the local and regional aviation industry.

According to the information provided by the HKIAA, the number of students enrolled in its courses in 2024-25 and 2025-26 (as at February) are around 71 000 and 67 000 respectively, with 40 and 70 students being graduates of the Hong Kong Diploma of Secondary Education Examination of the same year. The HKIAA currently provides over 110 foundation, academic and professional courses, covering a wide range of subjects to support practitioners' development needs for skills and knowledge in specific aviation disciplines. These courses cover air traffic control, airport operation and crisis management, aviation security and safety, as well as flight training and aircraft engineering. As most of the courses offered by the HKIAA are designed for in-service practitioners and relevant professionals, the majority of the students are existing airport employees.

Apart from promoting and introducing its courses through websites and social media, the HKIAA also regularly participates in education and career expos to provide relevant information to those aspiring to join the aviation industry and enhance their understanding and knowledge of the aviation industry, with a view to attracting more young people to join the aviation industry.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3288)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding "the work on rationalisation and optimisation of the efficient use of the airspace in the Greater Bay Area (GBA) in partnership with the civil aviation authorities of the Chinese Mainland and Macao" mentioned in the Programme, will the Administration advise on the following:

1. What are the number of meetings held and the specific outcomes achieved related to the work in the past year? As a result, what progress has been made in enhancing the air traffic management efficiency and the air traffic volume? and

2. What progress and outcomes have been achieved in the past year in the specific collaboration between the authorities and various airports in the GBA, including the Guangzhou Baiyun International Airport, the Macao International Airport, the Shenzhen Bao'an International Airport and the Zhuhai Airport? What are the specific plans, estimated expenditures and manpower arrangements in this area for the coming year?

Asked by: Hon FAN Chun-wah, Andrew (LegCo internal reference no.: 40)

Reply:

1. The Civil Aviation Department has been maintaining close liaison and co-operation with the Civil Aviation Administration of China and the Civil Aviation Authority of Macao, with a view to promoting the optimisation of the airspace in the Greater Bay Area (GBA). Through the co-operation platform of the "Pearl River Delta Region Air Traffic Management Planning and Implementation Tripartite Working Group" (TWG), the TWG takes a holistic view of the airspace development of the entire GBA to implement various optimisation projects and facilitate technology exchanges, so as to cope with the continuous growth in aircraft movements in the region. Last year, the TWG held 8 working meetings, including the Mainland, Hong Kong and Macao high-level air traffic management meeting in Macao in September to further study the planning of the peripheral air routes in the GBA and measures to enhance the efficiency of air traffic flow management in the region, including sharing of real-time weather information, operational information, etc.

The TWG will continue to study the airspace planning for the airport cluster in the GBA, optimise the peripheral air routes and airspace structure in the GBA in phases, enhance the efficiency of air traffic flow management in the region through strengthening the sharing of data, leverage the more precise navigation performances of aircraft and application of new technologies to create a more flexible air traffic management mode. The target is to maximise the utilisation of GBA airspace resources to promote the innovation and upgrading of air traffic management in the GBA and maximise the effectiveness of the various airports in the region to develop a world-class airport cluster in the GBA together, proactively aligning with the macro-strategies of the National 15th Five-Year Plan and the Outline Development Plan for the Guangdong-Hong Kong-Macao Greater Bay Area.

2. The Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) is actively enhancing the connection between the Hong Kong International Airport and the Chinese Mainland, as well as consolidating its status as an international aviation hub, pursuing differential development and positive interaction of the airport cluster in the GBA, and enhancing the competitiveness of the national aviation industry in accordance with the Outline Development Plan for the Guangdong-Hong Kong-Macao Greater Bay Area. In this regard, the AAHK and the Zhuhai Transportation Holdings Group signed the Agreement of Shares Acquisition concerning the equity acquisition of Zhuhai Airport in November 2024, which provides a reinforced foundation for deepening the co-operation between the 2 airports. The work is undertaken by the AAHK and does not involve government expenditure.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3292)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding "the work on taking forward initiatives in relation to the development of low-altitude economy (LAE), including the review of existing legislation and regulatory regime, implementation of Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ projects, infrastructural planning, etc." mentioned in the Programme, will the Administration advise on the following

1. What work has been undertaken and what outcomes achieved in the past year regarding the 3 areas mentioned above (i.e. review of legislation, the Regulatory Sandbox and infrastructural planning)?

2. Given that the Mainland has already made regulations to promote the LAE industry, launched air taxi passenger-carrying services and fostered an LAE ecosystem, what are the progress and pace as well as the implementation timetable of Hong Kong in this regard? and

3. What are the manpower and budget allocated by the Administration for the development of LAE in the coming year?

Asked by: Hon FAN Chun-wah, Andrew (LegCo internal reference no.: 41)

Reply:

1. Regarding the review of legislation, the Government has completed the first phase of legislative amendment, to expand the regulatory scope of the existing Small Unmanned Aircraft Order (Cap. 448G) to cover unmanned aircraft weighing between 25 and 150 kg, and to introduce provisions in the Air Navigation (Hong Kong) Order 1995 (Cap. 448C) to permit trial flights of unconventional aircraft under specified conditions. The amended legislation came into effect on 18 July 2025.

Regarding the Regulatory Sandbox, the Government announced the first batch of 38 Regulatory Sandbox projects in March 2025. Currently, 32 of these pilot projects have commenced within designated flight routes. Certain application scenarios that are relatively mature, involve lower risks and do not involve high volumes of people or vehicles in the area

have been regularised (such as the use of unmanned aircraft for façade cleaning, inspection of power lines and railway infrastructure).

The Government rolled out the advanced low-altitude economy (LAE) "Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$" pilot projects in November 2025 to cover unmanned aircraft system traffic management system demonstrations, unconventional aircraft, cross-boundary applications, multiple applications/users shared-platform and other application scenarios that are technically more complex. Application was closed on 28 February 2026. The response from the industry was enthusiastic, with numerous applications received for various application scenarios. The Working Group on Developing Low-altitude Economy (the Working Group) is carefully examining the applications, with the aim of progressively rolling out the pilot projects from the first half of this year.

Regarding infrastructural planning, the Working Group will, among other things, embark on technical studies and planning for low-altitude infrastructure, and draft the Action Plan on Developing Low-altitude Economy this year. The Government will make reference to the experience and data of the Regulatory Sandbox and Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ projects and the relevant technical studies for the formulation of appropriate infrastructure, related supporting facilities as well as standard rules and practices for low-altitude flying activities in the long run. The relevant studies and planning are still underway and the Government will continue to carefully assess the demand for and allocation of relevant resources.

2. The Working Group is actively liaising with the relevant Chinese Mainland authorities and is having discussions on issues such as the planning of cross-boundary air routes and cargo clearance arrangements. The aim is to commence trial flight projects as soon as possible, thereby laying a foundation for establishing a LAE corridor in the Greater Bay Area.

3. The Civil Aviation Department (CAD) has established the following permanent posts to take forward the initiatives in relation to the development of LAE, including the work related to the implementation of Regulatory Sandbox projects:

Rank	**No. of posts**
Senior Operations Officer (Aviation Administration)	1
Operations Officer (Aviation Administration)	1
Operations Officer (Airworthiness)	1
Assistant Operations Officer (Aviation Administration)	1
Senior Electronics Engineer	1
Electronics Engineer/Assistant Electronics Engineer	2
Total:	**7**

The salary provision (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary) for the 7 posts above in 2026-27 is $7.74 million. In addition, the CAD has retained a time-limited post of 1 Administrative Officer Staff Grade B (D3), as well as time-limited posts of 1 Chief Executive Officer and 1 Senior Executive Officer from 2025-26 to 2026-27 to undertake various work related to enhancing Hong Kong's status as an international aviation hub following the

commissioning of the Three-Runway System, supporting the development of LAE in Hong Kong and enhancing the overall administrative governance of the CAD. The salary provision (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary) for the 3 posts above in 2026-27 is $5.8 million. The Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB), on the other hand, has created 3 time-limited posts (1 Senior Engineer, 1 Engineer/Assistant Engineer and 1 Senior Executive Officer) from 2025-26 to 2029-30 to support the enhancement of Hong Kong's status as an international aviation hub and to take forward the development of LAE. The salary provision (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary) for the 3 posts above in 2026-27 is $3.76 million.

Currently, apart from the posts above, the TLB and the CAD will continue to use the existing resources to implement the Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ projects and other relevant work.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2005)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Talent is a crucial factor in supporting the development of Hong Kong as an international aviation hub. The Transport and Logistics Bureau, in collaboration with the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) and the industry, has implemented a number of initiatives to address the manpower shortage in the industry. In this connection, please inform this Committee of the following:

1. The specific situation of the importation of labour under the Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector – Transport Sector in 2025-26;

2. The number of trainees under the co-operation initiatives in civil aviation training provided together with the AAHK and the Civil Aviation Department in 2025-26;

3. The numbers of staff and amounts of expenditure involved in the 2 measures above; and

4. The current situation of the talent gap in the industry, as well as the Bureau's plans and estimated expenditure for addressing the demand for talent in 2026-27.

Asked by: Hon FOK Kai-kong, Kenneth (LegCo internal reference no.: 21)

Reply:

1. to 3. The Government launched the Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector – Aviation Industry (the Scheme) in July 2023 to allow licensees, franchisees or holders of operating permits issued by the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) to apply for labour importation to fill vacancies for frontline non-supervisory jobs under 10 designated job types at the airport, on the premise of safeguarding local workers, with a quota ceiling of 6 300.

After 3 rounds of applications, all 6 300 quotas have been granted, covering all 10 job types under the Scheme. As at January 2026, among the quotas used, a total of 5 373 imported workers have arrived to work in Hong Kong through the Scheme.

Furthermore, the Hong Kong International Aviation Academy (HKIAA) under the AAHK is actively providing aviation training for the aviation industry, with about 90 staff members of the Civil Aviation Department receiving the relevant training in 2025-26.

The administrative work and operation of the 2 initiatives above are undertaken by the AAHK and the HKIAA respectively and do not involve government staffing and expenditure.

4. The Government has been maintaining liaison with the industry, including exchanging views on issues such as manpower demand and talent training. We have also proactively reminded the industry to make good use of various talent admission schemes to recruit suitable talents to meet its development needs.

With regard to attracting outside talents, aircraft maintenance engineers were added to the updated Talent List in March 2025, while aircraft maintenance technicians were added to the Technical Professional List under the General Employment Policy and the Admission Scheme for Mainland Talents and Professionals in June 2025, with a view to addressing the manpower shortage problem in the local aircraft maintenance industry.

Moreover, the Government has been maintaining close liaison and communication with the AAHK and the aviation industry and has taken a series of measures to support the sustainable development of the aviation industry. In this regard, the Government established the Maritime and Aviation Training Fund (MATF) in 2014 and supported the AAHK in establishing the HKIAA in 2016 to promote the professional development of the aviation industry and to attract more young people to join the industry. The Government from time to time examines the training and incentive schemes under the MATF for enhancement, and the HKIAA has been continuously updating, enhancing and expanding its training courses in accordance with industry needs to attract and nurture more aviation talents. The above training work of the HKIAA is undertaken by the AAHK and the HKIAA and does not involve government expenditure. The estimated total expenditure on the aviation-related schemes under the MATF for 2026-27 is around $16.4 million.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB107**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2006)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat: Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

In the face of global competition, Hong Kong's status as an international aviation hub faces certain challenges. To consolidate Hong Kong's status, it is vital to increase the number of flight routes. In this connection, please inform this Committee of the following:

1. What is the number of flight routes increased after the establishment of new air services agreements with different countries or regions worldwide in 2025-26?

2. What are the number of staff and the amount of expenditure involved in the above work? and

3. What are the Administration's plans for further liberalising Hong Kong's air services regime with aviation partners in 2026-27, the estimated number of additional flight routes and the amount of expenditure required?

Asked by: Hon FOK Kai-kong, Kenneth (LegCo internal reference no.: 22)

Reply:

As at 2025, we have signed 86 bilateral air services documents covering more than 700 destinations worldwide. In 2025, we updated/ expanded bilateral air services arrangements with a number of aviation partners, and reached consensus with Chile, Peru, Poland, Togo, Argentina, Ecuador and Cuba on the establishment of new air services agreements. The Government will continue to actively participate in international civil aviation conferences and take the initiative to visit aviation partners, targeting to explore with 10 or more aviation partners within 2026 the enhancement of air connectivity (including discussing the establishment of new air services agreements or the expansion of traffic rights), with priority focus on regions with further development potential and new growth areas, such as South America, Central Asia, Africa and the Middle East, so as to support the Hong Kong International Airport to further expand its aviation network. The relevant work is undertaken by the existing staff.

The Government has been, in conjunction with the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK), strategically attracting local and non-local airlines to develop new destinations and increase flights through outreach efforts, incentive schemes and policy facilitation measures. For example, the AAHK launched the Air Network Development Programme (the Programme) in June 2024, which provides financial incentives to encourage airlines to open new routes and increase flight frequencies on the existing routes. To date, the Programme has attracted 36 airlines to open 82 new routes and increase flight frequencies on 14 existing routes. The expenditure for the Programme above is borne by the AAHK and does not involve government expenditure.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0187)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

According to surveys, the local vessel trade is facing an ageing workforce, with many coxswains aged over 60. Besides, there is a keen demand for chief engineers, sailors, etc. in the trade. Regarding the manpower problem of the local vessel trade, please advise on the following:

(a) The Transport and Logistics Bureau launched the Maritime and Aviation Training Fund (MATF) on 1 April 2014 to support manpower training for the industries. What are the details of financial assistance, annual expenditure and number of beneficiaries of each of the schemes under the MATF in the past 3 years? and

(b) To enhance Hong Kong's status as an international maritime centre, what measures will the Government implement in future to ensure the supply of the relevant talents? What is the budget for the work?

Asked by: Hon HO Chun-yin, Steven (LegCo internal reference no.: 7)

Reply:

(a) The Maritime and Aviation Training Fund (MATF) came into operation on 1 April 2014. The aim of the MATF is to build up in due course a vibrant, diversified and competitive pool of professionals and technical personnel to sustain and enhance the Government's support for the manpower development and promotion of the maritime, aviation and logistics industries, as well as to support the long-term development of the relevant industries. The number of beneficiaries and the amount of subsidy of each of the schemes under the MATF in the past 3 years are set out at the **Annex**.

(b) In 2026-27, the estimated cash flow requirement for the MATF is $47.5 million, with the target recipients, training content and estimated number of beneficiaries broadly similar to those in 2025-26. In addition to enhancing the existing schemes and introducing new measures, the MATF will also strengthen the support for manpower training, facilitate the industry to develop various high-end and high value-added sectors, and encourage the

industry to collaborate with tertiary institutions and professional organisations, leveraging the industry's knowledge and experience in the local maritime industry chain to promote the integration of new knowledge with local maritime development, to provide young people with the professional skills and practical knowledge required by the industry and attract more young people to join the industry. We will continue to work closely with the industry and the relevant institutions, with a view to formulating more comprehensive and diversified training initiatives and thereby enhancing the competitiveness of local maritime talents. In addition, through the Talent List and the Technical Professional List under the General Employment Policy, the Admission Scheme for Mainland Talents and Professionals and the Quality Migrant Admission Scheme, sufficient supply of the relevant talents to the industry can also be ensured.

Annex

Name of programme	2023-24		2024-25		2025-26 (as at the end of February 2026)	
	No. of beneficiaries	**Amount of subsidy ($'000)**	**No. of beneficiaries**	**Amount of subsidy ($'000)**	**No. of beneficiaries**	**Amount of subsidy ($'000)**
1. Professional Training and Examination Refund Scheme	1 529	5,750	1 399	5,230	1 189	4,350
2. Professional Training on Smart and Green Logistics Scheme	N/A	N/A	14	90	61	370
3. Sea-going Training Incentive Scheme %	28	4,054	23	4,510	17	3,400
4. Local Vessel Trade Training Incentive Scheme	4	329	7	210	17	220
5. Local Vessel Competency Enhancement Scheme	100	1,254	223	2,840	264	3,310
6. Ship Repair Training Incentive Scheme %	1	200	0	90	3	20^{+}
7. Partial Tuition Refund Scheme for the Specialised Aircraft Maintenance Programme	10	580	9	320	3	330
8. Aviation Operations Training Incentive Scheme	53	1,090	37	340	/ ^	/ ^
9. Maritime Services Traineeship Scheme – Legal %	4	327	4	1,070	5	1,130

Name of programme	2023-24		2024-25		2025-26 (as at the end of February 2026)	
	No. of beneficiaries	Amount of subsidy ($'000)	No. of beneficiaries	Amount of subsidy ($'000)	No. of beneficiaries	Amount of subsidy ($'000)
10. Maritime Services Traineeship Scheme – Marine Insurance	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	@	@
11. Maritime and Aviation Internship Scheme	399	5,434	515	7,250	481	7,350
12. Internship Scheme on Modern Logistics[#]	60	960	67	1,080	58	910
13. Maritime Training Support Scheme [c]	0	1,966	24	2,540	39	2,800
14. Overseas Exchange Scholarship Scheme	11	330	9	270	2	120
15. Hong Kong Nautical and Maritime Scholarship Scheme	3	384	5	480	2	420
16. Hong Kong Maritime and Logistics Scholarship Scheme	8	1,885	10	2,498	10	2,650
17. The University of Hong Kong – Dalian Maritime University Academic Collaboration Scheme	85	744	63	211	64	1,790

Name of programme	2023-24		2024-25		2025-26 (as at the end of February 2026)	
	No. of beneficiaries	Amount of subsidy ($'000)	No. of beneficiaries	Amount of subsidy ($'000)	No. of beneficiaries	Amount of subsidy ($'000)
18. The University of Hong Kong – Shanghai Maritime University Academic Collaboration Scheme	1	222	0	-	0	-
19. Hong Kong Aviation Scholarship Scheme	22	1,470	34	2,840	/ ^	/ ^
20. Maritime Promotion Project Funding	14 324 *	1,355	10 599 *	1,856	6 509 **	1,124
21. Aviation Promotion Project Funding Scheme	173 *	60	1 600 *	530	506 *	110
22. Logistics Promotion Funding Scheme	N/A	N/A	550 *	3,880	1 904 *	2,386

^ The subsidy is generally granted in the first quarter of each year. This year's applications for the subsidies are still undergoing the approval process, and therefore the relevant information is not available.

* The figures refer to the number of participants in the promotional activities.

** The figures only include the number of participants recorded in the statistics of the promotional activities.

It was formerly known as the Summer Internship Scheme on Supply Chain Management.

% The schemes have a subsidy period of more than 1 year. The number of beneficiaries refers to the number of new participants joining the schemes each year, while the amount of subsidy refers to the total amount of subsidy granted in that year. No applications were received for the Ship Repair Training Incentive Scheme in 2024-25.

+ Part of the subsidy will be granted after 31 March 2026.

@ The scheme was launched in November 2025, and therefore information on the number of beneficiaries and the amount of subsidy is not available.

c The scheme was launched in the 2021/22 school year to subsidise the Hong Kong Sea School to deliver a school-based Maritime Studies curriculum and thereby nurturing and attracting talents. The first batch of students graduated in 2024, and therefore the number of beneficiaries is not available for 2023-24.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1055)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

How will the authorities ensure the reconstruction and operational commencement of the AsiaWorld-Expo Phase 2 of SKYTOPIA in a timely manner? How will the second phase of the airport integrate with the surrounding hotels, retail businesses and commercial facilities to enhance the vitality of the Airport City?

Asked by: Hon KONG Man-wai, Vivian (LegCo internal reference no.: 34)

Reply:

The Airport Authority Hong Kong continues to actively take forward various projects to develop Airport City SKYTOPIA. Among them, the construction of AsiaWorld-Expo Phase 2 was commenced in 2025 and is expected to be completed in 2028.

Furthermore, to cope with the increasing number of passengers since the commissioning of the Three-Runway System, the expanded Terminal 2 of the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA) has commenced operations in phases starting from September 2025. Among the facilities, the Coach Hall commenced operations in September 2025, while the passenger departure facilities are scheduled to commence operations in May 2026. There will be a footbridge at the Departure Hall connecting to surrounding hotels, retail businesses and commercial facilities. Separately, the autonomous transport system connecting the HKIA and the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge Hong Kong Port is scheduled for operation this year. The flow of people between the various facilities and their synergies will then be further enhanced.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1056)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

What amount of resources will the authorities allocate to the yacht bay project? When will it be open to use? How will it align with the latest policies for the local tourism industry (high value-added overnight visitors, Meetings, Incentives, Conventions and Exhibitions tourism, etc.)?

Asked by: Hon KONG Man-wai, Vivian (LegCo internal reference no.: 35)

Reply:

The Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) continues to actively take forward various projects to develop Airport City SKYTOPIA. Among them, the yacht bay project will provide more than 500 berths, including berths that can accommodate superyachts over 80 metres in length, together with ancillary facilities and water recreation areas. The provision of various yacht tourism amenities is expected to attract high value-added visitors. The AAHK will invite expressions of interest for the development of the yacht bay and its ancillary facilities in 2026, with phased completion expected starting from 2028. The project is undertaken by the AAHK and does not involve government expenditure.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB111**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1057)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat: Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Since the launch of the direct passenger service from Zhuhai to Hong Kong for passengers taking flights at the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA), over 100 000 passenger trips have been made. Will the authorities consider extending the Zhuhai – HKIA direct mode to other major cities in the Greater Bay Area (GBA) so as to establish an airport transfer service network covering the Pearl River Delta? If other cities in the GBA are added as new service points, what is the estimated amount of resources to be allocated?

Asked by: Hon KONG Man-wai, Vivian (LegCo internal reference no.: 36)

Reply:

The Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) is committed to developing intermodal transport networks so as to enhance the convenience for the transport of passengers and goods in the Guangdong-Hong Kong-Macao Greater Bay Area (GBA) to and from all parts of the world via Hong Kong. Regarding passenger services, the AAHK started to provide transfer coach services between the SkyPier Terminal and the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (HZMB) Macao Port and Zhuhai Port in August and December 2023 respectively, and in parallel launched the "Fly-Via-Zhuhai-HK" direct passenger service in December 2023 to facilitate transit passengers from the Mainland and Macao to go to the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA) via the HZMB for onward flights to overseas destinations, and vice versa. Since the launch of the "Fly-Via-Zhuhai-HK" direct passenger service, over 100 000 passenger trips have been made. The AAHK will continue to step up promotion while further enhancing the connectivity between the Zhuhai Airport and the HKIA to encourage more passengers using the service.

Furthermore, the AAHK operates ferry services between 9 ports[1] in the GBA and the SkyPier Terminal of the HKIA, and has set up close to 40 city terminals at strategic locations in the GBA for passengers to check in in advance.

[1] Namely Shekou and Fuyong in Shenzhen, Humen in Dongguan, Nansha and Pazhou in Guangzhou, Zhongshan, Jiuzhou in Zhuhai, as well as Maritime Ferry Terminal and Taipa in Macao.

Meanwhile, the AAHK launched the “Park & Fly” service at the automated car park on the Hong Kong Port Island in November 2025 for non-commercial private cars from Guangdong and Macao to come to Hong Kong via the HZMB for onward flights.

The services above are undertaken by the AAHK and do not involve government expenditure.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB112**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2320)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat: Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

During 2026-27, the Transport and Logistics Bureau will continue to work with the Airport Authority Hong Kong on initiatives to enhance airport services, and the airport's connectivity and competitiveness. Please inform this Committee of the measures in place to further attract more airlines to set up their base in Hong Kong and encourage existing airlines to launch more new routes plying to and from Hong Kong. What are the resources and expenditures involved in such measures (if any)?

Asked by: Hon KONG Man-wai, Vivian (LegCo internal reference no.: 37)

Reply:

The Government will continue to actively participate in international civil aviation conferences and take the initiative to visit aviation partners, targeting to explore with 10 or more aviation partners within 2026 the enhancement of air connectivity (including discussing the establishment of new air services agreements or the expansion of traffic rights), with priority focus on regions with further development potential and new growth areas, such as South America, Central Asia, Africa and the Middle East, so as to support the Hong Kong International Airport to further expand its aviation network. The relevant work is undertaken by the existing staff.

Meanwhile, the Government has been, in conjunction with the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK), strategically attracting local and non-local airlines to develop new destinations and increase flights through outreach efforts, incentive schemes and policy facilitation measures. For example, the AAHK launched the Air Network Development Programme (the Programme) in June 2024, which provides financial incentives to encourage airlines to open new routes and increase flight frequencies on the existing routes. To date, the Programme has attracted 36 airlines to open 82 new routes and increase flight frequencies on 14 existing routes. The expenditure for the Programme above is borne by the AAHK and does not involve government expenditure.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB113**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0724)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in paragraph 150 of the Budget that the relevant legislation will be amended within this year to extend the current arrangements under the Air Transhipment Cargo Exemption Scheme to other sea transhipment and sea-air transhipment modes. Please advise on the following:

1. What are the legislative timetable and specific arrangements, and how do they differ from the existing air transhipment arrangements? and

2. Have arrangements been already made with specific Mainland piers? Apart from the intermodal pier of the Hong Kong International Airport Dongguan Logistics Park, what other piers will also be included?

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 5)

Reply:

To enhance Hong Kong's competitiveness as an international aviation hub, an international maritime centre and an international logistics hub, the Chief Executive announced in the 2024 Policy Address that the Government will examine the extension of the arrangements under the Air Transhipment Cargo Exemption Scheme (the Scheme) to other intermodal cargo-transhipment modes. Following study with other departments, the Transport and Logistics Bureau is exploring the possibility of extending, on the premise of minimising the risk of illegal leakage of the relevant cargoes into the local market, the arrangements under the Scheme currently applicable to the air-to-air transhipment mode to sea-to-sea transhipment and sea-to-air/air-to-sea transhipment modes.

Regarding sea-to-air/air-to-sea transhipment, the relevant exemption arrangements are only applicable to cargoes transported by sea to and from the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA). Under this mode, cargoes will go through security screening, palletisation and cargo acceptance in advance in the HKIA Dongguan Logistics Park set up by the Airport

Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) in Dongguan. They will then be transported by barges equipped with full-time surveillance functions to the airside of the HKIA and unloaded at a pier approved by the AAHK and installed with specified screening facilities for direct transhipment to overseas destinations by air, and vice versa. Given that the relevant arrangements are similar to the existing air transhipment arrangements, the risk of illegal leakage of the relevant cargoes into the local market is very low.

As for the sea-to-sea transhipment mode, cargoes carried by ocean-going vessels arriving in Hong Kong must be stored in designated secure yards during transhipment at the Kwai Tsing Container Terminals. These yards are subject to strict security requirements, such as the installation of 24-hour closed-circuit television surveillance systems equipped with artificial intelligence detection functions, access to the yards restricted only to qualified and pre-registered personnel, etc., so as to ensure the integrity of the cargoes during transhipment and minimise the risk of illegal leakage of the cargoes into the local market. Given that there are no designated loading or unloading ports for cargoes transported through the sea-to-sea transhipment mode, it is not necessary to make specific arrangements with any Chinese Mainland terminals.

The Government aims to introduce a bill into the Legislative Council within this year to extend the relevant arrangements to sea-to-sea transhipment and sea-to-air/air-to-sea transhipment modes.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0760)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the promotion of digitalisation in the logistics industry, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) Given that the Administration has indicated that $30 million will be earmarked for launching the Future Innovative Logistics Acceleration Scheme (FILAS), what are the implementation details of the scheme?

(2) Given that the Administration has launched the Pilot Subsidy Scheme for Third-party Logistics Service Providers (the Pilot Scheme) to encourage the logistics industry to enhance efficiency through the application of technology, what are the major differences between the aforementioned FILAS and the Pilot Scheme in terms of promoting the digitalisation of logistics enterprises?

(3) Since the launch of the Pilot Scheme, how many applications have been received, approved and rejected respectively so far? What are the main reasons for rejection and the average processing time for each approved application? What are the main technology application projects involved in and the amount of funding for each approved application? and

(4) Has the effectiveness of the Pilot Scheme been assessed? If so, what are the details?

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 7)

Reply:

With the launch of logistics data platforms by the Government and public organisations, the Government will launch the Future Innovative Logistics Acceleration Scheme (FILAS) this year to provide funding for the industry to develop IT onboarding solutions that are compatible with the logistics data platforms operated by the Government or public organisations, so as to facilitate the adoption of the relevant data platforms by the industry, drive the transformation of the industry and enhance the interconnectivity of logistics data,

with a view to enhancing the competitiveness of Hong Kong's logistics industry, and further developing Hong Kong into an international smart logistics hub.

FILAS will be established under the Pilot Subsidy Scheme for Third-party Logistics Service Providers (the Pilot Scheme) to provide subsidies specifically for logistics data platform IT onboarding solutions. The scope of subsidy under the Pilot Scheme covers various solutions related to smart and green logistics. After the launch of FILAS, logistics enterprises can continue to apply for subsidies under the Pilot Scheme as the 2 schemes work in parallel without conflict. The Government is working out the details of FILAS with reference to the Pilot Scheme and will announce the details in due course.

As for the Pilot Scheme, from its launch in October 2020 to February 2026, a total of 514 applications were received, with 307 applications approved, involving subsidies of about $188.3 million. The approved projects mainly cover 4 major areas, namely (1) logistics operation management systems, such as the systems for fleet management, transport management, freight management, warehouse and yard management, order fulfilment management, etc.; (2) enterprise and data management systems, such as enterprise resource planning and electronic data exchange systems; (3) application of artificial intelligence (AI) and data analytics, such as automation robotics, AI and Internet of Things technology; and (4) cargo identification and inspection equipment, such as X-ray screening equipment and Explosive Trace Detection equipment related to the establishment of Regulated Air Cargo Screening Facilities, Radio Frequency Identification systems, and cargo volume and weight measurement systems.

Since the launch of the Pilot Scheme, a total of 11 applications have been rejected so far. The main reason is that the applicant enterprises fail to meet the eligibility criteria for the scheme, such as that they fail to prove that they have substantive business operations in Hong Kong or that their business is not related to either inbound or outbound logistics services. As for the processing time for each application, it varies depending on the completeness and clarity of the information submitted by the applicant enterprises.

To assess the effectiveness of the Pilot Scheme, the secretariat invites subsidised enterprises to complete questionnaires after the completion of projects. The findings of the survey show that technology application has helped enhance enterprises' operational efficiency and service quality, effectively reduced manpower and operating costs, as well as boosted the overall business volume.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0767)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the frontline manpower of the aviation industry, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) It is noted that the quota of 6 300 imported workers under the Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector – Aviation Industry (the Scheme) has all been approved in its 3 rounds of applications. What are the number of imported workers approved who have arrived to work in Hong Kong and the breakdown by work type?

(2) Given the feedback that there is still manpower shortage of frontline staff in the aviation industry and upon the commissioning of Terminal 2 of the Hong Kong International Airport in future, manpower demand for airport frontline staff will increase gradually, will the Administration consider increasing the quota of imported workers under the Scheme and launch a new round of applications?

(3) Will the Administration explore enhancing the operation of the Scheme, including relaxing the existing manning ratio requirement of 2:1 of full-time local staff and imported labour and covering more job types for labour importation? and

(4) Has the Administration considered implementing more measures to attract and train more local talents to join the aviation industry so as to alleviate its manpower shortage?

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 20)

Reply:

(1) The Government launched the Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector – Aviation Industry (the Scheme) in July 2023 to allow licensees, franchisees or holders of operating permits issued by the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) to apply for labour importation to fill vacancies for frontline non-supervisory jobs under 10 designated job types at the airport, on the premise of safeguarding the employment of local workers, with a quota ceiling of 6 300.

After 3 rounds of applications, all 6 300 quotas have been granted, covering all 10 job types under the Scheme. As at January 2026, among the quotas used, a total of 5 373 imported workers have arrived to work in Hong Kong through the Scheme. Please refer to the table below for details.

Job type	No. of workers having arrived to work in Hong Kong
1. Passenger Services Officer	1 716
2. Ramp Services Agent	948
3. Cabin Worker	890
4. Aircraft Maintenance Mechanic/ Technician	52
5. Tractor Driver	495
6. Warehouse Operator/Cargo Hander	289
7. Equipment/Loader Operator	420
8. Customer Services Agent	263
9. Aircraft Tug Driver	42
10. Maintenance Technician	258
Total	**5 373**

(2) to (4) To ensure that the aviation industry has sufficient manpower, the AAHK and the airport community will continue to conduct local recruitment activities to promote the development prospects and employment opportunities of the aviation industry. They will also actively enhance the working environment and welfare of practitioners to retain talent. To reduce the manpower pressure in the long term, the AAHK implements technology and smart techniques in airport services. The relevant work does not involve government expenditure.

Moreover, the Government has been maintaining close liaison and communication with the AAHK and the aviation industry, and has taken a series of measures to support the sustainable development of the aviation industry. In this regard, the Government established the Maritime and Aviation Training Fund (MATF) in 2014 and supported the AAHK in establishing the Hong Kong International Aviation Academy (HKIAA) in 2016 to promote the professional development of the aviation industry and to attract more young people to join the industry. The Government from time to time examines the training and incentive schemes under the MATF for enhancement, and the HKIAA has been continuously updating,

enhancing and expanding its training courses in accordance with industry needs to attract and nurture more aviation talents.

The Government will take into account a number of relevant factors, such as the findings of the latest round of the airport manpower survey conducted by the AAHK, the latest situation in the local labour market, the implementation status of the Scheme, the stakeholders' views on the Scheme, in considering the way forward of the Scheme.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0771)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the Maritime and Aviation Training Fund (MATF), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) What are the numbers of (i) applications, (ii) approved cases and (iii) rejected cases in respect of the schemes for the (a) maritime, (b) aviation and (c) logistics sectors under the MATF in each of the past 5 years; as well as the main reasons for rejecting the applications and the average processing time for each approved case?

(2) For the approved cases mentioned in (1), what are the number of beneficiaries (with a breakdown of the number of in-service practitioners or students) and the amount of subsidies involved, broken down by scheme?

(3) As it is noted that some MATF schemes require beneficiaries to serve in the sectors concerned for at least 1 year upon graduation, are there any statistics on the number of students who received scholarships or allowances under the schemes mentioned in (1) have continued to stay in the sectors concerned after fulfilling the above requirement? If so, what are the details? and

(4) Has the Government assessed the cash flow requirement for the MATF for 2026-27 and the estimated number of beneficiaries for each scheme? If so, what are the details?

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 25)

Reply:

(1) & (2) The Maritime and Aviation Training Fund (MATF) came into operation on 1 April 2014, with 15 incentive schemes and a commitment of $100 million, aiming to continue and expand the various maritime- and aviation-related schemes and scholarships included in the MATF at the time, and to launch new initiatives to support the manpower training in the relevant industries. Following an injection of $200 million from the Government in 2019, the total commitment for the MATF has increased to $300 million for sustaining and

enhancing the operation of the MATF as well as optimising its incentive schemes, so as to provide continued support for talent development in Hong Kong's maritime and aviation industries.

Subsequently, the MATF received an additional injection of $200 million from the Government in 2023, with the total commitment increased to $500 million. Apart from continuously optimising the incentive and promotion schemes, the MATF has also enhanced talent training in the logistics industry and launched a new Maritime Services Traineeship Scheme (the Traineeship Scheme), which aims to incentivise participating companies to provide traineeship for young people who aspire to a career in maritime law. Meanwhile, local, Chinese Mainland and overseas promotion in respect of Hong Kong's advantages as an international maritime centre as well as an aviation and logistics hub was also stepped up with the injection. The scope of funding under the MATF continued to expand in 2025. Apart from extending the Traineeship Scheme to marine insurance, the coverage of promotion activities was also expanded to include local seminars, meetings, workshops and overseas professional exchange activities.

The number of applications, the number of beneficiaries and the amount of subsidies of the maritime-, aviation- and logistics-related schemes under the MATF in the past 5 years are set out at the **Annex**. Generally speaking, all applications are processed in accordance with the established procedures, and the main reasons for rejection include applicants failing to meet the eligibility criteria, insufficient or incorrect information submitted, late applications, etc. Processing times for applications may vary considerably with different schemes.

(3) Some schemes under the MATF, such as the Hong Kong Maritime and Logistics Scholarship Scheme, the Maritime Services Traineeship Scheme – Legal and the Hong Kong Aviation Scholarship Scheme, require recipients of the scholarship or training subsidy to undertake to work in the local maritime or aviation industry for a specified period after completing their studies or training; otherwise, they will be required to repay the scholarship or subsidy received to the Government in accordance with the relevant terms and conditions. Take the Maritime Services Traineeship Scheme – Legal as an example, according to the information provided by the applicant organisations, most of the subsidy recipients continue their career in maritime law locally after completing the relevant training.

(4) In 2026-27, the estimated cash flow requirement for the MATF is $47.5 million, with the target recipients, training content and estimated number of beneficiaries broadly similar to those in 2025-26.

Annex

Name of programme	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26 (as at the end of February 2026)
	(a) No. of applications (b) No. of beneficiaries (c) Amount of subsidy ($'000)	**(a) No. of applications (b) No. of beneficiaries (c) Amount of subsidy ($'000)**	**(a) No. of applications (b) No. of beneficiaries (c) Amount of subsidy ($'000)**	**(a) No. of applications (b) No. of beneficiaries (c) Amount of subsidy ($'000)**	**(a) No. of applications (b) No. of beneficiaries (c) Amount of subsidy ($'000)**
(A) Maritime					
(I) Provision of subsidy to in-service practitioners in the industry					
1. Professional Training and Examination Refund Scheme (Maritime)	(a) 1 350 (b) 1 060 (c) 2,853	(a) 922 (b) 799 (c) 2,358	(a) 1 014 (b) 1 022 (c) 3,172	(a) 968 (b) 836 (c) 2,510	(a) 771 (b) 556 (c) 1,790
2. Sea-going Training Incentive Scheme %	(a) 20 (b) 20 (c) 2,704	(a) 40 (b) 40 (c) 4,002	(a) 28 (b) 28 (c) 4,054	(a) 23 (b) 23 (c) 4,510	(a) 17 (b) 17 (c) 3,400
3. Local Vessel Trade Training Incentive Scheme	(a) 35 (b) 33 (c) 660	(a) 21 (b) 21 (c) 692	(a) 5 (b) 4 (c) 329	(a) 7 (b) 7 (c) 210	(a) 20 (b) 17 (c) 220
4. Local Vessel Competency Enhancement Scheme	(a) 61 (b) 67 (c) 804	(a) 93 (b) 84 (c) 1,008	(a) 108 (b) 100 (c) 1,254	(a) 245 (b) 223 (c) 2,840	(a) 252 (b) 264 (c) 3,310
5. Ship Repair Training Incentive Scheme %	(a) 9 (b) 10 (c) 690	(a) 0 (b) 2 (c) 560	(a) 0 (b) 1 (c) 200	(a) 0 (b) 0 (c) 90	(a) 3 (b) 3 (c) 20^{+}
6. Maritime Services Traineeship Scheme – Legal %	N/A	N/A	(a) 6 (b) 4 (c) 327	(a) 4 (b) 4 (c) 1,070	(a) 1 (b) 5 (c) 1,130
7. Maritime Services Traineeship Scheme – Marine Insurance	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	(a) 3 (b) @ (c) @
(II) Provision of subsidy to students					
8. Maritime and Aviation Internship Scheme (Maritime)	(a) 201 (b) 196 (c) 2,950	(a) 214 (b) 206 (c) 3,350	(a) 150 (b) 135 (c) 2,260	(a) 157 (b) 154 (c) 2,300	(a) 144 (b) 133 (c) 2,130

Name of programme	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26 (as at the end of February 2026)
	(a) No. of applications (b) No. of beneficiaries (c) Amount of subsidy ($'000)	**(a) No. of applications (b) No. of beneficiaries (c) Amount of subsidy ($'000)**	**(a) No. of applications (b) No. of beneficiaries (c) Amount of subsidy ($'000)**	**(a) No. of applications (b) No. of beneficiaries (c) Amount of subsidy ($'000)**	**(a) No. of applications (b) No. of beneficiaries (c) Amount of subsidy ($'000)**
9. Maritime Training Support Scheme [c]	N/A	(a) N/A (b) 0 (c) 2,480	(a) N/A (b) 0 (c) 1,966	(a) N/A (b) 24 (c) 2,540	(a) N/A (b) 39 (c) 2,800
10. Overseas Exchange Scholarship Scheme	(a) 0 (b) 0 (c) 0	(a) 4 (b) 4 (c) 60	(a) 11 (b) 11 (c) 330	(a) 9 (b) 9 (c) 270	(a) 2 (b) 2 (c) 120
11. Hong Kong Nautical and Maritime Scholarship Scheme	(a) 3 (b) 3 (c) 553	(a) 2 (b) 2 (c) 271	(a) 3 (b) 3 (c) 384	(a) 5 (b) 5 (c) 480	(a) 2 (b) 2 (c) 420
12. Hong Kong Maritime and Logistics Scholarship Scheme	(a) 13 (b) 5 (c) 804	(a) 10 (b) 9 (c) 2,072	(a) 15 (b) 8 (c) 1,885	(a) 18 (b) 10 (c) 2,498	(a) 16 (b) 10 (c) 2,650
13. The University of Hong Kong – Dalian Maritime University Academic Collaboration Scheme	(a) 46 (b) 44 (c) 642	(a) 70 (b) 69 (c) 469	(a) 87 (b) 85 (c) 744	(a) 64 (b) 63 (c) 211	(a) 64 (b) 64 (c) 1,790
14. The University of Hong Kong – Shanghai Maritime University Academic Collaboration Scheme	(a) 2 (b) 1 (c) 193	(a) 4 (b) 2 (c) 402	(a) 2 (b) 1 (c) 222	(a) 1 (b) 0 (c) -	(a) 1 (b) 0 (c) -
(III) Provision of subsidy to the relevant organisations or professional bodies for organising promotional activities					
15. Maritime Promotion Project Funding	(a) 5 (b) 10 252* (c) 675	(a) 5 (b)15 693* (c) 881	(a) 7 (b) 14 324* (c) 1,355	(a) 10 (b) 10 599* (c) 1,856	(a) 10 (b) 6 509** (c) 1,124

(B) Aviation					
(I) Provision of subsidy to in-service practitioners in the industry					
16. Professional Training and Examination Refund Scheme (Aviation)	(a) 686 (b) 581 (c) 2,000	(a) 840 (b) 730 (c) 2,800	(a) 595 (b) 507 (c) 2,580	(a) 721 (b) 563 (c) 2,720	(a) 734 (b) 633 (c) 2,560
(II) Provision of subsidy to students					
17. Maritime and Aviation Internship Scheme (Aviation)	(a) 163 (b) 162 (c) 1,920	(a) 284 (b) 276 (c) 3,550	(a) 264 (b) 264 (c) 3,180	(a) 367 (b) 361 (c) 4,950	(a) 349 (b) 348 (c) 5,220
18. Partial Tuition Refund Scheme for the Specialised Aircraft Maintenance Programme	(a) 45 (b) 43 (c) 1,130	(a) 13 (b) 13 (c) 820	(a) 10 (b) 10 (c) 580	(a) 10 (b) 9 (c) 320	(a) 3 (b) 3 (c) 330
19. Hong Kong Aviation Scholarship Scheme	(a) 23 (b) 23 (c) 2,110	(a) 28 (b) 28 (c) 2,420	(a) 22 (b) 22 (c) 1,470	(a) 34 (b) 34 (c) 2,840	(a) / ^ (b) / ^ (c) / ^
20. Aviation Operations Training Incentive Scheme	(a) 21 (b) 21 (c) 310	(a) 36 (b) 36 (c) 500	(a) 53 (b) 53 (c) 1,090	(a) 37 (b) 37 (c) 340	(a) / ^ (b) / ^ (c) / ^
(III) Provision of subsidy to the relevant organisations or professional bodies for organising promotional activities					
21. Aviation Promotion Project Funding Scheme	N/A	N/A	(a) 1 (b) 173* (c) 60	(a) 4 (b) 1 600* (c) 530	(a) 1 (b) 506* (c) 110
(C) Logistics					
(I) Provision of subsidy to in-service practitioners in the industry					
22. Professional Training on Smart and Green Logistics Scheme	N/A	N/A	N/A	(a) 16 (b) 14 (c) 90	(a) 74 (b) 61 (c) 370
(II) Provision of subsidy to students					
23. Internship Scheme on Modern Logistics #	N/A	N/A	(a) 60 (b) 60 (c) 960	(a) 67 (b) 67 (c) 1,080	(a) 58 (b) 58 (c) 910

(III) Provision of subsidy to the relevant organisations or professional bodies for organising promotional activities					
24. Logistics Promotion Funding Scheme	N/A	N/A	N/A	(a) 8 (b) 550* (c) 3,880	(a) 11 (b) 1 904* (c) 2,386

^ The subsidy is granted in the first quarter of each year. This year's applications for the subsidies are still undergoing the approval process, and therefore the relevant information is not available.

* The figures refer to the number of participants in the promotional activities.

** The figures only include the number of participants recorded in the statistics of the promotional activities.

It was formerly known as the Summer Internship Scheme on Supply Chain Management.

% The schemes have a subsidy period of more than 1 year. The number of beneficiaries refers to the number of new participants joining the schemes each year, while the amount of subsidy refers to the total amount of subsidy granted in that year. No applications were received for the Ship Repair Training Incentive Scheme in 2024-25.

\+ Part of the subsidy will be granted after 31 March 2026.

@ The scheme was launched in November 2025, and therefore information on the number of beneficiaries and the amount of subsidy is not available.

c The scheme was launched in the 2021/22 school year to subsidise the Hong Kong Sea School to deliver a school-based Maritime Studies curriculum and thereby nurturing and attracting talents. The first batch of students graduated in 2024, and therefore the number of beneficiaries is not available for 2022-23 and 2023-24.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0962)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding Item 6885TH under the Capital Works Reserve Fund: Route 11 (section between Yuen Long and North Lantau) – investigation study with an approved project estimate of over $319 million, please advise on the following:

1. What is the expenditure allocation for the revised estimate of over $24 million in 2025-26 and what are the expenditure arrangements for the estimate of $44.89 million in 2026-27?

2. Comparing with the actual expenditure up to the end of the 2025 financial year, what are the reasons for the decrease in expenditures on the investigation in the last 2 years and is it necessary to increase the budget for the investigation? and

3. Have all the investigation and design works been completed for the main project of the Route – the Tsing Lung Bridge? Will investments be required in the 2026-27 financial year?

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 34)

Reply:

1. The expenditure under works project 6885TH is mainly used for the investigation and preliminary design of Route 11 (section between Yuen Long and North Lantau) (Route 11), as well as the associated site investigations and works supervision. The allocation of estimated expenditures for the relevant works project in 2025-26 and 2026-27 is tabulated below:

	Estimated expenditure in 2025-26 ($ million)	Estimated expenditure in 2026-27 ($ million)
Investigation and preliminary design	14.28	44.75
Site investigations and works supervision	9.85	0.14
Total	**24.13**	**44.89**

2. The investigation study for Route 11 commenced in September 2021 and was largely completed in 2025-26. As such, the relevant budget for 2025-26 and 2026-27 is lower. Currently, the approved project estimate for the investigation study of Route 11 is sufficient to cover the work in future and there is no need to increase the budget.

3. The site investigation for the Tsing Lung Bridge is completed. The Highways Department is enhancing the preliminary design of the Tsing Lung Bridge based on the findings of the site investigation, and will continue to allocate resources to take forward the work related to the Tsing Lung Bridge in 2026-27, aiming for commissioning by 2033 or earlier.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2336)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the work to promote the development of low-altitude economy (LAE), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) Given that the Administration announced the first cohort of the LAE Regulatory Sandbox projects in March last year, please provide the following information on each project that has been put into real-world application: the applicant organisation, application scenario, location and preliminary results;

(2) Given that the Administration has indicated that it will examine regularising the operation of more mature application scenarios of the first cohort of the Regulatory Sandbox projects, what are the progress and details of the relevant work?

(3) Given that the Hong Kong Special Administrative Region Government has indicated that it is actively exploring with the Mainland to commence trial flights on cross-boundary low-altitude logistics, what are the details and timetable of the relevant work? and

(4) What measures are in place to enhance the training of LAE-related talents in Hong Kong?

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 12)

Reply:

(1) & (2) The Government announced the first batch of 38 Regulatory Sandbox projects in March 2025. Currently, 32 of these pilot projects have commenced within designated flight routes. Certain application scenarios that are relatively mature, involve lower risks and do not involve high volumes of people or vehicles in the area have been regularised (such as the use of unmanned aircraft for façade cleaning, inspection of power lines and railway infrastructure). Details of the projects (including the applicants, the scope of the projects, application scenarios and contents, as well as the progress/results of the trials) are set out at the **Annex**.

(3) The Working Group is actively liaising with the relevant Chinese Mainland authorities and is having discussions on issues such as the planning of cross-boundary air routes and cargo clearance arrangements. The aim is to commence trial flight projects as soon as possible, thereby laying a foundation for establishing a low-altitude economy (LAE) corridor in the Greater Bay Area.

(4) The development of LAE requires talent in various fields, including those engaging in industries such as Innovation and Technology (I&T). In respect of I&T talent, the Government has been adopting a multi-pronged approach to enlarging the local I&T talent pool. For example, regarding the nurturing of I&T talent, the Government has launched the STEM Internship Scheme to encourage university students to experience I&T-related work. The Government also launches different schemes to assist the youth in pursuing a career in I&T after graduation. For example, through the Research Talent Hub, the Government funds eligible institutions and enterprises to recruit university graduates of STEM subjects (Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics) to conduct research and development (R&D) work. The Hong Kong Science and Technology Parks Corporation and the Cyberport also provide I&T talent with internship and start-up opportunities through various schemes, whereas the Technology Talent Admission Scheme also provides a fast-track arrangement for admitting overseas and Mainland technology talent to conduct R&D work in Hong Kong. While taking forward the development of LAE, the Government will review the talent demand of the relevant industries, and maintain close communication with the industries to make timely planning accordingly.

Annex

Details of the Implemented LAE Regulatory Sandbox Projects (as at the end of February 2026)

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
1	Kangaroo Limited (Shenzhen Meituan Low Altitude Logistics Technology Co., Ltd.)	Drone delivery	1) Between Hong Kong Science Park (HKSP) and Tai Po Waterfront Park 2) Between HKSP and Ting Kok Village, Tai Po	Scope of trials being expanded
2	CLP Power Hong Kong	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Sai Wan, Sai Kung 2) Shing Mun Country Park 3) Ngau Tam Mei, Yuen Long (near Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works) 4) Lei Muk Shue to Lai Chi Kok	Operationalised
3	Lands Department	Surveillance	1) Tso Wo Hang, Sai Kung 2) Shap Sze Heung, Sai Kung 3) Cheung Shue Tan, Tai Po	Operationalised
4	Highways Department	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Tunnel Road, Tseung Kwan O 2) Cross Bay Link, Tseung Kwan O 3) Tate's Cairn Highway	Operationalised
5	Civil Engineering and Development Department	Infrastructure surveillance	Tai Mong Tsai, Sai Kung	Operationalised
6	POI Corporation Limited (Hong Kong Science and Technology Parks Corporation)	Building cleaning	HKSP	Operationalised
7	Geosys Hong Kong Limited ((i) Development Bureau; and (ii) FLYCAMHK.com)	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Mui Tsz Lam 2) Kowloon Reservoir 3) Chai Wan 4) Plover Cove Reservoir 5) Hung Shui Kiu 6) High Island Reservoir 7) Shau Kei Wan 8) Chai Wan	Operationalised

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
			9) Kam Tin River 10) Fanling 11) Sheung Shui Sewage Treatment Works 12) Ha Tsuen	
8	Traffic Control Technology (Hong Kong) Company Limited ((i) MTR Corporation Limited; and (ii) Traffic Control Technology Company Limited)	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Inside tunnel from Exhibition Centre Station to Admiralty Station 2) Sheung Shui Station	Operationalised
9	OWOWWW Creative (Hong Kong) Company Limited (Shenzhen HighGreat Innovation Technology Development Company Limited)	Drone show system	Cyberport	Operationalised
10	Aerovision Technology Limited ((i) China Merchants Godown, Wharf, & Transportation Co., Ltd.; (ii) The Hong Kong Polytechnic University (PolyU); (iii) Flight Pro Drone Solutions Limited; and (iv) Hong Kong Model Engineering Club Limited)	System/ infrastructure	China Merchants Wharf Pier	Operationalised
11	Fire Services Department	Emergency / search and rescue	1) Fire and Ambulance Services Academy 2) Pre-defined rural areas	Operationalised
12	Fame Faith Limited ((i) S.F. Express (Hong Kong) Limited; and (ii) Hospital Authority (St. John Hospital))	Drone delivery	Cyberport to Cheung Chau	In progress
13	Future Yixin Aviation Technology Limited ((i) Yixin Smart Technology Co. Ltd; and (ii) Easy Mobile Logistics Hong Kong Limited)	Drone delivery	Between Pak Shek Kok Promenade and Tai Po Waterfront Pier	In progress
14	Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited ((i) Civil Aid Service; (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance;	Emergency / search and rescue/ facilities surveillance	Civil Aid Service Tai Tan Camp	Operationalised

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
	(iii) China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited; and (iv) Town Formation Limited)			
15	DAMODA UAV (HK) Company Limited (Shenzhen DAMODA Intelligent Control Technology Co., Ltd.)	Drone show system	China Merchants Wharf Pier	Operationalised
16	Correctional Services Department (Electrical and Mechanical Services Department)	Infrastructure surveillance	Tong Fuk Correctional Institution	Operationalised
17	The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST) (China UniCom (Hong Kong) Innovation Research Institute Limited)	Others	HKUST campus	In progress
18	SUPTC Digital Technology (Hong Kong) Limited and PolyU ((i) Gleneagles Hospital Hong Kong; (ii) Hong Kong Broadband Network Enterprise Solutions; and (iii) AutosystemHK.ai)	Drone delivery	PolyU campus	In progress
19	United Airspace Management Limited ((i) DNT FPV Drone Association Hong Kong, China; and (ii) Raspect Intelligence Inspection Limited)	Drone delivery	Lau Fau Shan	In progress
20	Godo Innovation Technology (Hong Kong) Limited (China State Construction Engineering (Hong Kong) Limited)	Security patrol	Anderson Road Quarry Site construction site	Operationalised
21	Hong Kong Professional Unmanned Aerial Vehicles Association Ltd (Edko Films Ltd.)	Aerial photography	Fanling Hok Tau	Operationalised
22	Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited ((i) Agriculture, Fisheries and Conservation Department; (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited; and	Enforcement	Kat O	Operationalised

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
	(iv) Town Formation Limited)			
23	5G nuMultimedia Limited (DAMODA UAV (HK) Company Limited)	Drone livestreaming system	Cyberport	Operationalised
24	Hong Kong Logistics and Supply Chain MultiTech R&D Centre (Sunray Science and Technology Co. Ltd.)	Systems / infrastructure	Cyberport	Operationalised
25	Fire Services Department	Emergency / search and rescue	Fire and Ambulance Services Academy	Operationalised
26	Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited ((i) Environmental Protection Department; (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited; (iv) DAMODA UAV (HK) Company Limited; and (v) Shenzhen Feiliu Yunxiang Technology Co Ltd.)	Air quality surveillance	Peng Chau	Operationalised
27	Hong Kong Centre for Logistics Robotics Limited (Electrical and Mechanical Services Department)	Security patrol	Wo Hop Shek Public Cemetery	In progress
28	Alpha AI Technology Limited ((i) HKT Limited; (ii) U Resonance Limited; (iii) Hong Kong Cyberport Management Company Limited; (iv) Hong Kong Science & Technology Parks Corporation; (v) Auki Labs Limited; and (vi) Ricoh Hong Kong Limited)	Building inspection	Cyberport	Operationalised
29	China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited ((i) Hospital Authority (Princess Margaret Hospital); (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) Hangzhou Songba Logistics Technology Co., Ltd.; (iv) Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited; and (v) The University of Hong Kong)	Signal testing	Princess Margaret Hospital	In progress

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
30	China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited ((i) Auxiliary Medical Service; (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) POI Corporation Limited; and (iv) Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited)	Surveillance	Tolo Harbour Cycling Track	Operationalised
31	UAS Limited ((i) Jadason Technology Limited; (ii) Dynasty Premium Chartered Surveying Group; (iii) JOUAV Automation Tech. Co. Ltd.; and (iv) Aerovision Technology Limited)	Aerial survey	Yiu Lian Dockyards, Tsing Yi	Operationalised
32	TIRAIN (HK) Limited (Lands Department)	Aerial survey	Po Toi Island	Operationalised

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2337)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the work to expand Hong Kong's air services network, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) How many aviation partners has Hong Kong established air services agreements with so far and how many destinations are covered? How many aviation partners does Hong Kong expect to enhance air connectivity with within the next year?

(2) The Administration states that it will strive to enter into new air services agreements and expand traffic rights with regions demonstrating development potential, such as the Middle East, Central Asia, Africa and South America. What is the implementation timetable for the relevant work? and

(3) The Airport Authority Hong Kong launched the Air Network Development Programme in June 2024, encouraging airlines to open new routes and increase flight frequencies on the existing routes. Does the Government possess information on the number of participating airlines, the number of new routes opened, the increase in flight frequencies on the existing routes and the amount of financial incentives involved under the Programme?

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 13)

Reply:

As at 2025, we have signed 86 bilateral air services documents covering more than 700 destinations worldwide. In 2025, we updated/ expanded bilateral air services arrangements with a number of aviation partners, and reached consensus with Chile, Peru, Poland, Togo, Argentina, Ecuador and Cuba on the establishment of new air services agreements. The Government will continue to actively participate in international civil aviation conferences and take the initiative to visit aviation partners, targeting to explore with 10 or more aviation partners within 2026 the enhancement of air connectivity (including discussing the establishment of new air services agreements or the expansion of traffic rights), with priority focus on regions with further development potential and new growth areas, such as South

America, Central Asia, Africa and the Middle East, so as to support the Hong Kong International Airport to further expand its aviation network. The relevant work is undertaken by the existing staff.

The Government has been, in conjunction with the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK), strategically attracting local and non-local airlines to develop new destinations and increase flights through outreach efforts, incentive schemes and policy facilitation measures. For example, the AAHK launched the Air Network Development Programme (the Programme) in June 2024, which provides financial incentives to encourage airlines to open new routes and increase flight frequencies on the existing routes. To date, the Programme has attracted 36 airlines to open 82 new routes and increase flight frequencies on 14 existing routes. The expenditure for the Programme above is borne by the AAHK and does not involve government expenditure.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0088)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding vehicle maintenance, the Bureau has indicated that it will continue to examine the introduction of a mandatory registration scheme for vehicle mechanics and vehicle maintenance workshops taking into account evolvements in the vehicle market. Please inform this Committee of the following:

(1) What is the current progress of the study on the mandatory registration scheme? When is the public or industry consultation expected to commence? and

(2) Given the increasing prevalence of electric vehicles (EVs), has the Bureau earmarked resources in 2026-27 to assist existing vehicle mechanics in transition or enable them to take courses on EV maintenance? If so, how many qualified EV maintenance mechanics does the Bureau expect to train in the next 5 years? If not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon LAM Siu-lo, Andrew (LegCo internal reference no.: 36)

Reply:

(1) The Government is making reference to the practices of other jurisdictions to progressively enhance the registration arrangements for the electric vehicle (EV) maintenance service under the existing Voluntary Registration Scheme for Vehicle Mechanics and the Voluntary Registration Scheme for Vehicle Maintenance Workshops (voluntary registration schemes). At the same time, it will explore how to introduce mandatory registration schemes, including a study on the relevant legislative amendments. In addition, the Government maintains close co-operation with the Vehicle Maintenance Technical Advisory Committee (the Committee) to support the vehicle maintenance industry to move with the times and attract new recruits to join the industry, so as to ensure a healthy and sustainable development of the industry and minimise the impact of the policies on the industry and practitioners. The Government will announce the proposed arrangements and timetable for the mandatory registration schemes in due course.

(2) The Government and the Committee encourage vehicle mechanics to receive EV maintenance training to enhance their skills and register under the voluntary registration scheme. So far, the Committee has endorsed a total of 10 EV maintenance training programmes from 6 institutes and academies. It is expected that these programmes can meet the growing training needs of the market. As at the end of February 2026, around 1 300 mechanics have completed the relevant training programmes at their own expense to improve their professional skills and registered as EV maintenance mechanics. In view of the development trends in the vehicle market and its growing demand for EV maintenance, it is expected that more mechanics will complete the relevant programmes and obtain the qualifications for EV maintenance. The Government and the Committee are closely monitoring the situation in the industry and will provide assistance and support as appropriate. The work above is absorbed by the existing resources of the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0520)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 under Programme (3) that the Transport and Logistics Bureau will "continue to formulate and implement manpower development strategies, training and promotion initiatives under the Maritime and Aviation Training Fund (MATF), with the advice from the Manpower Development Committee of the Hong Kong Maritime and Port Development Board (HKMPDB), the Tripartite Taskforce on Manpower Training (Aviation) and the Hong Kong Logistics Development Council". In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(a) For each of the schemes under the MATF, what are the respective target groups, training content, expenditures, number of beneficiaries and number of individuals who still work in the maritime/aviation/logistics industries in the past 3 years, as well as the projections for 2026?

(b) In 2026, how will the Bureau work in line with the Action Plan on Modern Logistics Development, the Action Plan on Green Maritime Fuel Bunkering and the reconstitution of the Hong Kong Maritime and Port Board into the HKMPDB to introduce/enhance the schemes under the MATF, so as to nurture and retain local talents in a timely manner and reduce the need to import labour? and

(c) What are the staffing provision as well as salary, operational and equipment expenses provided by the Bureau to support the MATF in 2025-26, as well as the projections for 2026-27?

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 24)

Reply:

(a) The Maritime and Aviation Training Fund (MATF) was launched in 2014 and the expenditure for it is mainly for the provision of training, incentive and promotion schemes. The number of incentive schemes under the MATF has increased from 15 in 2014 to 22 at present. In the past 3 years (up to the end of February 2026), over 6 900 people have been

benefitted (excluding those participating in subsidised activities), 5 000 of whom are in-service practitioners. Please refer to the **Annex** for details. In 2026-27, the estimated cash flow requirement for the MATF is $47.5 million, with the target recipients, training content and estimated number of beneficiaries broadly similar to those in 2025-26.

(b) Since the establishment of the MATF in 2014, the Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB) has been reviewing its operation, taking into account the views of the industry stakeholders and enhancing the relevant training, incentive and promotion schemes under the MATF on a need basis, so as to ensure that the various schemes under the MATF will effectively support the sustainable development of the industries and attract more local people to join the maritime, aviation and logistics industries. In 2026, the TLB will continue to enhance the MATF to tie in line with the Action Plan on Modern Logistics Development to promote the development towards the directions of smart development and green transformation and, through the Hong Kong Maritime and Port Development Board, strengthen the nurturing of talents, provide dedicated training subsidies, subsidise the industry to conduct research and development work on logistics data sharing, as well as increase the training subsidies related to green fuel bunkering technologies, with a view to nurturing local talents and enhancing the competitiveness of maritime talents.

(c) The administrative cost for providing support to the MATF is absorbed by the block vote of the TLB, and hence no breakdown of the expenditures involved is available.

Annex

Name of programme	2023-24		2024-25		2025-26 (as at the end of February 2026)	
	No. of beneficiaries	**Amount of subsidy ($'000)**	**No. of beneficiaries**	**Amount of subsidy ($'000)**	**No. of beneficiaries**	**Amount of subsidy ($'000)**
1. Professional Training and Examination Refund Scheme	1 529	5,750	1 399	5,230	1 189	4,350
2. Professional Training on Smart and Green Logistics Scheme	N/A	N/A	14	90	61	370
3. Sea-going Training Incentive Scheme %	28	4,054	23	4,510	17	3,400
4. Local Vessel Trade Training Incentive Scheme	4	329	7	210	17	220
5. Local Vessel Competency Enhancement Scheme	100	1,254	223	2,840	264	3,310
6. Ship Repair Training Incentive Scheme %	1	200	0	90	3	20^{+}
7. Partial Tuition Refund Scheme for the Specialised Aircraft Maintenance Programme	10	580	9	320	3	330
8. Aviation Operations Training Incentive Scheme	53	1,090	37	340	/ ^	/ ^
9. Maritime Services Traineeship Scheme – Legal %	4	327	4	1,070	5	1,130

Name of programme	2023-24		2024-25		2025-26 (as at the end of February 2026)	
	No. of beneficiaries	Amount of subsidy ($'000)	No. of beneficiaries	Amount of subsidy ($'000)	No. of beneficiaries	Amount of subsidy ($'000)
10. Maritime Services Traineeship Scheme – Marine Insurance	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	@	@
11. Maritime and Aviation Internship Scheme	399	5,434	515	7,250	481	7,350
12. Internship Scheme on Modern Logistics[#]	60	960	67	1,080	58	910
13. Maritime Training Support Scheme [c]	0	1,966	24	2,540	39	2,800
14. Overseas Exchange Scholarship Scheme	11	330	9	270	2	120
15. Hong Kong Nautical and Maritime Scholarship Scheme	3	384	5	480	2	420
16. Hong Kong Maritime and Logistics Scholarship Scheme	8	1,885	10	2,498	10	2,650
17. The University of Hong Kong – Dalian Maritime University Academic Collaboration Scheme	85	744	63	211	64	1,790

Name of programme	2023-24		2024-25		2025-26 (as at the end of February 2026)	
	No. of beneficiaries	Amount of subsidy ($'000)	No. of beneficiaries	Amount of subsidy ($'000)	No. of beneficiaries	Amount of subsidy ($'000)
18. The University of Hong Kong – Shanghai Maritime University Academic Collaboration Scheme	1	222	0	-	0	-
19. Hong Kong Aviation Scholarship Scheme	22	1,470	34	2,840	/ ^	/ ^
20. Maritime Promotion Project Funding	14 324 *	1,355	10 599 *	1,856	6 509 **	1,124
21. Aviation Promotion Project Funding Scheme	173 *	60	1 600 *	530	506 *	110
22. Logistics Promotion Funding Scheme	N/A	N/A	550 *	3,880	1 904 *	2,386

^ The subsidy is generally granted in the first quarter of each year. This year's applications for the subsidies are still undergoing the approval process, and therefore the relevant information is not available.

* The figures refer to the number of participants in the promotional activities.

** The figures only include the number of participants recorded in the statistics of the promotional activities.

It was formerly known as the Summer Internship Scheme on Supply Chain Management.

% The schemes have a subsidy period of more than 1 year. The number of beneficiaries refers to the number of new participants joining the schemes each year, while the amount of subsidy refers to the total amount of subsidy granted in that year. No applications were received for the Ship Repair Training Incentive Scheme in 2024-25.

+ Part of the subsidy will be granted after 31 March 2026.

@ The scheme was launched in November 2025, and therefore information on the number of beneficiaries and the amount of subsidy is not available.

c The scheme was launched in the 2021/22 school year to subsidise the Hong Kong Sea School to deliver a school-based Maritime Studies curriculum and thereby nurturing and attracting talents. The first batch of students graduated in 2024, and therefore the number of beneficiaries is not available for 2023-24.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB122**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0955)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat: Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Transport and Logistics Bureau promulgated the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint and the Transport Strategy Blueprint in December 2023 and this February respectively. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(a) Regarding the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint and the Transport Strategy Blueprint, what are the respective (i) expenditures on the consultancy studies and (ii) manpower and expenditures for the Bureau to steer the consultancy?

(b) For each infrastructure mentioned in the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint, what are the respective (i) cost on the preliminary study; (ii) estimated construction cost; (iii) form of financing; (iv) year of first proposal; (v) year of commencement of the preliminary study; (vi) year of commencement of construction; (vii) estimated year of completion for commissioning; and (viii) current progress? (Please set out in tabular form)

(c) The Hong Kong Island West – Hung Shui Kiu Rail Link and the Hong Kong Island West – Northeast Lantau Link under the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint are ancillary facilities of the Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands, which will help alleviate the traffic pressure between the northwest New Territories and the Harbour Metropolis via the Tuen Ma Line and Route 3. However, as the Government announced that the reclamation project for the Artificial Islands would not be carried out within this term, has the Bureau conducted any studies on the ways to prevent the Tuen Ma Line and Route 3 from overloading? If so, what are the plans? If not, what are the reasons? and

(d) It is mentioned in Recommendation 4 "Facilitating Cross-boundary Vehicles" of the Transport Strategy Blueprint that "the Transport Department is actively studying the feasibility of mutual recognition of commercial vehicle driving licences among Guangdong, Hong Kong and Macao, and will further discuss the relevant details with the governments of the two places. The target is to achieve concrete outcomes in 2026, with a view to

implementing the relevant arrangements in 2027." Some members of the industry criticised the Bureau for not disclosing it to the public beforehand and were worried that the employment opportunities for drivers of local commercial vehicles would be further jeopardised. Has the Bureau consulted the industry, including operators and frontline staff, before announcing this policy? If so, what parties have been consulted? If not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 22)

Reply:

(a) The Highways Department (HyD) and the Transport Department (TD) commissioned consultants in December 2020 to conduct the Strategic Studies on Railways and Major Roads beyond 2030 and formulated the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint based on the findings of the studies. The costs for the railways part and the major roads part of the Strategic Studies on Railways and Major Roads beyond 2030 are approximately $61.8 million and $23.4 million, respectively. The supervision work for the studies is undertaken by the existing staff of the HyD and the TD and there is no separate breakdown of the manpower involved.

The TD commissioned consultants in December 2021 to conduct the Traffic and Transport Strategy Study, which has largely been completed. The Transport and Logistics Bureau and the TD formulated the Transport Strategy Blueprint based on the findings of the study. The relevant consultant fees and other associated expenses are estimated to be $77.19 million. The supervision work for the study is undertaken by the existing staff of the TD and there is no separate breakdown of the manpower involved.

(b) Information on the railway and Smart and Green Mass Transit System (SGMTS) projects as well as major roads projects set out in the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint is provided at **Annex 1** and **Annex 2** respectively.

(c) In the planning under the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint, the Government has displayed a series of transport infrastructure projects related to the proposed Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands, including the Hong Kong Island West – Hung Shui Kiu Rail Link. As there is no concrete implementation timetable for the reclamation works of the Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands at the present stage, the Government will review the planning and implementation arrangements for the related transport infrastructure projects, under which the Government will consider different options in the absence of the Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands development, including their transport demand, technical feasibility as well as the transport and cost effectiveness, and will take forward the relevant projects in a timely and orderly manner with due consideration of its urgency and priority.

(d) As regards the issue of mutual recognition of commercial vehicle driving licences among Guangdong, Hong Kong and Macao, the TD is currently studying its feasibility and will consult the stakeholders in due course.

Annex 1

Railway and SGMTS project	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)
	Cost of the preliminary study	**Estimated construction cost**	**Form of financing**	**Year of first proposal**	**Year of commencement of the preliminary study, planning and design**	**Year of commencement of construction**	**Estimated year of completion for commissioning**	**Current progress**
Tung Chung Line Extension	Undertaken by the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL)	$19.5 billion (in December 2020 prices)	See Note 1	2014	2020	2023	2029	Works in progress
Tuen Mun South Extension	Undertaken by the MTRCL	$15.8 billion (in July 2023 prices)	See Note 1	2014	2020	2023	2030	Works in progress
Oyster Bay Station	Undertaken by the MTRCL	$3.8 billion (in June 2022 prices)	See Note 1	2015	2020	2023	2030	Works in progress
Hung Shui Kiu Station	Undertaken by the MTRCL	$6.639 billion (in September 2024 prices)	See Note 1	2014	2021	2024	2030	Works in progress
Kwu Tung Station on the East Rail Line	Undertaken by the MTRCL	$5.9 billion (in July 2023 prices)	See Note 1	2000	2020	2023	2027	Works in progress

Railway and SGMTS project	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)
	Cost of the preliminary study	**Estimated construction cost**	**Form of financing**	**Year of first proposal**	**Year of commencement of the preliminary study, planning and design**	**Year of commencement of construction**	**Estimated year of completion for commissioning**	**Current progress**
Northern Link (NOL) Project (including NOL Main Line and Spur Line) (See Note 2)	Undertaken by the MTRCL	Part 1 of NOL Project: $31.4 billion (in July 2025 prices) Part 2 of NOL Project: To be confirmed	See Note 1	2000	NOL Main Line: 2020 NOL Spur Line: 2025	Part 1 of NOL Project: 2025 Part 2 of NOL Project: To be confirmed	Simultaneous commissioning of NOL Main Line and Spur Line by 2034 or earlier	The Government executed the project agreement with the MTRCL for Part 1 of the NOL Project. The MTRCL prioritised the commencement of the more mature and imminent works of NOL Project, and concurrently carried out the detailed planning and design, as well as the statutory procedures for NOL Spur Line.

Railway and SGMTS project	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)
	Cost of the preliminary study	**Estimated construction cost**	**Form of financing**	**Year of first proposal**	**Year of commencement of the preliminary study, planning and design**	**Year of commencement of construction**	**Estimated year of completion for commissioning**	**Current progress**
Hong Kong Section of Hong Kong – Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu – Qianhai) (HSWRL)	$303.8 million	The estimated construction cost and the form of financing of the project are to be confirmed.		2023	2025	The target is to have the Hong Kong section of the project technically ready for tendering in 2027 so as to commence the detailed design and construction works promptly.	Strive for commissioning in 2035	Investigation and design are currently in progress with the target of inviting tenders in 2027.
Pak Shek Kok Station	The Government announced in 2021 that studies would be carried out on the construction of the Pak Shek Kok Station on the East Rail Line and the comprehensive development of nearby areas. The preparatory work for the Pak Shek Kok comprehensive development project is now in the final stages. The Government will continue to maintain close liaison with the MTRCL and announce the overall proposals for the development project as early as possible upon completion of the internal procedures. The planning for the new railway station is proceeding in parallel as scheduled and the target is to commission it by 2033 or earlier.							
Tseung Kwan O Line Southern Extension	The project was proposed in 2023. The MTRCL submitted proposals in December 2025. The HyD is reviewing the MTRCL's proposals and is in close negotiation with the MTRCL. Details of the project are yet to be confirmed.							
Central Rail Link	The project was proposed in 2023. Details of the project are yet to be confirmed.							
Northern Link Eastern Extension	The project was proposed in 2023. The actual alignment and implementation timetable of the project will depend on the planning of land use and timetable of the development projects such as the New Territories North New Town, etc. Therefore, details of the project are yet to be confirmed.							

Railway and SGMTS project	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)
	Cost of the preliminary study	**Estimated construction cost**	**Form of financing**	**Year of first proposal**	**Year of commencement of the preliminary study, planning and design**	**Year of commencement of construction**	**Estimated year of completion for commissioning**	**Current progress**
Northeast New Territories Line	The project was proposed in 2023. The actual alignment and implementation timetable of the project will depend on the planning of land use and timetable of the development projects such as the New Territories North New Town, etc. Therefore, details of the project are yet to be confirmed.							
Hong Kong Island West – Hung Shui Kiu Rail Link	The engineering feasibility study of these 2 projects is part of Public Works Programme Item No. 5768CL – Studies related to Artificial Islands in the Central Waters (with an approved project estimate (APE) of $550.4 million). The study commenced in 2021. These 2 projects were first proposed in 2022. The detailed alignment and implementation timetable of the projects need to tie in with the planning of the proposed Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands. As there is no concrete implementation timetable for the reclamation works of the Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands at the present stage, details of the projects are yet to be confirmed.							
Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands Green Mass Transit System								
Smart and Green Mass Transit System (SGMTS) in Kai Tak	Approximately $67 million	See Note 3		2023	2023	Contract is expected to be awarded within 2026	2031	Tendering in progress
SGMTS in East Kowloon	Approximately $262.5 million	See Note 3		2023	2024	Tenders for the project are expected to be invited in 2026	2033	Detailed planning and design in progress

Railway and SGMTS project	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)
	Cost of the preliminary study	**Estimated construction cost**	**Form of financing**	**Year of first proposal**	**Year of commencement of the preliminary study, planning and design**	**Year of commencement of construction**	**Estimated year of completion for commissioning**	**Current progress**
SGMTS in Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen New Development Area	Phase 1: Approximately $44.11 million Remaining phases: Under review	Under review		2023	2024	Phase 1: Target for 2027 Remaining phases: Under review	Phase 1: Target for 2031 Remaining phases: Under review	Detailed planning and design in progress
South Island Line (West)	Undertaken by the MTRCL	See Note 4		2014	Adoption of SGMTS: 2024	Advance construction works are expected to commence in 2027	By 2034	Detailed planning and design in progress

Note 1: The Tung Chung Line Extension, Tuen Mun South Extension, Kwu Tung Station on the East Rail Line, Hung Shui Kiu Station, NOL Main Line and NOL Spur Line are implemented by the MTRCL through the "Rail-plus-Property" model, while the construction cost of the Oyster Bay Station is deducted from the land premium. No Government's APE is involved for these projects.

Note 2: Part 1 of the NOL Project includes the civil and structural works of 2 sections of the NOL Main Line from the Kam Sheung Road Station to the intersection with the approach tunnels to the Ngau Tam Mei Depot and from the San Tin (SAT) Station to the Kwu Tung Station, as well as the detailed planning and design of the NOL Spur Line. Part 2 of the Project includes the remaining section of the NOL Main Line, the Ngau Tam Mei Depot, and the NOL Spur Line from the SAT Station to the Huanggang Port Station, system-wide electrical and mechanical works and rolling stock, as well as the operation and maintenance of the NOL Project after commissioning.

Note 3: The Government plans to take forward the 2 SGMTS projects in Kai Tak and East Kowloon through the "Transit-Oriented Development" approach. No Government's APE is involved in these projects.

Note 4: The detailed planning and design of the South Island Line (West) are in progress. The Government will discuss the financial arrangements of the project with the MTRCL based on the ownership approach and the "Rail-plus-Property" model. The construction cost of the project is yet to be confirmed.

Annex 2

Major road project	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)
	Cost of the preliminary study (See Note 1)	**Estimated construction cost**	**Form of financing**	**Year of first proposal (See Note 2)**	**Year of commencement of the preliminary study (See Note 3)**	**Year of commencement of construction**	**Estimated year of completion for commissioning**	**Current progress**
Trunk Road T2 and Cha Kwo Ling Tunnel	$133.6 million (investigation and design)	$16.017 billion	Provisions from the Capital Works Reserve Fund (CWRF)	2001	2009	2019	2026	Works in progress
Central Kowloon Route	$206.9 million (detailed design and site investigation)	$42.3639 billion	Provisions from the CWRF	2007	2007	2017	Commissioned in 2025	Commissioned in December 2025
Fanling Bypass (Eastern Section)	See Note 4	See Note 5	Provisions from the CWRF	2014	2014	2020	2026	Works in progress and expected to be commissioned at the end of April/early May 2026
Fanling Bypass (Western Section)	See Note 6	See Note 7	Provisions from the CWRF	2019	2019	2025	2031	Works in progress
Trunk Road T4 in Sha Tin	$34.7 million (detailed design and site investigation)	$6.81 billion	Provisions from the CWRF	2005	2005	2024	2030	Works in progress

Major road project	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)
	Cost of the preliminary study (See Note 1)	**Estimated construction cost**	**Form of financing**	**Year of first proposal (See Note 2)**	**Year of commencement of the preliminary study (See Note 3)**	**Year of commencement of construction**	**Estimated year of completion for commissioning**	**Current progress**
Tuen Mun Bypass	See Note 8	See Note 9	See Note 9	2021	2022	See Note 9	See Note 9	Investigation study in progress
Route 11 (section between Yuen Long and North Lantau)	$319 million (investigation study)	See Note 9	See Note 9	2017	2021	See Note 9	See Note 9	Investigation study in progress
Tsing Yi – Lantau Link	$695 million (investigation study and detailed design)	See Note 9	See Note 9	2003	2023	See Note 9	See Note 9	Investigation study in progress
Widening of Yuen Long Highway (section between Lam Tei and Tong Yan San Tsuen)	See Note 8	See Note 9	See Note 9	2022	2022	See Note 9	See Note 9	The HyD invited tenders for the works in December 2025 for consultation with the Legislative Council on the works proposal in the second/third quarter of 2026.
Improvement of Lion Rock Tunnel	$240.7 million	See Note 9	See Note 9	2022	2019	See Note 9	See Note 9	Design in progress

Major road project	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)
	Cost of the preliminary study (See Note 1)	**Estimated construction cost**	**Form of financing**	**Year of first proposal (See Note 2)**	**Year of commencement of the preliminary study (See Note 3)**	**Year of commencement of construction**	**Estimated year of completion for commissioning**	**Current progress**
	(first stage design and site investigation)							
Widening of T6 Bridge of Tate's Cairn Highway	See Note 8	See Note 9	See Note 9	2022	2022	See Note 9	See Note 9	Design in progress
Improvement Works of Fanling Highway (between Pak Shek Au Interchange and Po Shek Wu Road Interchange)	See Note 6	See Note 7	Provisions from the CWRF	2019	2020	2024	2031	Works in progress
Widening of Tsuen Wan Road and the associated junction improvement works	See Note 8	See Note 9	See Note 9	2017	2019	See Note 9	See Note 9	Investigation study completed
Hong Kong Island West – Northeast Lantau Link	The engineering feasibility study of this project is part of Public Works Programme Item No. 5768CL – Studies related to Artificial Islands in the Central Waters (with APE of $550.4 million). The study commenced in 2021. This project was first proposed in 2022. The detailed alignment and implementation timetable of the project need to tie in with the planning of the proposed Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands. As there is no concrete implementation timetable for the reclamation works of the Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands at the present stage, details of the project are yet to be confirmed.							

Major road project	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)	(vii)	(viii)
	Cost of the preliminary study (See Note 1)	**Estimated construction cost**	**Form of financing**	**Year of first proposal (See Note 2)**	**Year of commencement of the preliminary study (See Note 3)**	**Year of commencement of construction**	**Estimated year of completion for commissioning**	**Current progress**
Road P1 (Tai Ho – Sunny Bay Section), Lantau	$130.2 million (investigation study, preliminary design and site investigation)	See Note 9	See Note 9	2018	2021	See Note 9	See Note 9	The current phase of the study is expected to be completed at the end of 2026
Northern Metropolis Highway	$688.3 million (investigation study)	See Note 9	See Note 9	2023	2025	See Note 9	See Note 9	Investigation study in progress
Tseung Kwan O – Yau Tong Tunnel	To be confirmed	See Note 9	See Note 9	2023	N/A	See Note 9	See Note 9	Under planning
Sha Tin Bypass	To be confirmed	See Note 9	See Note 9	2023	N/A	See Note 9	See Note 9	Under planning

Note 1: Only the APE related to the study/design of Category A works projects are included.

Note 2: The year of first proposal refers to the year in which the projects of the Northern Metropolis Highway, the Tseung Kwan O – Yau Tong Tunnel and the Sha Tin Bypass were proposed in the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint or the year in which the relevant district council was consulted before the commencement of the investigation study of the works project.

Note 3: The year of commencement of the preliminary study refers to the year of commencement of the investigation study of the works project.

Note 4: The detailed design and site investigation of the Fanling Bypass (Eastern Section) is part of Public Works Programme Item No. 7772CL – Advance site formation and engineering infrastructure works at Kwu Tung North new development area and Fanling North new development area –detailed design and site investigation (with APE of $340.8 million).

Note 5: The construction works of the Fanling Bypass (Eastern Section) is part of Public Works Programme Item No. 7747CL – Advance site formation and engineering infrastructure works at Kwu Tung North new development area and Fanling North new development area (with APE of $17.3201 billion).

Note 6: The detailed design and site investigation of the Fanling Bypass (Western Section) and the Improvement Works of Fanling Highway (between Pak Shek Au Interchange and Po Shek Wu Road Interchange) are part of Public Works Programme Item No. 7835CL – Remaining phase of site formation and engineering infrastructure works at Kwu Tung North new development area and Fanling North new development area – detailed design and site investigation (with APE of $764.5 million).

Note 7: The construction works of the Fanling Bypass (Western Section) and the Improvement Works of Fanling Highway (between Pak Shek Au Interchange and Po Shek Wu Road Interchange) are part of Public Works Programme Item No. 7828CL – Remaining phase of site formation and engineering infrastructure works at Kwu Tung North New Development Area and Fanling North New Development Area – Construction (with APE of $30.1679 billion).

Note 8: The costs of the study/design of the relevant works projects are paid by the annual provisions under Subhead 6100TX of the CWRF Head 706 – Highways.

Note 9: For projects in planning stage, their estimated construction cost and form of financing would be ascertained upon completion of the investigation and design work. The Government will continuously review the cost-effectiveness of works projects and take into account the urgency and priority of the relevant projects so as to take them forward in a timely and orderly manner.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0957)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 under Programme (3) that the Transport and Logistics Bureau will continue to work with the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) to implement the Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector – Aviation Industry. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(a) What are the staff establishment, expenditure on emoluments and operational expenses involved in processing the applications under the Scheme in 2025-26 and the respective estimated figures for 2026-27?

(b) What are the (i) number of applicant employers, (ii) number of quotas for labour importation/contract renewal applied for, and (iii) number of quotas for labour importation/contract renewal approved (with a breakdown by post for (ii) and (iii)) in each round of applications since the launch of the Scheme?

(c) Has the Government maintained the statistics on the number of complaints lodged by imported workers regarding exploitation of their rights and lack of occupational safety and health protection since the launch of the Scheme? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

(d) Has the Government looked into the changes in salaries, employment opportunities and unemployment/underemployment situation of local aviation practitioners since the launch of the Scheme? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

(e) What are the (i) respective numbers of employers who have been issued warning letters, have their approved quotas revoked and been temporarily banned from application due to violation of application guidelines or other legislation/guidelines since the launch of the Scheme; and (ii) numbers of warning letters and approved quotas revoked as well as the longest period that an applicant is banned from application? and

(f) Given that employers are required under the Scheme to pay $400 per month to the AAHK for each imported worker as a transport subsidy for local frontline airport staff, does the Government know the monthly expenditure and average number of beneficiaries under the subsidy scheme in the past 3 years and the respective estimated figures for 2026?

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 25)

Reply:

(a) & (b) The Government launched the Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector – Aviation Industry (the Scheme) in July 2023 to allow licensees, franchisees or holders of operating permits issued by the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) to apply for labour importation to fill vacancies for frontline non-supervisory jobs under 10 designated job types at the airport, on the premise of safeguarding local workers, with a quota ceiling of 6 300.

After the first 2 rounds of applications, there were a total of 2 206 unused and remaining quotas, which were all granted in the third round of applications. All 6 300 quotas have been granted to 39 eligible companies after 3 rounds of applications, covering all 10 job types under the Scheme. There were 29, 27 and 34 companies applying for quotas in the 3 rounds of applications respectively. Please refer to the table below for details.

Job type	First round of applications July to August 2023		Second round of applications March to April 2024		Third round of applications March to April 2025	
	No. of quotas applied	No. of quotas granted	No. of quotas applied	No. of quotas granted	No. of quotas applied	No. of quotas granted
1. Passenger Services Officer	728	719	1 213	1 184	951	510
2. Ramp Services Agent	465	445	549	545	714	472
3. Cabin Worker	366	366	283	263	398	328
4. Aircraft Maintenance Mechanic/Technician	390	390	192	192	210	60
5. Tractor Driver	325	306	212	212	218	103
6. Warehouse Operator/ Cargo Hander	206	206	140	140	101	101
7. Equipment/ Loader Operator	193	193	152	152	224	181
8. Customer Services Agent	90	90	148	148	206	206
9. Aircraft Tug Driver	30	30	10	10	15	13
10. Maintenance Technician	96	96	136	136	255	232
Total	**2 889**	**2 841**	**3 035**	**2 982**	**3 292**	**2 206**

To ensure the continuity of airport operations and services, the Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB) and the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) allow employers to apply for quotas for contract renewal starting from July 2025, so as to facilitate contract renewal with the existing imported workers. A total of 32 companies submitted applications. Please refer to the table below for details.

Job type	July to August 2025		January to February 2026	
	No. of quotas for contract renewal applied	No. of quotas for contract renewal granted	No. of quotas for contract renewal applied	No. of quotas for contract renewal granted
1. Passenger Services Officer	195	195	864	864
2. Ramp Services Agent	342	342	339	339
3. Cabin Worker	267	267	208	208
4. Aircraft Maintenance Mechanic/Technician	19	19	7	7
5. Tractor Driver	226	226	130	128
6. Warehouse Operator/ Cargo Hander	91	91	118	118
7. Equipment/ Loader Operator	130	130	106	106
8. Customer Services Agent	38	38	68	68
9. Aircraft Tug Driver	19	19	5	5
10. Maintenance Technician	28	28	68	68
Total	**1 355**	**1 355**	**1 913**	**1 911**

The administrative work of the Scheme is mainly undertaken by the AAHK and does not involve government expenditure, while the work related to the supervision of the Scheme and approval of applications for labour importation is absorbed by the block vote of the TLB, and hence no breakdown of the expenditures involved is available.

(c) & (e) Since the launch of the Scheme, the TLB has received a total of 11 referral cases from the Labour Department related to the imported workers under the Scheme. After checking by the AAHK, the relevant cases do not appear to have involved infringement of labour rights or occupational health and safety issues, but relate solely to matters such as the calculation of remuneration when leaving the job and salary terms upon contract renewal. The AAHK has reminded the employers again that they should establish an effective communication mechanism with the imported workers and explain to them clearly the terms of the employment contracts. If a case involves the violation of the Employment Ordinance or the terms of the employment contract, the AAHK will refer the case to the relevant law

enforcement agencies. Separately, there are no cases of administrative sanctions under the Scheme.

(d) & (f) On the premise of safeguarding the employment of local workers, the TLB adjusted the median wages for designated job types under the Scheme on 21 November 2025, with an average increase of about 3.6%. The TLB and the AAHK will continuously review the median wages for job types in the aviation sector and make timely adjustments, so as to ensure that the wages reflect the latest situations of the relevant job types. We will also continue to maintain communication with the relevant stakeholders regarding the implementation of the Scheme through the Stakeholder Consultative Group under the Scheme.

Moreover, with support from the Government, the AAHK co-ordinates the sums of payments contributed for each imported worker by the employers and the AAHK under the Scheme to subsidise the transport expenses of local frontline airport staff. Eligible recipients of the transport subsidy must be local frontline airport staff employed by eligible companies and engage in the 10 job types of work allowed under the Scheme. The subsidy for public transport expenses of each eligible staff member is subject to a ceiling of $400 per month, with a minimum of $100 per month. The first round of transport subsidy was disbursed to eligible staff in June 2024. At present, around 8 300 eligible staff members are benefitted each month. The relevant initiative is undertaken by the AAHK and does not involve government expenditure.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0113)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the training of aviation personnel, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. How many qualified aircraft maintenance and aircraft parts processing personnel are expected to be provided to the market by the Aircraft Engineering Training Centre each year?

2. In the co-operation agreements involving the training centre, how the clauses on intellectual property rights and technology transfer are set? How does the Administration ensure that the relevant core technologies and course certification authority will be gradually transferred to Hong Kong to establish our own training capabilities rather than merely opening up the market for overseas institutions? and

3. Has the Administration assessed the career prospects for the graduates of the training centre? Will a matching mechanism be established with local airlines or aircraft engineering companies to ensure that the personnel trained will be absorbed by the market?

Asked by: Hon LAU Chi-pang (LegCo internal reference no.: 9)

Reply:

The Hong Kong International Aviation Academy (HKIAA) signed a Memorandum of Understanding with Elior Asia Holdings Ltd, a subsidiary of a leading overseas aeronautic services company Elior Group SA, in June 2025. The co-operation agreement covers frameworks for intellectual property protection as well as the promotion of technology and skill transfer. The 2 parties jointly established the Aircraft Engineering Training Centre in December of the same year to offer a series professional training courses on aircraft maintenance, aircraft parts processing and certification, with a view to nurturing local professionals in aircraft maintenance, engineering and asset management. The training centre has launched its first trial course, with students all being local in-service aviation maintenance engineering technicians, and more courses will be rolled out progressively in the second quarter this year. It is anticipated that 300 training places will be provided within

this year and the enrolment will be expanded progressively to include non-serving aviation maintenance engineering technicians. The work is undertaken by the HKIAA and the relevant aeronautic services company and does not involve government expenditure.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0363)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the work to take forward the major transport infrastructure projects promulgated under the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint, including the railways, the smart and green mass transit systems and the major road projects, please inform this Committee of the following:

1. What is the planning and implementation progress of the projects, including i) the commencement/expected commencement dates for the studies, planning and design; ii) the commencement/expected commencement dates for construction; iii) the expected completion dates; and iv) the estimated expenditures?

2. There will be a net decrease of 6 posts in 2026-27 under this programme. What are i) the departments; ii) the grades; iii) the duties; and iv) the salary expenses involved? and

3. Has the impact of the decrease of posts on the implementation of infrastructure projects been assessed? How to ensure that the relevant projects will be properly monitored and completed on schedule?

Asked by: Hon LAU Ip-keung, Kenneth (LegCo internal reference no.: 4)

Reply:

1. Information on the railway and Smart and Green Mass Transit System (SGMTS) projects as well as major road projects set out in the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint is provided at **Annex 1** and **Annex 2** respectively.

2. The 6 posts deleted in 2026-27 is under the establishment of the Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB). The details are as follows:

The net decrease of posts in 2026-27				
Grade	Post	No. of posts	Main duties	Notional annual mid-point salary ($ million)
Executive Officer	Senior Executive Officer	1	To handle the gazettal of railway schemes and the associated works	Approximately 2.83
	Executive Officer II	1		
Clerical Officer	Assistant Clerical Officer	1		
Clerical Assistant	Clerical Assistant	2	To handle general office duties	
Workman II	Workman II	1		
Total:		**6**		

3. The 2 posts in the Executive Officer grade and the 1 post in the Clerical Officer grade are responsible for handling the gazettal of railway schemes and the associated works, while the remaining 3 posts are mainly responsible for providing supports to general office operations. The TLB will enhance its utilisation of manpower resources and improve its efficiency through measures such as internal allocation of resources, streamlining of procedures and adoption of technology, etc. so as to ensure that its services will not be affected.

Annex 1

Railway and SGMTS project	(i) Cost of the preliminary study	(ii) Estimated construction cost	(iii) Year of commencement of the preliminary study, planning and design	(iv) Year of commencement of construction	(v) Estimated year of completion	(vi) Current progress
Tung Chung Line Extension	Undertaken by the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL)	$19.5 billion (in December 2020 prices) (See Note 1)	2020	2023	2029	Works in progress
Tuen Mun South Extension	Undertaken by the MTRCL	$15.8 billion (in July 2023 prices) (See Note 1)	2020	2023	2030	Works in progress
Oyster Bay Station	Undertaken by the MTRCL	$3.8 billion (in June 2022 prices) (See Note 1)	2020	2023	2030	Works in progress
Hung Shui Kiu Station	Undertaken by the MTRCL	$6.639 billion (in September 2024 prices) (See Note 1)	2021	2024	2030	Works in progress
Kwu Tung Station on the East Rail Line	Undertaken by the MTRCL	$5.9 billion (in July 2023 prices) (See Note 1)	2020	2023	2027	Works in progress
Northern Link (NOL) Project (including NOL Main Line and Spur Line) (See Note 2)	Undertaken by the MTRCL	Part 1 of NOL Project: $31.4 billion (in July 2025 prices) Part 2 of NOL Project: To be confirmed (See Note 1)	NOL Main Line: 2020 NOL Spur Line: 2025	Part 1 of NOL Project: 2025 Part 2 of NOL Project: To be confirmed	Simultaneous commissioning of NOL Main Line and Spur Line by 2034 or earlier	The Government has executed the project agreement with the MTRCL for Part 1 of the NOL Project. The MTRCL prioritised the commencement of the more mature and imminent works of NOL Project, and

Railway and SGMTS project	(i) Cost of the preliminary study	(ii) Estimated construction cost	(iii) Year of commencement of the preliminary study, planning and design	(iv) Year of commencement of construction	(v) Estimated year of completion	(vi) Current progress
						concurrently carried out the detailed planning and design, as well as the statutory procedures for NOL Spur Line
Hong Kong Section of Hong Kong – Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu – Qianhai) (HSWRL)	$303.8 million	To be confirmed	2025	The target is to have the Hong Kong section of the project technically ready for tendering in 2027 so as to commence the detailed design and construction works promptly.	Strive for commissioning in 2035	Investigation and design are currently in progress
Pak Shek Kok Station	The Government announced in 2021 that studies would be carried out on the construction of the Pak Shek Kok Station on the East Rail Line and the comprehensive development in nearby areas. The preparatory work for the Pak Shek Kok comprehensive development project is now in the final stages. The Government will continue to maintain close liaison with the MTRCL and announce the overall proposals for the development project as early as possible upon completion of the internal procedures. In parallel, the planning of the new railway station is proceeding as scheduled and the target is to commission it by 2033 or earlier.					
Tseung Kwan O Line Southern Extension	The MTRCL submitted proposals in December 2025. The Highways Department is reviewing the MTRCL's proposals and is in close negotiation with the MTRCL. Details of the project are yet to be confirmed.					
Central Rail Link	Details of the project are yet to be confirmed.					
Northern Link Eastern Extension	The actual alignment and implementation timetable of the project will depend on the planning of land use and timetable of the development projects such as the New Territories North New Town, etc. Therefore, details of the project are yet to be confirmed.					

Railway and SGMTS project	(i) Cost of the preliminary study	(ii) Estimated construction cost	(iii) Year of commencement of the preliminary study, planning and design	(iv) Year of commencement of construction	(v) Estimated year of completion	(vi) Current progress
Northeast New Territories Line	The actual alignment and implementation timetable of the project will depend on the planning of land use and timetable of the development projects such as the New Territories North New Town, etc. Therefore, details of the project are yet to be confirmed.					
Hong Kong Island West – Hung Shui Kiu Rail Link Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands Green Mass Transit System	The engineering feasibility study of these 2 projects is part of Public Works Programme Item No. 5768CL – Studies related to Artificial Islands in the Central Waters (with an approved project estimate (APE) of $550.4 million). The study commenced in 2021. The detailed alignment and implementation timetable of the projects need to tie in with the planning of the proposed Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands. As there is no concrete implementation timetable for the reclamation works of the Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands at the present stage, details of the projects are yet to be confirmed.					
Smart and Green Mass Transit System (SGMTS) in Kai Tak	Approximately $67 million	See Note 3	2023	Contract is expected to be awarded within 2026	2031	Tendering in progress
SGMTS in East Kowloon	Approximately $262.5 million	See Note 3	2024	Tenders for the project are expected to be invited in 2026	2033	Detailed planning and design in progress
SGMTS in Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen New Development Area	Phase 1: Approximately $44.11 million Remaining phases: Under review	Under review	2024	Phase 1: Estimated to be in 2027 Remaining phases: Under review	Phase 1: Target for 2031 Remaining phases: Under review	Detailed planning and design in progress
South Island Line (West)	Undertaken by the MTRCL	See Note 4	Adoption of SGMTS: 2024	Advance construction works are expected to commence in 2027.	By 2034	Detailed planning and design in progress

Note 1: The Tung Chung Line Extension, Tuen Mun South Extension, Kwu Tung Station on the East Rail Line, Hung Shui Kiu Station, NOL Main Line and NOL Spur Line are implemented by the MTRCL through the "Rail-plus-Property" model, while the construction cost of the Oyster Bay Station is deducted from the land premium. No Government's APE is involved for these projects.

Note 2: Part 1 of the NOL Project includes the civil and structural works of 2 sections of the NOL Main Line from the Kam Sheung Road Station to the intersection with the approach tunnels to the Ngau Tam Mei Depot and from the San Tin (SAT) Station to the Kwu Tung Station, as well as the detailed planning and design of the NOL Spur Line. Part 2 of the Project includes the remaining section of the NOL Main Line, the Ngau Tam Mei Depot, and the NOL Spur Line from the SAT Station to the Huanggang Port Station, system-wide electrical and mechanical works and rolling stock, as well as the operation and maintenance of the NOL Project after commissioning.

Note 3: The Government plans to take forward the 2 SGMTS projects in Kai Tak and East Kowloon through the "Transit-Oriented Development" approach. No Government's APE is involved in these projects.

Note 4: The detailed planning and design of the South Island Line (West) are in progress. The Government will discuss the financial arrangements of the project with the MTRCL based on the ownership approach and the "Rail-plus-Property" model. The construction cost of the project is yet to be confirmed.

Annex 2

Major road project	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)
	Cost of the preliminary study (See Note 1)	**Estimated construction cost**	**Year of commencement of the preliminary study, planning and design (See Note 2)**	**Year of commencement of construction**	**Estimated year of completion**	**Current progress**
Trunk Road T2 and Cha Kwo Ling Tunnel	$133.6 million (investigation and design)	$16.017 billion	2009	2019	2026	Works in progress
Central Kowloon Route	$206.9 million (detailed design and site investigation)	$42.3639 billion	2007	2017	Commissioned in 2025	Commissioned in December 2025
Fanling Bypass (Eastern Section)	See Note 3	See Note 4	2014	2020	2026	Works in progress and expected to be commissioned at the end of April/early May 2026
Fanling Bypass (Western Section)	See Note 5	See Note 6	2019	2025	2031	Works in progress
Trunk Road T4 in Sha Tin	$34.7 million (detailed design and site investigation)	$6.81 billion	2005	2024	2030	Works in progress
Tuen Mun Bypass	See Note 7	See Note 8	2022	See Note 8	See Note 8	Investigation study in progress
Route 11 (section between Yuen Long and North Lantau)	$319 million (investigation study)	See Note 8	2021	See Note 8	See Note 8	Investigation study in progress
Tsing Yi – Lantau Link	$695 million (investigation study and detailed design)	See Note 8	2023	See Note 8	See Note 8	Investigation study in progress

Major road project	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)
	Cost of the preliminary study (See Note 1)	**Estimated construction cost**	**Year of commencement of the preliminary study, planning and design (See Note 2)**	**Year of commencement of construction**	**Estimated year of completion**	**Current progress**
Widening of Yuen Long Highway (section between Lam Tei and Tong Yan San Tsuen)	See Note 7	See Note 8	2022	See Note 8	See Note 8	The Highways Department invited tenders for the works in December 2025 for consultation with the Legislative Council on the works proposal in the second/third quarter of 2026
Improvement of Lion Rock Tunnel	$240.7 million (first stage design and site investigation)	See Note 8	2019	See Note 8	See Note 8	Design in progress
Widening of T6 Bridge of Tate's Cairn Highway	See Note 7	See Note 8	2022	See Note 8	See Note 8	Design in progress
Improvement Works of Fanling Highway (between Pak Shek Au Interchange and Po Shek Wu Road Interchange)	See Note 5	See Note 6	2020	2024	2031	Works in progress
Widening of Tsuen Wan Road and the associated junction improvement works	See Note 7	See Note 8	2019	See Note 8	See Note 8	Investigation study completed
Hong Kong Island West – Northeast Lantau Link	The engineering feasibility study of this project is part of Project Item No. 5768CL – Studies related to Artificial Islands in the Central Waters (with APE of $550.4 million). The study commenced in 2021. The detailed alignment and implementation timetable of the project need to tie in with the planning of the proposed Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands. As there is no concrete implementation timetable for the reclamation works of the Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands at the present stage, the details of the project are yet to be confirmed.					

Major road project	(i)	(ii)	(iii)	(iv)	(v)	(vi)
	Cost of the preliminary study (See Note 1)	**Estimated construction cost**	**Year of commencement of the preliminary study, planning and design (See Note 2)**	**Year of commencement of construction**	**Estimated year of completion**	**Current progress**
Road P1 (Tai Ho – Sunny Bay Section), Lantau	$130.2 million (investigation study, preliminary design and site investigation)	See Note 8	2025	See Note 8	See Note 8	The current phase of the study is expected to be completed at the end of 2026
Northern Metropolis Highway	$688.3 million (investigation study)	See Note 8	2025	See Note 8	See Note 8	Investigation study in progress
Tseung Kwan O – Yau Tong Tunnel	To be confirmed	See Note 8	N/A	See Note 8	See Note 8	Under planning
Sha Tin Bypass	To be confirmed	See Note 8	N/A	See Note 8	See Note 8	Under planning

Note 1: Only the APE related to the study/design of Category A works projects are included.

Note 2: The year of commencement of the preliminary study refers to the year of commencement of the investigation study of the works project.

Note 3: The detailed design and site investigation of the Fanling Bypass (Eastern Section) is part of Project Item No. 7772CL – Advance site formation and engineering infrastructure works at Kwu Tung North new development area and Fanling North new development area – detailed design and site investigation (with APE of $340.8 million).

Note 4: The construction works of the Fanling Bypass (Eastern Section) is part of Project Item No. 7747CL – Advance site formation and engineering infrastructure works at Kwu Tung North new development area and Fanling North new development area (with APE of $17.3201 billion).

Note 5: The detailed design and site investigation of the Fanling Bypass (Western Section) and the Improvement Works of Fanling Highway (between Pak Shek Au Interchange and Po Shek Wu Road Interchange) are part of Project Item No. 7835CL – Remaining phase of site formation and engineering infrastructure works at Kwu Tung North new development area and Fanling North new development area – detailed design and site investigation (with APE of $764.5 million).

Note 6: The construction works of the Fanling Bypass (Western Section) and the Improvement Works of Fanling Highway (between Pak Shek Au Interchange and Po Shek Wu Road Interchange) are part of Project Item No. 7828CL – Remaining phase of site formation and engineering infrastructure works at Kwu Tung North New Development Area and Fanling North New Development Area – Construction (with APE of $30.1679 billion).

Note 7: The costs of the study/design of the relevant works projects are paid by the annual provisions under Subhead 6100TX of the Capital Works Reserve Fund Head 706 (Highways).

Note 8: For projects in planning stage, their estimated construction cost would be ascertained upon completion of the investigation and design work. The Government will continuously review the cost-effectiveness of works projects and take into account the urgency and priority of the relevant projects so as to take them forward in a timely and orderly manner.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0369)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the matters related to the promotion of development of low-altitude economy (LAE), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. Please set out in tabular form the staffing provision, grades, salary expenses and administrative expenses involved in the implementation of the LAE Regulatory Sandbox and Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$.

2. Please set out in tabular form the details of the LAE Regulatory Sandbox and Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ pilot projects, including the applicant organisations, project scope, application scenarios and content, as well as the progress/results of the trials.

3. What are the staffing provision, grades, salary expenses and administrative expenses involved in the infrastructure planning for the promotion of LAE? Has funding been earmarked for constructing and developing the infrastructure related to LAE? and

4. Have assessments been conducted on whether the existing manpower is sufficient to support the implementation of the Regulatory Sandbox and Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$, as well as the review of regulations on low-altitude flying? Will additional resources be provided to enhance the work to attract and nurture professional talents in low-altitude flying so as to expedite the development of LAE?

Asked by: Hon LAU Ip-keung, Kenneth (LegCo internal reference no.: 11)

Reply:

1. The Civil Aviation Department (CAD) has established the following permanent posts to take forward the initiatives in relation to the development of low-altitude economy (LAE), including the work related to the implementation of Regulatory Sandbox projects:

Rank	No. of posts
Senior Operations Officer (Aviation Administration)	1
Operations Officer (Aviation Administration)	1
Operations Officer (Airworthiness)	1
Assistant Operations Officer (Aviation Administration)	1
Senior Electronics Engineer	1
Electronics Engineer/Assistant Electronics Engineer	2
Total:	**7**

The salary provision (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary) for the 7 posts above in 2026-27 is $7.74 million. In addition, the CAD has retained a time-limited post of 1 Administrative Officer Staff Grade B (D3), as well as time-limited posts of 1 Chief Executive Officer and 1 Senior Executive Officer from 2025-26 to 2026-27 to undertake various work related to enhancing Hong Kong's status as an international aviation hub following the commissioning of the Three-Runway System, supporting the development of LAE in Hong Kong and enhancing the overall administrative governance of the CAD. The salary provision (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary) for the 3 posts above in 2026-27 is $5.8 million. The Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB), on the other hand, has created 3 time-limited posts (1 Senior Engineer, 1 Engineer/Assistant Engineer and 1 Senior Executive Officer) from 2025-26 to 2029-30 to support the enhancement of Hong Kong's status as an international aviation hub and to take forward the development of LAE. The salary provision (in terms of notional annual mid-point salary) for the 3 posts above in 2026-27 is $3.76 million.

Currently, apart from the posts above, the TLB and the CAD will continue to use the existing resources to implement the Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ projects and other relevant work.

2. The Government announced the first batch of 38 Regulatory Sandbox projects in March 2025. Currently, 32 of these pilot projects have commenced within designated flight routes. Certain application scenarios that are relatively mature, involve lower risks and do not involve high volumes of people or vehicles in the area have been regularised (such as the use of unmanned aircraft for façade cleaning, inspection of power lines and railway infrastructure). Details of the projects (including the applicants, application scenarios/contents, locations/routes, as well as the progress/results of the trials) are set out at the **Annex**.

The Government rolled out the advanced LAE "Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$" pilot projects in November 2025 to cover unmanned aircraft system traffic management system demonstrations, unconventional aircraft, cross-boundary applications, multiple applications/users shared-platform and other application scenarios that are technically more complex. Application was closed on 28 February 2026. The response from the industry was enthusiastic, with numerous applications received for various application scenarios. The Working Group on Developing Low-altitude Economy (the Working Group) is carefully examining the applications, with the aim of progressively rolling out the pilot projects from the first half of this year.

3. The Working Group will, among other things, embark on technical studies and planning for low-altitude infrastructure, and draft the Action Plan on Developing Low-altitude Economy this year. The Government will make reference to the experience and data of the Regulatory Sandbox and Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ projects and the relevant technical studies for the formulation of appropriate infrastructure, related supporting facilities as well as standard rules and practices for low-altitude flying activities in the long run. The relevant studies and planning are still underway and the Government will continue to carefully assess the demand for and allocation of relevant resources.

4. The TLB and the CAD will continue to use the existing resources to implement the Regulatory Sandbox, the Regulatory Sandbox $\mathcal{X}$ and LAE-related regulatory review work, while keeping the implementation progress of the relevant work under review.

While taking forward the development of LAE, the Government will review the talent demand of the relevant industries, and maintain close communication with the industries to make timely planning accordingly.

Annex

Details of the Implemented LAE Regulatory Sandbox Projects (as at the end of February 2026)

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
1	Kangaroo Limited (Shenzhen Meituan Low Altitude Logistics Technology Co., Ltd.)	Drone delivery	1) Between Hong Kong Science Park (HKSP) and Tai Po Waterfront Park 2) Between HKSP and Ting Kok Village, Tai Po	Scope of trials being expanded
2	CLP Power Hong Kong	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Sai Wan, Sai Kung 2) Shing Mun Country Park 3) Ngau Tam Mei, Yuen Long (near Ngau Tam Mei Water Treatment Works) 4) Lei Muk Shue to Lai Chi Kok	Operationalised
3	Lands Department	Surveillance	1) Tso Wo Hang, Sai Kung 2) Shap Sze Heung, Sai Kung 3) Cheung Shue Tan, Tai Po	Operationalised
4	Highways Department	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Tunnel Road, Tseung Kwan O 2) Cross Bay Link, Tseung Kwan O 3) Tate's Cairn Highway	Operationalised
5	Civil Engineering and Development Department	Infrastructure surveillance	Tai Mong Tsai, Sai Kung	Operationalised
6	POI Corporation Limited (Hong Kong Science and Technology Parks Corporation)	Building cleaning	HKSP	Operationalised
7	Geosys Hong Kong Limited ((i) Development Bureau; and (ii) FLYCAMHK.com)	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Mui Tsz Lam 2) Kowloon Reservoir 3) Chai Wan 4) Plover Cove Reservoir 5) Hung Shui Kiu 6) High Island Reservoir 7) Shau Kei Wan	Operationalised

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
			8) Chai Wan 9) Kam Tin River 10) Fanling 11) Sheung Shui Sewage Treatment Works 12) Ha Tsuen	
8	Traffic Control Technology (Hong Kong) Company Limited ((i) MTR Corporation Limited; and (ii) Traffic Control Technology (Shenzhen) Company Limited)	Infrastructure surveillance	1) Inside tunnel from Exhibition Centre Station to Admiralty Station 2) Sheung Shui Station	Operationalised
9	OWOWWW Creative (Hong Kong) Company Limited (Shenzhen HighGreat Innovation Technology Development Company Limited)	Drone show system	Cyberport	Operationalised
10	Aerovision Technology Limited ((i) China Merchants Godown, Wharf, & Transportation Co., Ltd.; (ii) The Hong Kong Polytechnic University (PolyU); (iii) Flight Pro Drone Solutions Limited; and (iv) Hong Kong Model Engineering Club Limited)	System/ infrastructure	China Merchants Wharf Pier	Operationalised
11	Fire Services Department	Emergency / search and rescue	1) Fire and Ambulance Services Academy 2) Pre-defined rural areas	Operationalised
12	Fame Faith Limited ((i) S.F. Express (Hong Kong) Limited; and (ii) Hospital Authority (St. John Hospital))	Drone delivery	Cyberport to Cheung Chau	In progress
13	Future Yixin Aviation Technology Limited ((i) Yixin Smart Technology Co. Ltd; and	Drone delivery	Between Pak Shek Kok Promenade and Tai Po Waterfront Pier	In progress

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
	(ii) Easy Mobile Logistics Hong Kong Limited)			
14	Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited ((i) Civil Aid Service; (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited; and (iv) Town Formation Limited)	Emergency / search and rescue / facilities surveillance	Civil Aid Service Tai Tan Camp	Operationalised
15	DAMODA UAV (HK) Company Limited (Shenzhen DAMODA Intelligent Control Technology Co., Ltd.)	Drone show system	China Merchants Wharf Pier	Operationalised
16	Correctional Services Department (Electrical and Mechanical Services Department)	Infrastructure surveillance	Tong Fuk Correctional Institution	Operationalised
17	The Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (HKUST) (China UniCom (Hong Kong) Innovation Research Institute Limited)	Others	HKUST campus	In progress
18	SUPTC Digital Technology (Hong Kong) Limited and PolyU ((i) Gleneagles Hospital Hong Kong; (ii) Hong Kong Broadband Network Enterprise Solutions; and (iii) AutosystemHK.ai)	Drone delivery	PolyU campus	In progress
19	United Airspace Management Limited ((i) DNT FPV Drone Association Hong Kong, China; and (ii) Raspect Intelligence Inspection Limited)	Drone delivery	Lau Fau Shan	In progress
20	Godo Innovation Technology (Hong Kong) Limited (China State Construction Engineering (Hong Kong) Limited)	Security patrol	Anderson Road Quarry Site construction site	Operationalised

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
21	Hong Kong Professional Unmanned Aerial Vehicles Association Ltd (Edko Films Ltd.)	Aerial photography	Fanling Hok Tau	Operationalised
22	Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited ((i) Agriculture, Fisheries and Conservation Department; (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited; and (iv) Town Formation Limited)	Enforcement	Kat O	Operationalised
23	5G nuMultimedia Limited (DAMODA UAV (HK) Company Limited)	Drone livestreaming system	Cyberport	Operationalised
24	Hong Kong Logistics and Supply Chain MultiTech R&D Centre (Sunray Science and Technology Co. Ltd.)	Systems/ infrastructure	Cyberport	Operationalised
25	Fire Services Department	Emergency / search and rescue	Fire and Ambulance Services Academy	Operationalised
26	Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited ((i) Environmental Protection Department; (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited; (iv) DAMODA UAV (HK) Company Limited; and (v) Shenzhen Feiliu Yunxiang Technology Co Ltd.)	Air quality surveillance	Peng Chau	Operationalised
27	Hong Kong Centre for Logistics Robotics Limited (Electrical and Mechanical Services Department)	Security patrol	Wo Hop Shek Public Cemetery	In progress
28	Alpha AI Technology Limited ((i) HKT Limited; (ii) U Resonance Limited; (iii) Hong Kong Cyberport Management Company Limited;	Building inspection	Cyberport	Operationalised

	Applicant (Collaborating Organisation)	Application Scenario/Content	Location/Route	Trial Progress/Result
	(iv) Hong Kong Science & Technology Parks Corporation; (v) Auki Labs Limited; and (vi) Ricoh Hong Kong Limited)			
29	China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited ((i) Hospital Authority (Princess Margaret Hospital); (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) Hangzhou Songba Logistics Technology Co., Ltd.; (iv) Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited; and (v) The University of Hong Kong)	Signal testing	Princess Margaret Hospital	In progress
30	China Mobile Hong Kong Company Limited ((i) Auxiliary Medical Service; (ii) Greater Bay Area Low Altitude Economy Alliance; (iii) POI Corporation Limited; and (iv) Esri China (Hong Kong) Limited)	Surveillance	Tolo Harbour Cycling Track	Operationalised
31	UAS Limited ((i) Jadason Technology Limited; (ii) Dynasty Premium Chartered Surveying Group; (iii) JOUAV Automation Tech. Co. Ltd.; and (iv) Aerovision Technology Limited)	Aerial survey	Yiu Lian Dockyards, Tsing Yi	Operationalised
32	TIRAIN (HK) Limited (Lands Department)	Aerial survey	Po Toi Island	Operationalised

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0473)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Government states that it will introduce an amendment bill in the first half of this year to enhance existing tax concession measures for the maritime service industry and provide a half-rate tax concession to eligible commodities traders, which will further promote the development of high value-added maritime services in Hong Kong. What are the details?

Asked by: Hon LEE Chun-keung (LegCo internal reference no.: 14)

Reply:

Hong Kong has been a leading international maritime centre supported by our Country. The city ranks fourth in the 2025 Xinhua-Baltic International Shipping Centre Development Index, reflecting our comprehensive strengths in port, maritime services and overall business environment. With regard to the maritime service industry, Hong Kong has become an ideal base for shipping companies from around the world to establish businesses by virtue of our strengths such as "One Country, Two Systems", bilingual common law, free economy, as well as a simple and low tax system. Hong Kong currently has over 1 200 port and maritime companies, representing an increase of about 10% over 5 years earlier.

As the maritime service industry is highly internationalised and their mode of operation is inherently globalised with high mobility, Hong Kong must continue to reinforce and enhance the competitiveness and business edges of our maritime service industry in the face of keen competition from other parts of the world, so as to maintain our attractiveness and leading position as the international maritime centre. A favourable tax regime is one of the major factors in attracting the maritime service companies to set foot in Hong Kong. Hong Kong's simple and low tax regime has always been one of our competitive edges. In 2020-22, the Government has launched a series of tax concessionary measures to encourage more maritime service companies to choose Hong Kong as their business base. These include providing full profits tax exemptions for ship leasing activities, half-rate tax concessions for ship leasing management, marine insurance, ship management, ship agency and ship broking, etc., so as to reduce the operating costs of maritime service companies and strengthen Hong Kong's leading position in high value-added maritime services. Take ship leasing as an example,

the number of relevant enterprises more than quadrupled from 11 in 2020-21 to 64 in 2023-24.

After the introduction of the aforementioned tax concessions, there have been new changes in the international tax landscape. In response to the base erosion and profit shifting risks arising from the digitalisation of the economy, the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) announced the base erosion and profit shifting 2.0 proposals (BEPS 2.0 proposals) in 2021. Under the proposals, an in-scope multinational enterprise (MNE) group with an annual consolidated revenue of not less than EUR€750 million (in-scope MNE group) will be subject to a global minimum tax of at least 15% on the profits arising in each of the jurisdictions where it operates. To implement the proposals, Hong Kong has implemented a global minimum tax of 15% and imposed the Hong Kong minimum top-up tax starting from 2025. If the effective tax rate of an in-scope MNE group is less than 15% in Hong Kong (for example, due to tax concessionary measures), it must pay a top-up tax on behalf of its constituent entities at a rate equal to the difference between the effective tax rate and the minimum tax rate of 15%.

In view of the changes in the international tax rules, we have reviewed the existing tax concessionary regimes for the shipping-related activities and considered that there is room for enhancement in compliance with the international tax rules, including the introduction of tax deduction arrangements in line with the international standards (such as providing tax deductions on ship acquisition costs for ship lessors under an operating lease), and at the same time ensuring that Hong Kong's tax concessionary regimes for the shipping-related activities will maintain their competitiveness after the implementation of BEPS 2.0, with a view to sustaining the industry momentum.

Trading of commodities such as metal mine commodities account for more than half of the global shipping trade volume. Physical commodity traders are users of maritime services and an important element of the maritime service ecosystem. Attracting their presence to Hong Kong will propel the maritime service industry towards a more vibrant trajectory, which helps reinforce and enhance Hong Kong's position as an international maritime centre. To attract more Chinese Mainland and overseas physical commodity traders to establish a presence in Hong Kong or expand their businesses here, we will provide a half-rate profits tax concession for eligible physical commodity traders, whereby the applicable tax rate is reduced to 8.25% (plus an option for choosing 15% tax rate for enterprises to make an annual election if they are covered by BEPS 2.0), thereby injecting new impetus into the maritime service industry in Hong Kong.

We briefed the Panel on Economic Development of the Legislative Council (LegCo) on the proposals on 3 February this year and received Members' support. We are currently preparing the legislative work and plan to introduce a legislative amendment bill into LegCo within the first half of this year. Subject to the passage of the bill by LegCo, the tax concessions above (including the enhancements of the existing tax concessions for the shipping-related activities and the introduction of a half-rate tax concessionary regime for physical commodity trading) will be applicable to the qualifying profits for the years of assessment beginning on or after 1 April 2025.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2229)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

During 2026-27, the Transport and Logistics Bureau will continue to improve the intermodal operations and to facilitate the flow of goods and logistics information in the Greater Bay Area (GBA). Please inform this Committee of the relevant work plans. Apart from developing the Hong Kong International Airport Logistics Park in Dongguan, what plans are in place for further expanding the intermodal operations between Hong Kong and the GBA?

Asked by: Hon LEE Chun-keung (LegCo internal reference no.: 7)

Reply:

The connectivity in the transport of goods between Hong Kong and the Greater Bay Area (GBA), including the world-class cross-boundary infrastructure, the 24-hour operation at boundary control point, convenient cross-boundary transportation and highly efficient cargo clearance procedures, is the core strength of Hong Kong as an international logistics hub. Coupled with Hong Kong's well-connected international transport network, cargoes from the GBA and other places in the Chinese Mainland can be efficiently and seamlessly transhipped to the rest of the world through the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA) and the Hong Kong Port.

To maintain Hong Kong's role as the premier logistics gateway for goods between the GBA and overseas, as set out in the Action Plan on Modern Logistics Development promulgated by the Government in 2023, the Government will continue to enhance intermodal transhipment, including extending the existing arrangements under the Air Transhipment Cargo Exemption Scheme to other intermodal cargo transhipment modes, and continue to actively implement various clearance facilitation measures, such as further extending the coverage of the Single E-lock Scheme to Macao and other provinces and municipalities beyond the Guangdong Province in the Chinese Mainland; expanding the food types covered by the "Air-Land Fresh Lane" and extending its scope; introducing the "Cross-boundary Express Cargo Clearance Facilitation Arrangement" to reduce the time spent on loading, unloading and locating express cargoes inspected at Hong Kong's boundary control points; and continuously enhancing the "Single Submission for Dual Declaration" Scheme, which

will be rolled out concurrently with the launch of "Trade Single Window" in Hong Kong in mid-2026, as well as progressively extending it to include other trade documents and sea cargo, so as to save the time and manpower required for declaration by the trade, etc. Meanwhile, we support the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) in continuing to take forward the development of the sea-air intermodal cargo transhipment mode in conjunction with Dongguan. The AAHK is completing Phase 1 development of the permanent facilities of the HKIA Dongguan Logistics Park (HKIALP) in stages, with the target of commencing commercial trial operation on 1 April 2027 and full operation on 1 June 2027, gradually bringing its cargo handling capacity to 1 million tonnes per annum. The AAHK has also commenced the preliminary study for Phase 2 development of HKIALP for the introduction of more facilities to support high-value logistics, cross-boundary e-commerce and express parcel services.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2696)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

During 2026-27, the Transport and Logistics Bureau will continue to work with the Airport Authority Hong Kong on initiatives to enhance airport services, and the airport's connectivity and competitiveness. Please inform this Committee of the details of the relevant work plan, including the measures in place to further attract more airlines to set up their base in Hong Kong and encourage existing airlines to launch more new routes plying to and from Hong Kong, as well as the resources involved.

Asked by: Hon LEE Chun-keung (LegCo internal reference no.: 5)

Reply:

The Government will continue to actively participate in international civil aviation conferences and take the initiative to visit aviation partners, targeting to explore with 10 or more aviation partners within 2026 the enhancement of air connectivity (including discussing the establishment of new air services agreements or the expansion of traffic rights), with priority focus on regions with further development potential and new growth areas, such as South America, Central Asia, Africa and the Middle East, so as to support the Hong Kong International Airport to further expand its aviation network. The relevant work is undertaken by the existing staff.

Meanwhile, the Government has been, in conjunction with the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK), strategically attracting local and non-local airlines to develop new destinations and increase flights through outreach efforts, incentive schemes and policy facilitation measures. For example, the AAHK launched the Air Network Development Programme (the Programme) in June 2024, which provides financial incentives to encourage airlines to open new routes and increase flight frequencies on the existing routes. To date, the Programme has attracted 36 airlines to open 82 new routes and increase flight frequencies on 14 existing routes. The expenditure for the Programme above is borne by the AAHK and does not involve government expenditure.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2697)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Please inform this Committee of the increased number of aircraft lessors that have established their presence in Hong Kong after the enhancement to the aircraft leasing preferential tax regime by the Government and the economic benefits brought by aircraft leasing activities. During 2026-27, the Transport and Logistics Bureau will continue to work with the industry to enhance and promote Hong Kong's aircraft leasing. What are the plans and expenditures for the relevant work?

Asked by: Hon LEE Chun-keung (LegCo internal reference no.: 6)

Reply:

Since the introduction of the aircraft leasing preferential tax regime (the Regime) in 2017, the aircraft leasing business has started to develop in Hong Kong. A total of nearly 50 major industry players from the Mainland and overseas have been recorded to set up their subsidiaries/operating arms in Hong Kong, including 4 of the top 5 global aircraft lessors ranked by number of aircraft.

The Chief Executive announces in the 2022 Policy Address that the Government will develop Hong Kong into the preferred location for aircraft leasing in the region by further enhancing the Regime. The bill which amended the Inland Revenue Ordinance (Cap. 112) to enhance the Regime was passed by the Legislative Council in February 2024 and took retrospective effect from the year of assessment beginning on 1 April 2023. The industry generally supports the enhancement measure.

Furthermore, we signed a Memorandum of Understanding with the Administrative Commission of Tianjin Dongjiang Free Trade Port Zone to deepen co-operation in the development of the aircraft leasing and financing industries in April 2024, and co-organised a training workshop with the Administrative Commission of Tianjin Dongjiang Free Trade Port Zone in April 2025 to take forward the work on talent exchange and training. To step up publicity on the Regime, the Transport and Logistics Bureau sent representatives to attend an aircraft leasing and financing forum in Riyadh, Saudi Arabia at the end of April 2025 to

introduce Hong Kong's aircraft leasing policy to industry stakeholders from around the world. In future, we will continue to publicise the latest development of Hong Kong's aircraft leasing policy and the preferential tax regime so as to encourage global aircraft lessors to conduct business in Hong Kong.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0448)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in paragraph 151 of the 2026-27 Budget Speech that the Future Innovative Logistics Acceleration Scheme (FILAS) will be launched this year to enhance the interconnectivity of logistics data, with a view to increasing the competitiveness of the logistics industry. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. What are the specific details of FILAS (including its functions, objectives and expected effectiveness)?

2. As a follow-up to the above question, what are the correlation and inter-operational arrangements between FILAS and the existing systems (such as the Port Community System)? and

3. The current-term Government attaches great importance to artificial intelligence (AI), while smart logistics and data are closely related to AI. Please state what complementary schemes are in place to promote the application of the related technologies?

Asked by: Hon LEE Hoey Simon (LegCo internal reference no.: 7)

Reply:

Early in 2020, the Government launched the Pilot Subsidy Scheme for Third-party Logistics Service Providers (the Pilot Scheme) to subsidise the industry's adoption of various smart logistics technology solutions, covering artificial intelligence (AI), automation technologies, Internet of Things (IoT), real-time logistics tracking systems and various logistics management systems, etc., with a view to enhancing productivity and operational efficiency. In the Action Plan on Modern Logistics Development promulgated in October 2023, the Government proposes to promote the development of the Hong Kong's logistics industry towards the directions of smart development and digitalisation, as well as supporting the industry to upgrade and transform towards smart logistics. Subsequently, the Government enhanced the Pilot Scheme in February 2024, with the funding ceiling increased from

$1 million to $2 million per applicant enterprise and the scope of funding extended to cover training and Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) technology-related implementation services, including green logistics technology solutions incorporating AI technologies, with a view to encouraging wider adoption of innovative technologies by the industry and promoting the continuous upgrading and transformation of the logistics industry.

With the increasing prevalence of AI technologies, many projects approved under the Pilot Scheme involve the adoption of logistics management systems that integrate AI, big data analytics and/or IoT technologies. For instance, some enterprises apply AI to analyse past orders and transport data for demand forecasting and transport capacity planning, while others deploy AI algorithms to optimise route planning and fleet management to improve transport efficiency. As for warehouse management, some enterprises adopt AI together with automated equipment or robots for cargo sorting and inventory management, so as to enhance the operational efficiency and accuracy of warehouse operations.

In the meantime, the Port Community System (PCS) developed and operated by the Government was officially rolled out in January this year. The PCS is driven by AI, uses blockchain technology to record cargo flows, equipped with one-stop and round-the-clock real-time cargo tracking functions, and links up Hong Kong's sea, land, and air transport networks, thereby holistically enhancing the transparency, efficiency and interconnectivity of the logistics chain. Nevertheless, although various logistics data platforms, including the PCS, have been rolled out one after another, realisation of the full potential of the platforms will not be possible without the logistics industry's collective participation in using these platforms and providing logistics data to them. To this end, the Government will launch the Future Innovative Logistics Acceleration Scheme (FILAS) under the Pilot Scheme this year to provide funding for the industry to develop IT onboarding solutions that are compatible with the logistics data platforms operated by the Government or public organisations , with technologies such as AI, blockchain and/or big data model, etc. This aims to help and encourage the industry to use the relevant logistics data platforms such as the PCS, promote the industry's transformation towards smart logistics and enhance the interconnectivity of logistics data, with a view to enhancing the competitiveness of Hong Kong's logistics industry, further developing Hong Kong into an international smart logistics hub, as well as promoting smart port development and strengthening the competitiveness of the Hong Kong Port.

The target number of logistics enterprise beneficiaries under FILAS is 100. The Government is working out the detailed implementation details of FILAS and will announce the details in due course.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0690)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the 2026-27 Budget that the Future Innovative Logistics Acceleration Scheme (FILAS) will be launched to promote the upgrading and transformation of the logistics industry. Hong Kong has long been an important logistics hub for book trading and distribution. With the development of smart logistics in the Northern Metropolis (NM), this initiative will further enhance Hong Kong's advantages as a regional logistics hub. The main focus of public attention is how to ensure that FILAS will achieve the objective of "two-way flow in parallel", which enables books from the Chinese Mainland to be exported overseas via Hong Kong while at the same time allows books from overseas to be imported into the Mainland market, so as to fully leverage Hong Kong's role as a bridge. In addition, we will capitalise on technology empowerment to facilitate the trading of books as well as cultural and creative products, thereby better fulfilling Hong Kong's role as a hub for cultural and artistic exchange. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. What are the specific arrangements, scope of subsidy and eligibility criteria of FILAS?

2. Have key performance indicators (KPIs) been set for FILAS, such as (i) the number of participating enterprises; (ii) improvement in logistics efficiency; (iii) the number of jobs created; and (iv) sales volume of books as well as cultural and creative products generated, etc.?

3. Will the Administration consider reserving dedicated sites in the NM for developing into cross-boundary logistics hubs? If so, what are the details and timetable? If not, what are the reasons?

4. What specific measures does the Administration take to encourage logistics enterprises to adopt smart technologies (such as Internet of Things, big data, automated warehousing, blockchain tracing, etc.) in order to increase the logistics efficiency and transparency for books as well as cultural and creative products?

5. Will the smart logistics development in the NM create synergy with the logistics infrastructure in the surrounding areas (such as Qianhai, Nansha, etc.) to form a regional logistics network? and

6. Regarding Hong Kong's development strategies, will FILAS provide dedicated funding for the logistics of products in specific industries, so as to encourage enterprises to adopt smart logistics technologies (e.g. intelligent sorting systems, temperature- and humidity-controlled warehousing, tracing technologies for copyright protection, etc.) suited to the characteristics of the products?

Asked by: Hon LEE Ka-kui, Elvin (LegCo internal reference no.: 12)

Reply:

To promote the high-quality development of Hong Kong's logistics industry, the Government promulgated the Action Plan on Modern Logistics Development in 2023, in which it was proposed to promote the development of our logistics industry towards the 5 main directions of smart development, modernisation, green and sustainability, internationalisation and facilitation.

Regarding the promotion of digitalisation in the industry, the Government is committed to supporting the industry to upgrade and transform towards smart logistics. Following the launch of the Pilot Subsidy Scheme for Third-party Logistics Service Providers (the Pilot Scheme) in 2020 and the 2 enhancements of the Pilot Scheme in 2023 and 2024, the Financial Secretary announces in the 2026-27 Budget that the Government will launch the Future Innovative Logistics Acceleration Scheme (FILAS) this year to promote the transformation of the industry and enhance the interconnectivity of logistics data, with a view to increasing the competitiveness of the logistics industry. FILAS will be established under the Pilot Scheme to provide dedicated funding support for data platforms to launch IT onboarding solutions, thereby facilitating their connection with the logistics data platforms operated by the Government or public organisations. Through subsidising solutions adopting technologies such as artificial intelligence (AI), blockchain and/or big data models, FILAS aims to help the trade connect to the relevant logistics data platforms by supporting them in enhancing business operations. The target number of logistics enterprise beneficiaries under FILAS is 100. The eligibility criteria for the Pilot Scheme are that applicant enterprises must be third-party logistics service providers with substantive business operations related to either inbound or outbound logistics services in Hong Kong. As a sub-scheme under the Pilot Scheme, the eligibility criteria for FILAS will align with those of the Pilot Scheme.

Apart from FILAS, logistics enterprises may continue to apply for funding for various solutions related to smart and green logistics under the Pilot Scheme. Under the Pilot Scheme, enterprises may receive funding support of up to $2 million based on a subsidy ratio of 2 (Government) to 1 (enterprise). The approved projects under the Pilot Scheme mainly cover 4 major areas, namely (1) logistics operation management systems; (2) enterprise and data management systems; (3) application of AI and data analytics; and (4) cargo identification and inspection equipment. As such, the Pilot Scheme has effectively addressed the funding needs of third-party logistics service providers seeking to adopt various smart logistics technologies, including those that specifically tailored to individual industries. According to a survey, about 90% of the logistics enterprises indicated that the Pilot Scheme had brought positive impacts on their business operations, including improving operational processes, as well as enhancing operational efficiency and service quality, etc. We

encourage the industry to continue to make good use of the Pilot Scheme in future to adopt advanced logistics technologies to support Hong Kong in handling a wider variety of goods, thereby fully leveraging Hong Kong's role as a gateway for the import and export of goods in the Greater Bay Area and supporting the local development of various competitive industries, such as the arts and culture and creative industries. On the other hand, the Government, through the Professional Training on Smart and Green Logistics Scheme, also subsidises practitioners in the logistics industry to receive training related to modern and smart logistics, covering a wide range of courses related to smart logistics, digitalisation, AI, big data analytics, robots, automation technologies, cybersecurity technologies, as well as Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) issues, so as to further support the upgrading and transformation of the industry.

Regarding the promotion of logistics modernisation, an adequate supply of logistics sites is crucial to the relevant development. As such, the Government has reserved about 32 hectares of land in the Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen New Development Area for developing a modern logistics cluster (Hung Shui Kiu logistics cluster), so as to cater for the long-term needs of the industry for logistics sites. The findings of the relevant planning study were announced in January 2026. The Hung Shui Kiu logistics cluster is adjacent to Shenzhen Qianhai and Nanshan District and has convenient transport connections, being only a 5-minute drive to the Shenzhen Bay Port and a 20-minute drive to the Kwai Tsing Container Terminals and the Hong Kong International Airport. Besides, it is located in the north-western part of the New Territories, just 10 kilometres from Shenzhen in direct distance, thereby presenting favourable conditions for trialling low-altitude flying activities. Therefore, the Hung Shui Kiu logistics cluster has great potential for developing cross-boundary logistics, serving as a gateway for foreign cargo entering the Chinese Mainland market or Chinese Mainland products "going global" via Hong Kong.

The Government will invite expressions of interest from the industry for the first site in the Hung Shui Kiu logistics cluster within 2026, and will draw up the relevant land lease terms and development mode after taking into account the industry's interest to ensure that they will keep pace with the development needs of the industry.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0249)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Logistics supply chains around the globe are being disrupted by the volatile situation in the Middle East with many flights and ocean-going vessels diverting their routes, leading to increased freight costs and longer transport times. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1) Has the Government assessed the impact of the unstable situation in the Middle East on the local shipping and logistics industries? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

2) What measures has the Government taken to assist the industries in addressing the adverse impact arising from the unstable external situation? and

3) What are the expenditure and expected effectiveness of the measures?

Asked by: Hon LEUNG Chun, Jonathan (LegCo internal reference no.: 35)

Reply:

The Government has been closely monitoring the impact of the developments in the Middle East on the maritime and logistics industries in Hong Kong. Overall, as tensions in the Middle East persist, leading to a rise in international oil prices which in turn drives up freight costs, Hong Kong's maritime and logistics industries, which link up global cargo flows, are inevitably affected.

In terms of maritime transport, the routes currently affected by the military conflicts in the Middle East are mainly concentrated around the Strait of Hormuz, which serves as a key passage for oil tankers. As the vessels using the Hong Kong Port are mainly container vessels, the current core operations and routes of the Hong Kong Port have relatively limited connection with the affected waters. However, some vessels have to divert their routes due to tensions in the Middle East and global oil prices fluctuate as a result of the conflicts, thereby increasing fuel costs and insurance charges.

The Government will continue to monitor the latest developments in the Middle East and their impact on the maritime and logistics industries in Hong Kong, maintain close communication with the industries and take appropriate measures when necessary. In the long run, we will continue to consolidate and enhance Hong Kong's competitiveness as an international maritime centre and a regional logistics hub. Measures include promoting smart port development, developing green maritime fuel bunkering, and strengthening the economic and trade ties with the Belt and Road countries, with a view to diversifying risks and enhancing Hong Kong's resilience to external shocks.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2364)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the work to strengthen Hong Kong's status as an international and regional aviation centre, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1) What are the latest progress of establishing air services arrangements with more aviation partners and the specific targets for 2026-27?

2) Since the launch of the Air Network Development Programme by the Airport Authority Hong Kong in June 2024, what are the number of additional airlines that have come to operate in Hong Kong and their cumulative number, the number of flights involved in the new destinations, as well as the relevant passenger and cargo throughput? and

3) What are the manpower resources involved in the work to expand the aviation network?

Asked by: Hon LEUNG Chun, Jonathan (LegCo internal reference no.: 36)

Reply:

As at 2025, we have signed 86 bilateral air services documents covering more than 700 destinations worldwide. In 2025, we updated/ expanded bilateral air services arrangements with a number of aviation partners, and reached consensus with Chile, Peru, Poland, Togo, Argentina, Ecuador and Cuba on the establishment of new air services agreements. The Government will continue to actively participate in international civil aviation conferences and take the initiative to visit aviation partners, targeting to explore with 10 or more aviation partners within 2026 the enhancement of air connectivity (including discussing the establishment of new air services agreements or the expansion of traffic rights), with priority focus on regions with further development potential and new growth areas, such as South America, Central Asia, Africa and the Middle East, so as to support the Hong Kong International Airport to further expand its aviation network. The relevant work is undertaken by the existing staff.

The Government has been, in conjunction with the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK), strategically attracting local and non-local airlines to develop new destinations and increase flights through outreach efforts, incentive schemes and policy facilitation measures. For example, the AAHK launched the Air Network Development Programme (the Programme) in June 2024, which provides financial incentives to encourage airlines to open new routes and increase flight frequencies on the existing routes. To date, the Programme has attracted 36 airlines to open 82 new routes and increase flight frequencies on 14 existing routes. The expenditure for the Programme above is borne by the AAHK and does not involve government expenditure.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2365)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

In 2025-26, the Transport and Logistics Bureau followed up on the findings and recommendations of the Study on the Strategic Development Plan for Hong Kong Port 2030 and "Proposals for Enhancing the Use of Port Back-up Land in Kwai Tsing". In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the latest progress of the relevant work and the resources involved?

Asked by: Hon LEUNG Chun, Jonathan (LegCo internal reference no.: 37)

Reply:

The findings of the Study on the Strategic Development Plan for Hong Kong Port 2030 released in 2014 propose enhancing port facilities to enhance the competitiveness of the Hong Kong Port (HKP). To further consolidate and enhance Hong Kong's position as an international maritime centre, the Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB) promulgated the Action Plan on Maritime and Port Development Strategy in December 2023, which sets out 10 strategies and 32 action measures in 4 directions: enhancing port competitiveness; strengthening high value-added maritime services; enhancing promotion of Hong Kong maritime brand and grooming talent; and enhancing the support of the former Hong Kong Maritime and Port Board, to holistically attract cargoes from around the world to make use of the HKP. On the basis of the Action Plan, the Government is committed to enhancing the competitiveness of the HKP through a strategy of enhancing "quality" and enhancing "quantity".

In terms of enhancing "quality", the Government sets digitalisation, green transformation and smart transition as the specific development strategies, with the target of developing a world-class green and smart port, so as to ensure that Hong Kong keeps pace with global shipping trends, maintains its international connectivity and provides maritime enterprises with irreplaceable port services.

Regarding digitalisation, the Government rolled out the Port Community System (PCS) in January 2026 for use by the industry. The PCS is equipped with cargo tracking functions,

linking up Hong Kong's sea, land, and air cargo transport information and facilitating trade and capital flows through digitalisation. In addition, value-added electronic services such as the "One-Data-Multiple-Declarations" function for making import/export trade declarations for cargo are also provided. As for green transformation, the Government promulgated the Action Plan on Green Maritime Fuel Bunkering in November 2024, which covers a wide range of areas such as the supply of fuels, infrastructural support, port emissions reduction, etc., and is actively taking forward various action measures in the Action Plan. In 2025, the accumulated green maritime fuel bunkering volume in Hong Kong exceeded 220 000 tonnes, of which 16 and 110 operations were liquefied natural gas and biodiesel bunkering services respectively. We also provided green methanol bunkering services at an anchorage and a container terminal for the first time in early March this year, positioning Hong Kong as one of the major ports that provide a variety of green maritime fuel bunkering services in different modes. Regarding smart transition, the Kwai Tsing Container Terminals have been utilising computer systems for centralised resource allocation and management for many years. Port operators are gradually upgrading their hardware facilities to enhance the level of automation, including converting more older cranes to remote operation and introducing more autonomous electric terminal tractors. The Port Development Committee of the Hong Kong Maritime and Port Development Board is actively exploring feasible strategies to further promote automation in Hong Kong's container terminals, with a view to enhancing their overall operational efficiency.

Regarding enhancing "quantity", the Government has in recent years been actively establishing a comprehensive "rail-sea-land-river" intermodal transport system connecting to the inland region to extend the HKP's cargo hinterland and has achieved significant results. Port operators have launched various sea-rail intermodal routes, including the Chongqing-Shenzhen-Hong Kong scheduled rail-sea service, the Chengdu-Shenzhen-Hong Kong scheduled rail-sea service and the Chongqing-Qinzhou-Hong Kong sea-rail intermodal service. Cargoes from the central and western regions are transported by rail to coastal ports, and then transited to Hong Kong via barges or other liner services for onward transhipment via ocean-going vessels. During the Hong Kong Maritime Week in 2025, the operator of the Western New Land-Sea Corridor, the Guangxi Beibu Gulf and 2 container terminal operators in Hong Kong signed memoranda of understanding, launching a premium sea-rail transhipment service connecting Sichuan, Chongqing, Guangxi and Hong Kong. Looking ahead, the TLB will continue to further expand Hong Kong's cargo hinterland, taking into account factors such as cargo sources and volume. Meanwhile, we are closely monitoring the impact on the HKP of the commissioning of the Pinglu Canal in Guangxi this year, and will work with the industry to examine how to capitalise on the opportunities brought by the Pinglu Canal to attract more transhipment cargo to the HKP.

In the meantime, the Government is currently implementing the proposals in phases to enhance the use of port back-up land in the vicinity of the Kwai Tsing Container Terminals so as to meet the needs of port and logistics development, and will continue the relevant work in 2026-27.

Since 2015, the Government has refined the management mechanism for port back-up land in Kwai Tsing being let out by short-term tenancies (STTs) to better meet the operational needs of small- and medium-sized logistics enterprises. Relevant clauses include extending the fixed term of an STT from 3 or 5 years to 7 years (subject to the availability of land),

removing the triennial rent review during the fixed term of an STT, and confining permitted uses for each STT site to a single major use.

We will continue to collaborate with the relevant departments to provide suitable port back-up land for terminal yard space and barge berths, thereby enhancing the cargo handling efficiency of the Kwai Tsing Container Terminals.

In addition, relevant feasibility studies have been completed regarding the development of complex buildings on port back-up land for use as multi-storey modern logistics facilities cum public carpark, as well as for container storage and cargo handling purposes. We have identified 4 logistics sites with development potential in the vicinity of the Kwai Tsing Container Terminals and the first logistics site in Tsing Yi (i.e. Tsing Yi Town Lot No. 202) was sold through open tender in February 2025. We will dispose of a total of 3 logistics sites in the vicinity of the Kwai Tsing Container Terminals in an orderly manner subject to the market situation.

The relevant work is undertaken by the existing staff of the TLB as part of their regular duties and no breakdown of the expenditures involved is available.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3204)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Since the launch of the Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector – Aviation Industry by the Government, the manpower shortage in both the airlines and the ground services sector has been effectively mitigated, and the service quality has also seen an improvement. Regarding the scheme, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. What is the current number of imported workers of the 10 designated job types under the scheme? Among them, what is the number of those whose applications for contract renewal have been approved upon the completion of their two-year contracts?

2. Given that the ground services sector has indicated that it still faces recruitment difficulties, will the Government consider increasing the quota for labour importation for the aviation industry? If so, what are the details and will the application procedures be further simplified to shorten the processing time for approval? If not, what are the reasons and what are the other measures in place to alleviate the problem of manpower shortage in the aviation industry? and

3. Will the Transport and Logistics Bureau continue to work with the Airport Authority Hong Kong to implement the Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector – Aviation Industry in 2026-27? What are the plans and resources involved in such work?

Asked by: Hon LEUNG Chun, Jonathan (LegCo internal reference no.: 39)

Reply:

1. The Government launched the Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector – Aviation Industry (the Scheme) in July 2023 to allow licensees, franchisees or holders of operating permits issued by the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) to apply for labour importation to fill vacancies for frontline non-supervisory jobs under 10 designated job types at the airport, on the premise of safeguarding the employment of local workers, with a quota ceiling of 6 300.

After 3 rounds of applications, all 6 300 quotas have been granted, with the contract periods of the first batch of imported workers expiring towards the end of 2025. To ensure the continuity of airport operations and services, the Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB) and the AAHK allow employers to apply for quotas for contract renewal starting from July 2025, so as to facilitate contract renewal with the existing imported workers. Please refer to the table below for details.

Job type	July 2025		January 2026	
	No. of quotas for contract renewal applied	No. of quotas for contract renewal granted	No. of quotas for contract renewal applied	No. of quotas for contract renewal granted
1. Passenger Services Officer	195	195	864	864
2. Ramp Services Agent	342	342	339	339
3. Cabin Worker	267	267	208	208
4. Aircraft Maintenance Mechanic/Technician	19	19	7	7
5. Tractor Driver	226	226	130	128
6. Warehouse Operator/ Cargo Hander	91	91	118	118
7. Equipment/Loader Operator	130	130	106	106
8. Customer Services Agent	38	38	68	68
9. Aircraft Tug Driver	19	19	5	5
10. Maintenance Technician	28	28	68	68
Total	**1 355**	**1 355**	**1 913**	**1 911**

2. To ensure that the aviation industry has sufficient manpower, the AAHK and the airport community will continue to conduct local recruitment activities to promote the development prospects and employment opportunities of the aviation industry. They will also actively enhance the working environment and welfare of practitioners to retain talent. To reduce the manpower pressure in the long term, the AAHK also implements technology and smart techniques in airport services. The relevant work does not involve government expenditure.

The Government will take into account a number of relevant factors, such as the findings of the latest round of the airport manpower survey conducted by the AAHK, the latest situation in the local labour market, the implementation status of the Scheme, the stakeholders' views on the Scheme, in considering the way forward of the Scheme.

3. The administrative work of the Scheme is mainly undertaken by the AAHK and does not involve government expenditure, while the work related to the supervision of the Scheme and approval of applications for labour importation is absorbed by the block vote of the TLB, and hence no breakdown of the expenditures involved is available.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0548)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the Budget that the Transport Strategy Blueprint has recently been announced, outlining the implementation of a series of railway, major road, and Smart and Green Mass Transit System (SGMTS) projects, including the Northern Link Main Line and Spur Line, the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu-Qianhai), the Northern Metropolis Highway, and the SGMTS project in Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen. These projects are expected to be completed in phases over the next 10 to 15 years, involving massive public capital expenditure. Please inform this Committee of the following:

(1) Regarding the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link and other cross-boundary projects, has an initial consensus been reached with the relevant Mainland authorities on the capital contribution ratio? If so, what are the principles and ratio of contribution?

(2) Will the financing arrangements for the above railway and cross-boundary projects involve the "Rail-plus-Property" model, the offsetting of costs with land development revenues, the issuance of dedicated bonds, or other public-private partnership (PPP) models? What is the Government's financial commitment under each model? and

(3) Has a detailed transport demand forecast been conducted regarding the overall patronage distribution across the existing railway network upon the completion of the Northern Link? Under the full development scenario of the Northern Metropolis, what are the estimated highest loadings of the East Rail Line and Tuen Ma Line during peak hours?

Asked by: Hon LEUNG Tsz-wing, Dennis (LegCo internal reference no.: 7)

Reply:

(1) & (2) All along, the Government would consider the implementation and financial arrangements of each railway project taking into account the construction and operation details as well as the distinctiveness and individual circumstances of that railway project, and will also consider utilising market resources to take forward a project. Currently, railway projects are mainly implemented using the "Rail-plus-Property" (R+P) model which has

proven to be effective. The Government grants property development rights having regard to the funding gap of the project, while the railway company bears the commercial risks associated with the design, construction, operation and maintenance of the new railway project. Under this arrangement, the railway company would co-ordinate the works for the property development as well as those for the railway, which could enable synergy among the stations, depots and property development, and also create incentive for the railway company to complete the railway project and thus enhance the value of the property development as early as possible. Where circumstances warrant, the Government does not preclude the possibility to provide financial support for new railway projects through or in combination with other means. In fact, there were railway projects being taken forward using other approaches.

In accordance with the vision of jointly developing the "Greater Bay Area on the Rail", the Hong Kong Special Administrative Region Government and the Shenzhen authorities continue to jointly take forward the 2 cross-boundary railway projects namely the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu-Qianhai) (HSWRL) and the Northern Link (NOL) Spur Line projects through the Task Force for Hong Kong-Shenzhen Co-operation on Cross-Boundary Railway Infrastructure (the Task Force). To strengthen the co-ordination between the 2 places, the 2 governments established the Office for Implementing Cross-Boundary Railway Projects (the Office) and the Legal Group under the framework of the Task Force to take forward the investigation, planning and design of the cross-boundary railway projects, as well as to study and discuss the legal issues involved in the 2 projects.

The Highways Department (HyD) commenced the investigation and design for the Hong Kong section of the HSWRL in mid-2025 and is now carrying out the design and associated site investigation works, as well as the statutory procedures, and financial assessments, etc., during which an estimation of the construction cost for the Hong Kong section of the project will be made. As regards the apportionment of the construction cost of the HSWRL, the preliminary consensus of the 2 governments is that the costs of works that clearly fall within the boundary of one side, such as railway stations and tunnels, will be borne by the relevant side, while the costs of shared facilities for the entire railway line, such as train fleets and signalling systems, will be shared equally between the 2 sides. The 2 governments will continue to discuss the detailed arrangements through the Task Force and the Office.

The NOL project (including the NOL Main Line and the Spur Line) is implemented by the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) using the R+P model under the ownership approach, under which the MTRCL would be responsible for the financing, design, construction, operation and maintenance of the new railway project. No capital works funding from the Government is involved. In July 2025, the Transport and Logistics Bureau executed the Part 1 Project Agreement with the MTRCL for the NOL Project, which specifies that the financial support provided by the Government to the MTRCL is $39.05 billion (at money-of-the-day prices). As for Part 2 of the NOL Project, the HyD is reviewing the relevant detailed planning and design proposals and the financial support required would be confirmed in due course.

(3) The Government has promulgated the Hong Kong Major Transport Infrastructure Development Blueprint (the Blueprint) in 2023, which consolidates all major transport infrastructure currently under planning, design and construction in a forward-looking manner,

and holistically outlines and plans for the development of strategic transport infrastructure, with a view to meeting the transport and logistics demand up to 2046 and beyond. Taking into account the available planning data on land development, the Blueprint has duly considered the transport and logistics demand arising from population growth, employment and economic activities in the major planned development areas, such as the Northern Metropolis, as well as other places across the territory, and prioritise the implementation of projects based on traffic analysis. With the progressive completion of the various major transport infrastructure projects, as well as increasing the carrying capacity of the existing railway network through increasing the number of trains and upgrading the systems, it is expected that Hong Kong's railway and major road networks (including the Tuen Ma Line and the East Rail Line) will be sufficient to meet the transport and logistics demand arising from the Northern Metropolis.

Furthermore, the Government will continue to urge the MTRCL to closely monitor the patronage of railway lines in response to changes such as community development, local population growth, community planning and the addition of new stations, etc., and adopt a multi-pronged approach to improve passenger flow and enhance the travel experience of passengers, including adjusting train services flexibly, strengthening passenger flow control, enhancing spatial layouts of stations, etc. so as to continue to provide the community with safe, reliable and effective railway services.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2191)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Government launched the Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector – Aviation Industry (the Scheme) in July 2023 to allow aviation-related companies with direct contractual relationship with the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) to import workers. It is reported that an overwhelming number of applications have been received with all quotas allocated. It is mentioned under Programme (3) that the Transport and Logistics Bureau will continue to work with the AAHK to implement the Scheme. In this connection, please advise on the total number of workers approved to be imported since the launch of the Scheme. Does the Government have the latest estimated figures for the manpower shortage in the aviation-related job types? Are there any plans to increase the labour importation quotas and expand the job types under the Scheme in future?

Asked by: Hon NG Wing-ka, Jimmy (LegCo internal reference no.: 3)

Reply:

The Government launched the Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector – Aviation Industry (the Scheme) in July 2023 to allow licensees, franchisees or holders of operating permits issued by the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) to apply for labour importation to fill vacancies for frontline non-supervisory jobs under 10 designated job types at the airport, on the premise of safeguarding local workers, with a quota ceiling of 6 300.

After 3 rounds of applications, all 6 300 quotas have been granted, covering all 10 job types under the Scheme. As at January 2026, among the quotas used, a total of 5 373 imported workers have arrived to work in Hong Kong through the Scheme.

With the commissioning of the Three-Runway System at the end of 2024, the flight handling capacity and the number of passengers of the Hong Kong International Airport will continue to rise, and it is expected that the manpower required at the airport will also increase gradually. The AAHK and the airport community will continue to conduct local recruitment activities to promote the development prospects and employment opportunities of the aviation industry. They will also actively enhance the working environment and welfare of practitioners to retain

talent. To reduce manpower pressure in the long term, the AAHK also implements technology and smart techniques in airport services. The relevant work does not involve government expenditure.

The Government will take into account a number of relevant factors, such as the findings of the latest round of the airport manpower survey conducted by the AAHK, the latest situation in the local labour market, the implementation status of the Scheme, the stakeholders' views on the Scheme, in considering the way forward of the Scheme

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0586)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in paragraph 77 of the Budget Speech that on the premise of ensuring road safety, the Government is accelerating the development of autonomous driving into driverless mode and scaling up its operations, with a view to expediting its transition to commercial operations and encouraging the industry to leverage Hong Kong as a platform to tap into overseas markets. In this connection, will the Transport and Logistics Bureau inform this Committee of the following:

(1) Apart from the Airportcity Link, has the Government formulated specific implementation timetables and financial budgets for the pilot programmes for commercialisation of autonomous driving in more designated areas (such as the Northern Metropolis, innovation and technology parks or roads in new development areas)? If so, please set out the dedicated resources and the funding arrangements planned for this financial year; and

(2) To encourage local enterprises to substantively participate in the autonomous driving industry chain (including automotive AI chips, light detection and ranging devices, transducers, etc.), will the Government provide supporting tax concessions, priority arrangements in government procurement or financing support measures to develop a sustainable commercial model?

Asked by: Hon NG Wun-kit (LegCo internal reference no.: 20)

Reply:

(1) The Government has been promoting the development of autonomous vehicles (AVs) in Hong Kong in an active and orderly manner through a multi-pronged approach by providing policy support, regulatory backing and financial subsidy. The new regulatory framework for AVs came into effect in March 2024. The Transport Department (TD) concurrently published the Code of Practice for Trial and Pilot Use of Autonomous Vehicles (the Code), setting out the detailed technical, safety, and operational requirements to facilitate the trial and pilot use of AVs. As at the end of February 2026, the TD issued 6 pilot licences, involving a total of 62 AVs being trialed in different locations (i.e. North Lantau, the West

Kowloon Cultural District, Cyberport in the Southern District, the Kai Tak Development Area in Kowloon East, the Airportcity Link at the airport, and the "Park & Fly Car Park" of the Hong Kong Port of the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge).

To propel AV development to a higher level in accordance with the 2025 Policy Address and the Transport Strategy Blueprint, and to introduce and drive the industry to commence trial and use in the community at full speed, with a view to moving towards self-driving and large scaled operations as well as commercial operation, the Commissioner for Transport has established the Autonomous Vehicle Applications Promotion Working Group (the Working Group). The Working Group will advance related initiatives in collaboration with relevant departments and the industry, including reviewing the progress of individual AV projects, and providing steer on the trial locations and vehicle types, as well as the licensing arrangements required to support the commercial development of AVs. It will also explore appropriate regulatory arrangements to allow AVs to provide a certain degree of commercial services in specific areas on an individual pilot basis. This aims to accelerate the smooth transition of autonomous driving technology from the research and development testing phase to actual commercial operation, allowing more members of the public to access and experience the service.

The Working Group held its first meeting on 17 March 2026. The relevant work is undertaken by the existing staff of the TD as part of their regular duties and no breakdown of the resources involved is available.

(2) The Smart Traffic Fund provides funding support to local organisations or enterprises for conducting research and application of innovation and technology with the objective of promoting smart mobility. As at the end of February 2026, the Management Committee on Smart Traffic Fund approved 5 AV trial projects and 9 projects related to Vehicle-to-Everything (V2X) technology and other enabling technologies, involving a total funding amount of about $170 million. The trial routes cover public roads and various application scenarios, which aims to enhance the capability of AVs to handle Hong Kong's complex road conditions. Through projects under the Smart Traffic Fund, the Government, the industry and the academia have collectively accumulated experience. Coupled with cross-departmental collaboration, we have attracted multiple technology companies to conduct research and development on AVs and related technologies in Hong Kong.

In addition, Invest Hong Kong has been reaching out to a wide spectrum of enterprises in various industries around the world, including companies related to the autonomous driving industry chain, to attract and assist them to set up or expand their businesses in Hong Kong. In addition, one-stop customised support services will also be offered from the planning to implementation stages.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0635)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in paragraph 152 of the Budget Speech that the Government has reserved about 32 hectares of land in the Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen New Development Area for developing a modern logistics cluster and will invite expressions of interest from the industry this year. In this connection, will the Bureau inform this Committee of the following:

(1) Has the Government completed a cost-effectiveness analysis for the project? If so, please set out the estimated infrastructure costs and economic returns. and

(2) If the development proposals submitted by the industry are not sufficient to support the implementation of the project, does the Government have any alternative land use plans or adjustment proposals?

Asked by: Hon NG Wun-kit (LegCo internal reference no.: 23)

Reply:

To foster the development of the modern logistics industry and enhance Hong Kong's position as a sustainable international logistics hub focusing on high-value goods and the e-commerce market, the Government promulgated the Action Plan on Modern Logistics Development (Action Plan) in October 2023 to steer the future development of Hong Kong's logistics industry. The Action Plan points out that the insufficient supply of logistics land in Hong Kong leads to an increase in rental costs, which will in turn affect Hong Kong's competitiveness as a regional logistics hub. Considering that a stable supply of logistics sites is of utmost importance to promoting the development of modern logistics, the Action Plan proposes to develop modern logistics clusters with different functions in the new development areas (NDAs) of the Northern Metropolis (NM). The Government also promulgated the Northern Metropolis Action Agenda in the same year to outline the development blueprint for the NM. In particular, the Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen (HSK/HT) NDA is located within the zone of the High-end Professional Services and Logistics Hub in the NM. With the "East in East out, West in West out" strategy for cross-boundary goods movement and the advantage of proximity to the Shenzhen Bay Port, it has potential to

become a modern logistics hub. As such, the Government has reserved about 32 hectares of land in the HSK/HT NDA for developing a modern logistics cluster as a pilot site, so as to cater for the long-term needs of the industry for logistics land, leverage the clustering effect, and promote the sustainable development of smart and green logistics in Hong Kong. The findings of the relevant planning study were announced in January 2026.

The Hung Shui Kiu logistics cluster will be developed through an "enterprise-oriented" approach. Given that it comprises multiple land parcels, the Government will invite the industry to submit expressions of interest prior to the disposal of individual sites so as to gauge market interest, including the economic benefits, implementation arrangements, financial viability, etc. of the projects. The Government will draw up the relevant land lease terms and development modes after taking into account the industry's interest to ensure that they will keep pace with the development needs of the industry. Based on the interest and views of the industry, we will formulate suitable development conditions (including land use, building requirements, ways of land disposal, financial arrangements, etc.), the land disposal plan, etc.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1506)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the Budget that tender for the Smart and Green Mass Transit System (SGMTS) project in the Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen New Development Area is expected to be invited this year. In this connection, please inform this Committee of the following:

1. Regarding the project, what are the timetable for invitation of tenders and the estimated construction timetable? What are its overall works schedule and estimated expenditures?

2. According to the findings of a study by the Government earlier, the entire Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen and Yuen Long South system will have an alignment of about 16 kilometres in length, serving a population of around 300 000 residents, and it will be commissioned in phases. Will the Government advise on the expected completion and commissioning dates for the 2 phases? and

3. When taking forward the SGMTS, will the Government concurrently review and assess the carrying capacity of the related railway stations in use (e.g. Hung Shui Kiu Station, Tin Shui Wai Station, Long Ping Station, etc.) as well as the needs for public transport interchanges and other ancillary facilities, so as to ensure seamless transition between different modes of transport?

Asked by: Hon TAM Chun-kwok (LegCo internal reference no.: 17)

Reply:

The proposed Smart and Green Mass Transit System (SGMTS) in the Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen New Development Area (HSK/HT NDA) will have an alignment of about 16 kilometres in length. To meet the traffic and transport needs of the NDA at different stages of development, the Government will take forward the SGMTS in phases. Phase 1 of the proposed SGMTS is about 4.5 kilometres long with 7 proposed stations, connecting Nai Wai to the planned Residential Area, Enterprise and Technology Quarter, modern logistics cluster and industrial park in the HSK/HT NDA.

Currently, the Government is carrying out detailed design for Phase 1 of the SGMTS and concurrently reviewing the estimated expenditures for the associated works. The Government aims to invite tenders for Phase 1 project in the second half of this year and award the contract in 2027 for commissioning by 2031, so as to support the Second Phase Development of the HSK/HT NDA. We will also continue to plan and take forward the remaining parts of the SGMTS in phases to meet the traffic and transport needs of the HSK/HT and Yuen Long South NDAs at different stages of development.

The alignment design of the SGMTS will dovetail with the layouts of existing or proposed roads/public transport interchanges and railway stations, so as to ensure smooth transition from the SGMTS to different modes of transport and provide a smart and efficient travel experience. For Phase 1 planning of the SGMTS, it will connect to the Light Rail Nai Wai Stop, the Tuen Ma Line Hung Shui Kiu Station (under construction) and the Hong Kong-Shenzhen Western Rail Link (Hung Shui Kiu – Qianhai) (under planning). There will be pedestrian linkage walkways at interchange stations to connect to the stations mentioned above, providing convenient transport feeder services for the public to travel to various districts across the territory.

On the whole, the Tuen Ma Line (including the carrying capacity of its stations) can meet the transport needs arising from the major population intake in the HSK/HT NDA. The Government and the MTR Corporation Limited have also been closely monitoring the train services on various railway lines, and adopt a multi-pronged approach in a timely manner in response to changes in patronage and the actual situation, including increasing train frequencies, adjusting train services flexibly, arranging additional short-haul train services, strengthening passenger flow control, etc., so as to improve passenger flow and enhance the travel experience of passengers. In addition, under the current planning, a transport interchange hub will be built near the Hung Shui Kiu Station to facilitate transfers between different modes of transport. The Transport Department will make reference to the relevant transport consultancy reports to explore ways to strengthen public transport services in the area (such as franchised bus routes) to meet passenger demand.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1511)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding pet-friendly policies, please inform this Committee of the following:

1. Does the Administration have any plans to make legislative amendments to, for instance, By-law 28 of the Mass Transit Railway By-laws to allow passengers to bring pets on various modes of public transport? If so, what is the legislative timetable? If not, what are the reasons?

2. Given that both the MTR Corporation Limited and franchised bus operators have introduced pilot schemes before with enthusiastic responses from pet owners, has the Administration consulted public transport operators on their views and intentions regarding the issue of allowing passengers to bring pets on board? Are the responses positive? and

3. Has the Administration assessed the additional passenger trips and fare/ticket revenue estimated to be generated if passengers are allowed to bring pets on public transport?

Asked by: Hon TAM Chun-kwok (LegCo internal reference no.: 24)

Reply:

Currently, different public transport services have different requirements regarding whether animals are allowed on board. For the MTR, public light buses, ferries and taxis, the respective operators and taxi drivers may decide at their discretion whether to allow animals on board. Starting from 1 May 2025, the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) has allowed passengers to travel with their cats and dogs on the light rail during weekends and public holidays, subject to compliance of relevant requirements. In addition, the MTRCL organised a special event in March 2026 to allow eligible participants to travel with their pet dogs on the heavy rail.

As for franchised buses, passengers are currently prohibited from travelling with animals (except for guide dogs accompanying the visually impaired). Individual franchised bus operators provide pet bus services through non-franchised bus services.

We have noted that there are calls to relax the restrictions on travelling with pets on public transport, while there are also passengers who are concerned that such proposals may affect the operation of public transport. In considering whether to allow passengers to travel with their pets on public transport, the operators need to consider various factors holistically in order to strike a balance between the needs of pet owners and the comfort and safety of other passengers. These factors include the actual operations of different modes of public transport, compartment space, seating layout and carrying capacity, the handling of unexpected situations involving pets, as well as the potential impact on other passengers.

The Government will continue to listen carefully to the views of different stakeholders and passengers and maintain communication with different public transport operators, so as to continuously review and assess the situation and ensure that public transport services can properly address and balance the needs of different passengers.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1512)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned under the Programme of Land and Waterborne Transport that the Transport and Logistics Bureau will introduce legislative amendments for regulating the use of electric mobility devices to provide effective and safe short-distance commuting options. Will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. What are the latest developments and the detailed progress regarding the certification standards for such devices? When are the amendments expected to be tabled at the Legislative Council for consideration? and

2. In view of the frequent occurrences of explosions and injuries, does the Administration plan to enhance law enforcement and public awareness before legislation? If so, will this incur additional expenditure?

Asked by: Hon TAM Chun-kwok (LegCo internal reference no.: 26)

Reply:

1. The Government has always adopted an open attitude towards new technologies for promoting green commuting whilst attaching great importance to road safety. We note that electric mobility devices (EMDs) are becoming increasingly popular around the world. We plan to introduce a regulatory proposal and a bill this year to enable and regulate the use of EMDs. This will provide an effective first/last mile short-distance commuting solution, and will offer another green and low-carbon personal travel option, complementing the development of cycle tracks in new development areas.

To ensure the product quality and safety of EMDs, the Transport Department (TD) and the Hong Kong Productivity Council (HKPC) are devising a product certification mechanism, having regard to practices in various regions. The certification mechanism will require the engagement of accredited certification bodies to evaluate whether various models of EMDs comply with the technical specifications, including motor requirements, drawn up by the TD. A certification label with a QR code will be affixed to certified products for easy identification

by the public and law enforcement officers. In this regard, the TD has gauged the views of various stakeholders including manufacturers, suppliers, user organisations, testing laboratories, professional institutions, the Panel on Transport of the Legislative Council, the District Councils related to the trial arrangements, and the Transport Advisory Committee, so as to develop a mechanism and a set of standards that are practicable and safety-oriented. Meanwhile, the TD is working with the HKPC to implement simulated certification arrangements for industry participation, with a view to gaining trial experience and refining the certification requirements and arrangements.

2. The TD has all along been collaborating with the Road Safety Council and the Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF) in publicising messages on road safety and the use of EMDs (including the fire safety hazards of batteries) through various channels, including publications, websites and social media platforms. To ensure road safety, the HKPF carries out operations from time to time and takes strict enforcement actions against the illegal use of EMDs. We will continue to enhance safety awareness among the public through publicity and education. The expenditure for the publicity will be absorbed by the existing provisions.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1908)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in paragraph 142 of the Budget Speech that the construction of the intermodal pier under Phase 1 of the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA) Dongguan Logistics Park has been completed. The remaining works are expected to complete within this year, targeted for commissioning in the first half of next year. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. Are additional manpower and resources involved at the early stage of operation of the intermodal pier under Phase 1 of the HKIA Dongguan Logistics Park? If so, what is the staff establishment of the related work?

2. What is the work schedule for Phase 2 of the HKIA Dongguan Logistics Park? and

3. It is mentioned in paragraph 208 of the Budget Speech that processing facilities for local fisheries products will be developed under the Sustainable Fisheries Development Fund. In this regard, will the Government enhance communication and co-operation with the Agriculture, Fisheries and Conservation Department to study the development of cold chain processing and logistics facilities for fisheries products in the HKIA Dongguan Logistics Park, so as to tap into and leverage ancillary facilities such as the cold chain goods services in Phase 2 of the Dongguan Logistics Park, thereby jointly promoting Hong Kong's development of offshore fisheries, while enhancing services and competitiveness of the airport?

Asked by: Hon TAN Sunny (LegCo internal reference no.: 6)

Reply:

The Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) is actively taking forward the development of the sea-air intermodal cargo transshipment mode between the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA) and Dongguan, so as to provide a more seamless and convenient international air transport network for cargo in the Greater Bay Area (GBA) and to further develop Hong Kong's function as an air cargo transshipment hub.

The AAHK is completing the Phase 1 development of the permanent facilities of HKIA Dongguan Logistics Park (HKIALP) in stages, with the target of commencing commercial trial operation on 1 April 2027 and full operation on 1 June 2027, gradually bringing its cargo handling capacity to 1 million tonnes per annum. The AAHK has also commenced the preliminary study for Phase 2 development of HKIALP for the introduction of more facilities to support high-value logistics, cross-boundary e-commerce and express parcel services.

Meanwhile, the AAHK is actively working with the Dongguan Municipal Government to take forward the handling of different types of cargo in HKIALP. Among them, the cold-chain cargo service was launched in the first quarter of this year, allowing chilled seafood products to enter the GBA via Hong Kong through HKIALP.

The projects are undertaken by the AAHK and do not involve government expenditure.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2060)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in paragraph 225 of the Budget that tender for the Smart and Green Mass Transit System (SGMTS) project in Hung Shui Kiu will be invited this year. However, given that the Hong Kong Science Park (Science Park) has a working population reaching 26 000 persons, the transport services to and from the University Station are severely inadequate. In this connection, will the Administration inform this Committee of the following:

(a) What is the number of complaints received by the Transport Department about the inadequate public transport services for the Science Park and Pak Shek Kok in the last 3 years?

(b) Regarding the application from the Science Park for additional shuttle bus services at its own expense, will the Administration consider approving it? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons? and

(c) Given that it is feasible to introduce a new transport system in Hung Shui Kiu, will the Administration expedite the commencement of a feasibility study on the development of an SGMTS connecting the Science Park, Pak Shek Kok and the University Station? If so, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon WONG Wing-wai, Ray (LegCo internal reference no.: 19)

Reply:

(a) The number of complaints received by the Transport Department (TD) about the level of public transport services for the Science Park and Pak Shek Kok in the last 3 years is as follows:

	2023	**2024**	**2025**
No. of complaints	98	97	91

(b) The TD receives applications from employers from time to time for provision of non-franchised bus services to transport their employees to and from the Science Park. Upon receiving such applications, the TD will consider a basket of factors, including whether the costs of the proposed services will be fully borne by the employers, whether the locations of work related to the proposed services are far from railway stations and public transport interchanges, whether the passengers of the proposed services are limited to the employer's employees, the impact on road traffic, etc. Currently, the TD has approved more than 60 routes of non-franchised bus services for transporting employees between the Science Park and 88 different locations across Hong Kong. If new applications are received, the TD will continue to process them in accordance with the above mechanism.

In addition to the approved non-franchised bus services for employees above, there are currently 27 franchised bus routes and 8 green minibus routes serving the Science Park, of which 6 franchised bus routes and 1 green minibus route terminate or have stops at the University Station. The TD has also been working with public transport service operators to enhance services in accordance with passenger demand, so as to meet the transport needs of the working population of the Science Park.

(c) The relevant government bureaux and departments are actively following up on the Pak Shek Kok comprehensive development project with the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL), including the construction of a new railway station on the existing East Rail Line, the reprovisioning of the Hong Kong Education University (EdUHK) Sports Centre at a site near the EdUHK's main campus, and the use of the sites released from the reprovisioning of the EdUHK Sports Centre together with other adjoining land suitable for residential development to provide housing and ancillary facilities. The preparatory work for the Pak Shek Kok comprehensive development project is now in the final stages. The Government will continue to maintain close liaison with the MTRCL and announce the overall proposals for the development project as early as possible upon completion of the internal procedures. In parallel, the planning of the new railway station is proceeding as scheduled and the target is to commission it by 2033 or earlier.

In considering whether to introduce a smart and green mass transit system (SGMTS) or similar medium-capacity transit systems to a certain area, we have to take into account various factors, including the projected passenger demand and travelling patterns in the area, the space required for the construction of the system and associated depot facilities, the impact on local planning and the environment, the carrying capacity of the system, whether there will be an overlap with other public transport services and the cost-effectiveness of the construction and operation. We are of the view that, under the current development planning for the Pak Shek Kok area, the planned railway station together with other road-based public transport modes should be able to provide adequate local and cross-district public transport services. At present, we have no plans to develop an SGMTS in the Pak Shek Kok area.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0597)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Financial Secretary mentions in paragraph 148 of the Budget Speech that the development of Hong Kong into a green maritime fuel bunkering and trading centre will involve government subsidies of around $34 million. Please inform this Committee of the following:

(1) What are the specific purposes for which the $34 million subsidies be used? What are their respective proportions?

(2) How many vessels are expected to be attracted to bunker in Hong Kong as a result of the investment? and

(3) How will the direct and indirect economic output generated by the industry for Hong Kong within the year be measured?

Asked by: Hon WU Yingpeng (LegCo internal reference no.: 39)

Reply:

Maritime decarbonisation has become a global trend. In 2023, the International Maritime Organization set the goal of achieving net-zero carbon emissions from international shipping by or around 2050. The maritime industry has started switching to using low or even zero-carbon green maritime fuels as the most effective measure to reduce emissions.

To strengthen our competitiveness in the green maritime era, Hong Kong needs to grasp the international trend and develop its green maritime fuel bunkering capability. To this end, the Government promulgated the Action Plan on Green Maritime Fuel Bunkering (the Action Plan) on 15 November 2024, which sets out clear strategies and actions to promote the development of Hong Kong into a green maritime fuel bunkering and trading centre. The Government is taking forward various action measures in the Action Plan at full steam and announced the implementation of 2 of the measures in the 2026-27 Budget, including

providing port dues concessions for vessels powered by green fuel as well as those carrying green fuels, and launching an incentive scheme for green vessels registered in Hong Kong.

In this regard, the Government will introduce 25% or 50% port dues concessions for ocean-going vessels powered by, carrying and/or bunkering specified green maritime fuels in Hong Kong. This incentive will last for 3 years from mid-2026, involving an expenditure of around $11 million. The measure will reduce the cost of bunkering green maritime fuels by vessels in Hong Kong, and is expected to attract such vessels to call at or bunker green maritime fuels in Hong Kong for more than 1 000 times during the three-year period.

The Government will also introduce a three-year Green Vessels Registration Incentive Scheme for Hong Kong registered ships (including existing and newly-registered ships) powered by green maritime fuels to provide them with an incentive of HK$60,000 annually, involving a total expenditure of around $23 million. The incentive scheme will help further promote the green fleet brand of the Hong Kong Shipping Registry and enhance Hong Kong's competitiveness in the international maritime industry. It is expected to attract around 100 new ships powered by green maritime fuels to register in Hong Kong over the three-year period under the scheme, accounting for approximately a quarter of the total number of new green vessels worldwide during the same period.

The measures above will increase the green maritime fuel bunkering volume, attract more green vessels to register in Hong Kong and expedite the development of Hong Kong into a green maritime fuel bunkering centre. The increase in bunkering volume will then attract other participants in the green maritime fuel bunkering supply chain, such as fuel suppliers, bunkering operators and traders, to establish and expand their businesses in Hong Kong, thereby boosting the development of a comprehensive green maritime fuel bunkering industry chain in the city. The clustering of green fuel bunkering and trading activities in Hong Kong will further promote the development of high value-added professional services such as the maritime, financial, trading and legal services, and thus consolidating and enhancing Hong Kong's synergistic advantages as an international maritime centre, an international financial centre and an international trade centre, as well as injecting new impetus into the local economy.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2324)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Financial Secretary mentions in paragraph 143 of the Budget Speech that the Government is striving to promote smart logistics and digital transformation in the industry, while expanding Hong Kong's cargo hinterland to secure more transhipment cargo. Please inform this Committee of the following:

(1) What is the amount of provision dedicated to promoting smart logistics and digital transformation in the industry in 2026-27? What specific shipping ancillary projects will the provision be allocated to?

(2) By what percentage will the port cargo handling efficiency expected to be improved with smart logistics and digital transformation in the industry? and

(3) Where the cargo hinterland is planned to be expanded to in 2026-27?

Asked by: Hon WU Yingpeng (LegCo internal reference no.: 37)

Reply:

(1) To develop Hong Kong into an international smart logistics hub, the Financial Secretary announces in the 2026-27 Budget that the Government will launch the Future Innovative Logistics Acceleration Scheme (FILAS) this year to promote the transformation of the industry and enhance the interconnectivity of logistics data, with a view to enhancing the competitiveness of the logistics industry. FILAS will be established under the Pilot Subsidy Scheme for Third-party Logistics Service Providers (the Pilot Scheme). In line with the existing requirements of the Pilot Scheme, applicant enterprises of FILAS must be non-listed enterprises registered in Hong Kong under the Business Registration Ordinance (Cap. 310) with substantive business operations providing third-party logistics services in Hong Kong, and their business must be related to either inbound or outbound logistics services. The Government is working out other details of FILAS and will announce the details in due course. The Government will maintain close communication with the logistics industry to ensure that FILAS will address the needs and drive the transformation of the industry, as well

as enhance the interconnectivity of logistics data, thereby enhancing the competitiveness of the logistics industry.

(2) & (3) To consolidate and enhance Hong Kong's position as an international maritime centre, the Government is committed to enhancing the competitiveness of the Hong Kong Port (HKP) through a strategy of enhancing "quality" and enhancing "quantity".

In terms of enhancing "quality", the Government sets digitalisation, green transformation and smart transition as the specific development strategies, with the target of developing Hong Kong into a world-class green and smart port, so as to ensure that it keeps pace with global shipping trends, maintains its international connectivity and provides maritime enterprises with irreplaceable port services.

As regards digitalisation, the Legislative Council approved funding of $215.08 million in March 2025 for the development and implementation of the Port Community System (PCS), which was rolled out in January 2026 for use by the industry. The PCS is equipped with cargo tracking functions, linking up Hong Kong's sea, land, and air cargo transport information and facilitating trade and capital flows through digitalisation. In addition, value-added electronic services such as the "One-Data-Multiple-Declarations" function for making import/export trade declarations for cargo are also provided. Using the Netherlands' successful case as a reference, their system (i.e. Portbase) has enhanced the efficiency and generated substantial economic value for local businesses. The cumulative value added to these companies is over EUR€300 million per year. We expect that the PCS has the potential to deliver similar economic benefits to Hong Kong's maritime and logistics industries. The Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB) is collaborating with the Hong Kong Monetary Authority and the banking industry to examine how to leverage the cargo data recorded using blockchain technology in the PCS to enhance the efficiency of Hong Kong's trade financing business and help reduce credit costs and processing time for financial institutions and small and medium-sized enterprises.

Regarding smart transition, the Kwai Tsing Container Terminals have been utilising computer systems for centralised resource allocation and management for many years. Port operators are gradually upgrading their hardware facilities to enhance the level of automation, including converting more older cranes to remote operation and introducing more autonomous electric terminal tractors. The Port Development Committee of the Hong Kong Maritime and Port Development Board is actively exploring feasible strategies to further promote automation in Hong Kong's container terminals, with a view to enhancing their overall operational efficiency.

As for green transformation, the Government promulgated the Action Plan on Green Maritime Fuel Bunkering in November 2024, which covers a wide range of areas such as the supply of fuels, infrastructural support, port emissions reduction, etc., and is actively taking forward various action measures in the Action Plan. In 2025, the accumulated green maritime fuel bunkering volume in Hong Kong exceeded 220 000 tonnes, which were delivered in 16 liquefied natural gas and 110 biodiesel bunkering operations. We also conducted the first green methanol bunkering services at anchorage and the container terminals respectively in early March this year, positioning Hong Kong as one of the major ports that can provide a variety of green maritime fuel bunkering services in different modes.

The Government is confident that the measures above will comprehensively enhance the efficiency and reliability of port operations. As the effects will be reflected in the smooth operation of the supply chain as a whole and the continued strengthening of the industry's competitiveness, it is difficult to measure the actual enhancement in efficiency using a single quantitative indicator.

Regarding enhancing "quantity", the Government has in recent years been actively establishing a comprehensive "rail-sea-land-river" intermodal transport system connecting to the inland region to extend the HKP's cargo hinterland and has achieved significant results. Port operators have launched various sea-rail intermodal routes, including the Chongqing-Shenzhen-Hong Kong scheduled rail-sea service, the Chengdu-Shenzhen-Hong Kong scheduled rail-sea service and the Chongqing-Qinzhou-Hong Kong sea-rail intermodal service. Cargoes from the central and western regions are transported by rail to coastal ports, and then transited to Hong Kong via barges or other liner services for onward transhipment via ocean-going vessels. During the Hong Kong Maritime Week in 2025, the operator of the Western New Land-Sea Corridor, the Guangxi Beibu Gulf and the 2 container terminal operators in Hong Kong signed memoranda of understanding, launching a premium sea-rail transhipment service connecting Sichuan, Chongqing, Guangxi and Hong Kong. Looking ahead, the TLB will continue to visit other inland provinces and cities, taking into account factors such as cargo sources and volume, with a view to further expanding Hong Kong's cargo hinterland. Meanwhile, we are closely monitoring the impact on the HKP of the commissioning of the Pinglu Canal in Guangxi this year, and will work with the industry to examine how to capitalise on the opportunities brought by the Pinglu Canal to attract more transhipment cargo to the HKP.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB148**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0137)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat: Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding green shipping and smart logistics, please inform this Committee of the following:

It is mentioned in paragraph 151 of the 2026-27 Budget Speech that the Future Innovative Logistics Acceleration Scheme will be launched, with HK$30 million earmarked to benefit 100 logistics enterprises. What is the ceiling of funding support for each enterprise? What are the detailed eligibility criteria for enterprises applying for the scheme?

Asked by: Hon YAO Cho-fai, Andrew (LegCo internal reference no.: 9)

Reply:

To develop Hong Kong into an international smart logistics hub, the Financial Secretary announces in the 2026-27 Budget that the Government will launch the Future Innovative Logistics Acceleration Scheme (FILAS) this year to promote the transformation of the industry and enhance the interconnectivity of logistics data, with a view to increasing the competitiveness of the logistics industry. FILAS will be established under the Pilot Subsidy Scheme for Third-party Logistics Service Providers (the Pilot Scheme). In accordance with the existing requirements of the Pilot Scheme, applicant enterprises of FILAS must be non-listed enterprises registered in Hong Kong under the Business Registration Ordinance (Cap. 310) with substantive business operations providing third-party logistics services in Hong Kong, and their business must be related to either inbound or outbound logistics services. The Government is working out other details of FILAS and will announce them in due course. The Government will maintain close communication with the logistics industry to ensure that FILAS will address the needs of the industry, drive its transformation, as well as enhance the interconnectivity of logistics data, thereby increasing the competitiveness of the logistics industry.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0920)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Land and Waterborne Transport
(3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The financial provision increases from the revised estimate of $234.4 million in 2025-26 to $264.5 million in 2026-27 (an increase of 12.8%). In this connection, please inform this Committee of the following: (1) what are the respective budget allocations for the low-altitude economy initiatives and the smart and green mass transit systems in this increase; and (2) what is the estimated budget allocation for monitoring the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme? Will it increase proportionately with the rise in subsidies granted under the scheme? Furthermore, will the implementation of the monitoring system effectively curb the abuse of public subsidies?

Asked by: Hon YIM Kong, Erik (LegCo internal reference no.: 37)

Reply:

(1) The relevant increase does not involve budget allocations for the smart and green mass transit systems. As for low-altitude economy (LAE), the relevant work to take forward the development of LAE is mainly undertaken by the existing resources and manpower of the Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB) at present. The Working Group on Developing Low-altitude Economy will draft the Action Plan on Developing Low-altitude Economy this year, and will continue to carefully assess the demand for and allocation of relevant resources.

(2) The Government launched the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme (the Scheme) in 2019, with the objective of relieving the fare burden of commuters whose public transport expenses are relatively high. Currently, the Government provides a subsidy amounting to one-third of the commuter's monthly public transport expenses in excess of $500, subject to a maximum of $400 per month. The TLB is responsible for overseeing the implementation of the Scheme, while the Transport Department (TD) is responsible for its day-to-day administration, including the implementation of monitoring measures to deter abuse of the Scheme.

Under the Scheme, the commuters still have to bear most of the public transport expenses themselves and there is a cap on the monthly subsidy amount. Such design of the Scheme helps deter abuses. Meanwhile, the TD has adopted a series of monitoring measures to ensure proper use of public funds and minimise risks of abuse. The participating public transport operators are required to establish a set of audit and assurance standards to strengthen their internal control and submit assurance reports prepared by independent auditors in accordance with the standards issued by the Hong Kong Institute of Certified Public Accountants to the Government on a yearly basis. In addition, the monitoring measures taken by the Government include conducting regular transport surveys to gather operational data and passenger statistics, verifying the operational data submitted by the operators and checking the transaction records in the payment systems, etc. In the 3 financial years from 2023-24 to 2025-26, the TD conducted an average of about 90 to 170 field inspections and transport surveys per month, during which no cases involving abuse of subsidies were identified.

Except for the transport surveys, the tasks of overseeing the Scheme and carrying out day-to-day administration are undertaken by the existing staff of the TLB and the TD. There is no separate breakdown of the manpower and expenditure involved.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0885)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the Estimates this year that the Government will maintain and further develop Hong Kong's position as a centre of international and regional aviation by expanding aviation network, etc. Please inform this Committee of the following:

1. Since the launch of the Air Network Development Programme by the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK) in June 2024, how many participating airlines have opened new routes and increased flight frequencies on the existing routes and how many new destinations have been added? Will the Programme continue to be implemented?

2. Apart from utilising the resources of the AAHK, what measures will the Government take to encourage airlines to resume suspended flight services or open new routes and enhance the promotion of the transit function of the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA)? If so, what are the details and budget? If not, what are the reasons?

3. Does the Government have an overview of the fees charged by major international airports worldwide on flight passengers and airlines for airport usage in 2025, so as to assess the competitiveness of the HKIA? What are the details? and

4. Please set out in tabular form the details of the current number of global destinations to and from Hong Kong and the destination places, as well as the number of airlines providing flights to and from Hong Kong and the flight frequencies. Please also compare them with the figures in 2019.

Asked by: Hon YIU Pak-leung (LegCo internal reference no.: 43)

Reply:

1. & 2. The Government has been, in conjunction with the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK), strategically attracting local and non-local airlines to develop new destinations and increase flights through outreach efforts, incentive schemes and policy facilitation measures. For example, the AAHK launched the Air Network Development Programme (the

Programme) in June 2024, which provides financial incentives to encourage airlines to open new routes and increase flight frequencies on the existing routes. To date, the Programme has attracted 36 airlines to open 82 new routes and increase flight frequencies on 14 existing routes. The expenditure for the Programme above is borne by the AAHK and does not involve government expenditure.

At the same time, local airlines have responded positively to the Government's request to launch and increase flights to support the overall development of Hong Kong. Following the launch of direct passenger services to Dallas (the United States of America), Rome (Italy), Munich (Germany), Brussels (Belgium), Hyderabad (India), Adelaide and Cairns (Australia), Christchurch (New Zealand), as well as Datong, Enshi, Guilin, Zhangjiajie, Urumqi, Hailar, Yiwu, Changzhou, Xi'an, Quanzhou, Lijiang, Guiyang, Xuzhou and Changsha (Chinese Mainland) last year, they will commence direct flights to Seattle (the United States of America) later this year. The frequency of flights to Australia and other Asian cities will also be increased.

3. The AAHK has all along been setting the levels of airport charges according to commercial principles. At present, an independent international consultancy renowned in the aviation industry conducts a review on the charges of major international airports from time to time. In the latest 2025 report on such review in which about 50 major international airports in the world were covered, the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA)'s overall airport charges ranked in the mid-tier and were generally lower than many hub airports worldwide, including the London Heathrow Airport, Amsterdam Airport Schiphol and Singapore Changi Airport. The AAHK will continue to closely monitor market development and regularly review airport charge levels.

4. Before the pandemic, about 120 airlines operated flights between the HKIA and some 220 destinations worldwide, while currently close to 140 airlines operate flights between the HKIA and some 220 destinations. The numbers of weekly flights to and from Hong Kong before the pandemic and at present are at **Annex 1** and **Annex 2** respectively.

Annex 1

Weekly Air Services to and from Hong Kong before the Pandemic (flight information from 27 January to 2 February 2019)

Passenger services to and from Hong Kong

Name of Place	Number of Flights
Chinese Mainland	861
Japan	456
Taiwan	410
Thailand	264
Republic of Korea	196
The Philippines	177
The United States of America	144
Singapore	140
Australia	120
Malaysia	112
Vietnam	105
India	88
Indonesia	84
The United Kingdom	66
United Arab of Emirates	49
Canada	46
Cambodia	35
New Zealand	31
Germany	19
South Africa	17
France	17
Russia	15
Myanmar	15
Qatar	14
The Netherlands	14
Switzerland	14
Finland	12
Israel	11
Italy	11
Spain	8
Brunei	8
Nepal	8
Ethiopia	7
Maldives	7

Name of Place	Number of Flights
Bahrain	7
Sri Lanka	7
Guam	6
Turkey	6
Northern Mariana Islands	6
Mongolia	6
Fiji	5
Denmark	5
Republic of Ireland	4
Belgium	4
Jordan	4
Bangladesh	4
Papua New Guinea	3
Egypt	3
Kazakhstan	3
Mauritius	2
Total	**3 656**

All-cargo services to and from Hong Kong

Name of Place	Number of Flights
The United States of America	526
Chinese Mainland	158
United Arab Emirates	104
Japan	101
Germany	94
India	82
Taiwan	78
Singapore	70
Republic of Korea	67
Vietnam	57
Russia	45
Qatar	44
Luxembourg	44
Thailand	39
Malaysia	37
Bangladesh	31
Kazakhstan	23
Azerbaijan	22
Ethiopia	18
Bahrain	17
Saudi Arabia	17
Italy	16
Belgium	16
Turkey	16
Mexico	15
The Philippines	13
Australia	12
France	9
The United Kingdom	8
The Netherlands	4
Indonesia	4
Sri Lanka	3
Kuwait	3
Poland	3
Hungary	3
Canada	2
Oman	2
Cambodia	2

Austria	2
Guam	1
Jordan	1
Uzbekistan	1
Spain	1
Total	**1 811**

Annex 2

Current Weekly Air Services to and from Hong Kong (flight information from 25 to 31 January 2026)

Passenger services to and from Hong Kong

Name of Place	Number of Flights
Chinese Mainland	817
Japan	449
Taiwan	351
Thailand	206
The Philippines	175
Republic of Korea	158
Vietnam	129
Australia	108
The United States of America	101
Singapore	92
Malaysia	90
India	59
Indonesia	56
The United Kingdom	49
Canada	38
United Arab of Emirates	35
Cambodia	26
New Zealand	22
Germany	18
Switzerland	15
Qatar	14
France	14
The Netherlands	11
Turkey	10
Nepal	8
Ethiopia	7
Finland	7
Saudi Arabia	7
Mongolia	7
South Africa	7
Italy	7
Sri Lanka	7
Brunei	5

Name of Place	Number of Flights
Papua New Guinea	4
Belgium	4
Bangladesh	4
Spain	4
Fiji	4
Laos	3
Russia	3
Northern Mariana Islands	2
Total	**3 133**

All-cargo services to and from Hong Kong

Name of Place	Number of Flights
The United States of America	397
United Arab of Emirates	163
Malaysia	150
Germany	147
Japan	126
Chinese Mainland	114
Taiwan	95
Republic of Korea	94
Qatar	82
Singapore	61
Vietnam	60
India	60
Turkey	59
Luxembourg	58
Thailand	43
Azerbaijan	42
The Philippines	36
Bahrain	33
Saudi Arabia	30
The United Kingdom	30
France	29
Australia	28
Italy	26
Belgium	25
Ethiopia	24
Mexico	23
Indonesia	18
The Netherlands	13
Kazakhstan	12
Israel	11
Bangladesh	10
Hungary	7
Spain	6
Egypt	6
Canada	5
Norway	3
Cambodia	2
Kuwait	2

Name of Place	Number of Flights
Jordan	2
Oman	1
Guam	1
New Zealand	1
Total	**2 135**

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 Reply Serial No.

TLB151

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0886)

Head: (158) Government Secretariat:
Transport and Logistics Bureau

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) Air and Sea Communications and Logistics Development

Controlling Officer: Permanent Secretary for Transport and Logistics (Mr Vic YAU)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The main responsibilities of the Transport and Logistics Bureau this year include continuing to assist the Airport Authority Hong Kong to implement the Three-Runway System (3RS) project, and the phased commissioning of the 3RS passenger facilities. Will the Bureau inform this Committee of the following:

1. Please list the total number of passengers at the airport; the respective numbers of local, Mainland and other passengers; as well as the respective numbers of transfer and transit passengers in the past 3 years;

2. Please list the respective numbers of transfer and transit passengers in the past 3 years;

3. Please list the number of passengers from the Greater Bay Area who have used the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA) in the past 3 years; and

4. Please list the respective numbers of passengers transiting through the HKIA who came via city terminals, land boundary crossings, the SkyPier Terminal or the High Speed Rail in the past 3 years.

Asked by: Hon YIU Pak-leung (LegCo internal reference no.: 44)

Reply:

1. to 3. According to the information provided by the Airport Authority Hong Kong (AAHK), the total numbers of passengers at the Hong Kong International Airport (HKIA) and the relevant distribution from 2023 to 2025 are tabulated below:

Table 1

Year	No. of passengers (million)				
	Arriving/departing passengers			Transfer and transit passengers	Total no. of passengers
	Local passengers	Chinese Mainland passengers	Other passengers		
2023	17.72	5.30	8.43	8.04	39.49
2024	21.53	7.29	12.79	11.41	53.02
2025	21.87	7.98	14.83	16.30	60.97

Note 1: Arriving/departing passengers are defined by the passport they hold.
Note 2: Transfer and transit passengers refer to passengers who transfer and transit by air via the HKIA, while passengers transit via the HKIA by the intermodal mode are counted as arriving/departing passengers.
Note 3: The numbers of passengers in 2025 are provisional and the actual figures are yet to be verified by the airlines.

The numbers of arriving/departing Chinese Mainland and other passengers from cities in the Greater Bay Area from 2023 to 2025 are about 5.82 million, 9.52 million and 10.89 million respectively.

4. According to the information provided by the AAHK, the numbers of passengers entering and leaving Hong Kong via land and railway boundary control points and travelling to and from different parts of the world via the HKIA from 2023 to 2025 are tabulated below:

Table 2

Year	No. of passengers (million)	
	via land boundary control points	via railway boundary control points
2023	3.49	0.88
2024	5.82	1.33
2025	6.77	1.61

Note: The numbers of passengers in 2025 are provisional and the actual figures are yet to be verified by the airlines.

Separately, the numbers of passengers using the SkyPier Terminal from 2023 to 2025 are 470 000, 680 000 and 710 000 respectively.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0016)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Government has indicated that various departments are proactively leveraging artificial intelligence (AI) and related technologies to promote digital intelligence for enhancing the standard of public services. The Transport Department will explore the setting up of a traffic management platform integrating the use of big data analytics and AI, allowing comprehensive monitoring of real-time traffic conditions and enhancing management efficiency. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the estimated staff establishment and expenditure for setting up the traffic management platform in 2026-27, as well as the timetable for setting up the platform and its coverage;

2. whether performance indicators will be established for monitoring the effectiveness of the traffic management platform, such as the decrease in congestion index, the reduction in travelling time and the optimisation rate of signal timing, and regularly reported to the Legislative Council; and

3. whether the Government will consider conducting trials of commercial operations of autonomous vehicles on suitable road sections in the Northern Metropolis (e.g. new roads in new development areas) as soon as possible to accumulate empirical data and operational experience, with a view to promoting the development of autonomous driving technologies and aligning them with international standards; if yes, what are the specific timetable and scope of trials; if no, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon BOK Kwok-ming, Aaron (LegCo internal reference no.: 2)

Reply:

1. The Transport Department (TD) makes good use of big data analytics and AI technology to enhance the overall efficiency of the transport network, and plans to commence a study on the development [Internal notes to OLO: Reference from Para. 11 of LC Paper No. CB(3)89/2026(04)] of the Traffic Management Platform (the Platform) in 2026 in preparation for a regional pilot application.

The above study on the Platform includes examining the consolidation of a number of existing systems, data and operational workflows to support the functions of the Platform in future; setting out the functional, data and technical requirements for the development and operation of the Platform; recommending the overall strategy, specific technical solution and timetable for the implementation of the Platform in various districts; and estimating the total cost for the long-term development of the Platform to full-scale. Moreover, the TD will implement the regional pilot application in suitable districts and review its effectiveness. The estimated expenditure for the above study and pilot application is $62 million. As the implementation of the above items involves additional tasks, such as the consolidation of a number of existing traffic management systems and the co-ordination of data exchange among various public transport operators and other departments, two time-limited civil service posts, including one Senior Transport Officer and one Electronics Engineer/Assistant Electronics Engineer, will be created from 2026-27 to 2030-31. As for the manpower required to conduct the study, the TD will arrange for existing TD staff to undertake the work through deployment of internal resources.

2. In the above study, the TD will prepare for a regional pilot application and assess the effectiveness of the Platform in enhancing traffic management efficiency and transport service levels. The study is expected to commence in 2026, during which the TD will study the feasibility of applying the Platform in various districts of Hong Kong and consider setting appropriate performance indicators. The Government will report to the Legislative Council on the findings of the study of the Platform in a timely manner.

3. The Northern Metropolis presents unlimited opportunities for the development of autonomous vehicles in Hong Kong. With its forward-looking planning, abundant land resources, potential for cross-boundary collaboration, policy support and social needs, it is well-positioned to serve as one of the ideal locations for promoting autonomous driving technology in Hong Kong. The Government will actively promote the introduction of autonomous driving trials and uses in the Northern Metropolis under diversified scenarios. For example, proprietors may consider implementing connections between different districts and linking new development areas with transport hubs. This initiative aims to maximise the role of autonomous vehicles in the use of technology and logistics industry, as well as facilitate cross-boundary trials to promote autonomous vehicles' learning and adaptation to both Chinese Mainland and Hong Kong driving modes.

The Autonomous Vehicle Applications Promotion Working Group ("the Working Group"), chaired by the Commissioner for Transport, held its first meeting in March 2026. The Working Group is currently co-ordinating inter-departmental efforts with industry stakeholders to take forward related initiatives, and is specifically tasked with reviewing the progress and needs of individual autonomous vehicle projects. It provides steer on trial locations and vehicle types, as well as licensing arrangements required to support the commercial development of autonomous vehicles, and also sets out a roadmap for their long-term development, including promoting the development of autonomous vehicles in the Northern Metropolis.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0017)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 under the Programme concerned that the Government will continue to promote walkability in Hong Kong, including overseeing the implementation and review of various programmes/schemes related to enhancing walkability, such as pedestrian environment improvement schemes. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the implementation timetable for the 15 additional diagonal crossings; the criteria for selecting junctions and how to ensure that the traffic flow efficiency will not be significantly affected by the extension of the pedestrian green time;

2. the relevant staff establishment and expenditure in the 2026-27 Budget for the expansion project concerned, which involves works such as realignment of crossings, phase adjustment, installation of facilities and enhancement of signs; and

3. how the Government will evaluate the effectiveness of the provision of diagonal crossings, including the savings of pedestrian crossing time, improvement of junction congestion and safety risk control, and establish an adjustment mechanism?

Asked by: Hon BOK Kwok-ming, Aaron (LegCo internal reference no.: 5)

Reply:

1. In assessing the suitability of diagonal crossing implementation at individual junctions, the Transport Department (TD) will strike a balance among the needs of different road users, as well as carefully consider the traffic condition of individual junctions, including pedestrian demand for crossing the road diagonally, traffic and pedestrian flows at the junctions, and the crossing distance and time required. This is to ensure that adequate junction capacity can still be maintained at the junctions concerned after the implementation of diagonal crossings, so as to avoid accumulation of vehicles waiting to pass through the junctions and prevent traffic queues from extending to other junctions due to inadequate junction capacity, which could in turn affect vehicles passing by and passengers using public transport.

The TD and the works departments have commenced the relevant planning and design work of the 15 additional diagonal crossings, which are expected to be commissioned in batches from the latter half of 2026.

2. The estimate for the works project relevant to the provision of diagonal crossings is $10 million and will be funded by block allocation Subhead 6100TX under Head 706 of the Capital Works Reserve Fund. The estimated construction costs of the 15 junctions are about $4 million and $6 million respectively in 2026-27 and 2027-28.

   Regarding staff establishment, the planning, design and implementation of the diagonal crossings have been undertaken by the existing staff of TD and the relevant works departments. There is no separate breakdown of resources involved.

3. Upon completion of the 15 diagonal crossings concerned, the TD expects the diagonal crossing distance and time to be about 30% shorter than those of the original orthogonal crossings on average, providing convenience to pedestrians crossing diagonally. As the distance of a diagonal crossing is longer than that of a conventional crossing, a corresponding extension of the pedestrian green time is required for its provision, which may in turn reduce the time allowed for vehicles to pass the junctions. Therefore, the TD will continue to closely monitor the traffic conditions at the relevant junctions upon commissioning of the diagonal crossings and make appropriate adjustments to the setting of traffic lights when necessary.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0018)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Under this Programme, the Government has indicated that it will continue to introduce practicable measures to enhance traffic management and to alleviate road traffic congestion. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. In light of the views that junction layouts in some new development areas in Hong Kong (such as West Kowloon) are over-conservative with excessively large junctions and prolonged time of "all red signals" causing unnecessary traffic delays, will the Transport Department (TD) conduct a comprehensive review on the signal phase design of existing signalised junctions, particularly during non-peak hours, to suitably minimise the "all red signal time", thus reducing social resources wastage?

2. Will the Government study the large-scale introduction of "right-turn waiting zone" in new development areas or suitable junctions, and, with reference to international practices (such as those in the Chinese Mainland and North America), explore the feasibility of allowing left-turn vehicles to cautiously pass through (that is "slow driving" or "passing through after giving way") on the premise of safety, thereby enhancing traffic capacity at junctions?

Asked by: Hon BOK Kwok-ming, Aaron (LegCo internal reference no.: 7)

Reply:

1. The TD takes into account a number of traffic factors when planning and designing traffic light-controlled junctions (signalised junctions), including the traffic layout near the signalised junctions, the current and projected future traffic demands of vehicles and pedestrians, as well as the demand for vehicle turning movements. The design of signalised junctions (including junction layout and signal design) complies with relevant design standards and road safety guidelines, so that such junctions can meet the traffic needs of users and safeguard road safety.

To ensure the safe operation of signalised junctions, the traffic signal design must allow a sufficient green signal interval (intergreen period) between the end of the green signal in the previous phase and the start of the green signal light in the subsequent phase. This is to ensure that vehicles and/or pedestrians released in the previous phase can safely leave the junction area, thereby avoiding conflicts with traffic in the next phase and preventing potential hazards. This intergreen period is indicated by amber signals, "red and amber" signals, and/or "all red signals". The length of the intergreen period is set having regard to the actual conditions of individual junctions, such as the scale and layout of the junction and vehicle speeds, with a view to safeguarding road safety. To optimise the operational efficiency of signalised junctions, the TD has set different signal durations based on vehicular and pedestrian traffic conditions during different periods, including adopting shorter signal cycles during non-peak hours to reduce the average waiting time for vehicles and pedestrians. The TD will continue to monitor the actual operation of each signalised junction, conduct regular reviews on the relevant signal timing settings, and make adjustments when necessary.

In addition, the TD has conducted a pilot project to install ancillary equipment such as sensors and computing systems at designated signalised junctions in order to calculate appropriate signal timing using artificial intelligence technology. A pilot project of the real-time adaptive traffic signal system (RTATSS) at eight linked signalised junctions at Tung Chung Town Centre, which was completed by the TD in mid-2024, operated smoothly in general. To further facilitate smart traffic management and public commuting, the TD is implementing the RTATSS at about 50 suitable independent signalised junctions across the territory. It is expected that the RTATSS will be installed and commissioned progressively starting from the second half of this year. The whole project is expected to be completed in 2027.

2. The installation of right-turn waiting zones (commonly known as right-turn pockets) is a usual signalised junction design in Hong Kong. This arrangement allows vehicles to enter the right-turn pocket when the green signal is displayed and wait there until there is sufficient safe gap in the oncoming traffic flow to make a right turn, thereby optimising the junction's capacity.

Allowing vehicles to make a left turn when the red signal is displayed at signalised junctions differs from the driving habits and traffic laws conventionally adopted in Hong Kong. If such arrangement is adopted at signalised junctions with relatively busy traffic in Hong Kong, the risks of left-turning vehicles colliding with pedestrians crossing the road or with vehicles entering the same road section from other directions may increase. Currently, for signalised junctions with high left-turn traffic flow, the TD will adjust the traffic signal timings or implement other enhanced measures as necessary, such as providing additional dedicated left-turn lanes and/or adopting split-phased signal control, thereby enhancing traffic capacity at such junctions.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0104)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Following the abrupt termination of the tax concession for electric vehicles announced in the Budget, there are concerns in society that this will hinder the popularisation and development of electric vehicles. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee:

1. the numbers of electric vehicle registrations in the past five years, and their percentages relative to the overall number of vehicles.

Asked by: Hon BOK Kwok-ming, Aaron (LegCo internal reference no.: 36)

Reply:

1. In the past five years, the numbers of registered electric vehicles (EVs) and registered vehicles at the end of each year are tabulated as follows:

Year	Number of registered EVs	Number of registered vehicles	Percentage of registered EVs in total number of registered vehicles
2021	27 855	919 550	3.03%
2022	47 330	918 356	5.15%
2023	76 220	915 965	8.32%
2024	109 776	897 254	12.23%
2025	148 337	902 154	16.44%

Note 1: Hybrid vehicles are included under their respective fuel types. Only pure EVs are counted in the category of EVs.

Note 2: Government vehicles are not included as they are not required for registration.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0415)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Management of Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Under this Programme, please inform this Committee of the following:

1. the provisions and resources involved in the following items in 2024-25 and 2025-26:
   (a) management and operation of tunnel control areas (including the Cross-Harbour Tunnel, Tate's Cairn Tunnel, Tai Lam Tunnel, etc.); and
   (b) implementation, operation and maintenance of HKeToll;
   as well as the estimated provisions and resources allocated to the above-mentioned items (a) and (b) in 2026-27;

2. the reasons for the mere increase of $38.7 million from the actual expenditure of $1,427.1 million for 2024-25 to the revised expenditure of $1,465.8 million for 2025-26, with a breakdown by major expenditure items to explain the relatively small increase; and

3. whether the management and operating expenditure of Tai Lam Tunnel after the takeover by the Government have already been included in the above-mentioned revised expenditure for 2025-26; if yes, the amounts involved and the coverage period (for instance, from the month of takeover); if not, please specify the year in which or the subhead under which such expenditure will be included and the estimated amount.

Asked by: Hon BOK Kwok-ming, Aaron (LegCo internal reference no.: 48)

Reply:

1. & 3.

The expenditures of various government road tunnels in 2024-25, 2025-26 (estimate) and 2026-27 (estimate) (including the relevant operating and maintenance expenditures for the implementation of HKeToll) are tabulated at **Annex 1**. The expenditures for 2025-26 are estimated figures, including the expenditure of Tai Lam Tunnel from 31 May 2025 to 31 March 2026, and the actual figures are still under consolidation.

2. Under Programme (4), the revised expenditure is $1,465.8 million for 2025-26, which is $38.7 million higher than the actual expenditure of $1,427.1 million for 2024-25. This is mainly due to the increase in operating expenditure being offset by the decrease in capital account expenditure. The cash flow requirement for capital account expenditure would be adjusted every year in response to the number, nature, scale and progress of the items, thus it is difficult to compare the cash flow cross different years directly.

Annex 1

Operating Expenditures of Government Road Tunnels for 2024-25, 2025-26 (estimate) and 2026-27 (estimate)

Tolled tunnel/ control area[1]	2024-25 ($ million)	2025-26 Estimate ($ million)	2026-27 Estimate ($ million)
Cross-Harbour Tunnel	196	204	216
Eastern Harbour Crossing	240	235	243
Western Harbour Crossing	328	320	Pending tender results[4]
Tate's Cairn Tunnel	175	185	208
Aberdeen Tunnel	134	138	Pending tender results[4]
Lion Rock Tunnel	121	125	133
Shing Mun Tunnels	135	135	136
Route 8K	372	384	382
Tai Lam Tunnel[2]	N/A	252	291
Central Kowloon Bypass[3]	N/A	(Note 3)	(Note 3)

Note 1: The expenditures set out in the table include the management fees paid to the management, operation and maintenance contractors, the relevant operating and maintenance expenditure for the implementation of HKeToll, depreciation charge of capital costs and expenditure on government maintenance works of the tunnels for the years concerned.

Note 2: The Tai Lam Tunnel was returned to government management on 31 May 2025. The figure for 2025-26 refers to the period from 31 May 2025 to 31 March 2026.

Note 3: The Central Kowloon Bypass (CKB) (Yau Ma Tei Section) commenced operation on 21 December 2025. The toll for CKB will be commenced when the entire CKB (including the Kowloon Bay Section) is fully commissioned. Its operating expenditure is expected to be included in the Operating Accounts of Government Toll-Tunnels starting from 2027-28.

Note 4: As the operating expenditures include the management fees for the management, operation and maintenance contractors of tunnels, while the management, operation and maintenance agreements concerned will expire in 2026-27 and open tendering will be conducted, the management fees for 2026-27 are subject to the tender results and the projected operating expenditures are not available at this stage.

Toll-free tunnel[5]	2024-25 ($ million)	2025-26 Estimate ($ million)	2026-27 Estimate ($ million)
Tuen Mun–Chek Lap Kok Tunnel	81	88	89
Tseung Kwan O Tunnel	44	48	52
Tseung Kwan O–Lam Tin Tunnel	62	71	90
Central–Wan Chai Bypass Tunnel	152	168	171
Lung Shan Tunnel	57	63	64

Toll-free tunnel[5]	2024-25 ($ million)	2025-26 Estimate ($ million)	2026-27 Estimate ($ million)
Cheung Shan Tunnel	26	28	29
Airport Tunnel	26	26	28
Scenic Hill Tunnel	58	58	60
Kai Tak Tunnel	49	47	50

Note 5: Government toll-free tunnels are not included in the Operating Accounts of Government Toll-Tunnels. The expenditures set out in the table represent the management fees payable to the management, operation and maintenance contractors for the years concerned, excluding the depreciation charge of the capital costs and the expenditure on government maintenance works of the tunnels for the years concerned.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1773)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Under the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27, the Government will continue administering the Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector – Public Light Bus/Coach Trade (the Scheme). In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

It is learned that the transport industry practitioners, such as those in the coach trade, have encountered difficulties in quota renewals, in which local employees may have already left their jobs for various reasons, resulting in non-compliance with the required manning ratio of 2 :1 for local staff to imported labours. Does the Government has maintained the relevant statistics, and how will the Government straighten out the situation and support the trade in addressing this issue?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Chung-yee, Alan (LegCo internal reference no.2)

Reply:

As for the gradual expiry of the contracts of the first batch of workers imported under the Scheme from the end of 2025, the Transport Department (TD) announced the quota renewal arrangements in August 2025. The operators with allocated quotas should submit quota renewal applications five months prior to the expiry of the contracts of their imported drivers. As at end-February 2026, 589 quotas had been granted with approval for the renewal and no operator have had their quota renewal applications rejected for failing to continue meeting the criteria of the Scheme (including maintaining of the manning ratio of 1:2 for imported labours to local full-time staff, wage levels of imported drivers at not less than the median monthly wages of the relevant posts, and complying the relevant local driver recruitment requirements, etc.) The TD will continue to process quota renewal applications received in accordance with the criteria of the Scheme.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1791)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

In Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27, it is mentioned that the Government will continue to oversee the implementation of the Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector – Public Light Bus/Coach Trade (the Scheme). In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. It has been some time since the Government launched the first and second rounds of applications for the Scheme in mid-2023 and early 2024 respectively. Does the Government have any statistics on the number of applications, approved quotas and the actual number of imported drivers who have arrived in Hong Kong; the retention rate, working hours, record of incidents, and the number of complaints regarding the imported drivers? Has the Government used such data as policy basis for deciding whether to activate the next round of the Scheme?

2. Has any assessment been conducted regarding the activation of the third round of the Scheme? If yes, please provide a specific timetable, trade demand assessment, estimated number of drivers to be imported, and the progress of discussions with the trade. If not, what are the reasons?

3. After the implementation of the Scheme, has the median age of drivers in the taxi, public light bus, and coach trades been lowered? What are the original and current median ages of the drivers if lowered?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Chung-yee, Alan (LegCo internal reference no.: 21)

Reply:

1. The Government has all along been concerned about the driver shortage problem faced by the public light bus (PLB)/coach trade. To alleviate the problem of labour shortage in the trade, the Government announced the Scheme in June 2023, and approved 900 PLB and 800 coach driver quotas through two rounds of applications in September 2023 and July 2024 respectively. All applications were vetted by the inter-departmental liaison group (comprising representatives from the Transport and Logistics Bureau, the

Labour Department and the Transport Department (TD)). Details of the two rounds of applications are set out at **Annex**. As at end-February 2026, a total of 1 600 imported drivers had arrived in Hong Kong (excluding 276 imported drivers with contracts early terminated).

As at end-February 2026, the TD received a total of 61 complaints concerning imported drivers' service attitude and driving skills (as in the table below). The nature of the complaints includes failing to allow passengers to alight at specified locations/stops, or providing passengers with incorrect information on routes/destinations/departure schedules. Among them, 36 cases were substantiated after investigation by the TD.

	Number of complaints against imported drivers	**Number of substantiated cases**
From the launch of the Scheme to end-February 2025	33	28
From March 2025 to end-February 2026	28	8
Total	**61**	**36**

The TD does not maintain the statistics on working hours and record of incidents of the imported drivers.

2. While implementing the Scheme, the TD has all along maintained liaison with the transport sectors via the stakeholder consultative group (comprising representatives of employees and employers) under the Scheme to keep in view of the opinions from the employees and employers for the Scheme. Both employees and employers agreed that the trade has long been facing the problems of acute manpower shortage of drivers and ageing drivers. Employer representatives shared the view that labour importation can alleviate the problem of acute driver shortage. Therefore, we believe that extension of the existing quotas can allow these imported drivers with a pass in the local driving test and accumulated local driving experience, to continue providing services to the public and, in turn, help sustain the stability and quality of public transport services. In addition, as for the gradual expiry of the contracts of the first batch of imported workers by the end of 2025, the TD announced the quota renewal arrangements in August 2025. The operators with allocated quotas should submit renewal application to the TD five months prior to the expiry of the contracts of their imported drivers. As at end-February 2026, 589 quotas (including 324 PLB and 265 coach driver quotas) had been granted with approval for renewal. The TD will continue to process the renewal applications received, including reviewing whether or not the operators concerned continue to meet the criteria of the Scheme (including maintaining the manning ratio of 1:2 for imported labours to full-time local staff, the wage levels for imported workers at not less than the median monthly wages of the relevant posts, and complying with relevant local driver recruitment requirements). The TD will continue to keep in view the implementation of the Scheme, maintain liaison with various stakeholders and enhance information dissemination through the stakeholder consultative group, as well as review the Scheme in a timely manner with reference to the relevant opinion.

3. The Scheme covers the PLB and coach trades and is not applicable to the taxi trade. The TD does not maintain the statistics on the age of drivers in the taxi, PLB and coach trades.

Annex

Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector–
Public Light Bus (PLB)/Coach Trade

Numbers of applications and quotas allocated in the first round by driver job type

Driver job type	Number of applications received	Number of quotas applied for	Number of applications approved	Number of driver quotas allocated
Public Light Bus Driver	68 (involving 68 route packages)	547	59	461
Local Coach Driver	32 (involving 6 service endorsements) Note (1)	689	23	262
Cross-boundary Coach Driver	18 (involving routes plying 6 road-based boundary control points (BCPs))	365	16	246
Total	**118**	**1 601**	**98**	**969**

Numbers of applications and quotas allocated in the second round by driver job type

Driver job type	Number of applications received	Number of quotas applied for	Number of applications approved	Number of driver quotas allocated
Public Light Bus Driver	82 (involving 82 route packages)	842	82	467
Local Coach Driver	31 (involving 6 service endorsements) Note (1)	394	27	228
Cross-boundary Coach Driver	16 (involving routes plying 6 road-based BCPs)	237	16	154
Total	**129**	**1 473**	**125**	**849 Note (2)**

Notes:

(1) The six service endorsements include (i) tour service, (ii) hotel service, (iii) student service, (iv) employees' service, (v) residents' service and (vi) contract hire service.

(2) Including 118 approved quotas left unused in the first round and carried forward to the second round.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1792)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Under Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27, it is mentioned that the Transport and Logistics Bureau will continue to oversee the implementation of recommendations arising from the consultancy study on parking for commercial vehicles (CVs) to address the anticipated parking demand and in the Transport Strategy Blueprint. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. The Government has acknowledged that the ratio of CV parking spaces is persistently low (about 0.64:1 at present) and stated in the Transport Strategy Blueprint that it will "increase the supply of parking spaces at source". Will the Government formulate a specific timetable and district-specific targets to ensure that "every CV have a parking space at night"? Will the Government undertake to increase the ratio of CV parking spaces to at least 1:1 within the coming three to five years in order to prevent the continuous deterioration of issues such as cross-district search for parking spaces by drivers, fatigue driving and illegal parking?

2. The Government has indicated that it is exploring the possibility of opening loading/unloading bays in subsidised housing developments, schools, government offices and industrial areas for night-time CV parking. What are the current numbers of implemented projects and parking spaces involved? Will this arrangement be extended to more housing developments, hospitals, school premises and industrial areas in the future? Will the Government formulate uniform guidelines for and set up a inter-departmental group to co-ordinate and expedite the full implementation of "single site, multiple use"?

3. There are views that due to shortage of parking spaces, drivers have to search for parking spaces across districts and even park at car parks in remote mountain areas, leading to cases of drivers being bitten by stray dogs or have their daily working hours extended to 16 to 17 hours, resulting in an increased risk of fatigue driving and creating hundreds of thousands of "time bombs" (drivers who consistently lack adequate sleep) on the roads, as well as adding to road traffic load and emission. Has the Government conducted a risk assessment in this regard? Will the Government treat the shortage of

CV parking spaces as road safety and public health issues? Will the Government introduce emergency relief measures in the short term, such as providing designated night-time parking spaces, restricting private cars from using CV parking spaces, or establishing temporary parking lots in areas with high demands?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Chung-yee, Alan (LegCo internal reference no.: 22)

Reply:

1.
The Transport Department (TD) has been reviewing the supply of and demand for parking spaces in various districts and adopting a multi-pronged strategy to increase parking spaces holistically. The ratio of the number of parking spaces to the number of licensed vehicles has gradually rebounded in recent years, with the relevant initiatives gradually taking effect. The ratio of commercial vehicles (CVs) has also increased from 1:0.64 in 2020 to 1:0.67 in 2025. The Government continues to actively pursue a range of short-term and medium-to-long-term measures to increase the supply of CV parking spaces.

To address the shortfall in parking spaces for CVs, the Government will formulate more targeted solutions, systematically increasing the supply of parking spaces and ultimately realising "every commercial vehicle having a suitable parking space at night" in the long run. The specific new measures include allocating corresponding CV parking facilities for projects serving industrial and modern logistics uses (such as the Hung Shui Kiu Logistics Cluster and multi-storey buildings for modern industries) in the planning of new development areas (NDAs) such as the Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen NDA in the Northern Metropolis; implementing a dedicated scheme for night-time on-street parking spaces for CVs in NDAs through designating in advance night-time on-street CV parking spaces in suitable road sections; and when taking forward public vehicle park projects in areas with high concentration of logistics activities, prioritising the provision of more CV parking spaces.

The demand for CV parking spaces hinges on many factors, such as the overall economic situation, the local parking supply and demand, CV operating pattern, parking habits, and places of residence and work of drivers. At present, many CVs are parked not only at brownfield sites but also on the Mainland where drivers are engaged in cross-boundary operations. Moreover, some CVs (such as those for food transportation and distribution) have to operate during night time to meet industry needs. Currently, the figures for CV parking spaces and the demand for them do not taking into account vehicles parked at brownfield sites in Hong Kong or on the Mainland, nor vehicles operating at night. As such, the current ratio of CVs to CV parking spaces does not reflect the correspondingly higher supply and lower demand.

Hence, as outlined in the Transport Strategy Blueprint, the TD will initiate a new round of parking demand and supply study in 2026 to review the existing parking facilities and the parking demand and supply for various vehicle types, in particular CVs. The study results and recommendations are expected to be released in 2027. The study will analyse the operational patterns of CVs and their actual parking situations in locations such as private land, and take into consideration factors such as the future development of Hong Kong, thereby determining the demand gap for CV parking spaces. Targeted measures will be proposed to ensure a proper match between supply and demand, with a view to achieving "every commercial vehicle having a suitable parking space at night" in the long run.

2. and 3.
The Government is actively promoting "shared-use" parking spaces to enhance flexibility in parking supply and utilisation rates. Regarding public housing estates, as many CV drivers reside in such estates, if the loading/unloading bays of existing subsidised housing can be opened to CVs for parking at night, it will help increase the supply of relevant parking spaces. In this connection, the Housing Department and the TD launched the "Night-time CV Parking Scheme" at five public housing estates [Note 1] in November 2025 opening up loading/unloading bays for CVs to park overnight. At the same time, they are actively exploring extending the scheme to more public housing estates, with a focus on drivers' places of residence or nearby areas.

Moreover, 42 schools have already joined the "Opening Up School Parking Spaces to Student Service Vehicles Scheme", making a total of 126 school bus parking spaces available for student service vehicles during non-school hours. There are around 2 000 on-street night-time CV parking spaces for goods vehicles and coaches, covering industrial areas with higher demand for night-time CV parking, such as Tai Po Industrial Estate, Yuen Long Tung Tau Industrial Area and Tseung Kwan O Industrial Estate. The TD will continue to provide additional night-time CV parking spaces at suitable locations.

In addition, the Government is implementing measures at different levels to increase the supply of parking spaces, including providing public parking spaces in suitable "Government, Institution or Community" facilities and public open space projects under the "single site, multiple use" (SSMU) principle. The relevant bureaux and departments have fully considered the feasibility of providing public parking spaces during implementation of the SSMU projects. Currently, funding approval has been obtained from the Legislative Council for 16 public vehicle parks under the SSMU principle, of which three have been commissioned, and the remaining 13 projects are being taken forward for completion in phases between 2026 and 2031.

Apart from the above targeted measures, the TD will continue to step up its efforts, focusing on areas with a shortage of parking spaces by increasing the provision of night-time on-street parking spaces where practicable. It will also continue to stipulate the provision of a minimum number of parking spaces for CVs in suitable short-term tenancy car parks.

Note 1: Including Shek Pai Wan Estate in Aberdeen, Fung Wo Estate and Shui Chuen O Estate in Sha Tin, Mun Tung Estate on Lantau Island and Hung Fuk Estate in Yuen Long.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2183)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the use of Mass Transit Railway (MTR) services by visitors to access the boundary crossing points (BCPs) during the Golden Week, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. What is the number of visitors using MTR services such as the East Rail Line (ERL) to access the BCPs during the Golden Week, and its ratio to the number of local passengers?

2. Given the large number of visitors using ERL service, is congestion observed during the morning and evening peak hours? Is its carrying capacity exceeded? If yes, what are the details?

3. What are the measures taken by the Government and stakeholders to meet the additional service demand of local passengers as well as visitors during holidays?

4. Regarding visitors with bulky luggage, will the Government require the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) to carry out more stringent checks on luggage allowance during peak hours in order to avoid affecting the travelling experience and safety of other passengers?

5. Given that visitors are unfamiliar with the local commuting pattern as well as rules, regulations and system of public transport in Hong Kong, what are the Government's measures to enhance their awareness in this respect?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Hak-kan (LegCo internal reference no.: 31)

Reply:

1.-3. The Lunar New Year, Labour Day and National Day Golden Weeks are the peak periods for Mainland visitors to visit Hong Kong. The Government has been working with the public transport operators to plan ahead for the peak periods of cross-boundary travel and request the operators to scale up their services as appropriate to cope with the

travelling demand of local residents as well as visitors. The Transport Department (TD), the MTRCL and the departments working at the frontline of rail-based BCPs will maintain close liaison during the festive periods. The MTRCL will, having regard to the actual situation at the BCPs and the travel patterns and demands of passengers in different areas, make timely adjustments to the services of the ERL (including cross-boundary services to/from Lo Wu and Lok Ma Chau Stations) and other local railway lines, so as to facilitate the travelling of local residents and visitors alike. In addition, the MTRCL will deploy additional staff to implement crowd control measures at Sheung Shui Station and other major ERL stations to maintain order as necessary, and enhance the broadcast and dissemination of information.

In light of the passenger demand for ERL service, the MTRCL has adjusted the ERL train service to/from Lo Wu Station and to/from Lok Ma Chau Station between 9.a.m. and 9 p.m. on weekdays and between 10 a.m. and 7 p.m. on weekends and public holidays since 18 August 2025. During the relevant time slots, the ratio of departures for Lo Wu Station and Lok Ma Chau Station has been increased from 2:1 to 3:2. The headway of Lo Wu Station departures is comparable to the original one which is about 5 to 6.7 minutes, while the headway of Lok Ma Chau Station departures has been shortened from about 9.5 to 12 minutes to about 7.9 to 10 minutes during relevant time slots.

According to information provided by the MTRCL, the patronage of ERL service to/from Lo Wu and Lok Ma Chau Stations during the Golden Weeks of Labour Day and National Day in 2025 and Lunar New Year in 2026 is as follows:

	Total number of passengers of ERL service to/from Lo Wu and Lok Ma Chau Stations	
	Total number of passengers	**Average daily number of passengers**
Labour Day in 2025 (1 to 5 May 2025)	1 786 000	357 000
National Day in 2025 (1 to 8 October 2025)	2 600 000	325 000
Lunar New Year in 2026 (15 to 23 February 2025)	2 612 000	290 000

The TD and MTRCL do not maintain statistics on patronage of ERL cross-boundary services broken down by local residents and visitors.

During the above three Golden Weeks, the patronage of the critical link of ERL (i.e. from Tai Wai to Kowloon Tong) during the busiest one hour in the morning on weekdays was about 38 000, with an occupancy rate of about 84%. The occupancy rate of the critical link during the busiest hours on weekends or public holidays was about 60%. For most of the rest of the period, the occupancy rate was under 42%. Overall, there is still room for ERL to accommodate additional service demand.

4. According to the Conditions of Carriage of Luggage issued by the MTRCL, each passenger travelling on the trains of the urban lines (i.e. railway lines excluding Airport Express, Express Rail Link and Light Rail Transit) may carry one piece of luggage only,

with total dimensions not exceeding the specified limits (i.e. length and width and height of the luggage do not exceed 170 cm and the length of any one side of the luggage does not exceed 130 cm). The MTRCL staff may request a passenger to hand over the luggage for inspection and measurement as appropriate. In addition, the MTRCL has all along been using channels such as station announcements and station signs to appeal passengers carrying large items or luggage to use lifts, so as to avoid causing inconvenience to other passengers.

5. The MTRCL has been providing passengers (including visitors travelling on ERL and Express Rail Link) with train information of the MTR, such as rules and regulations, ticketing arrangements and passenger etiquette via various channels. Apart from putting up notices and signs at stations and on trains, delivering broadcasts at stations and in train compartments, and providing electronic information, the MTRCL organises regularly promotional activities with different themes and makes publicity and educational efforts via social media platforms commonly used by visitors. The Government will continue to encourage the MTRCL to provide passengers with caring and comfortable services, with a view to enhancing the travelling experience of local residents and visitors.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2184)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the patronage of the MTR East Rail Line (ERL), will the Government inform this Committee of the following for the past three years:

1. regarding the severe congestion observed at some ERL stations during the morning and evening peak hours, the five most congested ERL stations and time slots, and the targeted improvement measures;

2. given that the MTR Corporation Limited has been using the "Train Car Loading Indicator" for a period of time, whether the Government has assessed the positive effect of such information on passenger diversion; if yes, the details;

3. the operational situation of special short-haul services of ERL during peak hours on weekdays; and

4. other measures taken to alleviate congestion on ERL during peak hours?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Hak-kan (LegCo internal reference no.: 32)

Reply:

1., 3. and 4.

According to information provided by the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL), the critical link of the East Rail Line (ERL) during the busiest one hour in the morning in the past three years was from Tai Wai to Kowloon Tong. The occupancy rate during the busiest one hour in the morning in 2023, 2024 and 2025 for this critical link was 94%, 94% and 98% respectively (counting on the basis of four persons standing per square metre). The MTRCL evaluates the service demand for individual railway lines mainly on the basis of the passenger loading of the critical link during the morning peak hours. Therefore, the MTRCL does not have the statistics on the five most congested stations.

In light of the peak demand and travelling patterns of passengers on ERL during the morning peak hours, the MTRCL has implemented a series of measures to manage passenger flow through a multi-pronged approach, including arranging additional short-haul trips running between busy stations (including Sha Tin Station and Tai Po Market Station) during peak hours, implementing passenger diversion measures, applying technology and passenger flow management measures at stations to guide the passengers to board at parts of the platform with more available space, thereby achieving a more even distribution of passengers.

The Government and MTRCL will continue to closely monitor the operational situation, travelling patterns of passengers and patronage of ERL, and make timely adjustments to train services in light of actual needs and operational situation.

2. The MTRCL's "Train Car Loading Indicator" aims to provide passengers with real-time information on the occupancy of different train compartments, helping them to make more appropriate choices while waiting for trains, thereby improving the overall travelling experience. Such information can also help guide the passengers to board at parts of the platform with more available space and achieve a more even distribution of passengers in train compartments, which can in particular help enhance the operational efficiency of the MTR during peak hours. According to passenger feedback collected by the MTRCL on the information provided by the "Train Car Loading Indicator" and the observations of daily operations, most passengers consider that such information helps them choose to board the train at the less crowded compartments. The MTRCL will continue to review the application of such information through passenger feedback and observations of operations.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB162**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2185)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operating Expenses

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

On matters relating to the local transport matters in the past three years, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. the numbers of first registered private cars (PCs) and other vehicle classes with a breakdown by fuel types each year;

2. a breakdown of the number of fixed penalty notices (FPNs) against illegal parking by district each year;

3. the number of parking spaces in each of the 18 districts and the utilisation rates of government car parks;

4. the number of additional parking spaces planned to be provided in each of the 18 districts in the coming three years;

5. a breakdown of the number of vehicles with Guangdong-Hong Kong vehicle licences in Hong Kong by vehicle types;

6. the numbers of applications submitted and approved under the "Northbound Travel for Hong Kong Vehicles" scheme each year; and

7. the numbers of applications submitted and approved under the "Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles" since its implementation and among which, the number of contraventions of traffic regulations in Hong Kong.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Hak-kan (LegCo internal reference no.: 33)

Reply:

1. The numbers of first registered vehicles with breakdown by vehicle class and fuel type in the past three years are tabulated below:

Vehicle class	Number of first registered vehicles in 2023					
	Petrol	Diesel	Electric	Liquefied Petroleum Gas	Hydrogen	Total
Motorcycle	4 632	0	211	0	0	4 843
Private car	15 628	0	28 541	0	0	44 169
Taxi	2	0	17	933	0	952
Franchised bus	0	108	24	0	1	133
Non-franchised public bus	0	401	15	0	0	416
Private bus	0	90	0	0	0	90
Public light bus	0	93	1	21	0	115
Private light bus	0	81	1	0	0	82
Goods vehicle	0	4 701	308	0	0	5 009
Special purpose vehicle	0	81	7	5	0	93

Vehicle class	Number of first registered vehicles in 2024					
	Petrol	Diesel	Electric	Liquefied Petroleum Gas	Hydrogen	Total
Motorcycle	3 726	0	307	0	0	4 033
Private car	13 503	0	33 206	0	0	46 709
Taxi	4	0	140	827	0	971
Franchised bus	0	25	20	0	0	45
Non-franchised public bus	0	307	10	0	0	317
Private bus	0	63	3	0	0	66
Public light bus	0	105	3	14	0	122
Private light bus	0	132	1	0	0	133
Goods vehicle	0	2 936	249	0	0	3 185
Special purpose vehicle	2	71	3	5	0	81

Vehicle class	Number of first registered vehicles in 2025					
	Petrol	Diesel	Electric	Liquefied Petroleum Gas	Hydrogen	Total
Motorcycle	3 562	0	223	0	0	3 785
Private car	13 568	0	37 467	0	0	51 035
Taxi	93	0	899	812	0	1 804
Franchised bus	0	45	1	0	0	46
Non-franchised public bus	0	402	36	0	0	438
Private bus	0	38	6	0	0	44
Public light bus	0	41	11	1	0	53
Private light bus	0	89	5	0	0	94

Vehicle class	Number of first registered vehicles in 2025					
	Petrol	Diesel	Electric	Liquefied Petroleum Gas	Hydrogen	Total
Goods vehicle	0	2 383	551	0	0	2 934
Special purpose vehicle	1	72	6	0	3	82

Note 1: Hybrid vehicles are included under their respective fuel types. Only pure electric vehicles are counted in the category of electric vehicles.

2. The figures on FPNs issued against illegal parking in each of the past three years are tabulated below:

Police Region	Number of FPNs issued against illegal parking		
	2023	2024	2025
Hong Kong Island	523 167	397 077	302 958
Kowloon East	443 038	297 579	222 030
Kowloon West	960 276	872 319	742 407
New Territories South	471 527	390 462	329 572
New Territories North	615 011	585 760	471 140
Total	**3 013 019**	**2 543 197**	**2 068 107**

3. The numbers of parking spaces in the 18 districts as at December 2025 are at **Annex 1**. The utilisation rates of public car parks managed by the Transport Department (TD), the Government Property Agency (GPA) and the Leisure and Cultural Services Department (LCSD) in the past three years are at **Annex 2**, **Annex 3** and **Annex 4** respectively.

4. The Government expects to provide over 12 000 additional parking spaces across the territory in 2025 and 2026, covering both private cars (PCs) and commercial vehicles (CVs). These include more than 220 additional metered parking spaces and a minimum of 100 on-street night-time parking spaces for CVs to be completed by 2026, as well as the provision of about 600 parking spaces in short-term tenancy (STT) car parks to be leased in the next two years. The TD and relevant departments are actively taking forward these measures in accordance with the targets.

Moreover, the first three public vehicle parks (PVPs) [Note] implemented under the "single site, multiple use" principle have been commissioned, providing a total of about 860 parking spaces. With the successive commissioning of more PVP projects, including the PVP at Area 99 in Tung Chung, District Open Space, Sports Centre and PVP at Sze Mei Street, Redevelopment of Yuen Long Stadium and Kwun Tong Composite Development Project, which are expected to be completed between 2026 and 2027, a total of about 600 parking spaces will be provided. Together with other development projects and the ongoing short- and medium-term parking measures, the provision of new parking spaces will further increase in the next few years. The TD will continue to step up its efforts, focusing on districts with a shortage of parking spaces to increase the provision of on-street parking spaces as far as practicable. It will also continue to

stipulate the provision of a minimum number of CV parking spaces in suitable STT car parks.

Note: Including Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park in Sheung Shui, Pak Shing Kok Road Public Car Park in Tseung Kwan O and Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park.

5. Currently, cross-boundary vehicles of Guangdong and Hong Kong are regulated by a quota system jointly administered by the governments of the Hong Kong Special Administrative Region and Guangdong Province. These vehicles must obtain the Mainland Approval Notice issued by the Guangdong Provincial Public Security Department and the closed road permit (CRP) issued by the TD, and have completed the formalities required by the relevant authorities, before they can travel between Hong Kong and Guangdong Province. This quota system does not cover the cross-boundary shuttle buses plying between Lok Ma Chau and Huanggang (i.e. Yellow Buses), shuttle buses plying the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (HZMB) (i.e. Gold Buses), PCs under the Northbound Travel for Hong Kong Vehicles (the Northbound Travel Scheme), the Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles (the Southbound Travel Scheme) and the HZMB Macao Port Park-and-Ride Scheme.

As at end-February 2026, the numbers of the above registered and licensed cross-boundary coaches, goods vehicles and PCs issued with valid CRPs are tabulated below:

Vehicle type	**Number of Hong Kong vehicles issued with valid CRPs**
Goods vehicle	9 671
Coach	1 125
Private car	57 896

6. The Northbound Travel Scheme was launched in July 2023. To ensure that the Northbound Travel Scheme is implemented in an orderly manner, the governments of Guangdong and Hong Kong agreed to set a cap on the number of applications to be accepted, which is allocated through computer balloting. The number of applications to be accepted has been increased from 200 per working day at the beginning to 500 at present. In addition, the TD has put in place a replacement mechanism to include the quota of successful applicants who did not submit applications within the assigned period in the application quota of the subsequent round, with a view to fully utilising application quota of each round. The number of applications received by the TD (including new and renewal applications) and the number of approved applications since June 2023 are tabulated below:

Year	**Number of applications received**	**Number of approved applications**
2023 (June to December)	41 620	36 079
2024	91 316	82 333
2025	115 948	108 534
2026 (January to February)	22 732	18 288

7. The Southbound Travel Scheme (Entry into the Urban Area) has been open for application from eligible Guangdong PCs starting from 9 December. Upon receipt of

the applications transferred by the Mainland authorities, the TD will conduct vetting and issue an electronic International Circulation Permit (ICP) to the successful applicants. Guangdong vehicles issued with ICPs may make a booking to enter Hong Kong via the HZMB for up to three days per visit.

As at end-February 2026, the TD received approximately 4 200 applications and issued over 3 500 ICPs. About 700 remaining applications were being processed.

The violation cases under the Southbound Travel Scheme are sporadic, and the relevant cases have either been handled or are being followed up.

Annex 1

Numbers of parking spaces in 18 districts in Hong Kong
(as at December 2025)

District	**Total** [Note]
Central & Western	41 844
Wan Chai	41 178
Eastern	51 851
Southern	44 564
Yau Tsim Mong	39 466
Sham Shui Po	37 744
Kowloon City	59 789
Wong Tai Sin	24 541
Kwun Tong	57 500
Tsuen Wan	43 179
Tuen Mun	49 267
Yuen Long	49 294
North	26 101
Tai Po	36 952
Sai Kung	51 847
Sha Tin	82 629
Kwai Tsing	49 876
Islands	24 051
Total	**811 673**

Note: Taxis generally use the parking spaces for PCs. Franchised buses, public light buses, private light buses, special purpose vehicles and government vehicles mostly park at depots, bus stops within public transport termini as well as parking spaces at stands; therefore their parking spaces are excluded from the calculation.

Annex 2

Utilisation rates of car parks operated by the TD from 2023 to 2025

District	Car park	Number of parking spaces (except those for motorcycles (MCs)) [Note]	Average utilisation rate (%) of parking spaces					
			From 10:00 a.m. to 6:00 p.m.			From 6:00 p.m. to 10:00 a.m.		
			2023	2024	2025	2023	2024	2025
Central and Western	Star Ferry	377	82	81	80	31	28	28
	City Hall	170	65	58	51	25	24	18
	Rumsey Street	829	57	62	60	27	33	34
	Kennedy Town	195	86	85	87	80	80	88
Wan Chai	Tin Hau	428	79	75	73	64	62	61
Eastern	Shau Kei Wan	385	80	76	74	78	75	74
Southern	Aberdeen	293	64	63	62	79	78	78
Wong Tai Sin	Sheung Fung Street	267	77	74	72	83	80	79
	Wong Tai Sin	25	45	36	33	32	39	44
Kwai Tsing	Kwai Fong	511	83	73	77	76	68	74
Tsuen Wan	Tsuen Wan	545	86	79	77	82	77	76

District	Car park	Number of parking spaces for MCs	Average utilisation rate (%) of parking spaces for MCs					
			From 10:00 a.m. to 6:00 p.m.			From 6:00 p.m. to 10:00 a.m.		
			2023	2024	2025	2023	2024	2025
Central and Western	Star Ferry	37	72	65	65	54	47	45
	City Hall	27	77	74	77	68	67	68
	Rumsey Street	164	93	83	74	87	75	68
	Kennedy Town	37	74	75	72	82	82	77
Wan Chai	Tin Hau	75	77	76	79	78	77	80

District	Car park	Number of parking spaces for MCs	Average utilisation rate (%) of parking spaces for MCs					
			From 10:00 a.m. to 6:00 p.m.			From 6:00 p.m. to 10:00 a.m.		
			2023	2024	2025	2023	2024	2025
Eastern	Shau Kei Wan	72	76	72	71	81	78	78
Southern	Aberdeen	51	67	71	69	72	77	75
Wong Tai Sin	Sheung Fung Street	74	67	65	68	75	73	79
Kwai Tsing	Kwai Fong	93	82	75	80	80	71	78
Tsuen Wan	Tsuen Wan	34	64	69	69	63	68	67

Note: The number of parking spaces at Wong Tai Sin Car Park is the number of parking spaces for coaches/goods vehicles (over 5.5 tonnes); and the numbers of parking spaces at the remaining ten car parks are the numbers of parking spaces for PCs/van-type light goods vehicles.

Annex 3

Utilisation rates of public car parks managed by GPA from 2023 to 2025

District	Car park	Average utilisation rate (%)		
		2023(Note 1)	2024(Note 2)	2025(Note 3)
Central & Western	Queensway Government Offices	14	32	32
Wan Chai	Wanchai Tower, Immigration Tower and Revenue Tower	13	14(Note 6)	-
Eastern	North Point Government Offices	40	29	32
	Chai Wan Municipal Services Building(Note 4)	78	30	60
Southern	N/A			
Yau Tsim Mong	West Kowloon Government Offices	39	42	43
Sham Shui Po	Cheung Sha Wan Government Offices(Note 5)	49	54	54
Kowloon City	Tokwawan Market and Government Offices	36	77	97
	Trade and Industry Tower	38(Note 7)	29(Note 7)	31
Wong Tai Sin	N/A			
Kwun Tong	Shun Lee Disciplined Services Quarters(Note 4)	94	68	85
Tsuen Wan	N/A			
Tuen Mun	Tuen Mun Government Offices	23	10	9
Yuen Long	Yuen Long District Office Building	46	42	43
North	North District Government Offices	36	57	67
	Heung Yuen Wai Boundary Control Point(Note 4)	45(Note 8)	49	51
	Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park(Note 4)	-	19(Note 9)	54
Tai Po	Tai Po Government Offices	63	70	86
Sai Kung	Sai Kung Government Offices	12	18	25
	Tseung Kwan O Government Offices(Note 4)(Note 11)	-	-	-
	The Chinese Medicine Hospital of Hong Kong(Note 4)(Note 12)	-	-	-
Sha Tin	Sha Tin Government Offices	49	43	33
	New Territories (Shatin) Forensic Medicine Centre(Note 4)	13(Note 10)	20	23
Kwai Tsing	N/A			
Islands	Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge Hong Kong Port(Note 4)	26	18	19(Note 13)

Note 1: The average utilisation rates of parking spaces during the operating hours for the period from January to December 2023.

Note 2: The average utilisation rates of parking spaces during the operating hours for the period from January to December 2024.

Note 3: The average utilisation rates of parking spaces during the operating hours for the period from January to December 2025.

Note 4: The car parks at Chai Wan Municipal Services Building, Shun Lee Disciplined Services Quarters, Heung Yuen Wai Boundary Control Point, Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park, Tseung Kwan O Government Offices, The Chinese Medicine Hospital of Hong Kong, New Territories (Shatin) Forensic Medicine Centre and the HZMB Hong Kong Port are all-day fee-charging public car parks. The remaining properties in the above table are government joint-user general office buildings (JUBs), where the parking spaces are open for public use during non-office hours only.

Note 5: A portion of the fee-charging public car park in the building provides 24-hour parking spaces. The remaining parking spaces are for user departments of the Joint-User General Office Buildings and are open for public use during non-office hours only.

Note 6: The fee-charging public car park at Wanchai Tower, Immigration Tower and Revenue Tower ceased operation from 15 March 2024. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours in January 2024.

Note 7: The fee-charging public car park at Trade and Industry Tower ceased operation from 10 October 2023 to 25 April 2024. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours from January to September 2023 and from May to December 2024.

Note 8: The car park at Heung Yuen Wai Boundary Control Point commenced operation on 17 February 2023. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours from February to December 2023.

Note 9: Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park commenced operation in mid-November 2024. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours from December 2024.

Note 10: The New Territories (Shatin) Forensic Medicine Centre commenced operation on 1 February 2023, the relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours from February to December 2023.

Note 11: Tseung Kwan O Government Offices commenced operation in mid-December 2025. The contractor provides the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours starting from January 2026.

Note 12: The car park at The Chinese Medicine Hospital of Hong Kong commenced operation in mid-December 2025. The contractor provides the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours starting from January 2026.

Note 13: The fee-charging public car park at the HZMB Hong Kong Port has been managed by the Airport Authority Hong Kong since 16 July 2025. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours from January to June 2025.

Annex 4

Utilisation rates of public car parks managed by the LCSD from 2023 to 2025

District	Average utilisation rate (%)		
	2023	**2024**	**2025**
Central & Western	54	43	41
Wan Chai	49	50	51
Eastern	69	52	41
Southern	17	29	48
Yau Tsim Mong	38	33	29
Sham Shui Po	23	23	24
Kowloon City	57	55	70
Wong Tai Sin	21	28	31
Kwun Tong	50	44	44
Tsuen Wan	33	23	24
Tuen Mun	54	51	49
Yuen Long	63	35	38
North	65	58	52
Tai Po	27	28	29
Sai Kung	51	44	38
Sha Tin	55	52	42
Kwai Tsing	36	36	47
Islands	23	25	22

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1568)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

1. What are the numbers of Hong Kong private cars and residents travelling to the Mainland under the "Northbound Travel for Hong Kong Vehicles" (the Scheme) in each month since its launch? (Please set out by new and renewal applications);

2. Of the aforesaid vehicles which have obtained approval under the Scheme, what is the total number of vehicles trips to and from the Mainland? What is the average number of trips to and from the Mainland in each month?

3. Since the bridge was commissioned, what has been the annual expenditure incurred by the Government on the maintenance and repair of the Hong Kong section of the bridge? Please set out the relevant figures in tabular form.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.27)

Reply:

1. & 2.

The governments of Guangdong and Hong Kong have been closely monitoring the implementation situation of the Scheme to continuously take enhancement measures to provide greater convenience for the applicants, including the enhancement measure implemented by the Transport Department (TD) since 1 September 2025 to allow vehicles under the Scheme to travel to Guangdong Province via the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (HZMB) without travel bookings on Tuesdays and Wednesdays, except specified dates. The relevant data on travel bookings are set out at **Annex**, which already reflects the figures after implementing the aforesaid measure of no booking required on Tuesdays and Wednesdays. The TD does not have the information on travel bookings categorised by new or renewal applications, and does not maintain the statistics on the average monthly number of trips under the Scheme.

3. The HZMB comprises the Hong Kong Link Road (HKLR), the Main Bridge and the Zhuhai Link Road. The HKSAR Government is responsible for the repair and

maintenance of the HKLR. Following the full resumption of travel after the pandemic, since early 2023, traffic flow on the HKLR has gradually increased. The corresponding increase in repair and maintenance expenditure is attributable to actual operational needs, such as wear and tear arising from daily usage, the inspection work required, etc.. According to the information provided by the Highways Department (HyD), the annual expenditure on the HKLR from 2021-22 to 2025-26 is as follows:

Year	**Expenditure (HK$ million)**
2021-22 (actual expenditure)	8.6
2022-23 (actual expenditure)	5.7
2023-24 (actual expenditure)	21.7
2024-25 (actual expenditure)	39.8
2025-26 (revised estimate)	29.2

Note: The revised estimate for 2025-26 is lower than the actual expenditure for 2024-25, mainly due to HyD's installation of permanent working platforms in 2023-24 and 2024-25 to facilitate access to bridge access cage for routine inspections, thereby enhancing efficiency and site safety of future inspection.

Annex

Monthly numbers of travel bookings under the Scheme

Month	Number of travel bookings[#]
July 2023	3 713
August 2023	9 864
September 2023	16 743
October 2023	26 049
November 2023	32 575
December 2023	49 382
January 2024	41 539
February 2024	54 529
March 2024	60 448
April 2024	54 959
May 2024	61 661
June 2024	65 364
July 2024	60 682
August 2024	72 954
September 2024	57 105
October 2024	72 262
November 2024	64 323
December 2024	70 827
January 2025	81 568
February 2025	60 659
March 2025	71 066
April 2025	87 210
May 2025	87 254
June 2025	73 836
July 2025	75 864
August 2025	90 122
September 2025[*]	52 861
October 2025[*]	84 831
November 2025[*]	58 281
December 2025[*]	63 361
January 2026[*]	65 022
February 2026[*]	88 000

Excluding cancelled bookings.

* From 1 September 2025 onwards, bookings are not required on Tuesdays and Wednesdays (except specified dates) for vehicles travelling to Guangdong Province via HZMB under

the Scheme. Therefore, the figures on travel bookings from that month onwards should not be directly compared with those for previous months.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1570)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the road-based boundary control points (BCPs), i.e. Lok Ma Chau (LMC), Man Kam To (MKT), Sha Tau Kok (STK), Shenzhen Bay (SBP), Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (HZMB) and Heung Yuen Wai (HYW), please advise this Committee of the following:

1. the respective numbers of cross-boundary vehicles granted with regular quota for "travelling between Guangdong and Hong Kong" (i.e. dual-plate vehicles) for the above BCPs in the past three years; please set out the breakdowns by BCPs and vehicle types including buses, goods vehicles and private cars;

2. the respective designed capacities for vehicular flow and average daily utilisation figures of the above BCPs in the past three years; please set out the breakdowns by BCPs and vehicle types including buses, goods vehicles and private cars; and

3. the numbers and the average age of Hong Kong drivers operating cross-boundary commercial vehicles in the past three years and this year to date.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.: 29)

Reply:

1. Currently, cross-boundary vehicles of Guangdong and Hong Kong are regulated by a quota system jointly administered by the governments of the Hong Kong Special Administrative Region (HKSAR) and Guangdong Province. These vehicles must obtain the Mainland Approval Notice issued by the Guangdong Provincial Public Security Department and the closed road permit (CRP) issued by the Transport Department (TD), and have completed the formalities required by the relevant authorities, before they can travel between Hong Kong and Guangdong Province. This quota system does not cover the cross-boundary shuttle buses plying between LMC and Huanggang (i.e. Yellow Buses), shuttle buses plying the HZMB (i.e. Gold Buses), and private cars under the "Northbound Travel for Hong Kong Vehicles", the "Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles" and the HZMB Macao Port Park-and-Ride Scheme.

The numbers of CRPs (including newly issued and renewed CRPs) issued to buses, goods vehicles and private cars (including private cars issued with hire car permits) by the TD in the past three years are tabulated below:

(a) CRP for use at multiple BCPs (Note 1)

Vehicle type	2023	2024	2025
Goods vehicle	10 151	9 865	9 825
Bus	2 703	1 325	1 083

(b) CRP for use at specified BCP

BCP	Vehicle type	2023	2024	2025
LMC	Goods vehicle	115	81	79
	Private car	14 826	13 482	12 895
MKT	Goods vehicle	6	6	5
	Private car	1 888	1 922	1 858
STK	Goods vehicle	14	9	9
	Private car	4 424	3 875	4 227
SBP	Goods vehicle	1	1	1
	Private car (Note 2)	33 971	32 539	39 189
HZMB Hong Kong Port	Goods vehicle	85	106	110
	Private car (Note 3)	26 890	30 733	37 664
HYW	Goods vehicle	0	0	0
	Private car	2 493	3 245	5 143

Note 1: Currently, CRPs for use at multiple BCPs are issued to cross-boundary goods vehicles and cross-boundary buses. Cross-boundary goods vehicles may choose BCPs that suit their operational needs for travelling between the Mainland and Hong Kong. Cross-boundary buses are still subject to the quotas jointly allotted by the governments of the HKSAR and Guangdong Province and their specified BCPs for travelling between the Mainland and Hong Kong. An operator is allowed to arrange one northbound and one southbound cross-boundary bus trip via the specified BCP per day for every quota issued.

Note 2: Including Hong Kong and Macao cross-boundary private cars travelling to the Mainland via SBP.

Note 3: Including Hong Kong and Macao cross-boundary private cars travelling to Zhuhai Port and Macao Port via HZMB.

2. After consultation with the relevant departments, the designed capacity of the road-based BCPs and their average daily cross-boundary vehicular trips (two-way) in the past three years are set out as follows:

BCP[Note 4]	Designed capacity (vehicle trips/day) [Note5] (two-way)	Vehicle type	Average daily cross-boundary vehicular trips [Note 6] (two-way)		
			2023	2024	2025
LMC[Note7][Note 8]	about 33 000	Bus	886	1 111	1 181
		Goods vehicle	3 078	3 547	3 331
		Private car	4 983	6 870	8 193
		Total	**8 947**	**11 528**	**12 705**
MKT[Note 9]	about 14 000	Bus	228	193	223
		Goods vehicle	1 681	1 904	2 079
		Private car	188	276	323
		Total	**2 097**	**2 373**	**2 625**
SBP	about 78 000	Bus	235	593	666
		Goods vehicle	3 979	4 489	4 774
		Private car	5 412	8 408	10 759
		Total	**9 626**	**13 490**	**16 199**
HZMB Hong Kong Port	about 60 000	Bus	1 255	1 735	1 819
		Goods vehicle	798	946	1 317
		Private car	3 912	9 223	11 159
		Total	**5 965**	**11 904**	**14 295**
HYW[Note10]	about 17 850	Bus	157	190	242
		Goods vehicle	1 579	1 567	1 660
		Private car	500	1 339	2 063
		Total	**2 236**	**3 096**	**3 965**

Sources: Immigration Department, Customs and Excise Department and HZMB Authority

Note 4: Excluding STK BCP. To facilitate the redevelopment project of STK Port, passenger clearance service at STK BCP has been suspended since 30 January 2020, and cargo clearance service suspended since March 2022.

Note 5: The highest daily vehicular flow that can be handled, assuming that all vehicular kiosks at the BCPs operate at the same time.

Note 6: Figures calculated on the basis of the number of operating days of the BCPs.

Note 7: Passenger clearance service at LMC BCP was suspended between 4 February 2020 and 5 February 2023.

Note 8: Cross-boundary goods vehicle clearance service at LMC BCP was terminated with effect from 21 December 2025.

Note 9: At MKT BCP, passenger clearance service was suspended between 30 January 2020 and 7 January 2023, while passenger and cargo clearance services were suspended during various periods between July and November 2023.

Note 10: HYW BCP was officially commissioned on 26 August 2020, with its cargo clearance service commencing on the same day. Its passenger clearance service commenced on 6 February 2023 but passenger and cargo clearance services were suspended from 8 to 10 September 2023.

3. When submitting applications for CRPs for cross-boundary buses and goods vehicles, the applicants are required to provide the Mainland Approval Notice issued by the Guangdong Provincial Public Security Department, which sets out the associated drivers' information. With reference to the above information, statistics maintained by the TD on the numbers and the average age of Hong Kong cross-boundary bus and goods vehicle drivers in the past three years are set out below:

Year	**Hong Kong cross-boundary bus and goods vehicle drivers**	
	Number	**Average age (as at 31 December of the year)**
2023	13 918	56
2024	12 999	56
2025	11 353	56

Regarding cross-boundary hire cars, as at end of February 2026, there were a total of 605 private cars issued with Private Service (Limousine) (Cross Boundary Service) Hire Car Permits. The TD does not have statistics on the number and the average age of Hong Kong drivers involved.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1571)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Management of Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

1. The Transport Department awards contracts to different operators for the day-to-day management, operation and maintenance of tunnels. Please provide the revenues and expenditures on day-to-day management, operation and maintenance services of each tolled tunnel in the past three years.

Year

Name of tunnel	Toll Revenue	Expenditure on day-to-day management, operation and maintenance services

2. Please provide the expenditures on day-to-day management, operation and maintenance services of each of the toll-free tunnels in each of the past three years.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.: 30)

Reply:

1. The revenues and operating expenditures of government tolled tunnels in the past three financial years are set out as follows:

Tolled tunnel/ Control area [3]	**Revenue ($ million)**			**Operating expenditure [4] ($ million)**		
	2022-23	**2023-24**	**2024-25**	**2022-23**	**2023-24**	**2024-25**
Cross-Harbour Tunnel	653	867	1,073	158	199	196
Eastern Harbour Crossing	728	762	777	179	228	240
Western Harbour Crossing [1]	N/A	879	1,272	N/A	241	328
Tate's Cairn Tunnel	438	431	437	143	167	175
Aberdeen Tunnel	106	109	126	97	125	134

Tolled tunnel/ Control area [3]	Revenue ($ million)			Operating expenditure [4] ($ million)		
	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25
Lion Rock Tunnel	247	269	274	91	136	121
Shing Mun Tunnels	88	100	105	125	152	135
Route 8K	167	191	203	342	391	372
Tai Lam Tunnel [2]	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A

Note 1: Western Harbour Crossing was returned to government management on 2 August 2023. The figures for 2023-24 are for the period from 2 August 2023 to 31 March 2024.

Note 2: Tai Lam Tunnel was returned to government management on 31 May 2025.

Note 3: The Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section) commenced operation on 21 December 2025. All-day fixed toll of $8 for all vehicle types will be commenced upon the full commissioning of the Central Kowloon Bypass this year.

Note 4: The expenditures set out in the table include the management fees payable to the management, operation and maintenance contractors, the relevant operating and maintenance expenditure for the implementation of HKeToll, depreciation charge of capital costs and expenditure on government maintenance works of the tunnels for the years concerned.

2. The operating expenditures of government toll-free tunnels in the past three financial years are set out as follows:

Toll-free tunnel	Operating expenditure [2] ($ million)		
	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25
Tuen Mun - Chek Lap Kok Tunnel	73	79	81
Tseung Kwan O Tunnel [1]	35	31	44
Tseung Kwan O - Lam Tin Tunnel [1]	19	62	62
Central-Wan Chai Bypass Tunnel	148	148	152
Lung Shan Tunnel	61	57	57
Cheung Shan Tunnel	19	25	26
Airport Tunnel	26	26	26
Scenic Hill Tunnel	55	55	58
Kai Tak Tunnel	54	54	49

Note 1: Tseung Kwan O – Lam Tin Tunnel commenced operation on 11 December 2022 and the toll of Tseung Kwan O Tunnel was waived on the same day. The figure of Tseung Kwan O – Lam Tin Tunnel for 2022-23 is for the period from 11 December 2022 to 31 March 2023.

Note 2: Government toll-free tunnels are not included in the Operating Accounts of Government Toll-Tunnels. The expenditures set out in the table represent the management fees payable to the management, operation and maintenance contractors for the years concerned, excluding the depreciation charge of the capital costs and the expenditure on government maintenance works of the tunnels for the years concerned.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1573)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

All franchised buses have been exempted from paying tolls for government tunnels and roads since 17 February 2019. A dedicated account has been set up for each franchise, viz. the Franchised Bus Toll Exemption Fund (the Fund), to keep the toll saved. Please advise this Committee of the following:

1. What were the amounts deposited, amounts withdrawn and balance of the Fund of each franchised bus company (FBC) in the past three years? Please list (1) amounts deposited, (2) amounts withdrawn and (3) balances of the Funds by year and FBC.

2. Franchised bus operators should make use of the Funds to mitigate the fare increase magnitude imposed on passengers. Please advise how the Funds have helped relieve the fare increase pressure in the past three years. Please list the details by FBC.

3. Please set out the passenger reward measures offered by each FBC upon deduction of its permitted return under the existing fare adjustment arrangement and the respective sums involved in the past three years. Please list the relevant reward measures by FBC.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.: 33)

Reply:

1. All franchised buses have been exempted from paying tolls for government tunnels and roads since 17 February 2019. A dedicated account has been set up for each franchised bus operator (FBO), viz. the Franchised Bus Toll Exemption Fund (the Fund), to keep the toll saved. The balance in the Fund is reserved for relieving fare increase pressure of the corresponding FBOs. When a FBO applies for a fare increase and the Chief Executive in Council considers that there is a justifiable need to increase the fare, the magnitude of the increase may be reduced by using the Fund.

   The amounts deposited, amounts withdrawn and balances in the Fund set up by each FBO for its franchise in the past three years are tabulated below:

2023

Franchise **Note 1**	**Balance of the Fund Brought Forward from 2022 ($'000) [A]**	**Amount Deposited in 2023 ($'000) [B] Note 2**	**Amount Withdrawn in 2023 ($'000) [C]**	**Balance of the Fund in 2023 ($'000) [D] = [A] + [B] – [C]**
KMB	448,833	169,990	199,760	419,063
CTB (Urban and New Territories) Note 3	324	104,316	97,260	7,380
CTB (F2)	1,146	8,329	5,550	3,925
LW	1,541	1,150	990	1,701
NLB Note 4	17.9	0.1	0 Note 7	18.0

2024

Franchise **Note 1**	**Balance of the Fund Brought Forward from 2023 ($'000) [A]**	**Amount Deposited in 2024 ($'000) [B] Note 2**	**Amount Withdrawn in 2024 ($'000) [C]**	**Balance of the Fund in 2024 ($'000) [D] = [A] + [B] – [C]**
KMB	419,063	146,470	213,250	352,283
CTB (Urban and New Territories)	7,380	94,175	101,555	0
CTB (F2)	3,925	7,464	0 Note 6	11,389
LW	1,701	1,650	1,850	1,502 Note 5
NLB Note 4	18.0	0.3	0 Note 7	18.3

2025

Franchise **Note 1**	**Balance of the Fund Brought Forward from 2024 ($'000) [A]**	**Amount Deposited in 2025 ($'000) [B] Note 2**	**Amount Withdrawn in 2025 ($'000) [C]**	**Balance of the Fund in 2025 ($'000) [D] = [A] + [B] – [C]**
KMB	352,283	159,470	275,760	235,993
CTB (Urban and New Territories)	0	98,959	98,959	0
CTB (F2)	11,389	8,453	0 Note 6	19,842
LW	1,502 Note 5	3,413	1,850	3,064 Note 5
NLB Note 4	18.3	<0.1	0 Note 7	18.3

Note 1:
KMB: The Kowloon Motor Bus Company (1933) Limited
CTB (F1): Citybus Limited (Franchise for Hong Kong Island and Cross-Harbour Bus Network)
CTB (F2): Citybus Limited (Franchise for Airport and North Lantau bus network)

NWFB: New World First Bus Services Limited
CTB (Urban and New Territories): Citybus Limited (Franchise for the Urban and New Territories bus network)
LW: Long Win Bus Company Limited.
NLB: New Lantao Bus Company (1973) Limited

Note 2:
The amount deposited includes the interest (if any) received by the dedicated account in the year concerned.

Note 3:
As decided by the Chief Executive in Council, the franchises of CTB (F1) and NWFB were merged and covered by a new ten-year franchise (i.e. CTB (Urban and New Territories)) commencing at 4 a.m. on 1 July 2023. The balances, amounts deposited and amounts withdrawn in the Funds of CTB (F1) and NWFB before the merger in the year are reflected in the account of CTB (Urban and New Territories) for the year of 2023 as shown in the table above.

Note 4:
NLB operates no route via government tolled tunnels. It has only one recreational route using the Lantau Link and the tolls of the Lantau Link have been waived since 27 December 2020. Thus, basically there would be no money deposited in the Fund of NLB.

Note 5: Due to rounding, the total may not equal the sum of the individual items.

Note 6: CTB (F2) did not use the Fund in 2024 and 2025. The balance in the Fund will be reserved for alleviating fare increase pressure in the future when necessary.

Note 7: As NLB operated no route via government tolled tunnels or control areas when the fare adjustment was implemented in early 2025, it basically had no balance in the Fund and therefore could not use the Fund to mitigate the fare increase magnitude.

2. The extent of mitigation of a fare increase depends on the balance of the Fund as well as the frequency and level of fare increase of the respective franchises of the bus companies. In the past three years, the Fund has mitigated the magnitude of fare increase on the following occasions of fare adjustment:

KMB

(a) The overall actual weighted average rate (OAWAR) of fare increase shouldered by the passengers, which was implemented on 18 June 2023, was reduced from 5.5% to 3.9%; and

(b) The OAWAR of fare increase shouldered by the passengers, which was implemented on 5 January 2025, was reduced from 5.2% to 4.3%.

LW

The OAWAR of fare increase shouldered by the passengers, which was implemented on 18 June 2023, was reduced from 4.5% to 4.2%.

CTB (F1) and NWFB

The OAWAR of fare increase shouldered by the passengers, which was implemented on 18 June 2023, was reduced from 6.2% to 4.9%.

CTB (F2)

The OAWAR of fare increase shouldered by the passengers, which was implemented on 18 June 2023, was reduced from 6.4% to 4.2%.

3. A "passenger reward arrangement" is put in place under the current fare adjustment arrangement. When the rate of return on average net fixed assets of a franchise exceeds the Weighted Average Cost of Capital of the bus industry (currently 8.7% p.a.), the profit above the triggering point shall be shared with passengers on a 50:50 basis. The passengers' share is maintained as "passenger reward balance" to be used for providing fare concessions or relieving the pressure for future fare increase. Some franchised bus operators had used the cumulative passenger reward balance to provide fare concessions for passengers in the past three years. The amount involved is set out below:

	Amount involved in passenger reward ($ million)		
Franchise	**2023**	**2024**	**2025**
KMB	0	0	0
CTB (Urban and New Territories)	0.4 Note 1	0.4	0.6
CTB (F2)	0	28.2	41.8
LW	0	0	0
NLB	0.3	0.4	0.5

Note 1:

As mentioned above, the franchises of CTB (F1) and NWFB were merged to form CTB (Urban and New Territories) on 1 July 2023. The amounts involved in respect of the two franchises before the merger in that year are reflected in the account of CTB (Urban and New Territories) for the year of 2023, as shown in the table above.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1574)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Transport Department (TD) has issued various official Taxi Fleet Licences (for a period of five years). Please advise this Committee of the following:

1. What are the respective numbers of drivers and vehicles deployed in service of each licensed taxi fleet up to the present? Please set out in tabular form the details by taxi fleet.

2. What are the daily average number of orders received and amounts of fares for each licensed taxi fleet since their operation? Please set out in tabular form the details by taxi fleet.

3. What are the monthly operating costs and revenue for each licensed taxi fleet since their operation? Please set out in tabular form the details by taxi fleet.

4. Has TD received any passenger complaints against the various licensed taxi fleets since their operation? If yes, please set out the categories and numbers of complaints.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.: 34)

Reply:

1. to 3.

Since the TD issued the Taxi Fleet Licence to five taxi fleets in July 2025, the number of fleet taxis has continued to increase steadily. As at 13 March 2026, over 1 500 fleet taxis and about 2 000 taxi fleet drivers had been engaged in service, and more than 2.88 million trips had been completed. According to the conditions of the licence, taxi fleet operators are required to submit to the Commissioner for Transport (the Commissioner) the audited annual financial accounts prepared and certified by qualified auditors in accordance with the manner and format as specified by the Commissioner within four months after the end of each operating year, including financial information such as the statement of comprehensive income, statement of financial position, statement of cash flows and statement of changes in equity. The TD does not have the information on

the daily average fares of orders received and the monthly operating costs and revenue for the taxi fleets.

4. The TD has received a total of 175 complaints related to taxi fleet services since the commencement of taxi fleet operation up to 13 March 2026, mainly involving service attitude, driving behaviour and fare disputes. During the same period, the TD received about 6 500 complaints against non-fleet taxis.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2400)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (6) Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme (the Scheme), please advise this Committee of the following:

1. the total amount of subsidy received by commuters, the number of commuters receiving the subsidy and the average amount of subsidy received by each commuter in the past three years, with a breakdown by the following categories: $0 to $100, $101 to $200, $201 to $300, $301 to $400 or above (please indicate the changes in the number of beneficiaries and the amount of subsidy after a number of adjustments under the Scheme);

2. the approximate average decrease in subsidies received by each commuter after adjustments under the Scheme in the past three years, with a breakdown of the numbers of beneficiaries receiving less subsidies by the following categories: $0 to $10, $10 to $20, $20 to $30 or above;

3. the total amounts and percentages of subsidies for various modes of transport in the past three years;

4. the numbers of beneficiaries with expired subsidy with a breakdown by year, and how the expired subsidy will be handled by the Government;

5. the monthly amount of government subsidy provided and the related administrative costs under the Scheme. Please list out separately;

6. the respective percentages of commuters using AlipayHK, personalised Octopus and non-personalised Octopus to claim the subsidy, following the inclusion of AlipayHK into the Scheme starting from 1 January 2025 in addition to Octopus; and whether the Government will expand the options for other electronic payment means in the future; and

7. the numbers of commuters involved in the abuse of the Scheme in the past three years, the Government's monitoring measures to minimise such abuse and the manpower and expenditure involved?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.: 31)

Reply:

1-2. The total subsidy amount, average monthly subsidy amount, average number of beneficiaries per month and average amount of monthly subsidy per beneficiary during different periods in the past three years are set out in **Table 1**, while the average number of beneficiaries per month by monthly subsidy amount during different periods in the past three years is set out in **Table 2**.

Table 1:

Period	**Total subsidy amount ($ million)**	**Average monthly subsidy amount ($ million)**	**Average number of beneficiaries per month ('000)**	**Average amount of monthly subsidy per beneficiary ($)**
January to October 2023 (with temporary special measures)	3,482	348.2	3 234	108
November 2023 to May 2025	4,038	212.5	2 002	106
June to December 2025 (after adjustment of the monthly public transport expenses threshold)	1,155	164.9	1 582	104

Table 2:

Monthly amount of subsidy	**Average number of beneficiaries per month ('000)**		
	January to October 2023 (with temporary special measures)	November 2023 to May 2025	June to December 2025 (after adjustment of the monthly public transport expenses threshold)
$0.1 to $100.0	1 840	1 163	939
$100.1 to $200.0	890	550	418
$200.1 to $300.0	346	198	151
$300.1 or above	152	91	73

Note 1: Due to rounding, the average numbers of beneficiaries per month for a particular period in **Table 2** do not add up to the totals for that period shown in **Table 1**.

Note 2: To allow more commuters to benefit from the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme (the Scheme) during the COVID-19 pandemic, the Government implemented temporary special measures to temporarily relax the monthly public transport expenses threshold of the Scheme from $400 to $200 and temporarily increase the monthly subsidy cap from $400 to $500 from May 2022 to October 2023. With the expiry of the temporary special measures, the monthly public transport expenses threshold and the monthly subsidy cap were resumed to $400 from November 2023.

Note 3: From June 2025 onwards, the monthly public transport expenses threshold under the Scheme was raised from $400 to $500.

3. Target beneficiaries of the Scheme are the commuters who travel on local public transport services for daily commuting and whose relevant transport expenses are relatively high. Subsidies under the Scheme will not be disbursed to the public transport operators (PTOs).

4. Under the Scheme, the subsidy for each month is valid for collection within three months. Since the implementation of the Scheme, the Government has been reminding members of the public to collect their subsidies within the collection period through various publicity campaigns. On average, over 85% of beneficiaries collected the subsidy within the three-month collection period and the subsidy collected amounted to over 90% of the monthly total subsidy amount. The expired subsidy was returned to the Government by Octopus and AlipayHK.

The average monthly number of beneficiaries with expired subsidy from 2023 to 2025 (up to October) are set out in the table below:

Year	**Average monthly number of beneficiaries with expired subsidy ('000)**
2023	453
2024	191
2025 (up to October) Note	162

Note: The subsidy for November 2025 onwards remains valid for collection as at early March 2026 and hence is not included in the table.

5. The average monthly subsidy amount by year from 2023 to 2025 are set out below:

Year	**Average monthly subsidy amount ($ million)**
2023	325.7
2024	210.7
2025	186.5

The recurrent expenditure for the Scheme (excluding the subsidy amount) in the past three financial years are set out in the table below:

Financial year	**Recurrent expenditure ($ million)**
2022-23	37.4

Financial year	Recurrent expenditure ($ million)
2023-24	40.1
2024-25	42.0

The Government has been striving to lower the administrative cost of the Scheme as far as possible. The recurrent expenditure for the Scheme (excluding the subsidy amount) in the past three financial years was 1.1% to 1.7% of the annual total subsidy amount.

6. In addition to Octopus, public transport fares paid with AlipayHK have been incorporated into the Scheme with effect from 1 January 2025, providing the public with an extra electronic payment option. In 2025, the percentages of beneficiaries using non-personalised Octopus and personalised Octopus to claim the subsidy were about 70% and 28% respectively, with the remaining 2% of beneficiaries using AlipayHK.

When exploring the incorporation of more e-payment systems into the Scheme, we need to consider whether the relevant e-payment platform has been generally adopted by various PTOs for the collection of transport fares. Besides, as the Scheme involves a high volume of transactions every day, e-payment platforms to be incorporated under the Scheme would need to meet certain operational requirements, including those concerning the uploading and verification of transaction records, the arrangement of subsidy calculation and disbursement, monitoring mechanism, etc., in order to ensure the smooth operation of the Scheme.

7. As commuters themselves bear the majority portion of their public transport expenses and there is a cap on the monthly subsidy amount under the Scheme, such design helps deter abuses. Meanwhile, the Transport Department (TD) has adopted a series of monitoring measures to ensure proper use of public funds and minimise risks of abuse. The participating PTOs are required to establish a set of audit and assurance standards to strengthen their internal control and submit assurance reports prepared by independent auditors in accordance with the standards issued by the Hong Kong Institute of Certified Public Accountants to the Government on a yearly basis. In addition, the monitoring measures taken by the Government also include conducting regular transport surveys to gather operational data and passenger statistics, verifying the operational data submitted by the operators and checking the transaction records in the payment systems, etc. In the three financial years from 2023-24 to 2025-26, the TD conducted an average of about 90 to 170 field inspections and transport surveys per month, during which no case involving abuse of subsidies was identified.

Except for the transport surveys, monitoring work under the Scheme is undertaken by the TD's existing staff, and there is no separate breakdown of the manpower and expenditure involved.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2401)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The "Dedicated 100% Loan Guarantee Scheme for Battery Electric taxis" (the Scheme) was launched in 2023. Please advise this Committee of the following since the launch of the Scheme:

1. the number of applications;

2. the number of approved applications; and

3. the total loan amount since the launch of the Scheme up to the present.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.: 35)

Reply:

On 4 September 2023, the Government launched the "Dedicated 100% Loan Guarantee Scheme for Battery Electric Taxis (e-taxis)" (the Loan Scheme) to encourage the taxi trade to switch to battery e-taxis. The Loan Scheme is administered by the Hong Kong Mortgage Corporation Insurance Limited (HKMCI) and loan applications are processed by the participating lending institutions (PLIs).

Since the launch of the Loan Scheme up to 28 February this year, HKMCI has received from PLIs a total of 927 applications. Among them, 864 applications have been approved, nine applications are being processed, and 54 applications have the loan cancelled due to withdrawal of application by applicants or the applicants' failure to draw the loan within the period of time designated by HKMCI. Among the 864 approved applications, applicants of 700 applications have drawn the loan, with a total loan amount of about $230 million, while the remaining 164 applicants have yet to draw the loan due to various reasons, such as the vehicle has not been delivered.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2402)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Please list in table form the allowance/exemption items granted by the Government in respect of franchised bus, non-franchised bus (NFB), tram, taxi, ferry and public light bus (PLB) respectively and their respective expenditures incurred in each of the past three years and up to the present.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.: 36)

Reply:

From 2022-23 to 2025-26, the Government provided various forms of exemption/subsidy items to the public transport trades with details set out in the table below:

Public Transport Mode	**Exemption/Subsidy Items**	**Amount ($'000))**			
		2022-23	**2023-24**	**2024-25**	**2025-26 (as at 28 February 2026)**
Franchised Bus	Exemption of vehicle licence fees (Note 1)	25,484	25,333	25,641	18,724 **(as at 31 December 2025)**
	Reimbursement of Government rent and government land rental (Note 1 and Note 2)	95,282	248,679	449,035	331,143 **(as at 31 December 2025)**
	Exemption of tolls of government tunnels and roads (Note 3)	198,780	271,957	229,779	203,174 **(as at 31 December 2025)**

Public Transport Mode	Exemption/Subsidy Items	Amount ($'000))			
		2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26 (as at 28 February 2026)
	Exemption of first registration tax	28,638	11,612	4,221	2,811
	Waiver of vehicle examination fees for registered commercial vehicles (Note 4)	5,801	4,719	-	-
	Subsidy for installation of seats and estimated bus arrival time display panels at covered bus stops	4,863	911	263	159
	Subsidy for installation of safety devices on existing buses (Note 5)	127,107	54,282	60,538	-
Non-franchised Bus (NFB)	Waiver of vehicle licence fees for registered commercial vehicles (Note 4)	15,194	11,594	-	-
	Waiver of vehicle examination fees for registered commercial vehicles (Note 4)	6,303	5,497	-	-
	Waiver of fees payable for the new issue or renewal of Passenger Service Licence (PSL) for eligible types of vehicles (Note 4)	519	440	-	-
	Waiver of fees payable for the new issue or renewal of Passenger Service Licence Certificate (PSLC) for eligible types of vehicles (Note 4)	1,223	952	-	-
	Waiver of fees payable for the new issue or renewal of Closed Road Permit (CRP) for eligible types of vehicles (Note 4)	494	342	-	-

Public Transport Mode	Exemption/Subsidy Items	Amount ($'000))			
		2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26 (as at 28 February 2026)
Tram	Subsidy for tram track replacement and maintenance	5,000	10,000	10,000	-
	Reimbursement of government rent and government land rental (Note 2 & Note 6)	1,648	3,341	5,693	4,270
Taxi	Waiver of vehicle licence fees for registered commercial vehicles (Note 4)	55,261	43,230	-	-
	Waiver of vehicle examination fees for registered commercial vehicles (Note 4)	9,962	8,443	-	-
Ferry	Exemption of vessel licence fees (Note 7)	234	263	259	210 **(as at 31 December 2025)**
	Reimbursement of pier rental (Note 7)	2,415	5,286	9,166	6,792 **(as at 31 December 2025)**
	Reimbursement under Special Helping Measures (SHM) for outlying island ferry routes (Note 8)	215,282	218,879	221,541	215,351 **(as at 9 March 2026)**
Public light bus (PLB)	Waiver of vehicle licence fees for registered commercial vehicles (Note 4)	34,723	26,467	-	-
	Waiver of vehicle examination fees for registered commercial vehicles (Note 4)	2,762	2,304	-	-
	Waiver of fees payable for the new issue or renewal of PSL for eligible types of vehicles (Note 4)	303	238	-	-

Public Transport Mode	Exemption/Subsidy Items	Amount ($'000))			
		2022-23	2023-24	2024-25	2025-26 (as at 28 February 2026)
	Waiver of fees payable for the new issue or renewal of PSLC for eligible types of vehicles (Note 4)	735	504	-	-

Notes:

1. Under the Elderly Concessionary Fare Scheme (ECFS), the Government has exempted franchised buses from payment of annual vehicle licence fees, and reimbursed franchised bus operators (FBOs) the rentals of government land used for franchised bus operations.

2. From 2022-23 to June 2023, the Government provided 75% rental concession for Short Term Tenancy sites. Thereafter, the Government continued to provide 50% rental concession up to December 2023.

3. All franchised buses have been exempted from paying tolls for government tunnels and roads since 17 February 2019. A dedicated account has been set up for each franchise, viz. the Franchised Bus Toll Exemption fund (the Fund), to keep the toll saved. The balance in the Fund is reserved for relieving fare increase pressure of the corresponding FBO. When a franchisee applies for a fare increase and the Chief Executive in Council considers that there is a justifiable need to increase the fare, the magnitude of the increase may be reduced by using the Fund.

4. The Government implemented relief measures to waive vehicle licence fees and vehicle examination fees for registered commercial vehicles, as well as fees payable for the new issue or renewal of PSL, PSLC and CRP for eligible types of vehicles for four years from December 2019 to December 2023.

5. To enhance bus safety, the Government subsidised FBOs 80% of the cost of installing safety devices, such as electronic stability control, speed limiting retarder, etc. on appropriate existing franchised buses. Installation works were completed in December 2024.

6. The Government has reimbursed Hong Kong Tramways (HKT) the rentals of government land used for tram operations under the ECFS.

7. The Government has exempted ferries from annual vessel licence fees, and reimbursed ferry operators the rental of ferry piers used for franchised and licensed ferry operations under the ECFS.

8. Under SHM, subsidies are made through reimbursement of certain expenses associated with the operation of the ferry services, such as vessel-related and pier-related expenses. In 2022-23 to 2025-26, SHM were provided to the 13 outlying island ferry routes

continuously, which include "Central – Cheung Chau", "Central – Mui Wo", Inter-islands between Peng Chau, Mui Wo, Chi Ma Wan and Cheung Chau, "Central – Peng Chau", "Central – Yung Shue Wan", "Central – Sok Kwu Wan" "Discovery Bay – Central", "Ma Wan – Central", "Ma Wan – Tsuen Wan", "Aberdeen – Sok Kwu Wan via Mo Tat", "Discovery Bay – Mui Wo", "Aberdeen – Yung Shue Wan (via Pak Kok Tsuen)" and "Tuen Mun – Tung Chung – Sha Lo Wan – Tai O" routes.

Apart from the above supporting measures, the Government has completed the disbursement of a total of about $6.46 billion of subsidies to the public transport trades under various rounds of the Anti-epidemic Fund (AEF) and the measures approved by the AEF Steering Committee.

The financial impact of the measures under AEF does not form part of the Appropriation Bill or the estimates on the General Revenue Account.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3150)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the provision of parking spaces and facilities, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. in the past three years and up to the present:
   (a) the numbers of parking spaces for private cars (PCs), motorcycles (MCs) and commercial vehicles (CVs), with a breakdown by 18 districts;
   (b) the provision of the aforesaid parking spaces by the Government and the private sector in each district, and their utilisation rates;

2. the numbers of fixed penalty notices (FPNs) against illegal parking issued by the Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF) and the total amounts of fixed penalties involved in the past three years (set out the breakdown by 18 districts);

3. the number of short-term tenancy (STT) sites used as temporary car parks in each district in the past year, set out by STT locations, number of parking spaces, and scheduled resumption dates in table form.

4. The number of additional parking spaces planned to be provided in each of the 18 districts and the proportion of automated parking system (APS) in the next three years.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.38)

Reply:

1. In the past three years, the numbers of parking spaces for PCs, MCs and CVs provided by the Government and the private sector in the 18 districts are at **Annex 1**, while the utilisation rates of the public car parks managed by the Transport Department (TD), the Government Property Agency (GPA) and the Leisure and Cultural Services Department (LCSD) are at **Annex 2**.

The TD does not maintain the statistics on the utilisation rates of privately-operated car parks.

2. The statistics on FPNs issued against illegal parking by the Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF) are categorised by Police Region. Therefore, the relevant figures by 18 districts are not available. The figures on FPNs issued under the Fixed Penalty (Traffic Contraventions) Ordinance (Cap. 237) by the HKPF by Police Region and the total amounts of fixed penalty in the past three years are tabulated below:

Police Region	**Number of FPNs issued against illegal parking**		
	2023	**2024**	**2025**
Hong Kong Island	523 167	397 077	302 958
Kowloon East	443 038	297 579	222 030
Kowloon West	960 276	872 319	742 407
New Territories South	471 527	390 462	329 572
New Territories North	615 011	585 760	471 140
Total	**3 013 019**	**2 543 197**	**2 068 107**
Total amount of fixed penalty	$964 million	$814 million	$662 million

3. According to the information maintained by the Lands Department (LandsD) and the TD, the numbers of short-term tenancy (STT) fee-paying public car parks and the relevant numbers of parking spaces in 2025 with a breakdown by District Council district are set out at **Annex 3**. Regarding the scheduled resumption dates, the site of STT No. KX3079 located at Lei Yue Mun Path in Lei Yue Mun, Kowloon will be resumed for other purposes in the third quarter of 2026 according to the information from the LandsD.

4. The Government expects to provide over 12 000 additional parking spaces across the territory in 2025 and 2026, covering both PCs and CVs, including more than 220 metered parking spaces and a minimum of 100 on-street night-time parking spaces for CVs by 2026. Furthermore, in addition to providing about 600 parking spaces at short-term tenancy (STT) car parks over the next two years, a minimum number of CV parking spaces will be stipulated for suitable car parks. The Transport Department (TD) and relevant departments are actively taking forward these measures in accordance with the targets.

Besides, the first three public vehicle parks (PVPs) [Note] implemented under the "single site, multiple use" principle have been commissioned, providing a total of about 860 parking spaces. With the successive commissioning of more PVP projects, such as the PVP at Area 99 in Tung Chung, District Open Space, Sports Centre and Public Vehicle Park at Sze Mei Street, the redevelopment of Yuen Long Stadium and Kwun Tong Composite Development Project, etc., which are expected to be completed between 2026 and 2027, a total of about 600 parking spaces will be provided. Together with other development projects and the ongoing short- and medium-term parking measures, the provision of new parking spaces will further increase in the next few years. The TD will continue to step up its efforts, focusing on areas with a shortage of parking spaces to increase the provision of on-street parking spaces as far as practicable. It will

continue to stipulate the provision of a minimum number of parking spaces for CVs in suitable STT car parks.

For the automated parking system (APS), the TD does not maintain statistics on the number of privately-operated car parks equipped with APS. For public works projects with APS being taken forward by the Government, the percentage of APS parking spaces in all PC parking spaces is over 50% on average.

Note: Including Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park in Sheung Shui, Pak Shing Kok Road Public Car Park in Tseung Kwan O and Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park.

Annex 1

Numbers of parking spaces for PCs, MCs and CVs by district in the past three years [Note]

District	Situation as at end-December of each year	PC			MC			CV		
		Provided by the Government	Provided by the private sector	Total	Provided by the Government	Provided by the private sector	Total	Provided by the Government	Provided by the private sector	Total
Central & Western	2025	4 321	34 805	39 126	996	608	1 604	603	511	1 114
	2024	4 330	34 750	39 080	996	601	1 597	651	498	1 149
	2023	4 411	34 045	38 456	994	483	1 477	643	443	1 086
Wan Chai	2025	3 468	35 789	39 257	1 051	384	1 435	308	178	486
	2024	3 457	35 523	38 980	1 044	359	1 403	490	178	668
	2023	3 595	35 138	38 733	1 024	321	1 345	313	180	493
Eastern	2025	3 716	43 200	46 916	1 208	1 602	2 810	534	1 591	2 125
	2024	3 715	42 914	46 629	1 189	1 562	2 751	533	1 596	2 129
	2023	3 694	43 136	46 830	1 200	1 455	2 655	545	1 616	2 161
Southern	2025	3 303	37 780	41 083	949	1 111	2 060	323	1 098	1 421
	2024	3 329	36 970	40 299	935	1 079	2 014	323	1 073	1 396
	2023	3 326	36 751	40 077	935	1 053	1 988	327	1 069	1 396
Yau Tsim Mong	2025	2 467	33 217	35 684	1 383	836	2 219	700	863	1 563
	2024	2 486	33 153	35 639	1 353	786	2 139	708	859	1 567
	2023	2 537	33 421	35 958	1 343	797	2 140	774	875	1 649
Sham Shui Po	2025	5 421	26 376	31 797	1 431	968	2 399	1 425	2 123	3 548
	2024	5 316	26 215	31 531	1 396	929	2 325	1 433	2 206	3 639
	2023	5 323	25 305	30 628	1 380	854	2 234	1 446	2 292	3 738
	2025	5 504	49 994	55 498	1 278	1 352	2 630	429	1 232	1 661

District	Situation as at end-December of each year	PC			MC			CV		
		Provided by the Government	Provided by the private sector	Total	Provided by the Government	Provided by the private sector	Total	Provided by the Government	Provided by the private sector	Total
Kowloon City	2024	5 561	47 634	53 195	1 259	1 186	2 445	443	1 275	1 718
	2023	5 515	46 646	52 161	1 238	1 045	2 283	418	1 244	1 662
Wong Tai Sin	2025	4 703	15 877	20 580	1 185	1 406	2 591	458	912	1 370
	2024	4 604	16 132	20 736	1 135	1 426	2 561	468	921	1 389
	2023	4 493	16 472	20 965	1 080	1 328	2 408	458	910	1 368
Kwun Tong	2025	7 957	40 556	48 513	2 491	2 706	5 197	643	3 147	3 790
	2024	8 244	40 976	49 220	2 430	2 576	5 006	723	3 083	3 806
	2023	8 233	41 130	49 363	2 316	2 449	4 765	702	2 943	3 645
Tsuen Wan	2025	2 758	35 916	38 674	999	1 050	2 049	223	2 233	2 456
	2024	2 749	35 644	38 393	944	883	1 827	225	2 288	2 513
	2023	2 756	35 826	38 582	873	886	1 759	219	2 322	2 541
Tuen Mun	2025	5 125	39 120	44 245	1 115	1 102	2 217	678	2 127	2 805
	2024	5 098	38 655	43 753	1 131	1 097	2 228	669	2 138	2 807
	2023	5 036	38 658	43 694	1 118	958	2 076	668	2 131	2 799
Yuen Long	2025	4 586	40 134	44 720	866	1 276	2 142	670	1 762	2 432
	2024	4 612	39 363	43 975	878	1 149	2 027	676	1 909	2 585
	2023	4 609	39 436	44 045	864	1 110	1 974	699	1 811	2 510
North	2025	5 761	17 516	23 277	659	412	1 071	967	786	1 753
	2024	5 849	17 511	23 360	694	411	1 105	869	767	1 636
	2023	5 103	17 842	22 945	678	380	1 058	852	1 007	1 859
Tai Po	2025	2 715	31 561	34 276	397	906	1 303	641	732	1 373

District	Situation as at end-December of each year	PC			MC			CV		
		Provided by the Government	Provided by the private sector	Total	Provided by the Government	Provided by the private sector	Total	Provided by the Government	Provided by the private sector	Total
	2024	2 722	29 771	32 493	376	875	1 251	654	671	1 325
	2023	2 666	29 763	32 429	366	850	1 216	666	695	1 361
Sai Kung	2025	4 180	41 849	46 029	760	3 000	3 760	662	1 396	2 058
	2024	3 875	41 071	44 946	713	2 955	3 668	586	1 322	1 908
	2023	3 873	40 415	44 288	687	2 759	3 446	599	1 224	1 823
Sha Tin	2025	6 006	70 125	76 131	1 141	2 482	3 623	592	2 283	2 875
	2024	6 242	70 266	76 508	1 103	2 407	3 510	618	2 306	2 924
	2023	6 079	71 024	77 103	996	2 376	3 372	609	2 411	3 020
Kwai Tsing	2025	5 261	30 848	36 109	1 791	1 540	3 331	994	9 442	10 436
	2024	5 533	30 845	36 378	1 673	1 478	3 151	972	8 809	9 781
	2023	5 329	31 004	36 333	1 581	1 378	2 959	950	10 054	11 004
Islands	2025	2 860	18 891	21 751	397	604	1 001	255	1 044	1 299
	2024	2 862	17 541	20 403	397	370	767	255	1 044	1 299
	2023	2 628	18 022	20 650	319	390	709	389	884	1 273
Total	**2025**	**80 112**	**643 554**	**723 666**	**20 097**	**23 345**	**43 442**	**11 105**	**33 460**	**44 565**
	2024	**80 584**	**634 934**	**715 518**	**19 646**	**22 129**	**41 775**	**11 296**	**32 943**	**44 239**
	2023	**79 206**	**634 034**	**713 240**	**18 992**	**20 872**	**39 864**	**11 277**	**34 111**	**45 388**

Note: The above parking information is collated from the data provided by various departments, organisations and car park management companies or operators, and is for general reference only. The actual number of parking spaces may vary as the car park providers, management companies or operators responsible for managing the car parks may make adjustments to the numbers/types of parking spaces to suit their own requirements.

Annex 2

Utilisation rates of car parks operated by the TD from 2023 to 2025

District	Car Park	Number of parking spaces (except those for MCs) [Note]	Average utilisation rate (%) of parking spaces					
			From 10:00 am to 6:00 pm			From 6:00 pm to 10:00 am		
			2023	2024	2025	2023	2024	2025
Central and Western	Star Ferry	377	82	81	80	31	28	28
	City Hall	170	65	58	51	25	24	18
	Rumsey Street	829	57	62	60	27	33	34
	Kennedy Town	195	86	85	87	80	80	88
Wan Chai	Tin Hau	428	79	75	73	64	62	61
Eastern	Shau Kei Wan	385	80	76	74	78	75	74
Southern	Aberdeen	293	64	63	62	79	78	78
Wong Tai Sin	Sheung Fung Street	267	77	74	72	83	80	79
	Wong Tai Sin	25	45	36	33	32	39	44
Kwai Tsing	Kwai Fong	511	83	73	77	76	68	74
Tsuen Wan	Tsuen Wan	545	86	79	77	82	77	76

District	Car park	Number of MC parking spaces	Average utilisation rate (%) of parking spaces for MCs					
			From 10:00 am to 6:00 pm			From 6:00 pm to 10:00 am		
			2023	2024	2025	2023	2024	2025
Central and Western	Star Ferry	37	72	65	65	54	47	45
	City Hall	27	77	74	77	68	67	68
	Rumsey Street	164	93	83	74	87	75	68
	Kennedy Town	37	74	75	72	82	82	77
Wan Chai	Tin Hau	75	77	76	79	78	77	80
Eastern	Shau Kei Wan	72	76	72	71	81	78	78
Southern	Aberdeen	51	67	71	69	72	77	75
Wong Tai Sin	Sheung Fung Street	74	67	65	68	75	73	79
Kwai Tsing	Kwai Fong	93	82	75	80	80	71	78
Tsuen Wan	Tsuen Wan	34	64	69	69	63	68	67

Note: The number of parking spaces at Wong Tai Sin Car Park is the number of parking spaces for coaches/goods vehicles (over 5.5 tonnes); and the numbers of parking spaces at the remaining ten car parks are the numbers of parking spaces for PCs/van-type light goods vehicles.

Average utilisation rates (%) of public car parks managed by the GPA from 2023 to 2025

District	Car park	Average utilisation rate (%)		
		2023 (Note 1)	2024 (Note 2)	2025 (Note 3)
Central & Western	Queensway Government Offices	14	32	32
Wan Chai	Wanchai Tower, Immigration Tower and Revenue Tower	13	14 (Note 6)	-
Eastern	North Point Government Offices	40	29	32
	Chai Wan Municipal Services Building (Note 4)	78	30	60
Southern	No car park under GPA's management			
Yau Tsim Mong	West Kowloon Government Offices	39	42	43
Sham Shui Po	Cheung Sha Wan Government Offices (Note 5)	49	54	54
Kowloon City	Tokwawan Market and Government Offices	36	77	97
	Trade and Industry Tower	38 (Note 7)	29 (Note 7)	31
Wong Tai Sin	No car park under GPA's management			
Kwun Tong	Shun Lee Disciplined Services Quarters (Note 4)	94	68	85
Tsuen Wan	No car park under GPA's management			
Tuen Mun	Tuen Mun Government Offices	23	10	9
Yuen Long	Yuen Long District Office Building	46	42	43
North	North District Government Offices	36	57	67
	Heung Yuen Wai Boundary Control Point (Note 4)	45 (Note 8)	49	51
	Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park (Note 4)	-	19 (Note 9)	54
Tai Po	Tai Po Government Offices	63	70	86
Sai Kung	Sai Kung Government Offices	12	18	25
	Tseung Kwan O Government Offices (Note 4) (Note 11)	-	-	-
	Chinese Medicine Hospital of Hong Kong (Note 4) (Note 12)	-	-	-
Sha Tin	Sha Tin Government Offices	49	43	33
	New Territories (Shatin) Forensic Medicine Centre (Note 4)	13 (Note 10)	20	23
Kwai Tsing	No car park under GPA's management			
Islands	Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge Hong Kong Port (Note 4)	26	18	19 (Note 13)

Note 1: The average utilisation rates of parking spaces during the operating hours from January to December 2023.

Note 2: The average utilisation rates of parking spaces during the operating hours from January to December 2024.

Note 3: The average utilisation rates of parking spaces during the operating hours from January to December 2025.

Note 4: The car parks at Chai Wan Municipal Services Building, Shun Lee Disciplined Services Quarters, Heung Yuen Wai Boundary Control Point, Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park, Tseung Kwan O Government Offices, The Chinese Medicine Hospital of Hong Kong, the New Territories (Shatin) Forensic Medicine Centre and Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge Hong Kong Port are all-day fee-charging public car parks. The remaining properties in the above table are Joint-User General Office Buildings where the parking spaces are open for public use during non-office hours only.

Note 5: A portion of the fee-charging public car park in the building provides 24-hour parking spaces. The remaining parking spaces are for user departments of the Joint-User General Office Buildings and are open for public use during non-office hours only.

Note 6: The fee-charging public car park at Wanchai Tower, Immigration Tower and Revenue Tower ceased operation from 15 March 2024. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours in January 2024.

Note 7: The fee-charging public car park at Trade and Industry Tower ceased operation from 10 October 2023 to 25 April 2024. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours from January to September 2023 and from May to December 2024.

Note 8: The public car park at Heung Yuen Wai Boundary Control Point commenced operation on 17 February 2023. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours from February to December 2023.

Note 9: Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park commenced operation in mid-November 2024. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours starting from December 2024.

Note 10: The New Territories (Shatin) Forensic Medicine Centre commenced operation on 1 February 2023. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours from February to December 2023.

Note 11: Tseung Kwan O Government Offices commenced operation in mid-December 2025. The contractor provides the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours starting from January 2026.

Note 12: The car park at The Chinese Medicine Hospital of Hong Kong commenced operation in mid-December 2025. The contractor provides the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours starting from January 2026.

Note 13: The fee-charging public car park at the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge Hong Kong Port has been managed by the Airport Authority Hong Kong since 16 July 2025. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours from January to June 2025.

Utilisation rates of public car parks managed by the LCSD from 2023 to 2025

District	Average utilisation rate (%)		
	2023	2024	2025
Central & Western	54	43	41
Wan Chai	49	50	51
Eastern	69	52	41
Southern	17	29	48
Yau Tsim Mong	38	33	29
Sham Shui Po	23	23	24
Kowloon City	57	55	70
Wong Tai Sin	21	28	31
Kwun Tong	50	44	44
Tsuen Wan	33	23	24
Tuen Mun	54	51	49
Yuen Long	63	35	38
North	65	58	52
Tai Po	27	28	29
Sai Kung	51	44	38
Sha Tin	55	52	42
Kwai Tsing	36	36	47
Islands	23	25	22

Annex 3

Details of fee-charging STT public car parks by 18 districts in 2025

District	Number of car parks	Number of parking spaces
Central & Western	3	216
Wan Chai	-	-
Eastern	9	999
Southern	4	230
Yau Tsim Mong	3	577
Sham Shui Po	5	867
Kowloon City	3	786
Wong Tai Sin	3	409
Kwun Tong	6	999
Tsuen Wan	9	2 221
Tuen Mun	16	1 832
Yuen Long	15	1 154
North	10	1 103
Tai Po	10	1 570
Sai Kung	18	3 374
Sha Tin	14	2 039
Kwai Tsing	50	6 938
Islands	2	500
Total	**180**	**25 814**

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3272)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

On public transport fare increases, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. Please list the fare increase applications for various public transport services received by the Transport Department in the past year, including the routes involved, proposed rates of fare increase and results of assessment, with a breakdown by mode of public transport.

2. Please provide information on the interchange fare concession arrangements between different public transport operators in the past three years, with a breakdown by "Public transport operators involved in the interchange schemes", "Fare concession for each interchange trip", "Average daily interchange trips benefited" and "Dates of commencement and termination of the schemes".

3. What are the non-farebox revenue situations of various public transport modes and the proportions of non-farebox revenue in the profit of various operators? and

4. What are the public transport modes offering monthly passes or package tickets in the past year and at present, and the numbers of users?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.: 39)

Reply:

1. As public transport services are closely related to people's livelihoods, the Government will handle fare increase applications in a prudent manner as always, taking into account the operators' financial situation and prospects, public acceptability and affordability, etc., and continue to play a gatekeeper role. The fare adjustment applications of public transport services received by the Transport Department (TD) in 2025 are set out below:

(A) Green Minibus (GMB)

No.	GMB Route No.	Fare Increase Rate Applied (Full fare)	Result
Hong Kong Island			
1.	HKI 1	7.6%	Being processed
2.	HKI 1A	10.5%	Being processed
3.	HKI 2	10.7%	Being processed
4.	HKI 3	10.5%	Being processed
5.	HKI 3A	10.5%	Being processed
6.	HKI 4A	14.7%	Being processed
7.	HKI 4B	14.7%	Being processed
8.	HKI 4C	14.7%	Being processed
9.	HKI 4S	14.3%	Being processed
10.	HKI 5	21.2%	Being processed
11.	HKI 5M	15.5%	Being processed
12.	HKI 8	14.3%	Being processed
13.	HKI 8X	8.1%	Being processed
14.	HKI 9	11.2%	Being processed
15.	HKI 10	11.4%	Proposed increase by 7.1% Note (1)
16.	HKI 10P	11.4%	Proposed increase by 7.1% Note (1)
17.	HKI 12	22.7%	Being processed
18.	HKI 13	19.6%	Being processed
19.	HKI 16A	10.3%	Proposed increase by 8.3% Note (1)
20.	HKI 16M	10.3%	Proposed increase by 8.3% Note (1)
21.	HKI 16X	13.6%	Proposed increase by 9.1% Note (1)
22.	HKI 18M	17.2%	Proposed increase by 9.2% Note (1)
23.	HKI 20	20.8%	Proposed increase by 9.7% Note (1)
24.	HKI 20M	29.4%	Proposed increase by 11.8% Note (1)
25.	HKI 22	21.7%	Being processed
26.	HKI 22S	21.7%	Being processed
27.	HKI 22X	21.7%	Being processed
28.	HKI 23	14.1%	Being processed
29.	HKI 23M	14.1%	Being processed
30.	HKI 24A	8.8%	Being processed
31.	HKI 24M	9%	Being processed
32.	HKI 25	8.9%	Being processed
33.	HKI 28	10.4%	Being processed
34.	HKI 28M	10.4%	Being processed
35.	HKI 28S	10.4%	Being processed
36.	HKI 31	14.5%	Proposed increase by 7.3% Note (1)
37.	HKI 31X	14.5%	Proposed increase by 7.3% Note (1)
38.	HKI 32	12.5%	Proposed increase by 8.9% Note (1)
39.	HKI 32A	12.8%	Proposed increase by 10.3% Note (1)
40.	HKI 33	12.5%	Proposed increase by 8.9% Note (1)
41.	HKI 33M	12.8%	Proposed increase by 10.3% Note (1)
42.	HKI 35M	14.7%	Being processed
43.	HKI 39C	14.3%	Being processed
44.	HKI 39M	15.3%	Being processed

No.	GMB Route No.	Fare Increase Rate Applied (Full fare)	Result
45.	HKI 40	15.4%	Being processed
46.	HKI 40X	15.4%	Being processed
47.	HKI 51	16.7%	Being processed
48.	HKI 51A	16.7%	Being processed
49.	HKI 51S	17.1%	Being processed
50.	HKI 52	14.9%	Being processed
51.	HKI 56	14.2%	Proposed increase by 6.1% Note (1)
52.	HKI 56A	14.2%	Proposed increase by 6.1% Note (1)
53.	HKI 56B	14.2%	Proposed increase by 6.1% Note (1)
54.	HKI 69	15.9%	Being processed
55.	HKI 69A	12.9%	Being processed
56.	HKI 69X	10.4%	Being processed
57.	HKI N4A	17.1%	Being processed
58.	HKI N4C	17.1%	Being processed
59.	HKI N4M	14.5%	Being processed
60.	HKI N4X	17.1%	Being processed
61.	HKI N31	14.7%	Proposed increase by 6.2% Note (1)
62.	HKI N40	15.2%	Being processed
63.	HKI N51S	15.4%	Being processed
Kowloon			
1.	KLN 5M	12.5%	Proposed increase by 10.7% Note (1)
2.	KLN 9M	14.3%	Proposed increase by 9.5% Note (1)
3.	KLN 16	10.5%	Proposed increase by 7.9% Note (1)
4.	KLN 16A	9.3%	Proposed increase by 7.0% Note (1)
5.	KLN 16B	9.3%	Proposed increase by 7.0% Note (1)
6.	KLN 16S	9.3%	Proposed increase by 7.0% Note (1)
7.	KLN 17M	13.6%	Being processed
8.	KLN 22A	16.4%	Proposed increase by 8.2% Note (1)
9.	KLN 22M	17.3%	Proposed increase by 8.7% Note (1)
10.	KLN 25M	11.6%	Being processed
11.	KLN 25MS	14.3%	Being processed
12.	KLN 25A	11.6%	Being processed
13.	KLN 25B	10.1%	Being processed
14.	KLN 37A	10.6%	Proposed increase by 8.5% Note (1)
15.	KLN 37M	10.6%	Proposed increase by 8.5% Note (1)
16.	KLN 38M	14.6%	Being processed
17.	KLN 39M	14.6%	Being processed
18.	KLN 47	11.5%	Proposed increase by 8.2% Note (1)
19.	KLN 48	11.5%	Being processed
20.	KLN 49	12.2%	Being processed
21.	KLN 49M	1.9%	Being processed
22.	KLN 54	10.6%	Proposed increase by 8.5% Note (1)
23.	KLN 54M	10.0%	Proposed increase by 10.0% Note (1)
24.	KLN 54S	10.3%	Proposed increase by 9.0% Note (1)
25.	KLN 69	23.6%	Proposed increase by 10.1% Note (1)
26.	KLN 69A	18.6%	Proposed increase by 9.3% Note (1)

No.	GMB Route No.	Fare Increase Rate Applied (Full fare)	Result
27.	KLN 76A	10.6%	Being processed
28.	KLN 76B	10.6%	Being processed
29.	KLN 77M	6.5%	Being processed
30.	KLN 78	10.5%	Being processed
31.	KLN 79K	8.9%	Proposed increase by 8.9% Note (1)
32.	KLN 79M	9.1%	Proposed increase by 6.8% Note (1)
33.	KLN 79S	9.1%	Proposed increase by 6.8% Note (1)
34.	KLN 82	33.3%	Proposed increase by 8.9% Note (1)
35.	KLN 83A	22.2%	Proposed increase by 8.9% Note (1)
36.	KLN 83B	22.2%	Proposed increase by 8.9% Note (1)
37.	KLN 83M	22.2%	Proposed increase by 8.9% Note (1)
38.	KLN 87	18.1%	Increased by 9.1%
39.	KLN 89A	16.3%	Being processed
40.	KLN 89B	11.4%	Being processed
41.	KLN 89C	16.3%	Being processed
New Territories			
1.	NT 101M	11.9%	Being processed
2.	NT 102B	11.1%	Being processed
3.	NT 102S	20.2%	Being processed
4.	NT 102	11.1%	Being processed
5.	NT 105	20.0%	Proposed increase by 7.8% Note (1)
6.	NT 106	10.9%	Being processed
7.	NT 107	10.3%	Being processed
8.	NT 108A	10.8%	Increased by 9.2%
9.	NT 111	11.1%	Being processed
10.	NT 112M	7.7%	Increased by 5.8%
11.	NT 113	12.3%	Being processed
12.	NT 115	10.5%	Being processed
13.	NT 140M	20.5%	Increased by 5.5%
14.	NT 15A	15.4%	Increased by 9.6%
15.	NT 15M	11.8%	Increased by 9.8%
16.	NT 15	15.4%	Increased by 9.6%
17.	NT 16	11.5%	Increased by 9.6%
18.	NT 17A	13.3%	Increased by 8.9%
19.	NT 17M	13.3%	Increased by 8.9%
20.	NT 17	12.0%	Increased by 9.3%
21.	NT 20A	15.4%	Being processed
22.	NT 20B	15.7%	Being processed
23.	NT 20C	15.9%	Being processed
24.	NT 20E	15.9%	Being processed
25.	NT 20G	15.7%	Being processed
26.	NT 20K	15.3%	Being processed
27.	NT 20M	15.4%	Being processed
28.	NT 20P	15.4%	Being processed
29.	NT 20R	15.4%	Being processed
30.	NT 20S	15.4%	Being processed

No.	GMB Route No.	Fare Increase Rate Applied (Full fare)	Result
31.	NT 20T	15.7%	Being processed
32.	NT 20X	15.4%	Being processed
33.	NT 21A	15.4%	Being processed
34.	NT 21K	15.9%	Being processed
35.	NT 22K	15.4%	Being processed
36.	NT 23K	15.8%	Being processed
37.	NT 23S	16.1%	Being processed
38.	NT 24	13.5%	Being processed
39.	NT 26A	10.0%	Being processed
40.	NT 26	10.0%	Being processed
41.	NT 28A	11.7%	Being processed
42.	NT 28K	18.0%	Being processed
43.	NT 28S	18.0%	Being processed
44.	NT 29	14.5%	Increased by 10.80%
45.	NT 308A	9.4%	Proposed increase by 7.3% Note (1)
46.	NT 308M	9.4%	Proposed increase by 7.3% Note (1)
47.	NT 310M	20.8%	Increased by 5.7%
48.	NT 31A	16.9%	Being processed
49.	NT 31	16.9%	Being processed
50.	NT 32	18.8%	Being processed
51.	NT 39A	16.4%	Increased by 8.2%
52.	NT 39	13.9%	Increased by 8.3%
53.	NT 401	14.6%	Being processed
54.	NT 402S	16.2%	Being processed
55.	NT 403A	15.1%	Being processed
56.	NT 403P	15.1%	Being processed
57.	NT 403X	15.1%	Being processed
58.	NT 403	15.1%	Being processed
59.	NT 404M	10.2%	Increased by 8.5%
60.	NT 405	10.0%	Increased by 8.6%
61.	NT 406	10.4%	Proposed increase by 5.2% Note (1)
62.	NT 407A	11.3%	Proposed increase by 6.5% Note (1)
63.	NT 407B	11.7%	Proposed increase by 5.2% Note (1)
64.	NT 407	11.8%	Proposed increase by 4.5% Note (1)
65.	NT 410	20.8%	Increased by 3.8%
66.	NT 413	14.5%	Increased by 10.8%
67.	NT 43A	11.3%	Being processed
68.	NT 43B	11.8%	Being processed
69.	NT 43C	12.1%	Being processed
70.	NT 43S	11.8%	Being processed
71.	NT 43	11.8%	Being processed
72.	NT 46M	17.0%	Proposed increase by 5.7% Note (1)
73.	NT 47M	17.0%	Proposed increase by 5.1% Note (1)
74.	NT 481	15.4%	Being processed
75.	NT 482	15.4%	Being processed
76.	NT 501A	20.4%	Increased by 7.4%

No.	GMB Route No.	Fare Increase Rate Applied (Full fare)	Result
77.	NT 501C	20.4%	Increased by 7.4%
78.	NT 501S	20.4%	Increased by 6.3%
79.	NT 502	13.9%	Increased by 3.6%
80.	NT 503K	10.1%	Being processed
81.	NT 503	10.1%	Being processed
82.	NT 504	8.3%	Being processed
83.	NT 505	12.6%	Being processed
84.	NT 50A	12.9%	Rejected
85.	NT 50K	12.9%	Rejected
86.	NT 51B	12.2%	Rejected
87.	NT 51K	11.6%	Rejected
88.	NT 52A	15.4%	Increased by 7.7%
89.	NT 52B	16.7%	Increased by 7.5%
90.	NT 52K	16.7%	Increased by 7.5%
91.	NT 54A	15.4%	Increased by 7.7%
92.	NT 54K	16.1%	Increased by 10.7%
93.	NT 56A	12.8%	Increased by 7.7%
94.	NT 618A	11.1%	Being processed
95.	NT 618B	11.1%	Being processed
96.	NT 618	11.1%	Being processed
97.	NT 65A	15.4%	Increased by 8.2%
98.	NT 65K	13.3%	Increased by 6.7%
99.	NT 65M	17.2%	Application withdrawn with reduced fare concession
100.	NT 65S	12.9%	Increased by 3.2%
101.	NT 66K	13.3%	Increased by 6.7%
102.	NT 67A	26.1%	Increased by 10.9%
103.	NT 67K	14.9%	Increased by 7.5%
104.	NT 71A	11.4%	Being processed
105.	NT 71	11.5%	Being processed
106.	NT 72	11.5%	Being processed
107.	NT 75	30.0%	Being processed
108.	NT 76	30.0%	Being processed
109.	NT 806A	15.6%	Increased by 7.8%
110.	NT 806B	15.6%	Increased by 7.8%
111.	NT 806C	25.3%	Increased by 10.5%
112.	NT 806M	15.6%	Increased by 7.8%
113.	NT 814	11.4%	Being processed
114.	NT 81M	9.5%	Increased by 4.8%
115.	NT 81	9.7%	Increased by 3.2%
116.	NT 82M	10.4%	Increased by 4.2%
117.	NT 82	9.7%	Increased by 3.2%
118.	NT 88A	12.5%	Proposed increase by 7.5% Note (1)
119.	NT 88C	20.0%	Proposed increase by 6.7% Note (1)
120.	NT 88F	20.0%	Proposed increase by 7.5% Note (1)
121.	NT 88G	20.0%	Proposed increase by 6.7% Note (1)

No.	GMB Route No.	Fare Increase Rate Applied (Full fare)	Result
122.	NT 88M	20.5%	Proposed increase by 7.2% Note (1)
123.	NT 90A	27.3%	Proposed increase by 9.1% Note (1)
124.	NT 90M	18.2%	Proposed increase by 6.1% Note (1)
125.	NT 90P	27.3%	Proposed increase by 9.1% Note (1)
126.	NT 91A	24.2%	Proposed increase by 9.7% Note (1)
127.	NT 91	21.8%	Proposed increase by 8.7% Note (1)
128.	NT 92M	18.2%	Proposed increase by 6.1% Note (1)
129.	NT 93A	18.6%	Proposed increase by 4.1% Note (1)
130.	NT 93	18.2%	Proposed increase by 6.1% Note (1)
131.	NT 99	19.0%	Increased by 7.1%
132.	NT 616S	24.0%	Proposed increase by 14.0% Note (1)

Note (1): TD has completed processing the fare increase application for the GMB routes concerned and the proposed increases have yet to take effect.

(B) Ferry Service

No.	Ferry Service	Fare Increase Rate Applied (Full fare)	Result
1.	Central − Cheung Chau	20%	Increased by 8% for monthly tickets and multi-journey concessionary ticket types and 12.5% for single-journey tickets. As all services of the "Central − Mui Wo" and "Central − Peng Chau" routes are now operated exclusively by fast vessels, the single-journey ticket fares have been consolidated and a uniform single-journey fares has been adopted for both ordinary and fast ferry services. The consolidated single-journey ticket fares are lower than the fares of fast ferry service before consolidation.
2.	Central − Mui Wo	20%	
3.	Peng Chau − Mui Wo − Chi Ma Wan − Cheung Chau	20%	
4.	Central − Peng Chau	15% to 30%	
5.	Central − Yung Shue Wan	15% to 30%	
6.	Central − Sok Kwu Wan	15% to 30%	
7.	Tuen Mun − Tung Chung − Sha Lo Wan - Tai O	35%	Being processed
8.	North Point − Kwun Tong	70%	Being processed

No.	Ferry Service	Fare Increase Rate Applied (Full fare)	Result
	(Dangerous Goods Vehicular Ferry Services)		

2. To facilitate the use of various public transport services, there are interchange fare concession between different public transport operators (PTOs). Information on such arrangements from 2023 to 2025 is set out in the table below. Given the large number of routes involved, information is presented in aggregate form.

PTOs involved in the interchange schemes Note (2)	Adult fare concession for each interchange trip	Average daily passenger interchange trips benefited	Dates of commencement and termination of the Schemes Note (3)
Railway and franchised bus 2023: 19 routes 2024: 25 routes 2025: 19 routes	From 2023 to 2025: $0.6 - $2.0	2023: 26 660 2024: 21 940 2025: 22 900	On-going
Railway and GMB Note (4) 2023: 556 routes 2024: 560 routes 2025: 570 routes	From 1 January to 4 November 2023: $0.3 - $3 From 5 November 2023 onwards: $0.5 - $3	2023: 456 560 2024: 468 530 2025: 475 531	On-going
Railway and kaito (one route)	From 2023 to 2025: $0.5	2023: 370 2024: 350 2025: 310	Commenced on 1 June 2020 and on-going
Bus-bus interchange between different franchised bus companies Note (5) 2023: 629 routes 2024: 660 routes 2025: 655 routes	From 2023 to 2025: $0.1 - $38.7	2023: 180 900 2024: 191 340 2025: 193 380	On-going
Franchised bus and GMB 2023: 71 routes 2024: 96 routes 2025: 96 routes	From 2023 to 2025: $1.0 - $4.0	2023: 258 2024: 304 2025: 316	On-going
Franchised bus and Tram (36 routes)	2023 and 2024: $3.0 2025: $3.3	2023: 1 300 2024: 877 2025: 856	Commenced on 1 July 2017 and on-going
GMB-GMB interchange between	2023 and 2024: $1.0 - $11.9	N/A Note (6)	On-going

PTOs involved in the interchange schemes Note (2)	Adult fare concession for each interchange trip	Average daily passenger interchange trips benefited	Dates of commencement and termination of the Schemes Note (3)
different GMB route packages (41 routes)	2025: $1.0 - $12.3		
Ferry-ferry interchange between different ferry operators (two routes)	2023: $3.8 - $9.4 2024 and 2025: $5.5 - $9.4	2023: 21 2024: 21 2025: 20	Commenced on 1 July 2011 and on-going

Note (2): Interchange concessionary fare arrangements for routes operated by the same operator are not covered.

Note (3): TD does not have the information on the commencement date of each scheme.

Note (4): With effect from 3 June 2018, the MTR Corporation Limited introduced a railway and GMB interchange scheme under which a discount of $0.3 is offered to passengers using Octopus for interchange between MTR and GMB. With effect from 5 November 2023, the discount of the above scheme was increased from $0.3 to $0.5 per trip, and the scheme was further extended to cover all GMB routes. A discount up to $3 is offered for interchange between MTR and individual GMB routes.

Note (5): The figures cover all franchised bus routes for which interchange discounts are provided by franchised bus operators.

Note (6): TD does not have passenger trip figures of GMB-GMB interchange between different GMB route packages.

3. The Government has been encouraging and appropriately assisting PTOs to explore different ways to increase non-farebox revenue having regard their modes of operation, so as to improve their financial situation and help alleviate the pressure for fare increase. The measures currently taken by PTOs to increase non-farebox revenue are listed below:

PTO	Measures taken to increase non-farebox revenue	Proportion of non-farebox revenue in its total revenue
MTR	Providing an attractive mix of station retail outlets and services; and displaying advertisements in stations and trains and providing multi-media broadcast service.	18.5% Note (7)

PTO	Measures taken to increase non-farebox revenue	Proportion of non-farebox revenue in its total revenue
Franchised Bus	Displaying advertisements on bus bodies, bus compartments, and bus shelters; offering free rides to the public through commercial co-operation or sponsorship; providing refuelling/washing/repair and examination services to non-franchised buses at individual bus depots; providing charging services to other electric vehicles at some of the bus depots equipped with charging facilities; displaying advertisements on external walls of individual depots; leasing out part of the parking spaces at individual bus depots; leasing out some of the floors of individual depots; installing revenue-generating facilities at suitable public transport interchanges/terminals such as vending machines, self-pickup smart lockers, etc.; and setting up customer service kiosks at suitable bus-bus interchanges or public transport interchanges/terminals.	About 1-6%
Public Light Bus	Displaying advertisements on the bodies, compartments or multi-media devices on public light buses.	About 1%
Ferry	Leasing out vessels outside the routes' operating hours; subletting pier spaces for commercial and retail purposes, such as letting out shops and renting out advertising lightboxes; and organising commercial activities in vacant pier spaces.	About 1-72%
Tram	Advertising on tram bodies and at tram stop shelters; corporate sponsorship for Free Tram Ride Day; tram charter; sales of tickets for TramOramic Tour; and sales of tram souvenirs.	About 60%

Note (7): It represents the proportion of revenue derived from Hong Kong station commercial business in the total revenue of Hong Kong transport operations.

4. The Government has all along been encouraging PTOs to introduce fare reduction or concession as far as possible, such as offering fare concession and interchange schemes for various passenger groups, to help reduce passengers' travel expenses, taking into account the operators' respective operating and financial conditions, overall economic environment and passenger needs. We will continue to encourage PTOs to offer fare concession to passengers while maintaining proper and efficient services.

Details of the monthly passes or package tickets offered by PTOs and the number of users in 2025 are listed below:

PTO involved	Monthly pass/package ticket	Average daily number of users in 2025 (unless specified otherwise)
The Kowloon Motor Bus Company (1933) Limited (KMB) / Long Win Bus Company Limited	Monthly pass, KMB "Ride 10 Get 1 Free" and pre-paid tickets	About 80 720
New Lantao Bus Company (1973) Limited (NLB)	Ticket redemption arrangements of NLB Routes No. 1, 2, 3M, 4, 11, 21, 23, A35, N1 and N35	About 20
Citybus Limited (Franchise for the Urban and New Territories bus network)	Route B7 "3-day Return Journey Pass" and Route B8 "2-day Return Journey Pass"	About 20
Citybus Limited (Franchise for the Airport and North Lantau bus network)	Cityflyer Pre-paid Return Ticket and Route B5 "3-day Return Journey Pass"	About 330
Ferry operators (14 routes)	Monthly, multi-ride, return and 4-day tourist tickets	About 12 600
The MTR Corporation Limited	"City Saver" and "Monthly Pass" Note (8)	About 300 000 Note (9)
Hong Kong Tramways (HKT)	Monthly ticket and Golden Ticket for "TramOramic Tour"	Average monthly sales figure: About 1 100 Note (10)

Note (8): At present, the MTR Corporation Limited offers five types of "Monthly Passes", including Monthly Pass 1 (Sheung Shui/Wu Kai Sha − East Tsim Sha Tsui), Monthly Pass 2 (Tuen Mun − Nam Cheong), Monthly Pass 3 (Tuen Mun − Hung Hom), Monthly Pass 4 (Tung Chung − Nam Cheong) and Monthly Pass 5 (Tung Chung − Hong Kong).

Note (9): It represents the average daily number of passengers using "City Saver" and various types of "Monthly Pass" in 2025.

Note (10): It represents the average monthly sales figure of monthly tickets and package tickets in 2025. Since ticket holders are only required to present their monthly/package tickets to the motorman when alighting, HKT does not have the information on the daily number of passengers using monthly/package tickets.

In addition to the above concessions, the Government has also taken measures to subsidise targeted passenger groups, such as the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme to relieve the fare burden of commuters who travel on local public transport services for daily commuting and whose public transport expenses are relatively high, and the Government Public Transport Fare Concession Scheme for the Elderly and Eligible

Persons with Disabilities (i.e. the $2 Scheme) to benefit the elderly and eligible persons with disabilities.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3273)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the taxi trade, please inform this Committee of the following:

1. the numbers of taxi driving licence holders with a breakdown by age (59 or below/ 60 to 69/ 70 to 79/ 80 or above);

2. the numbers of traffic accidents involving taxi drivers from 2024 to the present with a breakdown by the above age groups in table form;

3. the numbers of complaints received by the Government involving taxi drivers' malpractices in the past three years with a breakdown by the top ten categories with the most prosecutions;

4. the numbers of prosecutions against illegal carriage of passengers by private cars and goods vehicles for hire or reward in the past three years; and

5. the numbers of barrier-free taxis (wheelchair accessible taxis) and electric taxis at present, and the measures taken to encourage the taxi trade to introduce barrier-free taxis and electric taxis.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.: 40)

Reply:

1. The numbers of holders of a valid driving licence for taxi as at 28 February 2026, broken down by age group, are tabulated below:

Age group	**No. of holders**
59 or below	80 369
60 to 69	92 126
70 to 79	37 232
80 or above	2 471
Total	**212 198**

2. According to the record, the numbers of taxi drivers involving in traffic accidents from January 2024 to February 2026, broken down by age group, are tabulated below:

Age group	Year		
	2024	2025*	2026 (January to February)*
59 or below	2 944	2 639	256
60 to 69	2 022	1 644	194
70 to 79	625	668	74
80 or above	26	33	3

* Provisional figures

3. The numbers of complaints against taxi drivers received by the Transport Department (TD) in each of the past three years, broken down by ten categories with the most complaints, are tabulated below. The numbers cover the complaints referred by the 1823 Call Centre, the Transport Complaints Unit under the Transport Advisory Committee and other government departments or organisations.

Type	**No. of complaints received by the TD**		
	2023	**2024**	**2025**
Overcharging	340	460	368
Refusing or neglecting to accept a hire	361	306	204
Refusing or neglecting to drive a taxi to the place indicated by the hirer	28	52	38
Failure to drive to a destination by the most direct practicable route	277	453	380
Improper driving behaviours	374	366	409
Behaving not in a civil and orderly manner	712	710	503
Failure to display driver identity plate	17	34	18
Smoking	26	36	38
Obstructing traffic	36	63	65
Poor vehicle conditions	22	29	35

4. The numbers of enforcement actions taken by the Hong Kong Police Force against illegal carriage of passengers by private cars and light goods vehicles for hire or reward in the past three years are tabulated below:

Year	**No. of enforcement actions**
2023	33
2024	47
2025	118

5. As at the end of February this year, there were 6 289 wheelchair accessible barrier-free taxis and 1 096 electric taxis (e-taxis).

Under the concept of "Transport for All", the Government has been actively encouraging the taxi trade to introduce more wheelchair accessible taxis and different models, so that more choices will be provided to wheelchair users to meet their travel

needs. The TD has all along been open to the introduction of wheelchair accessible taxi models by the taxi trade or vehicle suppliers. The TD will continue to maintain communication with the taxi trade and various vehicle suppliers to assist them in understanding the relevant standards and vetting procedures, and will help co-ordinate the trade's efforts in identifying models suitable for use on the roads in Hong Kong as and when necessary. In addition, to further improve taxi service quality, the Government issued the Taxi Fleet Licence to five taxi fleets in July 2025. According to the conditions of the licence, each fleet must provide a certain number of wheelchair accessible taxis. Currently, five taxi fleets have a total of about 130 wheelchair accessible taxis in service to facilitate travelling by wheelchair users.

Regarding e-taxis, the Government launched the "Dedicated 100% Loan Guarantee Scheme for Battery E-Taxis" (the Loan Scheme) on 4 September 2023 to encourage the taxi trade to switch to battery e-taxis. The maximum loan amount is the purchase price of the battery e-taxi, capped at $350,000. As at the end of February 2026, 864 applications under the Loan Scheme were approved. In addition, the Government promulgated the Green Transformation Roadmap of Public Buses and Taxis in December 2024 and launched the e-taxi subsidy scheme under the New Energy Transport Fund in the same month to subsidise taxi owners to purchase 3 000 e-taxis. The subsidy level for each e-taxi is $45,000. In the Updated Version of the Hong Kong Roadmap on Popularisation of Electric Vehicles announced in February this year, the Environment and Ecology Bureau (EEB) stated that it would introduce a $50 million subsidy scheme for electric wheelchair-accessible taxis this year. The EEB is currently formulating the framework for the new scheme. The details and arrangements will also be drawn up after consultation with relevant stakeholders, and will be announced in due course.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3274)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the implementation of the Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector – Public Light Bus/Coach Trade (the Scheme), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the number of applications and imported drivers since the launch of the Scheme in 2023? Please provide the details on the number of quotas applied, processing status and approval of applications for each round of application;

2. the distribution of the above-mentioned approved applications by public transport organisations;

3. the average monthly salary and age of the above-mentioned imported drivers;

4. whether the Transport Department has received any complaints about imported drivers; if yes, please provide the breakdown of the categories of complaints.

Regarding the park-and-ride (PnR) schemes, the current (a) locations of the car parks providing PnR facilities, (b) PnR fee and (c) utilisation rate of these facilities in each district (including the airport and various boundary control points).

Asked by: Hon CHAN Han-pan (LegCo internal reference no.: 42)

Reply:

1. - 2. The Government has all along been concerned about the long standing driver shortage problem faced by the public light bus (PLB)/coach trade. To alleviate the problem of labour shortage in the trade, the Government announced the Scheme in June 2023, and approved a total of 900 PLB and 800 coach driver quotas through two rounds of applications in September 2023 and July 2024 respectively. All applications were vetted by the inter-departmental liaison group (comprising representatives from the Transport and Logistics Bureau, the Labour Department and the Transport Department (TD)). Details of the two

rounds of application are at **Annex 1**. As for the gradual expiry of the contracts of the first batch of imported workers by the end of 2025, the TD has announced the quota renewal arrangements in August 2025. The operators with allocated quotas should submit renewal applications to the TD five months prior to the expiry of the contracts of their imported drivers. As at end-February 2026, 589 quotas (including 324 PLB and 265 coach driver quotas) have been granted with approval for renewal. The TD will continue to process the renewal applications received, including reviewing whether or not the operators concerned continue to meet the criteria of the Scheme (such as maintaining the manning ratio of 1:2 for imported labours to full-time local staff, offering the wage levels for imported labours at not less than the median monthly wages of relevant posts, and complying with the relevant local driver recruitment requirements). Besides, the number of imported drivers who have commenced work as at end-February 2026 is provided in the following table:

Driver job type	**No. of imported drivers who have commenced work**
Public Light Bus Driver	862
Local Coach Driver	365
Cross-boundary Coach Driver	370
Total	**1 597**

3. The TD does not maintain the statistics on the average monthly salary and age of the imported drivers.

4. As at end-February 2026, the TD received a total of 61 complaints concerning imported drivers' service attitude and driving skills (as in the table below). The nature of the complaints includes failing to allow passengers to alight at specified locations/stops, or providing passengers with incorrect information on routes/destinations/departure schedules.

	No. of complaints against imported drivers
From the launch of the Scheme to end-February 2025	33
From March 2025 to end-February 2026	28
Total	**61**

Regarding the park-and-ride (PnR) scheme, at present, a total of about 9 700 PnR parking spaces are provided at 24 car parks in Hong Kong. Details of the PnR facilities are in **Annex 2**. According to the information available to the TD, the current PnR hourly charge ranges from $7 to $24 and the daily charge (excluding the Airport Express and Express Rail Link PnR) ranges from $98 to $120. Charges depend on factors such as the PnR demand at each location. The TD does not have information on the utilisation rates of the PnR facilities.

Annex 1

Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector - Public Light Bus/Coach Trade

Numbers of applications and quotas allocated in the first round by driver job type

Driver job type	Number of applications received	Number of quotas applied for	Number of applications approved	Number of driver quotas allocated
Public Light Bus Driver	68 (involving 68 route packages)	547	59	461
Local Coach Driver	32 (involving 6 service endorsements) (1)	689	23	262
Cross-boundary Coach Driver	18 (involving routes plying 6 road-based boundary control points (BCPs))	365	16	246
Total	**118**	**1 601**	**98**	**969**

Numbers of applications and quotas allocated in the second round by driver job type

Driver job type	Number of applications received	Number of quotas applied for	Number of applications approved	Number of driver quotas allocated
Public Light Bus Driver	82 (involving 82 route packages)	842	82	467
Local Coach Driver	31 (involving 6 service endorsements) (1)	394	27	228
Cross-boundary Coach Driver	16 (involving routes plying 6 road-based BCPs)	237	16	154
Total	**129**	**1 473**	**125**	**849** (2)

Notes:

(1) The six service endorsements include (i) tour service, (ii) hotel service, (iii) student service, (iv) employees' service, (v) residents' service and (vi) contract hire service.
(2) Including 118 approved quotas left unused in the first round and carried forward to the second round.

Annex 2

Details of PnR facilities

Location	Management agent	PnR charge
Tsing Yi Station	MTRCL	The PnR hourly charge ranges from $7 to $24 and the daily charge (excluding the Airport Express and Express Rail Link PnR) ranges from $98 to $120.
Kam Sheung Road Car Park	MTRCL	
Kowloon Station	MTRCL	
Hung Hom Station	MTRCL	
Choi Hung PnR Public Car Park	MTRCL	
Hong Kong Station	MTRCL	
Ocean Park Station	MTRCL	
West Kowloon Station	MTRCL	
Tsuen Wan West Station	MTRCL	
First Phase Public Car Park in Po Shek Wu Estate	Housing Department	
Tuen Mun Station	Private	
Wu Kai Sha Station	Private	
East Point City Car Park	Private	The TD does not have relevant information.
Olympian City 1	Private	
Kai Tin Car Park	LINK	
Long Ping Car Park D	LINK	
Oi Man Car Park	LINK	
Lok Fu UNY Car Park	LINK	
Lok Fu Market Car Park	LINK	
Temple Mall North Car Park	LINK	
Temple Mall South Car Park	LINK	
Wong Tai Sin SC Lower II Car Park	LINK	
Tin Shing Car Park A	LINK	
Yu Chui Car Park	LINK	

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1712)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Currently, there are a total of about 220 and 160 locations with digital red light cameras and speed enforcement camera housings installed respectively. Matters Requiring Special Attention in the coming year include enhancing enforcement actions against red light jumping and speeding offences assisted by the red light camera system and speed enforcement camera system and liaising with relevant government departments on the planning and deployment of the systems. Will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1) whether more red light camera systems and speed enforcement camera systems will be installed this year; if yes, the number of systems to be installed and the cost involved;

2) the annual maintenance cost of the above systems; and

3) given that Multi-functional Smart Lampposts (smart lampposts) collect real-time city data such as air quality and traffic flow, whether smart lampposts are compatible with the functions of the above two systems; if yes, a comparison between the cost of installing compatible smart lampposts and that of installing independent red light camera systems and speed enforcement camera systems?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Hok-fung (LegCo internal reference no.: 19)

Reply:

1) The Government plans to install ten red light camera systems and three speed enforcement camera systems respectively in 2026, with a total expenditure of about $7.2 million.

2) During the one-year warranty period for the newly installed red light camera systems and speed enforcement camera systems, the maintenance expenditures are borne by the contractor, and no maintenance cost is currently incurred by the Government.

3) To ensure the reliability of the results obtained from red light camera systems and speed enforcement camera systems, the installation of the above traffic enforcement cameras must comply with the specific location requirements (such as height, angle and coverage), and should not be affected by interference from other equipment at the same time. Therefore, at present, traffic enforcement cameras are generally required to be installed on posts specially provided for independent operation so as to meet the aforesaid technical and enforcement requirements.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1654)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the road safety of cyclists, please advise this Committee of the following:

1. What were the numbers of traffic accidents involving bicycles, and among them, the respective numbers of cases causing fatalities, serious injuries, and slight injuries, with a breakdown by the location of accidents (including cycle tracks, carriageways, etc.) in the past three years?

2. What were the numbers of traffic accidents involving bicycles that resulted in fatalities or serious injuries, with a breakdown by the type of collision (e.g. bicycles hitting pedestrians, collision between bicycles, collision between bicycles and other vehicles, bicycles hitting objects, etc.) in each of the past three years?

3. What measures has the Government introduced to promote cycling safety and raise the cyclists' safety awareness with a view to reducing dangerous cycling behaviours and what were the expenditures involved in the past three years? What publicity or educational activities are planned for launching and what is the estimated expenditure involved this year?

4. What projects or enhancement measures has the Government undertaken to improve cycle tracks and related facilities to enhance the safety level of cycle tracks and what were the expenditures involved in the past three years? What plans will be conducted to improve the condition or design of cycle tracks and what is the estimated expenditure involved this year?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Kapui, Judy (LegCo internal reference no.: 28)

Reply:

1. According to records, the numbers of traffic accidents involving bicycles by location and severity in the past three years are tabulated as follows:

Year	Location	Numbers of traffic accidents		
		Fatal	Serious	Slight
2023	Cycle track	1	30	852
	Carriageway	5	53	818
	Others^	0	21	200
2024	Cycle track	0	19	739
	Carriageway	8	41	789
	Others^	1	7	275
2025*	Cycle track	1	9	930
	Carriageway	11	22	805
	Others^	0	5	315

Notes: * The numbers of traffic accidents in 2025 is provisional.
^ Others refers to cycle parks, playgrounds and open spaces, etc.

2. According to records, the numbers of bicycles involved in traffic accidents by type of bicycle collision and severity in the past three years are tabulated as follows:

Year	Type of bicycle collision#	Numbers of bicycles involved in traffic accidents^	
		Fatal	Serious
2023	Bicycle collided with pedestrians	0	11
	Collision between bicycles	2	16
	Collision between bicycle and other vehicles	4	30
	Bicycle collided with objects	0	8
	Without bicycle collision	1	48
2024	Bicycle collided with pedestrians	0	7
	Collision between bicycles	0	6
	Collision between bicycle and other vehicles	5	28
	Bicycle collided with objects	2	7
	Without bicycle collision	2	23
2025*	Bicycle collided with pedestrians	2	6
	Collision between bicycles	0	8
	Collision between bicycle and other vehicles	7	10
	Bicycle collided with objects	1	1
	Without bicycle collision	2	18

Notes:

* The numbers of traffic accidents in 2025 is provisional.

\# In a traffic accident involving more than one bicycle, the type of collision of each bicycle may be different. For instance, in a traffic accident, bicycle A collided with bicycle B and bicycle B then collided with a pedestrian. In this case, the type of collision of bicycle A is collision between bicycles while that of bicycle B is bicycle collided with pedestrians. As such, it would be more appropriate to

make analysis on the numbers of bicycles involved in traffic accidents when categorising collisions by type of bicycle collision.

^ As there may be more than one bicycle involved in the same traffic accident involving bicycles (for instance, a collision between two or more bicycles), the numbers of bicycles involved in traffic accidents may be larger than the numbers of traffic accidents involving bicycle.

3. In the past three years, the Transport Department (TD) has been working closely with the Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF) and the Road Safety Council to remind cyclists of the importance of safety and encourage them to use personal protective gear, thereby enhancing public awareness of cycling safety. This has been done through the distribution of promotional materials and leaflets about cycling safety at cycle tracks, cycling hotspots and bicycle accident black spots, the release of publicity video clips about cycling safety on social media, the creation of the Cycling Information Centre webpage, the production of other publicity materials and the organisation of Cycling Safety Carnival. The TD will continue to work with the HKPF to strengthen the cyclists' safety awareness and knowledge of the relevant legislation and regulations through multiple channels this year. The above publicity and education work have been undertaken by the existing staff of the TD and the HKPF as part of their established duties. There is no separate breakdown of resources involved.

4. In the past three years, the Government has completed the improvement works of the cycle tracks at Tung Chung Road, Nam Wan Road in Tai Po and Ming Kum Road in Tuen Mun and the relevant expenditure is about $170,000.

The Highways Department is carrying out improvement works to the cycle tracks in Tseung Kwan O and the estimate for 2026-27 is about $580,000. As for the other improvement works under planning, the Government will continue to review the use of public resources and the effectiveness of works projects, as well as the priority of improvement works, and will adjust the timetable as appropriate and determine the estimated expenditure having regard to the latest situation.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2414)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (6) Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme (the Scheme), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. (i) the total amount of subsidy disbursed, (ii) the average number of beneficiaries per month, and (iii) the percentage of increase or decrease as compared with the preceding year (set out by beneficiaries using Octopus and those using AlipayHK) under the Scheme in the past three years; and

2. whether the Government has conducted any reviews on the effectiveness of the Scheme to ensure that public funds are properly used; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons and whether a review will be conducted in the future.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Kapui, Judy (LegCo internal reference no.: 8)

Reply:

1. Under the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme (the Scheme), the total subsidy amount, the average number of beneficiaries per month, and the percentage of increase or decrease in these figures in the past three years as compared with the preceding year are set out in **Table 1**, while the breakdown by beneficiaries using Octopus and AlipayHK is set out in **Table 2**.

Table 1:

Year [Note 1]	Total subsidy amount ($ million)	Percentage increase/decrease in the total subsidy amount as compared with the preceding year	Average number of beneficiaries per month ('000)	Percentage increase/decrease in the average number of beneficiaries per month as compared with the preceding year
2023	3,909	+37.8%	3 036	+33.5%
2024	2,528	-35.3%	1 988	-34.5%
2025	2,238	-11.5%	1 764	-11.3%

Note 1: To allow more commuters to benefit from the Scheme during the COVID-19 pandemic, the Government implemented temporary special measures to temporarily relax the monthly public transport expenses threshold of the Scheme from $400 to $200 and temporarily increase the monthly subsidy cap from $400 to $500 from May 2022 to October 2023. With the expiry of the temporary special measures, the monthly public transport expenses threshold and the monthly subsidy cap were resumed to $400 from November 2023. From June 2025 onwards, the monthly public transport expenses threshold under the Scheme was raised from $400 to $500.

Table 2:

Year	Total subsidy amount ($ million)		Average number of beneficiaries per month ('000)	
	Octopus	AlipayHK [Note 2]	Octopus	AlipayHK [Note 2]
2023	3,909	N/A	3 036	N/A
2024	2,528	N/A	1 988	N/A
2025	2,214	24	1 738	26

Note 2: In addition to Octopus, public transport fares paid with AlipayHK have been incorporated into the Scheme with effect from 1 January 2025.

2. The Government launched the Scheme in 2019 to relieve the fare burden of the commuters whose public transport expenses are relatively high. The Scheme is simple, easy to understand and operate. Since its launch, the Scheme has been well received by the public and operating smoothly. In order to enable the continued operation of the Scheme in a financially sustainable manner, the Government completed the review of the Scheme in early 2025, and the threshold of monthly public transport expenses incurred for receiving the subsidy was raised from $400 to $500 from June 2025 onwards.

To ensure the sustainability of the Scheme and proper use of public funds, the Government will, on the premise of prudent fiscal management, review the Scheme from time to time and consider whether adjustment is necessary having regard to the prevailing circumstances (such as the public transport expenses level, inflation, the financial situation of the Government, and the overall economic environment, etc.).

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2415)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the issuance and fee of the Lantau Closed Road Permit (LCRP), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the respective numbers of applications received and approved for LCRP in the past three years.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Kapui, Judy (LegCo internal reference no.: 9)

Reply:

1. The number of applications for the Lantau Closed Road Permit (LCRP) received by the Transport Department and the number of LCRPs issued in the past three years are tabulated below.

Calendar year	2023	2024	2025
No. of applications	26 100	26 000	26 400
No. of LCRPs issued (Note)	36 800	37 200	37 300

Note: As more than one LCRP may be involved in one application, the total number of LCRPs issued each year may exceed the total number of applications received.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1883)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 that the Government will continue to administer the implementation of the Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector – Public Light Bus/Coach Trade (the Scheme). In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the respective numbers of applications received, quotas applied for, applications approved and driver quotas allocated in the two rounds of applications by driver job type;

2. the respective numbers of drivers who have taken the local driving test, passed the test and commenced work by driver job type;

3. the current numbers of workers, manpower shortfall and manpower required by driver job type;

4. the details regarding the numbers and nature of complaints against imported drivers and the follow-up action by driver job type; and

5. given that there is a growing demand from citizens and visitors for public transportation, particularly for local coach and cross-boundary coach services, whether consideration will be given to increasing the quotas and launching the third round of application under the Scheme; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Pui-leung (LegCo internal reference no.: 25)

Reply:

1., 3. and 5.

The Government has all along been concerned about the long standing driver shortage problem faced by the public light bus (PLB)/coach trade. Based on the public transport manpower study ever conducted by the Government in 2023, the numbers of workers of

the local PLB/coach trade are set out in the following table:

Driver job type	Manpower required	Current no. of workers	No. of shortfall
PLB Driver	8 270	6 290	1 980
Local Coach Driver	9 000	7 380	1 620
Cross-boundary Coach Driver			
Total	**17 270**	**13 670**	**3 600**

To alleviate the problem of labour shortage in the trade, the Government announced the the Scheme in June 2023, and approved a total of 900 PLB and 800 coach driver quotas through two rounds of applications in September 2023 and July 2024 respectively. All applications were vetted by the inter-departmental liaison group (comprising representatives from the Transport and Logistics Bureau, the Labour Department and the Transport Department (TD)). Details of the two rounds of applications are set out at **Annex**. While implementing the Scheme, TD has all along maintaining liaison with the relevant transport sectors via t the stakeholder consultative group (comprising representatives of both employees and employers) under the Scheme to keep in view the opinions from both employees and employers. Both employees and employers agreed that the trade has long been facing the problems of acute manpower shortage of drivers and ageing drivers. Employer representatives shared the view that labour importation can alleviate the problem of acute driver shortage. Therefore, we believe that the extension of the existing quotas can allow these imported drivers with a pass in the local driving test and accumulated local driving experience, to continue providing services to the public and, in turn, help sustain the stability and quality of public transport services. As for the gradual expiry of the contracts of the first batch of imported workers by the end of 2025, the TD announced the quota renewal arrangements in August 2025. The operators with allocated quotas should submit renewal applications to the TD five months prior to the expiry of the contracts of their imported drivers.

As at end-February 2026, 589 quotas (including 324 PLB and 265 coach driver quotas) have been granted with approval for renewal. The TD will continue to process the renewal applications received, including reviewing whether or not the relevant operators continue to meet the criteria of the Scheme (including maintaining the manning ratio of 1:2 for imported labours to full-time local staff, the wage levels for imported labours at not less than the median monthly wages of the relevant posts, and complying with relevant local driver recruitment requirements). At present, the TD has no plan to adjust the total number of quotas. In future, the TD will continue to pay attention to the changes in the local labour market and the manpower situation, review the implementation of the Scheme and assess the manpower demand of the industry. At the same time, the TD will maintain close liaison with various stakeholders and enhance information dissemination through the stakeholder consultative group as well as review the Scheme in a timely manner with reference to the opinions.

2. As at end-February 2026, the numbers of imported drivers who have taken the local driving test, who have passed the local driving test and who have commenced work are set out in the following table:

No. of imported drivers who have taken the local driving test Note (1)	No. of imported drivers who have passed the local driving test Note (1)	No. of imported drivers who have commenced work
1 812	1 656	1 597 Note (2)

Notes:

(1) The total numbers of drivers who have taken the local driving test and who have passed the local driving test include replacement drivers.

(2) The imported drivers who have passed the local driving test will gradually commence work after completing route training.

4. As at end-February 2026, the TD received a total of 61 complaints concerning imported drivers' service attitude and driving skills (as in the table below). The nature of complaints includes failing to allow passengers to alight at specified locations/stops, or providing passengers with incorrect information on routes/destinations/departure schedules. Among them, 36 cases were substantiated after investigation by the TD.

	Number of complaints against imported drivers	Number of substantiated cases
From the launch of the Scheme to end-February 2025	33	28
From March 2025 to end-February 2026	28	8
Total	**61**	**36**

Like local PLB/coach drivers, the performance of imported drivers is monitored by the operators. The operators are obliged to provide appropriate and proper services according to the requirements of the TD, including monitoring the driving and service performance of all drivers employed. The TD has urged the relevant operators to strengthen drivers' management. At the same time, the TD will inspect the performance of drivers (including local and imported drivers) on site in the regular monitoring to ensure that the driving and service performance of drivers meet the requirements. If any irregularity is found, the TD will follow up with the operators concerned. Overall speaking, imported drivers could provide high-level services based on our observation.

Annex

Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector–
Public Light Bus PLB)/Coach Trade

Numbers of applications and quotas allocated in the first round by driver job type

Driver job type	Number of applications received	Number of quotas applied for	Number of applications approved	Number of driver quotas allocated
Public Light Bus Driver	68 (involving 68 route packages)	547	59	461
Local Coach Driver	32 (involving 6 service endorsements) Note (1)	689	23	262
Cross-boundary Coach Driver	18 (involving routes plying 6 road-based boundary control points (BCPs))	365	16	246
Total	**118**	**1 601**	**98**	**969**

Numbers of applications and quotas allocated in the second round by driver job type

Driver job type	Number of applications received	Number of quotas applied for	Number of applications approved	Number of driver quotas allocated
Public Light Bus Driver	82 (involving 82 route packages)	842	82	467
Local Coach Driver	31 (involving 6 service endorsements) Note (1)	394	27	228
Cross-boundary Coach Driver	16 (involving routes plying 6 road-based BCPs)	237	16	154
Total	**129**	**1 473**	**125**	**849** Note (2)

Notes:

(1) The six service endorsements include (i) tour service, (ii) hotel service, (iii) student service, (iv) employees' service, (v) residents' service and (vi) contract hire service.

(2) Including 118 approved quotas left unused in the first round and carried forward to the second round.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1889)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the work of the Transport Department (TD) in relation to taxis under Programme (1), TD issued five Taxi Fleet Licences in July 2025 and closely monitored the operation of the licensed taxi fleets. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. For each of the five fleets, what are the numbers of taxis (including electric taxis, wheelchair-accessible taxis and premium taxis), patronage, mileage and amount of government funding received to date? Have the five fleets completed the key performance indicators set by the Government? If yes, what are the details? If no, what are the reasons?

2. Currently, passengers have to go through tedious procedures to book their journeys as each taxi fleet has its own mobile application. Octopus Cards Limited announced last year that it would launch "Easy Ride", an aggregation platform, on its mobile application, allowing passengers to book their journeys without downloading the respective mobile application of each taxi fleet. In this connection, has the Government been informed of the progress of the project? What is the estimated date of launching the platform? Is the Government providing any funding for this project? If yes, what are the details?

3. Regarding the poor passenger experience resulting from taxi and driver shortages and difficulty in booking journeys at present, has the Government reviewed the effectiveness of taxi fleets and considered further improvements? If yes, what are the details? If no, what are the reasons? And

4. It is reported that several taxi fleets are exploring collaborations with different online hailing platforms to rescue their business. What is the Government's stance on the above?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Pui-leung (LegCo internal reference no.: 33)

Reply:

1. & 3.

The taxi fleet regime introduced by the Government aims to introduce systematic professional fleet management in order to enhance taxi service quality. Through licensing conditions, the Transport Department (TD) regulates the operation and management of taxi fleets, and specifies the devices to be installed on fleet taxis, as well as the requirements in relation to fleet size, age of vehicles and the services to be provided by fleet licensees, such as the provision of online hailing channels (including mobile hailing applications, websites or telephone hotlines) and electronic payment means, and various in-vehicle safety devices (including dash cameras, driver monitoring system, etc.). Since the TD issued Taxi Fleet Licences to five taxi fleets in July 2025, the number of fleet taxis has been increasing steadily. As at 13 March 2026, over 1 500 fleet taxis and about 2 000 fleet taxi drivers had been engaged in service. The numbers of electric taxis, wheelchair-accessible taxis and premium taxis were about 740, 135 and 690 respectively (with some overlap among these three categories as a taxi may be both an electric taxi and a premium taxi). More than 2.88 million trips were completed.

The passengers' feedback on the taxi fleet services has been positive in general, noting a wider selection of vehicle models (including six-seaters and wheelchair-accessible taxis), newer vehicles, spacious and tidy compartments with enhanced equipment, and courteous drivers. Overall speaking, the taxi fleets have provided quality service, demonstrating a more professional management approach and bringing a positive new outlook to the taxi trade.

The Government has been actively co-ordinating and providing support for the operation of the fleets, including facilitating vehicle examination arrangements for fleet taxis, co-ordinating fleet operators' applications for Dedicated 100% Loan Guarantee Scheme for Battery Electric Taxis, and promoting fleet services to the public and tourists. In addition, to facilitate fleet taxis' picking up passengers with pre-booked service, the TD has set up about 90 designated fleet taxi stopping places across 16 locations, such as the airport, some of the boundary control points, Hong Kong West Kowloon Station of the Express Rail Link, some of the Airport Express stations, the Kai Tak Cruise Terminal, the Hong Kong Convention and Exhibition Centre Phase II, the Exhibition Centre Station Public Transport Interchange, and the M+ Museum. Furthermore, the TD has co-ordinated the co-operation among some fleet operators, power companies and other public transport operators to facilitate charging for electric taxis.

Moreover, the Government provides funding to taxi fleets through the Smart Traffic Fund, with a view to encouraging them to enhance the safety and quality of taxi fleet services by conducting research and applied technology projects. Five fleets have each been granted about $10 million in funding for their respective applications. To ensure effectiveness, the Government, having regard to the research content and characteristics of each project, has set corresponding key performance indicators (such as enhancing the taxi utilisation rate, ensuring the operating rate and reliability of electric taxi operating management system, and improving route efficiency, etc.). The projects are now in progress, and the Secretariat and the Management Committee will examine and assess the relevant deliverables upon completion of the projects.

As for driver recruitment, the TD has been assisting fleet operators in participating in district and thematic job fairs organised by the Labour Department, enabling operators to explain in detail to job seekers the management, training and support provided to drivers, so as to attract existing drivers and new blood to join. Meanwhile, the fleets have put in place different measures to recruit more drivers, including placing advertisements on radio and social media platforms, offering new driver referral bonus and safe driving bonus, as well as flexible working hour arrangements. We understand that the job fairs and the above measures have attracted enquiries from job seekers outside the taxi trade, and have successfully recruited more than 100 newcomers to switch careers and become fleet taxi drivers. Besides, to attract new blood to join the taxi trade, the TD has further enhanced the taxi written test on 3 November 2025 by substantially reducing and simplifying the questions on locations and routes, and adding new questions related to enhancement of taxi service quality, with the aim of maintaining assessment standards while better aligning with the practical needs of the taxi trade. As at 28 February 2026, the average monthly number of candidates increased from about 1 380 prior to the enhancement of the taxi written test to about 1 820 after the enhancement, representing an increase of about 30%, thereby bringing about a positive impact on overall manpower in the trade and the recruitment of fleet taxi drivers.

Furthermore, the TD is actively co-ordinating among the fleets and different stakeholders in the taxi trade (such as associations, trade unions, and taxi companies) to assist them in engaging drivers and taxi owners. The Government will, through the various co-ordination and support measures mentioned above, continue to urge the fleet operators to actively enhance their services and expedite the engagement of drivers and taxi owners, so as to drive the fleets towards their committed scale and provide passengers with quality taxi services.

2. To facilitate the public in booking fleet taxis, the TD has been actively promoting collaboration between the fleets and a third-party platform to provide a centralised online hailing platform, thereby enabling the public to book taxis from the fleets via a single mobile application. The third-party platform has already completed technical alignment with the fleets and is currently conducting internal testing, with a view to launching the application as soon as practicable.

4. The TD has been encouraging the five fleet operators to actively explore more opportunities through various channels, such as by collaborating with online hailing platforms, to facilitate passengers in booking fleet taxi services.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2412)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics, Secretary for Financial Services and the Treasury

Question:

It is mentioned in Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 that the Government will continue to further enhance the operation of the "Northbound Travel for Hong Kong Vehicles" (the Northbound Travel Scheme), and support the implementation of the "Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles" (the Southbound Travel Scheme). In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. What are the number of applications received, the number of applications approved, the cumulative number of closed road permits (CRPs) issued (the approximate number of which remain valid currently) and the cumulative number of travel bookings since the implementation of the Northbound Travel Scheme?

2. What are the number of applications received, the number of applications approved, the number of days planned to stay in Hong Kong, the utilisation rate of the "Park & Fly" carpark at the port, and the number of entries into Hong Kong's urban areas since the implementation of the Southbound Travel Scheme?

3. What are the number of offences and details of nature of cases regarding the Southbound Travel Scheme up to the present, and what are the Government's subsequent enforcement and follow-up actions?

4. The Government recently has stated that the Southbound Travel Scheme will be extended to four additional cities in Guangdong Province after six months. Is there a specific timetable and list of cities in this regard?

5. What is the total traffic flow (two-way) via the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (HZMB) up to the present, and of which the respective figures relating to the Northbound Travel Scheme and the Southbound Travel Scheme?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Pui-leung (LegCo internal reference no.: 30)

Reply:

1. Since the launch of the Northbound Travel Scheme in July 2023, the governments of Guangdong and Hong Kong have been closely monitoring its implementation situation to take timely measures for enhanced convenience for the applicants.

   Regarding applications, starting from October 2025, vehicles approved to participate in the Northbound Travel Scheme are no longer required to apply for a CRP. The Transport Department (TD) will issue an electronic approval letter to successful applicants to confirm their eligibility to participate in the Scheme. As at the end of February 2026, the cumulative number of applications received under the Northbound Travel Scheme by the TD was about 270 000, and the number of CRPs/electronic approval letters issued totalled about 250 000, of which about 100 000 (including renewal applications) are still valid.

   As for travel bookings, from September 2025 onwards, bookings are no longer required for vehicles travelling to Guangdong Province via the HZMB under the Northbound Travel Scheme on Tuesdays and Wednesdays (except specified dates (including Hong Kong or the Mainland public holidays and the day before, toll-free days of the HZMB and other dates specified by the authority from time to time). As at the end of February 2026, the cumulative number of travel bookings was about 1.9 million.

2. Under the arrangement of the Southbound Travel Scheme, eligible Guangdong private vehicles may apply to travel to Hong Kong via the HZMB through an innovative and simple means. After parking in the automated carparks (port carparks) on the artificial island at the HZMB Hong Kong Port, drivers and passengers may transfer to flights via the Hong Kong International Airport using the Park & Fly service, or enter into Hong Kong and travel by local public transport using the Park & Visit service when it becomes available, thereby enhancing Hong Kong's status as an international aviation hub. Alternatively, they may drive into the urban area via the HZMB without the need to obtain regular quotas.

   The port carparks were commissioned in November 2025, and the number of vehicle trips using the car parks under the Park & Fly service had reached about 3 000 as at the end of February 2026.

   The entry into the urban area has been open for application from eligible Guangdong private cars since December 2025. After receiving applications referred from the Mainland authorities, the TD will process them and then issue an electronic International Circulation Permit (ICP) to successful applicants. Guangdong vehicles issued with ICPs may make bookings to enter into Hong Kong via the HZMB for up to three days per visit. As at the end of February 2026, the TD received approximately 4 200 applications and issued over 3 500 ICPs, with the remaining about 700 applications under processing. The cumulative number of travel bookings was about 2 500.

3. The Government is committed to combating traffic offences on Hong Kong roads through publicity and education, in tandem with enforcement efforts, so as to ensure road safety. If Guangdong vehicles are found to contravene Hong Kong traffic regulations, the Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF) will handle the case in accordance

with local laws and procedures. The violation cases are sporadic, and the relevant cases have either been handled or are being followed up.

The governments of Guangdong and Hong Kong will also take appropriate measures, depending on the specific circumstances of the case and in accordance with the administrative measures for port carparks and entry into the urban area. Such measures include considering the suspension or cancellation of the eligibility of the vehicles concerned.

4. The Southbound Travel Scheme, which was initially open to four cities, namely Guangzhou, Zhuhai, Zhongshan and Jiangmen in the first phase, has generally operated smoothly. We are currently accumulating implementation experience and closely monitoring the implementation situation, including the operation at the ports, traffic conditions of the nearby roads, the adaptability of users and the public, and the enhancement of ancillary facilities, etc. We are continuing to review and discuss with the Guangdong authorities to increase the quota in an orderly manner, and plan to gradually extend the Scheme from the current four cities to other cities in Guangdong Province six months after its implementation, so as to take forward the Southbound Travel Scheme in a stable and manageable way. We will announce the relevant arrangements in due course.

5. Since its commissioning in 2018 up to 2025, the annual figure of vehicular throughput on the HZMB is set out in the table below. The TD does not maintain relevant statistics involving the Northbound Travel Scheme and the Southbound Travel Scheme:

Year	Vehicular throughput
2018[Note (1)]	241 099
2019	1 521 114
2020[Note (2)]	301 378
2021[Note (2)]	154 732
2022[Note (2)]	222 878
2023	2 279 087
2024	4 356 925
2025	5 217 784

(Source: The HZMB Authority [Note (3)])

Note:

(1) The HZMB was officially commissioned on 24 October 2018.

(2) The figure was affected by the anti-epidemic measures implemented in the Mainland, Hong Kong and Macao since the end of January 2020.

(3) The HZMB Authority was established pursuant to the laws of the Chinese Mainland as a non-profit-making public-institution legal entity, responsible for the construction, operation, management and maintenance.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2413)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (6) Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The provision for 2026-27 is $718.7 million (34.3%) higher than the revised estimate for 2025-26. This is mainly due to the increased provision for fare subsidy for public transport in 2026-27, taking into consideration the implementation of measures related to the review of the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme (the Scheme). In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the total subsidy amount, administrative costs, average monthly number of beneficiaries and average amount of monthly subsidy per beneficiary under the Scheme in the past five years;

2. whether the Government has identified any abuse of the Scheme in the past five years; if yes, the details and follow-up actions; if no, the reasons; and

3. the provision is $718.7 million higher than the revised estimate, of which the amount earmarked for the implementation of measures related to the review of the Scheme; the details of the relevant review measures.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Pui-leung (LegCo internal reference no.: 32)

Reply:

1. The total subsidy amount, average monthly number of beneficiaries and average amount of monthly subsidy per beneficiary under the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme (the Scheme) in the past five years are set out in **Table 1**, while the recurrent expenditure of the Scheme (excluding the subsidy amount) in the past five years are set out in **Table 2**.

Table 1:

Year [Note]	Total subsidy amount ($ million)	Average monthly number of beneficiaries ('000)	Average amount of monthly subsidy per beneficiary ($)
2021	3,709	2 999	103
2022	2,837	2 274	104
2023	3,909	3 036	107
2024	2,528	1 988	106
2025	2,238	1 764	106

Note: To allow more commuters to benefit from the Scheme during the COVID-19 pandemic, the Government implemented temporary special measures from July 2020 to December 2021 and from May 2022 to October 2023 by temporarily relaxing the monthly public transport expenses threshold of the Scheme from $400 to $200, and temporarily increasing the monthly subsidy cap from $400 to $500 from April to December 2021 and from May 2022 to October 2023. From June 2025 onwards, the monthly public transport expenses threshold under the Scheme was raised from $400 to $500.

Table 2:

Financial year	Recurrent expenditure ($ million)
2020-21	39.0
2021-22	41.8
2022-23	37.4
2023-24	40.1
2024-25	42.0

The Government has been striving to lower the administrative cost of the Scheme as far as possible. The recurrent expenditure of the Scheme (excluding the subsidy amount) in the past five financial years was equivalent to about 1.1% to 1.8% of the annual total subsidy amount.

2. As commuters themselves bear the majority portion of their public transport expenses and there is a cap on the monthly subsidy amount under the Scheme, such design helps deter abuses. Meanwhile, the Transport Department (TD) has adopted a series of monitoring measures to ensure proper use of public funds and minimise risks of abuse. The participating public transport operators are required to establish a set of audit and assurance standards to strengthen their internal control and submit assurance reports prepared by independent auditors in accordance with the standards issued by the Hong Kong Institute of Certified Public Accountants to the Government on a yearly basis. In addition, the monitoring measures taken by the Government also include conducting regular transport surveys to gather operational data and passenger statistics, verifying the operational data submitted by the operators and checking the transaction records in the payment systems, etc. In the five financial years from 2021-22 to 2025-26, the TD conducted an average of about 90 to 170 field inspections and transport surveys per month, during which no cases involving abuse of subsidies were identified.

3. In order to enable the continued operation of the Scheme in a financially sustainable manner, the Government completed the review of the Scheme in early 2025, and the threshold of monthly public transport expenses incurred for receiving the subsidy was raised from $400 to $500 from June 2025 onwards. The TD's work on implementing the refined arrangements is undertaken by its existing staff. There is no separate breakdown of the expenditure and manpower involved.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1934)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

On facilitating wider trial and use of autonomous vehicles (AVs) in Hong Kong, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. details of the staff establishment and expenditure involved in the Autonomous Vehicle Applications Promotion Working Group in the next financial year;

2. details of the staff establishment and expenditure involved, as well as the implementation timetable for formulating a roadmap for autonomous driving with carriage of passengers, implementing commercial operation for autonomous driving, and taking forward cross-district operations;

3. the information of AV trials in Hong Kong, including vehicle types, trial locations, numbers of vehicles, trial progress, cumulative trial mileage and cumulative passenger trips (if applicable) as at the latest date; as well as the conditions and criteria for achieving remote control trial in which AVs with remote backup operators only in lieu of in-vehicle backup operators;

4. whether any expenditure has been earmarked for incorporating the "vehicle-road-cloud integration" framework into the development plan of the Northern Metropolis; and for setting up an autonomous driving pilot zone in the Northern Metropolis; and

5. whether consideration will be given to setting up a dedicated fund for autonomous driving and offer tax concessions to enhance research and development capabilities as well as the drive for innovation, thereby promoting the development of the AV industry.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Siu-hung (LegCo internal reference no.: 1)

Reply:

1 - 2.

The Government has been promoting the development of autonomous vehicles (AVs) in Hong Kong in an active and orderly manner through a multi-pronged approach by

providing policy support, regulatory backing and financial subsidy. The new regulatory regime for AVs came into operation in March 2024. At the same time, to facilitate the trial and pilot use of AVs, the Transport Department (TD) has also promulgated the "Code of Practice for Trial and Pilot Use of AVs" (the Code) outlining detailed technical, safety and operational requirements in trial and use of AVs. To realise the vision of the Policy Address 2025 and the Transport Strategy Blueprint, which is to further promote the development of AVs and accelerate the introduction and promotion of industry-led trials and applications of AVs in different communities, with a view to moving towards unmanned driving, large-scale development and commercial operation, the Commissioner for Transport has already set up the Autonomous Vehicle Applications Promotion Working Group (the Working Group). This inter-departmental working group collaborates with industry stakeholders to advance related initiatives and is specifically tasked with reviewing the progress and needs of individual AV projects. It will provide steer on trial locations and vehicle types, as well as licensing arrangements required to support the commercial development of AVs. The Working Group also studies appropriate regulatory arrangements to allow AVs to provide a certain degree of commercial services on a pilot basis within designated areas, with a view to expediting the smooth transition of autonomous driving technology from the research and testing stage to actual operation and enabling more members of the public to access and experience such services. The first meeting of the Working Group was held on 17 March 2026. In respect of cross-district applications, we will progressively increase pilot sites and gradually expand the scale of cross-district trials in the future, as well as expand the AV application network in an orderly manner through various projects, including regional trials. For example, the North Lantau trial project extended the existing North Lantau airport route to Tung Chung and onwards to Sunny Bay in February 2026. Moreover, the TD is accelerating the commercialisation of AVs, and strives to implement the commercial operation of the Airportcity Link autonomous vehicle project connecting SKYCITY at Hong Kong International Airport with the artificial island of the Hong Kong Port of the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (HZMB) within 2026. The above tasks have been undertaken by the existing staff of TD as part of their established duties. There is no separate breakdown of resources involved.

3. As at the end of February 2026, the TD has issued six pilot licences involving the trial of 62 AVs at six locations. Details are as follows:

	Vehicle Type (Number of vehicles)	Trial location	Trial progress	Cumulative trial mileage (km)
1	Private car (30)	Airport Island	(1) Conducting open road trial (without passenger) (2) Conducting non-commercial operation (with designated staff) - cumulative passenger trips taken by designated staff: 700	About 137 800
		Tung Chung	Conducting open road trial (without passenger)	About 26 600

	Vehicle Type (Number of vehicles)	Trial location	Trial progress	Cumulative trial mileage (km)
2	Private light bus (2)	West Kowloon Cultural District	Conducting open road trial (without passenger)	About 1 400
3	Private car (10)	Cyberport in the Southern District	Conducting open road trial (without passenger)	About 7 600
4	Private car (10)	Kai Tak Development Area in Kowloon East	Conducting open road trial (without passenger)	About 2 500
5	Public light bus (7)	Airportcity Link at the Airport	Conducting initial planning	0
6	Private car (3)	"Park & Fly" Car Park at the Hong Kong Port of the HZMB	Conducting preparation work before the trial	0

To promote the development of unmanned AVs with remote operation of AV trials (replacing in-vehicle backup operator with remote backup operator), the Code specifies that the pilot proprietor should establish a remote control centre, and that AVs operated with in-vehicle backup operators should first complete the specified trial mileage before remote backup operators may monitor and control AV operations in real-time through the remote control centre upon the TD's approval. During AV operation, the pilot proprietor should ensure that remote backup operators can effectively take over AVs under specific operating conditions. The TD will perform its gatekeeping role and approve trial projects on the premise of ensuring road safety.

4. With the gradual popularisation of autonomous driving technology, the current development tends to focus on "single-vehicle intelligence" alone (i.e. without relying on external devices to operate the vehicle). Vehicle-to-Everything (V2X) technology also helps strengthen real-time data exchange between vehicles, enhancing the ability of AVs to handle complex traffic conditions. The TD will actively communicate with relevant departments to study the reservation of adequate space (such as underground conduits) in new development areas, so as to ensure road design can be flexibly adjusted in the future when V2X technology has further developed, and the relevant standards and cost-effectiveness have become mature. The Northern Metropolis presents opportunities for the development of AVs in Hong Kong. With its forward-looking planning, abundant land resources, potential for cross-boundary collaboration, policy support and social needs, it is well-positioned to serve as one of the ideal locations for promoting autonomous driving technology in Hong Kong. The Working Group also actively promotes the introduction of autonomous driving trials and uses in the Northern Metropolis under diversified scenarios.

5. The Government has been supporting local research and application of autonomous driving through the Smart Traffic Fund. As at end-February 2026, the Management Committee on the Smart Traffic Fund had approved five autonomous driving road trial projects, covering multiple road scenarios, with a view to steadily enhancing the capability of AVs to handle Hong Kong's complex road conditions.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1936)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB) will introduce subsidiary legislation in relation to the regulation of ride-hailing services and oversee the implementation of the relevant regulatory regime in 2026-27. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. the details of the staff establishment and the expenditure involved in the regulation of ride-hailing services; and

2. whether consideration will be given to including autonomous vehicles (AVs) in the future application of the ordinance on ride-hailing vehicles so as to reserve legal space for the scaled operation of AVs in Hong Kong; and

3. whether consideration will be given to imposing charges on ride-hailing platform companies through legislation, with additional charges imposed on point-to-point services provided by ride-hailing vehicles, so as to support the taxi trade in enhancing its service quality, thereby benefitting members of the public; if yes, the details; if not, the reasons.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Siu-hung (LegCo internal reference no.: 2)

Reply:

1. The work on the regulation of ride-hailing services is undertaken by existing staff of the Transport Department (TD). There is no separate breakdown of the expenditure involved.

2. To promote development of autonomous vehicles (AVs) in Hong Kong, the Government introduced legislative amendments in 2024 to provide a regulatory regime with appropriate flexibility to cope with technological developments. The new regulatory framework allows AVs to be registered and licensed in the same way as conventional vehicles in accordance with the Road Traffic Ordinance and its subsidiary legislation, aligning with the regulatory framework for conventional vehicles and bringing them

fully under statutory regulation, which covers vehicle classification, registration, licensing, etc. After completing the relevant registration and licensing procedures, applications for licences or permits corresponding to the vehicle type of the AVs may be made to the TD in accordance with their mode of business operation. AVs may commence operation after obtaining the approval. The Government will continue to closely follow the latest technological advancement and industrial development of AVs in order to promote safe and orderly driverless and large-scale development of AVs, and move towards commercial operation.

3. The Road Traffic (Amendment) (Ride-hailing Service) Bill 2025 was passed by the Legislative Council in October 2025. It stipulates the legal framework and key principles for regulating ride-hailing service, including the requirements for platforms, vehicles and drivers providing ride-hailing services to obtain appropriate licences or permits. The Government will charge fees for various licences and permits, including application fees, licence/permit fees and renewal fees. Such fees may be higher than the administrative costs.

Regarding the enhancement of the quality of taxi services, the Government has proactively introducing various measures in the past few years, including the launch of systematically managed taxi fleets, enhancement of the taxi written test, and the requirement for all taxi drivers to provide electronic payment means, so as to improve the image of the taxi trade and passengers' travelling experiences. The Government will continue to listen to the different views of the society and formulate appropriate measures with a view to further enhancing the overall taxi service quality.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1947)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the implementation of automated parking systems (APS), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the timetable for taking forward APS in 2025-26, and the staff establishment and estimated expenditure involved;

2. the numbers of parking spaces and APS parking spaces in public car parks across the territory and the percentage of APS parking spaces in the past three financial years;

3. given that the Transport Department has been implementing public vehicle parking projects with APS in Hong Kong since 2020, please tabulate the details of the implementation of APS, including the locations, APS types, numbers of parking spaces (excluding conventional parking spaces), commencement dates of construction, commissioning dates and expenditures involved;

4. the details of the APS expected to be completed in the next three financial years; whether these new systems will be installed with charging network for electric vehicles (medium or fast charging); if yes, the details; if not, the reasons; and

5. whether there is any maintenance cost involved for the APS commissioned and installed for public use; if yes, the details.

Asked by: Hon CHAN Siu-hung (LegCo internal reference no.: 43)

Reply:

1., 3. and 4.

The Transport Department (TD) has been implementing public vehicle parking projects with APS in Hong Kong since 2020, and has been actively promoting APS in suitable short-term tenancy (STT) car parks and public works projects. Among them, three STT car parks with APS have already been commissioned. The first public works

project with APS is located at the Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park, which was commissioned in December 2025. Information of the relevant projects since 2020 is listed at **Annex**.

There are currently no mature electric vehicle (EV) charging facilities proven to be reliable available in the market that can be installed for multi-storey or multidirectional APS, and internationally there are no specific standards at present for the installation of EV charging facilities in APS. Relevant departments are actively reviewing the latest developments in the application of APS in different regions. When the technologies become more mature, the Government will explore the provision of charging facilities at APS parking spaces. Having said that, power supply capacity has been reserved in relevant public works projects with reference to the standards of the Environment and Ecology Bureau for meeting the future power requirement of installation of medium chargers. The Government will continue to explore with the relevant departments the installation of EV charging facilities in APS as far as practicable where technically and financially viable. Taking the Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park as an example, the relevant departments have, after investigation, installed medium chargers at parking spaces on the bottom level of the puzzle stacking type APS. Currently, among the 225 APS parking spaces in the public car park, 102 are equipped with medium chargers.

The preparatory work for APS projects has been undertaken by TD's existing staff and hence there is no separate breakdown of the manpower and expenditure involved.

2. The numbers of parking spaces in public car parks across the territory [Note 1] in the past three years are set out in the table below:

	December 2023	**December 2024**	**December 2025**
No. of parking spaces in public car parks [Note 2]	207 000	207 000	217 000

Note 1: Figures are rounded to the nearest thousand.
Note 2: Public car parks include both car parks managed by the Government and provided in private development projects which are open for public use, as well as STT car parks.

For the APS, TD does not have information on the numbers of APS in privately-operated car parks. For public works projects with APS being taken forward by the Government, the percentage of APS parking spaces in all private car parking spaces is over 50% on average.

5. APS in STT car parks are constructed, operated and funded by the operators. Currently, as the aforementioned Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park, which is the first Government public car park equipped with APS, is still at an early stage of operation, the actual maintenance cost has yet to be determined, while other public car parks equipped with APS are under construction.

Annex

Project	APS Type	Commencement of Construction	Expected Commissioning Date	Total Number of Parking Spaces (Number of APS parking spaces)	Estimated Expenditure
A. APSs in STT car parks					
STT Car Park at Hoi Shing Road, Tsuen Wan	Puzzle stacking	December 2020	November 2021 (Commissioned)	245 (78)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Pak Shek Kok, Tai Po	Puzzle stacking	December 2021	December 2022 (Commissioned)	250 (52)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at junction of Yen Chow Street and Tung Chau Street, Sham Shui Po	Puzzle stacking	February 2023	April 2024 (Commissioned)	210 (52)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Hoi Wang Road, Yau Ma Tei	Puzzle stacking	July 2023	2026 (Tentative)	About 200 (117)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Lok Wah Street, Tsz Wan Shan	Puzzle stacking	October 2025	2027 (Tentative)	About 180 (About 40)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Po Tai Street, Ma On Shan	To be confirmed	October 2025	2027 (Tentative)	About 270 (About 100)	Funded by the STT car park operator

B. APSs in public works projects					
Project	**APS Type**	**Commencement of Construction**	**Expected Commissioning Date**	**Total Number of Parking Spaces (Number of APS parking spaces)**	**Estimated Expenditure for the Entire Public Works Programme Item** **Note 1**
Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park (i.e. Joint-user Government Office Building in Area 67, Tseung Kwan O)	Puzzle stacking	September 2020	December 2025 (Commissioned)	388 (225)	$5,228.4 M Note 2
District Open Space, Sports Centre and Public Vehicle Park at Sze Mei Street	Vertical lifting and horizontal sliding	May 2022	2027 (Tentative)	About 320 (About 160)	$1,605.0 M Note 3
Open Space with Public Vehicle Park at Yen Chow Street West, Sham Shui Po	Circular shaft lifting	August 2023	2028 (Tentative)	About 200 (About 170)	$777.9 M Note 4
Amenity Complex in Area 103, Ma On Shan	Puzzle stacking	November 2024	2029 (Tentative)	About 350 (About 180)	$2,888.4 M Note 5
Town Park with Public Vehicle Park in Area 66, Tseung Kwan O	Puzzle stacking	May 2025	2029 (Tentative)	About 450 (About 300)	$1,208.0 M Note 6

Note 1: The estimated expenditure is calculated in money-of-the-day prices and is the approved project estimate for the entire Public Works Programme Item approved by the Finance Committee.

Note 2: Including the construction costs for government offices and facilities, general out-patient clinic, job centre, families clinic and dental clinic, child care centre and public car park.

Note 3: Including the construction costs for open space, sports centre and public car park.

Note 4: Including the construction costs for open space and public car park.

Note 5: Including the construction costs for sports centre, indoor heated swimming pools, Hong Kong Public Libraries New Book Centre, community hall, Sha Tin District Office's Ma On Shan Sub-office and public car park.

Note 6: Including the construction costs for town park and public car park.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2417)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the management of government tunnels, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the operating expenditures, design capacities and peak-hour utilisation rates of various government road tunnels in the past three financial years;

2. the average daily traffic flows and the average traffic flows during peak time slots of the three road harbour crossings (RHCs) and their respective percentages in the total traffic flows by vehicle type in the past three years in table form;

3. the changes in traffic flows of the three RHCs during peak time slots on weekdays after the implementation of time-varying tolls; and whether the new tolls have induced additional traffic; and

4. whether provision has been earmarked for the construction of a fourth RHC; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Siu-hung (LegCo internal reference no.: 13)

Reply:

1. The expenditures of various government road tunnels in the past three financial years are tabulated at **Annex 1**.

   The design capacities and peak-hour utilisation rates (measured by ratios of traffic volume/design capacity) of various government road tunnels from 2022 to 2025 are presented by calendar year and tabulated at **Annex 2**.

2. The average traffic flows of the three road harbour crossings (RHCs) on weekdays and during peak time slots, with a breakdown by vehicle type and respective percentages, in the past three years (i.e. 2023 to 2025) are set out at **Annex 3**.

3. According to the traffic data of 2025, the overall cross-harbour traffic volume on weekdays increased by about 1% to about 274 000 vehicles as compared with the period before the implementation of time-varying tolls (i.e. December 2023). The daily traffic flows of the three RHCs were as follows: the traffic flow of the Western Harbour Crossing (WHC) increased by about 24% to 109 000 vehicles; the traffic flow of the Cross-Harbour Tunnel (CHT) decreased by 11% to about 94 000 vehicles; the traffic flow of the Eastern Harbour Crossing (EHC) decreased by about 10% to 71 000 vehicles. After the implementation of the new tolls, the cross-harbour traffic flows on weekdays have remained relatively stable and no significant additional traffic has been induced. At the same time, the traffic has been more evenly distributed among the three RHCs, thereby making better use of each tunnel's capacity.

   Moreover, the overall cross-harbour congestion has been alleviated. The traffic queues at the CHT and EHC during peak hours have generally reduced by about 1 km and 0.3 km respectively. During normal and off-peak time slots, which account for nearly 80% of the day, the traffic at the three RHCs (including CHT which used to be frequently congested in the past) has been significantly smoother than before. The non-cross-harbour traffic near the tunnel portals has also improved significantly, thus reducing the impact on traffic near the Gascoigne Road and Kwun Tong Bypass. These diversion effects have a positive impact on the overall commuting experience of the public, as well as on transport and logistics and the operation of public transport services.

   To further alleviate traffic conditions at WHC, the Government has constructed an additional lane at the Hong Kong Island exit of WHC towards Central and Sheung Wan. This lane was opened on 30 November 2025. Since then, observations show a noticeable reduction in vehicle weaving at the tunnel exit, and the traffic flow is significantly smoother than before, allowing more vehicles to pass through the tunnel. These works have removed the bottleneck at the Hong Kong Island exit of WHC, freeing up tunnel capacity that had previously not been fully utilised.

4. The Government has been monitoring cross-harbour traffic. Given that there is currently no concrete timetable for implementing the Kau Yi Chau Artificial Islands reclamation project, we will consider different proposals based on their transport demand, technical feasibility, transport effectiveness and cost-effectiveness, with a view to increasing the capacity of the RHCs connecting Hong Kong Island. We will prioritise these proposals according to urgency, and implement the relevant projects in a timely and orderly manner. The above tasks are currently undertaken by the staff of the Transport Department and the Highways Department using their internal resources.

Annex 1

Operating Expenditures of Government Road Tunnels from 2022-23 to 2024-25

Tolled tunnel/ Control area [1] [4]	2022-23 ($ million)	2023-24 ($ million)	2024-25 ($ million)
CHT	158	199	196
EHC	179	228	240
WHC [2]	N/A	241	328
Tate's Cairn Tunnel	143	167	175
Aberdeen Tunnel	97	125	134
Lion Rock Tunnel	91	136	121
Shing Mun Tunnels	125	152	135
Route 8	342	391	372
Tai Lam Tunnel [3]	N/A	N/A	N/A

Note 1: The expenditures set out in the table include the management fees paid to the management, operation and maintenance contractors, the relevant operating and maintenance expenditure for the implementation of HKeToll, depreciation charge of capital costs and expenditure on government maintenance works of the tunnels for the years concerned.

Note 2: WHC was returned to government management on 2 August 2023. The figure for 2023-24 is for the period from 2 August 2023 to 31 March 2024.

Note 3: Tai Lam Tunnel was returned to government management on 31 May 2025.

Note 4: The Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section) commenced operation on 21 December 2025. An all-day fixed toll of $8 for all vehicle types will be charged upon the full commissioning of the Central Kowloon Bypass this year.

Toll-free tunnel [5]	2022-23 ($ million)	2023-24 ($ million)	2024-25 ($ million)
Tuen Mun − Chek Lap Kok Tunnel	73	79	81
Tseung Kwan O Tunnel [6]	35	31	44
Tseung Kwan O − Lam Tin Tunnel [6]	19	62	62
Central − Wan Chai Bypass Tunnel	148	148	152
Lung Shan Tunnel	61	57	57
Cheung Shan Tunnel	19	25	26
Airport Tunnel	26	26	26
Scenic Hill Tunnel	55	55	58
Kai Tak Tunnel	54	54	49

Note 5: Government toll-free tunnels are not included in the Operating Accounts of Government Toll-Tunnels. The expenditures set out in the table represent the management fees paid to the management, operation and maintenance contractors for the years concerned, excluding the depreciation charges of capital costs and the

expenditure on government maintenance works of the tunnels for the years concerned.

Note 6: Tseung Kwan O − Lam Tin Tunnel commenced operation on 11 December 2022, and the toll of Tseung Kwan O Tunnel was waived on the same day. The figure of Tseung Kwan O − Lam Tin Tunnel for 2022-23 is for the period from 11 December 2022 to 31 March 2023.

Annex 2

Design Capacities and Peak-hour [1] Utilisation Rates [2] of Government Road Tunnels

Tunnel [4]	Design capacity (vehicle/ hour)	Peak-hour utilisation rate			
		2022	2023	2024	2025
Aberdeen Tunnel	2 600	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8
CHT	2 600	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1
EHC	2 600	1.1	1.0	1.1	1.1
WHC	4 200	0.8	0.9	1.0	1.0
Lion Rock Tunnel	2 600	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1
Tate's Cairn Tunnel	2 600	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.0
Eagle's Nest Tunnel and Sha Tin Heights Tunnel	4 700	0.7	0.7	0.8	0.8
Shing Mun Tunnels	2 600	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8
Tai Lam Tunnel [3]	4 200	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.9
Central Kowloon Bypass	4 200	N/A			0.5 [4]

Notes:

1. The figures listed in the table represent the annual average traffic flow of the above tunnels from Mondays to Fridays (except public holidays) between 2022 and 2025 according to the toll collection system. Except for the three RHCs, "peak hour" refers to the busiest one hour from 7 a.m. to 10 a.m. and from 5 p.m. to 8 p.m. in the busiest direction. To more accurately reflect the cross-harbour traffic flow, "peak-hour" of the three RHCs refers to the busiest one hour from 7:30 a.m. to 10:30 a.m. and from 4:30 p.m. to 7:30 p.m.

2. The utilisation rates have not taken into account those vehicles queueing to enter the tunnels and do not reflect the actual traffic demand against the design capacity. The actual traffic capacity of the tunnels may be affected by other traffic factors, including the proportions of different types of vehicles using the road section concerned, the geometry of the road section, etc. Therefore, a mere comparison between the actual traffic volume and the design capacity may not truly reflect the actual traffic condition.

3. With reference to the actual vehicle mix after the Government's takeover of Tai Lam Tunnel and the toll reduction in 2025, the tunnel's design capacity is adjusted to 4 200 vehicles per hour, and the utilisation rate in 2025 is also calculated based on the traffic flow after the takeover of Tai Lam Tunnel.

4. The Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section) commenced operation on 21 December 2025. An all-day fixed toll of $8 for all vehicle types will be charged upon its full commissioning as the tenth tolled tunnel this year. Therefore, its peak-hour utilisation rate in 2025 is calculated based on the data from Mondays to Fridays (except public holidays) between 21 and 31 December 2025, and the traffic flow has yet to stabilise.

Annex 3

Average Daily Traffic Flows on Weekdays by Vehicle Type and Respective Percentages at the Three RHCs (in Two-way Vehicles) [1&2]

Year	WHC					
	Private car	**Motorcycle [3]**	**Taxi**	**Bus [4]**	**Light bus [5]**	**Goods vehicle**
2023	36 200 [50%]	1 400 [2%]	19 100 [27%]	4 200 [6%]	400 [1%]	10 700 [15%]
2024	51 300 [50%]	2 100 [2%]	22 700 [22%]	5 700 [6%]	500 [1%]	20 200 [20%]
2025	57 500 [53%]	2 200 [2%]	21 600 [20%]	6 000 [6%]	400 [0.4%]	20 800 [19%]

Notes:

1. Cross-harbour traffic flows on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays), before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays.
2. Figures in brackets denote the percentage share of the respective vehicle type in the total traffic flow.
3. "Motorcycle" includes motor tricycles.
4. "Bus" includes public and private buses.
5. "Light bus" includes public and private light buses.
6. The percentages may not add up to 100% due to rounding.

Annex 3

Average Daily Traffic Flows on Weekdays by Vehicle Type and Respective Percentages at the Three RHCs (in Two-way Vehicles) [1&2]

Year	CHT					
	Private car	**Motorcycle [3]**	**Taxi**	**Bus [4]**	**Light bus [5]**	**Goods vehicle**
2023	48 800 [48%]	4 500 [4%]	16 700 [16%]	6 400 [6%]	800 [1%]	24 600 [24%]
2024	53 600 [57%]	3 900 [4%]	17 200 [18%]	5 400 [6%]	600 [1%]	14 100 [15%]
2025	55 800 [60%]	3 600 [4%]	16 300 [17%]	5 200 [6%]	500 [1%]	12 300 [13%]

Notes:

1. Cross-harbour traffic flows on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays), before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays.
2. Figures in brackets denote the percentage share of the respective vehicle type in the total traffic flow.
3. "Motorcycle" includes motor tricycles.
4. "Bus" includes public and private buses.
5. "Light bus" includes public and private light buses.
6. The percentages may not add up to 100% due to rounding.

Annex 3

Average Daily Traffic Flows on Weekdays by Vehicle Type and Respective Percentages at the Three RHCs (in Two-way Vehicles) [1&2]

Year	EHC					
	Private car	**Motorcycle [3]**	**Taxi**	**Bus [4]**	**Light bus [5]**	**Goods vehicle**
2023	42 000 [57%]	2 600 [4%]	14 200 [19%]	2 800 [4%]	600 [1%]	11 200 [15%]
2024	40 800 [57%]	2 700 [4%]	12 800 [18%]	3 100 [4%]	600 [1%]	12 000 [17%]
2025	41 400 [58%]	2 700 [4%]	11 900 [17%]	3 200 [4%]	600 [1%]	11 600 [16%]

Notes:
1. Cross-harbour traffic flows on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays), before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays.
2. Figures in brackets denote the percentage share of the respective vehicle type in the total traffic flow.
3. "Motorcycle" includes motor tricycles.
4. "Bus" includes public and private buses.
5. "Light bus" includes public and private light buses.
6. The percentages may not add up to 100% due to rounding.

Annex 3

Average Traffic Flows during Peak Time Slots by Vehicle Type and Respective Percentages at the Three RHCs (in Two-way Vehicles)[1&2]

Year	WHC					
	Private car	**Motorcycle [3]**	**Taxi**	**Bus [4]**	**Light bus [5]**	**Goods vehicle**
2023 [6]	16 400 [55%]	700 [2%]	6 400 [22%]	2 100 [7%]	200 [1%]	3 900 [13%]
2024	19 600 [50%]	900 [2%]	8 000 [20%]	2 800 [7%]	200 [0.5%]	8 000 [20%]
2025	21 200 [52%]	900 [2%]	7 600 [19%]	2 900 [7%]	200 [0.4%]	8 000 [20%]

Notes:

1. Unless otherwise specified, cross-harbour traffic flows during peak time slots refer to the traffic flows from 7:30 a.m. to 10:30 a.m. and from 4:30 p.m. to 7:30 p.m. on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays), before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays.
2. Figures in brackets denote the percentage share of the respective vehicle type in the total traffic flow.
3. "Motorcycle" includes motor tricycles.
4. "Bus" includes public and private buses.
5. "Light bus" includes public and private light buses.
6. As HKeToll has not yet been fully implemented, only the hourly data of traffic flows can be provided. Therefore, the cross-harbour traffic flows during peak time slots refer to the traffic flows from 7 a.m. to 10 a.m. and from 5 p.m. to 8 p.m. on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays), before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays.
7. The percentages may not add up to 100% due to rounding.
8. The traffic flows have not taken into account those vehicles queueing to enter the tunnel during peak time slots (if any).

Annex 3

Average Traffic Flows during Peak Time Slots by Vehicle Type and Respective Percentages at the Three RHCs (in Two-way Vehicles)[1&2]

Year	CHT					
	Private car	**Motorcycle [3]**	**Taxi**	**Bus [4]**	**Light bus [5]**	**Goods vehicle**
2023 [6]	17 300 [55%]	1 900 [6%]	2 400 [8%]	2 500 [8%]	200 [1%]	6 900 [22%]
2024	19 600 [63%]	1 600 [5%]	3 500 [11%]	2 000 [6%]	100 [0.4%]	4 400 [14%]
2025	20 000 [65%]	1 500 [5%]	3 500 [11%]	1 900 [6%]	100 [0.4%]	3 800 [12%]

Notes:

1. Unless otherwise specified, cross-harbour traffic flows during peak time slots refer to the traffic flows from 7:30 a.m. to 10:30 a.m. and from 4:30 p.m. to 7:30 p.m. on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays), before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays.
2. Figures in brackets denote the percentage share of the respective vehicle type in the total traffic flow.
3. "Motorcycle" includes motor tricycles.
4. "Bus" includes public and private buses.
5. "Light bus" includes public and private light buses.
6. As HKeToll has not yet been fully implemented, only the hourly data of traffic flows can be provided. Therefore, the cross-harbour traffic flows during peak time slots refer to the traffic flows from 7 a.m. to 10 a.m. and from 5 p.m. to 8 p.m. on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays), before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays.
7. The percentages may not add up to 100% due to rounding.
8. The traffic flows have not taken into account those vehicles queueing to enter the tunnel during peak time slots (if any).

Annex 3

Average Traffic Flows during Peak Time Slots by Vehicle Type and Respective Percentages at the Three RHCs (in Two-way Vehicles)[1&2]

Year	EHC					
	Private car	**Motorcycle [3]**	**Taxi**	**Bus [4]**	**Light bus [5]**	**Goods vehicle**
2023 [6]	18 200 [64%]	1 300 [4%]	4 000 [14%]	1 300 [4%]	200 [1%]	3 500 [12%]
2024	17 300 [60%]	1 300 [4%]	4 200 [15%]	1 400 [5%]	200 [1%]	4 500 [16%]
2025	17 400 [61%]	1 200 [4%]	4 000 [14%]	1 400 [5%]	200 [1%]	4 300 [15%]

Notes:

1. Unless otherwise specified, cross-harbour traffic flows during peak time slots refer to the traffic flows from 7:30 a.m. to 10:30 a.m. and from 4:30 p.m. to 7:30 p.m. on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays), before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays.
2. Figures in brackets denote the percentage share of the respective vehicle type in the total traffic flow.
3. "Motorcycle" includes motor tricycles.
4. "Bus" includes public and private buses.
5. "Light bus" includes public and private light buses.
6. As HKeToll has not yet been fully implemented, only the hourly data of traffic flows can be provided. Therefore, the cross-harbour traffic flows during peak time slots refer to the traffic flows from 7 a.m. to 10 a.m. and from 5 p.m. to 8 p.m. on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays), before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays.
7. The percentages may not add up to 100% due to rounding.
8. The traffic flows have not taken into account those vehicles queueing to enter the tunnel during peak time slots (if any).

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2418)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

On monitoring existing railway services, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. the manpower establishments and expenditures by rank for monitoring railway services and enforcing railway safety in the past three years;

2. the maximum carrying capacity, average patronage, and carrying capacities and loading at four and six persons (standing) per square metre (ppsm) during peak hours in the morning and evening of various railway lines in each of the past three years;

3. the numbers of trains, numbers of cars and average frequency of train service during peak and non-peak hours of various railway lines in the past three years;

4. the numbers of service disruption incidents of various railway lines in the past three years, by cause, duration of disruption, penalty amount and numbers of passengers affected of each incident in table form; and

5. the timetables for upgrading the signalling systems of various railway lines, the expected service commencement dates, expected train frequencies and carrying capacity that can be increased in table form?

Asked by: Hon CHAN Siu-hung (LegCo internal reference no.: 14)

Reply:

1. The Railways Branch (RB) of the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department (EMSD), in accordance with the ordinances on railway safety, is responsible for regulating and monitoring the safe operation of railway systems, including those operated by the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL), the Automated People Mover at the Hong Kong International Airport operated by the Airport Authority Hong Kong, the tramway system operated by the Hong Kong Tramways Limited and the peak tramway

system operated by the Peak Tramways Company Limited. The establishments of RB of EMSD over the past three years are set out below:

Rank	2023	2024	2025
Assistant Director	1	1	1
Chief Engineer	4*	4*	4*
Senior Engineer	15	15	15
Engineer	28	28	28
Inspector	4	4	4

* Two of the posts are time-limited directorate posts, which were created in July 2021 and approved for extention in 2025 for a period of five years until 2030.

The total expenditures of RB of EMSD in the past three years are set out in the following table:

	2023-24	**2024-25**	**2025-26 (Estimated)**
Expenditure ($ million)	87.1	91.8#	87.7^

The increase in the total expenditure for 2024-25 as compared with 2023-24 was mainly due to the increase in salary expenses for the civil service pay adjustment and staff pre-retirement leave in 2024-25.

^ The total expenditure for 2025-26 is expected to decrease mainly due to the decrease in salary expenses for staff pre-retirement leave.

The Bus and Railway Branch (BRB) of the Transport Department (TD) is responsible for regulating and monitoring the services of MTR, franchised bus, tram and non-franchised bus. Other sections of the TD also assist in railway-related matters, including incident co-ordination and planning of transport facilities related to new railways. The establishments of BRB of the TD for regulating and monitoring MTR services over the past three years are set out below:

Rank	**2023**	**2024**	**2025**
Assistant Commissioner	1	1	1
Principal Transport Officer	1	1	1
Chief Transport Officer	1	1	1
Senior Transport Officer	3	3	3
Transport Officer	3	3	3

Note:
Apart from regulating and monitoring MTR services, some of the staff in the above establishment is also responsible for other BRB issues, such as regulating franchised and non-franchised bus services, as well as tram services.

Regulating and monitoring railway services is part of the regular duties of the above staff of TD, and other TD divisions also assist in handling railway-related issues. There is no separate breakdown of the estimated expenditure involved.

2. According to the information provided by the MTRCL, in general, the highest passenger loading of a railway line occurs during the morning peak hours as the passengers travel in the same period of time. As for the evening peak hours, the travelling pattern of passengers is relatively more dispersed, hence the peak loading is usually lower in the evening peak period than that in the morning peak period. As such, when evaluating the most crowded scenario and the service demand for individual railway lines, the MTRCL will mainly base on the passenger loading during the morning peak hours.

   The carrying capacities, average patronage and loading during the busiest one hour in the morning per direction at critical links, and the critical links of various heavy rail lines and light rail routes in the past three years are set out at **Annexes 1 and 2** respectively.

3. For the past three years, the numbers of trains and train coaches for heavy rail and light rail are set out at **Annex 3,** while the frequencies of train services during peak and non-peak periods of heavy rail and light rail are set out at **Annex 4**.

4. The numbers of incidents which caused service disruption due to factors under the MTRCL's control, the causes and the amounts set aside under the enhanced Service Performance Rebate for the incidents in the past three years are set out at **Annex 5**.

5. The MTRCL is now replacing the signalling system of Tsuen Wan Line, Island Line, Kwun Tong Line and Tseung Kwan O Line to enhance operational and maintenance efficiency in the long run. The overall project is expected to be completed in 2029. The new signalling system for Tsuen Wan Line was commissioned on 15 March 2026. The remaining three railway lines will draw on the experience gained from the signalling system upgrading work for the Tsuen Wan Line and will be commissioned progressively as tabulated below:

Railway line	**Expected service commencement date of the new signalling system**
Tsuen Wan Line	Commissioned on 15 March 2026
Island Line	2027
Kwun Tong Line	2028
Tseung Kwan O Line	2029

Annex 1

Statistics for the Heavy Rail System
(the busiest one hour in the morning per direction for critical links)

		East Rail Line	Tuen Ma Line	Tseung Kwan O Line	Island Line	South Island Line	Kwun Tong Line	Tsuen Wan Line	Disneyland Resort Line	Tracks sharing at some sections	
										Tung Chung Line (Note 1)	Airport Express (Notes 1 and 2)
2023											
1.	Maximum carrying capacity when train frequency is maximised (6 persons (standing) per square metre (ppsm)) (a) (Note 3)	82 500	70 000	67 600	80 000	27 000	71 400	75 000	9 600	45 000	4 800
2.	Carrying capacity (6 ppsm) (b)	62 500	58 800	67 600	80 000	16 800	71 400	75 000	8 300	42 500	4 200
3.	Difference between (a) and (b) (Note 4)	20 000	11 200	0	0	10 200	0	0	1 300	2 500	600
4.	Patronage (c)	42 400	35 700	40 400	46 300	9 800	34 500	38 800	3 200	21 200	1 700
5.	Loading (6 ppsm) [(c)/(b)] { } critical link	68% {Tai Wai to Kowloon Tong}	61% {Tsuen Wan West to Mei Foo}	60% {Yau Tong to Quarry Bay}	58% {Tin Hau to Causeway Bay}	58% {Admiralty to Ocean Park}	48% {Choi Hung to Kowloon Bay}	52% {Sham Shui Po to Prince Edward}	39% {Sunny Bay to Disneyland Resort}	50% {Olympic to Kowloon}	40% {Tsing Yi to Airport}
6.	Loading (4 ppsm) (Note 5)	94%	85%	84%	81%	82%	68%	73%	54%	70%	N/A

		East Rail Line	Tuen Ma Line	Tseung Kwan O Line	Island Line	South Island Line	Kwun Tong Line	Tsuen Wan Line	Disneyland Resort Line	Tracks sharing at some sections	
										Tung Chung Line (Note 1)	Airport Express (Notes 1 and 2)
7.	Monthly average patronage (million)	23.7	23.9	9.8	25.7	2.2	18.2	27.7	0.5	6.5	0.9
8.	Total patronage (million)	283.6	280.3	114.8	311.0	25.8	215.1	344.6	5.8	77.1	10.8
2024											
1.	Maximum carrying capacity when train frequency is maximised (6 ppsm) (a) (Note 3)	82 500	70 000	67 600	80 000	27 000	71 400	75 000	9 600	45 000	4 800
2.	Carrying capacity (6 ppsm) (b)	62 500	58 800	67 600	80 000	16 800	71 400	75 000	8 600	42 500	4 200
3.	Difference between (a) and (b) (Note 4)	20 000	11 200	0	0	10 200	0	0	1 000	2 500	600
4.	Patronage (c)	42 800	36 200	38 400	44 100	9 900	34 200	38 400	2 800	20 900	2 000
5.	Loading (6 ppsm) [(c)/(b)] { } critical link	68% {Tai Wai to Kowloon Tong}	62% {Tsuen Wan West to Mei Foo}	57% {Yau Tong to Quarry Bay}	55% {Tin Hau to Causeway Bay}	59% {Admiralty to Ocean Park}	48% {Choi Hung to Kowloon Bay}	51% {Sham Shui Po to Prince Edward}	33% {Sunny Bay to Disneyland Resort}	49% {Olympic to Kowloon}	48% {Tsing Yi to Airport}
6.	Loading (4 ppsm) (Note 5)	94%	86%	80%	77%	83%	67%	72%	46%	69%	N/A
7.	Monthly average patronage (million)	25.9	24.7	9.8	25.9	2.4	18.2	27.7	0.5	6.5	1.1

		East Rail Line	Tuen Ma Line	Tseung Kwan O Line	Island Line	South Island Line	Kwun Tong Line	Tsuen Wan Line	Disneyland Resort Line	Tracks sharing at some sections	
										Tung Chung Line (Note 1)	Airport Express (Notes 1 and 2)
8.	Total patronage (million)	310.3	296.9	118.0	311.4	29.0	218.1	332.1	6.4	77.8	13.1
2025											
1.	Maximum carrying capacity when train frequency is maximised (6 ppsm) (a) (Note 3)	82 500	70 000	67 600	80 000	27 000	71 400	75 000	9 600	45 000	4 800
2.	Carrying capacity (6 ppsm) (b)	62 500	58 800	67 600	80 000	16 800	71 400	70 100	8 600	42 500	4 200
3.	Difference between (a) and (b) (Note 4)	20 000	11 200	0	0	10 200	0	4 900	1 000	2 500	600
4.	Patronage (c)	44 400	38 400	38 700	43 900	10 100	33 800	38 400	3 000	22 200	1 900
5.	Loading (6 ppsm) [(c)/(b)] { } critical link	71% {Tai Wai to Kowloon Tong}	65% {Tsuen Wan West to Mei Foo}	57% {Yau Tong to Quarry Bay}	55% {Tin Hau to Causeway Bay}	60% {Admiralty to Ocean Park}	47% {Choi Hung to Kowloon Bay}	55% {Sham Shui Po to Prince Edward}	35% {Sunny Bay to Disneyland Resort}	52% {Olympic to Kowloon}	45% {Tsing Yi to Airport}
6.	Loading (4 ppsm) (Note 5)	98%	92%	80%	77%	84%	66%	77%	49%	73%	N/A
7.	Monthly average patronage (million)	26.3	25.4	9.8	25.8	2.5	17.9	27.2	0.5	6.4	1.1
8.	Total patronage (million)	315.7	304.2	117.7	309.9	29.6	214.6	326.4	6.2	76.8	13.3

Note 1: As Airport Express and Tung Chung Line share tracks at some sections, the overall capacity of the railway lines are affected by the train service pattern.

Note 2: The design of Airport Express is based on seat provision where the passenger density level in terms of the number of standees does not apply. The figures are calculated based on existing carrying capacity.

Note 3: All train compartments of the existing MTR lines are designed based on the industry standard design adopted at the time of the construction of railway lines, which can accommodate a passenger density of six ppsm. In actual operation, as passengers are less willing to board a train that looks crowded even when there is still room available, trains only achieve a passenger density of only around four ppsm. Therefore, the TD provides the carrying capacity of six ppsm to reflect the maximum level of train capacity, as well as the loading of four ppsm to reflect the situation in actual operation.

Note 4: This is because the service frequency has not yet been increased to the maximum level the signalling system permits.

Note 5: For a typical heavy rail train operating in the urban area, there are 340 seats and 2 160 standees under a passenger density level of six ppsm, adding up to a total carrying capacity of about 2 500 per train. Under a passenger density level of four ppsm, the 340 number of seats will remain unchanged while the number of standees will be reduced to 1 440, adding up to a total carrying capacity of about 1 780 per train. Hence, the carrying capacity under a passenger density level of four ppsm is 71.2% of that of six ppsm. For the East Rail Line, the proportion of seats and standees is slightly different from that of other heavy rail trains as it has a First Class compartment. The capacity of trains is 2 845 and 2 061 respectively for six and four ppsm.

Annex 2

Statistics for the Light Rail System
(the busiest one hour in the morning per direction for critical links)

Light Rail route	Maximum carrying capacity			Passenger loading (Note 1)		
	2023	**2024**	**2025**	**2023**	**2024**	**2025**
505	2 993	2 993	2 993	66%	79%	82%
506P (Note 2)	424	424	424	70%	45%	70%
507	2 827	2 827	2 625	83%	85%	86%
507P	212	212	212	90%	90%	50%
610	2 056	2 056	2 056	93%	93%	84%
614	1 122	1 122	1 156	77% (Note 3)	77%	90%
614P	1 363	1 363	1 368			
615	960	960	960	74% (Note 3)	87%	75%
615P	1 600	1 600	1 600			
705	4 240	4 240	4 240	63%	82%	72%
706	5 088	5 088	5 088	63%	80%	82%
720 (Note 2)	N/A	212	212	N/A	20%	10%
751	2 993	2 993	2 857	64%	81%	85%
751P	398	398	424	60%	80%	95%
761P	4 240	4 240	4 240	64%	86%	76%

Patronage (million)

	2023	**2024**	**2025**
Monthly average patronage	12.5	12.9	12.9
Total patronage	150.0	154.6	154.4

Note 1: Light Rail is an open system where there are a number of routes passing through a single Light Rail stop. One cannot work out the exact loading or patronage of individual Light Rail routes by projecting the route chosen by passengers based on their entry/exit records, which is the methodology currently adopted in assessing the loading of heavy rail lines. The MTRCL currently assesses the loading of Light Rail Vehicles by on-site observations and surveys. The passenger density standard of four or six ppsm adopted in the calculation of heavy rail loading is not applicable.

Note 2: The MTRCL introduced Routes 506P and 720 in September 2023 and September 2024 respectively to run in the morning peak hours.

Note 3: The figures show the average loading of Route 614/614P and Route 615/615P. Within the Tuen Mun District, the alignments of Routes 614 and 614P overlap completely, same for Routes 615 and 615P. However, Routes 614P and 615P only operate between Tuen Mun Ferry Pier and Siu Hong Station, while Routes 614 and 615 provide cross-district services to Yuen Long after serving Siu Hong Station. The busiest sections of these two routes are normally located along the overlapping sections in Tuen Mun District. For passengers travelling within Tuen Mun District, it makes no difference to take Route 614 or 614P, or to take Route 615 or 615P. Therefore, using average loading of the Light Rail routes can more accurately reflect the actual situation.

Annex 3

The Numbers of Trains and Coaches for Heavy Rail and Light Rail

As at December of the year	2023		2024		2025	
	Trains	Coaches per train	Trains	Coaches per train	Trains	Coaches per train
East Rail Line	37	9	37	9	37	9
Tuen Ma Line	65	8	65	8	65	8
Tseung Kwan O Line	16	8	16	8	17	8
Island Line	36	8	36	8	38	8
South Island Line	10	3	10	3	10	3
Kwun Tong Line	39	8	39	8	39	8
Tsuen Wan Line	35	8	35	8	34	8
Disneyland Resort Line	3	4	3	4	3	4
Tung Chung Line	16	8	16	8	16	8
Airport Express	11	8	11	8	11	8

Light rail system is operated by single-set or coupled-set Light Rail Vehicles, the latter of which is formed by two coaches. The total number of light rail coaches stood at 149 in 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Annex 4

Train Frequencies of the Heavy Rail System (Note 1)

As at December of the year	2023		2024		2025	
	Frequency during the morning peak hours (minutes)	Frequency during the non-peak hours (minutes)	Frequency during the morning peak hours (minutes)	Frequency during the non-peak hours (minutes)	Frequency during the morning peak hours (minutes)	Frequency during the non-peak hours (minutes)
East Rail Line						
Admiralty-Sheung Shui	2.7 - 3.8	4 - 8	2.7 - 5.5	4 - 8	2.7 - 5.5	4 - 8
Admiralty-Lo Wu (Note 2)	5.5	6 - 10	3 - 7	6 - 10	3 - 7	4 - 10
Admiralty-Lok Ma Chau (Note 2)	12	12 - 14.5	9 - 14	12 - 14	9 - 14	8 - 14
Tuen Ma Line	2.7 - 3	6 - 7	2.7 - 3	6 - 7	2.7 - 3	6 - 7
Tseung Kwan O Line						
North Point-Tseung Kwan O	2.2	--	2.2	--	2.2	--
North Point-Po Lam	2.5 - 4	5 - 6	2.5 - 4	5 - 6	2.5 - 4	4.5 - 6
North Point-LOHAS Park	6.7	--	6.7	--	6.7	--
Tiu Keng Leng-LOHAS Park	--	10 - 14	--	10 - 14	--	9 - 14
Island Line	1.9	3.6 - 5	1.9	3.6 - 5	1.9	3.6 - 5
South Island Line	3.3	6 - 7.5	3.3	5 - 7.5	3.3	5 - 7.5

Kwun Tong Line						
Tiu Keng Leng-Ho Man Tin	2.1	3.5 - 5	2.1	3.5 - 5	2.1	3.5 - 5
Ho Man Tin-Whampoa	4.2	3.5 - 5	4.2	3.5 - 5	4.2	3.5 - 5
Tsuen Wan Line	2	3.5 - 5	2	3.5 - 5	2.1	3.5 - 5
Disneyland Resort Line	5	10 - 20	5	10	5	10
Tung Chung Line						
Hong Kong-Tsing Yi	3 - 4	7 - 10	3 - 4	7 - 10	3 - 4	7 - 10
Hong Kong-Tung Chung	6 - 8	7 - 10	6 - 8	7 - 10	6 - 8	7 - 10
Airport Express	10	10	10	10	10	10

Note 1: The figures tabulated above are the train frequencies on weekdays.

Note 2: Due to the COVID-19 pandemic, services at Lo Wu Station and Lok Ma Chau Station were suspended since 4 February 2020. Lok Ma Chau Station and Lo Wu Station were re-opened on 8 January and 6 February 2023 respectively.

Train Frequencies of the Light Rail System (Note 1)

Light Rail Route (Note 2)	2023		2024		2025	
	Frequency during the morning peak hours (minutes)	Frequency during the non-peak hours (minutes)	Frequency during the morning peak hours (minutes)	Frequency during the non-peak hours (minutes)	Frequency during the morning peak hours (minutes)	Frequency during the non-peak hours (minutes)
505	6 - 11	10 - 18	6 - 10	10 - 18	6 - 10	10 - 18
507	6 - 9	7 - 16	6 - 9	9 - 21	6 - 9	9 - 21
610	8 - 10	9 - 17	8 - 11	9 - 17	8 - 11	9 - 17
614	12 - 18	12 - 23	15 - 18	15 - 23	15 - 18	15 - 23
614P	8 - 13	11 - 19	8 - 14	11 - 18	8 - 14	11 - 18
615	14 - 18	14 - 24	15 - 19	15 - 24	15 - 19	15 - 24
615P	9 - 13	10 - 19	8 - 14	11 - 18	8 - 14	11 - 18
705	5 - 7	7 - 12	5 - 7	6 - 12	5 - 7	6 - 12
706	5 - 7	7 - 12	5 - 7	6 - 12	5 - 7	6 - 12
751	7 - 12	8 - 17	7 - 11	8 - 15	7 - 11	8 - 15
761P	5 - 8	6 - 15	5 - 8	7 - 15	5 - 8	7 - 15

Note 1: The figures tabulated above are the train frequencies on weekdays.

Note 2: The MTRCL introduced Routes 506P and 720 in September 2023 and September 2024 respectively to run in the morning peak hours.

Annex 5

Numbers of Incidents which Caused Service Disruption of Eight Minutes or Above due to Factors under the MTRCL's Control

Kwun Tong Line

Year	Number of incidents	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) (Note 3)
				Half an hour or less (Note 1)		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure (Note 2)	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	17	17	0	15	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	2
2024	12	11	1	10	1	1	0	0	0	0	0	1
2025	4	3	1	3	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Tsuen Wan Line

Year	Number of incidents	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) (Note 3)
				Half an hour or less (Note 1)		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure (Note 2)	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	8	8	0	7	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	1
2024	10	10	0	9	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	1
2025	11	11	0	11	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Island Line

Year	Number of incidents	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) (Note 3)
				Half an hour or less (Note 1)		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure (Note 2)	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	5	5	0	4	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	1
2024	10	8	2	7	2	1	0	0	0	0	0	1
2025	5	5	0	5	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Tseung Kwan O Line

Year	Number of incidents	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) (Note 3)
				Half an hour or less (Note 1)		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure (Note 2)	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	6	6	0	4	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	3
2024	12	10	2	10	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2025	10	10	0	9	0	0	0	0	0	1	0	19.2

South Island Line

Year	Number of incidents	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) (Note 3)
				Half an hour or less (Note 1)		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure (Note 2)	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	1	1	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2024	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2025	4	4	0	3	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	1

East Rail Line

Year	Number of incidents	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) (Note 3)
				Half an hour or less (Note 1)		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure (Note 2)	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	13	13	0	13	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2024	11	11	0	11	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2025	12	11	1	9	1	2	0	0	0	0	0	2

Tuen Ma Line

Year	Number of incidents	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) (Note 3)
				Half an hour or less (Note 1)		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure (Note 2)	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	18	18	0	18	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2024	6	6	0	5	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	1
2025	10	10	0	7	0	3	0	0	0	0	0	3

Tung Chung Line

Year	Number of incidents	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) (Note 3)
				Half an hour or less (Note 1)		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure (Note 2)	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	10	8	2	7	2	1	0	0	0	0	0	1
2024	11	10	1	9	1	1	0	0	0	0	0	1.2
2025	6	6	0	4	0	2	0	0	0	0	0	2

Disneyland Resort Line

Year	Number of incidents	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) (Note 3)
				Half an hour or less (Note 1)		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure (Note 2)	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2024	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2025	1	1	0	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Airport Express

Year	Number of incidents	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) (Note 3)
				Half an hour or less (Note 1)		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure (Note 2)	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	5	4	1	4	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2024	7	7	0	7	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2025	9	7	2	7	2	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Light Rail

Year	Number of incidents	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) (Note 3)
				Half an hour or less (Note 1)		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure (Note 2)	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	18	14	4	13	2	1	1	0	0	0	1	17
2024	10	9	1	9	1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
2025	11	8	3	8	3	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

Note 1: According to the existing railway incident reporting mechanism, the MTRCL is required to notify the TD within eight minutes of any railway incident which has caused train service disruption of eight minutes or is expected to cause disruption of eight minutes or more. For service disruption of less than eight minutes, the impact on passengers is comparatively minimal and the MTRCL is not required to notify the TD. Hence, the TD does not have the number of incidents with service disruption of less than eight minutes.

Note 2: Equipment failure includes failure in station equipment, infrastructure (e.g. signalling system), rolling stock, etc.

Note 3: After the review of 2023 Fare Adjustment Mechanism, there is an increase in the amount to be set aside for incidents that cause disruptions of more than three hours and the maximum amount to be set aside per incident, as well as an introduction of a peak hour multiplier under the Service Performance Rebate.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0656)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the implementation of the Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector, will the Government inform this Committee of:

(1) the following information of each round of application since the launch of the Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector – Public Light Bus/Coach Trade (the Scheme):
   (i) the number of new applications received;
   (ii) the number of renewal applications received;
   (iii) the number of quotas approved (by driver job type); and
   (iv) the number of applications rejected and the quotas involved by driver job type);

(2) the numbers and nature of complaints received against imported public light bus drivers, local coach drivers and cross-boundary coach drivers, the numbers of substantiated cases and associated follow-up actions and penalty measures since the launch of the Scheme; and

(3) whether any participating employers or imported labour of the Schemes have been found to have violated the requirements under the Scheme or relevant labour laws; if yes, the numbers and details?

Asked by: Hon CHAU Siu-chung (LegCo internal reference no.: 11)

Reply:

(1) The Government has all along been concerned about the long standing driver shortage problem faced by the public light bus (PLB)/coach trade. To alleviate the problem of labour shortage in the trade, the Government announced the Scheme in June 2023, and approved 900 PLB and 800 coach driver quotas through two rounds of applications in September 2023 and July 2024 respectively. All applications were vetted by the inter-departmental liaison group (comprising representatives from the Transport and Logistics Bureau, the Labour Department and the Transport Department (TD)). Details of the two rounds of applications are set out at **Annex**. In addition, as for the gradual expiry

of the contracts of the first batch of imported workers from the end of 2025, the TD announced the quota renewal arrangements in August 2025. The operators with allocated quotas should submit renewal applications to the TD five months prior to the expiry of the contracts of their imported drivers. As at end-February 2026, the TD has received renewal applications for a total of 733 quotas (including 377 PLB and 356 coach driver quotas), of which 589 quotas (including 324 PLB and 265 coach driver quotas) had been granted with approval for renewal. The TD is processing the remaining renewal applications, including reviewing whether or not the operators concerned continue to meet the criteria of the Scheme (including maintaining the manning ratio of 1:2 for imported labours to full-time local staff, the wage levels of imported workers at not less than the median monthly wages of the relevant posts, and complying with relevant local driver recruitment requirements, etc.).

(2) As at end-February 2026, the TD received a total of 61 complaints concerning imported drivers' service attitude and driving skills (as in the table below). The nature of the complaints includes failing to allow passengers to alight at specified locations/stops, or providing passengers with incorrect information on routes/destinations/departure schedules. Among them, 36 cases were substantiated after investigation by the TD.

	Number of complaints against imported drivers	**Number of substantiated cases**
From the launch of the Scheme to end-February 2025	33	28
From March 2025 to end-February 2026	28	8
Total	**61**	**36**

Like local PLB/coach drivers, the performance of imported drivers is monitored by the operators. The operators are obliged to provide appropriate and proper services according to the requirements of the TD, including monitoring the driving and service performance of all drivers employed. The TD has urged the operators to strengthen drivers' management. The TD will also inspect the performance of drivers (including local and imported drivers) on site in the regular monitoring to ensure that the driving and service performance of drivers meet the requirements. If any irregularity is found, the TD will follow up with the operators concerned. Overall speaking, imported drivers could provide high-level services based on our observation.

(3) The Government has adopted a multi-pronged approach, including preparation of standard employment contract (SEC), inspections, law enforcement, education and promotion, to protect the rights and benefits of imported workers. If employers have violated relevant labour/immigration laws, requirements under the Scheme or SEC, the Government will consider imposing administrative sanctions on the employers as appropriate, including refusal to process applications for labour importation under the Scheme and withdrawal of the approvals previously granted for importation of drivers. There is no case of administrative sanctions warranting the imposition of administrative sanctions by the relevant enforcement departments since the launch of the Scheme.

Annex

Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector –Public Light Bus (PLB)/Coach Trade

Numbers of applications and quotas allocated in the first round by driver job type

Driver job type	Number of applications received	Number of quotas applied for	Number of applications approved	Number of driver quotas allocated
Public Light Bus Driver	68 (involving 68 route packages)	547	59	461
Local Coach Driver	32 (involving six service endorsements) Note (1)	689	23	262
Cross-boundary Coach Driver	18 (involving routes plying six road-based boundary control points (BCPs))	365	16	246
Total	**118**	**1 601**	**98**	**969**

Numbers of applications and quotas allocated in the second round by driver job type

Driver job type	Number of applications received	Number of quotas applied for	Number of applications approved	Number of driver quotas allocated
Public Light Bus Driver	82 (involving 82 route packages)	842	82	467
Local Coach Driver	31 (involving six service endorsements) Note (1)	394	27	228
Cross-boundary Coach Driver	16 (involving routes plying six road-based BCPs)	237	16	154
Total	**129**	**1 473**	**125**	**849**(2)

Notes:

(1) The six service endorsements include (i) tour service, (ii) hotel service, (iii) student service, (iv) employees' service, (v) residents' service and (vi) contract hire service.

(2) Including 118 approved quotas left unused in the first round and carried forward to the second round.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0657)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the provision of new parking spaces, will the Government inform this Committee:

(1) of the following details about the provision of new parking spaces in Hong Kong in the recent two years and this year to date (with a breakdown by District Council district): (i) number of additional parking spaces, (ii) year-on-year percentage change, (iii) total number of the relevant parking spaces and (iv) proposed number of additional parking spaces in the next two years for on-street parking spaces, night-time parking spaces for commercial vehicles, designated parking spaces underneath flyovers, parking spaces at short-term tenancy car parks and parking spaces at government buildings opened up during non-office hours; and

(2) of the current numbers of parking spaces by vehicle type (i.e. motorcycles, private cars, goods vehicles, coaches and non- franchised public buses) in various districts of Hong Kong.

Asked by: Hon CHAU Siu-chung (LegCo internal reference no.: 12)

Reply:

(1) The numbers of on-street parking spaces, night-time parking spaces for commercial vehicles (CVs), designated parking spaces underneath flyovers, parking spaces at short-term tenancy (STT) car parks and parking spaces at government buildings opened up during non-office hours in the 18 districts in the past two years[Note 1], together with the increases or decreases in such numbers and the corresponding percentage changes, are set out at **Annex 1**, **Annex 2**, **Annex 3**, **Annex 4** and **Annex 5** respectively.

Overall, the total number of parking spaces in the territory has increased in the past two years. That said, the number of parking spaces in some districts has decreased due to various factors. Taking the parking spaces at STT car parks as an example, some car parks have been resumed to meet urban development, resulting in a decrease in the number of parking spaces.

The Government expects to provide over 12 000 additional parking spaces across the territory in 2025 and 2026, covering both private cars and CVs. These include more than 220 metered parking spaces and a minimum of 100 on-street night-time parking spaces for CVs by 2026, as well as about 600 parking spaces at STT car parks to be leased over the next two years. The Transport Department (TD) and relevant departments are actively taking forward these measures in accordance with the targets.

Besides, the first three public vehicle parks (PVPs)[Note 2] implemented under the "single site, multiple use" principle have been commissioned, providing a total of about 860 parking spaces. With the successive commissioning of more PVP projects, including the PVP at Area 99 in Tung Chung, District Open Space, Sports Centre and Public Vehicle Park at Sze Mei Street, the redevelopment of Yuen Long Stadium, and the Kwun Tong Composite Development Project, which are expected to be completed between 2026 and 2027, a total of about 600 parking spaces will be provided. Together with other development projects and the ongoing short- and medium-term parking measures, the supply of new parking spaces will further increase over the next few years. The TD will continue to step up its efforts, focusing on areas with a shortage of parking spaces to increase the provision of on-street parking spaces as far as practicable. It will continue to stipulate the provision of a minimum number of CV parking spaces in suitable STT car parks.

Note 1: The various types of parking spaces are managed by different departments and operators, who are still collecting and compiling the relevant information. Therefore, the organisations concerned are unable to provide data for the current year to date.

Note 2: Including Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park in Sheung Shui, the Pak Shing Kok Road Public Car Park in Tseung Kwan O and the Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park.

(2) The current numbers of parking spaces in the 18 districts by vehicle type are set out at **Annex 6**.

Annex 1

Total Numbers, Changes in Numbers and Percentage Changes of On-street Parking Spaces in 18 Districts in 2024 and 2025

District	Total number of parking spaces		Change in number of parking spaces Note	Percentage change
	2024	2025		
Central & Western	1 373	1 373	0	0.0%
Wan Chai	1 886	1 891	5	0.3%
Eastern	1 509	1 528	19	1.3%
Southern	1 236	1 252	16	1.3%
Yau Tsim Mong	3 415	3 451	36	1.1%
Sham Shui Po	2 411	2 444	33	1.4%
Kowloon City	3 683	3 709	26	0.7%
Wong Tai Sin	990	1 024	34	3.4%
Kwun Tong	1 680	1 788	108	6.4%
Tsuen Wan	1 659	1 721	62	3.7%
Tuen Mun	2 631	2 648	17	0.6%
Yuen Long	2 431	2 387	-44 Note	-1.8%
North	2 227	2 160	-67 Note	-3.0%
Tai Po	2 319	2 329	10	0.4%
Sai Kung	2 897	2 949	52	1.8%
Sha Tin	2 606	2 522	-84 Note	-3.2%
Kwai Tsing	1 637	1 789	152	9.3%
Islands	1 046	1 046	0	0.0%
Total	**37 636**	**38 011**	**375**	**1.0%**

Note 1: The reasons for the decrease include (i) the exclusion of some parking spaces after their locations were clarified and confirmed as not being located on public roads; (ii) the closure of the road sections where the parking spaces are located for public works; and (iii) the relocation of parking spaces to public car parks in new development projects to meet the development needs.

Annex 2

Total Numbers, Changes in Numbers and Percentage Changes of On-street Night-time Parking Spaces for CVs in 18 Districts in 2024 and 2025

District	Total number of parking spaces		Change in the number of parking spaces	Percentage change
	2024	2025		
Central & Western	96	96	0	0.0%
Wan Chai	19	19	0	0.0%
Eastern	82	87	5	6.1%
Southern	17	17	0	0.0%
Yau Tsim Mong	8	9	1	12.5%
Sham Shui Po	81	84	3	3.7%
Kowloon City	4	6	2	50.0%
Wong Tai Sin	27	45	18	66.7%
Kwun Tong	139	215	76	54.7%
Tsuen Wan	32	32	0	0.0%
Tuen Mun	195	195	0	0.0%
Yuen Long	212	218	6	2.8%
North	184	194	10	5.4%
Tai Po	236	236	0	0.0%
Sai Kung	141	149	8	5.7%
Sha Tin	118	144	26	22.0%
Kwai Tsing	256	266	10	3.9%
Islands	8	8	0	0.0%
Total	**1 855**	**2 020**	**165**	**8.9%**

Annex 3

Total Numbers, Changes in Numbers and Percentage Changes of Designated Parking Spaces Underneath Flyovers in 18 Districts in 2024 and 2025

District	Total number of parking spaces		Change in the number of parking spaces	Percentage change
	2024	2025		
Central & Western	147	147	0	0.0%
Wan Chai	87	87	0	0.0%
Eastern	116	116	0	0.0%
Southern	0	0	0	0.0%
Yau Tsim Mong	369	369	0	0.0%
Sham Shui Po	87	87	0	0.0%
Kowloon City	76	76	0	0.0%
Wong Tai Sin	49	60	11	22.4%
Kwun Tong	165	165	0	0.0%
Tsuen Wan	160	227	67	41.9%
Tuen Mun	184	242	58	31.5%
Yuen Long	9	9	0	0.0%
North	6	6	0	0.0%
Tai Po	42	42	0	0.0%
Sai Kung	0	0	0	0.0%
Sha Tin	131	155	24	18.3%
Kwai Tsing	34	34	0	0.0%
Islands	0	0	0	0.0%
Total	**1 662**	**1 822**	**160**	**9.6%**

Annex 4

Total Numbers, Changes in Numbers and Percentage Changes of Parking Spaces at STT Car Parks in 18 Districts in 2024 and 2025[Note]

District	Total number of parking spaces		Change in the number of parking spaces	Percentage change
	2024	2025		
Central & Western	210	216	6	2.9%
Wan Chai	0	0	0	0.0%
Eastern	858	999	141	16.4%
Southern	260	230	-30	-11.5%
Yau Tsim Mong	727	577	-150	-20.6%
Sham Shui Po	896	867	-29	-3.2%
Kowloon City	758	786	28	3.7%
Wong Tai Sin	362	409	47	13.0%
Kwun Tong	1 302	999	-303	-23.3%
Tsuen Wan	2 441	2 221	-220	-9.0%
Tuen Mun	2 079	1 832	-247	-11.9%
Yuen Long	1 118	1 154	36	3.2%
North	819	1 103	284	34.7%
Tai Po	1 359	1 570	211	15.5%
Sai Kung	3 439	3 374	-65	-1.9%
Sha Tin	2 124	2 039	-85	-4.0%
Kwai Tsing	6 095	6 938	843	13.8%
Islands	47	500	453	963.8%
Total	**24 894**	**25 814**	**920**	**3.7%**

Note: The above parking information is collated from the data provided by various departments or the concerned car park management companies or operators, and is for general reference only. The actual number of parking spaces may vary as the departments, management companies or operators responsible for managing the car parks may make adjustments to the numbers/types of parking spaces to suit their own requirements.

Annex 5

Total Numbers, Changes in Numbers and Percentage Changes of Parking Spaces at Government Joint-user General Office Buildings Managed by the Government Property Agency Opened Up During Non-office Hours in 18 Districts in 2024 and 2025

District	Location of car park	Total number of parking spaces		Change in the number of parking spaces	Percentage change
		2024	2025		
Central & Western	Queensway Government Offices	159	158	-1	-0.6%
Wan Chai	-	N/A			
Eastern	North Point Government Offices	95	95	0	0%
Southern	-	N/A			
Yau Tsim Mong	West Kowloon Government Offices	50	50	0	0%
Sham Shui Po	Cheung Sha Wan Government Offices	250	250	0	0%
Kowloon City	Tokwawan Market and Government Offices	28	28	0	0%
	Trade and Industry Tower	24	22	-2	-8.3%
Wong Tai Sin	-	N/A			
Kwun Tong	-	N/A			
Tsuen Wan	-	N/A			
Tuen Mun	Tuen Mun Government Offices	42	42	0	0%
Yuen Long	Yuen Long District Office Building	43	43	0	0%
North	North District Government Offices	96	96	0	0%
Tai Po	Tai Po Government Offices	69	69	0	0%
Sai Kung	Sai Kung Government Offices	70	70	0	0%
Sha Tin	Sha Tin Government Offices	122	119	-3	-2.5%
Kwai Tsing	-	N/A			
Islands	-	N/A			
Total		**1048**	**1 042**	**-6**	**-0.6%**

Annex 6

Numbers of Parking Spaces in 18 Districts by Vehicle Type in December 2025[Note]

District	Private car	Goods vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total
Central & Western	39 126	1 030	84	1 604	41 844
Wan Chai	39 257	342	144	1 435	41 178
Eastern	46 916	1 867	258	2 810	51 851
Southern	41 083	1 138	283	2 060	44 564
Yau Tsim Mong	35 684	1 316	247	2 219	39 466
Sham Shui Po	31 797	3 120	428	2 399	37 744
Kowloon City	55 498	1 408	253	2 630	59 789
Wong Tai Sin	20 580	1 280	90	2 591	24 541
Kwun Tong	48 513	3 653	137	5 197	57 500
Tsuen Wan	38 674	2 056	400	2 049	43 179
Tuen Mun	44 245	2 553	252	2 217	49 267
Yuen Long	44 720	2 031	401	2 142	49 294
North	23 277	1 637	116	1 071	26 101
Tai Po	34 276	1 200	173	1 303	36 952
Sai Kung	46 029	1 673	385	3 760	51 847
Sha Tin	76 131	2 680	195	3 623	82 629
Kwai Tsing	36 109	10 045	391	3 331	49 876
Islands	21 751	1 008	291	1 001	24 051
Total	**723 666**	**40 037**	**4 528**	**43 442**	**811 673**

Note: The above parking information is collated from the data provided by various departments or the concerned car park management companies or operators, and is for general reference only. The actual number of parking spaces may vary as the departments, management companies or operators responsible for managing the car parks may make adjustments to the numbers/types of parking spaces to suit their own requirements.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0660)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the implementation of the "Northbound Travel for Hong Kong Vehicles" (the Scheme), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the number of random checks of the crossing records of vehicles under the Scheme carried out in each of the past two years and this year to date to ensure that travellers travel according to the reserved period;

2. the number of cases of violation of travel arrangements found during the random checks mentioned in part (1) and the numbers of warning letters or reminder messages issued to the applicants of vehicles in violation, suspension of their eligibility to make travel reservations through the "Specified Date Booking System", revocation of their eligibility for the Scheme, and suspension of their eligibility to apply for the Scheme again;

3. the number of traffic accidents or incidents in the Mainland involving Hong Kong vehicles under the Scheme in the past two years and this year to date; and

4. the numbers of prosecutions and convictions against applicants for the Scheme who are suspected of engaging in illegal cross-boundary carriage of passengers for reward in the past two years and this year to date.

Asked by: Hon CHAU Siu-chung (LegCo internal reference no.: 13)

Reply:

1. and 2.

As stipulated in the terms and conditions of application for the Scheme, travellers have to obtain a booking confirmation via the booking system in order to travel to Guangdong Province via the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (HZMB) Hong Kong Port except for the dates that do not require travel booking. This arrangement aims to ensure that travellers travel according to the reserved period, maintain orderly border crossings and facilitate the traffic management at the boundary control points. To provide better

travelling experience, the Transport Department (TD) has been maintaining close liaison with the relevant Mainland authorities and conducting random checks to verify the travellers' booking records under the Scheme and on entry and exit information at the HZMB ports, so as to ensure that travellers travel according to their reserved dates and times and that the Scheme operates smoothly. We have always adjusted the frequency of random checks dynamically in accordance with the risk-based principle.

As at February 2026, following investigations, the TD has issued a total of about 5 500 reminder messages or warnings and suspended the eligibility of about 500 vehicles participating in the Scheme to make travel bookings.

3. According to the information from relevant Mainland authorities, there were about 400 traffic accidents or incidents in the Mainland involving Hong Kong vehicles participating in the Scheme in 2024 and 2025.

4. The Hong Kong Police Force does not have the figures as requested in the question.

- End-

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 Reply Serial No.

TLB191

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0680)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the supply of parking spaces for school private light buses, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the number of newly added school private light buses in each of the past two years and this year to date, and the current total number of private light buses;

2. the number of participating schools and the number of parking spaces for school private light buses provided in each school year since the launch of the Opening Up School Parking Spaces to Student Service Vehicles Scheme(the Scheme); and

3. whether the Government will consider offering greater incentives to encourage more schools to participate in the Scheme; if yes, what are the details; if no, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon CHAU Siu-chung (LegCo internal reference no.: 34)

Reply:

1. The numbers of first registered school private light buses each year from 2024 to the end of February 2026 are set out in the table below:

Year	Number of first registered school private light buses
2024	10
2025	8
2026 (as at the end of February)	2

As at the end of February 2026, there are a total of 3 393 registered private light buses, 1 858 of which are school private light buses.

2. The Transport Department (TD) and the Education Bureau (EDB) launched the "Opening Up School Parking Spaces to Student Service Vehicles Scheme" (the Scheme) on a pilot basis in the 2018/19 school year. To date, both the number of participating schools and the number of parking spaces opened have been increasing steadily. The number of participating schools and parking spaces opened for school private light buses in each school year are set out in the table below:

School Year	Number of Participating Schools	Number of Parking Spaces Opened		
		Private Light Bus	Coach	Total
2018/19	8	4	24	28
2019/20	24	14	60	74
2020/21	29	19	69	88
2021/22	32	19	76	95
2022/23	35	27	73	100
2023/24	37	31	77	108
2024/25	40	33	85	118
2025/26	42	34	92	126

3. The Scheme is open to all public sector schools and schools under the Direct Subsidy Scheme (DSS), encouraging them to make their parking spaces available to student service vehicles (SSVs) during non-school hours.

To encourage school participation, the EDB issued a circular inviting public sector and DSS schools to join the Scheme. To facilitate the submission of applications and expedite the process, the Scheme was revised to accept applications on a year-round basis starting from the 2022/23 school year, replacing the previous practice of accepting applications only during a designated period each year. The processing of applications has also been accelerated. In addition, the EDB continues to encourage schools to participate in the Scheme through various channels, such as its Fast Information Transmission System and routine communication with schools, and provides them with relevant information about the Scheme.

As at 2025/26 school year, 42 schools are participating in the Scheme, providing a total of 126 parking spaces for SSVs. To further encourage schools' participation, the TD and EDB met with representatives from schools and the school bus sector in August and October 2025 to exchange views on the measures to enhance the Scheme, including streamlining the application procedures and examining the feasibility of relaxing the eligibility criteria, etc. Through the subsequent survey by the TD and the EDB, a list has been compiled of schools with school bus parking spaces, their willingness to open up such spaces, and the number of parking spaces available. The TD and the EDB are now analysing the information collected from the survey so as to gain a better understanding of schools' concerns and provide appropriate support, thereby encouraging more schools to participate in the Scheme. The TD will continue to increase the supply of parking spaces for SSVs through various measures.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2409)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (6) Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme (the Scheme), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) the revised estimate of the Scheme for 2025-26 has significantly decreased by 23.6% over the original estimate, has the Government analysed the reasons for this; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons;

(2) as the estimate of the Scheme for 2026-27 has substantially increased by 34.3% as compared to the revised estimate of last year; and there have been no significant adjustments to the Scheme, why a substantial increase in the estimate is required;

(3) the details of the Scheme in the past two years and this year to date (please set out the monthly numbers in table form), including total subsidy expenditure, recurrent expenditure (excluding the subsidy amount), number of beneficiaries with a breakdown by subsidy amount (i.e. less than $100, $101 to $200, $201 to $300 and $301 to $400), and average amount of subsidy per beneficiary; and

(4) whether consideration will be given to lowering the threshold for the Scheme and increasing the subsidy cap to reduce the transport expenses of the public; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons.

Asked by: Hon CHAU Siu-chung (LegCo internal reference no.: 32)

Reply:

(1) The revised estimate of the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme (the Scheme) for the 2025-26 financial year is lower than the original estimate mainly because the expenditure for subsidy amount is lower than expected, which is attributable to factors including the lower-than-expected public transport patronage.

(2) From 1 June 2025 onwards, the threshold of monthly public transport expenses incurred for receiving the subsidy under the Scheme was raised from $400 to $500. Taking into account the expenditure savings brought about by the adjustment to the Scheme, there is still an increase of about $720 million in the estimated total expenditure of the Scheme for the 2026-27 financial year over the revised estimate for the 2025-26 financial year. This is mainly taking into account factors such as increase in public transport patronage and fare adjustments.

(3) The total subsidy amount, average monthly number of beneficiaries and average amount of monthly subsidy per beneficiary under the Scheme in the past three years are set out in **Table 1**. The average monthly number of beneficiaries by monthly subsidy amount in the past three years is set out in **Table 2**, while the recurrent expenditure (excluding the subsidy amount) in the past three financial years is set out in **Table 3**.

Table 1:

Year Note 1	**Total subsidy amount ($ million)**	**Average monthly number of beneficiaries ('000)**	**Average amount of monthly subsidy per beneficiary ($)**
2023	3,909	3 036	107
2024	2,528	1 988	106
2025	2,238	1 764	106

Note 1: To allow more commuters to benefit from the Scheme during the COVID-19 pandemic, the Government implemented temporary special measures to temporarily relax the monthly public transport expenses threshold of the Scheme from $400 to $200 and temporarily increase the monthly subsidy cap from $400 to $500 from May 2022 to October 2023. With the expiry of the temporary special measures, the monthly public transport expenses threshold and the monthly subsidy cap were resumed to $400 from November 2023. From June 2025 onwards, the monthly public transport expenses threshold under the Scheme was raised from $400 to $500.

Table 2:

Monthly subsidy amount	**Average monthly number of beneficiaries ('000)** Note 2		
	2023	**2024**	**2025**
$0.1 to $100.0	1 732	1 157	1 033
$100.1 to $200.0	836	545	475
$200.1 to $300.0	321	196	173
$300.1 or above	140	90	83

Note 2: Due to rounding, the average monthly numbers of beneficiaries for each period do not add up to the totals shown in Table 1.

Table 3:

Financial year	**Recurrent expenditure ($ million)**
2022-23	37.4
2023-24	40.1

Financial year	Recurrent expenditure ($ million)
2024-25	42.0

The Government has been striving to lower the administrative cost of the Scheme as far as possible. The recurrent expenditure of the Scheme (excluding the subsidy amount) in the past three financial years was equivalent to about 1.1% to 1.7% of the annual total subsidy amount.

(4) The policy objective of the Scheme is to relieve the fare burden of commuters whose public transport expenses are relatively high. To ensure the sustainability of the Scheme and proper use of public funds, the Government will, on the premise of prudent fiscal management, review the Scheme from time to time and consider whether adjustment is necessary having regard to prevailing circumstances (such as the public transport expenses level, inflation, the financial situation of the Government, and the overall economic environment, etc.).

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2410)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development,
(2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the provision of parking spaces for private cars (PCs) and commercial vehicles (CVs) in Hong Kong, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) the current numbers of various motor vehicles and non-motor vehicles with valid licences;

(2) in each of the past two years and this year to date, the numbers of parking spaces for PCs, motorcycles and CVs and their respective ratios to the total number of parking spaces;

(3) in each of the past two years and this year to date, a breakdown by District Council district and vehicle type of the information of on-street parking spaces in the territory, including the number of parking spaces and year-on-year percentage change, and utilisation rates on weekdays, weekends and public holidays;

(4) in each of the past two years and this year to date, a breakdown by District Council district of the information of parking spaces at car parks under the Transport Department's management, including the number of parking spaces and year-on-year percentage change, and utilisation rates on weekdays, weekends and public holidays;

(5) in each of the past two years and this year to date, a breakdown by District Council district of the information of parking spaces at fee-charging public car parks leased out by the Government Property Agency, including the number of parking spaces and year-on-year percentage change, and utilisation rate on weekdays, weekends and public holidays; and

(6) in each of the past two years and this year to date, the numbers of fixed penalty notices against illegal parking and the amounts of fixed penalties involved.

Asked by: Hon CHAU Siu-chung (LegCo internal reference no.: 33)

Reply:

(1) As at the end of 2025, the numbers of licensed motor vehicles and licensed non-motor vehicles are listed below:

Motorised Vehicles	**As at the end of 2025**
	Number of licensed vehicles
Motorcycles	72 943
Private Cars	584 914
Taxis	17 695
Franchised Buses	5 793
Non-franchised Public Buses	6 732
Private Buses	833
Public Light Buses	4 053
Private Light Buses	3 320
Goods Vehicles	107 611
Special Purpose Vehicles	1 852
Government Vehicles	7 221
Sub-total (i):	**812 967**
Non-Motorised Vehicles	**Number of licensed vehicles**
Trailers	10 186
Sub-total (ii):	**10 186**
Total (i) + (ii):	**823 153**

(2) The numbers of licensed private cars (PCs), licensed motorcycles (MCs) and licensed commercial vehicles (CVs) and their parking spaces, as well as the ratios of the numbers of parking spaces to the numbers of these licensed vehicles in 2024 and 2025[Note] are tabulated below:

Vehicle type	As at the end of each year	Number of licensed vehicles	Number of parking spaces	Ratio of the number of parking spaces to the number of licensed vehicles
PC	2025	633 988	723 666	1 : 1.14
	2024	628 790	715 518	1 : 1.14
MC	2025	72 134	43 442	1 : 0.60
	2024	72 614	41 775	1 : 0.58
CV	2025	66 753	44 565	1 : 0.67
	2024	67 243	44 239	1 : 0.66

Note: The various types of parking spaces are managed by different departments and operators, who are still collecting and compiling the relevant information. Therefore, the organisations concerned are unable to provide the data for this year to date.

(3) There was an overall increase in the number of on-street metered parking spaces by District Council districts in 2024 and 2025. The relevant information is set out at **Annex 1** and **Annex 2**. The number of on-street parking spaces for MCs has also increased. The relevant information is set out at **Annex 3**. Note

Note: The various types of parking spaces are managed by different departments and operators, who are still collecting and compiling the relevant information. Therefore, the organisations concerned are unable to provide the data for this year to date.

(4) The numbers of parking spaces at car parks operated by the Transport Department (TD) in 2024 and 2025Note by District Council districts remained generally the same. The relevant numbers and utilisation rates are set out at **Annex 4**.

Note: The car parks operated by the TD are managed by the operators, who are still collecting and compiling the relevant information, and therefore the data for this year to date is not available.

(5) The numbers of parking spaces at fee-charging public car parks leased out by the Government Property Agency (GPA) from 2024 to January 2026 remained generally the same. Their numbers, percentage changes and utilisation rates on weekdays, weekends and public holidays by District Council districts are set out at **Annex 5**.

(6) The numbers of fixed penalty notices (FPNs) against illegal parking and the amounts of fixed penalties involved from 2024 to February 2026 are as follows:

Numbers of FPNs against illegal parking issued by the Hong Kong Police Force from 2024 to February 2026			
Year	**2024**	**2025**	**2026 (as at February) (Note)**
Number of FPNs against illegal parking	2 543 197	2 068 107	248 831
Amount of fixed penalties	$814 million	$662 million	$99.5 million

Note: The number of FPNs for 2026 is preliminary. Besides, the fixed penalty for illegal parking has been increased from $320 to $400 with effect from 1 January 2026.

Annex 1

Numbers and percentage changes of on-street metered parking spaces in 2024 and 2025 by District Council districts and vehicle types

District	Number of parking spaces			
	2024		2025	
	General vehicle[Note 1]	CV[Note 2]	General vehicle[Note 1]	CV[Note 2]
Central and Western	482	117	481	117
Eastern	500	92	497	92
Southern	598	87	601	87
Wan Chai	970	52	985	47
Hong Kong Island (Sub-total)	2 550	348	2 564	343
Kowloon City	2 300	276	2 322	310
Kwun Tong	537	93	544	94
Sham Shui Po	1 202	154	1 254	152
Wong Tai Sin	292	120	297	121
Yau Ysim Mong	1 564	430	1 530	425
Kowloon (Sub-total)	5 895	1 073	5 947	1 102
Islands	137	38	137	38
Kwai Tsing	443	142	442	158
North	968	157	958	157
Sai Kung	1 666	283	1 692	283
Sha Tin	1 435	270	1 434	268
Tai Po	1 420	196	1 435	198
Tsuen Wan	620	65	634	64
Tuen Mun	1 107	169	1 128	175
Yuen Long	944	285	942	284
New Territories (Sub-total)	8 740	1 605	8 802	1 625
Total	**17 185**	**3 026**	**17 313**	**3 070**

By comparing the total number of parking spaces in December 2025 with that in December 2024, the number of parking spaces in both Kowloon and New Territories recorded an increase of about 1%, while that on Hong Kong Island remained broadly unchanged.

Note 1: "General vehicle" refers to vehicles other than medium and heavy goods vehicles, buses, MCs and bicycles.
Note 2: "CV" refers to goods vehicles and buses.

Annex 2

Average utilisation rates of on-street metered parking spaces in 2024 and 2025 by District Council districts

District	2024		2025	
	Weekdays (%)	Weekends and holidays (%)	Weekdays (%)	Weekends and holidays (%)
Central and Western	93	86	91	84
Eastern	91	92	91	92
Southern	68	73	68	73
Wan Chai	90	89	89	88
Hong Kong Island (Sub-total)	88	85	87	85
Kowloon City	91	91	90	90
Kwun Tong	92	93	93	92
Sham Shui Po	94	93	93	94
Wong Tai Sin	94	93	92	92
Yau Ysim Mong	96	94	95	96
Kowloon (Sub-total)	93	94	93	92
Islands	75	73	74	74
Kwai Tsing	96	91	95	91
North	88	89	88	89
Sai Kung	75	70	75	69
Sha Tin	86	90	86	89
Tai Po	82	90	83	91
Tsuen Wan	90	92	88	93
Tuen Mun	84	92	83	94
Yuen Long	89	85	90	86
New Territories (Sub-total)	85	86	86	87
Total	**88**	**88**	**88**	**88**

Annex 3

Numbers, percentage changes and utilisation rates[Note 1] of on-street parking spaces for MCs in 2024 and 2025 by District Council districts

District	2024		2025	
	Number of parking spaces	Average utilisation rate on weekdays (%)	Number of parking spaces	Average utilisation rate on weekdays (%)
Central and Western	651	100	651	100
Eastern	807	100	826	100
Southern	447	100	461	99
Wan Chai	779	100	784	100
Hong Kong Island (Sub-total)	2 684	100	2 722	100
Kowloon City	1 002	100	1 025	100
Kwun Tong	921	100	998	100
Sham Shui Po	884	100	919	100
Wong Tai Sin	545	100	570	100
Yau Ysim Mong	1 319	100	1 349	100
Kowloon (Sub-total)	4 671	100	4 861	100
Islands	261	83	261	89
Kwai Tsing	772	100	898	100
North	424	100	389	100
Sai Kung	505	100	530	99
Sha Tin	602	100	649	100
Tai Po	280	100	301	100
Tsuen Wan	700	100	755	100
Tuen Mun	892	100	876	100
Yuen Long	636	100	624	100
New Territories (Sub-total)	5 072	98	5 283	99
Total	**12 427**	**99**	**12 866**	**99**

By comparing the total number of parking spaces in December 2025 with that in December 2024, the number of parking spaces on Hong Kong Island recorded an increase of about 1%, while that in both Kowloon and the New Territories recorded an increase of about 4%.

Note 1: As some users of on-street parking spaces for MCs do not park their MCs according to the parking space lines, the number of parked MCs may be higher than the number of available parking spaces. Hence, the utilisation rate is shown as 100% in the above table. Besides, the TD does not maintain the statistics on the utilistion rates of on-street parking spaces for MCs on weekends and holidays.

Annex 4

Numbers and utilisation rates of parking spaces at car parks operated by the TD in 2024 and 2025 by District Council districts [Note 1]

District	Car park	Number of parking spaces (except those for MCs) [Note 2]	Average utilisation rate (%) of parking spaces			
			From 10:00 am to 6:00 pm		From 6:00 pm to 10:00 am	
			2024	2025	2024	2025
Central and Western	Star Ferry	377	81	80	28	28
	City Hall	170	58	51	24	18
	Rumsey Street	829	62	60	33	34
	Kennedy Town	195	85	87	80	88
Wan Chai	Tin Hau	428	75	73	62	61
Eastern	Shau Kei Wan	385	76	74	75	74
Southern	Aberdeen	293	63	62	78	78
Wong Tai Sin	Sheung Fung Street	267	74	72	80	79
	Wong Tai Sin	25	36	33	39	44
Kwai Tsing	Kwai Fong	511	73	77	68	74
Tsuen Wan	Tsuen Wan	545	79	77	77	76

District	Car park	Number of MC parking spaces	Average utilisation rate (%) of parking spaces for MCs			
			From 10:00 am to 6:00 pm		From 6:00 pm to 10:00 am	
			2024	2025	2024	2025
Central and Western	Star Ferry	37	65	65	47	45
	City Hall	27	74	77	67	68
	Rumsey Street	164	83	74	75	68
	Kennedy Town	37	75	72	82	77
Wan Chai	Tin Hau	75	76	79	77	80
Eastern	Shau Kei Wan	72	72	71	78	78
Southern	Aberdeen	51	71	69	77	75
Wong Tai Sin	Sheung Fung Street	74	65	68	73	79
Kwai Tsing	Kwai Fong	93	75	80	71	78
Tsuen Wan	Tsuen Wan	34	69	69	68	67

The total number of parking spaces (except those for MCs) decreased by about 0.2% by comparing the number in December 2025 with that in December 2024.

Note 1: The TD does not maintain the statistics on the utilisation rates of parking spaces at car parks operated by the TD on weekends and holidays.

Note 2: The number of parking spaces at Wong Tai Sin Car Park is the number of parking spaces for coaches/goods vehicles (over 5.5 tonnes); and the numbers of parking spaces at the remaining 10 car parks are the numbers of parking spaces for PCs/van-type light goods vehicles.

Annex 5

Numbers, percentage changes and average utilisation rates of parking spaces at public car parks under the management of GPA from 2024 to January 2026

District	Car park	Numbers, percentage changes and average utilisation rates on weekdays, weekends and holidays of parking spaces (%)[Note 1]										
		2024			2025				2026[Note 2]			
		Number of parking spaces	Average utilisation rate on weekdays	Average utilisation rate on weekends and holidays	Number of parking spaces	Percentage change	Average utilisation rate on weekdays	Average utilisation rate on weekends and holidays	Number of parking spaces	Percentage change	Average utilisation rate on weekdays	Average utilisation rate on weekends and holidays
Central & Western	Queensway Government Offices	182	25%	26%	181	-1%	25%	25%	181	0%	- [Note 9]	- [Note 9]
Wan Chai	Wanchai Tower, Immigration Tower and Revenue Tower [Note 3]	Ceased operation from 15 March 2024	2%	10%	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Eastern	North Point Government Offices	95	5%	21%	95	0%	3%	15%	95	0%	4%	11%
	Chai Wan Municipal Services Building	45	26%	39%	45	0%	38%	55%	45	0%	- [Note 9]	- [Note 9]
Southern	No car park under GPA's management											
Yau Tsim Mong	West Kowloon Government Offices	50	21%	45%	50	0%	20%	41%	50	0%	20%	42%

District	Car park	Numbers, percentage changes and average utilisation rates on weekdays, weekends and holidays of parking spaces (%)[Note 1]										
		2024			2025				2026[(Note 2)]			
		Number of parking spaces	Average utilisation rate on weekdays	Average utilisation rate on weekends and holidays	Number of parking spaces	Percentage change	Average utilisation rate on weekdays	Average utilisation rate on weekends and holidays	Number of parking spaces	Percentage change	Average utilisation rate on weekdays	Average utilisation rate on weekends and holidays
Sham Shui Po	Cheung Sha Wan Government Offices	263	24%	59%	263	0%	24%	59%	263	0%	24%	61%
Kowloon City	Tokwawan Market and Government Offices	32	50%	65%	32	0%	70%	70%	32	0%	67%	64%
	Trade and Industry Tower (Note 4)	24	1%	2%	22	-8%	1%	1%	22	0%	0%	2%
Wong Tai Sin	No car park under GPA's management											
Kwun Tong	Shun Lee Disciplined Services Quarters	105	33%	46%	105	0%	40%	52%	105	0%	37%	56%
Tsuen Wan	No car park under GPA's management											
Tuen Mun	Tuen Mun Government Offices	42	6%	16%	42	0%	5%	14%	42	0%	7%	15%
Yuen Long	Yuen Long District Office Building	43	28%	32%	43	0%	20%	32%	43	0%	22%	33%

District	Car park	Numbers, percentage changes and average utilisation rates on weekdays, weekends and holidays of parking spaces (%)[Note 1]										
		2024			2025				2026[(Note 2)]			
		Number of parking spaces	Average utilisation rate on weekdays	Average utilisation rate on weekends and holidays	Number of parking spaces	Percentage change	Average utilisation rate on weekdays	Average utilisation rate on weekends and holidays	Number of parking spaces	Percentage change	Average utilisation rate on weekdays	Average utilisation rate on weekends and holidays
North	North District Government Offices	96	9%	57%	96	0%	9%	63%	96	0%	9%	66%
	Heung Yuen Wai Boundary Control Point	466	46%	51%	466	0%	50%	54%	466	0%	50%	54%
	Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park (Note 5)	326	19%		326	0%	54%		326	0%	70%	
Tai Po	Tai Po Government Offices	73	11%	76%	73	0%	13%	86%	73	0%	21%	89%
Sai Kung	Sai Kung Government Offices	70	8%	30%	70	0%	25%	25%	70	0%	- (Note 9)	- (Note 9)
	Tseung Kwan O Government Offices (Note 6)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	388	-	65%	
	Chinese Medicine Hospital of Hong Kong (Note 7)	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	146	-	75%	

District	Car park	Numbers, percentage changes and average utilisation rates on weekdays, weekends and holidays of parking spaces (%)[Note 1]										
		2024			2025				2026[(Note 2)]			
		Number of parking spaces	Average utilisation rate on weekdays	Average utilisation rate on weekends and holidays	Number of parking spaces	Percentage change	Average utilisation rate on weekdays	Average utilisation rate on weekends and holidays	Number of parking spaces	Percentage change	Average utilisation rate on weekdays	Average utilisation rate on weekends and holidays
Sha Tin	Sha Tin Government Offices	143	2%	35%	140	-2%	1%	17%	140	0%	1%	11%
	New Territories (Shatin) Forensic Medicine Centre	50	20%	21%	50	0%	22%	27%	50	0%	26%	27%
Kwai Tsing	No car park under GPA's management											
Islands	Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge Hong Kong Port [(Note 8)]	733	15%	31%	733	0%	13%	29%	-	-	-	-

Note 1: The contractors could only provide the average utilisation rates of hourly parking spaces but not the relevant data for the parking spaces as a whole (including monthly and hourly parking spaces).

Note 2: These are the average utilisation rates of parking spaces of the car parks during the operating hours in January 2026 provided by the contractors.

Note 3: The fee-charging public car park at Wanchai Tower, Immigration Tower and Revenue Tower ceased operation from 15 March 2024. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of PC parking spaces of the car park during the operating hours in January 2024.

Note 4: The fee-charging public car park at Trade and Industry Tower resumed operation on 25 April 2024. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of thr parking spaces during the operating hours from May 2024.

Note 5: Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park commenced operation in mid-November 2024. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours from December 2024.

Note 6: The car park at Tseung Kwan O Government Offices commenced operation in mid-December 2025. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours in January 2026.

Note 7: The car park at The Chinese Medicine Hospital of Hong Kong commenced operation in mid-December 2025. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours in January 2026.

Note 8: The lease of the fee-charging public car park at Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge Hong Kong Port has been managed by the Airport Authority Hong Kong since 16 July 2025. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours from Jaunary to June 2025.

Note 9: The contractors are unable to provide the average utilisation rates of parking spaces of the car parks concerned during the operating hours in Jaunary 2026 at the moment.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0288)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Transport Department (TD) is responsible for handling matters relating to vehicle licences and driving licences (DLs). In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. The TD expects that the target of conducting road test within 82 days upon application for light bus, bus, medium and heavy goods vehicle and articulated vehicle DL will be decreased to 95% in 2026, which is 5% lower than the actual percentage in 2024 and 2025. Although the Annual Transport Digest 2025 shows a year-on-year declining trend in the number of applicants for the private car (combined test) and light goods vehicle (combined test) since 2021, the service level target cannot be maintained. Has the TD reviewed the staff establishment in order to expedite the processing of the applications? What are the number of relevant staff and the expenditure?

2. In recent months, the number of applications for direct issue of Hong Kong DLs has increased after the launch of the online appointment booking system by the TD. Has the TD increased the manpower and expenditure to process these applications? If yes, what are the number of relevant staff and the expenditure? If no, what are the reasons?

3. The TD enhanced the taxi written test by updating the test content and adjusting the number of questions at the end of last year. What is the number of applicants?

4. Features like low-floor design and active safety systems are available in new taxi models but not in older models. Besides, public light buses registered before September 2023 are not installed with the Seat Belt Fastening Detection and Alert System. What are the numbers of relevant registered public vehicles (please provide breakdown by classification such as urban taxis, New Territories taxis, Lantau taxis, red minibuses and green minibuses)?

Asked by: Hon CHEUNG Pui-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 22)

Reply:

1. The Transport Department (TD) has, over the years, set the target waiting time for conducting road tests upon receipt of applications for light bus, bus, medium and heavy goods vehicle and articulated vehicle driving licences at 82 days, with a compliance rate of 95%. The actual compliance rate in respect of waiting time in 2024 and 2025 was 100%. The TD will continue to maintain the waiting time for road tests to be arranged in 2026 for the above-mentioned vehicles at 82 days with the compliance rate at 95%. The TD will continue to deploy resources flexibly to provide driving test services, with a view to meeting the demand for driving tests of various vehicle types and shortening the waiting time as far as possible.

   In 2026-27, the establishment of Driving Examiners I (DEsI) and Driving Examiners II (DEsII) in the TD will remain unchanged at 19 and 65 respectively, while the strength is expected to stand at 19 and 63 respectively. The annual staff cost (notional annual mid-point salary) of DEsI and DEsII will be about $12.87 million and $30.71 million respectively. The TD is preparing for a new recruitment exercise to ensure sufficient manpower for the grade of DEs in order to meet the demand.

2. The TD has been proactively conducting process re-engineering of licensing services through digitalisation of licensing services to enhance efficiency and the effective use of counter resources, while at the same time saving applicants the time of visiting the Licensing Offices for application processing in person. Among them, the TD has fully implemented the online appointment for counter services for applications for direct issue of Hong Kong Full Driving Licence (Direct Issue), with the appointment quota increased to 550 per working day starting from 16 March 2026 and the extension of the services to the four Licensing Offices across the territory at the same time, providing greater convenience to applicants and making better use of resources. The TD handles the above work with existing resources, including deployment of manpower saved from promoting digitisation of licensing services, to cope with the work arising from the increased appointment quota for Direct Issue.

3. The TD has further enhanced the taxi written test since 3 November 2025 by reducing the questions on locations and routes, and adding new questions related to enhancement of taxi service quality, with the aim of maintaining assessment standards while better aligning with the practical needs of the trade. As at 28 February 2026, the average monthly number of applicants increased from about 1 380 prior to the enhancement of the taxi written test to about 1 820 after the enhancement, representing an increase of about 30%. This shows that the measures effectively attract more people to apply for the taxi written test.

4. The numbers of barrier-free taxis accessible by wheelchairs and taxis equipped with active safety system were 6 289 and 852 respectively as at end-February 2026.

   Newly registered public light buses (PLBs) are required to be installed with a seat belt fastening detection and alert system starting from 1 September 2023 in accordance with the licensing conditions set out by the Commissioner for Transport under the Road Traffic (Registration and Licensing of Vehicles) Regulations (Cap. 374E). According to the TD's record, there were a total of 213 PLBs newly registered after September 2023

that were installed with a seat belt fastening detection and alert system as at end-February 2026.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0976)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services
(4) Management of Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Government has indicated that it will continue to monitor the implementation of time-varying tolls at the three road harbour crossings (RHCs). In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the respective numbers of trips made by and revenues generated from various vehicle types through the three RHCs in the past five years;

2. the total expenditures of the three RHCs in the past five years, with a breakdown of the specific amounts for each expenditure item;

3. whether the Government has completed a comprehensive, objective and independent assessment of the effectiveness of traffic diversion, changes in duration of congestion during peak hours, changes in average travelling cost of the public, associated impacts on the capacity of public transport, and changes in road safety conditions for the three RHCs since the implementation of rationalisation of traffic distribution among them; and

4. as some members of the public consider the uniform toll for commercial vehicles after the rationalisation of traffic distribution among the three RHCs unfair for light goods vehicles, substantially increasing their costs for crossing the harbour and affecting their livelihood; in this connection, whether the Government will consider reviewing the toll level and making adjustments; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons.

Asked by: Hon CHEUNG Pui-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 23)

Reply:

1. The average weekday daily traffic flows of the three road harbour crossings (RHCs), namely the Western Harbour Crossing (WHC), the Cross-Harbour Tunnel (CHT) and the Eastern Harbour Crossing (EHC), with a breakdown by vehicle type, in the past five years (i.e. 2021 to 2025) are set out at **Annex 1**.

The revenue of the three RHCs in the past five financial years is tabulated below:

RHC	Annual Revenue ($m)				
	2020-21	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24[2]	2024-25
CHT	642	639	653	867	1,073
EHC	709	737	728	762	777
WHC[1]	N/A	N/A	N/A	879	1,272

Note 1: The WHC was returned to government management on 2 August 2023. The figure for 2023-24 is for the period from 2 August 2023 to 31 March 2024.

Note 2: Upon the takeover of WHC on 2 August 2023, the Government implemented the 633 fixed toll plan at the three RHCs in the first stage, which was followed by the time-varying toll plan in the second stage at the three RHCs starting from 17 December 2023.

2. The operating expenditure of the three RHCs in the past five financial years is tabulated below:

RHC	Annual Operating Expenditure[2] ($m)				
	2020-21	2021-22	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25
CHT	143	154	158	199	196
EHC	165	177	179	228	240
WHC[1]	N/A	N/A	N/A	241	328

Note 1: The WHC was returned to government management on 2 August 2023. The figure for 2023-24 is for the period from 2 August 2023 to 31 March 2024.

Note 2: The expenditures set out in the table include the management fees paid to the management, operation and maintenance contractors, the relevant operating and maintenance expenditure for the implementation of HKeToll, depreciation charges of capital costs and expenditure on government maintenance works of the tunnels for the years concerned.

3. According to the traffic data for 2025, the daily traffic flows of the three RHCs as compared with December 2023 (before implementation of the new tolls) were as follows: the traffic flow of WHC increased by about 24% to 109 000 vehicles; the traffic flow of CHT decreased by 11% to about 94 000 vehicles; the traffic flow of EHC decreased by about 10% to 71 000 vehicles. After the implementation of the new tolls, the cross-harbour traffic flows on weekdays have remained relatively stable and the traffic has been more evenly distributed among the three RHCs, thereby making better use of each tunnel's capacity. In fact, the overall congestion at the three RHCs has been alleviated after the implementation of time-varying tolls. The traffic queues at the CHT and EHC during peak hours have generally reduced by about 1 km and 0.3 km respectively. During normal and off-peak time slots, which account for nearly 80% of the day, the traffic at the three RHCs (including CHT which used to be frequently

congested in the past) has been significantly smoother than before. The non-cross-harbour traffic near the tunnel portals has also improved significantly, thus reducing the impact on traffic near the Gascoigne Road and Kwun Tong Bypass. These diversion effects have a positive impact on the overall commuting experience of the public, as well as on transport and logistics and the operation of public transport services.

The Government will continue to monitor traffic conditions and observe the impact arising from the full commissioning of the Central Kowloon Bypass on the overall urban traffic in order to review the traffic situation and toll arrangement of the three RHCs more comprehensively and implement science-based traffic management measures in a timely manner, including consideration of toll adjustment to peak periods through the mechanism stipulated in the legislation.

4. Under the time-varying tolls, the Government has simplified the toll structure for different classes of commercial vehicles. Consistent with the principle of "efficiency first", the Government lowered tolls for goods vehicles to levels broadly comparable to those for private cars. This approach enabled goods vehicles with higher transport efficiency to benefit more significantly from the toll adjustments. For instance, the tolls for medium and heavy goods vehicles have decreased by 17% and 39% respectively, compared with the average tolls of the RHCs in the past.

At present, peak-hour cross-harbour traffic continues to exceed the combined capacity of the three RHCs. Given the lower operational expenses and more flexible operating mode of light goods vehicles / van-type light goods vehicles compared with other commercial vehicles, they tend to be relatively sensitive to price changes. Therefore, a reduction in tunnel tolls for light goods vehicles / van-type light goods vehicles may induce additional traffic and further increase the traffic burden on the RHCs. The Transport Department is continuing to monitor and review the traffic situation of the RHCs and the effectiveness of the tolls in managing traffic, and will report to the Legislative Council in a timely manner.

Annex 1

Average Weekday Daily Traffic Flows by Vehicle Type at the Three RHCs (in Two-way Vehicles)[1]

Year	WHC					
	Private car	**Motorcycle [2]**	**Taxi**	**Bus [3]**	**Light bus [4]**	**Goods vehicle**
2021	34 400	1 600	11 200	4 000	600	11 600
2022	27 900	1 400	10 100	3 600	400	10 500
2023	36 200	1 400	19 100	4 200	400	10 700
2024	51 300	2 100	22 700	5 700	500	20 200
2025	57 500	2 200	21 600	6 000	400	20 800

Notes:

1. Cross-harbour traffic flows on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays), before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays.
2. "Motorcycle" includes motor tricycles.
3. "Bus" includes public and private buses.
4. "Light bus" includes public and private light buses.

Annex 1

Average Weekday Daily Traffic Flows by Vehicle Type at the Three RHCs (in Two-way Vehicles)[1]

Year	CHT					
	Private car	**Motorcycle [2]**	**Taxi**	**Bus [3]**	**Light bus [4]**	**Goods vehicle**
2021	48 700	5 400	18 100	6 800	1 000	25 300
2022	46 600	4 800	17 800	6 000	800	24 800
2023	48 800	4 500	16 700	6 400	800	24 600
2024	53 600	3 900	17 200	5 400	600	14 100
2025	55 800	3 600	16 300	5 200	500	12 300

Notes:

1. Cross-harbour traffic flows on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays), before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays.
2. "Motorcycle" includes motor tricycles.
3. "Bus" includes public and private buses.
4. "Light bus" includes public and private light buses.

Annex 1

Average Weekday Daily Traffic Flows by Vehicle Type at the Three RHCs (in Two-way Vehicles)[1]

Year	EHC					
	Private car	**Motorcycle [2]**	**Taxi**	**Bus [3]**	**Light bus [4]**	**Goods vehicle**
2021	47 600	3 000	14 600	3 000	600	12 600
2022	41 500	2 600	13 700	2 700	500	11 400
2023	42 000	2 600	14 200	2 800	600	11 200
2024	40 800	2 700	12 800	3 100	600	12 000
2025	41 400	2 700	11 900	3 200	600	11 600

Notes:

1. Cross-harbour traffic flows on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays), before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays.
2. "Motorcycle" includes motor tricycles.
3. "Bus" includes public and private buses.
4. "Light bus" includes public and private light buses.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1116)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Management of Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The HKeToll, a free-flow tolling service, was launched in 2023. Late payment of tunnel tolls will incur surcharges and may affect vehicle licence renewal. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. Serious defaulters will be referred to the court and may face a maximum penalty of a fine of $5,000 per trip. What were the respective numbers of cases that were referred to the court in each of the past three years?

2. Among the outstanding payment cases with the highest cumulative outstanding amounts, what were the numbers of unpaid trips and the total amounts owed by the top ten HKeToll accounts with the highest outstanding amounts? Were these cases eventually settled?

3. What were the respective numbers of applications submitted for exemption from tunnel tolls in each of the past three years? Among these, what were the respective numbers of applications approved each year?

Asked by: Hon CHIK Kit-ling, Elaine (LegCo internal reference no.: 115)

Reply:

1-2. The Transport Department (TD) has, according to the established procedures, referred cases of outstanding tolls to the magistrate. The magistrate is progressively hearing cases of outstanding tolls and surcharges and issuing orders to the registered vehicle owners involved, demanding them to settle all outstanding amounts (including tolls, initial surcharge of $175 and further surcharge of $350) in respect of each case, as well as relevant penalty and costs. The numbers of cases of outstanding tolls that were referred to the court by the TD were about 8 800, 18 000, and 3 800 in 2024, 2025 and 2026 (up to February) respectively. As at February 2026, based on the amounts claimed from individual registered vehicle owners by the magistrate, the number of transactions claimed ranged from 90 to 220, with the total amounts involved ranging

from about $100,000 to $270,000 for the ten highest amounts claimed. Of these, one registered vehicle owner has settled in full the amounts claimed by the magistrate. As for the remaining nine cases in which the vehicle owners failed to settle all/ part of the outstanding amounts, the magistrate has issued warrants of distress, authorising the distress and sale of the property of the vehicle owners by bailiffs to recover the outstanding amounts unless the amounts claimed by the magistrate are settled in full.

3. In the past three years, the toll service provider (TSP) received around 40 000 applications for toll refund, of which 34 000 were accepted. The main reasons include suspected fraudulent use of licence plate numbers, illegible licence plate numbers or occasional duplicated payment due to unstable network connection of payment platforms. With TSP's continuous enhancement of the automatic licence plate recognition system, the strengthening of training for frontline staff on techniques to accurately identify licence plates, and requests for the replacement of illegible licence plates by individual vehicle owners, the number of cases for toll refund has been on a decrease. The number of cases for toll refund by year is tabulated below:

	Number of applications for toll refund (accounting for the traffic flow in the same period)	**Number of applications for toll refund accepted (accounting for the traffic flow in the same period)**
2023 (May to December)	15 000 (0.017%)	12 000 (0.014%)
2024	17 000 (0.008%)	15 000 (0.007%)
2025	8 000 (0.004%)	7 000 (0.003%)
Total	**40 000 (0.008%)**	**34 000 (0.006%)**

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1117)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Transport Department (TD) will serve a Notice of Advice of Driving-offence Points (the Notice), which has a detailed record of points incurred, on drivers who have accumulated 8 points or more for driving offences within any two-year period in order to remind them to improve their driving behaviour. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. in each of the past three years, the number of Notices served;

2. the cost of serving each Notice;

3. since the TD launched the e-Licensing Portal, an online licensing platform, in 2024, the total number of logins to the portal to access the records of driving offence points in the past year; and

4. whether, in order to save public funds and protect the environment, the Government will consider serving the Notice in electronic format so as to reduce or even eliminate the delivery of the Notice in paper form; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons?

Asked by: Hon CHIK Kit-ling, Elaine (LegCo internal reference no.117)

Reply:

1. Under the Driving-offence Points (DOP) System, if a driver incurs 8 points or more but less than 15 points within a two-year period, the Commissioner for Transport shall issue a Notice of Advice of Driving-offence Points (the Notice) to that driver pursuant to the Road Traffic (Driving-offence Points) Ordinance (Cap.375) (the Ordinance). The Notice sets out the driver's record of points incurred in respect of the scheduled offences committed within the two-year period, informs the driver of the consequences of incurring more points, and reminds the driver to improve his driving behavior. The TD issued 44 603, 39 424 and 38 547 Notices in 2023, 2024 and 2025 respectively.

2. The TD issues the Notices by ordinary post. In 2025, the postage cost for each Notice is $2.2. The manpower and other expenditure for the preparation and issuance of Notices are absorbed under the overall provision and establishment of TD, and cannot be separately identified.

3. As at 31 December 2025, there were about 160 000 registered users of e-Licensing Portal (e-LP), the one-stop online licensing platform. The TD does not have a breakdown of access to driving-offence point records via e-LP.

4. Members of the public may enquire via e-LP about their records of points incurred since its implementation. According to the Ordinance, the Notices issued by the TD shall be served personally, by post or by registered post, but not by electronic means. Nevertheless, the TD will review the relevant arrangements in a timely manner, having regard to the actual needs.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 Reply Serial No.

TLB198

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2427)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

All roads on South Lantau are closed roads, motorists who wish to access the closed roads are required to hold a valid Lantau Closed Road Permit (LCRP). In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the number of LCRPs approved in each of the past three years;

2. further to the above, the number of LCRPs approved under the Driving on Lantau Island Scheme in each of the past three years;

3. the number of prosecution cases against illegal driving on South Lantau without valid LCRPs in each of the past three years;

4. further to the above, the number of prosecution cases against illegal driving on South Lantau without valid LCRPs involving cross boundary vehicles entering Hong Kong in each year; and

5. currently, the Government mainly relies on enforcement actions or setting up of road blocks on Tung Chung Road by the Police to verify whether the vehicles possess valid LCRPs for driving on South Lantau; whether the Government has explored the use of smart technologies for identifying if a vehicle possesses valid LCRP for driving on South Lantau; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons.

Asked by: Hon CHIK Kit-ling, Elaine (LegCo internal reference no.: 114)

Reply:

1. - 2.

The numbers of LCRPs issued by the Transport Department (TD) and those issued under the Driving on Lantau Island Scheme in the past three years are tabulated below:

Year	2023	2024	2025
(a) No. of LCRPs issued [including (b)]	36 800	37 200	37 300
(b) No. of LCRPs issued under the Driving on Lantau Island Scheme	12 500	12 200	12 400

3. - 4.

The Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF) does not maintain prosecution figures on illegal driving on South Lantau without valid LCRPs or those cases involving cross boundary vehicles entering Hong Kong in the past three years.

5. To strengthen the monitoring of traffic control over closed roads on Lantau Island, the Civil Engineering and Development Department, the TD and the HKPF commissioned the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department to conduct a proof-of-concept study on the application of technology for identifying vehicles without valid LCRPs entering the Lantau closed roads. The on-site devices were installed, and site trials were completed in September 2024. Law enforcement departments are currently upgrading and integrating the relevant law enforcement system, with a target to commission the system in mid-2026.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3211)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

When approaching a tram stop without traffic island, vehicles must stop behind the yellow line in accordance with the legislation to give way to passengers boarding and alighting from a tram. However, there are occasionally drivers, particularly those from outside Hong Kong Island, who do not pay attention and cause danger. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the number of traffic accidents involving trams in each of the past three years;

2. the number of prosecutions against vehicles which fail to stop at a suitable place at a tram stop without traffic island in each of the past three years;

3. as the Transport Department has earlier on carried out improvement works at tram stops without traffic islands by painting the relevant road surface in red and adding road marking "Beware of Passengers"; the locations of improvement works completed or in progress and the relevant expenditure; and

4. apart from the above-mentioned improvement works, whether the Government will consider installing light signals or applying smart technologies to further enhance the safety of passengers boarding and alighting at tram stops without traffic islands.

Asked by: Hon CHIK Kit-ling, Elaine (LegCo internal reference no.: 116)

Reply:

1. According to records, the number of traffic accidents involving trams from year 2023 to 2025 is tabulated below:

Year	Number of traffic accidents
2023	37
2024	35
2025*	41

* Provisional figures

2. The Hong Kong Police Force does not maintain the statistics on the number of prosecutions against vehicles which fail to stop at a suitable place at the tram stop without traffic island.

3. The Highways Department has completed improvement works at seven tram stops without traffic islands. Their locations are tabulated below:

	Location	**Tram Stop Number**
1	Queen's Road West	96W
2	Kennedy Town Praya	98W
3	Wong Nai Chung Road	108
4	Hong Kong Cemetery	109
5	Nam Kong Street	99E
6	Chai Wan Road	101E
7	Shau Kei Wan Terminus (near 134 Shau Kei Wan Main Street East)	-

The improvement works concerned include painting the relevant road surface in red and adding road marking "Beware of Passengers". The total expenditure for the works is about HK$380,000.

4. The Hong Kong Tramways Limited has completed a research titled "Advanced Intelligent Control Management and AI Optimisation Project for Hong Kong Tramway" to develop and implement an intelligent control management system for tramway based on Radio Frequency Identification (RFID) system and AI Optimizer, with a geo-fencing program to remind drivers to pay attention to the driving speed. Among them, the geo-fencing adopts the RFID technology, in-vehicle units and roadside equipment to enable positioning. When a tram approaches a pre-set location and potential speeding is detected, the system will automatically alert the driver to pay attention to the driving speed, thereby effectively enhancing overall driving safety. At present, the relevant system has been applied to daily operation of the Hong Kong Tramways to enhance management efficiency and achieve intelligent deployment.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1407)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding fostering a pedestrian-friendly environment and promoting "Walk in HK", will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) the detailed information on implemented walkability enhancement measures at each selected area in the past three years, including for each project the title/location, brief description (e.g. Provision of cover to walkway, Pedestrian wayfinding signage system, etc.), duration of works and expenditure;

(2) regarding the follow-ups on the hillside escalator links and elevator systems proposals, the proposed project locations, estimated commencement dates of the works, and preliminary estimates of project costs?

Asked by: Hon CHIU Duncan (LegCo internal reference no.37)

Reply:

(1) The provision of cover to walkway and the pedestrian wayfinding signage system projects completed in various districts in the past three years are tabulated below:

(a) The provision of cover to walkway

District	Alignment of cover	Project cost[1] ($million)	Project commencement date	Completion date
Sham Shui Po	Walkway along Woh Chai Street between MTR Shek Kip Mei Station Exit A and Mei Leong House of Shek Kip Mei Estate	17.3	2020	2023

District	Alignment of cover	Project cost[1] ($million)	Project commencement date	Completion date
Sha Tin	Walkway along Lok King Street between MTR Fo Tan Station Exit A and Ficus Garden	23.0	2021	2023
Southern	Walkway along Pok Fu Lam Road northbound (connecting the cover completed under the first phase to the bus stop)	2.0	2022	2023
Tai Po	Walkway along Nam Wan Road between Plover Cove Road and MTR Tai Po Market Station	35.7	2021	2024
Tsuen Wan	Walkway between Tsuen Wan West Station and Hoi On Road	47.4	2022	2024
Kowloon City	Walkway cover near Hong Kong Children's Hospital	11.1	2022	2024
Kowloon City	Walkway cover near Hong Kong Eye Hospital	17.3	2023	2025

Note 1: Figure shown in money-of-the-day (MOD) prices.

(b) Pedestrian wayfinding signage system

District	Project cost[2] ($million)	Project commencement date	Completion date
Sham Shui Po, Central, Wan Chai and Causeway Bay	3.7	2022	2024

Note 2: Figure shown in money-of-the-day (MOD) prices.

(2) The implementation progress of the hillside escalator links and elevator systems (HEL) projects is set out below:

(i) Projects currently under planning and design

District	Project title / Proposed alignment	Implementation progress
Central & Western	From Smithfield along Pokfield Path to Pokfield Road	Currently under advance work for the preliminary technical feasibility studies
Southern	From Yue Fai Road to Yue Kwong Road	
Wong Tai Sin	Pedestrian Link near Chuk Yuen North Estate	Currently under investigation and design
Kwun Tong	Lift and Pedestrian Walkway System at Kung Lok Road	
Sai Kung	Pedestrian Link between Po Lam Road North and Po Hong Road, Tseung Kwan O	
Wanchai	From Wood Road to Queen's Road East near St. Joseph's Primary School	
Eastern	From Sai Wan Ho Street to Holy Cross Church	
	From Healthy Street East to Pak Fuk Road	
Sham Shui Po	From Ching Cheung Road footbridge near Mei Foo MTR Station to Lai King Hill Road near Ching Lai Commercial Centre	
Sha Tin	Escalator Link System between Sha Tin Sui Wo Court and MTR Fo Tan Station	
	From the footway near Greenview Garden to Sha Tin Tau Road	
Tsuen Wan	From Kwok Shui Road Park to Kwok Shui Road	
Kwai Tsing	From Shek Yam Road near Kam Shek Building to Tai Pak Tin Street	

As the aforesaid projects are still at the planning and design stage, the relevant estimated project costs have yet to be confirmed.

(ii) Projects currently at the tendering stage or under construction

District	**Project title / Proposed alignment**	**Approved project estimate**[3] ($ million)	**Project commencement date**	**Anticipated completion date**
Wan Chai	Lift and Pedestrian Walkway System between Lau Sin Street and Tin Hau Temple Road	Projects are currently at the tendering stage. Project costs have yet to be confirmed.	Second quarter of 2026[4]	First quarter of 2029
Kwai Tsing	Lift and Pedestrian Walkway System between Lai King Hill Road and Lai Cho Road		Third quarter of 2026[4]	Third quarter of 2029
	Escalator Link System between Wah Sing Street and Castle Peak Road – Kwai Chung		Second quarter of 2026[4]	First quarter of 2029
Eastern	Braemar Hill Pedestrian Link	682.6	August 2021	will be completed in phases from mid-2026
Kwai Tsing	Pedestrian Walkway System between Hing Shing Road and Tai Wo Hau Road	192.5	July 2023	Third quarter of 2026

Note 3: Figure shown in money-of-the-day (MOD) prices.
Note 4: Anticipated commencement date.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1291)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

In 2026-27, the Transport and Logistics Bureau will introduce legislative amendments for the wearing of helmets by cyclists. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(a) please set out in table form (i) the number of traffic accidents involving bicycles, (ii) numbers of injuries and fatalities, (iii) number and proportion of head injuries, and (iv) number of injured persons wearing or not wearing helmet at the time of the accident in the past three years; and

(b) (i) the estimated expenditure on publicity work, (ii) estimated administrative costs, (iii) estimated number of enforcement staff and (iv) estimated staff costs for enforcement staff for this new legislation.

Asked by: Hon CHONG Ho-fung (LegCo internal reference no.: 23)

Reply:

(a) According to records, the numbers of traffic accidents involving bicycles and the number of cyclist casualties from 2023 to 2025 are tabulated as follows:

	2023	**2024**	**2025***
Number of traffic accidents	1980	1879	2098
Number of fatalities	6	9	9
Number of seriously injured	93	59	31
Number of slightly injured	1740	1623	1860
Number of persons and the percentage of sustaining head injuries (Note 1)	719 (39%)	666 (39%)	597 (31%)
Number of persons not wearing helmets (Note 2)	844	577	1084

Note:
* Provisional figures
(1) Figures in brackets represent the percentage of persons sustaining head injuries among all casualties.
(2) Figures represent the number of cyclist casualties not wearing a helmet among casualties, irrespective of whether they sustained head injuries.

(b) Studies indicate that helmets can provide effective protection for cyclists and reduce the chance of their sustaining head injury in a traffic accident. Furthermore, information shows that nearly 60 per cent of cyclists killed or seriously injured in traffic accidents in the past five years were not wearing helmets. The Government is carefully studying the statutory requirement for cyclists to wear helmets, and will listen to the views of the stakeholders with a view to forging consensus and proposing legislative amendments in a timely manner, while considering publicity, enforcement arrangements and necessary expenditures.

While the Government is examining the issue, the Transport Department (TD) will continue working closely with the Hong Kong Police Force and the Road Safety Council to enhance cyclists' understanding of the relevant laws and rules through multiple channels, including Announcements of Public Interests on television, radio broadcasts, the "Cycling Information Centre" website, and other promotional publications. The Road Users' Code (the Code) also provides the public with essential information on road safety, legal requirements, and related offenses when using bicycles. The Code also encourages them to use personal protective gear (including bicycle helmets, etc.), and promotes mutual respect among road users. These tasks are undertaken by existing staff of TD as part of their established duties and therefore no separate breakdown of resources involved.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1295)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is the duty of the Transport Department to plan and develop ride-hailing services, as well as formulate regulatory measures for the services and plan their related facilities. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(a) whether the Government will consider setting the quota at not less than 10 000; if yes, the details; if not, the reasons;

(b) whether the Government will consider requesting the ride-hailing platforms to introduce facial recognition technology or other biometric authentication; if yes, the details; if not, the reasons; and

(c) regarding the "one-vehicle-one-driver" rule, whether the Government has assessed the effect of such rule on the vehicle efficiency and drivers' family income; if yes, the details; if not, the reasons.

Asked by: Hon CHONG Ho-fung (LegCo internal reference no.: 27)

Reply:

The Road Traffic (Amendment) (Ride-hailing Service) Bill 2025 was passed by the Legislative Council in October 2025. It stipulates a legal framework and key principles for regulating ride-hailing service, including the requirements for platforms, vehicles and drivers providing ride-hailing services to obtain licences or permits and to comply with the conditions of the relevant licences or permits, as well as the Government's imposition of control on the total number of ride-hailing vehicles.

Moreover, regarding the platforms, platforms holding ride-hailing service licences are responsible for conducting due diligence on their vehicles and drivers to ensure that the passenger transport services provided are in compliance with local legislation, with a view to safeguarding public safety and rights. As for vehicles and drivers, only private cars registered in the name of an individual may apply for ride-hailing vehicle permits (vehicle permits), and such vehicles can only be driven by their registered owners when providing

ride-hailing passenger transport services in the future. This requirement aims to prevent the emergence of a rental market and speculation of vehicle permits, thereby ensuring the quality of ride-hailing services.

The Government is now actively advancing the next stage of work and will continue to communicate with various stakeholders, with a view to finalising the technical details for regulating ride-hailing services, including the operation modes of platforms, vehicles and drivers (for instance, whether the platform can apply facial recognition or other biometric authentication to ensure that the ride-hailing vehicle drivers hold valid permits), the hardware facilities and the number of vehicle permits, and to incorporating them into the subsidiary legislation or conditions of licence or permit as appropriate. In considering the number of vehicle permits, the Government will balance various factors, including the travel needs and experiences of the public, the carrying capacity of the road network, the ecosystem of the public transport system, as well as the health and sustainable development of the overall personalised point-to-point transport service industry. The Government plans to submit the relevant subsidiary legislation to the Legislative Council for scrutiny in the first half of 2026.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1296)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

In 2026-27, the Transport Department (TD) will continue to follow up on the legislative amendment proposals to regulate the use of electric mobility devices (EMDs) with a view to providing a proper regulatory arrangement for EMDs. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(a) whether the TD will consider mandatorily requiring individual users or sharing enterprises providing rental services to take out Third Party Liability Insurance to protect pedestrian safety and provide accident compensation; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons;

(b) whether an assessment has been made of the safety risks to the users and pedestrians posed by EMDs; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons;

(c) as the Government carried out a trial scheme on the shared use of power assisted pedal cycles in Pak Shek Kok in 2023, what are the current findings; and

(d) whether an assessment has been made of the feasibility of popularising the operation of shared mode in Hong Kong; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons;

Asked by: Hon CHONG Ho-fung (LegCo internal reference no.: 29)

Reply:

(a) & (b)

As EMDs are mechanically propelled, they fall within the current definition of "motor vehicles" under the Road Traffic Ordinance (Cap. 374). As such, the use of unregistered or unlicensed EMDs may contravene the relevant laws.

Having said that, the Government has always been open-minded on new technologies that promote green commuting whilst attaching great importance to road safety. We also note that EMDs are becoming increasingly popular around the world. Therefore, we plan to introduce a regulatory framework and a legislative bill for EMDs this year,

stipulating the technical and safety requirements for such devices, so as to enable their safe use within designated areas. To ensure the product quality and safety of EMDs, the TD and the Hong Kong Productivity Council are devising a product certification arrangement, having regard to the experience in various regions, as the core of the regulatory framework.

Under the proposed certification arrangement, compliant EMDs would operate in a manner similar to bicycles in many respects, and their associated risks are therefore expected to be comparable. Given that third-party insurance is not currently required for the use of bicycles, and most of other jurisdictions do not set third-party insurance as a mandatory requirement for the use of EMDs, we have no plans to impose such a requirement.

(c) & (d)

The TD has conducted site trials of EMDs on the cycle tracks in Tseung Kwan O South and those adjacent to the Hong Kong Science Park. In particular, the TD carried out a trial scheme for shared use of power-assisted pedal cycles in Pak Shek Kok from 2023 to 2024. The operation of the trial scheme was generally smooth, with findings indicating that suitable ancillary facilities and arrangements (e.g. battery facilities and charging frequency) will be required for the operation of shared arrangement. The TD is studying the relevant experience and will keep in view the actual usage of EMDs following the implementation of the proposed legislation, with a view to examining the feasibility and regulatory arrangements for the shared use of EMDs.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2424)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is the duty of the Transport Department to monitor existing railway services, assess the impact of new railways on other public transport modes and maintain a co-ordinated network of public transport services along rail corridors. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following in the past three years:

(a) please set out in tabular form the maximum carrying capacity of each MTR line for both the heavy rail and the Light Rail (loading at four persons (standing) per square metre (ppsm));

(b) please set out in tabular form the patronage of each MTR line for both the heavy rail and the Light Rail (loading at four ppsm);

(c) please set out in tabular form the patronage of each MTR line during peak hours for both the heavy rail and the Light Rail (loading at four ppsm);

(d) please set out in tabular form the latest loading per hour per direction during morning peak hours for critical links of the MTR lines for both the heavy rail and the Light Rail (loading at four ppsm);

(e) please set out in tabular form the numbers of maintenance staff, on establishment and supernumerary, of each MTR line for both the heavy rail and the Light Rail;

(f) please set out in tabular form the numbers of trains and cars of each MTR line for both the heavy rail and the Light Rail;

(g) the nature and numbers of MTR incidents lasting 30 minutes or less, 31 minutes to one hour, more than one hour but less than or equal to two hours, more than two hours but less than or equal to three hours, more than three hours but less than or equal to four hours and more than four hours (if applicable); and

(h) please set out in tabular form the number of signalling failure in MTR in each year and the respective numbers of failure stemming from hardware and software problems.

Asked by: Hon CHONG Ho-fung (LegCo internal reference no.: 20)

Reply:

(a) to (d)

The carrying capacities, patronage and loading during the busiest one hour in the morning per direction for critical links, and critical links of various heavy rail lines and Light Rail routes in the past three years are set out respectively at **Annexes 1 and 2**.

(e) The staff establishment for system maintenance of the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) for the heavy rail and light rail systems in the past three years (as at 31 December of each year) are 5 839 (2023), 6 261 (2024) and 6 356 (2025) respectively.

The MTRCL has adopted various arrangements to fill staff vacancies, including arranging term labour to assist in maintenance work under the supervision of MTR staff. The actual numbers of term labour engaged in the past three years (as at 31 December of each year) are 432 (2023), 424 (2024) and 433 (2025) respectively.

(f) The numbers of trains and cars for heavy rail and light rail in the past three years are set out at **Annex 3**.

(g) The numbers of incidents which caused service disruption due to factors under the MTRCL's control, the causes and the amounts set aside under the enhanced Service Performance Rebate for the incidents in the past three years are set out at **Annex 4**.

(h) According to the existing railway incident reporting mechanism, the MTRCL is required to notify the Transport Department (TD) of any railway incident which has caused train service disruption of eight minutes or is expected to cause disruption of eight minutes or more. If the incident is caused by factors under the control of the MTRCL, it should also be categorised as either equipment failure (covering signalling system failure) or human factor. The TD has not maintained a further breakdown of the incidents caused by equipment failures and therefore cannot provide statistics on the breakdown of service disruption caused by signalling system failures.

Annex 1

Statistics for the Heavy Rail System
(the busiest one hour in the morning per direction for critical links)

		East Rail Line	Tuen Ma Line	Tseung Kwan O Line	Island Line	South Island Line	Kwun Tong Line	Tsuen Wan Line	Disneyland Resort Line	Tracks sharing at some sections	
										Tung Chung Line (Note 1)	Airport Express (Notes 1 and 2)
2023											
1.	Maximum carrying capacity when train frequency is maximised (6 persons (standing) per square metre (ppsm)) (a) (Note 3)	82 500	70 000	67 600	80 000	27 000	71 400	75 000	9 600	45 000	4 800
2.	Carrying capacity (6 ppsm) (b)	62 500	58 800	67 600	80 000	16 800	71 400	75 000	8 300	42 500	4 200
3.	Difference between (a) and (b) (Note 4)	20 000	11 200	0	0	10 200	0	0	1 300	2 500	600
4.	Patronage (c)	42 400	35 700	40 400	46 300	9 800	34 500	38 800	3 200	21 200	1 700

		East Rail Line	Tuen Ma Line	Tseung Kwan O Line	Island Line	South Island Line	Kwun Tong Line	Tsuen Wan Line	Disneyland Resort Line	Tracks sharing at some sections	
										Tung Chung Line (Note 1)	Airport Express (Notes 1 and 2)
5.	Loading (6 ppsm) [(c)/(b)] { } critical link	68% {Tai Wai to Kowloon Tong}	61% {Tsuen Wan West to Mei Foo}	60% {Yau Tong to Quarry Bay}	58% {Tin Hau to Causeway Bay}	58% {Admiralty to Ocean Park}	48% {Choi Hung to Kowloon Bay}	52% {Sham Shui Po to Prince Edward}	39% {Sunny Bay to Disneyland Resort}	50% {Olympic to Kowloon}	40% {Tsing Yi to Airport}
6.	Loading (4 ppsm) (Note 5)	94%	85%	84%	81%	82%	68%	73%	54%	70%	N/A
7.	Monthly average patronage (million)	23.7	23.9	9.8	25.7	2.2	18.2	27.7	0.5	6.5	0.9
8.	Total patronage (million)	283.6	280.3	114.8	311.0	25.8	215.1	344.6	5.8	77.1	10.8
2024											
1.	Maximum carrying capacity when train frequency is maximised (6 ppsm) (a) (Note 3)	82 500	70 000	67 600	80 000	27 000	71 400	75 000	9 600	45 000	4 800
2.	Carrying capacity (6 ppsm) (b)	62 500	58 800	67 600	80 000	16 800	71 400	75 000	8 600	42 500	4 200

		East Rail Line	Tuen Ma Line	Tseung Kwan O Line	Island Line	South Island Line	Kwun Tong Line	Tsuen Wan Line	Disneyland Resort Line	Tracks sharing at some sections	
										Tung Chung Line (Note 1)	Airport Express (Notes 1 and 2)
3.	Difference between (a) and (b) (Note 4)	20 000	11 200	0	0	10 200	0	0	1 000	2 500	600
4.	Patronage (c)	42 800	36 200	38 400	44 100	9 900	34 200	38 400	2 800	20 900	2 000
5.	Loading (6 ppsm) [(c)/(b)] { } critical link	68% {Tai Wai to Kowloon Tong}	62% {Tsuen Wan West to Mei Foo}	57% {Yau Tong to Quarry Bay}	55% {Tin Hau to Causeway Bay}	59% {Admiralty to Ocean Park}	48% {Choi Hung to Kowloon Bay}	51% {Sham Shui Po to Prince Edward}	33% {Sunny Bay to Disneyland Resort}	49% {Olympic to Kowloon}	48% {Tsing Yi to Airport}
6.	Loading (4 ppsm) (Note 5)	94%	86%	80%	77%	83%	67%	72%	46%	69%	N/A
7.	Monthly average patronage (million)	25.9	24.7	9.8	25.9	2.4	18.2	27.7	0.5	6.5	1.1
8.	Total patronage (million)	310.3	296.9	118.0	311.4	29.0	218.1	332.1	6.4	77.8	13.1
2025											
1.	Maximum carrying capacity when train frequency is maximised (6 ppsm) (a)	82 500	70 000	67 600	80 000	27 000	71 400	75 000	9 600	45 000	4 800

		East Rail Line	Tuen Ma Line	Tseung Kwan O Line	Island Line	South Island Line	Kwun Tong Line	Tsuen Wan Line	Disneyland Resort Line	Tracks sharing at some sections	
										Tung Chung Line (Note 1)	Airport Express (Notes 1 and 2)
	(Note 3)										
2.	Carrying capacity (6 ppsm) (b)	62 500	58 800	67 600	80 000	16 800	71 400	70 100	8 600	42 500	4 200
3.	Difference between (a) and (b) (Note 4)	20 000	11 200	0	0	10 200	0	4 900	1 000	2 500	600
4.	Patronage (c)	44 400	38 400	38 700	43 900	10 100	33 800	38 400	3 000	22 200	1 900
5.	Loading (6 ppsm) [(c)/(b)] { } critical link	71% {Tai Wai to Kowloon Tong}	65% {Tsuen Wan West to Mei Foo}	57% {Yau Tong to Quarry Bay}	55% {Tin Hau to Causeway Bay}	60% {Admiralty to Ocean Park}	47% {Choi Hung to Kowloon Bay}	55% {Sham Shui Po to Prince Edward}	35% {Sunny Bay to Disneyland Resort}	52% {Olympic to Kowloon}	45% {Tsing Yi to Airport}
6.	Loading (4 ppsm) (Note 5)	98%	92%	80%	77%	84%	66%	77%	49%	73%	N/A
7.	Monthly average patronage (million)	26.3	25.4	9.8	25.8	2.5	17.9	27.2	0.5	6.4	1.1
8.	Total patronage (million)	315.7	304.2	117.7	309.9	29.6	214.6	326.4	6.2	76.8	13.3

Note 1: As Airport Express and Tung Chung Line share tracks at some sections, the overall capacity of the railway lines are affected by the train service pattern.

Note 2: The design of Airport Express is based on seat provision where the passenger density level in terms of the number of standees does not apply. The figures are calculated based on existing carrying capacity.

Note 3: All train compartments of the existing MTR lines are designed based on the industry standard design adopted at the time of the construction of railway lines, which can accommodate a passenger density of six ppsm. In actual operation, as passengers are less willing to board a train that looks crowded even when there is still room available, trains only achieve a passenger density of only around four ppsm. Therefore, the TD provides the carrying capacity of six ppsm to reflect the maximum level of train capacity, as well as the loading of four ppsm to reflect the situation in actual operation.

Note 4: This is because the service frequency has not yet been increased to the maximum level the signalling system permits.

Note 5: For a typical heavy rail train operating in the urban area, there are 340 seats and 2 160 standees under a passenger density level of six ppsm, adding up to a total carrying capacity of about 2 500 per train. Under a passenger density level of four ppsm, the 340 number of seats will remain unchanged while the number of standees will be reduced to 1 440, adding up to a total carrying capacity of about 1 780 per train. Hence, the carrying capacity under a passenger density level of four ppsm is 71.2% of that of six ppsm. For the East Rail Line, the proportion of seats and standees is slightly different from that of other heavy rail trains as it has a First Class compartment. The capacity of trains is 2 845 and 2 061 respectively for six and four ppsm.

Annex 2

Statistics for the Light Rail System
(the busiest one hour in the morning per direction for critical links)

Light Rail route	Maximum carrying capacity			Passenger loading (Note 1)		
	2023	2024	2025	2023	2024	2025
505	2 993	2 993	2 993	66%	79%	82%
506P(Note 2)	424	424	424	70%	45%	70%
507	2 827	2 827	2 625	83%	85%	86%
507P	212	212	212	90%	90%	50%
610	2 056	2 056	2 056	93%	93%	84%
614	1 122	1 122	1 156	77%(Note 3)	77%(Note 3)	90%(Note 3)
614P	1 363	1 363	1 368			
615	960	960	960	74%(Note 3)	87%(Note 3)	75%(Note 3)
615P	1 600	1 600	1 600			
705	4 240	4 240	4 240	63%	82%	72%
706	5 088	5 088	5 088	63%	80%	82%
720(Note 2)	N/A	212	212	N/A	20%	10%
751	2 993	2 993	2 857	64%	81%	85%
751P	398	398	424	60%	80%	95%
761P	4 240	4 240	4 240	64%	86%	76%

Patronage (million)

	2023	2024	2025
Monthly average patronage	12.5	12.9	12.9
Total patronage	150.0	154.6	154.4

Note 1: Light Rail is an open system where there are a number of routes passing through a single Light Rail stop. One cannot work out the exact loading or patronage of individual Light Rail routes by projecting the route chosen by passengers based on their entry/exit records, which is the methodology currently adopted in assessing the loading of heavy rail lines. The MTRCL currently assesses

the loading of Light Rail Vehicles by on-site observations and surveys. The passenger density standard of four or six ppsm adopted in the calculation of heavy rail loading is not applicable.

Note 2: The MTRCL introduced Routes 506P and 720 in September 2023 and September 2024 respectively to run in the morning peak hours.

Note 3: The figures show the average loading of Route 614/614P and Route 615/615P. Within the Tuen Mun District, the alignments of Routes 614 and 614P overlap completely, same for Routes 615 and 615P. However, Routes 614P and 615P only operate between Tuen Mun Ferry Pier and Siu Hong Station, while Routes 614 and 615 provide cross-district services to Yuen Long after serving Siu Hong Station. The busiest sections of these two routes are normally located along the overlapping sections in Tuen Mun District. For passengers travelling within Tuen Mun District, it makes no difference to take Route 614 or 614P, or to take Route 615 or 615P. Therefore, using average loading of the Light Rail routes can more accurately reflect the actual situation.

Annex 3

The Numbers of Trains and Cars for Heavy Rail and Light Rail

As at December of the year	2023		2024		2025	
	Trains	**Cars per train**	**Trains**	**Cars per train**	**Trains**	**Cars per train**
East Rail Line	37	9	37	9	37	9
Tuen Ma Line	65	8	65	8	65	8
Tseung Kwan O Line	16	8	16	8	17	8
Island Line	36	8	36	8	38	8
South Island Line	10	3	10	3	10	3
Kwun Tong Line	39	8	39	8	39	8
Tsuen Wan Line	35	8	35	8	34	8
Disneyland Resort Line	3	4	3	4	3	4
Tung Chung Line	16	8	16	8	16	8
Airport Express	11	8	11	8	11	8

Light rail system is operated by single-set or coupled-set Light Rail Vehicles, the latter of which is formed by two cars. The total number of light rail cars stood at 149 in 2023, 2024 and 2025.

Annex 4

Numbers of Incidents which Caused Service Disruption of Eight Minutes or Above due to Factors under the MTRCL's Control

Year	Number of incidents	Cause		Duration of disruption							
				Half an hour or less (Note 1)		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours	
		Equipment failure (Note 2)	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors
2023	101	94	7	86	5	8	1	0	0	0	1
2024	89	82	7	77	7	5	0	0	0	0	0
2025	83	76	7	67	7	8	0	0	0	1	0

Note 1: According to the existing railway incident reporting mechanism, the MTRCL is required to notify the TD within eight minutes of any railway incident which has caused train service disruption of eight minutes or is expected to cause disruption of eight minutes or more. For service disruption of less than eight minutes, the impact on passengers is comparatively minimal and the MTRCL is not required to notify the TD. Hence, the TD does not have the number of incidents with service disruption of less than eight minutes.

Note 2: Equipment failure includes failure in station equipment, infrastructure (e.g. signalling system), rolling stock, etc.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2425)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Management of Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

One of the aims of the Transport Department is to ensure the efficient management of services in respect of government tunnels and bridges. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following information on various government road tunnels, major suspension bridges and trunk roads:

(a) their respective annual operating expenditure in the past five years;

(b) the respective ratios of vehicular flow/design capacity during peak hours and non-peak hours in the past five years;

(c) the charging criteria of the Government when considering the adjustment or charging of tolls in future.

Asked by: Hon CHONG Ho-fung (LegCo internal reference no.21)

Reply:

(a) The expenditures of various government road tunnels and control areas in the past five financial years are set out at **Annex 1**.

(b) The peak-hour and non-peak hour utilisation rates (measured by ratios of traffic volume/design capacity) of various government road tunnels in the past five years (i.e. 2021-2025) are set out at **Annex 2**. Regarding the statistics on the government strategic routes and bridges, as the Annual Traffic Census 2025 is still under compilation, the traffic volume statistics from 2020 to 2024 are set out at **Annex 3**.

(c) In determining the tolls for tunnels and trunk roads, the Government will adhere to four major principles, namely traffic management needs, efficiency first, public transport first and "user pays", and will also carefully weigh factors such as public affordability and the prevailing social circumstances. At the same time, we will consider the specific circumstances of each tunnel and trunk road, such as geographical location, target users, traffic management needs, and strike a balance among the principles to

formulate appropriate tolls that reflect prevailing circumstances and are tailored to local conditions.

Annex 1

Operating Expenditures of Government Road Tunnels and Control Areas from 2020-21 to 2024-25

Tolled tunnel/ control area [1,4]	2020-21 ($ million)	2021-22 ($ million)	2022-23 ($ million)	2023-24 ($ million)	2024-25 ($ million)
Cross Harbour Tunnel	143	154	158	199	196
Eastern Harbour Crossing	165	177	179	228	240
Western Harbour Crossing [2]	N/A	N/A	N/A	241	328
Tate's Cairn Tunnel	142	144	143	167	175
Aberdeen Tunnel	95	97	97	125	134
Lion Rock Tunnel	74	76	91	136	121
Shing Mun Tunnels	109	114	125	152	135
Route 8	330	320	342	391	372
Tai Lam Tunnel [3]	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A

Note 1: The expenditures set out in the table include the management fees paid to the management, operation and maintenance contractors, the relevant operating and maintenance expenditure for the implementation of HKeToll, depreciation charge of capital costs and expenditure on government maintenance works of the tunnels for the years concerned.

Note 2: The Western Harbour Crossing was returned to government management on 2 August 2023. The figure for 2023-24 is for the period from 2 August 2023 to 31 March 2024.

Note 3: The Tai Lam Tunnel was returned to government management on 31 May 2025.

Note 4: The Central Kowloon Bypass (CKB) (Yau Ma Tei Section) commenced operation on 21 December 2025. An all-day fixed toll of $8 for all vehicle types will be charged upon the full commissioning of the Central Kowloon Bypass this year.

Toll-free tunnel/ control area [5]	2020-21 ($ million)	2021-22 ($ million)	2022-23 ($ million)	2023-24 ($ million)	2024-25 ($ million)
Tuen Mun-Chek Lap Kok Tunnel [6]	19	71	73	79	81
Tseung Kwan O Tunnel [7]	37	37	35	31	44
Tseung Kwan O–Lam Tin Tunnel [7]	N/A	N/A	19	62	62
Central–Wan Chai Bypass Tunnel	120	148	148	148	152
Lung Shan Tunnel	57	61	61	57	57
Cheung Shan Tunnel	18	19	19	25	26

Toll-free tunnel/ control area [5]	2020-21 ($ million)	2021-22 ($ million)	2022-23 ($ million)	2023-24 ($ million)	2024-25 ($ million)
Airport Tunnel	25	25	26	26	26
Scenic Hill Tunnel	54	54	55	55	58
Kai Tak Tunnel	54	54	54	54	49
Lantau Link[6]	133	133	139	142	147

Note 5: Government toll-free tunnels are not included in the Operating Accounts of Government Toll-Tunnels. The expenditures set out in the table represent the management fees payable to the management, operation and maintenance contractors for the years concerned, excluding the depreciation charge of the capital costs and the expenditure on government maintenance works of the tunnels and Lantau Link for the years concerned.

Note 6: The Tuen Mun – Chek Lap Kok Tunnel commenced operation on 27 December 2020, and the toll of Lantau Link was waived on the same day. The figure of Tuen Mun – Chek Lap Kok Tunnel for 2020-21 is for the period from 27 December 2020 to 31 March 2021.

Note 7: Tseung Kwan O – Lam Tin Tunnel commenced operation on 11 December 2022, and the toll of Tseung Kwan O Tunnel was waived on the same day. The figure of Tseung Kwan O – Lam Tin Tunnel for 2022-23 is for the period from 11 December 2022 to 31 March 2023.

Annex 2

Design Capacities and Peak-hour [1] and Non-peak Hour [1] Utilisation Rates of Government Road Tunnels

Tunnel	Design capacity (vehicle/hour)	Utilisation rate [2]									
		2021		2022		2023		2024		2025	
		Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour
Aberdeen Tunnel	2 600	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8
Cross Harbour Tunnel	2 600	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.0	1.1	1.0
Eastern Harbour Crossing	2 600	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.0	1.0	1.0	1.1	0.9	1.1	1.0
Western Harbour Crossing	4 200	0.9	0.7	0.8	0.6	0.9	0.7	1.0	0.8	1.0	1.0
Lion Rock Tunnel	2 600	1.1	1.0	1.1	1.0	1.1	1.0	1.1	1.0	1.1	1.0
Tate's Cairn Tunnel	2 600	1.0	0.8	1.0	0.7	1.0	0.7	1.0	0.8	1.0	0.8
Eagle's Nest Tunnel and Sha Tin Heights Tunnel	4 700	0.8	0.5	0.7	0.4	0.7	0.5	0.8	0.5	0.8	0.5
Shing Mun Tunnels	2 600	0.8	0.6	0.8	0.6	0.8	0.6	0.8	0.6	0.8	0.6
Tai Lam Tunnel [3]	4 200	0.7	0.4	0.6	0.3	0.6	0.3	0.6	0.3	0.9	0.5
Central Kowloon Bypass [4]	4 200	N/A								0.5	0.5

Note 1: The figures listed in the table represent the annual average traffic flow of the above tunnels from Mondays to Fridays (except public holidays) between 2021 and 2025 according to the toll collection system. Except for the three road harbour crossings (RHCs), "peak-

hour" refers to the busiest one hour from 7 a.m. to 10 a.m. and from 5 p.m. to 8 p.m. in the busiest direction, while "non-peak hour" refers to the busiest one hour during the remaining hours in the busiest direction. To more accurately reflect the cross-harbour traffic flow, "peak-hour" of the three RHCs refers to the busiest one hour from 7:30 a.m. to 10:30 a.m. and from 4:30 p.m. to 7:30 p.m.

Note 2: The utilisation rates have not taken into account those vehicles queueing to enter the tunnels and do not reflect the actual traffic demand against the design capacity. The actual traffic capacity of the tunnels may be affected by other traffic factors, including the proportions of different types of vehicles using the road section concerned, geometry of the road section, etc. Therefore, a mere comparison between the actual traffic volume and the design capacity may not truly reflect the actual traffic condition.

Note 3: With reference to the actual vehicle mix after the Government's takeover of Tai Lam Tunnel and the toll reduction in 2025, the tunnel's design capacity is adjusted to 4 200 vehicles per hour, and the utilisation rate in 2025 is also calculated on the basis of the traffic flow after the takeover of Tai Lam Tunnel.

Note 4: The Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section) commenced operation on 21 December 2025. An all-day fixed toll of $8 for all vehicle types will be charged upon its full commissioning as the tenth tolled tunnel this year. Therefore, its utilisation rates during peak and non-peak hours in 2025 are calculated on the basis of the data from Mondays to Fridays (except public holidays) between 21 and 31 December 2025, and the traffic flow has yet to stabilise.

Annex 3

Design Capacities and Peak-hour [1] and Non-peak Hour [1] Utilisation Rates of Government Strategic Routes and Bridges

Road Section	Strategic route [2] and bridge	Design capacity (vehicle/hour)	Utilisation rate									
			2020		2021		2022		2023		2024	
			Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour
Hong Kong Island												
Harcourt Road (westbound between Tamar Street and Arsenal Street)	Route 4	9 450	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6
Central-Wan Chai Bypass	Route 4	4 700	0.5	0.4	0.5	0.4	0.4	0.3	0.5	0.4	0.5	0.4
Kowloon												
Princess Margaret Road (between Wylie Road and Pui Ching Road)	Route 1	4 700	0.6	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.5	0.6	0.5	0.6	0.5
Kwun Tong Bypass (between Kai Yan Street and Lung Cheung Road)	Route 2	4 700	0.6	0.5	0.6	0.5	0.6	0.5	0.6	0.5	0.6	0.5
West Kowloon Highway (between Lin Cheung Road and Hing Wah Street West)	Route 3	4 700	0.9	0.7	0.8	0.7	0.7	0.7	0.8	0.7	0.9	0.7

Road Section	Strategic route [2] and bridge	Design capacity (vehicle/hour)	Utilisation rate									
			2020		2021		2022		2023		2024	
			Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour
East Kowloon Corridor (between Ma Tau Kok Road and Chatham Road North)	Route 5	3 000	0.9	0.9	1.0	1.0	1.0	0.9	1.0	0.9	1.1	1.0
Lung Cheung Road (between Nam Cheong Street and Lion Rock Tunnel Road)	Route 7	4 700	0.9	0.7	1.0	0.7	0.8	0.7	0.9	0.8	0.8	0.8
New Territories												
Ting Kau Bridge	Route 3	4 700	1.2	0.8	1.2	0.8	1.1	0.7	1.2	0.8	1.2	0.7
Nam Wan Tunnel	Route 8	4 700	0.4	0.3	0.5	0.3	0.4	0.3	0.5	0.4	0.5	0.4
Lantau Link	Route 8	4 700	0.6	0.4	0.5	0.3	0.6	0.4	0.7	0.5	0.8	0.6
Tolo Highway (between Ma Liu Shui Interchange and Yuen Shin Road Interchange)	Route 9	6 300	1.1	0.8	1.1	0.8	1.1	0.8	1.1	0.8	1.2	0.8
Fanling Highway (between So Kwun Po Interchange and Wo Hop Shek Interchange)	Route 9	4 700	0.5	0.4	0.6	0.4	0.6	0.4	0.6	0.6	0.7	0.6
Tuen Mun Road (eastbound between Sham Tseng and Tsing Long Highway,	Route 9	6 300	0.9	0.7	0.9	0.7	0.9	0.7	0.9	0.7	0.9	0.7

Road Section	Strategic route [2] and bridge	Design capacity (vehicle/hour)	Utilisation rate									
			2020		2021		2022		2023		2024	
			Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour
including the slip road from Sham Tseng)												
Kong Sham Western Highway (between Yick Yuen Road and Shenzhen Bay Bridge)	Route 10	4 700	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.2	0.2

Note 1: The figures listed in the table represent the traffic flow of various transport facilities from Mondays to Fridays (except public holidays) between 2020 and 2024. "Peak-hour" refers to the busiest one hour from 7 a.m. to 10 a.m. and from 5 p.m. to 8 p.m. in the busiest direction, while "non-peak hour" refers to the busiest one hour during the remaining hours in the busiest direction

Note 2: Route 6 comprises the Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section), the Central Kowloon Bypass (Kowloon Bay Section) and Tseung Kwan O–Lam Tin Tunnel. Since the entire Route 6 is scheduled for commissioning this year, its utilisation rate is currently not available.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3086)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is the duty of the Transport and Logistics Bureau to promote "Smart Mobility", implement and maintain intelligent transport systems, and take forward automated parking system (APS) projects. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(a) the numbers of various motor vehicles and non-motor vehicles registered and licensed respectively in 2024 and 2025;

(b) the total lengths of carriageways in Hong Kong in 2024 and 2025;

(c) regarding APS projects already completed and commissioned in the territory, their respective locations, construction costs, parking fees charged, total numbers of parking spaces provided, and numbers of system failures recorded;

(d) regarding the APS projects already approved for construction, their respective locations, types, completion timetables, construction costs and total numbers of parking spaces provided;

(e) regarding parking spaces for various types of vehicles including but not limited to motorcycles, private cars and coaches, the total numbers of those provided on-street, in government car parks and in privately-operated car parks, set out by District Council district in the past five years;

(f) the number of Disabled Person's Parking Permits issued and the numbers of car parking spaces for the disabled and their utilisation rates, set out by District Council district; and

whether the Government will explore suitable locations for night-time parking spaces for commercial vehicles through a process of "trade's proposal for Government's approval"; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons?

Asked by: Hon CHONG Ho-fung (LegCo internal reference no.: 28)

Reply:

(a) The numbers of various motor vehicles and non-motor vehicles registered and licensed in 2024 and 2025 are listed below:

Motorised Vehicles	**2024**		**2025**	
	Registered	**Licensed**	**Registered**	**Licensed**
Motor Cycles	108 883	73 494	110 284	72 943
Private Cars	630 711	578 001	635 933	584 914
Taxis	18 163	17 773	18 163	17 695
Franchised Buses	6 160	5 870	6 117	5 793
Non-franchised Public Buses	6 836	6 582	6 951	6 732
Private Buses	855	837	862	833
Public Light Buses	4 340	4 077	4 339	4 053
Private Light Buses	3 420	3 354	3 376	3 320
Goods Vehicles	115 677	109 885	113 932	107 611
Special Purpose Vehicles	2 209	1 892	2 197	1 852
Government Vehicles	7 006	7 006	7 221	7 221
Sub-total (i):	**904 260**	**808 771**	**909 375**	**812 967**
Non-Motorised Vehicles	**2024**		**2025**	
	Registered	**Licensed**	**Registered**	**Licensed**
Trailers	13 443	9 877	13 226	10 186
Sub-total (ii):	**13 443**	**9 877**	**13 226**	**10 186**
Total (i)+(ii):	**917 703**	**818 648**	**922 601**	**823 153**

(b) The total lengths of carriageways in Hong Kong are about 2 241 and 2 269 km [Note] in 2024 and 2025 respectively.

Note: Only carriageways maintained by the Highways Department are included.

(c) The information on the automated parking system (APS) projects currently in operation in short-term tenancy (STT) car parks and government car parks is set out at **Annex 1**. APS is subject to the regulatory control of the Lifts and Escalators Ordinance (Cap. 618), and is regularly examined and maintained by registered lift contractors. As the relevant STT car parks are operated by the tenants, the Transport Department (TD) does not keep such records of the APS concerned. Based on the experience of STT tenants, there have been only a few system failures in the APS, and it has continued to operate reliably. The Government's first public car park equipped with APS, located at the Tseung Kwan O Government Offices, was commissioned at the end of December 2025 and is currently at an early stage of adaptation and tuning.

(d) The information on public vehicle park (PVP) projects with APS already approved for construction is set out at **Annex 2**.

(e) The numbers of on-street parking spaces, parking spaces provided in Government and privately-operated car parks in the 18 districts by vehicle type in the past five years are tabulated in **Annex 3**, **Annex 4** and **Annex 5** respectively.

(f) As at February 2026, the number of valid Disabled Person's Parking Permits was 1 499. Information on the numbers and utilisation rates of on-street parking spaces designated for the disabled in various districts (by District Council district) is set out at **Annex 6** and **Annex 7**.

Regarding the site selection for on-street night-time parking spaces for commercial vehicles (CVs), the TD has been maintaining close communication with the trade through various channels, including regular meetings to listen to the trade's suggestions on suitable locations, and has been reviewing and implementing feasible options, subject to factors such as traffic flow, road safety, impact on residents, parking demand and engineering feasibility. Meanwhile, the TD will also closely monitor the changes in the supply of parking spaces in various districts and take into account the demand from various trades, with a view to implementing a series of short- and medium-to long-term measures to provide CV parking spaces. These measures include: designating daytime loading and unloading locations as night-time parking spaces for CVs; flexibly adjusting the operating hours of some on-street parking spaces; converting on-street daytime private car parking spaces for CV night-time parking; flexibly adjusting the operating hours of on-street night-time parking spaces for CVs, taking into account the general off-duty hours of goods vehicle and coach drivers; and opening public light bus (PLB) stands during non-business hours for PLB night-time parking. The TD will continue to step up its efforts, focusing on districts with a shortage of parking spaces and increasing the supply wherever feasible. Meanwhile, a dedicated scheme for night-time on-street parking spaces for CVs will be implemented at new development areas, and such facilities will be planned in advance at suitable road sections.

As announced in the Transport Strategy Blueprint, the TD will initiate a new round of parking demand and supply study in 2026 to review the existing parking facilities and the parking demand and supply for various types of vehicles, in particular CVs. The study results and recommendations are expected to be released in 2027. This study will analyse the operational patterns of CVs and their actual parking situations in locations such as private land, and take into consideration factors such as the future development of Hong Kong, thereby determining the shortfall in CV parking spaces. Targeted measures, taking into account the views from the transport trades, stakeholders and relevant government departments, will be proposed to ensure a proper match between supply and demand, with a view to achieving "every commercial vehicle having a suitable parking space at night" in the long run.

Annex 1

Parking Fees for APS Parking Spaces, Number of Parking Spaces and Estimated Expenditure of the APS Projects in Operation

Project	Parking Fee for APS Parking Space [Note 1]	Total Number of Parking Spaces (Number of APS Parking Spaces)	Estimated Expenditure
A. APS in STT car parks			
STT Car Park at Hoi Shing Road, Tsuen Wan	Monthly rate: $2,800 to $3,400 (No hourly parking)	245 (78)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Pak Shek Kok, Tai Po	Monthly rate: $3,600 to $4,400 (No hourly parking)	250 (52)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Tung Chau Street, Sham Shui Po	Hourly rate: $20 Monthly rate: $3,300	210 (52)	Funded by the STT car park operator

Project	Parking Fee for APS Parking Space [Note 1]	Total Number of Parking Spaces (Number of APS Parking Spaces)	Estimated Expenditure of the Entire Public Works Programme Item [Note 2]	
B. APS in public works projects				
Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park (i.e. Joint-user Government Office Building in Area 67, Tseung Kwan O)	Hourly rate: $14 Monthly rate: $2,500	388 (225)	$5,228 M [Note 3]	

Note 1: The relevant STT car parks are funded and constructed by the tenants, and are operated on a commercial basis. The relevant government car parks are leased by the Government to operators for management and operation, and therefore the parking fees and mode of operations are determined by the operators subject to market conditions.

Note 2: The estimated expenditure is calculated in money-of-the-day (MOD) prices and is the approved project estimate for the entire Public Works Programme Item approved by the Finance Committee.

Note 3: Including the construction costs for government offices and facilities, general out-patient clinic, job centre, families clinic and dental clinic, child care centre and public car park.

Annex 2

Type, Construction and Commissioning Dates, Number of Parking Spaces and Estimated Expenditure of the APS Projects Approved for Construction

Project	APS Type	Commencement of Construction	Expected Commissioning Date	Total Number of Parking Spaces (Number of APS parking spaces)	Estimated Expenditure
A. APS in STT car parks					
STT Car Park at Hoi Wang Road, Yau Ma Tei	Puzzle stacking	July 2023	2026 (Tentative)	About 200 (117)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Lok Wah Street, Tsz Wan Shan	Puzzle stacking	October 2025	2027 (Tentative)	About 180 (About 40)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Po Tai Street, Ma On Shan	To be determined	October 2025	2027 (Tentative)	About 270 (About 100)	Funded by the STT car park operator

Project	APS Type	Commencement of Construction	Expected Commissioning Date	Total Number of Parking Spaces (Number of APS parking spaces)	Estimated Expenditure of the Entire Public Works Programme Item [Note 1]
B. APS in public works projects					
District Open Space, Sports Centre and PVP at Sze Mei Street	Vertical lifting and horizontal sliding	May 2022	2027 (Tentative)	About 320 (About 160)	$1,605.0 M [Note 2]

Project	APS Type	Commencement of Construction	Expected Commissioning Date	Total Number of Parking Spaces (Number of APS parking spaces)	Estimated Expenditure of the Entire Public Works Programme Item [Note 1]
Open Space with PVP at Yen Chow Street West, Sham Shui Po	Circular shaft lifting	August 2023	2028 (Tentative)	About 200 (About 170)	$778 M [Note 3]
Amenity Complex in Area 103, Ma On Shan	Puzzle stacking	November 2024	2029 (Tentative)	About 350 (About 180)	$2,888 M [Note 4]
Town Park with PVP in Area 66, Tseung Kwan O	Puzzle stacking	May 2025	2029 (Tentative)	About 450 (About 300)	$1,208 M [Note 5]

Note 1: The estimated expenditure is calculated in MOD prices and is the approved project estimate for the entire Public Works Programme Item approved by the Finance Committee. The estimate includes car park and facilities such as open space, amenity complex and sports centre, etc.

Note 2: Including the construction costs for open space, sports centre and public car park.

Note 3: Including the construction costs for open space and public car park.

Note 4: Including the construction costs for sports centre, indoor heated swimming pools, Hong Kong Public Libraries New Book Centre, community hall, Sha Tin District Office's Ma On Shan Sub-office and public car park.

Note 5: Including the construction costs for town park and public car park.

Annex 3

Numbers of on-street parking spaces in 18 districts by vehicle type in the past five years

District	Situation as at end-December of each year	Private Car [Note 1]	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total [Note 2]
Central & Western	2025	509	202	11	651	1 373
	2024	509	202	11	651	1 373
	2023	508	193	11	651	1 363
	2022	443	193	9	618	1 263
	2021	516	191	12	609	1 328
Wan Chai	2025	1 040	24	43	784	1 891
	2024	1 029	25	53	779	1 886
	2023	1 017	24	48	761	1 850
	2022	990	24	22	711	1 747
	2021	986	24	17	684	1 711
Eastern	2025	535	101	66	826	1 528
	2024	536	101	65	807	1 509
	2023	529	91	75	818	1 513
	2022	523	91	62	777	1 453
	2021	479	84	62	776	1 401
Southern	2025	655	51	85	461	1 252
	2024	653	51	85	447	1 236
	2023	645	50	85	447	1 227
	2022	642	53	85	447	1 227
	2021	625	53	135	434	1 247
Yau Tsim Mong	2025	1 592	369	141	1 349	3 451
	2024	1 586	369	141	1 319	3 415
	2023	1 561	363	138	1 309	3 371
	2022	1 389	364	94	1 299	3 146
	2021	1 578	371	138	1 306	3 393
Sham Shui Po	2025	1 296	219	10	919	2 444
	2024	1 295	220	12	884	2 411
	2023	1 273	229	9	876	2 387
	2022	1 249	228	9	861	2 347
	2021	1 221	223	15	787	2 246
Kowloon City	2025	2 373	157	154	1 025	3 709
	2024	2 378	143	160	1 002	3 683
	2023	2 336	143	134	991	3 604
	2022	2 296	140	140	965	3 541
	2021	2 288	140	143	921	3 492
Wong Tai Sin	2025	321	133	0	570	1 024
	2024	316	129	0	545	990
	2023	306	129	0	519	954
	2022	303	128	0	475	906
	2021	301	144	0	440	885

District	Situation as at end-December of each year	Private Car [Note 1]	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total [Note 2]
Kwun Tong	2025	600	134	56	998	1 788
	2024	586	120	53	921	1 680
	2023	531	115	42	834	1 522
	2022	538	123	42	795	1 498
	2021	484	117	43	771	1 415
Tsuen Wan	2025	868	67	31	755	1 721
	2024	859	69	31	700	1 659
	2023	888	63	31	629	1 611
	2022	814	67	31	623	1 535
	2021	811	49	31	595	1 486
Tuen Mun	2025	1 321	338	113	876	2 648
	2024	1 297	329	113	892	2 631
	2023	1 267	330	113	886	2 596
	2022	1 274	354	112	886	2 626
	2021	1 297	332	44	849	2 522
Yuen Long	2025	1 240	445	78	624	2 387
	2024	1 266	419	110	636	2 431
	2023	1 308	427	114	626	2 475
	2022	1 274	426	114	617	2 431
	2021	1 203	433	89	681	2 406
North	2025	1 388	354	29	389	2 160
	2024	1 406	365	32	424	2 227
	2023	1 283	359	27	424	2 093
	2022	1 228	357	27	424	2 036
	2021	1 249	422	21	426	2 118
Tai Po	2025	1 603	339	86	301	2 329
	2024	1 601	352	86	280	2 319
	2023	1 556	359	84	270	2 269
	2022	1 614	353	72	266	2 305
	2021	1 539	336	84	218	2 177
Sai Kung	2025	1 941	319	159	530	2 949
	2024	1 930	316	146	505	2 897
	2023	1 932	305	155	481	2 873
	2022	1 971	316	146	479	2 912
	2021	1 954	332	165	439	2 890
Sha Tin	2025	1 474	338	61	649	2 522
	2024	1 600	337	67	602	2 606
	2023	1 600	335	64	514	2 513
	2022	1 570	335	68	506	2 479
	2021	1 550	302	56	506	2 414
Kwai Tsing	2025	484	376	31	898	1 789
	2024	484	360	21	772	1 637
	2023	424	353	21	726	1 524
	2022	416	364	21	721	1 522
	2021	411	368	21	694	1 494

District	Situation as at end-December of each year	Private Car Note 1	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total Note 2
Islands	2025	640	67	78	261	1 046
	2024	640	67	78	261	1 046
	2023	517	55	75	205	852
	2022	510	55	79	152	796
	2021	496	44	65	175	780
Total#	**2025**	**19 880**	**4 033**	**1 232**	**12 866**	**38 011**
	2024	**19 971**	**3 974**	**1 264**	**12 427**	**37 636**
	2023	**19 481**	**3 923**	**1 226**	**11 967**	**36 597**
	2022	**19 044**	**3 971**	**1 133**	**11 622**	**35 770**
	2021	**18 988**	**3 965**	**1 141**	**11 311**	**35 405**

Note 1: These parking spaces are for private cars and taxis, as well as light buses, tricycles and light goods vehicles of similar dimensions.

Note 2: Excluding about 370 parking spaces reserved for special public services such as refuse collection or post offices' vehicles.

Annex 4

Numbers of parking spaces provided at the Government car parks in 18 districts by vehicle type in the past five years [Note]

District	Situation as at end-December of each year	Private Car	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total
Central & Western	2025	3 812	377	13	345	4 547
	2024	3 821	425	13	345	4 604
	2023	3 903	426	13	343	4 685
	2022	3 921	427	13	351	4 712
	2021	3 926	428	14	335	4 703
Wan Chai	2025	2 428	230	11	267	2 936
	2024	2 428	401	11	265	3 105
	2023	2 578	230	11	263	3 082
	2022	2 605	227	11	262	3 105
	2021	2 754	227	11	280	3 272
Eastern	2025	3 181	346	21	382	3 930
	2024	3 179	346	21	382	3 928
	2023	3 165	346	33	382	3 926
	2022	3 143	351	33	374	3 901
	2021	3 150	351	33	373	3 907
Southern	2025	2 648	177	10	488	3 323
	2024	2 676	177	10	488	3 351
	2023	2 681	182	10	488	3 361
	2022	2 670	182	11	483	3 346
	2021	2 670	182	11	483	3 346
Yau Tsim Mong	2025	875	172	18	34	1 099
	2024	900	180	18	34	1 132
	2023	976	253	20	34	1 283
	2022	1 066	254	20	39	1 379
	2021	1 064	254	20	39	1 377
Sham Shui Po	2025	4 125	1 170	26	512	5 833
	2024	4 021	1 175	26	512	5 734
	2023	4 050	1 175	33	504	5 762
	2022	4 073	1 178	33	498	5 782
	2021	3 844	1 183	33	481	5 541
Kowloon City	2025	3 131	111	7	253	3 502
	2024	3 183	135	5	257	3 580
	2023	3 179	134	7	247	3 567
	2022	3 183	134	7	247	3 571
	2021	3 198	134	5	237	3 574
Wong Tai Sin	2025	4 382	282	43	615	5 322
	2024	4 288	295	44	590	5 217
	2023	4 187	285	44	561	5 077
	2022	4 213	282	25	552	5 072
	2021	4 245	296	25	563	5 129

District	Situation as at end-December of each year	Private Car	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total
Kwun Tong	2025	7 357	430	23	1 493	9 303
	2024	7 658	520	30	1 509	9 717
	2023	7 702	511	34	1 482	9 729
	2022	7 696	469	36	1 449	9 650
	2021	7 744	468	37	1 425	9 674
Tsuen Wan	2025	1 890	121	4	244	2 259
	2024	1 890	121	4	244	2 259
	2023	1 868	121	4	244	2 237
	2022	1 914	124	4	242	2 284
	2021	1 906	122	4	232	2 264
Tuen Mun	2025	3 804	179	48	239	4 270
	2024	3 801	179	48	239	4 267
	2023	3 769	179	46	232	4 226
	2022	3 501	142	46	166	3 855
	2021	3 494	142	46	166	3 848
Yuen Long	2025	3 346	111	36	242	3 735
	2024	3 346	111	36	242	3 735
	2023	3 301	112	46	238	3 697
	2022	3 315	107	49	238	3 709
	2021	3 353	104	39	236	3 732
North	2025	4 373	529	55	270	5 227
	2024	4 443	417	55	270	5 185
	2023	3 820	411	55	254	4 540
	2022	3 475	374	42	126	4 017
	2021	2 687	374	27	113	3 201
Tai Po	2025	1 112	208	8	96	1 424
	2024	1 121	208	8	96	1 433
	2023	1 110	208	15	96	1 429
	2022	897	213	8	80	1 198
	2021	787	210	8	73	1 078
Sai Kung	2025	2 239	121	63	230	2 653
	2024	1 945	73	51	208	2 277
	2023	1 941	73	66	206	2 286
	2022	1 938	73	61	206	2 278
	2021	1 841	70	62	167	2 140
Sha Tin	2025	4 532	161	32	492	5 217
	2024	4 642	182	32	501	5 357
	2023	4 479	179	31	482	5 171
	2022	4 420	183	33	481	5 117
	2021	4 378	170	33	441	5 022
Kwai Tsing	2025	4 777	575	12	893	6 257
	2024	5 049	579	12	901	6 541
	2023	4 905	564	12	855	6 336
	2022	4 836	563	12	845	6 256
	2021	4 836	563	10	840	6 249

District	Situation as at end-December of each year	Private Car	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total
Islands	2025	2 220	71	39	136	2 466
	2024	2 222	71	39	136	2 468
	2023	2 111	242	17	114	2 484
	2022	1 601	115	17	109	1 842
	2021	1 717	181	17	102	2 017
Total	**2025**	**60 232**	**5 371**	**469**	**7 231**	**73 303**
	2024	**60 613**	**5 595**	**463**	**7 219**	**73 890**
	2023	**59 725**	**5 631**	**497**	**7 025**	**72 878**
	2022	**58 467**	**5 398**	**461**	**6 748**	**71 074**
	2021	**57 594**	**5 459**	**435**	**6 586**	**70 074**

Note: The above parking information is collated from the data provided by various departments or the concerned car park management companies or operators, and is for general reference only. The actual number of parking spaces may vary as the departments, management companies or operators responsible for managing the car parks may make adjustments to the numbers/types of parking spaces to suit their own requirements.

Annex 5

Numbers of parking spaces provided at the privately-operated car parks in 18 districts by vehicle type in the past five years [Note]

District	Situation as at end-December of each year	Private Car	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total
Central & Western	2025	34 805	451	60	608	35 924
	2024	34 750	439	59	601	35 849
	2023	34 045	385	58	483	34 971
	2022	34 073	457	58	483	35 071
	2021	34 065	464	57	480	35 066
Wan Chai	2025	35 789	88	90	384	36 351
	2024	35 523	88	90	359	36 060
	2023	35 138	83	97	321	35 639
	2022	35 170	83	98	323	35 674
	2021	35 507	85	97	352	36 041
Eastern	2025	43 200	1 420	171	1 602	46 393
	2024	42 914	1 403	193	1 562	46 072
	2023	43 136	1 389	227	1 455	46 207
	2022	43 112	1 379	238	1 440	46 169
	2021	42 775	1 390	238	1 451	45 854
Southern	2025	37 780	910	188	1 111	39 989
	2024	36 970	894	179	1 079	39 122
	2023	36 751	892	177	1 053	38 873
	2022	37 059	861	188	1 016	39 124
	2021	36 564	877	189	1 008	38 638
Yau Tsim Mong	2025	33 217	775	88	836	34 916
	2024	33 153	773	86	786	34 798
	2023	33 421	774	101	797	35 093
	2022	33 280	770	94	753	34 897
	2021	33 351	869	107	745	35 072
Sham Shui Po	2025	26 376	1 731	392	968	29 467
	2024	26 215	1 820	386	929	29 350
	2023	25 305	1 905	387	854	28 451
	2022	24 774	1 891	387	817	27 869
	2021	24 469	1 902	362	794	27 527
Kowloon City	2025	49 994	1 140	92	1 352	52 578
	2024	47 634	1 171	104	1 186	50 095
	2023	46 646	1 090	154	1 045	48 935
	2022	45 911	977	91	896	47 875
	2021	44 141	962	112	834	46 049
Wong Tai Sin	2025	15 877	865	47	1 406	18 195
	2024	16 132	874	47	1 426	18 479
	2023	16 472	865	45	1 328	18 710
	2022	16 401	877	73	1 311	18 662
	2021	16 192	880	63	1 285	18 420

District	Situation as at end-December of each year	Private Car	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total
Kwun Tong	2025	40 556	3 089	58	2 706	46 409
	2024	40 976	3 044	39	2 576	46 635
	2023	41 130	2 896	47	2 449	46 522
	2022	40 501	2 765	45	2 354	45 665
	2021	39 852	2 766	111	2 323	45 052
Tsuen Wan	2025	35 916	1 868	365	1 050	39 199
	2024	35 644	1 914	374	883	38 815
	2023	35 826	1 960	362	886	39 034
	2022	35 777	1 866	362	807	38 812
	2021	35 120	1 817	387	773	38 097
Tuen Mun	2025	39 120	2 036	91	1 102	42 349
	2024	38 655	2 047	91	1 097	41 890
	2023	38 658	2 038	93	958	41 747
	2022	38 177	2 012	93	872	41 154
	2021	37 585	2 007	93	804	40 489
Yuen Long	2025	40 134	1 475	287	1 276	43 172
	2024	39 363	1 621	288	1 149	42 421
	2023	39 436	1 524	287	1 110	42 357
	2022	39 196	1 512	281	1 099	42 088
	2021	38 004	1 516	237	989	40 746
North	2025	17 516	754	32	412	18 714
	2024	17 511	735	32	411	18 689
	2023	17 842	975	32	380	19 229
	2022	17 804	884	32	361	19 081
	2021	17 533	825	30	343	18 731
Tai Po	2025	31 561	653	79	906	33 199
	2024	29 771	613	58	875	31 317
	2023	29 763	641	54	850	31 308
	2022	29 446	638	54	845	30 983
	2021	28 674	619	54	827	30 174
Sai Kung	2025	41 849	1 233	163	3 000	46 245
	2024	41 071	1 176	146	2 955	45 348
	2023	40 415	1 076	148	2 759	44 398
	2022	40 472	1 103	139	2 657	44 371
	2021	40 273	1 129	132	2 553	44 087
Sha Tin	2025	70 125	2 181	102	2 482	74 890
	2024	70 266	2 204	102	2 407	74 979
	2023	71 024	2 310	101	2 376	75 811
	2022	69 538	2 234	101	2 208	74 081
	2021	68 768	2 224	144	2 139	73 275
Kwai Tsing	2025	30 848	9 094	348	1 540	41 830
	2024	30 845	8 628	181	1 478	41 132
	2023	31 004	9 658	396	1 378	42 436
	2022	30 887	9 883	399	1 358	42 527
	2021	30 715	9 876	399	1 350	42 340

District	Situation as at end-December of each year	Private Car	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total
Islands	2025	18 891	870	174	604	20 539
	2024	17 541	870	174	370	18 955
	2023	18 022	708	176	390	19 296
	2022	13 835	700	190	386	15 111
	2021	13 732	697	190	370	14 989
Total	**2025**	**643 554**	**30 633**	**2 827**	**23 345**	**700 359**
	2024	**634 934**	**30 314**	**2 629**	**22 129**	**690 006**
	2023	**634 034**	**31 169**	**2 942**	**20 872**	**689 017**
	2022	**625 413**	**30 892**	**2 923**	**19 986**	**679 214**
	2021	**617 320**	**30 905**	**3 002**	**19 420**	**670 647**

Note: The above parking information is collated from the data provided by various departments, organisations and car park management companies or operators, and is for general reference only. The actual number of parking spaces may vary as the car park providers, management companies or operators responsible for managing the car parks may make adjustments to the numbers/types of parking spaces to suit their own requirements.

Annex 6

Numbers of on-street parking spaces designated for the disabled in 18 districts (as at February 2026)

District	Number of Parking Spaces Designated for the Disabled
Central & Western	28
Wan Chai	55
Eastern	38
Southern	27
Yau Tsim Mong	60
Sham Shui Po	42
Kowloon City	48
Wong Tai Sin	25
Kwun Tong	41
Tsuen Wan	40
Tuen Mun	18
Yuen Long	31
North	12
Tai Po	20
Sai Kung	24
Sha Tin	25
Kwai Tsing	33
Islands	14
Total	**581**

Annex 7

Utilisation rates of on-street parking spaces designated for the disabled in 18 districts (Survey data from September to December 2025)

District	Number of on-street parking spaces designated for the disabled[Note 1]	Utilisation rate [Note 2]
Central & Western	28	57%
Wan Chai	52	63%
Eastern	40	45%
Southern	27	33%
Yau Tsim Mong	56	88%
Sham Shui Po	41	71%
Kowloon City	47	64%
Wong Tai Sin	24	75%
Kwun Tong	37	78%
Tsuen Wan	39	59%
Tuen Mun	19	53%
Yuen Long	33	45%
North	12	67%
Tai Po	18	56%
Sai Kung	24	42%
Sha Tin	26	54%
Kwai Tsing	32	47%
Islands	14	14%
Total	**569** [Note 2]	**59%**

Note 1: The data was obtained from the surveys on the utilisation of on-street parking spaces designated for the disabled conducted from September to December 2025. Therefore, the data do not include the additional parking spaces after December 2025. When calculating the utilisation rate of parking spaces, illegal occupation of such parking spaces is not included.

Note 2: As at February 2026, the number of on-street parking spaces designated for the disabled has increased to 581.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3200)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The aims of the Transport Department (TD) are to operate an efficient vehicle and driver registration and licensing system, and to promote road safety through the efficient regulation of drivers. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

(a) the annual number of commercial vehicle (CV) drivers aged 60 or above in the past five years;

(b) (i) the number of traffic accidents; (ii) the number of casualties; and (iii) the number of cases where accidents were caused by illnesses after passing the medical assessment, which involved CV drivers aged 60 or above (set out in table form, with a breakdown by type of CV) in the past five years;

Asked by: Hon CHONG Ho-fung (LegCo internal reference no.: 38)

Reply:

(a) There is no definition of "commercial vehicles" (CV) in the existing legislation. As far as driving licences are concerned, private and public light buses, taxis, private and public buses, franchised buses, medium goods vehicles, heavy goods vehicles, articulated vehicles and special purpose vehicles are generally regarded as CVs. The annual number of persons aged 60 or above who held valid full driving licences for various types of CVs in the past five years (as at the end of each year) is tabulated below:

Vehicle type	**Year**				
	2021	**2022**	**2023**	**2024**	**2025**
Private light bus	85 358	88 911	92 927	95 466	97 013
Public light bus	82 445	85 866	89 745	92 152	93 600
Taxi	117 356	122 139	127 592	130 621	131 884
Private bus	55 071	58 251	61 973	64 655	66 699
Public bus	55 025	58 157	61 823	64 455	66 445

Vehicle type	Year				
	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Franchised bus	10 746	11 090	11 554	11 878	12 007
Medium goods vehicle	79 813	83 647	87 681	90 413	92 220
Heavy goods vehicle	50 478	50 978	51 859	51 982	51 692
Articulated vehicle	19 703	21 186	22 662	23 722	24 586
Special purpose vehicle	5 424	5 985	6 536	7 017	7 467

Note: A person's driving licence may have endorsements of more than one class of vehicles.

(b) According to records, the number of traffic accidents and the number of casualties involving CV drivers aged 60 or above, with a breakdown by vehicle class, during the period from 2021 to 2025 are tabulated below:

Vehicle type	Year									
	2021		2022		2023		2024		2025*	
	No. of traffic accidents	No. of casualties	No. of traffic accidents	No. of casualties	No. of traffic accidents	No. of casualties	No. of traffic accidents	No. of casualties	No. of traffic accidents	No. of casualties
Private light bus	43	51	29	46	46	82	63	70	57	86
Public light bus	500	660	475	669	557	898	667	966	561	791
Taxi	1 966	2 558	1 820	2 381	2 346	3 316	2 530	3 369	2 227	2 958
Private bus	3	4	2	2	12	15	7	10	8	17
Public bus	353	424	321	419	421	653	531	680	475	619
Medium goods vehicle	213	267	197	249	228	379	229	291	226	289
Heavy goods vehicle	63	106	70	88	72	117	103	132	87	127
Special purpose vehicle	14	19	12	13	23	31	19	35	34	43

* Provisional figures

The Transport Department does not maintain data on the number of cases in which traffic accidents were caused by sudden illnesses of CV drivers aged 60 or above who had passed medical assessment.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0359)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

1. What is the utilisation rate of various vehicle types since the commissioning of the Central Kowloon Bypass?

2. Please list the ten major roads most impacted by the Central Kowloon Bypass since its commissioning, and provide the relevant data.

Asked by: Hon FONG Kwok-shan, Christine (LegCo internal reference no.: 35)

Reply:

1. The Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section) (CKB(YMT)) was commissioned on 21 December 2025. As at February 2026, the average daily traffic flow of the CKB(YMT) on weekdays was 66 500 (in two-way vehicles). Upon the full commissioning of the Central Kowloon Bypass (CKB) this year, the vehicle detectors for identifying vehicle types will commence operation. Meanwhile, the Transport Department (TD) will carry out the annual census to collect traffic data of major roads in Hong Kong this year. Upon completion of the relevant data collection, the data on different types of vehicles using the CKB can be provided.

   As CKB(YMT) is still at an early stage of operation, its overall traffic flow is expected to gradually stabilise. The TD will continue to closely monitor the CKB(YMT) and related traffic conditions.

2. The CKB is a strategic route connecting Kowloon East and West. The first commissioned CKB(YMT) has helped divert the traffic along the east-west major roads. According to the traffic data as at February 2026, there has been a noticeable diversion effect on the traffic along Lung Cheung Road and Gascoigne Road. In particular, the eastbound and westbound traffic flows on Lung Cheung Road during morning peak hours has decreased by about 20%. A decrease of about 10% in the eastbound and westbound traffic flow along the Gascoigne Road Flyover has also been recorded, and it is noted that there are no significant traffic queues of eastbound and westbound traffic

during morning peak hours, in contrast to the traffic queues reaching 500 metres or more before the commissioning of CKB(YMT). The details are set out in the table below:

Average Hourly Traffic Flow During Morning Peak Hours on Weekdays (in Vehicle)

		Before Commissioning of the CKB(YMT) [1]	**After Commissioning of the CKB(YMT)**	
			January 2026[2]	**February 2026**[2]
Lung Cheung Road	Eastbound	3 680	3 160 [-14%]	3 260 [-11%]
	Westbound	4 070	3 230 [-21%]	3 090 [-24%]
	Average change in eastbound and westbound traffic:		**-18%**	**-18%**
West Kowloon Corridor (to and from Gascoigne Road Flyover)	Southbound	2 000	1 990 [-1%]	1 940 [-3%]
	Northbound	1 290	1 090 [-16%]	1 030 [-20%]
	Average change in southbound and northbound[5] **traffic:**		**-9%**	**-12%**

Note:

1. The highest hourly traffic flow during peak hours, according to the data of traffic surveys on 9 and 10 December 2025.
2. Mondays to Fridays throughout the period, excluding public holidays and the associated days affected.
3. Percentage in [ ] denotes the changes after the commissioning of CKB(YMT) as compared with before its commissioning.
4. The data on traffic queues for the road section during peak hours (if any) are not taken into account in the traffic flows.
5. Although the West Kowloon Corridor runs in a south-north alignment on the map, in terms of its function as a route connecting various districts in Kowloon, it should be considered together with the Gascoigne Road Flyover as a route for east-west traffic in Kowloon.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0361)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

1. Will the Government consider setting up night-time parking spaces on roads with relatively low traffic volumes but high parking demand in the vicinity? If yes, please provide details.

2. Will the Government explore setting up night-time parking, for example, in the vicinity of Anderson Road?

3. Is the provision of parking spaces adequate in all 18 districts of Hong Kong? Please provide data for illustration.

Asked by: Hon FONG Kwok-shan, Christine (LegCo internal reference no.: 37)

Reply:

1. The Government's policy in the provision of parking spaces is to accord priority to considering and meeting the parking demand of commercial vehicles (CVs). Where overall development permits, an appropriate number of private car (PC) parking spaces are also provided. Given the limited land resources in Hong Kong, in addition to suitably increasing the supply of parking spaces, it is also necessary to flexibly utilise and optimise the existing parking resources. The Transport Department (TD) has been actively implementing the "shared-use" strategy, while closely identifying suitable locations for additional on-street night-time parking spaces in various districts, and carefully balancing a range of factors such as geographical constraints, the impacts on road traffic, and the parking demand of various types of vehicles, with a view to increasing the supply of parking spaces within limited space. Regarding specific measures, the TD is actively designating daytime loading and unloading locations as night-time parking spaces for CVs, while converting certain on-street PC parking spaces for CV night-time parking and reverting their use to PCs during the day. As at December 2025, about 2 000 night-time on-street parking spaces for CVs have been provided across the territory. The TD will continue to step up its efforts, focusing on districts with a shortage of parking spaces and increasing the supply wherever feasible.

Meanwhile, a dedicated programme on night-time on-street parking spaces for CVs will be implemented at new development areas (NDAs), and such facilities will be planned in advance at suitable road sections.

2. The TD has kept under review the parking supply and demand in the Anderson NDA and is exploring the feasibility of providing additional night-time on-street parking spaces for CVs in light of the traffic conditions and public views. The TD has planned to provide additional night-time on-street parking spaces for CVs at suitable locations on On Yu Road and is currently conducting public consultation via the Sai Kung District Office. Subsequently, it will co-ordinate with the Highways Department to take forward the project. In addition, the TD has identified other suitable locations and is exploring the feasibility of setting up similar parking spaces. The TD will consult the public in due course, in tandem with the completion of the Anderson NDA.

   In addition to the night-time on-street parking spaces for CVs, the Joint-user Complex at Site G2, Anderson Road Quarry will include a public car park, providing some 300 parking spaces. Furthermore, most of the subsidised housing projects in the vicinity of Anderson NDA have been planned according to the revised standards of the Hong Kong Planning Standards and Guidelines (2021) (HKSPG), offering a higher proportion of ancillary parking spaces for PCs, motorcycles and CVs than before the revision, totalling about 980 parking spaces.

3. The TD has been reviewing the supply and demand of parking spaces in various districts and adopting a multi-pronged strategy to increase parking spaces in a holistic manner. The ratio of the number of parking spaces to the number of licensed vehicles across the territory has gradually rebounded in recent years, with the relevant initiatives gradually taking effect. For PCs, the ratio has steadily increased from 1:1.10 in 2020 to 1:1.14 in 2025; and that for CVs has also increased from 1:0.64 to 1:0.67. The number of additional parking spaces provided across the territory is anticipated to exceed 12 000, covering both PCs and CVs, within 2025 and 2026.

   As announced in the Transport Strategy Blueprint, the TD will initiate a new round of parking demand and supply study in 2026 to review the existing parking facilities and the parking demand and supply for various types of vehicles, in particular CVs. The study results and recommendations are expected to be released in 2027. This study will analyse the operational patterns of CVs and their actual parking situations in locations such as private land, and take into considerations factors such as the future development of Hong Kong, thereby determining the demand gap of parking spaces for CVs. Targeted measures will be proposed to ensure a proper match between supply and demand, with a view to achieving “every commercial vehicle having a suitable parking space at night” in the long run.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0307)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the ancillary facilities of public piers, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(a) the area, the number of berths provided and the utilisation of each public pier in table form; and

(b) the ancillary facilities of each public pier, including roof cover, catering facilities, landing facilities and number of toilets in table form.

Asked by: Hon HO Chun-yin, Steven (LegCo internal reference no.15)

Reply:

(a) & (b)

At present, there are approximately 130 public piers in Hong Kong. The Transport Department (TD) is responsible for the daily management of 65 of them, while relevant works departments are responsible for repair and maintenance. These public piers are not equipped with catering facilities or toilets. Information on their area, number of landing (berths) facilities, whether roof cover is provided, and utilisation is set out in the table below. The remaining approximately 65 public piers are managed by different government departments. The TD does not maintain the relevant information.

	Structure Number	Name of public pier	Area (approx. m^2) (Note 1)	Number of landing (berths) facilities (Note 1)	Roof cover (Yes/-) (Note 1)	Daily utilisation of the pier (No. of vessels) (Note 2)	
						Weekdays or Saturdays	Sundays or public holidays
Hong Kong Island							
1	HP105	Tong Shui Road Pier	370	2	-	(Note 3)	
2	HP113	St. Stephen's Beach (South) Pier	50	1	-	0	0
3	HP148	Blake Pier at Stanley	690	2	Yes	0	0
4	HP116	Tai Tam Bay Pier	130	3	-	0	7
5	HP150	Central Pier No. 9	1 350	6	Yes	35	54
6	HP151	Central Pier No. 10	1 310	6	Yes	5	7
Kowloon							
7	KP058	Kwun Tong Public Pier	730	4	Yes	166	125
8	KP070	Kowloon Public Pier	4 620	6	Yes	39	102
New Territories							
9	IP026	Cheung Chau Public Pier	580	4	Yes	32	26
10	IP027	Sai Wan Jetty	Improvement works in progress				
11	IP031	Sok Kwu Wan Pier No. 2	540	2	Yes	8	8
12	IP035	Lo Tik Wan Pier	60	1	-	0	1
13	IP038	Pak Kok Pier	400	2	Yes	14	17
14	IP039	Sok Kwu Wan Public Pier	280	2	Yes	8	16
15	IP040	Yung Shue Wan Public Pier	Improvement works in progress				
16	IP047	Chi Ma Wan Pier	360	3	-	9	9
17	IP049	Sha Lo Wan Pier	380	1	-	7	16
18	IP050	Tai O Public Pier	Improvement works in progress				
19	IP051	Tai Shui Hang Pier	380	1	-	9	9

	Structure Number	Name of public pier	Area (approx. m^2) (Note 1)	Number of landing (berths) facilities (Note 1)	Roof cover (Yes/-) (Note 1)	Daily utilisation of the pier (No. of vessels) (Note 2)	
						Weekdays or Saturdays	Sundays or public holidays
20	IP053	Tung Chung Public Pier	270	2	-	3	5
21	IP055	Peng Chau Public Pier	390	3	Yes	18	43
22	IP056	Tai Lei Island Pier	340	1	-	0	0
23	IP058	Po Toi Public Pier	140	2	Yes	1	2
24	IP061	Tung Lung Chau Public Pier	160	1	-	0	8
25	IP069	Tung Lung Chau (North) Pier	210	2	-	1	2
26	IP075	Tai Pai Tsui Pier	470	1	-	0	0
27	IP076	Yung Shue Wan Development Pier	70	1	-	1	1
28	IP083	Luk Chau Tsuen Pier	210	1	-	2	2
29	IP101	Tung Chung Development Pier (Public)	760	1	Yes	29	18
30	KP092	Tsuen Wan Ferry Pier	470	1	Yes	0	0
31	KP093	Tsuen Wan Public Landing Steps	350	3	Yes	67	98
32	NP051	Joss House Bay Public Pier	610	2	-	0	0
33	NP053	Tung Ping Chau Public Pier	270	2	-	2	3
34	NP059	Pak A Pier	160	1	-	0	0
35	NP065	Yim Tin Tsai Pier	160	1	Yes	24	38
36	NP071	Hap Mun Bay Public Pier	60	1	-	4	7
37	NP073	Sai Kung Public Pier	1 070	6	Yes	25	71

	Structure Number	Name of public pier	Area (approx. m^2) (Note 1)	Number of landing (berths) facilities (Note 1)	Roof cover (Yes/-) (Note 1)	Daily utilisation of the pier (No. of vessels) (Note 2)	
						Weekdays or Saturdays	Sundays or public holidays
38	NP074	Sha Kiu Public Pier	70	1	-	0	0
39	NP075	Tai Tau Chau Pier	180	1	-	0	2
40	NP076	Tso Wo Hang Pier	430	2	-	2	0
41	NP082	Ap Chau Public Pier	160	1	-	7	7
42	NP083	Kat O Chau Pier	390	2	Yes	9	9
43	NP088	Wu Kai Sha Pier	160	1	Yes	0	1
44	NP091	Sham Tseng Public Pier	80	2	Yes	1	0
45	NP094	Sam Mun Tsai Village Pier	910	3	Yes	11	8
46	NP095	Tai Mei Tuk Pier No. 1	40	1	-	2	3
47	NP096	Tai Mei Tuk Pier No. 2	40	1	-	4	4
48	NP097	Tai Po Railway Pier	220	1	-	0	0
49	NP108	Chek Keng Pier	300	1	-	25	31
50	NP110	Kei Ling Ha Hoi Pier	330	2	-	0	0
51	NP111	Lai Chi Chong Pier	620	2	Yes	6	6
52	NP112	Sham Chung Pier	610	2	Yes	4	6
53	NP113	Tap Mun Pier	280	3	Yes	15	9
54	NP123	Tsing Yi Public Pier	1 350	1	Yes	20	29
55	NP125	Yau Kom Tau Pier	100	1	-	0	1
56	NP128	Kadoorie Pier	200	1	Yes	0	0
57	NP141	Ma Liu Shui Ferry Pier	440	2	Yes	6	15
58	NP147	Po Toi O Pier No. 2	290	1	-	1	3
59	NP149	Pak Sha Wan Pier No. 2	560	5	Yes	47	110

	Structure Number	Name of public pier	Area (approx. m^2) (Note 1)	Number of landing (berths) facilities (Note 1)	Roof cover (Yes/-) (Note 1)	Daily utilisation of the pier (No. of vessels) (Note 2)	
						Weekdays or Saturdays	Sundays or public holidays
60	NP161	Pier at Angler's Beach Sham Tseng	550	3	Yes	0	6
61	NP164	Tiu Keng Leng Pier	90	1	-	31	19
62	NP165	Sha Tau Kok Public Pier	1 730	4	Yes	14	20
63	NP166	Wong Shek Public Pier	610	3	Yes	47	107
64	NP167	Ko Lau Wan Public Pier	510	2	Yes	14	24
65	NP189	Ma Liu Shui New Ferry Pier	640	1	-	(Note 4)	

Note 1: The information on the area, number of landing (berths) facilities and whether roof cover of the relevant public piers is provided is supplied by the Civil Engineering and Development Department. "Yes" denotes that roof cover is provided; "-" denotes that roof cover is not provided.

Note 2: The surveys on utilisation were conducted between 7 a.m. and 8 p.m. on a normal weather day in 2023-2024.

Note 3: To facilitate construction works in the vicinity, Tong Shui Road Pier (HP105) was closed temporarily from May 2023 to June 2025. The TD does not have the relevant data on utilisation.

Note 4: Ma Liu Shui New Ferry Pier (NP189) commenced operation in September 2025. The TD does not have the relevant data on utilisation.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0290)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the first registration tax (FRT) concession arrangement for electric private cars (e-PCs), will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

(1) What are the numbers of various types of newly registered vehicles in Hong Kong since the implementation of the arrangement? Please set out the respective numbers and their percentages, with a breakdown by the fuel type they used in table form; and

(2) What are the numbers of e-PCs that have benefitted from basic FRT concessions each year since the implementation of the arrangement? Please list the amount involved in FRT concessions each year.

Asked by: Hon HO King-hong, Adrian Pedro (LegCo internal reference no.: 1)

Reply:

The Government provides first registration tax (FRT) concession arrangement for electric private cars (e-PCs), electric commercial vehicles, electric motorcycles (including electric motor tricycles).

(1) In the past 5 years (2021-2025), the numbers and percentages of first registered vehicles by vehicle class and fuel type are tabulated as follows:

2021

Vehicle class	Number of first registered vehicles					
	Petrol	**Diesel**	**Electric**	**Liquefied Petroleum Gas**	**Hydrogen**	**Total [Percentage of the vehicle class in total number of vehicles]**
Motorcycle	9 013	0	79	0	0	**9 092 [15.78%]**
Private car	29 724	2	9 583	0	0	**39 309 [68.20%]**
Taxi	0	0	0	1 120	0	**1 120 [1.94%]**
Franchised bus	0	277	0	0	0	**277 [0.48%]**
Non-franchised public bus	0	277	0	0	0	**277 [0.48%]**
Private bus	0	74	0	0	0	**74 [0.13%]**
Public light bus	0	13	0	146	0	**159 [0.28%]**
Private light bus	0	63	0	46	0	**109 [0.19%]**
Goods vehicle	2	7 045	55	0	0	**7 102 [12.32%]**
Special purpose vehicle	0	91	13	11	0	**115 [0.20%]**
Total [Percentage of the fuel type in total number of vehicles]	**38 739 [67.22%]**	**7 842 [13.61%]**	**9 730 [16.88%]**	**1 323 [2.30%]**	**0 [0.00%]**	**Total number of First registered vehicles: 57 634**

2022

Vehicle class	Number of first registered vehicles					
	Petrol	**Diesel**	**Electric**	**Liquefied Petroleum Gas**	**Hydrogen**	**Total [Percentage of the vehicle class in total number of vehicles]**
Motorcycle	7 477	0	163	0	0	**7 640 [14.11%]**
Private car	17 683	0	19 795	0	0	**37 478 [69.20%]**
Taxi	10	0	1	1 094	0	**1 105 [2.04%]**
Franchised bus	0	217	19	0	0	**236 [0.44%]**
Non-franchised public bus	0	310	2	0	0	**312 [0.58%]**
Private bus	0	57	0	0	0	**57 [0.11%]**
Public light bus	0	14	0	115	0	**129 [0.24%]**
Private light bus	0	69	0	1	0	**70 [0.13%]**
Goods vehicle	0	6 913	80	0	0	**6 993 [12.91%]**
Special purpose vehicle	0	120	13	4	0	**137 [0.25%]**
Total [Percentage of the fuel type in total number of vehicles]	**25 170 [46.48%]**	**7 700 [14.22%]**	**20 073 [37.06%]**	**1 214 [2.24%]**	**0 [0.00%]**	**Total number of first registered vehicles: 54 157**

2023

Vehicle class	Number of first registered vehicles					
	Petrol	**Diesel**	**Electric**	**Liquefied Petroleum Gas**	**Hydrogen**	**Total [Percentage of the vehicle class in total number of vehicles]**
Motorcycle	4 632	0	211	0	0	**4 843 [8.66%]**
Private car	15 628	0	28 541	0	0	**44 169 [79.01%]**
Taxi	2	0	17	933	0	**952 [1.70%]**
Franchised bus	0	108	24	0	1	**133 [0.24%]**
Non-franchised public bus	0	401	15	0	0	**416 [0.74%]**
Private bus	0	90	0	0	0	**90 [0.16%]**
Public light bus	0	93	1	21	0	**115 [0.21%]**
Private light bus	0	81	1	0	0	**82 [0.15%]**
Goods vehicle	0	4 701	308	0	0	**5 009 [8.96%]**
Special purpose vehicle	0	81	7	5	0	**93 [0.17%]**
Total [Percentage of the fuel type in total number of vehicles]	**20 262 [36.25%]**	**5 555 [9.94%]**	**29 125 [52.10%]**	**959 [1.72%]**	**1 [0.00%]**	**Total number of first registered vehicles: 55 902**

2024

Vehicle class	Number of first registered vehicles					
	Petrol	**Diesel**	**Electric**	**Liquefied Petroleum Gas**	**Hydrogen**	**Total [Percentage of the vehicle class in total number of vehicles]**
Motorcycle	3 726	0	307	0	0	**4 033 [7.25%]**
Private car	13 503	0	33 206	0	0	**46 709 [83.92%]**
Taxi	4	0	140	827	0	**971 [1.74%]**
Franchised bus	0	25	20	0	0	**45 [0.08%]**
Non-franchised public bus	0	307	10	0	0	**317 [0.57%]**
Private bus	0	63	3	0	0	**66 [0.12%]**
Public light bus	0	105	3	14	0	**122 [0.22%]**
Private light bus	0	132	1	0	0	**133 [0.24%]**
Goods vehicle	0	2 936	249	0	0	**3 185 [5.72%]**
Special purpose vehicle	2	71	3	5	0	**81 [0.15%]**
Total [Percentage of the fuel type in total number of vehicles]	**17 235 [30.96%]**	**3 639 [6.54%]**	**33 942 [60.98%]**	**846 [1.52%]**	**0 [0.00%]**	**Total number of first registered vehicles: 55 662**

2025

Vehicle class	Number of first registered vehicles					
	Petrol	**Diesel**	**Electric**	**Liquefied Petroleum Gas**	**Hydrogen**	**Total [Percentage of the vehicle class in total number of vehicles]**
Motorcycle	3 562	0	223	0	0	**3 785 [6.28%]**
Private car	13 568	0	37 467	0	0	**51 035 [84.61%]**
Taxi	93	0	899	812	0	**1 804 [2.99%]**
Franchised bus	0	45	1	0	0	**46 [0.08%]**
Non-franchised public bus	0	402	36	0	0	**438 [0.73%]**
Private bus	0	38	6	0	0	**44 [0.07%]**
Public light bus	0	41	11	1	0	**53 [0.09%]**
Private light bus	0	89	5	0	0	**94 [0.16%]**
Goods vehicle	0	2 383	551	0	0	**2 934 [4.86%]**
Special purpose vehicle	1	72	6	0	3	**82 [0.14%]**
Total [Percentage of the fuel type in total number of vehicles]	**17 224 [28.56%]**	**3 070 [5.09%]**	**39 205 [65.00%]**	**813 [1.35%]**	**3 [0.00%]**	**Total number of first registered vehicles: 60 315**

Note 1: Hybrid vehicles are included under their respective fuel types. Only pure electric vehicles are counted in the category of electric vehicles.

Note 2: Government vehicles are not included as they are not required for registration.

Note 3: The percentages may not add up to 100% due to rounding.

(2) The numbers of e-PCs first registered in Hong Kong and granted the basic FRT concession* in the past five years (2021 to 2025) and the concession amount involved are set out in the table below:

Year	**Basic FRT concession***	
	Number	**Total amount of FRT concession granted ($m)**
2021	266	26
2022	427	42
2023	326	32
2024	636	52
2025	4 677	274

* An e-PC not registered under the "One-for-One" Replacement Scheme is, if eligible, entitled to basic FRT concession on or before 31 March 2026.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0302)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the enhancement of road safety at black spots and pedestrian safety, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. whether the Government has conducted systematic studies or assessments on black spots across the territory; if yes, the relevant data of the studies and the expenditure involved;

2. the targeted road improvement works or traffic management measures implemented at various black spots in the past three years; please list by year the locations of the black spots involved, details of the improvement works, the relevant expenditure, and whether the Government has assessed the effectiveness of the works (such as changes in the number of traffic accidents);

3. whether the Government will deploy extra manpower to step up inspection and law enforcement so as to more effectively prevent traffic accidents at black spots in future; if yes, the estimated increase in manpower and relevant expenditure;

4. whether the Government will raise drivers' awareness by stepping up publicity, education and law enforcement efforts, or reviewing the penalty levels to increase the deterrent effect; and

5. whether the Government has any plan to introduce smart monitoring system or dynamic adaptive traffic signal system to improve the safety management of black spots in future; if yes, the specific plan, implementation timetable and estimated expenditure.

Asked by: Hon HO King-hong, Adrian Pedro (LegCo internal reference no.: 13)

Reply:

1. and 2.

The Government has been enhancing road safety through a multi-pronged approach and is committed to reducing traffic accidents at the source. Key initiatives include improving road design and traffic management, reviewing legislation to strengthen

driving safety requirements and increase the deterrent effect of penalties, incorporating technology to enhance traffic oversight, and stepping up publicity, education, and enforcement action.

Regarding improvement to road designs and traffic management initiatives, the Transport Department (TD) analyses accident data of traffic black spots and other locations with a relatively high frequency of accidents to identify any distinct patterns or common causes, enabling the formulation of targeted improvement measures, such as adjusting traffic signals, adding central dividers, improving pedestrian facilities, and optimising traffic signage and road markings. The above tasks have been undertaken by the existing staff of TD as part of their established duties. There is no separate breakdown of resources involved.

Between 2023 and 2025, the TD drew up and implemented road improvement works at 65 accident black spots and locations with a relatively high frequency of accidents. As at the end of 2025, improvement works have been completed at 47 of these locations. Among them, 31 locations recorded a reduction in the overall numbers of traffic accidents and casualties by approximately 22% and 36% respectively one year following the completion of the works, compared with the year prior. For the remaining 16 locations, as improvement works were completed less than a year ago, the TD is currently continuing to collect and analyse further data in order to evaluate their effectiveness. The locations and improvement details are tabulated at Annex, and the estimated expenditure for the works is about $1.6 million.

3. "Road safety" is one of the selected traffic enforcement priorities of the Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF). Based on the accident data and analytical results of various black spots, the HKPF will review road design and traffic facilities with relevant government departments, and deploy resources in light of actual needs to step up enforcement actions, so as to strengthen the deterrent effect against offences. The HKPF will also enhance publicity and education efforts to further raise the safety awareness of all road users, including drivers and pedestrians.

4. and 5.

The Government attaches great importance to road safety and continues to introduce various enhancement measures. In the past few years, several legislative amendments submitted to the Legislative Council (LegCo) to strengthen road safety have gradually come into force, including requirements for electric vehicles to be equipped with an acoustic vehicle alerting system, for vehicles with extendable aerial structures to have an over-height warning system, for child passengers in private cars to use child restraining devices, and for tightening the use of mobile telecommunications devices by drivers while driving. These measures help further protect road users. In 2025, the Government proposed to increase fixed penalties for illegal parking and 19 traffic offences related to road safety, such as speeding, failure to comply with traffic signs and markings, crossing double white lines, etc., to enhance their deterrent effect. Such proposals were passed by the LegCo and came into effect in January 2026.

The TD and the HKPF will continue to leverage new technologies to improve traffic management and enhance road safety. The TD had, by the end of 2024, installed new auxiliary devices which project red light at signalised crossings at a total of about 100

locations across various districts, which are black spots with a relatively high number of vehicle-to-pedestrian collisions, with a view to reminding pedestrians no red-light running at crossings. Regarding zebra crossings, the TD has commissioned the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department to replace all traditional Belisha beacons at zebra crossings on public roads in Hong Kong, and the replacement works commenced at the end of 2024. The new beacons consist of a halo of flashing yellow light and a post with flashing white bands. They are more visible than the traditional beacons to draw the attention of motorists to the presence of zebra crossings and remind them to stop and give way to pedestrians. To further facilitate smart traffic management and public commuting, the TD is implementing the real-time adaptive traffic signal system (RTATSS) at about 50 suitable independent signalised junctions across the territory. It is expected that the RTATSS will be installed and commissioned progressively starting from the second half of this year. The whole project is expected to be completed in 2027.

Overall speaking, most traffic accidents are attributed to driver-related factors, including inattentive driving, tailgating and careless lane changes. The TD will continue to collaborate with the HKPF and the Road Safety Council to promote road safety among different road users through publicity and education, such as production and broadcasting of television and online publicity video clips, publication and distribution of Road Safety Bulletins and leaflets, affixing publicity covers on traffic signal controllers, conducting road safety talks in primary and secondary schools and elderly centres, and disseminating information on social media platforms.

Annex

Road improvement works carried out at traffic accident black spots and locations with a relatively high frequency of accidents in the past three years

Year	Location	Details
2023	Junction of Salisbury Road and Kowloon Park Drive	Enlarging the signal heads of existing traffic lights
	Junction of Nam Cheong Street and Hai Tan Street	Adjusting existing traffic signals and improving road markings
	Junction of Repulse Bay Road and Island Road	Improving traffic signs
	Junction of Tai Chung Road Interchange and Tai Chung Road	Improving traffic signs and road markings
	Junction of Cheung Sha Wan Road and Hing Wah Street	Improving traffic signs and railings
	Tuen Mun Road eastbound near Tsing Long Highway	Improving traffic signs
	Junction of Kwan Mun Hau Street, Tsuen Fu Street and Tsuen Wan Market Street	Improving railings
	Junction of Camp Street and Un Chau Street	Improving railings
	Tuen Mun Road westbound near Chai Wan Kok	Improving road markings
	Junction of Tsuen Kam Interchange and Wai Tsuen Road	Improving traffic signs, road markings and railings
	Junction of Tsuen Kam Interchange and Tai Ho Road North	Improving traffic signs
	Junction of Tsuen Kam Interchange and Texaco Road North	Improving traffic signs and railings
	Junction of Cameron Road and Carnarvon Road	Improving railings
	Route Twisk near lamppost nos. FA5570 to FA5576	Improving traffic signs
	Route Twisk near Chuen Lung lamppost nos. FA5583 to FA5589	Improving traffic signs
	Island Road near Deep Water Bay Beach	Improving railings
2024	Junction of Shun Tung Road and Tat Tung Road	Installing additional backing boards at traffic lights
	Junction of Castle Peak Road and Tonkin Street	Installing additional backing boards at traffic lights
	Junction of Tai Po Road and Caldecott Road	Improving railings
	Clear Water Bay Road westbound near Ngau Chi Wan Market	Improving traffic signs
	Lung Cheung Road westbound near Hung Ngok House	Improving traffic signs
	Junction of Shung Wah Street and Wan Wah Street	Improving traffic signs and road markings

Year	Location	Details
	Junction of Kwun Tong Road and Hong Ning Road	Improving traffic signs
	Junction of Wo Yi Hop Road and Lei Muk Road	Improving railings
	Junction of Fa Yuen Street and Soy Street	Improving traffic signs and road markings
	Junction of Castle Peak Road and Fuk Wa Street	Improving railings
	Junction of Ap Lei Chau Bridge Road and Lee Nam Road	Improving traffic signs, road markings and railings
	Junction of Castle Peak Road and Cheung Fat Street	Improving railings
	Junction of Castle Peak Road and Tung Chau West Street	Improving railings
	Junction of Sha Tsui Road and Tai Chung Road	Improving road markings
	Junction of Tsuen Kam Interchange and Route Twisk	Improving traffic signs
	Junction of Wan Chai Road, Cross Street and Tai Wo Street	Improving traffic signs and road markings
	Junction of Morrison Hill Road and Sports Road	Improving traffic signs and narrowing the carriageway
	Junction of Chung On Street and Shiu Wo Street	Improving traffic signs and road markings
	Junction of Hing Fong Road and Kwai Yik Road	Improving road markings
	Tuen Mun Road westbound near Rhine Garden	Improving traffic signs
	Junction of Princess Margaret Road and Man Fung Path	Improving traffic signs
	Junction of Yen Chow Street and Tung Chau Street	Adjusting existing traffic signals and improving road markings
	Junction of Cheung Sha Wan Road and Lai Chi Kok Road	Improving traffic signs and road markings
	Junction of Yen Chow Street and Yee Kuk Street	Adjusting existing traffic signals and improving road markings
	Junction of Haiphong Road and Lock Road	Improving road markings
	Junction of Kimberley Road and Observatory Road	Improving traffic signs and road markings
	Tung Chung Eastern Interchange	Improving traffic signs
	Lung Cheung Road eastbound near Fung Mo Street	Improving traffic signs
	Junction of Wo Yi Hop Road and Cheung Wing Road	Improving road markings
	Cheung Tsing Highway eastbound near the western entrance of Cheung Tsing Tunnel	Improving traffic signs

Year	Location	Details
	Lung Cheung Road southbound near Mount Beacon	Improving traffic signs
2025	Junction of Princess Margaret Road and Man Fung Path	Improving traffic signs
	Junction of Sheung Heung Road and Kowloon City Road	Improving traffic signs and road markings
	Junction of Bonham Strand, Hillier Street and Mercer Street	Improving traffic signs and road markings
	Lung Cheung Road eastbound near Jockey Club Breast Health Centre	Improving traffic signs and road markings
	Junction of Ngau Tau Kok Road near Ngau Tau Kok MTR Station	Improving railings
	Junction of Castle Peak Road - Tsuen Wan, Kwan Mun Hau Street and Shing Mun Road	Improving road markings
	Junction of Tsing Yi Heung Sze Wui Road and Chung Mei Road	Improving road markings
	Long Yat Road near Yuen Long Station Public Transport Interchange	Improving traffic signs and road markings
	Clear Water Bay Road westbound near Jat's Incline	Improving traffic signs
	Junction of Clear Water Bay Road and Fung Shing Street	Improving traffic signs
	Junction of Morrison Hill Road and Sports Road	Improving traffic signs and narrowing the roadway
	Austin Road near Austin Avenue	Improving railings
	Junction of Castle Peak Road - Tsuen Wan and Sai Lau Kok Road	Improving road markings
	Ching Cheung Road westbound near Lai Chi Kok Park	Improving traffic signs
	Tai Po Tai Wo Road northbound near Po Nga Road	Improving traffic signs
	Junction of Harbour Road and Fleming Road	Improving traffic signs
	Junction of Kwai Chung Road, Kwai On Road and Kwai Yik Road	Improving road markings
	Fanling Highway southbound near chainage 20.6	Improving traffic signs
	Fan Kam Road near Ta Shek Wu Shek Tong	Improving traffic signs and road markings

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0312)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the facilities and efforts to improve pedestrians' safety at road crossings, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. details of the expenditure involved (including but not limited to equipment procurement, installation cost, operating cost, maintenance fee, etc.) for the Transport Department's installation of auxiliary devices which project red light at signalised locations at specific road crossing black sites in various districts;

2. the numbers of accidents and incidents occurred at these locations after the installation of auxiliary devices; and

3. whether there will be a review of more road crossing locations across the territory in the future and a plan to expand the coverage of installation of auxiliary devices if the results are notable; if not, the reasons.

Asked by: Hon HO King-hong, Adrian Pedro (LegCo internal reference no.: 15)

Reply:

1. Since November 2023, the Transport Department (TD) has started installing auxiliary devices which project red light (auxiliary devices) at signalised crossings at a total of 100 locations across various districts, which are black sites or where a relatively high number of vehicle-to-pedestrian collisions have occurred. The installation works were completed in December 2024. The total expenditures on installation of auxiliary devices at 100 locations are as follows:

Item	Expenditure (HK$)
Procurement and installation expenditures	About $21.66 million
Annual expenditure on electricity tariff (Note)	About $260,000
Annual maintenance cost (including inspections, repair and replacement of damaged devices) (Note)	About $100,000

Note: Expenditure between January and December 2025

2. The TD has engaged a professional team from the University of Hong Kong to evaluate the effectiveness of the auxiliary devices in enhancing pedestrian safety. The evaluation was completed in November 2025. The result revealed that the overall number of red-light running by pedestrians at crossings reduced by about 24% after the installation of auxiliary devices. Regarding traffic accidents, the numbers before the installation (2020-2023), during the installation (2024) and after the installation (2025) of auxiliary devices are tabulated as follows:

Year	2020	2021	2022	2023*	2024*	2025^
The number of traffic accidents involving vehicle-to-pedestrian collisions at the 100 locations installed with auxiliary devices	66	55	39	42	23	14

*The installation works of auxiliary devices were carried out between November 2023 and December 2024.

^The number of traffic accidents in 2025 is a provisional figure.

3. The current 100 locations installed with auxiliary devices have covered all road crossing black sites where a relatively high number of vehicle-to-pedestrian collisions had occurred during the site selection in late 2023. The TD will keep under review the traffic conditions at various junctions and the availability of its resources, and consider installing auxiliary devices at individual suitable locations (such as new road crossing black sites with a relatively high number of pedestrian accidents) so as to enhance pedestrian safety in a targeted and effective manner.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0330)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding public bus services provided under the Public Bus Services Ordinance (Cap. 230) (i.e. franchised buses), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) Among the routes operated by the current franchised bus operators in Hong Kong, what are the respective numbers of routes which offer section fares and the respective percentages of such routes in the company?

(2) For routes providing section fares, what are the respective numbers of routes that offer two-way section fares (i.e. the section fares offered to passengers irrespective of whether they board the bus in the front or end part of the bus journey) operated by each bus operator?

(3) Has the Government previously obtained information about two-way section fares usage on various routes from the franchised bus operators? If yes, what are the details? If no, whether there are any plans to collect such information from the operators in the future?

(4) Given that the fares of franchised bus routes are linked to the Government's reimbursement of the revenue forgone under the Government Public Transport Fare Concession Scheme for the Elderly and Eligible Persons with Disabilities, enhanced implementation of two-way section fares by operators will help save public funds. Will the Government request the operators concerned to strengthen their policies on two-way section fares when examining the renewal of bus franchises in future? If not, will operators be required to maintain a certain level of short-haul bus services?

Asked by: Hon HO King-hong, Adrian Pedro (LegCo internal reference no.: 34)

Reply:

(1) and (2)

An overview of the section fares provided by franchised bus operators (FBOs) as at mid-February 2026 is set out below:

Operator	Number of main routes (Note 1)	Number of main routes with section fares (Note 2)	Percentage of main routes with section fares	Number of main routes with section fares throughout the journey (Note 3)	Percentage of main routes with section fares throughout the journey
KMB	455	342	75%	97	21%
LW	43	40	93%	1	2%
CTB (F1)	208	189	91%	35	17%
CTB (F2)	32	27	84%	6	19%
NLB	29	15	52%	10	34%

Note 1: Including jointly operated routes.

Note 2: Generally speaking, there are two types of section fares, namely "front-part-journey section fare" and "end-part-journey section fare". Passengers need to tap their Octopus cards or scan QR codes at the on-board fare collection systems before alighting or at validators located at bus stops in order to receive the "front-part-journey section fare" rebate. In addition, some routes offer concessions through the driver who adjusts the fare to a lower one according to passengers' destination when they board the bus. "End-part-journey section fare" refers to fare concessions offered at designated stops at the latter section of the bus route journey. Passengers immediately enjoy fare concessions upon boarding a bus on a route with "end-part-journey section fare" by tapping their cards or scanning the QR code to pay the fare on board. Routes providing either type of section fare, i.e. "front-part-journey section fare" or "end-part-journey section fare", are included in the calculation.

Note 3: It means both "front-part-journey section fare" and "end-part-journey section fare" are provided.

(3) and (4)

The Government has all along been encouraging FBOs to provide fare concessions, including section fares, having regard to their operating and financial conditions, overall economic environment, passenger demands and vehicle resources, etc. In considering the introduction of section fares for bus routes, the Transport Department (TD) needs to give due consideration to the overall transport service provision and planning, including how to address and balance different travel needs of short-haul and long-haul passengers to prevent short-haul passengers from taking up the capacity of long-haul routes or the occupancy rates from becoming too low when short-haul passengers alight midway to make effective use of public transport resources.

Measures to refine the "$2 Scheme" announced in the 2025-26 Budget will help reduce the public subsidy for the scheme. At the same time, the TD has been proactively co-ordinating with FBOs to introduce section fares on more suitable bus routes, and 100 "front-part-journey section fare" schemes have been introduced in phases in 2025-26. As at 28 February 2026, 88 schemes have been implemented, while the 12 remaining schemes will be implemented progressively within this year. The TD will maintain close liaison with FBOs to monitor the implementation of section fares.

In considering matters relating to bus franchises, the TD will continue to encourage FBOs to adopt various measures to enhance operational efficiency and maintain financial viability, with a view to further improving the quality of bus services, including the provision of more fare concessions. The TD will also review the bus routes provided by FBOs from time to time to cope with the travelling demand of passengers.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0331)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Management of Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

According to the Annual Transport Digest 2025, as at the end of 2024, there were about 37 600 designated on-street parking spaces in the territory and a total of about 4 000 parking spaces for private cars and about 600 parking spaces for motor cycles were provided at ten multi-storey car parks operated by the Transport Department. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the current progress and expenditure on introducing automated parking systems (APS) at public car parks to enhance the operational efficiency and increase the number of parking spaces; the estimates for promoting APS in the future?

Asked by: Hon HO King-hong, Adrian Pedro (LegCo internal reference no.: 35)

Reply:

1. The Transport Department (TD) has been implementing public vehicle parking projects with APS in Hong Kong since 2020, and has been actively promoting APS in suitable short-term tenancy (STT) car parks and public works projects. Among them, three STT car parks with APS have already been commissioned. The first public works project with APS is located at the Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park, which was commissioned in December 2025. Information of the relevant projects since 2020 is listed at **Annex**.

Annex

Project	APS Type	Commencement of Construction	Expected Commissioning Date	Total Number of Parking Spaces (Number of APS parking spaces)	Estimated Expenditure
A. APSs in STT car parks					
STT Car Park at Hoi Shing Road, Tsuen Wan	Puzzle stacking	December 2020	November 2021 (Commissioned)	245 (78)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Pak Shek Kok, Tai Po	Puzzle stacking	December 2021	December 2022 (Commissioned)	250 (52)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at junction of Yen Chow Street and Tung Chau Street, Sham Shui Po	Puzzle stacking	February 2023	April 2024 (Commissioned)	210 (52)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Hoi Wang Road, Yau Ma Tei	Puzzle stacking	July 2023	2026 (Tentative)	About 200 (117)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Lok Wah Street, Tsz Wan Shan	Puzzle stacking	October 2025	2027 (Tentative)	About 180 (About 40)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Po Tai Street, Ma On Shan	To be confirmed	October 2025	2027 (Tentative)	About 270 (About 100)	Funded by the STT car park operator

B. APSs in public works projects					
Project	**APS Type**	**Commencement of Construction**	**Expected Commissioning Date**	**Total Number of Parking Spaces (Number of APS parking spaces)**	**Estimated Expenditure of the Entire Public Works Programme Item** [Note 1]
Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park (i.e. Joint-user Government Office Building in Area 67, Tseung Kwan O)	Puzzle stacking	September 2020	December 2025 (Commissioned)	388 (225)	$5,228.4 M [Note 2]
District Open Space, Sports Centre and Public Vehicle Park at Sze Mei Street	Vertical lifting and horizontal sliding	May 2022	2027 (Tentative)	About 320 (About 160)	$1,605.0 M [Note 3]
Open Space with Public Vehicle Park at Yen Chow Street West, Sham Shui Po	Circular shaft lifting	August 2023	2028 (Tentative)	About 200 (About 170)	$777.9 M [Note 4]
Amenity Complex in Area 103, Ma On Shan	Puzzle stacking	November 2024	2029 (Tentative)	About 350 (About 180)	$2,888.4 M [Note 5]
Town Park with Public Vehicle Park in Area 66, Tseung Kwan O	Puzzle stacking	May 2025	2029 (Tentative)	About 450 (About 300)	$1,208.0 M [Note 6]

Note 1: The estimated expenditure is calculated in money-of-the-day prices and is the approved project estimate for the entire Public Works Programme Item approved by the Finance Committee.

Note 2: Including the construction costs for government offices and facilities, general out-patient clinic, job centre, families clinic and dental clinic, child care centre and public car park.

Note 3: Including the construction costs for open space, sports centre and public car park.

Note 4: Including the construction costs for open space and public car park.

Note 5: Including the construction costs for sports centre, indoor heated swimming pools, Hong Kong Public Libraries New Book Centre, community hall, Sha Tin District Office's Ma On Shan Sub-office and public car park.

Note 6: Including the construction costs for town park and public car park.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1304)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the continuous monitoring of the operation of the licensed taxi fleets under Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026–27, please advise this Committee of the following:

1. As there are five taxi fleets currently, the respective numbers of taxis registered under each fleet and the numbers of taxis in daily operation;

2. According to the licensing conditions, the taxi fleets are required to reach a total number of 3 500 taxis within four months after licensing, i.e. by the end of November last year, but this target has not been met up to the present, whether the Government will set a "deadline" for revocation of licences if the relevant terms remain unfulfilled; if yes, the details; if not, the reasons;

3. As the Government will officially legislate the regulation of ride-hailing services this year, whether it will consider requiring online ride-hailing platforms to include taxi fleets to increase their utilisation rate; if yes, the details; if not, the reasons.

Asked by: Hon IP Ngo-tung, Chris (LegCo internal reference no.: 5)

Reply:

1.-2.

The taxi fleet regime introduced by the Government aims to introduce a systematic and professional approach for fleet management to enhance the quality of taxi services. The Transport Department (TD) regulates the operation and management of taxi fleets through licensing conditions, and specifies the devices to be installed on fleet taxis and the requirements in relation to fleet size, age of vehicles and services to be provided by fleet licensees, such as the provision of online hailing channels (including mobile hailing applications, websites and telephone hotlines) and electronic payment means, as well as the installation of various in-vehicle safety devices (including dash cameras, driver monitoring system, etc.). Since the TD issued Taxi Fleet Licences to five taxi fleets in July 2025, the number of fleet taxis has continued to increase steadily. As at 13 March

2026, over 1 500 fleet taxis and about 2 000 fleet taxi drivers had been engaged in service, and more than 2.88 million trips had been completed.

The passengers' feedback on the taxi fleet services has been positive in general, noting a wider selection of vehicle models (including six-seater taxis and wheelchair-accessible taxis), newer vehicles, spacious and tidy compartments with enhanced equipment, and courteous drivers. Overall speaking, the taxi fleets have provided quality services, demonstrating a more professional management approach, bringing a positive new outlook to the taxi trade.

The Government has been actively co-ordinating and providing support for the operation of the fleets, including facilitating vehicle examination arrangements for fleet taxis, co-ordinating fleet operators' applications for Dedicated 100% Loan Guarantee Scheme for Battery Electric Taxis, promoting fleet services to the public and tourists, and facilitating each fleet to co-operate with third-party platform to provide centralised taxi-hailing service. In addition, to facilitate fleet taxis' picking up passengers with pre-booked service, the TD has set up about 90 designated fleet taxi stopping places across 16 locations, such as the airport, some of the boundary control points, Hong Kong West Kowloon Station of the Express Rail Link, some of the Airport Express stations, the Kai Tak Cruise Terminal, the Hong Kong Convention and Exhibition Centre Phase II, the Exhibition Centre Station Public Transport Interchange, and the M+ Museum. Furthermore, the TD has co-ordinated the co-operation among some fleet operators, power companies and other public transport operators to facilitate charging for electric taxis.

Regarding driver recruitment, the TD has been assisting fleet operators in participating in district and thematic job fairs organised by the Labour Department, enabling operators to explain in detail to job seekers the management, training and support provided to drivers, so as to attract existing drivers and new blood to join. Meanwhile, the fleets have put in place different measures to recruit more drivers, including placing advertisements on radio and social media platforms, offering new driver referral bonus and safe driving bonus, as well as flexible working hour arrangements. We understand that the job fairs and the above measures have attracted enquiries from job seekers outside the taxi trade, and have successfully recruited more than 100 newcomers to switch careers and become taxi fleet drivers. Besides, to attract more new blood to join the taxi trade, the TD has further enhanced the taxi written test on 3 November 2025 by substantially reducing and simplifying the questions on locations and routes, and adding new questions related to enhancement of taxi service quality, with the aim of maintaining assessment standards while better aligning with the practical needs of the taxi trade. As at 28 February 2026, the average monthly number of candidates applying for a taxi written test has increased from about 1 380 prior to the enhancement of the taxi written test to about 1 820 after the enhancement, representing an increase of about 30%, thereby bringing about a positive impact on overall manpower in the trade and the recruitment of fleet taxi drivers.

Furthermore, the TD is actively co-ordinating among the fleets and different stakeholders in the taxi trade (such as associations, trade unions, and taxi companies) to assist them in engaging drivers and taxi owners. The Government will, through the various co-ordination and support measures mentioned above, continue to urge the fleet

operators to actively enhance their services and expedite the engagement of drivers and taxi owners, so as to drive the fleets towards their committed scale and provide passengers with quality taxi services.

3. The Road Traffic (Amendment) (Ride-hailing Service) Bill 2025 (the Bill) was passed by the Legislative Council in October 2025. It stipulates the legal framework and key principles for regulating ride-hailing service, including the requirement for platforms, vehicles and drivers providing ride-hailing services to obtain appropriate licences or permits and to comply with the conditions of the relevant licences or permits. Quite a number of taxi drivers are now accustomed to accepting street-hailing and taking online bookings through ride-hailing platforms to increase their income. We welcome and encourage ride-hailing platforms to provide booking services for both private cars and taxis. This will enhance the competitiveness of taxi drivers and at the same time boost the overall capacity of platforms, offering passengers more choices and allowing them to book trips more conveniently and quickly through ride-hailing platforms.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1305)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the utilisation of parking meters, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the utilisation rates of the parking meters (by operating hours) for each district in Hong Kong in the past three years (set out by district in table form);

2. the monthly utilisation rates of parking meters (by operating hours) for each district in Hong Kong in 2025 (set out by district and month in table form); and

3. the total revenue generated from parking meters across the territory and the expenditure on their maintenance and replacement in each of the past three years (set out in table form).

Asked by: Hon IP Ngo-tung, Chris (LegCo internal reference no.8)

Reply:

1.&2. The average utilisation rates of parking meters for each district in the past three years are as follows:

District	2023		2024		2025	
	Weekdays (%)	Weekends and holidays (%)	Weekdays (%)	Weekends and holidays (%)	Weekdays (%)	Weekends and holidays (%)
Central & Western	90	81	93	86	91	84
Eastern	91	83	91	92	91	92
Southern	62	70	68	73	68	73
Wan Chai	91	91	90	89	89	88
Hong Kong Island (Sub-total)	84	82	88	85	87	85
Kowloon City	95	95	91	91	90	90
Kwun Tong	93	95	92	93	93	92

District	2023		2024		2025	
	Weekdays (%)	Weekends and holidays (%)	Weekdays (%)	Weekends and holidays (%)	Weekdays (%)	Weekends and holidays (%)
Sham Shui Po	96	91	94	93	93	94
Wong Tai Sin	91	91	94	93	92	92
Yau Tsim Mong	93	92	96	94	95	96
Kowloon (Sub-total)	95	93	93	94	93	92
Islands	68	76	75	73	74	74
Kwai Tsing	92	92	96	91	95	91
North	88	90	88	89	88	89
Sai Kung	74	76	75	70	75	69
Sha Tin	87	92	86	90	86	89
Tai Po	88	92	82	90	83	91
Tsuen Wan	88	92	90	92	88	93
Tuen Mun	88	92	84	92	83	94
Yuen Long	88	90	89	85	90	86
New Territories (Sub-total)	85	88	85	86	86	87
Total	**88**	**89**	**88**	**88**	**88**	**88**

The Transport Department has not maintained the statistics on the average monthly utilisation rates of parking meters.

3. Revenues and recurrent expenditures of the parking meter system in the past three financial years are as follows:

	2022-23	2023-24	2024-25
Revenue ($ million)	377	412	439
Recurrent expenditure ($ million)	47	51	58

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 Reply Serial No.

TLB218

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2428)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding regulating driving instructors' licences, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the percentage of active private driving instructor (PDI) among Group 1 to Group 3 Private Driving Instructor Licences (PDI licences) in each group in each of the past three years;

2. whether the Government has reviewed the demand and supply for PDIs of each group in the recent three years; if yes, what are the details;

3. noting that there had been discussions proposing the combination of the three groups of PDI licences, i.e. the "three-in-one" proposal, but the proposal has not been implemented, whether the Government has any intention to re-examine the said proposal; if yes, what are the details; if not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon IP Ngo-tung, Chris (LegCo internal reference no.6)

Reply:

1. Whether a PDI has been providing training depends on various factors. According to the prevailing consensus between the Transport Department (TD) and the trade, a PDI who has accompanied a candidate to a driving test within one year will be regarded as active. The numbers and the percentages of active PDIs in their respective groups are as follows:

Year	Group 1		Group 2		Group 3	
	Average number of valid driving instructor's licences	**Number of active driving instructors (% in the group)**	**Average number of valid driving instructor's licences**	**Number of active driving instructors (% in the group)**	**Average number of valid driving instructor's licences**	**Number of active driving instructors (% in the group)**
2023	1 015	814 (80.2%)	96	33 (34.4%)	171	75 (43.9%)
2024	1 000	812 (81.2%)	91	37 (40.7%)	168	73 (43.5%)
2025	953	796 (83.5%)	80	35 (43.8%)	162	72 (44.4%)

2. The TD conducts reviews regularly to assess the need for issuing new PDI licences by taking all relevant factors into consideration, including the supply and demand for PDI's training services. The TD has completed the regular review in 2025 and will announce the findings in a timely manner.

3. The TD conducted a comprehensive review of driving training policy in 2020 and enhanced the issuing mechanism of PDI licences in 2021, including the introduction of a quota mechanism. Under the new mechanism, 75% of the new PDI licences are allocated as public quota for application to allow new blood to enter the trade, while 25% are allocated as driving instructor quota (DI quota) for application by holders of valid PDI licences of other groups and serving restricted driving instructors (RDIs) and ex-RDIs of designated driving schools and franchised bus companies. The quota mechanism, on the one hand, ensures that new blood can enter the trade through public quota (in particular PDIs for Group 2 and Group 3) so as to foster competition and improve service quality; on the other hand, DI quota helps **make better use of the experience of** driving instructors and allows driving training services to be provided flexibly among different groups, thereby maintaining overall supply stability.

   Regarding the "three-in-one" proposal of combining the three groups of driving instructor licences, the TD considers that different teaching skills are required of PDIs for different groups of vehicles. The current grouping arrangement, which classifies PDIs according to their technical expertise, was determined after thorough discussion with the trade. It is more preferable and reliable and is also in line with common practices in other places.

   The enhanced issuing mechanism for PDI licences has been operating smoothly since its launch. the TD will continue to monitor the effectiveness of the mechanism and the quota allocation method.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB219**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2429)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

One of the duties of the Transport Department is to monitor existing railway services, assess the impact of new railways on other public transport modes and maintain a coordinated network of public transport services along rail corridors. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. the nature and numbers of MTR incidents lasting 30 minutes or less, 31 minutes to three hours and more than three hours, and resulting penalty (if any) in the past three years;

2. the number of signalling failure in MTR in each of the past three years, and the respective numbers of failure stemming from hardware and software problems (broken down by various railway lines in table form);

3. as the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) is replacing the signalling systems, and the signalling system for Tsuen Wan Line will be commissioned this year, the estimated timetable for the commissioning of the replaced signalling systems for various railway lines in table form;

4. the average frequencies of train services during peak and non-peak periods of Tseung Kwan O Line (including North Point - Po Lam, North Point - LOHAS Park and Tiu Keng Leng - LOHAS Park) in the past three years; and

5. given the increasing population in LOHAS Park, whether the Government has any plan to request the MTRCL to enhance its service in the area; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons?

Asked by: Hon IP Ngo-tung, Chris (LegCo internal reference no.: 7)

Reply:

1. The numbers of incidents which caused service disruption due to factors under the MTR Corporation Limited's (MTRCL) control, the causes and the amounts set aside under

the enhanced Service Performance Rebate for the incidents in the past three years are set out at **Annex 1**.

2. According to the existing railway incident reporting mechanism, the MTRCL is required to notify the Transport Department (TD) of any railway incident which has caused train service disruption of eight minutes or is expected to cause disruption of eight minutes or more. If the incident is caused by factors under the control of the MTRCL, it should also be categorised as either equipment failure (covering signalling system failure) or human factor. The TD has not maintained a further breakdown of the incidents caused by equipment failures and therefore cannot provide statistics on the breakdown of service disruption caused by signalling system failures.

3. The MTRCL is now replacing the signalling system of Tsuen Wan Line, Island Line, Kwun Tong Line and Tseung Kwan O Line to enhance operational and maintenance efficiency in the long run. The overall project is expected to be completed in 2029. The new signalling system for Tsuen Wan Line was commissioned on 15 March 2026. The remaining three railway lines will draw on the experience gained from the signalling system upgrading work for the Tsuen Wan Line and will be commissioned progressively as tabulated below:

Railway line	**Expected service commencement date of the new signalling system**
Tsuen Wan Line	Commissioned on 15 March 2026
Island Line	2027
Kwun Tong Line	2028
Tseung Kwan O Line	2029

4. The average train frequencies during peak and non-peak hours on weekdays of the Tseung Kwan O Line (including North Point – Tseung Kwan O, North Point – Po Lam, North Point – LOHAS Park and Tiu Keng Leng – LOHAS Park) in the past three years are set out at **Annex 2**.

5. Since the commissioning of LOHAS Park Station, the MTRCL has been making timely adjustments to train services to meet passenger demand, having regard to changes in patronage of Tseung Kwan O Line and the actual situation. The MTRCL has been operating a trial of using both platforms for boarding and alighting at LOHAS Park Station during morning peak hours on weekdays since August 2025, with a view to effectively separating arriving and departing passengers and facilitating a smoother travelling process. The operation has been generally smooth. To further rationalise passenger flow on the platforms, this arrangement has been extended with effect from 19 January this year, under which both platforms at LOHAS Park Station are operated simultaneously from 7:15 a.m. on weekdays. In addition, the MTRCL also continues to adopt a multi-pronged approach to improve passenger flow and enhance passengers' travelling experience, including flexible adjustments to train services, strengthening of passenger flow control measures, enhancement of the station layout, etc.

Annex 1

Numbers of Incidents which Caused Service Disruption of Eight Minutes or Above due to Factors under the MTRCL's Control

Year	Number of incidents	Cause		Duration of disruption								Amount set aside ($ million) (Note 3)
				Half an hour or less (Note 1)		31 minutes to 3 hours		3 to 4 hours		Over 4 hours		
		Equipment failure (Note 2)	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	Equipment failure	Human factors	
2023	101	94	7	86	5	8	1	0	0	0	1	25
2024	89	82	7	77	7	5	0	0	0	0	0	5.2
2025	83	76	7	67	7	8	0	0	0	1	0	27.2

Note 1: According to the existing railway incident reporting mechanism, the MTRCL is required to notify the TD within eight minutes of any railway incident which has caused train service disruption of eight minutes or is expected to cause disruption of eight minutes or more. For service disruption of less than eight minutes, the impact on passengers is comparatively minimal and the MTRCL is not required to notify the TD. Hence, the TD does not have the number of incidents with service disruption of less than eight minutes.

Note 2: Equipment failure includes failure in station equipment, infrastructure (e.g. signalling system), rolling stock, etc.

Note 3: After the review of 2023 Fare Adjustment Mechanism, there is an increase in the amount to be set aside for incidents that cause disruptions of more than three hours and the maximum amount to be set aside per incident, as well as an introduction of a peak hour multiplier under the Service Performance Rebate.

Annex 2

Train Frequencies of the Tseung Kwan O Line (Note)

As at December of the year	2023		2024		2025	
	Frequency during the morning peak hours (minutes)	Frequency during the non-peak hours (minutes)	Frequency during the morning peak hours (minutes)	Frequency during the non-peak hours (minutes)	Frequency during the morning peak hours (minutes)	Frequency during the non-peak hours (minutes)
Tseung Kwan O Line						
North Point – Tseung Kwan O	2.2	--	2.2	--	2.2	--
North Point – Po Lam	2.5 - 4	5 - 6	2.5 - 4	5 - 6	2.5 - 4	4.5 - 6
North Point – LOHAS Park	6.7	--	6.7	--	6.7	--
Tiu Keng Leng – LOHAS Park	--	10 - 14	--	10 - 14	--	9 - 14

Note: The figures tabulated above are the train frequencies on weekdays.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0761)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding autonomous driving, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the current number of autonomous vehicles (AVs) issued with Movement Permits (MPs) under the Road Traffic Ordinance (Cap. 374) to conduct AV trials; and for each trial project, the trial commencement date, vehicle types, number of vehicles, trial locations or routes, and cumulative trial mileage;

2. up to the present, the number of trial projects issued with pilot licences under the new legislation on AVs enacted in 2024; and for each trial project, the trial commencement date, vehicle types, number of vehicles, trial locations or routes, and cumulative trial mileage; and

3. up to present, the number of projects related to autonomous driving subsidised by the Smart Traffic Fund; and for each project, the project theme, implementation timetable, funding amount and effectiveness (if applicable)?

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.10)
Reply:

1. The Government has been promoting the development of autonomous vehicles (AVs) in Hong Kong in an active and orderly manner through a multi-pronged approach by providing policy support, regulatory backing and financial subsidy. To facilitate the development of AV technology and industry, the Transport Department (TD) has, since 2017, been facilitating AV trials by issuing Movement Permits (MPs) to individual AVs in accordance with the Road Traffic (Registration and Licensing of Vehicles) Regulations (Cap. 374E). Customised conditions were individually imposed on a case-by-case basis. Currently, to further promote research and development and facilitate other trials, the TD will continue to issue MPs having regard to the needs of individual trials. At the end of February 2026, four AVs issued with MPs continue to carry out trials at various locations. Details are as follows:

Item	Vehicle type (no. of vehicles)	Trial location	Trial commencement date	Cumulative trial mileage
1	Private light bus (2)	Fairview Park	Third quarter of 2024	About 13 200 km (including trial mileage on closed roads in the Mainland)
2	Special purpose vehicle (cleansing purpose) (1)	Yuen Long Tam Mei Construction Sector Imported Labour Quarters	23 April 2024	About 670 km
3	Special purpose vehicle (cleansing purpose) (1)	Light Public Housing project on Yau Pok Road	16 October 2025	About 6 km

2. The new regulatory regime for AVs came into operation in March 2024. At the same time, to facilitate the trial and pilot use of AVs, the TD has also promulgated the "Code of Practice for Trial and Pilot Use of AVs" outlining detailed technical, safety and operational requirements in trial and use of AVs. As at the end of February 2026, the TD has issued six pilot licences involving the trial of 62 AVs at six locations. Details are as follows:

	Vehicle type (no. of vehicles)	Trial location	Trial commencement date	Cumulative trial mileage (km)
1	Private car (30)	Airport Island	11 December 2024	About 137 800
		Tung Chung	18 June 2025	About 26 600
2	Private light bus (2)	West Kowloon Cultural District	3 October 2025	About 1 400
3	Private car (10)	Cyberport in Southern District	21 August 2025	About 7 600
4	Private car (10)	Kai Tak Development Area in Kowloon East	7 November 2025	About 2 500
5	Public light bus (7)	Airportcity Link at the Airport	Trial not yet commenced	0
6	Private car (3)	"Park & Fly" Car Park at the Hong Kong Port of the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge	Trial not yet commenced	0

3. The Government has been funding local research on and application of AVs through the Smart Traffic Fund. As at the end of February 2026, the Management Committee of the Smart Traffic Fund had approved five autonomous driving road trial projects, covering multiple road scenarios, with a view to steadily enhancing the capability of AVs to handle Hong Kong's complex road conditions. (see **Annex** for details).

Annex

Smart Traffic Fund approved AV's projects with road trials

	Project title	Project theme	Approved funding	Implementation schedule	Project results
1	Pilot Project of 5G-enabled Autonomous People Mover Service in a Residential Park	This project aims to develop autonomous light bus for operation in a Hong Kong low-density residential complex, with Fairview Park as the trial location.	$19,730,872.00	On-site trials have commenced in the third quarter of 2024 and operated until the end of March 2026.	The trial data and experience gathered from the project have laid an important foundation for local research and development, which will help enhance the capability of other AVs to handle Hong Kong's complex road conditions and promote the long-term development of AVs in Hong Kong at the same time.
2	Pilot Project of Autonomous AIBus Operation on Public Road with Real Traffic	This project aims to develop the first autonomous light bus for operation on public roads in Hong Kong, with WKCD as the trial location.	$19,998,500.00	Road trials (without passenger) have commenced in the fourth quarter of 2025.	Projects are in progress.
3	Dedicated Line Connected Autonomous Bus	This project aims to develop connected autonomous light bus for connecting between Hong Kong Science Park and the University MTR Station travelling in complex road environment such as roundabouts and public transport interchange.	$19,995,050.00	Road trials (without passenger) are expected to commence within 2026.	

	Project title	Project theme	Approved funding	Implementation schedule	Project results
4	Next Generation Safety Enhanced AI Bus with Self Intelligence	This project aims to develop autonomous bus capable of travelling long distance and adapting to changes in tunnel lighting luminance for connecting residential area at Discovery Bay and Sunny Bay public transport interchange.	$17,475,400.00	Road trials (without passenger) are expected to commence within 2027.	
5	Connected Autonomous Bus with Multi-system Compatibility	This project aims to develop autonomous bus that is compatible with different traffic systems, capable of handling different traffic system information and various geographical differences between the Chinese Mainland and Hong Kong, with Lok Ma Chau Loop as the trial location, in order to advance the development of future cross-border autonomous driving.	$18,673,861.00	Road trials (without passenger) are expected to commence within 2026.	

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0762)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding digital intelligence in traffic management, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

(1) As indicated by the Government, it will explore the setting up of a traffic management platform integrating the use of big data analytics and artificial intelligence (AI), allowing comprehensive monitoring of real-time traffic conditions and enhancing management efficiency. What are the estimated manpower and expenditure involved in setting up such platform?

(2) As indicated by the Government, it will first conduct a trial of the traffic management platform in the urban area of Aberdeen and consider progressively extending it to more districts. What are the criteria for prioritising the roll-out districts and the trial schedule?

(3) The Government has implemented a pilot project on real-time adaptive traffic signal systems since 2019 and has launched the Smart Traffic Management System San Po Kong and Kwun Tong Business Areas respectively in 2025. Has any assessment been conducted to evaluate the effectiveness of these two schemes or projects? If yes, what are the details?

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 11)

Reply:

(1) The Transport Department (TD) makes good use of big data analytics and AI technology to enhance the overall efficiency of the transport network, and plans to commence a study on the development of the Traffic Management Platform (the Platform) in 2026 in preparation for a regional pilot application.

The above study on the Platform includes examining the consolidation of a number of existing systems, data and operational workflows to support the functions of the Platform in future; setting out the functional, data and technical requirements for the

development and operation of the Platform; recommending the overall strategy, specific technical solution and timetable for the implementation of the Platform in various districts, and estimating the total cost for the long-term development of the Platform to full-scale. Moreover, the TD will implement the regional pilot application in suitable districts and review its effectiveness. The estimated expenditure for the above study and pilot application is $62 million. As the implementation of the above items involves additional tasks, such as the consolidation of a number of existing traffic management systems and the co-ordination of data exchange among various public transport operators and other departments, two time-limited civil service posts, including one Senior Transport Officer and one Electronics Engineer/Assistant Electronics Engineer, will be created from 2026-27 to 2030-31. As for the manpower required to conduct the study, the TD will arrange for existing TD staff to undertake the work through deployment of internal resources.

(2) In view of the recent development in Aberdeen, and the relatively heavy reliance of its transport network on individual roads and public transport services, the TD plans to select the Aberdeen area as the first trial site to test the practical applications and functions of the Platform in the road environment in Hong Kong. For example, in the event of an incident on the major roads, regional roads or public transport services in the district, or during major events held within the district, various traffic and transport data of the district can be collected and consolidated via the Platform, thereby enabling changes of traffic conditions to be predicted, incidents and traffic bottlenecks to be identified, and contingency plans to be formulated. The study will review and consider road networks of different districts, their public transport services, pedestrian and vehicular flow conditions at different times, and the impact of major events or unexpected incidents on traffic in those districts in the past, thereby exploring the criteria for prioritising the rollout to other districts, the specific trial site, the trial schedule, etc. in the future.

(3) The TD completed a pilot project on real-time adaptive traffic signal system (RTATSS) at five selected independent signalised junctions in 2021. Sensors and ancillary equipment such as computing systems were installed at specified signalised junctions to compute the appropriate signal timing using AI technology. According to the experience gained from the pilot project, the relevant signalised junctions can flexibly adjust signal timing in response to the instant vehicular and pedestrian flows after the system is implemented at those junctions, thereby making good use of the remaining green signal time and fully utilising the capacity of the junctions. Data show that, after the installation of RTATSS at the trial signalised junctions, the average waiting time for vehicles passing through those junctions decreased by about 5% to 10%, thereby enhancing the operational efficiency of the junctions. The TD is implementing the RTATSS at about 50 suitable independent signalised junctions across the territory. It is expected that the RTATSS will be installed and commissioned progressively starting from the second half of this year. The whole project is expected to be completed in 2027.

The “Wong Tai Sin Police Smart Traffic” project (the project) completed its trial at the San Po Kong Business Area in 2025, with the aim of alleviating traffic congestion in the area by optimising the deployment of traffic light settings and implementing strategic and targeted enforcement. Test results showed that it effectively improved traffic

efficiency, reduced the pedestrian waiting time, and enhanced the manpower resource deployment efficiency of the Hong Kong Police Force after implementation of the project. During peak hours, traffic delay time on Ng Fong Street was reduced by over 30%, while that on Choi Hung Road was improved by about 25%, and pedestrian waiting time on Tai Yau Street and Sam Chuk Street also decreased by an average of 10% to 20%. Meanwhile, the manpower required for traffic control operations in the Wong Tai Sin Police District was reduced by about 85%, making manpower deployment more flexible and highly efficient. Furthermore, the installation of the Smart Traffic Management System in the Kwun Tong Business Area has been completed and the system has commenced operation, collecting traffic data. The Government will continue to optimise the system and analyse traffic conditions, and will review and evaluate the project's effectiveness after sufficient data have been obtained.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0768)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development,
(2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the manpower of public light bus (PLB) drivers, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. as it is learned that all 900 PLB driver quotas under the Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector – Public Light Bus/Coach Trade (the Scheme) have been approved, what is the number of drivers who have successfully obtained the local driving licence and have been deployed to services up to date;

2. as there are views that there is still a shortage of PLB drivers, will the Government consider increasing the PLB driver quotas under the Scheme and launching another round of applications;

3. (a) the number of holders of a valid full driving licence for PLB and (b) the number of new holders of a full driving licence for PLB (excluding imported drivers) in each of the past five years and this year to date, with a breakdown by age group and the respective percentages;

4. whether there are statistics on the number of in-service PLB drivers (excluding imported drivers) in each of the past five years and this year to date; if yes, the details with a breakdown by age group and employment type (full time or part-time) and the respective percentages; if no, whether there is a plan to compile the relevant statistics in the future; and

5. whether it has explored introducing more measures, including strengthening the assistance to the PLB trade in improving the operating environment, to attract more drivers to join the industry.

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 21)

Reply:

(1) The Government has all along been concerned about the long standing driver shortage problem faced by the PLB/coach trade. To alleviate the problem of labour shortage in the trade, the Government announced the Scheme in June 2023, and approved 900 PLB driver quotas through two rounds of applications in September 2023 and July 2024 respectively. As at end-February 2026, a total of 862 imported PLB drivers had passed the local driving test and were currently deployed to driving duties on designated routes.

(2) In response to the gradual expiry of the contracts of the first batch of imported workers by the end of 2025, the TD has announced the quota renewal arrangements in August 2025. The operators with allocated quotas should submit renewal applications to the TD five months prior to the expiry of the contracts of their imported drivers. As at end-February 2026, 324 PLB driver quotas was granted with approval for renewal. At present, the TD has no plan to adjust the total number of quotas. In future, the TD will continue to pay attention to the changes in the local labour market and the manpower situation, review the implementation of the Scheme and assess the manpower demand of the industries. At the same time, the TD will maintain close liaison with various stakeholders, and enhance information dissemination through the stakeholders consultative group as well as review the Scheme in a timely manner with reference to the opinions.

(3) and (4) The information on the numbers and the age groups of persons holding a valid full driving licence for PLB in the past five years (as at the end of each year) and as at end-February in 2026 is set out at the table below:

Year	**Age groups**					
	29 or below	**30 to 39**	**40 to 49**	**50 to 59**	**60 to 69**	**70 or above**
2021	1 035 (0.6%)	8 707 (5.2%)	27 452 (16.3%)	48 291 (28.8%)	61 756 (36.8%)	20 689 (12.3%)
2022	1 258 (0.8%)	7 580 (4.5%)	26 204 (15.7%)	45 706 (27.4%)	63 491 (38.1%)	22 375 (13.5%)
2023	1 427 (0.8%)	6 776 (4.1%)	24 918 (15.0%)	43 109 (26.0%)	65 201 (39.3%)	24 544 (14.8%)
2024	1 445 (0.9%)	6 338 (3.8%)	23 700 (14.4%)	41 398 (25.1%)	65 655 (39.8%)	26 497 (16.0%)
2025	1 480 (0.9%)	6 003 (3.7%)	22 636 (13.9%)	39 514 (24.2%)	65 369 (40.0%)	28 231 (17.3%)
2026 (as at end-February)	1 492 (0.9%)	5 967 (3.7%)	22 438 (13.8%)	39 276 (24.1%)	65 164 (40.0%)	28 479 (17.5%)

The numbers and percentages of persons with newly issued with a valid full driving licence for PLB in the same period, with breakdown by age group, are set out below:

Year	**Age groups**					
	29 or below	**30 to 39**	**40 to 49**	**50 to 59**	**60 to 69**	**70 or above**
2021	482 (25.9%)	518 (27.8%)	493 (26.5%)	308 (16.6%)	57 (3.1%)	1 (0.1%)
2022	472 (26.9%)	512 (29.2%)	432 (24.7%)	282 (16.1%)	54 (3.1%)	0 (0%)
2023	433	524	556	374	71	2

Year	Age groups					
	29 or below	**30 to 39**	**40 to 49**	**50 to 59**	**60 to 69**	**70 or above**
	(22.1%)	(26.7%)	(28.4%)	(19.1%)	(3.6%)	(0.1%)
2024	340 (13.8%)	576 (23.4%)	898 (36.5%)	551 (22.4%)	94 (3.8%)	1 (0.1%)
2025	380 (16.3%)	560 (24.1%)	797 (34.3%)	480 (20.6%)	107 (4.6%)	2 (0.1%)
2026 (as at end-February)	62 (19.4%)	72 (22.6%)	93 (29.1%)	79 (24.8%)	12 (3.8%)	1 (0.3%)

Note: The TD does not maintain the statistics on those newly issued with a valid full driving licence for PLB who are imported drivers.

In response to the implementation of the Scheme, the Government ever conducted a public transport manpower study in 2023, which revealed that there were about 6 300 in-service PLB drivers in Hong Kong. The TD does not maintain the information on the age and employment type of PLB drivers.

(5) The Government has been paying close attention to the operating situation of the PLB trade and has implemented various measures to help the trade improve the operating environment. The TD will continue to provide appropriate support to the trade with a view to improving its operating environment and enhancing the service reliability. For example, the TD will introduce new green minibus (GMB) routes as appropriate when planning transport services for new development areas as well as improve the operational efficiency of GMB through adjustment of service schedule and routeing, etc. Where appropriate, the TD has permitted PLBs to park at the PLB stands during non-operating hours to better meet the actual operational needs of the trade. As for manpower, apart from the Scheme, the Government continues to implement various measures with a view to assisting and encouraging the trade to boost local driver recruitment, including the relaxation of application requirements for driving licence for commercial vehicles, co-ordination of the trade's participation in various employment schemes, promotion of diversified local recruitment channels and introduction of relevant training courses of the trade, etc. At the same time, through the collaboration of the TD and the Employees Retraining Board (ERB), ERB as well as the PLB operators and third-party training organisations jointly launched the placement-tied driving training scheme in 2024 with the GMB trade as a pilot with a view to encouraging local workers to join the PLB trade. The first batch of trainees was deployed to driving duties for designated GMB routes (after completion of the training courses and obtaining the required driving licences) in the second quarter of 2025. The ERB continued the placement-tied driving training scheme for the GMB trade in 2025. Some trainees of the second batch who have obtained the required driving licences and completed route training, are already deployed to driving duties for designated GMB routes in January 2026.

The Government will continue to encourage the PLB operators to improve the remuneration package of their staff through various means, such as increasing wages and paid leave so as to create a more desirable working environment and attract more new blood to join the trade, as well as to employ part-time drivers to meet the manpower demand for services during peak hours.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 Reply Serial No.

TLB223

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0769)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development,
(2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the manpower of local coach and cross-boundary coach drivers, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) as it is learned that all 800 coach driver quotas under the Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector – Public Light Bus/Coach Trade (the Scheme) have been approved, the number of drivers who have successfully obtained the local driving licence and have been deployed to services up to date, with a breakdown by driver job type;

(2) as there are views that there is still a shortage of local coach and cross-boundary coach drivers, whether consideration will be given to increasing the relevant driver quotas under the Scheme and launching another round of applications;

(3) (a) the number of persons holding a valid full driving licence for public bus and (b) the number of persons newly issued with a full driving licence for public bus (excluding imported drivers) in each of the past five years and this year to date, with a breakdown by age group and the respective percentages;

(4) whether there are statistics on the number of in-service local coach and cross-boundary coach drivers (excluding imported drivers) in each of the past five years and this year to date; if yes, the details with a breakdown by age group and employment type (full time or part-time) and the respective percentages; if no, whether there is a plan to compile the relevant statistics in the future; and

(5) whether it has explored introducing more measures to attract more new drivers to join the industry.

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 22)

Reply:

(1)
The Government has all along been concerned about the long standing driver shortage problem faced by the local and cross-boundary coach trade. To alleviate the problem of labour shortage in the trade, the Government announced the Scheme in June 2023, and approved 800 coach driver quotas through two rounds of applications in September 2023 and July 2024 respectively. All applications were vetted by the inter-departmental liaison group (comprising representatives from the Transport and Logistics Bureau, the Labour Department and the Transport Department (TD)). Imported drivers must pass the relevant vehicle type driving test, complete a pre-service course and receive its certification before they can obtain a formal driving licence for the relevant vehicle type. As at end-February 2026, a total of 735 imported coach drivers had passed the local driving test and were deployed to driving duties.

(2)
In response to the gradual expiry of the contracts of the first batch of imported workers by the end of 2025, the TD has announced the quota renewal arrangements in August 2025. The operators with allocated quotas should submit renewal applications to the TD five months prior to the expiry of the contracts of their imported drivers. As at end-February 2026, 265 local and cross-boundary coach driver quotas was granted with approval for renewal. At present, the TD has no plans to adjust the total number of quotas. In future, the TD will continue to pay attention to the changes in the local labour market and the manpower situation, review the implementation of the Scheme and, assess the manpower demand of the industries. At the same time, the TD will maintain close liaison with various stakeholders, and enhance information dissemination through the stakeholders consultative group, as well as review the Scheme in a timely manner with reference to the opinions.

(3)
The numbers and percentages of persons holding a valid full driving licence for public bus in the past five years (as at the end of each year) and in 2026 up to end-February, with breakdown by age group, are set out below:

Year	Age groups					
	29 or below	30 to 39	40 to 49	50 to 59	60 to 69	70 or above
2021	1 583 (1.2%)	10 250 (7.5%)	28 770 (21.0%)	41 351 (30.2%)	42 989 (31.3%)	12 036 (8.8%)
2022	1 636 (1.2%)	9 047 (6.6%)	27 651 (20.2%)	40 237 (29.5%)	44 828 (32.8%)	13 329 (9.7%)
2023	1 687 (1.2%)	8 183 (6.0%)	26 449 (19.3%)	39 061 (28.5%)	46 800 (34.1%)	15 023 (10.9%)
2024	1 621 (1.2%)	7 649 (5.6%)	25 303 (18.4%)	38 478 (28.0%)	47 875 (34.8%)	16 580 (12.0%)
2025	1 602 (1.2%)	7 156 (5.2%)	24 301 (17.7%)	37 626 (27.5%)	48 431 (35.3%)	18 014 (13.1%)
2026 (as at end-February)	1 606 (1.2%)	7 102 (5.2%)	24 093 (17.6%)	37 500 (27.4%)	48 403 (35.3%)	18 234 (13.3%)

The numbers and percentages persons newly issued with a valid full driving licence for public bus in the same period, with breakdown by age group, are set out below:

Year	Age groups					
	29 or below	30 to 39	40 to 49	50 to 59	60 to 69	70 or above
2021	432 (29.5%)	420 (28.6%)	378 (25.8%)	213 (14.5%)	24 (1.6%)	0 (0%)
2022	454 (28.8%)	463 (29.4%)	388 (24.6%)	241 (15.3%)	31 (1.9%)	0 (0%)
2023	429 (22.4%)	509 (26.6%)	574 (30.0%)	348 (18.2%)	53 (2.7%)	1 (0.1%)
2024	349 (14.8%)	544 (23.2%)	934 (39.8%)	448 (19.1%)	73 (3.1%)	0 (0%)
2025	390 (17.5%)	522 (23.4%)	800 (35.9%)	455 (20.4%)	61 (2.7%)	1 (0.1%)
2026 (as at end-February)	60 (21.2%)	72 (25.4%)	83 (29.3%)	61 (21.6%)	7 (2.5%)	0 (0%)

Note: The TD does not maintain the statistics on those newly issued with a valid full driving licence for public bus who are imported drivers.

(4)
In response to the implementation of the Scheme, the Government ever conducted a public transport manpower study in 2023, which revealed that there were about 7 400 in-service coach drivers in Hong Kong. The TD does not maintain the information on the age and employment type of public bus drivers. The TD has been maintaining close communication with the trade and keeping tracks of the situation of driver shortage through regular meetings and monitoring of daily services.

(5)
Apart from the Scheme, the Government continues to implement various measures to assist and encourage the trade in local driver recruitment, including the relaxation of application requirements for driving licence for commercial vehicles, co-ordination of the trade's participation in various employment schemes, promotion of diversified local recruitment channels and introduction of relevant training courses of the trade, etc.

The Government will also continue to encourage the local and cross-boundary coach operators to improve the remuneration package of their staff through various means, such as increasing wages and paid leave so as to create a more desirable working environment and attract more new blood to join the trade, as well as to employ part-time drivers to meet the manpower demand for services during peak hours.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2423)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding various road tunnels and strategic routes, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

(1) (i) the design capacities, and (ii) peak-hour and (iii) non-peak hour utilisation rates of various (a) road tunnels and (b) strategic routes in each of the past three years;

(2) the operating and maintenance expenditures for various (a) road tunnels and (b) strategic routes in each of the past three years;

(3) a comparison of (a) the average daily traffic flow on weekdays (with a breakdown by vehicle type) and (b) the average longest traffic queues in the morning peak hours on weekdays at the three road harbour crossings (RHCs) before and after the implementation of time-varying tolls.

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 9)

Reply:

(1) The design capacities, and peak-hour and non-peak hour utilisation rates (measured by ratios of traffic volume/design capacity) of various road tunnels in the past three years (i.e. 2023-2025) are set out at **Annex 1.** Regarding the statistics on the government strategic routes, as the Annual Traffic Census 2025 is still under compilation, the traffic volume statistics from 2022 to 2024 are provided and set out at **Annex 2**.

(2) The expenditures of various government road tunnels in the past three financial years are set out at **Annex 3**.

The Highways Department does not maintain separate statistics on the maintenance cost of individual road (including strategic routes).

(3) The Government has implemented time-varying tolls since 17 December 2023 at the three RHCs, namely the Western Harbour Crossing (WHC), the Cross Harbour Tunnel

(CHT) and the Eastern Harbour Crossing (EHC). The average daily traffic flows on weekdays and the average longest traffic queues in the morning peak hours on weekdays by vehicle type before and after the implementation of the new tolls are set out at **Annex 4** and **Annex 5** respectively.

Annex 1

Design Capacities and Peak-hour [2] and Non-peak Hour [2] Utilisation Rates of Road Tunnels

Tunnel[1]	Design capacity (vehicle/hour)	Utilisation rate [3]					
		2023		2024		2025	
		Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour
Aberdeen Tunnel	2 600	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8
CHT	2 600	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.0	1.1	1.0
EHC	2 600	1.0	1.0	1.1	0.9	1.1	1.0
WHC	4 200	0.9	0.7	1.0	0.8	1.0	1.0
Lion Rock Tunnel	2 600	1.1	1.0	1.1	1.0	1.1	1.0
Tate's Cairn Tunnel	2 600	1.0	0.7	1.0	0.8	1.0	0.8
Eagle's Nest Tunnel and Sha Tin Heights Tunnel	4 700	0.7	0.5	0.8	0.5	0.8	0.5
Shing Mun Tunnels	2 600	0.8	0.6	0.8	0.6	0.8	0.6
Tai Lam Tunnel [4]	4 200	0.6	0.3	0.6	0.3	0.9	0.5
Central Kowloon Bypass [5]	4 200	N/A				0.5	0.5

Note 1: The Transport Department (TD) does not have the data of Discovery Bay Tunnel which was built and is currently managed by a private company for the exclusive use of authorised vehicles only.

Note 2: The figures listed in the table represent the annual average traffic flow of the above tunnels from Mondays to Fridays (except public holidays) between 2023 and 2025, according to the toll collection system. Except for the three RHCs, "peak hour" refers to the busiest one hour from 7 a.m. to 10 a.m. and from 5 p.m. to 8 p.m. in the busiest direction, while "non-peak hour" refers to the busiest one hour during the remaining hours in the busiest direction. To more accurately reflect the cross-harbour traffic flow, "peak-hour" of the three RHCs refers to the busiest one hour from 7:30 a.m. to 10:30 a.m. and from 4:30 p.m. to 7:30 p.m.

Note 3: The utilisation rates have not taken into account those vehicles queueing to enter the tunnels and do not reflect the actual traffic demand against the design capacity. The actual traffic capacity of the tunnels may be affected by other traffic factors, including the

proportions of different types of vehicles using the road section concerned, geometry of the road section, etc. Therefore, a mere comparison between the actual traffic volume and the design capacity may not truly reflect the actual traffic condition.

Note 4: With reference to the actual vehicle mix after the Government's takeover of Tai Lam Tunnel and the toll reduction in 2025, the tunnel's design capacity is adjusted to 4 200 vehicles per hour, and the utilisation rate in 2025 is also calculated on the basis of the traffic flow after the takeover of Tai Lam tunnel.

Note 5: The Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section) commenced operation on 21 December 2025. All-day fixed toll of $8 for all vehicle types will be charged upon its full commissioning as the tenth tolled tunnel this year. Therefore, its utilisation rates during peak and non-peak hours in 2025 are calculated on the basis of the data from Mondays to Fridays (except public holidays) between 21 and 31 December 2025, and the traffic flow has yet to stabilise.

Annex 2

Design Capacities and Peak-hour [1] and Non-peak Hour [1] Utilisation Rates of Strategic Routes

Road section	Strategic route [2]	Design capacity (vehicle/hour)	Utilisation rate					
			2022		2023		2024	
			Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour
Hong Kong Island								
Harcourt Road (westbound between Tamar Street and Arsenal Street)	Route 4	9 450	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6
Central-Wan Chai Bypass	Route 4	4 700	0.4	0.3	0.5	0.4	0.5	0.4
Kowloon								
Princess Margaret Road (between Wylie Road and Pui Ching Road)	Route 1	4 700	0.5	0.5	0.6	0.5	0.6	0.5
Kwun Tong Bypass (between Kai Yan Street and Lung Cheung Road)	Route 2	4 700	0.6	0.5	0.6	0.5	0.6	0.5
West Kowloon Highway (between Lin Cheung Road and Hing Wah Street West)	Route 3	4 700	0.7	0.7	0.8	0.7	0.9	0.7
East Kowloon Corridor (between Ma Tau Kok Road and Chatham Road North)	Route 5	3 000	1.0	0.9	1.0	0.9	1.1	1.0
Lung Cheung Road (between Nam Cheong Street and Lion Rock Tunnel Road)	Route 7	4 700	0.8	0.7	0.9	0.8	0.8	0.8
New Territories								

Road section	Strategic route [2]	Design capacity (vehicle/hour)	Utilisation rate					
			2022		2023		2024	
			Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour	Peak-hour	Non-peak hour
Ting Kau Bridge	Route 3	4 700	1.1	0.7	1.2	0.8	1.2	0.7
Nam Wan Tunnel	Route 8	4 700	0.4	0.3	0.5	0.4	0.5	0.4
Tolo Highway (between Ma Liu Shui Interchange and Yuen Shin Road Interchange)	Route 9	6 300	1.1	0.8	1.1	0.8	1.2	0.8
Fanling Highway (between So Kwun Po Interchange and Wo Hop Shek Interchange)	Route 9	4 700	0.6	0.4	0.6	0.6	0.7	0.6
Tuen Mun Road (eastbound between Sham Tseng and Tsing Long Highway, including the slip road from Sham Tseng)	Route 9	6 300	0.9	0.7	0.9	0.7	0.9	0.7
Kong Sham Western Highway (between Yick Yuen Road and Shenzhen Bay Bridge)	Route 10	4 700	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.2	0.2

Note 1: The figures listed in the table represent the traffic flow of various transport facilities from Mondays to Fridays (except public holidays) between 2022 and 2024. "Peak hour" refers to the busiest one hour from 7 a.m. to 10 a.m. and from 5 p.m. to 8 p.m. in the busiest direction, while "non-peak hour" refers to the busiest one hour during the remaining hours in the busiest direction.

Note 2: Route 6 comprises the Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section), the Central Kowloon Bypass (Kowloon Bay Section), and the Tseung Kwan O–Lam Tin Tunnel. Since the entire Route 6 is scheduled for commissioning this year, its utilisation rate is currently not available.

Annex 3

Operating Expenditures of Government Road Tunnels from 2022-23 to 2024-25

Tolled tunnel/ Control area [1,4]	2022-23 ($ million)	2023-24 ($ million)	2024-25 ($ million)
CHT	158	199	196
EHC	179	228	240
WHC [2]	N/A	241	328
Tate's Cairn Tunnel	143	167	175
Aberdeen Tunnel	97	125	134
Lion Rock Tunnel	91	136	121
Shing Mun Tunnels	125	152	135
Route 8	342	391	372
Tai Lam Tunnel [3]	N/A	N/A	N/A

Note 1： The expenditures set out in the table include the management fees paid to the management, operation and maintenance contractors, the relevant operating and maintenance expenditure for the implementation of HKeToll, depreciation charges of capital costs and expenditure on government maintenance works of the tunnels for the years concerned.

Note 2： WHC was returned to the government management on 2 August 2023. The figure for 2023-24 is for the period from 2 August 2023 to 31 March 2024.

Note 3： The Tai Lam Tunnel was returned to government management on 31 May 2025.

Note 4： The Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei section) commenced operation on 21 December 2025. All-day fixed toll of $8 for all vehicle types will be charged upon the full commissioning of the Central Kowloon Bypass this year.

Toll-free tunnel [5]	2022-23 ($ million)	2023-24 ($ million)	2024-25 ($ million)
Tuen Mun-Chek Lap Kok Tunnel	73	79	81
Tseung Kwan O Tunnel [6]	35	31	44
Tseung Kwan O-Lam Tin Tunnel [6]	19	62	62
Central-Wan Chai Bypass Tunnel	148	148	152
Lung Shan Tunnel	61	57	57
Cheung Shan Tunnel	19	25	26
Airport Tunnel	26	26	26
Scenic Hill Tunnel	55	55	58
Kai Tak Tunnel	54	54	49

Note 5： Government toll-free tunnels are not included in the Operating Account of Government Toll-Tunnels. The expenditures set out in the table represent the management fees paid to the management, operation and maintenance contractors for the years concerned, excluding the depreciation charges of capital costs and the

expenditure on government maintenance works of the tunnels for the years concerned.

Note 6： Tseung Kwan O − Lam Tin Tunnel commenced operation on 11 December 2022, and the toll of Tseung Kwan O Tunnel was waived on the same day. The figure of Tseung Kwan O − Lam Tin Tunnel for 2022-23 is for the period from 11 December 2022 to 31 March 2023.

Annex 4

Average Daily Traffic Flows on Weekdays by Vehicle Type
at the Three RHCs Before and After the Implementation of New Tolls (in Two-way Vehicles) [1]

	WHC					
	Private car	**Motorcycle [4]**	**Taxi**	**Bus [5]**	**Light bus [6]**	**Goods vehicle**
Before the implementation of new tolls [2]	43 200	1 600	26 400	4 500	400	11 200
After the implementation of new tolls [3]	57 500	2 200	21 600	6 000	400	20 800

Note:
1. Cross-harbour traffic flows on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays)
2. Referring to the period from 4 to 8 December 2023
3. Referring to the period between January and December 2025, before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays
4. "Motorcycle" includes motor tricycles
5. "Bus" includes both public and private buses
6. "Light bus" includes both public and private light buses

Annex 4

Average Daily Traffic Flows on Weekdays by Vehicle Type
at the Three RHCs Before and After the Implementation of New Tolls (in Two-way Vehicles) [1]

	CHT					
	Private car	**Motorcycle [4]**	**Taxi**	**Bus [5]**	**Light bus [6]**	**Goods vehicle**
Before the implementation of new tolls [2]	51 800	5 000	13 500	7 100	900	26 700
After the implementation of new tolls [3]	55 800	3 600	16 300	5 200	500	12 300

Note:
1. Cross-harbour traffic flows on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays)
2. Referring to the period from 4 to 8 December 2023
3. Referring to the period between January and December 2025, before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays
4. "Motorcycle" includes motor tricycles
5. "Bus" includes both public and private buses
6. "Light bus" includes both public and private light buses

Annex 4

Average Daily Traffic Flows on Weekdays by Vehicle Type
at the Three RHCs Before and After the Implementation of New Tolls (in Two-way Vehicles) [1]

	EHC					
	Private car	**Motorcycle [4]**	**Taxi**	**Bus [5]**	**Light bus [6]**	**Goods vehicle**
Before the implementation of new tolls [2]	46 100	3 100	14 000	3 000	700	12 300
After the implementation of new tolls [3]	41 400	2 700	11 900	3 200	600	11 600

Note:
1. Cross-harbour traffic flows on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays)
2. Referring to the period from 4 to 8 December 2023
3. Referring to the period between January and December 2025, before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays
4. "Motorcycle" includes motor tricycles
5. "Bus" includes both public and private buses
6. "Light bus" includes both public and private light buses

Annex 5

Average Longest Traffic Queues
in the Morning Peak Hours on Weekdays at the Three RHCs (km)

	WHC [3]	**CHT**	**EHC [6]**
Before the implementation of new tolls [1]	1.2	3.0 [4]	1.7
After the implementation of new tolls [2]	1.8	1.9 [5]	1.4

Note:
1. During the period in December 2023
2. The period between January and December 2025, excluding the days affected by summer holidays and public holidays
3. Comparison with the traffic queue at West Kowloon Highway
4. Longest traffic queue forming at Gascoigne Road Flyover
5. Longest traffic queue forming at Princess Margaret Road
6. Comparison with the traffic queue at Kwun Tong Bypass

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3027)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the provision of parking spaces, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. the numbers of parking spaces for private cars, motorcycles and commercial vehicles (CVs) in each of the past three years (up to the end of that year); and the ratios of the total number of parking spaces to the number of the corresponding type of licensed vehicles during the same period;

2. The numbers of on-street parking spaces, parking spaces provided at government and privately-operated car parks in various districts in Hong Kong in each of the past three years (up to the end of that year), with a breakdown by vehicle type (e.g. goods vehicles, coaches/ buses);

3. the specific work done by the Government to increase the provision of parking spaces for CVs, including the measures adopted, the total number of newly provided parking spaces, and the applicable vehicle types in the past three years ; and

4. the estimated increase in parking spaces for CVs in the coming year, and the relevant details.

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 8)

Reply:

1. The numbers of licensed private cars, licensed motorcycles and licensed CVs in Hong Kong, and the corresponding numbers of parking spaces and the ratios to these vehicles in the past three years, are tabulated below:

Vehicle type	Year (as at end of each year)	Number of licensed vehicles	Number of parking spaces	Ratio of the number of parking spaces to the number of licensed vehicles
Private car	2025	633 988	723 666	1 : 1.14
	2024	628 790	715 518	1 : 1.14
	2023	632 174	713 240	1 : 1.13
Motorcycle	2025	72 134	43 442	1 : 0.60
	2024	72 614	41 775	1 : 0.58
	2023	73 480	39 864	1 : 0.54
Commercial Vehicle	2025	66 753	44 565	1 : 0.67
	2024	67 243	44 239	1 : 0.66
	2023	69 737	45 388	1 : 0.65

2. The numbers of on-street parking spaces, parking spaces provided at the Government and privately-operated car parks in the 18 districts by CV type in the past three years are tabulated in **Annex 1**, **Annex 2** and **Annex 3** respectively.

3. The measures taken to provide additional CV parking spaces and the progress made in the past three years are set out at **Annex 4**.

4. The Government expects to provide over 12 000 additional parking spaces across the territory in 2025 and 2026, covering both private cars and CVs, including more than 220 metered parking spaces and a minimum of 100 on-street night-time parking spaces for CVs by 2026. Furthermore, in addition to providing about 600 parking spaces at short-term tenancy (STT) car parks, a minimum number of CV parking spaces will also be specified for suitable car parks over the next two years. The Transport Department (TD) and relevant departments are actively taking forward these measures in accordance with the targets.

Besides, the first three public vehicle parks (PVPs) [Note] implemented under the "single site, multiple use" (SSMU) principle have been commissioned, providing a total of 140 CV parking spaces. With the successive commissioning of more PVP projects, including District Open Space, Sports Centre and Public Vehicle Park at Sze Mei Street, the redevelopment of Yuen Long Stadium, and the Kwun Tong Composite Development Project, etc., which are expected to be completed between 2026 and 2027, a total of about 70 CV parking spaces will be provided. Together with other development projects and the ongoing short- and medium-term parking measures, the provision of new CV parking spaces will further increase in the future. The TD will continue to step up its efforts, focusing on areas with a shortage of parking spaces to increase the provision of on-street parking spaces as far as practicable. It will also continue to stipulate the provision of a minimum number of parking spaces for CVs in suitable STT car parks.

Note: Including Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park in Sheung Shui, the Pak Shing Kok Road Public Car Park in Tseung Kwan O and the Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park

Annex 1

Numbers of on-street parking spaces in 18 districts by vehicle type in the past three years

District	As at December of each year	Private Car [Note 1]	Goods Vehicle	Coach/ Bus	Motorcycle	Total [Note 2]
Central & Western	2025	509	202	11	651	1 373
	2024	509	202	11	651	1 373
	2023	508	193	11	651	1 363
Wan Chai	2025	1 040	24	43	784	1 891
	2024	1 029	25	53	779	1 886
	2023	1 017	24	48	761	1 850
Eastern	2025	535	101	66	826	1 528
	2024	536	101	65	807	1 509
	2023	529	91	75	818	1 513
Southern	2025	655	51	85	461	1 252
	2024	653	51	85	447	1 236
	2023	645	50	85	447	1 227
Yau Tsim Mong	2025	1 592	369	141	1 349	3 451
	2024	1 586	369	141	1 319	3 415
	2023	1 561	363	138	1 309	3 371
Sham Shui Po	2025	1 296	219	10	919	2 444
	2024	1 295	220	12	884	2 411
	2023	1 273	229	9	876	2 387
Kowloon City	2025	2 373	157	154	1 025	3 709
	2024	2 378	143	160	1 002	3 683
	2023	2 336	143	134	991	3 604
Wong Tai Sin	2025	321	133	0	570	1 024
	2024	316	129	0	545	990
	2023	306	129	0	519	954
Kwun Tong	2025	600	134	56	998	1 788
	2024	586	120	53	921	1 680
	2023	531	115	42	834	1 522
Tsuen Wan	2025	868	67	31	755	1 721
	2024	859	69	31	700	1 659
	2023	888	63	31	629	1 611
Tuen Mun	2025	1 321	338	113	876	2 648
	2024	1 297	329	113	892	2 631
	2023	1 267	330	113	886	2 596
Yuen Long	2025	1 240	445	78	624	2 387
	2024	1 266	419	110	636	2 431
	2023	1 308	427	114	626	2 475
North	2025	1 388	354	29	389	2 160
	2024	1 406	365	32	424	2 227
	2023	1 283	359	27	424	2 093

District	As at December of each year	Private Car [Note 1]	Goods Vehicle	Coach/ Bus	Motorcycle	Total [Note 2]
Tai Po	2025	1 603	339	86	301	2 329
	2024	1 601	352	86	280	2 319
	2023	1 556	359	84	270	2 269
Sai Kung	2025	1 941	319	159	530	2 949
	2024	1 930	316	146	505	2 897
	2023	1 932	305	155	481	2 873
Sha Tin	2025	1 474	338	61	649	2 522
	2024	1 600	337	67	602	2 606
	2023	1 600	335	64	514	2 513
Kwai Tsing	2025	484	376	31	898	1 789
	2024	484	360	21	772	1 637
	2023	424	353	21	726	1 524
Islands	2025	640	67	78	261	1 046
	2024	640	67	78	261	1 046
	2023	517	55	75	205	852
Total	**2025**	**19 880**	**4 033**	**1 232**	**12 866**	**38 011**
	2024	**19 971**	**3 974**	**1 264**	**12 427**	**37 636**
	2023	**19 481**	**3 923**	**1 226**	**11 967**	**36 597**

Note 1: These parking spaces are intended for parking private cars, taxis, and light buses, tricycles and light goods vehicles of similar dimensions.

Note 2: The figures exclude about 370 parking spaces reserved for special public services such as refuse collection or post offices' vehicles.

Annex 2

Numbers of parking spaces provided at the Government car parks in 18 districts by vehicle type in the past three years [Note 1]

District	As at December of each year	Private Car	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total
Central & Western	2025	3 812	377	13	345	4 547
	2024	3 821	425	13	345	4 604
	2023	3 903	426	13	343	4 685
Wan Chai	2025	2 428	230	11	267	2 936
	2024	2 428	401	11	265	3 105
	2023	2 578	230	11	263	3 082
Eastern	2025	3 181	346	21	382	3 930
	2024	3 179	346	21	382	3 928
	2023	3 165	346	33	382	3 926
Southern	2025	2 648	177	10	488	3 323
	2024	2 676	177	10	488	3 351
	2023	2 681	182	10	488	3 361
Yau Tsim Mong	2025	875	172	18	34	1 099
	2024	900	180	18	34	1 132
	2023	976	253	20	34	1 283
Sham Shui Po	2025	4 125	1 170	26	512	5 833
	2024	4 021	1 175	26	512	5 734
	2023	4 050	1 175	33	504	5 762
Kowloon City	2025	3 131	111	7	253	3 502
	2024	3 183	135	5	257	3 580
	2023	3 179	134	7	247	3 567
Wong Tai Sin	2025	4 382	282	43	615	5 322
	2024	4 288	295	44	590	5 217
	2023	4 187	285	44	561	5 077
Kwun Tong	2025	7 357	430	23	1 493	9 303
	2024	7 658	520	30	1 509	9 717
	2023	7 702	511	34	1 482	9 729
Tsuen Wan	2025	1 890	121	4	244	2 259
	2024	1 890	121	4	244	2 259
	2023	1 868	121	4	244	2 237
Tuen Mun	2025	3 804	179	48	239	4 270
	2024	3 801	179	48	239	4 267
	2023	3 769	179	46	232	4 226
Yuen Long	2025	3 346	111	36	242	3 735
	2024	3 346	111	36	242	3 735
	2023	3 301	112	46	238	3 697
North	2025	4 373	529	55	270	5 227
	2024	4 443	417	55	270	5 185

District	As at December of each year	Private Car	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total
	2023	3 820	411	55	254	4 540
Tai Po	2025	1 112	208	8	96	1 424
	2024	1 121	208	8	96	1 433
	2023	1 110	208	15	96	1 429
Sai Kung	2025	2 239	121	63	230	2 653
	2024	1 945	73	51	208	2 277
	2023	1 941	73	66	206	2 286
Sha Tin	2025	4 532	161	32	492	5 217
	2024	4 642	182	32	501	5 357
	2023	4 479	179	31	482	5 171
Kwai Tsing	2025	4 777	575	12	893	6 257
	2024	5 049	579	12	901	6 541
	2023	4 905	564	12	855	6 336
Islands	2025	2 220	71	39	136	2 466
	2024	2 222	71	39	136	2 468
	2023	2 111	242	17	114	2 484
Total	**2025**	**60 232**	**5 371**	**469**	**7 231**	**73 303**
	2024	**60 613**	**5 595**	**463**	**7 219**	**73 890**
	2023	**59 725**	**5 631**	**497**	**7 025**	**72 878**

Note 1: The above parking information is collated from the data provided by various departments or the concerned car park management companies or operators, and is for general reference only. The actual number of parking spaces may vary as the departments, management companies or operators responsible for managing the car parks may make adjustments to the numbers/types of parking spaces to suit their own requirements.

Annex 3

Numbers of parking spaces provided at the privately-operated car parks in 18 districts by vehicle type in the past three years [Note 1]

District	As at December of each year	Private Car	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total
Central & Western	2025	34 805	451	60	608	35 924
	2024	34 750	439	59	601	35 849
	2023	34 045	385	58	483	34 971
Wan Chai	2025	35 789	88	90	384	36 351
	2024	35 523	88	90	359	36 060
	2023	35 138	83	97	321	35 639
Eastern	2025	43 200	1 420	171	1 602	46 393
	2024	42 914	1 403	193	1 562	46 072
	2023	43 136	1 389	227	1 455	46 207
Southern	2025	37 780	910	188	1 111	39 989
	2024	36 970	894	179	1 079	39 122
	2023	36 751	892	177	1 053	38 873
Yau Tsim Mong	2025	33 217	775	88	836	34 916
	2024	33 153	773	86	786	34 798
	2023	33 421	774	101	797	35 093
Sham Shui Po	2025	26 376	1 731	392	968	29 467
	2024	26 215	1 820	386	929	29 350
	2023	25 305	1 905	387	854	28 451
Kowloon City	2025	49 994	1 140	92	1 352	52 578
	2024	47 634	1 171	104	1 186	50 095
	2023	46 646	1 090	154	1 045	48 935
Wong Tai Sin	2025	15 877	865	47	1 406	18 195
	2024	16 132	874	47	1 426	18 479
	2023	16 472	865	45	1 328	18 710
Kwun Tong	2025	40 556	3 089	58	2 706	46 409
	2024	40 976	3 044	39	2 576	46 635
	2023	41 130	2 896	47	2 449	46 522
Tsuen Wan	2025	35 916	1 868	365	1 050	39 199
	2024	35 644	1 914	374	883	38 815
	2023	35 826	1 960	362	886	39 034
Tuen Mun	2025	39 120	2 036	91	1 102	42 349
	2024	38 655	2 047	91	1 097	41 890
	2023	38 658	2 038	93	958	41 747
Yuen Long	2025	40 134	1 475	287	1 276	43 172
	2024	39 363	1 621	288	1 149	42 421
	2023	39 436	1 524	287	1 110	42 357
North	2025	17 516	754	32	412	18 714
	2024	17 511	735	32	411	18 689
	2023	17 842	975	32	380	19 229

District	As at December of each year	Private Car	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total
Tai Po	2025	31 561	653	79	906	33 199
	2024	29 771	613	58	875	31 317
	2023	29 763	641	54	850	31 308
Sai Kung	2025	41 849	1 233	163	3 000	46 245
	2024	41 071	1 176	146	2 955	45 348
	2023	40 415	1 076	148	2 759	44 398
Sha Tin	2025	70 125	2 181	102	2 482	74 890
	2024	70 266	2 204	102	2 407	74 979
	2023	71 024	2 310	101	2 376	75 811
Kwai Tsing	2025	30 848	9 094	348	1 540	41 830
	2024	30 845	8 628	181	1 478	41 132
	2023	31 004	9 658	396	1 378	42 436
Islands	2025	18 891	870	174	604	20 539
	2024	17 541	870	174	370	18 955
	2023	18 022	708	176	390	19 296
Total	**2025**	**643 554**	**30 633**	**2 827**	**23 345**	**700 359**
	2024	**634 934**	**30 314**	**2 629**	**22 129**	**690 006**
	2023	**634 034**	**31 169**	**2 942**	**20 872**	**689 017**

Note 1: The above parking information is collated from the data provided by various departments or the concerned car park management companies or operators, and is for general reference only. The actual number of parking spaces may vary as the car park providers, management companies or operators responsible for managing the car parks may make adjustments to the numbers/types of parking spaces to suit their own requirements.

Annex 4

Progress of providing additional CV parking spaces
(as at December 2025)

	Measure	Progress	Vehicle Type
1.	Designating suitable on-street locations as on-street parking spaces, including night-time parking spaces	● About 2 240 additional on-street parking spaces have been provided between 2023 and 2025 ● A total of about 38 010 on-street parking spaces are provided up to end-2025	goods vehicles, non-franchised buses, light buses, taxis
2.	Stipulating the provision of a minimum number of parking spaces for CVs in the tenancy agreement of suitable STT car parks	● At least about 180 parking spaces for CVs have been provided, as stipulated in the tenancy agreement between 2023 and 2025 ● At least about 2 030 parking spaces for CVs are involved up to end-2025	goods vehicles, non-franchised buses, light buses
3.	Encouraging schools to allow student service vehicles to park within school premises during non-school hours	● Seven more schools have provided a total of 26 parking spaces for student service vehicles between 2023 and 2025 ● 42 schools have provided a total of 126 parking spaces for student service vehicles to park during non-school hours up to end-2025	non-franchised buses, light buses
4.	Increasing public parking spaces including those for CVs in suitable "Government, Institution or Community" facilities and public open space projects	● The first three PVPs implemented under SSMU have been commissioned, of which Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park in Sheung Shui was commissioned in November 2024, while the Pak Shing Kok Road Public Car Park in Tseung Kwan O and the Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park were commissioned in December 2025. The three projects have provided a total of 860 parking spaces, of which	goods vehicles, non-franchised buses, light buses

	Measure	Progress	Vehicle Type
		140 are CV parking spaces.	
5.	Opening up a certain number of ancillary parking spaces and loading/unloading bays in suitable new developments as night-time public parking spaces for CVs	● Ancillary parking spaces and loading/unloading bays have been opened up in four new developments for sale, providing about 270 night-time public parking spaces for CVs	goods vehicles, non-franchised buses, taxis

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3030)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development,
(2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding manpower of taxi drivers, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(1) the numbers of candidates attending and passing the taxi written test as well as the pass rate in each of the past five years and this year to date;

(2) the numbers of (a) holders and (b) new holders of a valid full driving licence for taxi in each of the past five years and this year to date, with a breakdown by age group and their respective percentages;

(3) the numbers of active taxi drivers in each of the past five years and this year to date, with a breakdown by age groups and mode of employment (full time or part-time) as well as their respective percentages; and

(4) whether the Government has assessed the shortage of drivers for the taxi industry in Hong Kong and what are the measures to increase the supply of taxi drivers, including whether consideration will be given to importing drivers?

Asked by: Hon LAM Ming-fung, Lothair (LegCo internal reference no.: 24)

Reply:

(1) The numbers of candidates attending and passing the taxi written test as well as the pass rate in the past five years (as at the end of each year) and up to end-February this year are as follows:

Year	No. of candidates attending the test	No. of candidates passing the test	Pass rate
2021	10 189	6 164	60%
2022	7 654	4 551	59%

Year	No. of candidates attending the test	No. of candidates passing the test	Pass rate
2023	11 398	6 874	60%
2024	13 813	8 259	60%
2025	13 816	8 009	58%
2026 (as at end-February)	2 888	1 793	62%

(2) The numbers of holders of a valid full driving licence for taxi broken down by age group and their respective percentages in the past five years (as at the end of each year) and up to end-February this year are set out below:

Year	Age group					
	29 or below	30 to 39	40 to 49	50 to 59	60 to 69	70 or above
2021	1 931 (0.9%)	9 224 (4.5%)	20 897 (10.3%)	54 472 (26.7%)	89 655 (44.0%)	27 701 (13.6%)
2022	2 260 (1.1%)	9 475 (4.7%)	20 897 (10.3%)	49 271 (24.1%)	91 483 (44.8%)	30 656 (15.0%)
2023	2 778 (1.3%)	10 343 (5.0%)	21 596 (10.4%)	44 575 (21.6%)	93 661 (45.3%)	33 931 (16.4%)
2024	3 424 (1.6%)	11 832 (5.6%)	22 568 (10.8%)	41 585 (19.8%)	93 867 (44.7%)	36 754 (17.5%)
2025	3 925 (1.9%)	13 075 (6.2%)	23 779 (11.2%)	39 185 (18.5%)	92 461 (43.6%)	39 423 (18.6%)
2026 (as at end-February)	4 062 (1.9%)	13 343 (6.3%)	24 038 (11.3%)	38 926 (18.3%)	92 126 (43.4%)	39 703 (18.8%)

The numbers of new holders of a valid full driving licence for taxi broken down by age group and their respective percentages in the same period are set out below:

Year	Age group					
	29 or below	30 to 39	40 to 49	50 to 59	60 to 69	70 or above
2021	1 022 (19.2%)	1 566 (29.5%)	1 402 (26.4%)	1 022 (19.2%)	295 (5.6%)	3 (0.1%)
2022	811 (18.1%)	1 361 (30.4%)	1 234 (27.5%)	838 (18.7%)	235 (5.2%)	6 (0.1%)
2023	1 067 (16.6%)	1 959 (30.6%)	1 838 (28.7%)	1 160 (18.1%)	370 (5.8%)	16 (0.2%)
2024	1 331 (16.5%)	2 416 (29.9%)	2 278 (28.2%)	1 462 (18.1%)	559 (6.9%)	22 (0.4%)
2025	1 371 (17.7%)	2 244 (29.0%)	2 068 (26.7%)	1 419 (18.3%)	608 (7.9%)	32 (0.4%)
2026	271 (18.8%)	383 (26.5%)	407 (28.2%)	280 (19.4%)	101 (7.0%)	2 (0.1%)

Year	Age group					
	29 or below	**30 to 39**	**40 to 49**	**50 to 59**	**60 to 69**	**70 or above**
(as at end-February)						

(3) The current number of active taxi drivers is about 46 000. The Government does not have the breakdown as mentioned in the question.

(4) The Government has been taking a multi-pronged approach to expand the overall taxi driver supply, including the further enhancement of taxi written test starting from 3 November 2025 by reducing the questions on locations and routes, and adding new questions related to enhancement of taxi service quality, with the aim of maintaining assessment standards while better aligning the questions with the practical needs of the taxi industry. As at 28 February 2026, the average monthly number of candidates applying for the taxi written test increased from about 1 380 prior to the enhancement of the taxi written test to about 1 820 after the enhancement, representing an increase of about 30%. This shows that the measures can effectively attract more people to apply for the taxi written test.

Apart from enhancing the taxi written test, the Government also relaxed the eligibility requirements for taxi driving licences in 2020. The period required for an applicant to hold a private car or light goods vehicle full driving licence has been shortened from a minimum of three years to at least one year. Besides, the Government has implemented a number of measures in recent years to enhance the service quality and overall image of the taxi industry, thereby bringing a positive impact on attracting new blood to join the industry. Such measures include introducing taxi fleets with systematic management, organising the Taxi Service Commendation Scheme, increasing the maximum passenger seating capacity of taxis, introducing a Taxi-Driver-Offence Points system, and relaxing no-stopping restrictions for taxis at designated restricted zones. In addition, the Employees Retraining Board also offers taxi-driver-related training courses to assist participants to join the taxi driver industry. Eligible persons may even receive tuition reductions.

Regarding labour importation for taxi drivers, taxi is a type of personalised point-to-point transport service, drivers should be familiar with the local road network and transport system, and should be able to select the most direct and practical routes to destinations having regard to real-time traffic conditions. Drivers also need to maintain communication with passengers, and adjust routes and drop-off points in accordance with their requests. The nature of taxi services is different from that of public light buses or non-franchised buses which have fixed stopping points and routes. The expectations and demands of passengers for taxi services are also different from those for other public transport modes. At present, the Government has no plans to import labour for the taxi industry.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB227**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0057)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned under Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 that renewal of Belisha beacons at zebra crossings on public roads will be carried out. Please advise this Committee of the following:

(1) According to Item 8A4 under Subhead 603, the approved commitment for the renewal of Belisha beacons is $61.8 million and the accumulated expenditure as at the end of March 2025 is $6.3 million. What is the progress of the renewal of the Belisha beacons? What is the target timetable for replacing all Belisha beacons across Hong Kong? And

(2) What new technologies are adopted in the new generation of Belisha beacons? Has the Government conducted pilot data analysis to assess the reduction in traffic accident rate at zebra crossings resulting from the new Belisha beacons as compared with the old design? Or what indicators are used to evaluate the performance of the new design?

Asked by: Hon LAM Siu-lo, Andrew (LegCo internal reference no.: 23)

Reply:

(1) The Transport Department (TD) has commissioned the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department to replace all traditional Belisha beacons at zebra crossings on public roads in Hong Kong, and the replacement works commenced at the end of 2024. The initial stage of the works mainly involved detailed design and approval of the new Belisha beacons, review on adequacy of foundations of the existing Belisha beacons at various zebra crossings, and trial installations at individual locations. The works proceeded to the mass installation stage in 2025. As at the end of February 2026, replacement works at 148 zebra crossings, accounting for more than 60% of all zebra crossings on public roads across Hong Kong, had been completed. All replacement works are expected to be completed in 2027.

(2) The new beacons consist of a halo of flashing yellow light and a post with flashing white bands. They are more visible than the traditional design of a yellow globe lamp atop a black and white post in drawing the attention of motorists to the presence of zebra crossings and reminding them to stop and give way to pedestrians.

In 2022, TD launched the trial scheme to enhance zebra crossing facilities by replacing traditional Belisha beacons with the above new beacons at five zebra crossings in Kwai Tsing, Sham Shui Po, Kowloon City and Tai Po Districts. Upon replacement of new Belisha beacons at the above locations, the proportion of motorists stopping in front of the zebra crossings to give way to pedestrians increased significantly from 42% to 80%. Before the replacement of Belisha beacons (i.e. from 2020 to April 2022), a total of five traffic accidents involving pedestrians (including two fatal, one serious and two slight accidents) occurred at the above trial locations. From the time the new Belisha beacons were installed until December 2024, the number of traffic accidents had decreased to three, and all of which were slight accidents.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0058)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding item 89P Set up a Smart Traffic Fund (the Fund) under the non-recurrent expenditure item, the accumulated expenditure is around $695 million as at 31March 2025, with a balance of about $354 million. Please advise this Committee of the following:

(1) What is the total number of projects approved by the Fund up to the present? What are the main areas of technology and application covered? Among the completed projects, how many deliverables have been successfully put into practical application and adopted by the industry or government departments?

(2) It is estimated in the Budget that the balance is $354 million for 2026-27. What plans does the Department have to expedite the utilisation rate of the Fund so as to promote more research on vehicle-related innovation and technology?

Asked by: Hon LAM Siu-lo, Andrew (LegCo internal reference no.: 25)

Reply:

(1) As at end-February 2026, the Management Committee of the Fund had approved 87 projects, which mainly cover areas including road safety, driving behaviour, traffic forecasting, parking, vehicle safety devices, and technologies related to autonomous vehicles.

Funded projects are classified into two categories, namely "Pure Research Project" and "Research and Application Project". The category "Pure Research Project" aims to provide funding support for local applicants to conduct research on vehicle-related innovation and technology and brings opportunities in innovative technologies to the industry, while the applicants for "Research and Application Projects" are required to, subject to their research deliverables, commercialise the results and put them into practical application upon completion of the projects. Currently, 12 research and application projects have completed their research respectively and entered the application stage (please refer to Annex for details). The Secretariat for the Fund (the

Secretariat) and the Management Committee will continue to closely monitor the implementation progress and usage status of all approved projects.

(2) The Fund accepts applications for research on vehicle-related innovation and technology. To further encourage collaboration among the industry, academia and research sector, the Fund increased the maximum funding percentage from the original 50% to 70% in November 2023 for joint applications from the corporate sector and R&D centres/ UGC-funded universities/ Government-established universities. The Secretariat also continues to promote the Fund through various channels to attract more quality innovative projects. Taking the year 2025 as an example, the Secretariat has organised four seminars and reached out to tertiary institutions and research institutions to promote the Fund to potential applicants and provide them with application information.

We will continue to review the operation of the Fund and make timely adjustments so as to further enhance the operational arrangements of the Fund.

Annex

Smart Traffic Fund
Research and Application Projects with Research Completed and Ongoing Application

	Project Title	Project Summary	Approved Funding	Related Practical Applications
1	Big data AI system for taxi safe driving	This project aims at developing a driving risk assessment model for evaluating taxi drivers' driving risk levels using data collected by the Smart On-Board Units to be installed in taxis. Online platform and mobile application for taxi owners and drivers will be developed for visualising the driving risk data. The project aims at reducing the taxi accident rate and alleviating the issue of high taxi insurance premiums.	$11,835,000.00	This system has been applied to taxis. It assesses drivers' driving risk levels and provides driving risk data to drivers via online platform and mobile application, thereby effectively enhancing overall driving safety.
2	Development of Departure Safety Checking System for Minibus	This project aims to develop a system for minibuses comprising sensors and controllers to monitor the minibus environment before and after passengers getting on/off the minibus. If a potential danger is detected, the system can take suitable safety control and alert the driver to check on specific area.	$3,240,000.00	This checking system has been applied to minibuses. If a potential danger is detected, the system will immediately alert the driver to check on specific area to prevent accidents at the departure of the minibus, thereby ensuring passenger safety.
3	Development of Crane Position Monitoring System	This project aims to develop a monitoring system to detect crane position on a truck (height of crane and side range) and alert driver when the crane is in a dangerous position that would affect road safety. Users can also check the status of a crane and the location of a vehicle on a system online platform.	$3,240,000.00	This monitoring system has been applied to crane trucks. When the crane reaches an excessive height, the system will issue an immediate alert to prevent collisions with overpasses while the vehicle is in motion, thereby enhancing the driving safety of crane trucks.

	Project Title	Project Summary	Approved Funding	Related Practical Applications
4	Pilot Project of 5G enabled Autonomous People Mover Service in a Residential Park	This project aims to develop a 5G-enabled autonomous people mover service in a Hong Kong low-density residential complex to enhance the mobility of the residents in the area. The Autonomous Vehicle (AV) platform can detect the presence of surrounding vehicles, pedestrians, cyclists and obstacles, and will timely and appropriately respond to avoid collisions. This project will build up talents and experience for local AV research and development.	$19,730,872.00	This autonomous minibus has completed the trial in a low-density residential complex. The trial data and experience gathered from the project have laid an important foundation for local research and development, which will help enhance the capability of other AVs to handle Hong Kong's complex road conditions and promote the long-term development of AVs in Hong Kong at the same time.,
5	AI driven Barrier-Free Smart mobility platform-BoBo	This project aims at using artificial intelligence, big data and machine learning to develop a ride-hailing mobile application for accessible transport, so as to assist the elderly and people with disabilities in booking wheelchair accessible taxi, Welcab, Rehabus, etc.	$3,387,108.00	This project has launched a mobile application to assist the elderly and people with disabilities in booking wheelchair-accessible taxis, Welcabs, Rehabuses, thereby enhancing their travel convenience.
6	Using Generalised Linear Model (GLM) and Machine Learning to develop an Analytical System Correlating Vehicle Usage, Driving Behaviour and Traffic Accident	This project aims to develop a system to analyse the correlation between vehicle usage, driving behaviour and traffic accident, with data collection via a on-board device, and conducting analysis with Generalised Linear Model and Machine Learning.	$11,254,796.94	This system has been applied to taxis. By analysing the correlation between vehicle usage, driving behaviour and traffic accident, the system provides drivers with suggestions for improvement, thereby effectively enhancing overall driving safety.

	Project Title	Project Summary	Approved Funding	Related Practical Applications
7	Advanced Intelligent Control Management and AI Optimisation Project for Hong Kong Tramway	This project aims to develop and implement an intelligent control management system for tramway based on RFID system and AI Optimizer, with a geo-fencing program to remind drivers of their speed.	$2,597,760.50	This system has been applied to the daily operation of the trams in Hong Kong to enhance management efficiency and enable intelligent deployment. Additionally, geo-fencing has effectively enhanced overall driving safety.
8	Development of Smart Meter System to Enhance Taxi Drivers' Convenience and Passengers' Travelling Experience	The project aims to develop a smart meter platform that will provide automated payment functions, real-time driver identity authentication, road-side hailing hotspot analytics, etc.	$9,602,315.46	This smart meter has been applied to taxis. By integrating the smart meter with the developed system, it enables automated payment, making the process of hailing a taxi and payment smoother, thereby enhancing the commuting experience of passengers.
9	Smart Minibus 2.0	This project aims to develop three technological components related to public light buses, namely, a dynamic speed limit mechanism, passenger counting system and smart bus stop.	$1,183,205.97	This system has been applied to private residential shuttle services, providing residents with real-time seat information, enhancing the transport operational efficiency of the housing estate and facilitating travel planning of passengers.

	Project Title	Project Summary	Approved Funding	Related Practical Applications
10	Development of an AI Computer Vision Solution to Facilitate Commuting for Visually Impaired Persons	The project aims to develop AI computer vision to recognise obstacles, identify bus stations and buses in order to increase the safety and convenience of visually impaired persons via the deployment of a specifically designed mobile application and smart glasses. This could encourage more frequent use of public transport by the visually impaired persons.	$1,514,000.00	The smart glasses developed in this project have been distributed to some visually impaired persons and placed in centres for the visually impaired for loan to those in need, thereby effectively enhancing the travel safety and convenience for visually impaired persons.
11	Development of the Next Generation of Traffic Accident Risk Management Solution (ARM)	The project aims to develop a traffic Accident Risk Management Solution, which includes new generation of Advanced Driver Assistance System, Electronic Data Recording System, Speeding Alert System, Alert Button System, Predictive Maintenance system, and Driving Behaviour and Fleet Management Monitoring System.	$13,440,750.00	This traffic accident risk management solution has been applied to minibuses and coaches. The system provides risk heat maps and analyses driver behaviour, providing fleet management companies with comprehensive risk reference data, thereby effectively enhancing fleet monitoring efficiency and overall driving safety.
12	Smart Cloud Taximeter System	The project aims to develop the first taxi operational data statistics and analysis platform in Hong Kong. The platform will analyse the operational status of taxis by remotely collecting taximeter data. The driver database and itinerary information will be uploaded to a cloud platform, providing comprehensive driver behaviour and risk references for taxi fleet management companies and taxi owners.	$10,634,000.00	This smart meter has been applied to taxis. The system remotely collects and analyses itinerary data and fare information, providing taxi owners and taxi fleet management companies with comprehensive reference data, thereby effectively enhancing fleet management and deployment efficiency.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0883)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Management of Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Transport Department has stated that preparation work is underway for the implementation of HKeToll upon the full commissioning of the Central Kowloon Bypass (CKB). Please inform this Committee of the following:

1. What is the estimated total expenditure for the procurement, installation and trial run of the HKeToll system of the CKB?

2. What is the expected daily volume of traffic flow (in vehicles) to be handled and diverted upon the commissioning of the CKB and the implementation of HKeToll?

3. Will the Government, depending on the data collected by HKeToll, consider implementing a time-varying toll mechanism for the CKB and its adjoining roads?

Asked by: Hon LAM Siu-lo, Andrew (LegCo internal reference no.: 24)

Reply:

1. The estimated expenditure for implementing HKeToll at the Central Kowloon Bypass (CKB), including the procurement, installation and testing of related equipment, is about $78.6 million in money-of-the-day prices.

2. Upon full commissioning of the CKB and implementation of an $8 toll, we expect that the daily traffic flow (in two-way vehicles) on weekdays will be approximately 77 000. It is expected that about 20% traffic flow along the east-west major roads (such as Lung Cheung Road, Gascoigne Road Flyover and Kwun Tong Bypass) in Kowloon will be diverted.

3. The main purpose of implementing time-varying tolls is to suppress and divert traffic flow through charging different toll levels at different time slots (i.e. higher tolls during peak time-slots), and to encourage motorists to change their commuting behaviours and travel outside the peak hours, thereby reducing congestion during peak hours.

As for the CKB, the design capacity of the tunnel is expected to accommodate the peak-hour traffic at the initial commissioning stage. Therefore, we have adopted a fixed toll that applies to all vehicles throughout the day.

Upon full commissioning of the CKB, the Transport Department will continue to collect traffic data on the CKB and its adjoining roads through HKeToll and traffic surveillance systems, and will closely monitor the relevant traffic conditions in order to examine the diversion effect and toll arrangements in a timely manner.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0531)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational expenses

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The work of the Transport Department (TD) under Programme (2) involves arranging written and road tests for drivers and driving instructors. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

(a) the respective numbers of various driving tests conducted at driving test centres by the Driving Services Section of TD and of candidates passing the tests in 2025;

(b) in relation to the driving tests for (i) public light buses and (ii) buses for the imported labour under the Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector - PLB/Coach Trade in 2025, the respective numbers of candidates attending and passing the test, and their pass rate (broken down by number of attempts);

(c) the change in waiting time (number of days) for the end-of-list test appointment date for various driving tests in the past three years and the corresponding estimates up to the end of 2026 (broken down by month);

(d) the respective monthly numbers of applicants and ballot winners for those driving tests where the Repeater Early Test Appointment Booking Service is available in the past three years; and

(e) the respective establishment, salary, operation and equipment expenses of Driving Examiner I, Driving Examiner II and other staff in the Driving Services Section of TD in 2025-26 and 2026-27?

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 29)

Reply:

(a) The Transport Department (TD) administers driving tests for various types of vehicles, among which the written test (Part A) and the taxi written test are conducted at the written test centre in Cheung Sha Wan Government Offices, while the road tests at the

driving test centres (DTCs). The numbers of candidates attending and passing various driving tests in 2025 are set out in the table below. The breakdown of the number of driving tests conducted at individual DTCs in 2025 is set out at **Annex 1**. The TD does not have statistics on candidates passing driving tests for individual DTCs.

Type of driving test	Number of candidates attending the driving tests in 2025	Number of candidates passing the driving tests in 2025
(i) Written test (Part A test)	50 074	43 327
(ii) Private car (combined test)	33 989	11 280
(iii) Private car (Part B test)	3 051	2 454
(iv) Private car (Part C test)	27 048	15 879
(v) Motorcycle (Part B test)	5 687	4 198
(vi) Motorcycle (Part C test)	10 498	4 846
(vii) Light goods vehicle (combined test)	31 145	8 914
(viii) Light goods vehicle (Part B test)	2 443	2 018
(ix) Light goods vehicle (Part C test)	32 122	17 266
(x) Taxi written test	13 816	8 009
(xi) Medium goods vehicle	6 987	2 371
(xii) Light bus	1 001	353
(xiii) Bus	4 365	1 543
(xiv) Heavy goods vehicle	3 400	792
(xv) Articulated vehicle	1 921	616

(b) For the driving tests for light buses and buses for the imported labour under the Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector - PLB/Coach Trade in 2025, the numbers of candidates (i) attending and (ii) passing the test, and the respective numbers and percentages of candidates passing the test at (iii) first attempt, (iv) second attempt and (v) third attempt or more are set out below:

	Light bus driving test	Bus driving test
(i) Number of candidates attending the test	659	532
(ii) Number of candidates passing the test	287	261
(iii) Number of candidates passing the test at first attempt (Percentage in the total number of candidates passing the test) ((iii)/(ii))	89 (31.0%)	112 (42.9%)
(iv) Number of candidates passing the test at second attempt (Percentage in the total number of	92 (32.1%)	89 (34.1%)

		Light bus driving test	Bus driving test
	candidates passing the test) ((iv)/(ii))		
(v)	Number of candidates passing the test at third attempt or more (Percentage in the total number of candidates passing the test) ((v)/(ii))	106 (36.9%)	60 (23.0%)

(c) The average waiting time (number of days) for the end-of-list test appointment date for various driving tests per month in the past three years and the monthly changes are set out at **Annex 2**. Overall speaking, the waiting times for the private car (combined test) and light goods vehicle (combined test) have both been shortened from about 12 months in January 2023 to about five months in December 2025.

As the waiting time for road tests hinges on a number of factors, such as the test demand for different vehicle types/ parts of the driving tests, the scheduling of tests, etc., the TD does not have an estimate of the monthly changes in the average waiting time (number of days) for 2026. The TD will keep closely in view the situation while allocating resources and taking feasible measures to shorten the waiting time for road tests as far as practicable.

(d) The TD has established the Repeater Early Test Appointment Booking Service (RETAS) with an aim to better utilise the vacant test slots released by candidates as a result of their application of test postponement or temporary cancellation of tests. With the introduction of computer balloting mechanism for allocation of the vacant test slots in RETAS on 28 March 2023, repeaters can register for the balloting. Since the implementation of the balloting arrangement up to December 2025, the total number of applicants for RETAS and number of ballot winners who have selected their test slot are listed below. Overall speaking, the ratio of ballot winners who have selected their test slot has increased from 28% in April 2023 (when the service was launched) to 73% in December 2025.

Month	Total number of applicants	Number of ballot winners who have selected their test slot
March 2023	6 215	321
April 2023	11 852	3 294
May 2023	15 652	3 471
June 2023	15 464	3 133
July 2023	14 875	2 427
August 2023	19 026	3 003
September 2023	18 298	2 272
October 2023	17 841	2 645
November 2023	16 901	4 736
December 2023	14 061	3 689
January 2024	14 810	4 616
February 2024	11 661	3 941
March 2024	11 458	4 305

Month	Total number of applicants	Number of ballot winners who have selected their test slot
April 2024	10 952	4 660
May 2024	10 843	4 138
June 2024	9 850	4 426
July 2024	11 143	4 318
August 2024	10 035	4 833
September 2024	9 304	4 082
October 2024	9 573	5 003
November 2024	8 354	4 092
December 2024	8 897	3 773
January 2025	7 774	3 849
February 2025	8 436	4 166
March 2025	8 131	3 386
April 2025	7 854	4 441
May 2025	6 870	4 222
June 2025	7 361	4 447
July 2025	6 851	4 751
August 2025	5 748	3 593
September 2025	6 017	3 201
October 2025	6 140	3 516
November 2025	5 148	3 997
December 2025	5 105	3 734

(e) In 2025-2026, there were 19 Driving Examiners I (DEIs), 65 Driving Examiners II (DEIIs) and 72 staff of other grades in the establishment of the Driving Service Section (DSS) under the TD. The staff cost (notional annual mid-point salary) is about $77.45 million.

In 2026-27, the establishment of DEIs and DEIIs in DSS under the TD will remain unchanged at 19 and 65 respectively, while that of the staff of other grades will be decreased to 71. The staff cost (notional annual mid-point salary) will be about $77.20 million.

The expenditure involved in the operation and equipment of DSS is absorbed under the overall provision for the TD, and cannot be separately identified.

Annex 1

Number of driving tests conducted at individual DTCs in 2025

Name of DTCs	Private car (combined test)	Private car (Part B test)	Private car (Part C test)	Light goods vehicle (combined test)	Light goods vehicle (Part B test)	Light goods vehicle (Part C test)	Motorcycle (Part B test)	Motorcycle (Part C test)	Medium goods vehicle	Light Bus	Bus	Heavy goods vehicle	Articulated vehicle
(I) Hong Kong Island													
Happy Valley	4 773	213	3 737	N/A									
So Kon Po	N/A			2 967	61	3 421	N/A	1 553	N/A				
Sheung On	N/A								1 855	176	1 448	N/A	
New Horizon School of Motoring	2 908	132	2 610	1871	41	2 342	1 030	962	N/A				
(II) Kowloon													
Chung Yee Street	5 792	N/A	2 830	2 204	N/A	1 225	N/A						
Tin Kwong Road	N/A			7 557	N/A	4 195	N/A	4 604	N/A				
Yau Tong	N/A		2 099	5 393	N/A	4 644	N/A						
Pui Ching Road	7 035	1	4 075	9	2	2	N/A						
Pak Wan Street	N/A					3 722	N/A						
New Kwun Tong Driving School	N/A	1 651	N/A		1 699		1 549	N/A					
(III) The New Territories													
Wing Hau Street	1 452	889	2 212	2 989	539	4 648	N/A						
Tsuen Wan	N/A								3 927	702	1 744	3 400	N/A
Shek Yam	3 496	N/A	2 968	N/A									
Yuen On	N/A												1 533
Container Port Road South	N/A												127
Hong Kong School of Motoring (Sha Tin)	5 767	111	4 129	4 876	58	4 467	1 778	1 678	455	123	493	N/A	

Name of DTCs	Private car (combined test)	Private car (Part B test)	Private car (Part C test)	Light goods vehicle (combined test)	Light goods vehicle (Part B test)	Light goods vehicle (Part C test)	Motorcycle (Part B test)	Motorcycle (Part C test)	Medium goods vehicle	Light Bus	Bus	Heavy goods vehicle	Articulated vehicle
Hong Kong School of Motoring (Yuen Long)	2 763	54	2 376	3 277	41	3 445	1 330	1 701	750	N/A	680	N/A	261
Ankor Driving School *	3	N/A	12	2	2	11	N/A						

*Ankor Driving School Driving Centre has commenced operation since 14 November 2025

Annex 2

The average waiting time (number of days) for the end-of-list test appointment date for various driving tests per month and the monthly changes between 2023 and 2025

2023												
Type of driving test	**Average waiting time (number of days) (Changes as compared with the preceding month)**											
	January	**February**	**March**	**April**	**May**	**June**	**July**	**August**	**September**	**October**	**November**	**December**
Written test (Part A test)	40 (0)	43 (+3)	41 (-2)	41 (0)	41 (0)	44 (+3)	44 (0)	42 (-2)	40 (-2)	40 (0)	41 (+1)	41 (0)
Private car (combined test)	363 (+2)	356 (-7)	352 (-4)	347 (-5)	339 (-8)	328 (-11)	317 (-11)	310 (-7)	301 (-9)	290 (-11)	278 (-12)	275 (-3)
Private car (Part B test)	93 (-14)	89 (-4)	89 (0)	84 (-5)	88 (+4)	89 (+1)	95 (+6)	96 (+1)	103 (+7)	102 (-1)	93 (-9)	83 (-10)
Private car (Part C test)	348 (-5)	342 (-6)	335 (-7)	317 (-18)	306 (-11)	298 (-8)	286 (-12)	279 (-7)	274 (-5)	257 (-17)	243 (-14)	227 (-16)
Motorcycle (Part C test)	238 (-6)	237 (-1)	234 (-3)	226 (-8)	223 (-3)	220 (-3)	216 (-4)	216 (0)	213 (-3)	210 (-3)	210 (0)	202 (-8)
Light goods vehicle (combined test)	367 (+2)	363 (-4)	358 (-5)	351 (-7)	342 (-9)	331 (-11)	320 (-11)	311 (-9)	303 (-8)	292 (-11)	284 (-8)	280 (-4)
Light goods vehicle (Part B test)	97 (-12)	98 (+1)	92 (-6)	86 (-6)	86 (0)	87 (+1)	88 (+1)	98 (+10)	95 (-3)	99 (+4)	96 (-3)	89 (-7)
Light goods vehicle (Part C test)	347 (-3)	341 (-6)	334 (-7)	313 (-21)	298 (-15)	284 (-14)	273 (-11)	267 (-6)	260 (-7)	252 (-8)	239 (-13)	223 (-16)
Medium goods vehicle	100 (-4)	102 (+2)	100 (-2)	93 (-7)	89 (-4)	85 (-4)	83 (-2)	84 (+1)	78 (-6)	78 (0)	77 (-1)	73 (-4)
Light bus	71 (-17)	57 (-14)	81 (+24)	68 (-13)	49 (-19)	61 (+12)	44 (-17)	41 (-3)	67 (+26)	59 (-8)	48 (-11)	31 (-17)

2023												
Type of driving test	**Average waiting time (number of days) (Changes as compared with the preceding month)**											
	January	**February**	**March**	**April**	**May**	**June**	**July**	**August**	**September**	**October**	**November**	**December**
Bus	97 (-4)	94 (-3)	99 (+5)	87 (-12)	79 (-8)	78 (-1)	79 (+1)	82 (+3)	76 (-6)	76 (0)	75 (-1)	69 (-6)
Taxi written test	43 (-2)	44 (+1)	47 (+3)	43 (-4)	42 (-1)	45 (+3)	43 (-2)	47 (+4)	45 (-2)	43 (-2)	44 (+1)	44 (0)
Heavy goods vehicle	100 (-9)	97 (-3)	90 (-7)	80 (-10)	72 (-8)	74 (+2)	78 (+4)	76 (-2)	75 (-1)	73 (-2)	68 (-5)	67 (-1)
Articulated vehicle	94 (-13)	94 (0)	93 (-1)	82 (-11)	89 (+7)	90 (+1)	92 (+2)	92 (0)	93 (+1)	79 (-14)	67 (-12)	77 (+10)

2024												
Type of driving test	**Average waiting time (number of days) (Changes as compared with the preceding month)**											
	January	**February**	**March**	**April**	**May**	**June**	**July**	**August**	**September**	**October**	**November**	**December**
Written test (Part A test)	40 (-1)	39 (-1)	42 (+3)	38 (-4)	39 (+1)	41 (+2)	42 (+1)	43 (+1)	40 (-3)	37 (-3)	44 (+7)	44 (0)
Private car (combined test)	270 (-5)	259 (-11)	252 (-7)	243 (-9)	237 (-6)	227 (-10)	220 (-7)	212 (-8)	211 (-1)	210 (-1)	204 (-6)	197 (-7)
Private car (Part B test)	95 (+12)	86 (-9)	90 (+4)	87 (-3)	90 (+3)	83 (-7)	79 (-4)	79 (0)	80 (+1)	87 (+7)	87 (0)	79 (-8)
Private car (Part C test)	214 (-13)	205 (-9)	194 (-11)	186 (-8)	179 (-7)	173 (-6)	165 (-8)	162 (-3)	156 (-6)	156 (0)	168 (+12)	179 (+11)
Motorcycle (Part C test)	200 (-2)	198 (-2)	191 (-7)	186 (-5)	180 (-6)	175 (-5)	168 (-7)	161 (-7)	147 (-14)	155 (+8)	150 (-5)	149 (-1)
Light goods vehicle (combined test)	276 (-4)	265 (-11)	256 (-9)	249 (-7)	242 (-7)	230 (-12)	221 (-9)	211 (-10)	211 (0)	209 (-2)	202 (-7)	192 (-10)
Light goods vehicle (Part B test)	89 (0)	94 (+5)	77 (-17)	71 (-6)	85 (+14)	82 (-3)	82 (0)	80 (-2)	82 (+2)	86 (+4)	84 (-2)	77 (-7)
Light goods vehicle (Part C test)	216 (-7)	199 (-17)	201 (+2)	190 (-11)	184 (-6)	178 (-6)	166 (-12)	163 (-3)	161 (-2)	151 (-10)	160 (+9)	172 (+12)
Medium goods vehicle	74 (+1)	68 (-6)	60 (-8)	56 (-4)	59 (+3)	62 (+3)	50 (-12)	57 (+7)	58 (+1)	62 (+4)	62 (0)	59 (-3)
Light bus	41 (+10)	77 (+36)	54 (-23)	49 (-5)	62 (+13)	52 (-10)	64 (+12)	59 (-5)	58 (-1)	61 (+3)	52 (-9)	50 (-2)
Bus	66 (-3)	59 (-7)	55 (-4)	53 (-2)	59 (+6)	50 (-9)	55 (+5)	56 (+1)	63 (+7)	63 (0)	60 (-3)	55 (-5)
Taxi written test	43 (-1)	47 (+4)	45 (-2)	45 (0)	46 (+1)	46 (0)	44 (-2)	42 (-2)	49 (+7)	44 (-5)	43 (-1)	44 (+1)

2024												
Type of driving test	**Average waiting time (number of days) (Changes as compared with the preceding month)**											
	January	**February**	**March**	**April**	**May**	**June**	**July**	**August**	**September**	**October**	**November**	**December**
Heavy goods vehicle	70 (+3)	61 (-9)	52 (-9)	51 (-1)	49 (-2)	51 (+2)	47 (-4)	54 (+7)	49 (-5)	46 (-3)	48 (+2)	48 (0)
Articulated vehicle	79 (+2)	67 (-12)	61 (-6)	68 (+7)	69 (+1)	70 (+1)	63 (-7)	66 (+3)	59 (-7)	68 (+9)	81 (+13)	60 (-21)

2025												
Type of test	**Average waiting time (number of days) (Changes as compared with the preceding month)**											
	January	**February**	**March**	**April**	**May**	**June**	**July**	**August**	**September**	**October**	**November**	**December**
Written test (Part A test)	42 (-2)	39 (-3)	40 (+1)	40 (0)	40 (0)	40 (0)	37 (-3)	39 (+2)	40 (+1)	37 (-3)	38 (+1)	38 (0)
Private car (combined test)	205 (+8)	203 (-2)	197 (-6)	189 (-8)	180 (-9)	174 (-6)	178 (+4)	172 (-6)	172 (0)	169 (-3)	168 (-1)	161 (-7)
Private car (Part B test)	66 (-13)	72 (+6)	65 (-7)	72 (+7)	60 (-12)	58 (-2)	64 (+6)	65 (+1)	68 (+3)	62 (-6)	61 (-1)	61 (0)
Private car (Part C test)	186 (+7)	191 (+5)	200 (+9)	193 (-7)	177 (-16)	165 (-12)	151 (-14)	139 (-12)	133 (-6)	130 (-3)	126 (-4)	113 (-13)
Motorcycle (Part C test)	144 (-5)	142 (-2)	137 (-5)	131 (-6)	130 (-1)	128 (-2)	121 (-7)	122 (+1)	122 (0)	115 (-7)	113 (-2)	109 (-4)
Light goods vehicle (combined test)	194 (+2)	192 (-2)	188 (-4)	183 (-5)	182 (-1)	176 (-6)	178 (+2)	169 (-9)	169 (0)	166 (-3)	163 (-3)	158 (-5)
Light goods vehicle (Part B test)	67 (-10)	70 (+3)	64 (-6)	72 (+8)	57 (-15)	60 (+3)	66 (+6)	60 (-6)	62 (+2)	66 (+4)	58 (-8)	61 (+3)
Light goods vehicle (Part C test)	178 (+6)	186 (+8)	189 (+3)	177 (-12)	162 (-15)	148 (-14)	135 (-13)	124 (-11)	115 (-9)	117 (+2)	117 (0)	106 (-11)
Medium goods vehicle	49 (-10)	55 (+6)	62 (+7)	58 (-4)	52 (-6)	49 (-3)	52 (+3)	54 (+2)	51 (-3)	48 (-3)	46 (-2)	40 (-6)
Light bus	47 (-3)	40 (-7)	38 (-2)	42 (+4)	38 (-4)	37 (-1)	41 (+4)	33 (-8)	36 (+3)	34 (-2)	29 (-5)	36 (+7)
Bus	48 (-7)	57 (+9)	56 (-1)	53 (-3)	43 (-10)	41 (-2)	41 (0)	47 (+6)	44 (-3)	40 (-4)	45 (+5)	41 (-4)
Taxi written test	46 (+2)	45 (-1)	47 (+2)	47 (0)	46 (-1)	45 (-1)	46 (+1)	44 (-2)	42 (-2)	42 (0)	48 (+6)	48 (0)

2025												
Type of test	**Average waiting time (number of days) (Changes as compared with the preceding month)**											
	January	**February**	**March**	**April**	**May**	**June**	**July**	**August**	**September**	**October**	**November**	**December**
Heavy goods vehicle	40 (-8)	38 (-2)	44 (+6)	42 (-2)	45 (+3)	39 (-6)	36 (-3)	39 (+3)	31 (-8)	31 (0)	36 (+5)	33 (-3)
Articulated vehicle	60 (0)	63 (+3)	66 (+3)	68 (+2)	61 (-7)	62 (+1)	55 (-7)	60 (+5)	51 (-9)	70 (+19)	56 (-14)	50 (-6)

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Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB231**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0533)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the statistics on commercial vehicle (CV) drivers, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

(a) the numbers of people holding driving licences (DLs) for various classes of CVs in the past three years (set out by (i) vehicle type (taxi, minibus, bus, medium goods vehicle, heavy goods vehicle, special purpose vehicle) and (ii) age group (21 to 29, 30 to 39, 40 to 49, 50 to 59, 60 to 64, 65 to 69, 70 to 74, 75 to 79, 80 or above); same hereinafter);

(b) the numbers of people with new issue of various classes of CV DLsin the past three years (set out by vehicle type and age group);

(c) the numbers of traffic accidents and the accident rates involving holders of various classes of CV DLs in the past three years (set out by vehicle type and age group);

(d) whether there are statistics on the number of in-service drivers for different CVs in the past three years; if yes, the details (set out by vehicle type and age group); if no, the reasons, and whether a survey will be conducted to assist the Government and the trades in human resources planning with a view to avoiding excessive labour importation; and

(e) the numbers of free health check-up quotas and the expenditure involved under the Safe Driving and Health Campaign (the Campaign) by the Transport Department (TD) for commercial vehicle drivers in the past three years and in 2026 (estimate); whether TD will consider increasing the number of free health check-up quotas in light of the ageing of CV drivers in general and TD's recommendation to mandate annual health check for CV drivers aged 65 or above for licence renewal; if yes, the details and the estimated additional annual expenditure; if no, the reasons?

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 30)

Reply:

There is no definition of "commercial vehicles" (CV) in the existing legislation. As far as driving licences (DLs) are concerned, the type of DLs mentioned (i.e. taxis, private and public light buses (PLBs), private and public buses, medium goods vehicles, heavy goods vehicles, and special purpose vehicles) are generally regarded as CVs.

(a) The number of holders of valid full DLs, with a breakdown by CV type and age group, in the past three years are is out at **Annex 1**.

(b) The number of persons with new issue of full DLs, with a breakdown by CV type and age group, in the past three years is set out at **Annex 2.**

(c) The number of drivers involved in traffic accidents and the traffic accident rates of drivers, with a breakdown by CV type and age group, in the past three years are set out at **Annex 3**.

(d) For the implementation of the Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector – Public Light Bus (PLB)/Coach Trade (the Scheme), the Government conducted a public transport manpower study in 2023, and the numbers of drivers of the local PLB/coach trade are set out in the table below:

Driver job type	**Number of drivers**
PLB driver	6 290
Local coach driver	7 380
Cross-boundary Coach Driver	
Total	**13 670**

The TD does not maintain the statistics on the age of PLB and coach drivers.

The TD has all along maintained liaison with the transport sectors via the stakeholder consultative group (comprising representatives of employees and employers) under the Scheme to keep in view of the opinions from the employees and employers as well as review the Scheme in a timely manner with reference to the relevant opinion.

As for other types of CVs, the TD will continue to take note of the needs and views of the trade and take follow-up action in a timely manner.

(e) The free health check-up services for CV drivers (free check-up services) under the Campaign of the TD aim to encourage CV drivers to undergo regular basic health check-ups so as to understand their own health conditions at an early stage. Each eligible CV driver can register once for the free check-up services provided by the TD within a year. In the past three years, the number of participants amounted to about 9 000, involving expenditures of around $5.3 million.

This year, the TD will continue to publicise the free check-up services through radio, social media and websites, with a view to encouraging CV drivers to maintain proper driving attitude, pay more attention to personal health and actively participate in the free check-up services.

The above free check-up services are intended for encouragement and are open to CV drivers of all ages. The check-ups only involved relatively basic health examination items, rather than a physical assessment specifically for determining fitness to drive. Therefore, the concerned check-up report cannot replace the medical certification required for aged drivers when applying for a DL. When the TD enhances the physical fitness certification requirements for CV drivers in the future, it will invite more doctors to provide health assessment services for aged drivers through publicity, thereby introducing market forces to make related service fees more competitive. The TD will also draw up a "list of doctors", and make available information on these doctors who provide relevant services, with a view to facilitating drivers to choose suitable doctors for their medical assessment according to their needs.

Annex 1

Number of Full Driving Licence Holders by CV Type and Age Group

(i) As at end-2023

Type of CV	Age group								
	21-29	**30-39**	**40-49**	**50-59**	**60-64**	**65-69**	**70-74**	**75-79**	**80 or above**
Taxi	2 778	10 343	21 596	44 575	47 508	46 153	23 710	8 302	1 919
Private light bus	2 112	8 778	27 669	45 836	34 633	32 768	16 660	6 926	1 940
Public light bus	1 427	6 776	24 918	43 109	33 373	31 828	16 026	6 662	1 856
Private bus	2 109	8 709	26 992	39 474	24 896	22 098	10 415	3 779	785
Public bus	1 687	8 183	26 449	39 061	24 789	22 011	10 371	3 783	869
Medium goods vehicle	2 648	12 945	32 387	48 261	33 509	30 694	15 844	6 113	1 521
Heavy goods vehicle	951	4 951	13 220	19 467	14 466	17 983	12 490	5 478	1 442
Special purpose vehicle	238	1 509	4 099	5 039	2 976	2 317	971	241	31

(ii) As at end-2024

Type of CV	Age group								
	21-29	**30-39**	**40-49**	**50-59**	**60-64**	**65-69**	**70-74**	**75-79**	**80 or above**
Taxi	3 424	11 832	22 568	41 585	45 495	48 372	24 814	9 785	2 155
Private light bus	2 091	8 452	26 886	44 361	33 615	34 317	17 568	7 855	2 111
Public light bus	1 445	6 338	23 700	41 398	32 352	33 303	16 940	7 528	2 029
Private bus	2 077	8 318	25 994	39 019	24 691	23 402	11 188	4 455	919
Public bus	1 621	7 649	25 303	38 478	24 563	23 312	11 148	4 444	988
Medium goods vehicle	2 637	12 567	31 392	46 588	32 732	32 240	16 717	7 040	1 684
Heavy goods vehicle	928	4 820	12 881	18 682	13 841	17 730	12 653	6 181	1 577
Special purpose vehicle	226	1 459	3 984	5 096	3 031	2 561	1 076	308	41

(iii) As at end-2025

Type of CV	Age group								
	21-29	**30-39**	**40-49**	**50-59**	**60-64**	**65-69**	**70-74**	**75-79**	**80 or above**
Taxi	3 925	13 075	23 779	39 185	42 372	50 089	25 413	11 622	2 388
Private light bus	2 125	8 103	26 114	42 696	32 172	35 555	18 116	8 856	2 314
Public light bus	1 480	6 003	22 636	39 514	30 886	34 483	17 504	8 500	2 227
Private bus	2 106	7 954	25 157	38 287	24 162	24 515	11 748	5 220	1 054
Public bus	1 602	7 156	24 301	37 626	24 010	24 421	11 701	5 198	1 115
Medium goods vehicle	2 605	12 226	30 800	44 858	31 410	33 606	17 185	8 135	1 884
Heavy goods vehicle	893	4 671	12 713	17 884	13 313	17 243	12 391	6 998	1 747
Special purpose vehicle	205	1 416	3 824	5 080	3 068	2 778	1 174	396	51

Note: A person may hold a driving licence with endorsement of more than one type of vehicles

Annex 2

Number of Persons with New Issue of Full Driving Licence by CV Type and Age Group

(i) As at end-2023

Type of CV	Age group								
	21-29	30-39	40-49	50-59	60-64	65-69	70-74	75-79	80 or above
Taxi	1 067	1 959	1 838	1 160	287	83	15	1	0
Private light bus	537	674	748	436	68	15	1	0	0
Public light bus	433	524	556	374	58	13	2	0	0
Private bus	537	672	742	418	59	12	0	0	0
Public bus	429	509	574	348	44	9	1	0	0
Medium goods vehicle	789	1 117	860	327	37	2	0	0	0
Heavy goods vehicle	332	480	426	146	15	1	0	0	0
Special purpose vehicle	60	160	169	155	81	53	6	0	0

(ii) As at end-2024

Type of CV	Age group								
	21-29	30-39	40-49	50-59	60-64	65-69	70-74	75-79	80 or above
Taxi	1 331	2 416	2 278	1 462	410	149	19	2	1
Private light bus	465	761	1 435	713	87	10	0	0	0
Public light bus	340	576	898	551	82	12	1	0	0
Private bus	454	670	1 098	541	75	6	0	0	0
Public bus	349	544	934	448	65	8	0	0	0
Medium goods vehicle	717	1 090	832	337	34	2	0	0	0
Heavy goods vehicle	242	474	448	147	10	1	0	0	0
Special purpose vehicle	74	186	262	259	111	60	16	2	0

(iii) As at end-2025

Type of CV	Age group								
	21-29	**30-39**	**40-49**	**50-59**	**60-64**	**65-69**	**70-74**	**75-79**	**80 or above**
Taxi	1 371	2 244	2 068	1 419	458	150	31	1	0
Private light bus	528	713	1 142	606	87	23	2	0	0
Public light bus	380	560	797	480	82	25	2	0	0
Private bus	520	658	954	537	63	9	1	0	0
Public bus	390	522	800	455	53	8	1	0	0
Medium goods vehicle	692	1 083	947	339	25	3	1	0	0
Heavy goods vehicle	233	431	517	183	10	2	1	0	0
Special purpose vehicle	61	162	175	179	78	35	7	1	0

Annex 3

Numbers of Drivers Involved in Traffic Accidents by CV Type and Age Group

Year	Age group	Type of CV							
		Taxi	PLB	Private light bus	Public bus	Private bus	Medium goods vehicle	Heavy goods vehicle	Special purpose vehicle
2023	21 - 29	150	1	0	139	0	34	16	8
	30 - 39	450	3	5	239	3	133	34	21
	40 - 49	794	48	9	504	7	201	50	25
	50 - 59	1 283	147	19	669	8	200	82	14
	60 - 64	989	163	15	305	8	140	44	11
	65 - 69	890	188	18	95	3	67	19	8
	70 - 74	491	137	10	20	1	22	10	5
	75 - 79	108	71	2	4	0	3	2	0
	≥ 80	27	9	1	0	0	0	0	0
2024	21 - 29	199	1	1	172	3	42	19	6
	30 - 39	595	14	0	290	1	152	42	18
	40 - 49	897	52	16	562	7	258	70	18
	50 - 59	1 253	129	24	770	13	251	74	26
	60 - 64	1 081	186	22	361	5	122	56	12
	65 - 69	941	217	19	137	2	84	33	7
	70 - 74	483	175	19	27	0	24	10	1
	75 - 79	142	91	3	9	0	4	5	0
	≥ 80	26	16	0	1	0	0	0	0
2025*	21 - 29	208	5	1	183	1	44	14	8
	30 - 39	554	15	1	266	4	152	51	18
	40 - 49	854	80	9	477	5	201	73	19
	50 - 59	1 023	133	18	742	14	255	96	19
	60 - 64	865	136	20	295	6	121	48	19
	65 - 69	779	177	21	152	2	86	30	10
	70 - 74	490	156	13	25	0	21	5	4
	75 - 79	178	84	3	4	0	1	4	1
	≥ 80	33	19	0	0	0	2	0	0

Note: *Provisional figures

Traffic Accident Rates of Drivers by Age Group and CV Type (per 1 000 Driving Licence Holders) ^

Year	Age group	Type of CV							
		Taxi	PLB	Private light bus	Public bus	Private bus	Medium goods vehicle	Heavy goods vehicle	Special purpose vehicle
2023	21 - 29	59.3	0.4	0.0	32.2	0.0	9.1	6.3	33.3
	30 - 39	45.2	0.3	0.5	17.1	0.3	8.6	4.3	13.1
	40 - 49	37.3	1.8	0.3	14.7	0.2	5.8	3.1	6.0
	50 - 59	27.3	3.2	0.4	14.0	0.2	4.0	3.8	2.8
	60 - 64	20.4	4.8	0.4	10.3	0.3	4.1	2.9	3.7
	65 - 69	20.0	6.1	0.6	3.7	0.1	2.3	1.1	3.7
	70 - 74	21.4	8.9	0.6	1.7	0.1	1.4	0.8	5.5
	75 - 79	14.5	11.5	0.3	1.0	0.0	0.5	0.4	0.0
	≥ 80	15.2	5.2	0.6	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
2024	21 - 29	64.1	0.4	0.3	41.3	0.9	11.7	8.5	24.4
	30 - 39	52.7	1.7	0.0	22.1	0.1	10.5	5.8	12.2
	40 - 49	40.6	2.0	0.6	16.9	0.2	7.6	4.5	4.5
	50 - 59	28.9	3.0	0.5	16.4	0.3	5.2	3.6	5.1
	60 - 64	23.1	5.6	0.6	12.4	0.2	3.7	3.9	4.0
	65 - 69	20.0	6.6	0.6	5.0	0.1	2.7	1.8	2.9
	70 - 74	19.9	10.7	1.1	2.1	0.0	1.5	0.8	1.0
	75 - 79	16.1	13.1	0.4	2.0	0.0	0.6	0.9	0.0
	≥ 80	13.1	8.4	0.0	1.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
2025*	21 - 29	56.4	2.2	0.4	45.2	0.3	12.7	6.7	37.9
	30 - 39	44.3	2.0	0.1	21.4	0.4	11.0	7.6	12.5
	40 - 49	37.0	3.2	0.3	14.9	0.2	6.2	4.9	4.9
	50 - 59	25.3	3.2	0.4	16.1	0.4	5.5	4.9	3.7
	60 - 64	19.5	4.2	0.6	10.3	0.2	3.7	3.5	6.2
	65 - 69	15.9	5.2	0.6	5.3	0.1	2.6	1.7	3.8
	70 - 74	19.5	9.0	0.7	1.8	0.0	1.2	0.4	3.5
	75 - 79	16.8	10.6	0.4	0.7	0.0	0.1	0.6	2.9
	≥ 80	14.7	8.9	0.0	0.0	0.0	1.1	0.0	0.0

Note: ^ The accident involvement rate of drivers refers to the number of drivers of specific CV type involved in traffic accidents per 1 000 driving licence holders of that CV type in the same age group (based on driving entitlement as at the middle of the year). The figures

in the table are calculated with reference to the numbers of driving licence holders (not the actual numbers engaged as drivers) of individual CV types in different age groups. The proportion of driving licence holders who are actually engaged as drivers of the corresponding types of CVs varies across age groups. Therefore, the accident involvement rate of CV drivers across different age groups may not be directly comparable.

* Provisional figures

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0535)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned under Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 of Programme (2) that the Transport Department (TD) will continue to further enhance the operation of the Northbound Travel for Hong Kong Vehicles (the Scheme). In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

(a) Since the implementation of the Scheme, what are the monthly numbers of (i) registration for balloting, (ii) closed road permits issued, (iii) travel bookings, (iv) arrivals at the boundary control point on time as booked, (v) arrivals at the boundary control point later than the booked time, (vi) cancelled bookings, and (vii) cases where the applicant, without cancelling the booking, fails to show up at the boundary control point;

(b) What are the staff establishment, and the expenditure on salary, equipment and operation incurred by the TD in processing the applications for licenses and permits under the Scheme since its implementation and in 2026-27;

(c) What are the staff establishment, salary expenditure and the system maintenance cost incurred by the TD (or the contractor) in providing support for the online application system of the Scheme in 2025-26 and 2026-27; and

(d) Has the Government explored with the Government of Guangdong Province to make another Hong Kong-Shenzhen land boundary control point available for the Scheme; if yes, what are the proposal and the implementation timetable; if not, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 31)

Reply:

(a) The governments of Guangdong and Hong Kong have been closely monitoring the implementation situation of the Scheme and continuously taking enhancement measures to provide greater convenience for the applicants, including the enhancement measure

implemented by the Transport Department (TD) since 1 September 2025 to allow vehicles under the Scheme to travel to Guangdong Province via the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (HZMB) without travel bookings on Tuesdays and Wednesdays, except specified dates.

The monthly number of applications registered for balloting and Closed Road Permits (CRPs)/electronic approval letters issued since the launch of the Scheme are set out at **Annex 1.** The monthly numbers of travel bookings and cancelled bookings are set out at **Annex 2** which has reflected the figures after implementing the waiving booking arrangements on Tuesdays and Wednesdays. The TD does not maintain other information by month as requested in the question.

(b) The work relating to the processing of applications for licences and permits under the Scheme is mainly undertaken by the existing staff of the TD and the relevant expenditure involved is absorbed under the overall provision and establishment for the TD. Thus, no separate breakdown can be provided. To enhance the capability and efficiency in processing the applications under the Scheme, the TD has created posts filled by outsourced workers since 2023-24. The total expenditure of the relevant outsourced posts was about $7.7 million as at 2025-26. In 2026-27, the relevant estimated expenditure is about $3.6 million.

(c) The work relating to the online application system of the Scheme is mainly undertaken by the existing staff of the TD. The staff establishment involved has been absorbed under the overall establishment of the TD and there is no separate breakdown. In 2025-26, the TD's expenditure on system enhancement, upgrading and outsourced maintenance was about $1.5 million. For 2026-27, the estimated expenditure involved in system maintenance and upgrading is about $1.8 million.

(d) The Hong Kong Special Administrative Region Government has all along been maintaining close communication with the relevant Mainland authorities in respect of the Scheme to implement enhancement measures in a timely manner, with a view to providing the public with a more convenient travel experience. Regarding the extension of the Scheme to a Hong Kong/Shenzhen land-based boundary control point, the governments of Guangdong and the HKSAR have agreed to draw on the implementation experience of the Scheme at the HZMB and proactively study the extension of the Scheme to a Shenzhen/Hong Kong land-based boundary control point in due course, such that Hong Kong private cars can travel to both the eastern and western parts of Guangdong.

Annex 1

Number of registrations for balloting and Number of CRPs/electronic approval letters issued by the TD under the Scheme

Month[1]	Number of registrations for balloting for applications under the Scheme [2]	Number of CRPs/ electronic approval letters issued[3]
May 2023[4]	17 261	N/A[4]
June 2023[4]	24 795	474
July 2023	19 099	3 615
August 2023	14 788	5 169
September 2023	15 136	6 037
October 2023	7 311	8 428
November 2023	7 795	7 740
December 2023	7 709	5 957
January 2024	8 012	6 836
February2024	5 544	5 983
March 2024	12 253	5 696
April 2024	7 468	6 063
May 2024	7 196	5 897
June 2024	6 832	5 602
July 2024	6 359	7 986
August 2024	10 478	7 687
September 2024	8 648	7 285
October 2024	11 195	8 983
November 2024	13 148	7 754
December 2024	13 957	7 428
January 2025	18 181	9 161
February 2025	8 874	7 820
March 2025	6 409	9 095
April 2025	5 298	8 500
May 2025	5 790	7 319
June 2025	6 964	8 248
July 2025	6 089	9 838
August 2025	4 942	8 798
September 2025	4 673	8 726
October 2025	5 611	10 073
November 2025	5 734	10 054
December 2025	7 873	10 902
January 2026	6 279	9 964
February 2026	4 559	8 324

Note 1：Based on the date of balloting.

Note 2：As some applicants have registered for more than one round of balloting, registrations made by the same applicant are all counted into the figures.

Note 3: Starting from 13 October 2025, vehicles approved to participating in the Scheme

are not required to apply for a CRP. The TD will issue an electronic approval letter to successful applicants to confirm their eligibility for participation.

Note 4：The TD started receiving registrations for the Scheme on 29 May 2023 and has been issuing permits since June 2023, allowing successful applicants to travel to Guangdong Province via the HZMB from 1 July 2023 onwards.

Annex 2

Monthly number of travel bookings under the Scheme

Month	Number of travel bookings[#]	Number of cancelled bookings
July 2023	3 713	621
August 2023	9 864	883
September 2023	16 743	2 233
October 2023	26 049	1 972
November 2023	32 575	1 822
December 2023	49 382	5 282
January 2024	41 539	2 518
February2024	54 529	7 287
March 2024	60 448	6 301
April 2024	54 959	6 439
May 2024	61 661	6 827
June 2024	65 364	7 924
July 2024	60 682	5 378
August 2024	72 954	5 562
September 2024	57 105	5 963
October 2024	72 262	7 664
November 2024	64 323	5 040
December 2024	70 827	8 816
January 2025	81 568	10 536
February 2025	60 659	5 813
March 2025	71 066	5 109
April 2025	87 210	11 578
May 2025	87 254	11 368
June 2025	73 836	7 176
July 2025	75 864	8 584
August 2025	90 122	8 036
September 2025[*]	52 861	6 428
October 2025[*]	84 831	11 858
November 2025[*]	58 281	6 690
December 2025[*]	63 361	17 080
January 2026[*]	65 022	10 519
February 2026[*]	88 000	21 330

Excluding cancelled bookings.

* From 1 September 2025 onwards, bookings are not required for vehicles travelling to Guangdong Province via the HZMB under the Scheme on Tuesdays and Wednesdays, except specified dates. Hence, the figures on travel bookings since that month should not be directly compared with those of the previous months.

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CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0544)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Management of Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The original estimate for 2025-26 under Programme (4) of the Transport Department (TD) is $1,521.5 million while the revised estimate is 1,465.8 million, representing a decrease of $55.7 million or 3.7%. The estimate for 2026-27 is $1,678.9 million, representing an increase of $213.1 million or 14.5% over the revised estimate for 2025-26. As explained by the TD, this is mainly due to the increased cash flow requirement for replacement of plants, vehicles and equipment for tunnels and control areas as well as the increased provision for operating expenses. In this regard, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(a) What are the aforesaid plants, vehicles and equipment, and in which tunnels/control areas are they used?

(b) What are the reasons for the significant fluctuations between the estimates for this year and next year?

(c) What are the staff establishment, and the expenditure on salary, operation and equipment incurred by the TD in monitoring the management of government tunnels and bridges in 2025-26 and 2026-27 (estimate);

(d) What is the expenditure incurred by TD in awarding the management contracts for each of the government tunnels and bridges in the past three years and 2026-27(estimate)? Does the TD know about the staffing, salary expenditure, and salary adjustment mechanisms proposed by the contractors in the agreements? and

(e) What were the monthly traffic flows of various government tunnels and bridges with a breakdown by vehicle type over the past three years?

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 34)

Reply:

(a) & (b)

The financial provision under Programme (4) of the Transport Department (TD) covers the Capital Account and Operational Expenses. The Capital Account mainly involves expenditure on procurement and replacement of plants, vehicles and equipment for transport infrastructure whereas Operating Expenses mainly involve expenditure on engaging operators for the management, operation and maintenance of government transport infrastructure.

The revised estimate for 2025-26 under Programme (4) is 1,465.8 million, representing a decrease of $55.7 million compared to the original estimate for 2025-26. It is mainly due to adjustments in response to the work progress and actual situation of procurement items under the Capital Account, and the lower-than-estimated contract prices for some items after open tendering. The estimate for 2026-27 is $1,678.9 million, representing an increase of $213.1 million over the revised estimate for 2025-26. It is primarily due to the increase in the overall cash flow requirement in 2026-27 under the Capital Account for the ongoing replacement works of plants, vehicles and equipment for tunnels and control areas, with expenditure incurred based on the actual progress of the works, as compared to 2025-26. It is also due to the proposed creation of five new projects under subhead 603 of the Capital Account, i.e. 8AE−Replacement of Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition System and Central Monitoring and Control System at the Tsing Ma Control Area; 8AF−Replacement of Central Monitoring and Control System at the Western Harbour Crossing; 8AG−Replacement of High Voltage, Low Voltage and Generator Power Supply System at the Tsing Ma Control Area; 8AH−Replacement of Tunnel Lighting System at the Tseung Kwan O Tunnel and 8AJ−Replacement and Enhancement of Security System for Lower Deck Service Walkway at the Tsing Ma Control Area. Furthermore, the increased provision for Operational Expenses for 2026-27 is mainly due to the increased provision required for the annual expenses for the management fee payable to the operator for the management, operation and maintenance of the Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section).

The cash flow requirement for capital account expenditure would be adjusted every year in response to the number, nature, scale, and progress of the items, thus it is difficult to compare the cash flow across different years directly.

(c) The TD is responsible for the monitoring the management of 23 government tunnels, the Tsing Ma Control Area and the Tsing Sha Control Area, as well as the daily operation of the Discovery Bay Tunnel which is built and operated by the private sector. In 2025-26 and in 2026-27 (estimate), two Chief Transport Officers, five Senior Transport Officers, six Transport Officers I, four Transport Officers II, four Senior Transport Controllers, eight Transport Controllers I, 14 Transport Controllers II are assigned to handle the above matters. The annual staff cost (notional annual mid-point salary) is about $31.55 million.

The expenditure involved in the monitoring of government tunnels and bridges is absorbed under the overall provision for the TD and there is no separate breakdown for the estimated expenditure involved.

(d) The expenditures of government road tunnels and control areas in the past three financial years and in 2026-27 (estimate) are set out at **Annex 1**.

The TD has specified the minimum staffing establishment in the management, operation, and maintenance agreements for all government road tunnels and control areas. The salary expenses incurred by the contractors are included in the management fees payable to them, there is no separate breakdown.

(e) The monthly traffic flows of various government tunnels and bridges by vehicle type in the past three years (i.e. 2023 to 2025) are set out at **Annex 2**.

Annex 1

Operating Expenditures of Government Road Tunnels and Control Areas from 2022-23 to 2024-25 and for 2026-27 (estimate)

Tolled tunnel/ control area[1 and 4]	2022-23 ($ million)	2023-24 ($ million)	2024-25 ($ million)	2026-27 Estimate ($ million)
Cross-Harbour Tunnel	158	199	196	216
Eastern Harbour Crossing	179	228	240	243
Western Harbour Crossing[2]	N/A	241	328	pending tender results[5]
Tate's Cairn Tunnel	143	167	175	208
Aberdeen Tunnel	97	125	134	pending tender results[5]
Lion Rock Tunnel	91	136	121	133
Shing Mun Tunnels	125	152	135	136
Route 8K	342	391	372	382
Tai Lam Tunnel[3]	N/A	N/A	N/A	291

Note 1: The expenditures set out in the table include the management fees payable to the management, operation and maintenance contractors, the relevant operating and maintenance expenditure for the implementation of HKeToll, depreciation charge of capital costs and expenditure on government maintenance works of the tunnels for the years concerned.

Note 2: The Western Harbour Crossing was returned to government management on 2 August 2023. The figure for 2023-24 is for the period from 2 August 2023 to 31 March 2024.

Note 3: The Tai Lam Tunnel was returned to government management on 31 May 2025.

Note 4: The Central Kowloon Bypass (CKB) (Yau Ma Tei Section) commenced operation on 21 December 2025. The toll for the CKB (an all-day fixed toll of $8 for all vehicle types) will be commenced when the entire CKB (including the Kowloon Bay Section) is fully commissioned. Its operating expenditure is expected to be included in the Operating Accounts of Government Toll-Tunnels starting from 2027-28.

Note 5: As the operating expenditures include the management fees for the management, operation and maintenance contractors of tunnels, while the management, operation and maintenance agreements concerned will expire in 2026-27 and open tendering will be conducted, the management fees for 2026-27 are subject to the tender results and the projected operating expenditures are not available at this stage.

Toll-free tunnel/ control area[6]	2022-23 ($ million)	2023-24 ($ million)	2024-25 ($ million)	2026-27 Estimate ($ million)
Tuen Mun–Chek Lap Kok Tunnel	73	79	81	89
Tseung Kwan O Tunnel[7]	35	31	44	52
Tseung Kwan O–Lam Tin Tunnel[7]	19	62	62	90
Central–Wan Chai Bypass Tunnel	148	148	152	171
Lung Shan Tunnel	61	57	57	64
Cheung Shan Tunnel	19	25	26	29
Airport Tunnel	26	26	26	28
Scenic Hill Tunnel	55	55	58	60
Kai Tak Tunnel	54	54	49	50
Lantau Link	139	142	147	158

Note 6: Government toll-free tunnels are not included in the Operating Accounts of Government Toll-Tunnels. The expenditures set out in the table represent the management fees payable to the management, operation and maintenance contractors for the years concerned, excluding the depreciation charge of the capital costs and the expenditure on government maintenance works of the tunnels and Lantau Link for the years concerned.

Note 7: Tseung Kwan O – Lam Tin Tunnel commenced operation on 11 December 2022 and the toll of Tseung Kwan O Tunnel was waived on the same day. The figures of Tseung Kwan O – Lam Tin Tunnel for 2022-23 cover the period from 11 December 2022 to 31 March 2023.

Annex 2

Monthly Traffic Flows of Government Tunnels and Bridges by Vehicle Type (in Millions of Two-way Vehicles)

Tolled Tunnel	Year	Private car and motorcycle [1]	Taxi	Other commercial vehicle	Monthly traffic flow [3]
Aberdeen Tunnel [2]	2023	1.28		0.55	1.83
	2024	1.02	0.38	0.44	1.85
	2025	1.03	0.36	0.43	1.81
Cross-Harbour Tunnel	2023	1.75	0.56	0.86	3.17
	2024	1.74	0.55	0.55	2.84
	2025	1.80	0.52	0.49	2.81
Eastern Harbour Crossing	2023	1.42	0.42	0.40	2.24
	2024	1.27	0.37	0.41	2.06
	2025	1.29	0.34	0.40	2.03
Western Harbour Crossing	2023	1.11	0.55	0.42	2.07
	2024	1.57	0.66	0.69	2.92
	2025	1.76	0.62	0.71	3.10
Lion Rock Tunnel [2]	2023	2.00		0.64	2.63
	2024	1.61	0.42	0.57	2.60
	2025	1.60	0.39	0.52	2.52
Tate's Cairn Tunnel [2]	2023	1.33		0.43	1.76
	2024	1.05	0.23	0.45	1.73
	2025	1.06	0.22	0.46	1.73
Shing Mun Tunnels [2]	2023	1.03		0.48	1.51
	2024	0.76	0.24	0.49	1.48
	2025	0.77	0.22	0.48	1.47
Eagle's Nest Tunnel and Sha Tin Heights Tunnel [2]	2023	1.26		0.55	1.81
	2024	1.03	0.30	0.60	1.93
	2025	1.07	0.28	0.58	1.93
Tai Lam Tunnel	2023	0.66	0.15	0.50	1.30
	2024	0.64	0.14	0.49	1.27
	2025	0.86	0.14	0.55	1.54
Central Kowloon Bypass [4]	2023	N/A			
	2024				
	2025	0.57			

Toll-free tunnel and bridge [5]	Year	Monthly traffic flow [3]
Tseung Kwan O Tunnel	2023	2.46
	2024	2.55
	2025	2.56
Tuen Mun – Chek Lap Kok Tunnel	2023	0.91
	2024	1.11
	2025	1.15

Toll-free tunnel and bridge [5]	Year	Monthly traffic flow [3]
Tseung Kwan O – Lam Tin Tunnel	2023	0.77
	2024	0.83
	2025	0.85
Central – Wan Chai Bypass Tunnel	2023	1.40
	2024	1.56
	2025	1.48
Lung Shan Tunnel	2023	0.61
	2024	0.70
	2025	0.77
Cheung Tsing Tunnel	2023	2.29
	2024	2.28
	2025	2.53
Nam Wan Tunnel	2023	1.69
	2024	1.93
	2025	1.90
Kai Tak Tunnel	2023	1.73
	2024	1.93
	2025	1.83
Cheung Shan Tunnel	2023	0.25
	2024	0.36
	2025	0.43
Scenic Hill Tunnel	2023	0.21
	2024	0.38
	2025	0.42
Airport Tunnel	2023	0.09
	2024	0.13
	2025	0.15
Ting Kau Bridge	2023	2.82
	2024	2.84
	2025	2.95
Stonecutters Bridge	2023	1.73
	2024	1.94
	2025	1.91
Lantau Link	2023	2.42
	2024	2.78
	2025	2.90

Note 1: "Motorcycles" include motor tricycles.

Note 2: Traffic data on relevant tunnels by vehicle type is not available for 2023.

Note 3: The figures include those on weekends and public holidays. Individual figures in the table may not add up to total due to rounding.

Note 4: The Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section) commenced operation on 21 December 2025. Therefore, its monthly traffic flow in 2025 is calculated only on the basis of data for the period between 21 and 31 December 2025, and the data

by vehicle type is not available.

The toll for the CKB will be commenced when the entire CKB (including the Kowloon Bay Section) is fully commissioned.

Note 5: Traffic data on toll-free tunnels and bridges by vehicle type is not available.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0956)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned under Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026–27 that the Transport and Logistics Bureau will continue to oversee the implementation of recommendations arising from the consultancy study on parking for commercial vehicles to address the anticipated parking demand and in the Transport Strategy Blueprint. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(a) What are the respective numbers of new registrations and total number of licensed vehicles for various types of commercial vehicles (CVs) in the past three years and 2026 (set out by taxi, light bus, bus, medium goods vehicle, heavy goods vehicle, special purpose vehicle; same hereinafter);

(b) What are the respective numbers of additional and total on-street parking spaces and indoor parking spaces for various types of commercial vehicles in the past three years and 2026 (set out by District Council district);

(c) What were the respective numbers of fixed penalty notices (FPNs) issued against illegal parking by various types of commercial vehicles in the past three years;

(d) It is mentioned in the Transport Strategy Blueprint that in the long run, more than 6 000 goods vehicle parking spaces will be provided so as to realise "every commercial vehicle having a parking space at night". What is the distribution of those parking spaces (set out by District Council district, location, planned number of parking spaces provided);

(e) As the Government has stated that short-term measures will be launched, such as optimising the use of spaces underneath flyovers, opening up government properties, and encouraging schools to allow parking within school premises, so as to increase the supply of night-time parking spaces for CVs. What is the estimated increase in parking spaces for various types of CVs through the aforesaid measures in the coming three years; and

(f) Does the Government have any measures to ensure that vehicles can still park at nearby sites when short-term tenancy car parks for CVs are resumed?

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.23)
Reply:

(a) The numbers of first registrations and the total numbers of various types of commercial vehicles (CVs) (i.e. taxi, light bus, bus, medium goods vehicle, heavy goods vehicle, special purpose vehicle) in the past three years and as at February 2026 are tabulated as follows:

Vehicle Class	**Number of first registered vehicles**			
	2023	**2024**	**2025**	**2026 (as at February)**
Taxi	952	971	1 804	226
Light bus	197	255	147	33
Bus	639	428	528	73
Medium goods vehicle	1 191	758	841	75
Heavy goods vehicle	596	541	383	40
Special purpose vehicle	93	81	82	19
Total	**3 668**	**3 034**	**3 785**	**466**

(b) The additional and total numbers of on-street parking spaces and parking spaces provided at car parks in 18 districts by type of CV in the past three years are set out at **Annex 1** and **Annex 2** respectively.

(c) The numbers of fixed penalty notices (FPNs) issued against illegal parking by various types of commercial vehicles in the past three years are as follows:

Vehicle Type	**Number of FPNs issued against illegal parking**		
	2023	**2024**	**2025**
Goods vehicle	875 438	768 055	614 005
Taxi	83 025	74 898	60 942
Public bus [note]	53 187	50 711	45 235
Public light bus	7 715	6 144	4 316
Other vehicles [note]	15 675	13 341	9 765

Note: According to the information on FPNs issued against illegal parking maintained by the Hong Kong Police Force, public buses include franchised buses and non-franchised public buses; while other vehicles include private buses, private light buses, special purpose vehicles and trailers.

(d) As mentioned in the Transport Strategy Blueprint, the Government will introduce a series of specific measures to accord priority to meeting the parking needs of commercial vehicles, including the allocation of corresponding commercial vehicle parking facilities for projects serving industrial and modern logistics uses (such as the Hung Shui Kiu Logistics Cluster and multi-storey buildings for modern industries) in

the planning of the New Development Areas (NDAs) such as the Hung Shui Kiu/Ha Tsuen NDA in the Northern Metropolis; the implementation of a dedicated scheme for night-time on-street parking spaces for commercial vehicles in NDAs through pre-designing night-time on-street commercial vehicle parking spaces in suitable road sections; and prioritising the provision of more commercial vehicle parking spaces when taking forward public vehicle park projects in areas with high concentrations of logistics activities. As more car park projects will be successively implemented, it is expected that more than 6 000 goods vehicles parking spaces will be provided in the long run. Since the relevant development projects of the aforesaid measures are still at the planning stage, no information on the specific locations or numbers of parking spaces is available at this stage. The Government will continue to carry out planning based on actual needs to ensure an adequate supply.

(e) The Government expects to provide over 12 000 additional parking spaces across the territory in 2025 and 2026, covering both private cars and CVs, including more than 220 metered parking spaces and a minimum of 100 on-street night-time parking spaces for CVs by 2026. Furthermore, in addition to providing about 600 parking spaces at short-term tenancy (STT) car parks, a minimum number of CV parking spaces will also be specified for suitable car parks over the next two years. The Transport Department (TD) and relevant departments are actively taking forward these measures in accordance with the targets.

Besides, the first three public vehicle parks (PVPs) implemented under the "single site, multiple use" (SSMU) principle have been commissioned [Note], providing a total of 140 CV parking spaces. With the successive commissioning of more PVP projects, including District Open Space, Sports Centre and Public Vehicle Park at Sze Mei Street, the redevelopment of Yuen Long Stadium, and the Kwun Tong Composite Development Project, etc., which are expected to be completed between 2026 and 2027, a total of about 70 CV parking spaces will be provided. Together with other development projects and the ongoing short- and medium-term parking measures, the provision of new CV parking spaces will further increase next year. The TD will continue to step up its efforts, focusing on areas with a shortage of parking spaces to increase the provision of on-street parking spaces as far as practicable. It will also continue to stipulate the provision of a minimum number of parking spaces for CVs in suitable STT car parks.

Note: Including Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park in Sheung Shui, Pak Shing Kok Road Public Car Park in Tseung Kwan O and Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park.

(f) If a STT car park is to be resumed for long-term development, the TD will require the project proponent to review the impact of the development project on the supply and demand for parking spaces at the planning stage of the relevant project, and take appropriate short-term mitigation measures, including identifying an alternative location or providing an appropriate number of public parking spaces within the relevant development project, so as to make up for the shortfall in parking spaces.

Annex 1

Total and Additional Numbers[note] of on-street parking spaces in 18 districts by type of CV in the past three years

District	Situation as at December of each year	Total number of parking spaces		Number of additional parking spaces	
		Goods Vehicle	Coach/ Bus	Goods Vehicle	Coach/ Bus
Central & Western	2025	202	11	0	0
	2024	202	11	1	0
	2023	193	11	0	1
Wan Chai	2025	24	43	0	0
	2024	25	53	1	1
	2023	24	48	0	2
Eastern	2025	101	66	0	2
	2024	101	65	1	1
	2023	91	75	0	1
Southern	2025	51	85	0	0
	2024	51	85	0	0
	2023	50	85	0	0
Yau Tsim Mong	2025	369	141	2	0
	2024	369	141	1	2
	2023	363	138	1	9
Sham Shui Po	2025	219	10	1	0
	2024	220	12	1	1
	2023	229	9	1	0
Kowloon City	2025	157	154	2	3
	2024	143	160	0	1
	2023	143	134	2	0
Wong Tai Sin	2025	133	0	2	0
	2024	129	0	0	0
	2023	129	0	0	0
Kwun Tong	2025	134	56	14	4
	2024	120	53	1	4
	2023	115	42	1	3
Tsuen Wan	2025	67	31	2	0
	2024	69	31	2	1
	2023	63	31	0	0
Tsuen Mun	2025	338	113	3	0
	2024	329	113	0	0
	2023	330	113	0	0
Yuen Long	2025	445	78	25	0
	2024	419	110	1	0
	2023	427	114	2	1
North	2025	354	29	1	0
	2024	365	32	1	3

District	Situation as at December of each year	Total number of parking spaces		Number of additional parking spaces	
		Goods Vehicle	Coach/ Bus	Goods Vehicle	Coach/ Bus
	2023	359	27	1	0
Tai Po	2025	339	86	1	0
	2024	352	86	0	1
	2023	359	84	5	2
Sai Kung	2025	319	159	0	0
	2024	316	146	11	2
	2023	305	155	1	1
Sha Tin	2025	338	61	1	2
	2024	337	67	0	0
	2023	335	64	0	0
Kwai Tsing	2025	376	31	1	10
	2024	360	21	0	1
	2023	353	21	0	0
Islands	2025	67	78	0	0
	2024	67	78	0	0
	2023	55	75	0	0
Total	**2025**	**4 033**	**1 232**	**55**	**21**
	2024	**3 974**	**1 264**	**21**	**18**
	2023	**3 923**	**1 226**	**14**	**20**

Note: Currently, there are about 370 parking spaces reserved for special public services in Hong Kong. As both taxis and private light buses use private car on-street parking spaces, there is no breakdown of dedicated on-street parking spaces.

Annex 2

Total and Additional Numbers[note] of parking spaces provided at car parks in 18 districts by type of CV in the past three years

District	Situation as at December of each year	Total number of parking spaces		Number of additional parking spaces	
		Goods Vehicle	Coach/ Bus	Goods Vehicle	Coach/ Bus
Central & Western	2025	828	73	0	0
	2024	864	72	0	0
	2023	811	71	0	0
Wan Chai	2025	318	101	0	0
	2024	489	101	0	0
	2023	313	108	0	0
Eastern	2025	1 766	192	0	0
	2024	1 749	214	0	8
	2023	1 735	260	0	0
Southern	2025	1 087	198	0	0
	2024	1 071	189	0	0
	2023	1 074	187	0	0
Yau Tsim Mong	2025	947	106	0	0
	2024	953	104	0	6
	2023	1 027	121	0	20
Sham Shui Po	2025	2 901	418	9	0
	2024	2 995	412	0	0
	2023	3 080	420	0	0
Kowloon City	2025	1 251	99	7	0
	2024	1 306	109	74	0
	2023	1 224	161	104	0
Wong Tai Sin	2025	1 147	90	0	0
	2024	1 169	91	0	0
	2023	1 150	89	0	0
Kwun Tong	2025	3 519	81	0	3
	2024	3 564	69	136	0
	2023	3 407	81	0	0
Tsuen Wan	2025	1 989	369	0	1
	2024	2 035	378	0	0
	2023	2 081	366	0	0
Tuen Mun	2025	2 215	139	0	0
	2024	2 226	139	47	0
	2023	2 217	139	0	0
Yuen Long	2025	1 586	323	16	0
	2024	1 732	324	173	0
	2023	1 636	333	40	0
North	2025	1 283	87	151	0
	2024	1 152	87	6	0

District	Situation as at December of each year	Total number of parking spaces		Number of additional parking spaces	
		Goods Vehicle	Coach/ Bus	Goods Vehicle	Coach/ Bus
	2023	1 386	87	111	0
Tai Po	2025	861	87	65	0
	2024	821	66	1	0
	2023	849	69	0	0
Sai Kung	2025	1 354	226	132	41
	2024	1 249	197	5	0
	2023	1 149	214	0	0
Sha Tin	2025	2 342	134	60	0
	2024	2 386	134	0	0
	2023	2 489	132	69	0
Kwai Tsing	2025	9 669	360	244	32
	2024	9 207	193	1 044	0
	2023	10 222	408	91	0
Islands	2025	941	213	0	0
	2024	941	213	0	0
	2023	950	193	0	0
Total	**2025**	**36 004**	**3 296**	**684**	**77**
	2024	**35 909**	**3 092**	**1 486**	**14**
	2023	**36 800**	**3 439**	**415**	**20**

Note: The above parking information is collated from the data provided by various departments, car park management companies or operators, and is for general reference only. The actual number of parking spaces may vary as various departments, car park management companies or operators responsible for managing the car parks may make adjustments to the numbers/types of parking spaces to suit their own requirements.

In general, taxis may use private car parking spaces, whereas most franchised buses, public light buses, private light buses, special purpose vehicles and government vehicles should be parked at the parking spaces at depots, bus stops within public transport termini, and the parking spaces at stands. Accordingly, such parking spaces are excluded from the calculation.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0958)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational Expenses

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Transport Department (TD) mentioned in the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 under Programme (1) that the TD will continue to administer the Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector – Public Light Bus/Coach Trade (the Scheme). In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(a) the staff establishment, and the expenditure on salary, operation and equipment involved in processing the applications under the Scheme by the TD for 2025-26 and 2026-27 (estimate);

(b) the number of applicants, routes, imported drivers quotas applied for and approved quotas in respect of the (i) the public light bus (PLB) and (ii) the coach trade in each round of application since the launch of the Scheme;

(c) amongst the approved imported drivers in the (i) PLB and (ii) coach trade, the numbers of drivers who have passed the driving test and been deployed o driving duties (by the number of tests taken), and those who were dismissed by the employer due to failure to pass the driving test or other reasons;

(d) further to the above, whether the TD knows if the fees for applying for a learner's driving licence and the driving test are borne by the employer or the imported labour; whether the Government has provided any subsidy scheme for this; if yes, the reasons and the amount of subsidy;

(e) whether the Government has maintained the statistics on the number of complaints lodged by imported workers regarding exploitation of rights and interests, and lack of occupational safety and health protection since the launch of the Scheme; if yes, the details; if not, the reasons;

(f) whether the Government has conducted surveys on the changes in the salaries, employment opportunities and unemployment/ underemployment situation of local drivers since the launch of the Scheme; if yes, the details; if not, the reasons; and

(g) please provide (i) the respective numbers of employers who were issued warning letters, had the approved quotas revoked and were temporarily prohibited from application due to violation of application guidelines or other legislation/ guidelines since the launch of the Scheme; and (ii) the number of warning letters, the number of quotas revoked and the longest period that an applicant is prohibited from application.

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 26)

Reply:

(a) In 2025-26 and 2026-27 (estimate), the manpower and expenditure of the TD involved in the implementation of the Scheme are absorbed under the overall provision and establishment for the TD, and cannot be separately identified.

(b) The Government approved a total of 900 PLB and 800 coach driver quotas through two rounds of applications in September 2023 and July 2024 respectively. All applications were vetted by the inter-departmental liaison group (comprising representatives from the Transport and Logistics Bureau (TLB), the Labour Department (LD) and the TD). Details of the two rounds of applications are set out at **Annex 1**.

(c) As at end-February 2026, the numbers of imported drivers who have passed the local driving test, who have commenced work and whose contracts were prematurely terminated are set out at **Annex 2**. The TD does not maintain a breakdown of termination of contracts of imported drivers by various reasons.

(d) The employer shall enter into a Standard Employment Contract (SEC) with the imported driver and provide relevant driving training before the driving test and pre-service driver training courses of public buses or PLBs for free in accordance with the requirements of the contract, so as to facilitate the imported driver to obtain and apply for the full driving licence of the relevant vehicle class and thereby acquire the qualification to engage in the work specified in the SEC. All fee in relation to examination and application for driving licence shall be paid in full by the employer without any deduction from the wages of the employee.

(e) TD has received five complaints relating to local coach and cross-boundary coach drivers since the launch of the Scheme, mainly concerning allegations that workers were subjected to wage rebates, employers failing to provide suitable accommodation according to the standards stipulated in the employment contract, and employers requiring them to work overtime without compensation. The TD has, according to the established procedures, referred the cases received to the LD for follow-up actions.

(f) The PLB/coach trade has long been facing the problem of shortage of drivers. The Government has all along been maintaining liaison with representatives of the transport sectors and labour unions via the stakeholder consultative group (comprising representatives of employees and employers) under the Scheme to keep in view the implementation of the Scheme. At the same time, the TD has been keeping in view the operation and manpower of individual routes through daily monitoring. The Government will continue to closely monitor changes in the local labour market and the

manpower situation, and will continue to review the implementation of the Scheme and assess the manpower demand of the industries.

(g) The Government has been protecting the rights and benefits of imported workers through a multi-pronged approach, including preparation of SEC, inspections, law enforcement, education and promotion. If employers have violated relevant labour/immigration laws, requirements under the Scheme or SEC, the Government will consider imposing administrative sanctions on the employers as appropriate, including refusal to process applications for labour importation under the Scheme and withdrawal of the approvals previously granted for importation of drivers. There is no case warranting administrative sanction by relevant enforcement departments since the launch of the Scheme.

Annex 1

Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector - Public Light Bus/Coach Trade

Numbers of applications and quotas allocated in the first round by driver job type

Driver job type	Number of applications received	Number of quotas applied for	Number of applications approved	Number of driver quotas allocated
Public Light Bus Driver	68 (involving 68 route packages)	547	59	461
Local Coach Driver	32 (involving 6 service endorsements)Note(1)	689	23	262
Cross-boundary Coach Driver	18 (involving routes plying 6 road-based Boundary control points (BCPs))	365	16	246
Total	**118**	**1 601**	**98**	**969**

Numbers of applications and quotas allocated in the second round by driver job type

Driver job type	Number of applications received	Number of quotas applied for	Number of applications approved	Number of driver quotas allocated
Public Light Bus Driver	82 (involving 82 route packages)	842	82	467
Local Coach Driver	31 (involving 6 service endorsements)Note (1)	394	27	228
Cross-boundary Coach Driver	16 (involving routes plying 6 road-based Boundary control points (BCPs))	237	16	154
Total	**129**	**1 473**	**125**	**849** Note (2)

Notes:

(1) The six service endorsements include (i) tour service, (ii) hotel service, (iii) student service, (iv) employees' service, (v) residents' service and (vi) contract hire service.

(2) Including 118 approved quotas left unused in the first round and carried forward to the second round.

Annex 2

Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector - Public Light Bus/Coach Trade
Numbers of imported drivers who have passed the local driving test, who have commenced work and whose contracts were terminated by driver job type
(as at end-February 2026)

Driver job type	Imported drivers who have passed the local driving test Note (1)		Number of imported drivers who have commenced work	Number of imported drivers whose contracts were prematurely terminated
	Number of tests taken	Number of drivers		
Public Light Bus Driver	1	335	862	149
	2	314		
	3	146		
	4	83		
	5 or more	35		
	Sub-total	**913**		
Local Coach Driver	1	165	365	64
	2	110		
	3	41		
	4	27		
	5 or more	17		
	Sub-total	**360**		
Cross-boundary Coach Driver	1	223	370	63
	2	107		
	3	43		
	4	10		
	5 or more	0		
	Sub-total	**383**		
	Total	**1 656**	**1 597** Note(2)	**276**

Notes:

(1) As some drivers have their contracts prematurely terminated for various reasons, the approved quotas can be used for importing replacement drivers. The total number of drivers who have passed the local driving test includes replacement drivers.

(2) Imported drivers who have passed the local driving test will gradually commence work after completing route training.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0959)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operational expenses

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned under Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 of Programme (2) that the Transport Department (TD) will continue to support the implementation of the "Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles" (the Scheme). In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(a) Does the TD know from the information provided by the Guangdong Provincial Government, since the implementation of the Scheme, the monthly numbers of (i) registrations for balloting, (ii) closed road permits issued, (iii) travel bookings, (iv) arrivals at the boundary control point on time as booked, (v) arrivals at the boundary control point later than the booked time, (vi) cancelled bookings, and (vii) cases where the applicant, without cancelling the booking, fails to show up at the boundary control point?

(b) In relation to the handling of applications for Hong Kong permits/licences under the Scheme, what are the staff establishment, and expenditure on salary, equipment and operation incurred by the TD in 2026-27?

(c) The TD stated that vehicles under the Scheme are required to meet the vehicle examinations standards in Hong Kong. However, it is reported that the light transmission rate (LTR) of the window glasses on Guangdong vehicles is lower than that of the vehicles registered in Hong Kong, raising concerns about inconsistencies in the standards. Apart from LTR of the window glasses, are there any other aspects where local and Guangdong vehicles are subject to different technical standards? If yes, what is the legal basis, and will the TD formulate a set of unified technical standards? If no, what are the reasons?

(d) It is reported that Guangdong drivers are using the "Integrated Driver Control Assistance System", which has not been approved in Hong Kong, while driving around the city. Will the TD provide owners/drivers of Guangdong vehicles with a list of approved and unapproved driver assistance systems in Hong Kong to avoid breaches of the law? If a Guangdong vehicle is involved in any violation of the law in Hong Kong, how will the

HKSAR Government ensure that the vehicle owner/driver fulfils his/her legal obligations before leaving Hong Kong? If the vehicle owner/driver leaves Hong Kong before a fixed penalty notice is issued or an arrest is made, how will the HKSAR Government co-operate with relevant Mainland authorities to handle such cases?

(e) Have the TD or other departments maintained statistics on the number and percentage of vehicles under the Scheme involved in traffic offences and accidents? Is there a significant difference between these figures and those of dual-plate Mainland vehicles with vehicle registration marks prefixed by "FU/FV", dual-plate Hong Kong vehicles with mainland vehicle licences and local vehicles? If the data shows that the number and percentage of vehicles under the Scheme involved in traffic offences and accidents are significantly higher than those of other vehicles, will the TD or other departments discuss with the Guangdong Provincial Government to introduce measures for enhancing safety awareness among drivers under the Scheme? And

(f) At this stage, has the TD set a timetable for increasing the quota for entering the urban areas under the Scheme? If yes, what are the details, and how will the TD assess the potential demand for travel between popular areas and tourist attractions to ensure that road capacity, road safety, and the supply of parking spaces will not be excessively affected?

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 32)

Reply:

(a) The Southbound Travel Scheme (Entry into Urban Area) (the Scheme) has allocated quotas to eligible vehicle owners through a monthly ballot since November 2025, and has been open for application from eligible Guangdong private cars starting from 9 December. Upon receipt of the applications transferred by the Mainland authorities, the Transport Department (TD) will conduct vetting and issue an electronic International Circulation Permit (ICP) to the successful applicants. Guangdong vehicles issued with ICPs may make a booking to enter Hong Kong via the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge for up to three days per visit. According to the existing regulations, vehicles under the Scheme are not required to apply for a Closed Road Permit.

According to information published by the Mainland Authorities on the website of Guangdong's information system of the Scheme, the Mainland authorities has conducted four rounds of balloting since November 2025, and the number of applications registered for balloting received in each round were about 2 400, 1 700, 7 300 and 6 500 respectively.

Regarding the monthly numbers of applications received by the TD from the Mainland, ICPs issued, travel bookings and cancelled bookings are tabulated as follows:

Month	**Number of applications received from the Mainland by the TD**	**Number of ICPs issued**	**Number of travel bookings** **Note (2)**	**Number of cancelled bookings**
December 2025	1 829	634	192	15
January 2026	1 499	1 531	801	113

Month	Number of applications received from the Mainland by the TD	Number of ICPs issued	Number of travel bookings Note (2)	Number of cancelled bookings
February 2026	905	1 390	1 492	224

Notes:

1. Depending on the applicant's progress in arranging the vehicle inspection and submitting the relevant information, the TD may not be able to complete vetting in the same month as receipt of the application.
2. Excluding cancelled bookings.

The TD does not have the other information as requested in the question.

(b) In 2026-27, the manpower and expenditure of the TD involved in the processing of applications for licences and permits under the Scheme will be absorbed under the establishment and overall provision for the TD, and cannot be separately identified. To process the applications and enhance the efficiency, the TD is required to create posts to be filled by outsourced workers, estimated salary expenses for which is about $6.1 million.

(c) The Government has been attaching great importance to road and vehicle safety. Accordingly, the TD has appointed Hong Kong service providers to set up vehicle inspection centres in Guangdong Province to carry out vehicle inspections for the applicants under the Scheme (Entry into Urban Area). Currently, the TD has appointed 13 vehicle inspection centres in Guangzhou, Zhuhai, Jiangmen and Zhongshan to carry out vehicle inspections for Guangdong vehicles. The facilities and daily operation of the vehicle inspection centres, as well as the qualifications of the inspection personnel and their code of practice, shall comply with the TD's requirements and be supervised by Hong Kong service providers. Vehicle inspections shall be conducted in accordance with the Road Traffic (Construction and Maintenance of Vehicles) Regulations (Cap. 374A), including the inspection of body structure, lighting, steering, suspension and braking systems. For vehicles making a temporary stay in Hong Kong, the minimum light transmittance of the windshield is 70%, and no light transmittance requirement has been imposed on the side window glass of the front seats. These arrangements have made reference to the circumstances and requirements in other places and Hong Kong. The TD is currently reviewing the light transmittance requirement of the window glasses and other advanced automotive technologies, with a view to keeping the rules and regulations abreast of the technological developments, on the premise of ensuring road safety.

(d) The TD has been referencing the developments in technology and relevant legislation worldwide, and has reviewed the local situation in a timely manner, with a view to updating the relevant local legislation as appropriate. Regarding various driver assistance systems, the TD has issued guidelines for approval of the "Integrated Driver Control Assistance System" (IDCAS). The relevant system is required to consider local traffic conditions and traffic rules when controlling vehicle movements so as to ensure road safety. As traffic signs, road markings, traffic signals and traffic rules of Hong Kong are different from the Mainland (e.g. in the road system of Mainland, the

left lane is regarded as the fast lane while the right lane is considered the slow lane which are contrary to Hong Kong), the IDCAS is required to obtain the approval of the TD to ensure that its operation complies with the traffic rules in Hong Kong. Therefore, any IDCAS which has not been approved by the TD is not permitted for use on roads in Hong Kong.

The TD has issued the Guidelines for Cross-boundary Vehicles – "Integrated Driver Control Assistance System" and "Remote Control Parking System" (the Guidelines) for Autonomous Driving to remind Guangdong vehicle owners/drivers not to use IDCAS which has not been approved to use on roads in Hong Kong. In addition to uploading the Guidelines to its website for information by applicants participating in the Scheme, the TD has also required the vehicle inspection centres in the Mainland to distribute the Guidelines to owners/drivers whose vehicles are equipped with an IDCAS and have passed the vehicle inspection, and to remind them not to activate the IDCAS within Hong Kong by way of the Vehicle Inspection Conformity Certificate issued to them. At the same time, the TD will also send the same reminder by email to applicants who have passed the vehicle inspection.

(e) According to records, the accident involvement rate of left-hand-drive vehicles in Hong Kong in 2025 was 0.28% (Notes 1, 2), which was lower than the overall accident involvement rate in Hong Kong (3.37%) (Notes 1, 2), reflecting that left-hand-drive vehicles do not pose a significant risk to road safety in Hong Kong. In taking forward the Scheme, the TD has continuously provided information and carried out publicity and education for drivers under the Scheme through various channels, by releasing videos on driving in Hong Kong at vehicle inspection centres and on social media in the Mainland to introduce Hong Kong's traffic rules, traffic signs and road markings and points to note while driving. Publicity leaflets have also been distributed for enhanced education to remind Guangdong drivers of the differences of road designs, traffic rules and facilities between the Mainland and Hong Kong to ensure road and driving safety.

If Guangdong vehicles are found to contravene Hong Kong traffic regulations, the Hong Kong Police Force will handle the case in accordance with local laws and procedures. The violation cases are sporadic, and the relevant cases have either been handled or are being followed up.

The governments of Guangdong and Hong Kong will also take appropriate measures, depending on the specific circumstances of the case and in accordance with the management measures for the Scheme. Such measures include considering the suspension or cancellation of the eligibility of the vehicles concerned. Nevertheless, during the early stage of implementation of the Scheme, four Guangdong vehicles entering the urban areas of Hong Kong did not comply with the relevant guidelines of the TD (such as activating autonomous driving features or making illegal modifications). The TD has suspended the travel booking eligibility of the vehicles concerned and required the vehicle owners to rectify the situation. The relevant cases have also been reported to the Guangdong authorities.

Notes:

1. Provisional figures

2. The accident involvement rate is calculated based on the number of licensed vehicles in the middle of the year.

(f) The Scheme was initially open to four cities, namely Guangzhou, Zhuhai, Zhongshan and Jiangmen in the first phase. For entry into the urban area, it started with a daily booking quota of 100 vehicles and has generally operated orderly and smoothly. We will continue to better control the overall number of vehicles entering the urban area, divert traffic and enhance the supporting facilities, and distribute tourist parking guides to southbound travellers, so as to facilitate them in combining self-driving with public transport and assist them in choosing itineraries covering culture, sports, exhibitions, shopping and theme parks. Travellers are guided to visit various districts in Hong Kong instead of congregating in individual locations. We are currently accumulating implementation experience and closely monitoring the implementation situation, including the operation at the port, traffic conditions of the nearby roads, the adaptability of users and the public, the enhancement of ancillary facilities, etc. We are continuing to review and discuss with the Guangdong authorities to increase the quota in an orderly manner, and plan to gradually extend the Scheme from the current four cities in Guangdong Province (viz. Guangzhou, Zhuhai, Zhongshan and Jiangmen) to other cities in Guangdong Province six months after its implementation, so as to take forward the Scheme in a stable and manageable way. We will announce the relevant arrangements in due course.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0960)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operating Expenses

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Transport Department (TD) mentioned in the Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 under Programme (2) that the TD will continue to conduct process re-engineering of licensing services, including arranging more online services and using artificial intelligence (AI) to assist in the processing of licensing applications. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(a) What are the staff establishment, and the expenditure on salary, operation and equipment involved in processing licensing applications in the past three years and 2026-27?

(b) What are the respective numbers of various licensing applications processed (i) at counters at Licensing Offices and (ii) online in the past three years and 2026-27 (for driving licence applications, please provide a breakdown by learner's driving licence, probationary driving licence, full driving licence after completion of the probationary driving period, renewal of full driving licence and direct issue of full driving licence (direct issue))?

(c) Given that the arrival of Mainland talents and professionals and the commencement of entry into the urban area under the Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles have led to an increased demand for direct issue, which has resulted in "queuing gangs" (i.e. paid agents) queuing for same-day queue tickets outside the Hong Kong Licensing Office of TD in Admiralty. To tackle this issue, the "Online Same-day Queue Ticket" arrangement will cease from 16 March this year onwards, with full implementation of online appointment for counter services. In this connection, what is the expenditure for developing the appointment booking system? Does the system have any way to distinguish whether the person entering the system to make an appointment is the applicant himself? Will the TD explore setting up separate queues for in-person applications and applications by agents at Licensing Offices to prioritise the processing of in-person applications?

(d) In the long run, has the TD planned to fully digitalise the application process for direct issue and cease counter services; if yes, what is the timetable and whether consideration

will be given to ensure the authenticity of the supporting documents submitted by applicants; if no, the reasons;

(e) To address the potential queuing issue of the online appointment services for direct issue, will the TD discuss with the Guangdong Provincial Government to enhance the application process for the Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles, such as exploring the provision of designated quotas for applicants and authorising car testing organisations in the Mainland to collect applicant's information and transfer it to the TD to make the application on the applicant's behalf; and

(f) The Transport and Logistics Bureau mentioned in Recommendation 4 – Facilitating Cross-boundary Vehicles in the Transport Strategy Blueprint that "the TD is actively studying the feasibility of mutual recognition of commercial vehicle driving licences among Guangdong, Hong Kong and Macao, and will further discuss the relevant details with the governments of the two places. The target is to achieve concrete outcomes in 2026, with a view to implementing the relevant arrangements in 2027". Does this arrangement involve the expansion of the applicable vehicle classes of direct issue and legislative amendments? Given the different classifications, technical specifications and test contents of the commercial vehicles of Guangdong, Hong Kong and Macao, how will the TD assess the safety of the non-local commercial vehicles operating in Hong Kong in order to safeguard road safety?

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 33)

Reply:

(a) The processing of licensing applications is carried out by existing staff of the Transport Department (TD). The staff establishment, expenditure on salary, operation and equipment involved have been absorbed under the overall establishment and provision for the TD and there is no separate breakdown.

(b) At present, the Licensing Offices of the TD process applications for various driving licences (DLs) and vehicle licences (VLs) with the Vehicles and Drivers Licensing Integrated Data System (VALID System). The VALID System classifies the application channels into applications submitted through "the Internet" and those submitted through "other application channels". The latter covers applications submitted at service counters, by drop-in boxes and by post, with no further breakdown. Based on the above classification, the number of applications for DLs and VLs received by the TD in the past three years are tabulated below, and the overall number of licence applications to be processed in 2026-27 is expected to be similar to that in 2025-26:

Applications in relation to DLs

	Number of applications		
	2023-24	**2024-25**	**2025-26 (as at end-January 2026)**
(1) Issue of learner's DL			
Submission at service counters, by drop-in boxes and by post	93 829	75 410	45 356

	Number of applications		
	2023-24	**2024-25**	**2025-26 (as at end-January 2026)**
Submission through the Internet	16 488	27 948	26 740
Total	110 317	103 358	72 096
(2) Issue of probationary DL			
Submission at service counters, by drop-in boxes and by post	42 004	37 225	24 226
Submission through the Internet	13 722	23 888	27 447
Total	55 726	61 113	51 673
(3) New issue of full DL			
Submission at service counters, by drop-in boxes and by post	34 659	29 666	20 273
Submission through the Internet	5 668	18 764	24 800
Total	40 327	48 430	45 073
(4) Renewal of full DL			
Submission at service counters, by drop-in boxes and by post	97 602	85 040	67 000
Submission through the Internet	49 559	63 456	62 384
Total	147 161	148 496	129 384
(5) Direct issue of Hong Kong full DL (direct issue)			
Submission at service counters (Note)	71 023	73 455	75 370
Total	71 023	73 455	75 370
(6) Other matters related to DL			
Submission at service counters, by drop-in boxes and by post	665 490	561 124	394 887
Submission through the Internet	101 806	242 690	253 911
Total	767 296	803 814	648 798

Note: Applicants may only submit applications for direct issue the counters of the Licensing Offices.

Applications in relation to VLs

	Number of applications		
	2023-24	**2024-25**	**2025-26 (as at end-January 2026)**
Submission at service counters, by drop-in boxes and by post	1 205 783	1 120 320	892 890
Submission through the Internet	130 276	187 331	225 185
Total	1 336 059	1 307 651	1 118 075

(c) to (e)

The TD has fully implemented online appointment for counter services for applications for direct issue from 16 March 2026 and has extended the services to four Licensing Offices (LOs) across the territory at the same time, with the number of booking slots increased by 40% to 550 per working day. Applicants or their authorised persons may submit applications to the designated LOs at the appointed date and time to save queuing time. The enhanced appointment booking system adopts real-name registration. Applicants are required to log in using a registered iAM Smart account or upload their identity document and DL when making a booking. The system will, with the aid of artificial intelligence (AI) technologies, conduct preliminary vetting of the information submitted by applicants to verify their identity. The above arrangements provide greater convenience to applicants, improve crowd management and make better use of resources. The expenses for developing the enhanced booking system are about $1.22 million.

The TD will closely monitor the implementation of the new arrangements to ensure smooth system operation, and will make timely review and launch enhanced measures. The TD will also actively explore the use of AI technologies to process the applications for directly-issued licences, with a view to enabling applicants to upload application documents to the new online platform for preliminary vetting, and then visit the LO at their booked time slot with their original documents for verification, so as to ensure the authenticity of the documents and a smooth and efficient application process.

Besides, Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles (Entry into the Urban Area) has been accepting applications from eligible Guangdong private cars since 9 December 2025. The Government has been closely monitoring the implementation and maintaining close liaison with the relevant Mainland authorities to continue to review and discuss enhancement measures.

(f) At present, commercial vehicles (CVs) are not covered by the relevant legislation of direct issue. To enhance the connectivity in the Greater Bay Area and promote transport connectivity among Guangdong, Hong Kong and Macao, the Government has stated in the Transport Strategy Blueprint announced earlier that the TD is actively studying the feasibility of mutual recognition of CV DLs among the three places, and will further discuss the details with the governments of Guangdong and Macao, with a view to firming the details of the arrangement next year.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2422)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (6) Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The threshold of monthly public transport expenses incurred for receiving the subsidy under the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme (the Scheme) was raised from $400 to $500 starting from June 2025. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

(a) The revised estimate for 2025-26 is $2.0964 billion, representing a decrease of $648.1 million or 23.6% compared to the original estimate of $2.7445 billion, while the estimate for 2026-27 is $2.8151 billion, representing an increase of $718.7 million or 34.3% compared to the revised estimate for 2025-26. What are the reasons for the significant fluctuations between the estimates for this year and next year?

(b) What are (i) the amount of subsidies disbursed to the beneficiaries; (ii) the staff establishment and salary expenditure incurred by the Transport Department (TD) in overseeing the Scheme; and (iii) other operational expenses in 2025-26 and 2026-27 respectively?

(c) What are the average monthly numbers of people using Octopus cards and AlipayHK respectively to receive subsidies in 2025 and 2026 respectively;

(d) What are (i) the average monthly eligible public transport expenses, with a breakdown into (1) $400.1 to $500.0; (2) $500.1 to $600.0; …… ; (13) $1,600.1 to $1,700.0; and (14) $1,700.1 or above, (ii) the average monthly number of beneficiaries by subsidy amount, with a breakdown into (1) $0.1 to $100.0; (2) $100.1 to $200.0; (3) $200.1 to $300.0; and (4) $300.1 to $400.0, and (iii) the average amount of monthly subsidy per beneficiary under the Scheme in 2025? and

(e) Following the announcement of the 2025-26 Budget, it is reported that the Government expected a decrease in the average monthly number of beneficiaries from about 2 million to about 1.9 million upon raising the monthly public transport expenses threshold, achieving annual savings of $540 million in government expenditure. However, according to the data currently provided by the TD, the number of beneficiaries has

decreased by about 0.22 million, and the savings in expenditure amounting to $648.1 million. What are the reasons for the greater-than-expected decrease?

Asked by: Hon LAM Wai-kong (LegCo internal reference no.: 27)

Reply:

(a) The revised estimate of the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme (the Scheme) for the 2025-26 financial year is lower than the original estimate mainly because the expenditure for subsidy amount is lower than expected, which is attributable to factors including the lower-than-expected public transport patronage.

From 1 June 2025 onwards, the threshold of monthly public transport expenses incurred for receiving the subsidy under the Scheme was raised from $400 to $500. Taking into account the expenditure savings brought about by the adjustment to the Scheme, there is still an increase of about $720 million in the estimated total expenditure of the Scheme for the 2026-27 financial year over the revised estimate for the 2025-26 financial year. This is mainly taking into account factors such as increase in public transport patronage and fare adjustments.

(b) The revised estimate under the Scheme for the 2025-26 financial year is about $2.096 billion, while the estimated total expenditure for the 2026-27 financial year is about $2.815 billion. Of these, about $2.050 billion and $2.767 billion respectively are subsidies disbursed to the beneficiaries under the Scheme, both accounting for about 98% of the estimated total expenditure in the relevant financial year. The remaining 2% is the administrative cost of the Scheme. The Government will continue to strive to lower the administrative cost of the Scheme as far as possible.

Monitoring measures under the Scheme are undertaken by existing staff of the Transport Department and there is no separate breakdown of the manpower and expenditure involved.

(c) The average monthly number of beneficiaries under the Scheme in 2025 was about 1.76 million, of which the numbers of beneficiaries receiving subsidies via Octopus and AlipayHK were about 1.74 million and 20 000 respectively. The estimated average monthly number of beneficiaries in 2026 is 1.8 million. We do not have estimated figures broken down by electronic payment means.

(d)(i)

The distribution of public transport expenses under the Scheme in 2025 is set out as follows:

Amount of monthly public transport expenses under the Scheme	**Average monthly number of Octopus / AlipayHK account involved (rounded off to the nearest thousand)**
$400.1-$500	458 000
$500.1-$600	385 000
$600.1-$700	313 000
$700.1-$800	242 000
$800.1-$900	182 000

Amount of monthly public transport expenses under the Scheme	Average monthly number of Octopus / AlipayHK account involved (rounded off to the nearest thousand)
$900.1-$1,000	135 000
$1,000.1-$1,100	96 000
$1,100.1-$1,200	68 000
$1,200.1-$1,300	46 000
$1,300.1-$1,400	33 000
$1,400.1-$1,500	22 000
$1,500.1-$1,600	15 000
$1,600.1-$1,700	11 000
$1,700.1 or above	22 000

(d)(ii)

The average monthly number of beneficiaries by monthly subsidy amount under the Scheme in 2025 is set out as follows:

Monthly subsidy amount	Average monthly number of beneficiaries ('000)
$0.1-$100.0	1 033
$100.1-$200.0	475
$200.1-$300.0	173
$300.1 or above	83

(d)(iii)

The average amount of monthly subsidy per beneficiary under the Scheme in 2025 was $106.

(e) Prior to the adjustment of the threshold of monthly public transport expenses incurred for receiving the subsidy under the Scheme, the average monthly subsidy amount from January to May 2025 was about $217 million, with an average of 2 million beneficiaries per month. After the adjustment to the Scheme, the average monthly subsidy amount from June 2025 to February 2026 was about $162 million, with an average of 1.6 million beneficiaries per month. The adjustment to the Scheme is effective in achieving savings in expenditures and ensuring the financial sustainability of the Scheme, while preserving its policy intent of relieving the fare burden of commuters whose public transport expenses are relatively high.

The subsidy amount and number of beneficiaries under the Scheme depend on a number of factors, such as the actual public transport expenses of commuters, change in public transport patronage and fare adjustments. The Government will continue to closely monitor the operation of the Scheme.

- End –

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB239**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0362)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

There will be a net decrease of 42 posts under this Programme in 2026-27. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. Details of the posts deleted, including: i) divisions, ii) grades, iii) duties, and iv) salary expenses;

2. Under Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 of this Programme, it is mentioned that the Government will continue to conduct process re-engineering of licensing services. What are the details and progress, including the savings in staffing and expenditure achieved by the rollout of more online services and more extensive artificial intelligence applications; and

3. Under Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 of this Programme, it is mentioned that the Department will further enhance the operation of the Northbound Travel for Hong Kong Vehicles and support the implementation of the "Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles". Has the Government assessed the impact of the reduction of 42 posts on the implementation of these two schemes, and whether the performance measures under this Programme can be maintained?

Asked by: Hon LAU Ip-keung, Kenneth (LegCo internal reference no.: 2)

Reply:

1. The net decrease of 42 posts under Programme (2) in 2026-27 includes one Analyst/Programmer grade post, one Executive Officer grade post and 40 posts in the Clerical Officer/ Clerical Assistant grades. Their main duties are to provide computer system support. The total annual staff cost (notional annual mid-point salary) of such posts involved is about $14.9 million.

2. The Transport Department (TD) has been enhancing the efficiency of its work by streamlining the application procedures, rolling out electronic licensing initiatives and applying new technologies such as artificial intelligence (AI) to support the

Government's "Be the Smart Regulator" initiative and address the growing demand for licensing services. Currently, the TD offers over 20 online services, allowing the public to use the digital signing and/or form filling functions of iAM Smart to submit licence applications via a mobile phone or computer anytime anywhere.

In recent years, the TD has introduced a number of new electronic licensing initiatives, including the enhanced Vehicle Licence (VL), the e-Licensing Portal, the e-Auction, the International Driving Permit Self-Service Kiosks, the Electronic Driving Licence (eDL) and the Electronic International Circulation Permit. After enhancement of VL, the number of online applications for renewal of VL has increased significantly by 62%, from about 150 000 in 2024 to about 250 000 in 2025, while the eDL, rolled out in September 2025, has been used by about 350 000 applicants within half a year up to the present. In addition, the TD just fully implemented the online appointment for counter services for application for the direct issue of the Hong Kong Full Driving Licence (direct issue) and cancelled the Same-day Queue Ticket arrangement on 16 March 2026. The direct issue service has also been extended to the four Licensing Offices across the territory to provide greater convenience to applicants and make better use of resources.

In 2026-27, to tie in with the Digital Policy Office's roll-out of the "Digital Corporate Identity" platform (the business version of iAM Smart), the TD will enhance its system to support online VL renewal for businesses and introduce online services for application of the Private Driving Instructors' Test. We will continue to proactively promote electronic licensing initiatives and leverage AI to expedite the processing and approval of licences, thereby saving the need and time for using counter services, and redeploying the manpower resources saved to meet the increasing demand for new licensing services.

3. In 2026-27, the Government will continue to further enhance the operation of the Northbound Travel for Hong Kong Vehicles and support the implementation of the Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles. The net decrease in posts under Programme (2) does not involve these two schemes, and therefore the related services will not be affected.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 Reply Serial No.

TLB240

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0805)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the operating conditions of the Hong Kong section of the Guangzhou-Shenzhen-Hong Kong-Express Rail Link (XRL), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the average daily patronages and the highest daily patronages at the XRL West Kowloon Station (WKS) in the past three years, with a breakdown by short-haul destinations and long-haul destinations;

2. whether the Kowloon-Canton Railway Corporation and the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL) have activated the Cap-and-Collar Mechanism due to deviations in patronage since the operation of the Hong Kong section of the XRL; if yes, the details;

3. the cumulative number of purchases of the 20-ride Ticket and 30-day Ticket since their launch, with a breakdown by Mainland destinations; whether it will explore other ticketing arrangements with greater flexibility and more discounts; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons;

4. whether it will consider further extending the Same-day Flexi-trip Arrangement (Flexi-trip) to all existing short-haul destinations, such as Guangzhou, Humen and Dongguan, to enhance journey flexibility for passengers; if yes, the specific timetable; and

5. given that the number of destinations directly connected to WKS has increased substantially to 110 from 44 in 2018, whether the Government and MTRCL have assessed if the existing station facilities are sufficient to cope with the continuous growth in passenger flow, and whether provision will be earmarked for implementing enhancement works?

Asked by: Hon LAU Ip-keung, Kenneth (LegCo internal reference no.: 6)

Reply:

1. The Hong Kong section of the Guangzhou-Shenzhen-Hong Kong-Express Rail Link (XRL) was commissioned on 23 September 2018. As at March 2026, the number of Mainland destinations directly accessible from West Kowloon Station (WKS) in Hong Kong has increased from 44 at the time of commissioning to 110, among which the number of short-haul destinations has increased from 6 to 11 (Note 1) while the number of long-haul destinations has increased from 38 to 99. According to the XRL ticket sales from 2023 to 2025 provided by the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL), the average daily patronage and highest daily patronage for trips between Hong Kong WKS and short-haul and long-haul destinations are tabulated below:

XRL Train Service	Average Daily Patronage	Highest Daily Patronage (Note 2)
2023		
Short-haul Services	47 000	105 000
Long-haul Services	10 000	25 000
2024		
Short-haul Services	60 000	108 000
Long-haul Services	13 000	26 000
2025		
Short-haul Services	70 000	115 000
Long-haul Services	15 000	33 000

Note 1: The six short-haul destinations at the time of commissioning included Futian, Shenzhenbei, Guangmingcheng, Humen, Qingsheng (now renamed as Nanshabei) and Guangzhounan. The current 11 short-haul destinations include Futian, Shenzhenbei, Guangmingcheng, Dongguannan, Changping, Dongguan, Humen, Nanshabei, Guangzhouxintang, Guangzhounan and Guangzhoudong.

Note 2: The highest daily patronage of short-haul services and long-haul services is not necessarily recorded on the same day.

2. According to the "Patronage Cap-and-Collar Mechanism" under the "Supplemental Service Concession Agreement" for the Hong Kong Section of XRL signed between the Kowloon-Canton Railway Corporation (KCRC) and the MTRCL, the KCRC and the MTRCL will share the upside gain or downside risk if the deviation of the actual annual patronage from the projected level is beyond 15 per cent. Services of the Hong Kong section of XRL were suspended from 30 January 2020 to 14 January 2023, and the KCRC shared part of the downside risk in accordance with the Mechanism.

3. & 4.

Apart from gradually introducing more destinations, the MTRCL has been actively exploring the provision of diversified XRL train services and products with the Mainland railway authorities, with a view to providing convenience to passengers and meeting their different needs. On 25 January 2024, the MTRCL introduced Cross-boundary Multi-ride Tickets, including the 20-ride Ticket and 30-day Ticket, allowing passengers to travel multiple times between WKS in Hong Kong and one fixed Mainland short-haul destination to facilitate business visitors and commuters. The sales figure of Cross-boundary Multi-ride Tickets is internal commercial information of the operation of XRL, and the Government does not have the relevant figure.

Moreover, the MTRCL introduced the Flexi-trip Arrangement for travelling between WKS in Hong Kong and Futian Station on 14 August 2023, and between WKS in Hong Kong and Shenzhenbei Station and 18 March 2024, allowing passengers to change to designated trains between the two stations up to three times on the same day for free. This is a new ticketing arrangement that facilitates flexible travel for travellers. We noted that the MTRCL will engage with relevant Mainland authorities and departments to explore the feasibility of introducing the "Same-day One-time Valid" electronic ticket arrangement to appropriate short-haul destinations on the Hong Kong Section of XRL, with a view to further enhancing the flexibility of travelling by XRL. The HKSAR Government and the railway authorities in Hong Kong and the Mainland will continue to closely follow the development of the nationwide XRL network and enhance XRL services in a timely manner, so as to provide travellers with more diversified choices and services.

5. The layout of the Hong Kong WKS was designed based on the blueprint and patronage forecast of the railway development between the Mainland and Hong Kong at the time of project planning. Since the commissioning of the Hong Kong section of XRL and WKS in 2018, the MTRCL, as the operator of the Hong Kong section of XRL, has been closely monitoring the operation of the station, as well as travellers' travelling pattern and demand. As patronage increases, the MTRCL will continue to review and enhance the ancillary facilities of Hong Kong WKS as needed, including enhancing the layout of ticketing concourse and waiting hall, as well as facilities such as shops and seats in the station, in order to meet the needs of passengers and long-term development of XRL. The expenditure for enhancing the station facilities will be borne by the MTRCL.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2403)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (6) Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The threshold of monthly public transport expenses incurred for receiving the subsidy under the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme (the Scheme) was adjusted and raised from $400 to $500 starting from 1 June 2025. Upon adjustment, savings totalling about $3.56 billion are expected to be achieved in the financial years from 2025-26 to 2029-30. However, the provision for this programme for 2026-27 has increased by $718.7 million (34.3%) compared to the revised estimate for 2025-26. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the i) total subsidy amount, ii) average number of beneficiaries per month and iii) average amount of monthly subsidy per beneficiary of the Scheme for the financial years 2024-25 and 2025-26, and the estimates for the financial year 2026-27;

2. whether the Government has explored including payment means other than Octopus cards and AlipayHK EasyGo in the Scheme to facilitate public commuting; if yes, the details; and

3. how the Government assesses the substantial increase in funding for the adjusted Scheme for 2026-27; whether the target of savings in expenditure totalling about $3.56 billion as mentioned above has changed.

Asked by: Hon LAU Ip-keung, Kenneth (LegCo internal reference no.: 3)

Reply:

1. The total subsidy amount, average number of beneficiaries per month and average amount of monthly subsidy per beneficiary under the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme (the Scheme) are set out below:

Financial year	Actual/Estimated total subsidy amount ($ million)	Actual average number of beneficiaries per month ('000)	Actual average amount of monthly subsidy per beneficiary ($)
2024-25	2,441	1 996	102
2025-26	2,050 (Revised estimate)	N/A	N/A
2026-27	2,767 (Estimate)	N/A	N/A

2. In addition to Octopus, public transport fares paid with AlipayHK have been incorporated into the Scheme with effect from 1 January 2025, allowing the public an extra electronic payment option under the Scheme. When exploring the incorporation of more e-payment systems into the Scheme, we need to consider whether the relevant e-payment platform has been generally adopted by various public transport operators for the collection of transport fares. Besides, as the Scheme involves a high volume of transactions every day, e-payment platforms to be incorporated under the Scheme would need to meet certain operational requirements, including those concerning the uploading and verification of transaction records, the arrangement of subsidy calculation and disbursement, monitoring mechanism, etc., in order to ensure the smooth operation of the Scheme.

3. From 1 June 2025 onwards, the threshold of monthly public transport expenses incurred for receiving the subsidy under the Scheme was raised from $400 to $500. Prior to the adjustment of the Scheme, the average monthly subsidy amount from January to May 2025 was about $217 million. After adjustment to the Scheme, the average monthly subsidy amount from June 2025 to February 2026 was about $162 million. This represents a reduction of about $55 million in the average monthly subsidy amount. The adjustment to the Scheme is effective in achieving savings in expenditures and ensuring the financial sustainability of the Scheme, while preserving its policy intent of relieving the fare burden of commuters whose public transport expenses are relatively high.

Taking into account the expenditure savings brought about by the adjustment to the Scheme, there is still an increase of about $720 million in the estimated total expenditure of the Scheme for the 2026-27 financial year over the revised estimate for the 2025-26 financial year. This is mainly taking into account factors such as increase in public transport patronage and fare adjustments.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2404)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the operation of the Northbound Travel for Hong Kong Vehicles (the Northbound Travel Scheme), and the related measures to support the implementation of the Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles (the Southbound Travel Scheme), will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. i) the number of registrations for balloting received; ii) the number of closed road permits or electronic approval letters issued; iii) the number of travel bookings; and iv) the number of cancelled bookings per month since the implementation of the Northbound Travel Scheme;

2. i) the number of registrations for balloting received; ii) the number of electronic International Circulation Permits (ICPs) and approval letters issued; iii) the number of travel bookings; and iv) the number of cancelled bookings per month since the implementation of the Southbound Travel Scheme;

3. the numbers of traffic violations and traffic accidents involving vehicles from the Northbound Travel Scheme and the Southbound Travel Scheme respectively in the past three years; and

4. whether a study will be conducted to consider extending the Northbound Travel Scheme and the Southbound Travel Scheme to other land boundary control points and introducing innovative technologies at the control points to facilitate vehicle clearance and commuting; if yes, the expenditure involved and details.

Asked by: Hon LAU Ip-keung, Kenneth (LegCo internal reference no.: 13)

Reply:

1. The governments of Guangdong and Hong Kong have been closely monitoring the implementation situation of the Northbound Travel Scheme to continuously take enhancement measures to provide greater convenience for the applicants, including the enhancement measure implemented by the Transport Department (TD) since 1

September 2025 to allow vehicles under the Northbound Travel Scheme to travel to Guangdong Province via the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (HZMB) without travel bookings on Tuesdays and Wednesdays, except specified dates.

The monthly numbers of registrations for balloting and Closed Road Permits (CRPs)/electronic approval letters issued since the launch of the Northbound Travel Scheme are set out in **Annex 1**. The monthly numbers of travel bookings and cancelled bookings are set out in **Annex 2**, in which the figures upon implementation of the above booking waiver arrangements on Tuesdays and Wednesdays have been reflected.

2. The Southbound Travel Scheme (Entry into Urban Area) allocates quotas to eligible vehicle owners through a monthly ballot. Starting from November 2025, eligible Guangdong private car owners can register with the relevant Mainland authorities for balloting in order to obtain quotas under the Southbound Travel Scheme (Entry into Urban Area). Successful applicants can submit their applications to the Mainland authorities. After vetting by the Mainland authorities, the applications will be passed to the TD for further vetting. The TD will issue an electronic International Circulation Permit (ICP) to the successful applicants. Starting from 23 December, Guangdong vehicles issued with ICPs may enter Hong Kong's urban areas via the HZMB for up to three days per visit.

According to information published by the Mainland authorities on the website of Guangdong's information system of the Southbound Travel Scheme, since the commencement of the first round of registration for balloting under the Southbound Travel Scheme (Entry into Urban Area) in November 2025, the Mainland authorities has conducted four rounds of balloting, and the number of applications registered for balloting received in each round is about 2 400, 1 700, 7 300 and 6 500 respectively.

The TD received about 1 800, 1 500 and 900 applications referred from the Mainland authorities in December 2025, January and February 2026 respectively. After vetting, the TD issued about 600, 1 500 and 1 400 ICPs respectively during the same periods.

The monthly numbers of travel bookings and cancelled bookings from 23 December 2025 to 28 February 2026 are tabulated as follows:

Month	Number of travel bookings [Note]	Number of cancelled bookings
December 2025 (23 to 31)	192	15
January 2026	801	113
February 2026	1 492	224

Note: Excluding cancelled bookings.

3. According to information from the relevant Mainland authorities, there were about 500 traffic accidents or incidents involving Hong Kong vehicles in the Mainland under the Northbound Travel Scheme in the past three years. The violation cases under the Southbound Travel Scheme are sporadic, and the relevant cases have either been handled or are being followed up.

4. The HKSAR Government has been maintaining close liaison with the relevant Mainland authorities to take timely enhancement measures under the Northbound Travel Scheme and the Southbound Travel Scheme to provide greater convenience and improve travel experience for the public. Based on the Guangdong Province Administrative Measures, we will first focus on allowing Hong Kong and Guangdong vehicles to travel between Guangdong and Hong Kong via the HZMB. As the car park where the Airport Authority Hong Kong provides the "Park & Fly" service is located at the HZMB Hong Kong Port, using the HZMB for vehicle travel under the Southbound Travel Scheme is well suited. The HKSAR Government will continue to closely monitor the clearance and traffic conditions at the HZMB ports during peak days and periods, and take various enhancement measures to enhance the clearance capacity of the Hong Kong Port and ensure smooth traffic flow.

According to the information provided by the Customs and Excise Department (C&ED), to align with the development of Smart Customs and to cater for the increasing cross-boundary private vehicle traffic, the C&ED has been developing an Automated Private Car Clearance System (the system) since 2025. Through the use of smart hardware and automation technology, the system is equipped with computer- controlled automatic drop-arm barriers and high-definition cameras capable of reading licence plates of vehicles from Guangdong, Hong Kong and Macao to assist frontline Customs officers in vehicle clearance. During the pilot run of the system, the C&ED can handle a larger volume of clearance work with the same level of manpower in coping with the increasingly heavy flow of cross-boundary private cars.

The C&ED has carried out a pilot run of the system at the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge Hong Kong Port since January 2026, and will gradually extend the system to other land boundary control points, with completion scheduled for 2027. The system development and pilot run have been carried out by the C&ED with existing manpower and resources, which have been included in the general operating expenditure; a breakdown of expenditure is not available.

Annex 1

Number of registrations for balloting and number of CRPs/electronic approval letters issued by the TD under the Northbound Travel Scheme

Month [1]	Number of registrations for balloting for application to the Northbound Travel Scheme [2]	Number of CRPs/electronic approval letters issued [3]
May 2023 [4]	17 261	N/A [4]
June 2023 [4]	24 795	474
July 2023	19 099	3 615
August 2023	14 788	5 169
September 2023	15 136	6 037
October 2023	7 311	8 428
November 2023	7 795	7 740
December 2023	7 709	5 957
January 2024	8 012	6 836
February 2024	5 544	5 983
March 2024	12 253	5 696
April 2024	7 468	6 063
May 2024	7 196	5 897
June 2024	6 832	5 602
July 2024	6 359	7 986
August 2024	10 478	7 687
September 2024	8 648	7 285
October 2024	11 195	8 983
November 2024	13 148	7 754
December 2024	13 957	7 428
January 2025	18 181	9 161
February 2025	8 874	7 820
March 2025	6 409	9 095
April 2025	5 298	8 500
May 2025	5 790	7 319
June 2025	6 964	8 248
July 2025	6 089	9 838
August 2025	4 942	8 798
September 2025	4 673	8 726
October 2025	5 611	10 073
November 2025	5 734	10 054
December 2025	7 873	10 902
January 2026	6 279	9 964
February 2026	4 559	8 324

Note 1: Based on the date of balloting.

Note 2: As some applicants have registered for more than one round of balloting, registrations made by the same applicant are all counted into the figures.

Note 3: Starting from 13 October 2025, vehicles approved to participate in the Northbound Travel Scheme are not required to apply for a CRP. The TD will issue an electronic approval letter to successful applicants to confirm their eligibility for participation.

Note 4: The TD started receiving registrations for the Northbound Travel Scheme on 29 May 2023 and has been issuing permits since June 2023, allowing successful applicants to travel to Guangdong Province via the HZMB from 1 July 2023 onwards.

Annex 2

Monthly numbers of travel bookings under the Northbound Travel Scheme

Month	Number of travel bookings[#]	Number of cancelled bookings
July 2023	3 713	621
August 2023	9 864	883
September 2023	16 743	2 233
October 2023	26 049	1 972
November 2023	32 575	1 822
December 2023	49 382	5 282
January 2024	41 539	2 518
February 2024	54 529	7 287
March 2024	60 448	6 301
April 2024	54 959	6 439
May 2024	61 661	6 827
June 2024	65 364	7 924
July 2024	60 682	5 378
August 2024	72 954	5 562
September 2024	57 105	5 963
October 2024	72 262	7 664
November 2024	64 323	5 040
December 2024	70 827	8 816
January 2025	81 568	10 536
February 2025	60 659	5 813
March 2025	71 066	5 109
April 2025	87 210	11 578
May 2025	87 254	11 368
June 2025	73 836	7 176
July 2025	75 864	8 584
August 2025	90 122	8 036
September 2025 [*]	52 861	6 428
October 2025 [*]	84 831	11 858
November 2025 [*]	58 281	6 690
December 2025 [*]	63 361	17 080
January 2026 [*]	65 022	10 519
February 2026 [*]	88 000	21 330

Excluding cancelled bookings.

* From 1 September 2025 onwards, bookings are not required for vehicles travelling to Guangdong Province via the HZMB under the Northbound Travel Scheme on Tuesdays and Wednesdays, except specified dates. Hence, the figures on travel bookings since that month should not be directly compared with those of the previous months.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3213)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned under Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27 that the Government will continue to introduce practicable measures to enhance traffic management and to alleviate road traffic congestion, including taking forward progressively the Transport Strategy Blueprint. It has been proposed that big data and cloud computing technologies should be applied in the analysis of traffic data to enable the public transport system to adjust bus and ferry frequencies in rural areas in real-time on demand, with a view to implementing smart mobility. In this connection, please advise this Committee of the following:

Will the Government study piloting relevant technologies in outlying islands and other rural and remote areas to improve the travelling experience for residents and tourists? If yes, has the Government formulated long-term plans and resource allocation plans for the development of smart mobility in rural areas? What are the specific timetable and performance indicators? If no, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon LAU Man-kwan, Julia (LegCo internal reference no.: 38)

Reply:

With a view to enhancing the flexibility of public transport services, the Transport Strategy Blueprint recommends utilising technology to monitor and forecast passenger demand, especially in areas with scattered passengers' travel needs, remote locations, or periods of lower passenger volume. This approach will allow the dynamic adoption of more efficient routes and flexible schedules in response to demand, thus optimising the use of resources. Under this smart demand-responsive public transport mode, passengers can use a mobile application to submit their travel requests in advance. The backend system of public transport operators analyses the aggregated travel demand (including travel times, origins and destinations) and, based on real-time traffic conditions and passenger pick-up and drop-off points, flexibly determines appropriate routes and schedules.

To test the feasibility of implementing the above operation mode in Hong Kong, certain research institutions, with funding support from the Smart Traffic Fund, will commence testing on public light bus routes in collaboration with public light bus operators within this

year to evaluate the relevant technology and practical operation. In addition, the Transport Department is actively exploring with franchised bus operators the feasibility of introducing the relevant intelligent operation mode for testing on specified franchised bus routes, such as airport overnight bus routes and sightseeing bus routes. The Government will study the franchised bus services beyond the existing ones, using technology to flexibly schedule and deploy services according to demand. Subject to the effectiveness of testing and development of this operation mode, the Government will consider extending this mode to suitable public transport services for testing.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0472)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

On combating illegal carriage of passengers by motor vehicles for hire or reward, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. What is the number of enforcement actions taken to combat the illegal carriage of passengers by motor vehicles for hire or reward, and how many of these cases involved cross-boundary vehicles in 2025?

2. What is the number of vehicles impounded with the relevant licences suspended on grounds of illegal carriage of passengers for hire or reward, and how many of these cases involved cross-boundary vehicles in 2025?

3. The Transport Department will continue to assist the Transport and Logistics Bureau in matters relating to the formulation of measures combating the illegal carriage of passengers by motor vehicles for hire or reward in 2026-27. What are details of the work and resources involved? and

4. Will the Hong Kong Police Force be called upon to reinforce the efforts to combat the illegal carriage of passengers for hire or reward? If yes, what are the details? If no, what are the reasons?

Asked by: Hon LEE Chun-keung (LegCo internal reference no.: 11)

Reply:

1. In 2025, the Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF) has taken 118 enforcement actions against the use of motor vehicles for illegal carriage of passengers for hire or reward, and none of which involved cross-boundary vehicles.

2. In 2025, 55 vehicles were detained with their vehicle licences suspended by the Transport Department (TD) on grounds of illegal carriage of passengers for hire or

reward, four of which were cross-boundary vehicles involved in the enforcement actions taken in 2024.

3. The TD has been conducting education and publicity through various channels such as posting publicity messages on social media platforms, releasing online promotional video, broadcasting announcement on radio, displaying samples of hire car permits (HCPs) on the TD's website, putting up posters at land control points, the airport and in public places, etc. to remind the public to choose lawful modes of public transport when travelling and enquire with the relevant service operators about whether the vehicles concerned have been issued with HCPs before travelling. The TD has also set up an online enquiry system for the public to check and verify whether a vehicle has been issued with a valid HCP. The TD will continue to remind the public to pay attention to safety, emphasising that using illegal hire car services can put passengers at risk as the third party insurance for any vehicle used for illegal carriage of passengers for hire or reward may be invalidated in the event of a traffic accident. The TD will continue its publicity efforts and work with the HKPF on information exchange in order to combat the use of motor vehicles for illegal carriage of passengers for hire or reward.

   Moreover, the Road Traffic (Amendment) (Ride-hailing Service) Bill 2025 (the Bill), which was passed by the Legislative Council in October 2025, stipulates a regulatory framework for ride-hailing services and strengthens the penalties against illegal carriage of passengers for hire or reward. The Bill stipulates that convicted drivers should be disqualified from driving for not less than 12 months and not more than three years; and strengthens the arrangement for the suspension of vehicle licences and impoundment of vehicles, allowing a mechanism under which the Government may impound the vehicles involved even if the driver involved cannot be identified for the purpose of instituting criminal proceedings, thereby enhancing deterrence against, and combating, the illegal carriage of passengers for hire or reward by motor vehicles by vehicle owners or drivers.

   In addition, the Bill stipulates that, under the regulatory framework for ride-hailing services to be implemented, any platform providing ride-hailing service without a valid ride-hailing service licence commits an offence and is liable to a maximum penalty of fine at $1 million and imprisonment for 12 months. Any person driving or using a private car for providing ride-hailing passenger transport service without a ride-hailing vehicle permit or a ride-hailing vehicle driving permit, or the trip concerned is not arranged through a platform holding a valid ride-hailing service licence, commits an offence and is liable to a maximum penalty of fine at level 3 ($10,000) and imprisonment for six months on first conviction, and a maximum penalty of fine at level 4 ($25,000) and imprisonment for 12 months on subsequent conviction. The implementation date of the Bill will be announced separately by a notice published in the Gazette.

   The above tasks have been undertaken by the existing staff of the TD as part of their established duties. There is no separate breakdown of resources involved.

4. The Government has all along been concerned about the use of motor vehicles for illegal carriage of passengers for hire or reward. The HKPF has been taking enforcement actions against illegal carriage of passengers for hire or reward through gathering intelligence through different channels. If there is sufficient evidence proving suspected vehicles without a valid HCP being used for illegal carriage of passengers for

hire or reward, the HKPF will immediately take appropriate enforcement actions. The HKPF will continue to allocate appropriate resources to step up enforcement actions against illegal carriage of passengers for reward so as to protect the safety of passengers and road users.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB245**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2407)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the support for the implementation of the "Dedicated 100% Loan Guarantee Scheme for Battery Electric Taxis" (the Loan Scheme), please advise this Committee of the latest progress of the Loan Scheme since its implementation in September 2023, with details including the number of applications received and approved by various lending institutions, the number of vehicles and loan amounts involved, and the time taken in approving the applications.

Asked by: Hon LEE Chun-keung (LegCo internal reference no.8)

Reply:

On 4 September 2023, the Government launched the "Dedicated 100% Loan Guarantee Scheme for Battery Electric Taxis (e-taxis)" (the Loan Scheme) to encourage the taxi trade to switch to battery e-taxis. The Loan Scheme is administered by the Hong Kong Mortgage Corporation Insurance Limited (HKMCI) and loan applications are processed by the participating lending institutions (PLIs).

Since the launch of the Loan Scheme up to 28 February this year, HKMCI has received from PLIs a total of 927 applications. Among them, 864 applications have been approved, nine applications are being processed, and 54 applications have the loan cancelled due to withdrawal of application by applicants or the applicants' failure to draw the loan within the period of time designated by HKMCI. Among the 864 approved applications, applicants of 700 applications have drawn the loan, with a total loan amount of about $230 million, while the remaining 164 applicants have yet to draw the loan due to various reasons, such as the vehicle has not been delivered.

In general, HKMCI can approve a loan within a week upon receipt of a PLI's submission of application with all the required documents.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2408)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

On increasing the provision of parking spaces, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. The Transport Department (TD) took forward a host of measures to increase car parking spaces in 2024. Please give information on the numbers of additional parking spaces for various types of commercial vehicles (CVs) (i.e. taxis, minibuses, goods vehicles and non-franchised buses) in various districts and the resources involved in the relevant work.

2. For the 11 government public car parks, will the Government consider introducing concessionary measures to attract, in particular, CVs to park during periods of lower usage? If yes, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons?

3. As the ratio of the number of CVs to the number of CV parking spaces has remained at 1:0.6 for a long time, will the Government consider setting performance indicators for increasing the number of parking spaces, so as to ensure that the problem of insufficient CV parking spaces can be gradually improved? If yes, what are the details? If not, what are the reasons? Are there any measures in place to effectively alleviate the problem of insufficient parking spaces for CVs?

Asked by: Hon LEE Chun-keung (LegCo internal reference no.: 9)

Reply

1. Commercial vehicles (CVs), which carry goods and passengers, play an important role in various industries as well as the overall economy. The Government's policy on the provision of parking spaces is to accord priority to considering and meeting the parking demand of CVs. It has been actively pursuing a host of short-term and medium-to-long-term measures through a multi-pronged approach to increase CV parking spaces in a holistic manner, including:

(i) providing additional on-street CV parking spaces (including metered parking spaces) at suitable locations without compromising traffic flow, road safety or the loading/unloading activities of other road users;
(ii) designating suitable on-street locations as night-time parking spaces for CVs and flexibly adjusting their operating hours;
(iii) utilising spaces underneath flyovers to designate parking spaces;
(iv) continuing to communicate closely with the Lands Department, identifying suitable sites for short-term tenancy car parks having regard to local parking demand, and stipulating the provision of a minimum number of parking spaces for CVs in suitable car parks;
(v) encouraging schools to allow student service vehicles to park within school premises during non-school hours;
(vi) providing public vehicle parks (PVPs) including parking spaces for CVs in suitable "Government, Institution or Community" facilities and public open space in line with the "single site, multiple use" (SSMU) principle. The first three PVPs constructed under the SSMU principle, namely Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park in Sheung Shui, the Pak Shing Kok Road Public Car Park at The Chinese Medicine Hospital of Hong Kong in Tseung Kwan O, and the Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park, have commenced operation;
(vii) revising the Hong Kong Planning Standards and Guidelines in 2021, which increased the types and numbers of parking spaces for CVs in subsidised housing development projects, introduced two types of "shared-use" parking spaces [Note 1] with reference to the similar vehicle dimensions of CVs, and increased the number of loading/unloading bays in subsidised housing so that they can be opened up for night-time parking of large-sized CVs (i.e. medium/heavy goods vehicles and coaches); and
(viii) requiring that a certain number of ancillary parking spaces and loading/unloading bays in suitable new development projects be opened for public night-time parking of CVs.

The distribution of, and changes in, the number of CV parking spaces in various districts in 2025 are set out at **Annex**. Overall, the number of parking spaces increased by 326. As there is no separate breakdown of this figure, it does not include parking spaces at depots, public transport termini or stands.

The above measures and tasks are mainly carried out by existing staff of the TD as part of their established duties and therefore no separate breakdown of expenditure could be provided.

Note 1: One type is "shared-use" by light goods vehicles and light buses, the other is "shared-use" by medium/heavy goods vehicles and coaches.

2. At present, van-type light goods vehicles and private cars are charged the same parking fees at the 11 public car parks operated by the TD (except Wong Tai Sin Car Park [Note 1]). The parking fees of the above-mentioned 11 public car parks are generally lower than those of nearby car parks, and six of them [Note 2] offer concessionary night-time parking fees during periods of relatively low usage at night to attract motorists, including van-type light goods vehicle drivers.

Note 1: The Wong Tai Sin Car Park only provides parking spaces for coaches/goods vehicles (over 5.5 tonnes) and does not provide parking spaces for van-type light goods vehicles or private cars.

Note 2: The six car parks are Rumsey Street Car Park, City Hall Car Park, Star Ferry Car Park, Tsuen Wan Car Park, Kwai Fong Car Park and Wong Tai Sin Car Park.

3. The demand for CV parking spaces depends on many factors, such as the overall economic situation, local demand and supply of parking spaces, CV operating patterns, parking habits, and places of residence and work of drivers. At present, many CVs are parked not only at brownfield sites but also on the Chinese Mainland where drivers are engaged in cross-boundary operations. Some CVs (such as those for food transportation and distribution) operate at night to meet industry needs. Currently, the figures for CV parking spaces and demand for them do not take into account the above three types of vehicles. As such, the current ratio of CVs to CV parking spaces does not reflect the higher supply and lower demand.

As announced in the Transport Strategy Blueprint, the TD will initiate a new study on parking demand and supply in 2026 to review the existing parking facilities and the parking demand and supply for various types of vehicles, in particular CVs. The study results and recommendations are expected to be released in 2027. This study will analyse the operating patterns of CVs and their actual parking situations in locations such as private land, and take into consideration factors such as the future development of Hong Kong, thereby determining shortfall in CV parking spaces. Targeted measures will be proposed to ensure a proper match between supply and demand, with a view to achieving "every commercial vehicle having a suitable parking space at night" in the long run.

Annex

Changes in number of parking spaces by type of CVs in 18 districts in 2025 [Note 1]

District	Change in the number of parking spaces	
	Goods vehicle	**Coach/bus**
Central & Western	-36	1
Wan Chai	-172	-10
Eastern	17	-21
Southern	16	9
Yau Tsim Mong	-6	2
Sham Shui Po	-95	4
Kowloon City	-41	-16
Wong Tai Sin	-18	-1
Kwun Tong	-31	15
Tsuen Wan	-48	-9
Tuen Mun	-2	0
Yuen Long	-120	-33
North	120	-3
Tai Po	27	21
Sai Kung	108	42
Sha Tin	-43	-6
Kwai Tsing	478	177
Islands	0	0
Total	**154**	**172**

Note 1: In general, taxis may use private car parking spaces, whereas most franchised buses, public light buses, private light buses, special purpose vehicles and government vehicles should be parked at the parking spaces at depots, bus stops within public transport termini, and the parking spaces at stands. Accordingly, such parking spaces are excluded from the calculation.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB247**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2698)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the implementation of the Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector – Public Light Bus/Coach Trade (the Scheme) aiming at alleviating manpower shortage problem in the transport sectors, despite of low unemployment rate in Hong Kong remained, the transport trades are still facing recruitment difficulties, please inform this Committee on whether the Government will consider increasing the number of quotas on imported drivers; if yes, the details; and whether the Government will further implement streamlined measures to expedite the processing of applications; if not, the reasons; and whether there are any measures to alleviate the driver shortage problem of the transport sectors?

Asked by: Hon LEE Chun-keung (LegCo internal reference no.10)

Reply:

The Government has all along been concerned about the long standing driver shortage problem faced by the public light bus (PLB)/coach trade. To alleviate the problem of labour shortage in the trade, the Government announced the Scheme in June 2023, and approved a total of 900 PLB and 800 coach driver quotas through two rounds of applications in September 2023 and July 2024 respectively. All applications were vetted by the inter-departmental liaison group (comprising representatives from the Transport and Logistics Bureau, the Labour Department and the Transport Department (TD)). In addition, as for the gradual expiry of the contracts of the first batch of imported workers under the Scheme from the end of 2025, the TD announced the quota renewal arrangements in August 2025. The operators with allocated quota should submit renewal applications to TD five months prior to the expiry of the contracts of their imported drivers. As at end-February 2026, 589 quotas (including 324 PLB and 265 coach driver quotas) have been granted with approval for renewal. The TD will continue to process the renewal applications received, including reviewing whether or not the operators concerned continue to meet the criteria of the Scheme (such as maintaining the manning ratio of 1:2 for imported labrours to full-time local staff, the wage levels for imported labours at not less than the median monthly wages of the relevant posts, and complying relevant local driver recruitment requirements, etc.).

At present, the TD has no plan to adjust the total number of quotas. In future, the TD will continue to pay attention to the changes in the local labour market and the manpower situation,

review the implementation of the Scheme and assess the manpower demand of the industries. At the same time, the TD will maintain close liaison with various stakeholders and enhance information dissemination through the stakeholders consultative group as well as review the Scheme in a timely manner with reference to the opinions.

Moreover, the TD has been maintaining close communication with the trade and keeping in view of the situation of driver shortage through regular meetings and daily service monitoring. Apart from the Scheme, the Government continues to implement various measures with a view to assisting and encouraging the trade to local recruitment, including the relaxation of application requirements for driving licence for commercial vehicles, coordination of the trade's participation in various employment schemes, promotion of diversified local recruitment channels and introduction of relevant training courses of the trade, etc. At the same time, through the collaboration of the TD and the Employees Retraining Board (ERB), the ERB as well as the PLB operators and third-party training organisations, launched the placement-tied driving training scheme in 2024 with the green minibus (GMB) as a pilot with a view to encouraging local workers to join the PLB trade. The first batch of trainees was deployed to driving duties for designated GMB routes (after completing the training courses and obtaining relevant driving licenses) in the second quarter of 2025. The ERB has continued the placement-tied driving training scheme for GMB trade in 2025. Some trainees of the second batch, who obtained the required licences and completed route training, have already been deployed to driving duties for designated GMB routes in January 2026.

The Government will continue to encourage operators to improve the remuneration packages of their staff through various means, such as increasing salaries and paid leave, so as to create a more desirable working environment and attract more new blood to join the trade, as well as to employ part-time drivers to meet the manpower demand for services during peak-hour.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0447)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Ms Angela LEE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in Head 158 of the 2026-27 Budget that the Transport and Logistics Bureau will introduce legislative amendments for regulating the use of electric mobility devices (EMDs). Will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the numbers of accidents and casualties involving EMDs in the past three years;

2. the number of arrests for illegal use of EMDs in the past three years; and

3. whether there is a plan to improve the relevant infrastructures (such as parking spaces, charging facilities, etc.).

Asked by: Hon LEE Hoey Simon (LegCo internal reference no.: 6)

Reply:

1. The numbers of accidents involving EMDs with casualties in the past three years are set out in the table below:

	2023	**2024**	**2025**
Fatal accident	0	0	0
Serious accident	1	1	0
Slight accident	9	2	8
Total no. of accidents (Note 1 and 2)	**10**	**3**	**8**

Note:

(1) The Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF) does not maintain statistics on the number of casualties in accidents.

(2) Fatal accident refers to an accident where one or more persons die within 30 days of the accident.
Serious accident refers to an accident where one or more persons are injured and detained in hospital for more than 12 hours.
Slight accident refers to an accident where all persons involved are either not detained in hospitals or detained in hospitals for not more than 12 hours.

2. The numbers of persons arrested by the HKPF for the use of unlicensed EMDs in 2023, 2024 and 2025 are 267, 647 and 760 respectively.

3. EMDs can serve as a mean of transport for short-distance travel and first-mile/last-mile connectivity to and from railway stations and other public transport stations etc., providing the public with more active mobility options. We plan to introduce a regulatory framework and a legislative bill to regulate EMDs this year. To ensure the product quality and safety of EMDs, the Transport Department (TD) and the Hong Kong Productivity Council are devising a product certification arrangement, having regard to the experience of various regions, as the core of the regulatory framework. The TD has been proactively engaging with relevant departments on the construction of comprehensive cycle track networks in new development areas (such as the Hung Shui Kiu New Development Area), while at the same time selecting suitable cycle tracks in other areas (such as those with sufficient width and high connectivity) to allow for the safe co-use of bicycles and EMDs.

Regarding parking facilities, the TD will implement measures to increase the number of bicycle parking spaces and supporting facilities. These include incorporating bicycle parking spaces as ancillary facilities in land use and providing sufficient bicycle parking spaces at suitable sites, having regard to the needs of the corresponding land use. Such parking spaces will also be suitable for power-assisted pedal cycles. As for EMDs of smaller size (such as motorised skateboards), drawing reference from the practices of other cities, we will encourage the provision of storage facilities at suitable locations (such as at the Transport Interchange Hubs) to facilitate the use of EMDs by the public for connecting journeys.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0809)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Government has announced the Transport Strategy Blueprint earlier, and one of its recommendations is to continue increasing the supply of parking spaces comprehensively. Please advise this Committee of the following:

1. the numbers of commercial vehicles (CVs) and their parking spaces, as well as the ratio of the number of parking spaces to the number of CVs in the past three years;

2. the distribution and growth rate of parking spaces for CVs by district in the past three years;

3. the distribution and utilisation rates of metered parking spaces by district in the past three years; and

4. as there are views that abuse of metered parking spaces has been found (such as prolonged parking, fare evasion, and use of parking spaces for commercial activities), whether the Government has noticed the situation; if yes, the measures to be taken to prevent abuse of metered parking spaces.

Asked by: Hon LEE Hoey Simon (LegCo internal reference no.: 4)

Reply:

1. The numbers of licensed commercial vehicles (CVs) and their parking spaces, as well as the ratios of the numbers of parking spaces to the numbers of these licensed CVs in the past three years are tabulated below:

Year	Number of licensed CVs	Number of parking spaces for CVs	Ratio
December 2023	69 737	45 388	0.65
December 2024	67 243	44 239	0.66
December 2025	66 753	44 565	0.67

2. The numbers and percentage changes of parking spaces for CVs in 18 districts in the past three years are tabulated below:

District	Number of parking spaces for CVs			Percentage change (from 2023 to 2025)
	2023	2024	2025	
Central & Western	1 086	1 149	1 114	2.6%
Wan Chai	493	668	486	-1.4%
Eastern	2 161	2 129	2 125	-1.7%
Southern	1 396	1 396	1 421	1.8%
Yau Tsim Mong	1 649	1 567	1 563	-5.2%
Sham Shui Po	3 738	3 639	3 548	-5.1%
Kowloon City	1 662	1 718	1 661	-0.1%
Wong Tai Sin	1 368	1 389	1 370	0.1%
Kwun Tong	3 645	3 806	3 790	4.0%
Tsuen Wan	2 541	2 513	2 456	-3.3%
Tuen Mun	2 799	2 807	2 805	0.2%
Yuen Long	2 510	2 585	2 432	-3.1%
North	1 859	1 636	1 753	-5.7%
Tai Po	1 361	1 325	1 373	0.9%
Sai Kung	1 823	1 908	2 058	12.9%
Sha Tin	3 020	2 924	2 875	-4.8%
Kwai Tsing	11 004	9 781	10 436	-5.2%
Islands	1 273	1 299	1 299	2.0%

The above parking information is collated from the data provided by various departments or the relevant car park management companies or operators, and is for general reference only. The actual number of parking spaces may vary as the departments, management companies or operators responsible for managing the car parks may make adjustments to the number/types of parking spaces to suit their own requirements.

In view of the overall development needs of Hong Kong in the past three years, some short-term tenancy (STT) car parks have been gradually resumed for long-term developments, resulting in a decrease in the number of parking spaces for CVs in certain areas. To alleviate the pressure on the overall short-term supply of parking spaces, the Transport Department (TD) has been closely monitoring the changes in the supply and demand for parking spaces in various districts and, proactively increasing on-street and night-time parking spaces for CVs and providing more parking spaces in suitable STT car parks, where practicable. Following the gradual implementation of these measures, the total number of parking spaces for CVs in Hong Kong rebounded in 2025.

As outlined in the Transport Strategy Blueprint, the TD will conduct a new round of parking demand and supply study in 2026 to review existing parking facilities and the demand for and supply of parking spaces for various types of vehicles (especially CVs), and will release the results and recommendations of the study in 2027. This study will analyse CVs' operational patterns and their actual parking situations at locations like private land, and, determine the gap between the demand for and supply of parking spaces for CVs, having regard to factors such as Hong Kong's future development, and propose targeted measures to ensure that the supply of parking spaces matches the demand.

3. The distribution of metered parking spaces (metered spaces) by district in the past three years is tabulated below:

District	2023	2024	2025
Central & Western	599	599	598
Eastern	579	592	589
Southern	687	685	688
Wan Chai	1 019	1 022	1 032
Hong Kong (Sub-total)	**2 884**	**2 898**	**2 907**
Kowloon City	2 564	2 576	2 632
Kwun Tong	575	630	638
Sham Shui Po	1 347	1 356	1 406
Wong Tai Sin	403	412	418
Yau Tsim Mong	1 982	1 994	1 955
Kowloon (Sub-total)	**6 871**	**6 968**	**7 049**
Islands	175	175	175
Kwai Tsing	516	585	600
North	1 069	1 125	1 115
Sai Kung	1 863	1 949	1 975
Sha Tin	1 699	1 705	1 702
Tai Po	1 599	1 616	1 633
Tsuen Wan	669	685	698
Tuen Mun	1 269	1 276	1 303
Yuen Long	1 182	1 229	1 226
New Territories (Sub-total)	**10 041**	**10 345**	**10 427**
Total	**19 796**	**20 211**	**20 383**

The average utilisation rates of metered spaces in the past three years are tabulated below:

District	2023		2024		2025	
	Weekdays (%)	Weekends and holidays (%)	Weekdays (%)	Weekends and holidays (%)	Weekdays (%)	Weekends and holidays (%)
Central & Western	90	81	93	86	91	84
Eastern	91	83	91	92	91	92
Southern	62	70	68	73	68	73
Wan Chai	91	91	90	89	89	88
Hong Kong (Sub-total)	**84**	**82**	**88**	**85**	**87**	**85**
Kowloon City	95	95	91	91	90	90
Kwun Tong	93	95	92	93	93	92
Sham Shui Po	96	91	94	93	93	94
Wong Tai Sin	91	91	94	93	92	92
Yau Tsim Mong	93	92	96	94	95	96

District	2023		2024		2025	
	Weekdays (%)	Weekends and holidays (%)	Weekdays (%)	Weekends and holidays (%)	Weekdays (%)	Weekends and holidays (%)
Kowloon (Sub-total)	**95**	**93**	**93**	**94**	**93**	**92**
Islands	68	76	75	73	74	74
Kwai Tsing	92	92	96	91	95	91
North	88	90	88	89	88	89
Sai Kung	74	76	75	70	75	69
Sha Tin	87	92	86	90	86	89
Tai Po	88	92	82	90	83	91
Tsuen Wan	88	92	90	92	88	93
Tuen Mun	88	92	84	92	83	94
Yuen Long	88	90	89	85	90	86
New Territories (Sub-total)	**85**	**88**	**85**	**86**	**86**	**87**
Total	**88**	**89**	**88**	**88**	**88**	**88**

4. The Government has all along been combating the illegal occupation of metered spaces, deterring fare evasion and other forms of illegal use, with a view to enhancing turnover and ensuring that these spaces meet short-term parking needs. The Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF) conducts inspections and takes enforcement actions against unpaid parking, and maintains close coordination with relevant departments, such as the TD, at the district level for ongoing monitoring. The parking meter system, equipped with sensors, can detect real-time occupancy and enable the TD to identify unpaid metered spaces through the backend computer system. The TD shares this information with the HKPF via a dedicated application to facilitate enforcement.

The parking meter operator engaged by the TD provides the HKPF with information on unpaid but occupied metered spaces detected by the sensors for follow-up, and dispatches staff to regularly patrol parking meters in various districts. If any unlawful occupation of metered spaces is observed, the contractor will report the situation to relevant departments (for example, the HKPF, the Lands Department and the Food and Environmental Hygiene Department) for enforcement.

Moreover, the TD is arranging for the testing of artificial intelligence sensors to distinguish whether objects occupying metered spaces are vehicles, thereby enhancing the management and operational efficiency of metered spaces and facilitating follow-up by the relevant law enforcement departments. The TD and the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department have formulated technical details for the pilot scheme and completed the tender exercise in the first quarter of this year. The development of the relevant equipment is expected to commence in the second quarter of this year, to be followed by a six-month on-site trial.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2405)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It has been more than two years since the implementation of the toll plan for rationalising traffic among the three road harbour crossings (RHCs) at the end of 2023, please advise this Committee of the following:

1. the average daily traffic flows of various types of vehicles at the three RHCs and their respective percentages in the past three years;

2. the design capacities and peak-hour utilisation rates of the three RHCs in the past three years; and

3. in relation to the significantly increased traffic flow at the Western Harbour Crossing (WHC) after the implementation of the toll plan for rationalising traffic among the three RHCs, the measures taken by the Government to alleviate congestion at WHC during peak hours and the impact on traffic flow on adjoining roads in the past two years.

Asked by: Hon LEE Hoey Simon (LegCo internal reference no.: 5)

Reply:

1. The average daily traffic flows of the three road harbour crossings (RHCs), namely the Western Harbour Crossing (WHC), the Cross-Harbour Tunnel (CHT) and the Eastern Harbour Crossing (EHC), on weekdays with a breakdown by vehicle type and respective percentage, in the past three years (i.e. 2023 to 2025) are set out at **Annex 1**.

2. The design capacities and peak-hour utilisation rates (measured by ratios of vehicular flow/design capacity) of the three RHCs in the past three years (i.e. 2023 to 2025) are tabulated at **Annex 2**.

3. According to the traffic data of 2025, after the implementation of time-varying tolls, the total cross-harbour traffic flows of the three tunnels on weekdays remained generally stable without significantly inducing additional traffic. At the same time, the traffic

was more evenly distributed among the three RHCs, and the capacity of each tunnel was better utilised, thus effectively achieving the policy objectives and expectations.

With the reduction in tolls, the traffic at WHC is busier than before. To alleviate traffic conditions at WHC, the Government has constructed an additional lane at the exit of WHC on the Hong Kong Island towards Central and Sheung Wan, which was commissioned on 30 November 2025, allowing vehicles, in particular heavy vehicles and buses, to travel to Central, Sheung Wan and Sai Ying Pun more directly without the need to weave. It is observed that there has been a noticeable reduction in vehicle weaving at the tunnel portal since the commissioning of the additional lane. The traffic flow is significantly smoother than before, allowing more vehicles to pass through the tunnel, thereby increasing the actual number of vehicles accommodated by the tunnel.

Annex 1

Average Daily Traffic Flows on Weekdays by Vehicle Type and Respective Percentage at the Three RHCs (in Two-way Vehicles) [1&2]

Year	WHC					
	Private car	**Motorcycle [3]**	**Taxi**	**Bus [4]**	**Light bus [5]**	**Goods vehicle**
2023	36 200 [50%]	1 400 [2%]	19 100 [27%]	4 200 [6%]	400 [1%]	10 700 [15%]
2024	51 300 [50%]	2 100 [2%]	22 700 [22%]	5 700 [6%]	500 [1%]	20 200 [20%]
2025	57 500 [53%]	2 200 [2%]	21 600 [20%]	6 000 [6%]	400 [1%]	20 800 [19%]

Notes:

1. Cross-harbour traffic flows on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays), before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays.
2. Figures in brackets denote the percentage share of the respective vehicle type in the total daily traffic flow.
3. "Motorcycle" includes motor tricycles.
4. "Bus" includes public and private buses.
5. "Light bus" includes public and private light buses.
6. The percentages may not add up to 100% due to rounding.

Annex 1

Average Daily Traffic Flows on Weekdays by Vehicle Type and Respective Percentage at the Three RHCs (in Two-way Vehicles) [1&2]

Year	CHT					
	Private car	**Motorcycle [3]**	**Taxi**	**Bus [4]**	**Light bus [5]**	**Goods vehicle**
2023	48 800 [48%]	4 500 [4%]	16 700 [16%]	6 400 [6%]	800 [1%]	24 600 [24%]
2024	53 600 [57%]	3 900 [4%]	17 200 [18%]	5 400 [6%]	600 [1%]	14 100 [15%]
2025	55 800 [60%]	3 600 [4%]	16 300 [17%]	5 200 [6%]	500 [1%]	12 300 [13%]

Notes:
1. Cross-harbour traffic flows on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays), before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays.
2. Figures in brackets denote the percentage share of the respective vehicle type in the total daily traffic flow.
3. "Motorcycle" includes motor tricycles.
4. "Bus" includes public and private buses.
5. "Light bus" includes public and private light buses.
6. The percentages may not add up to 100% due to rounding.

Annex 1

Average Daily Traffic Flows on Weekdays by Vehicle Type and Respective Percentage at the Three RHCs (in Two-way Vehicles) [1&2]

Year	EHC					
	Private car	**Motorcycle [3]**	**Taxi**	**Bus [4]**	**Light bus [5]**	**Goods vehicle**
2023	42 000 [57%]	2 600 [4%]	14 200 [19%]	2 800 [4%]	600 [1%]	11 200 [15%]
2024	40 800 [57%]	2 700 [4%]	12 800 [18%]	3 100 [4%]	600 [1%]	12 000 [17%]
2025	41 400 [58%]	2 700 [4%]	11 900 [17%]	3 200 [4%]	600 [1%]	11 600 [16%]

Notes:

1. Cross-harbour traffic flows on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays), before excluding the days affected by summer holidays and long holidays.
2. Figures in brackets denote the percentage share of the respective vehicle type in the total daily traffic flow.
3. "Motorcycle" includes motor tricycles.
4. "Bus" includes public and private buses.
5. "Light bus" includes public and private light buses.
6. The percentages may not add up to 100% due to rounding.

Annex 2

Design Capacities and Peak-hour [1] Utilisation Rates [2] of the Three RHCs

Tunnel	Design capacity (vehicle/hour)	Peak-hour utilisation rates		
		2023	2024	2025
WHC	4 200	0.9	1.0	1.0
CHT	2 600	1.1	1.1	1.1
EHC	2 600	1.0	1.1	1.1

Notes:

1. Peak hours of the RHCs refer to the busiest one hour from 7:30 a.m. to 10:30 a.m. and from 4:30 p.m. to 7:30 p.m. on weekdays (i.e. Mondays to Fridays, except public holidays).

2. The utilisation rate of tolled tunnels refers to the ratio of average hourly traffic flow to tunnel design capacity provided by toll collection systems. The utilisation rates set out in the table have not taken into account those vehicles queueing to enter the tunnels and do not reflect the actual traffic demand against the design capacity. The actual traffic capacity of the tunnels may be affected by other traffic factors, including the proportions of different types of vehicles using the road section concerned, geometry of the road section, etc. Therefore, a mere comparison between the actual traffic flow and the design capacity may not truly reflect the actual traffic condition.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0402)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

In recent years, the Government has been actively promoting smart mobility, including the development of automated parking systems (APS) and the optimisation of the HKeMeter mobile application. In this connection, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. the estimated expenditure for the construction and planning of APS in 2026-27; and among which the specific estimated amounts for taking forward APS at the automated car parks on the Hong Kong Port Island of the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (HZMB), newly completed government car parks, and short-term tenancy (STT) car park projects;

2. the number of APS parking spaces in operation in various districts of Hong Kong as at the end of February 2026; and whether the current progress aligns with the Government's target of providing no less than 3 000 APS parking spaces by 2026, and the expected date for full achievement of the target;

3. the expenditures for the operation and optimisation of the HKeMeter mobile application in each of the past three financial years (2023-24 to 2025-26) and the estimated expenditure in 2026-27;

4. the number of transactions made through HKeMeter and its proportion in the total number of payment transactions for on-street parking spaces in Hong Kong; and the average monthly number of active users in the past year (2025-26); and

5. whether the Transport Department will earmark any resources in 2026-27 to further enhance the functions of the HKeMeter mobile application, such as including real-time parking vacancy information, extending the time limit for remote payment, or integrating more smart mobility services, in order to improve user experience and parking efficiency; if yes, the details and the estimated expenditure.

Asked by: Hon LEE Tsz-king, Dominic (LegCo internal reference no.: 25)

Reply:

(1) and (2)

The Transport Department (TD) has been implementing public vehicle parking projects with APS in Hong Kong since 2020, and has been actively promoting APS in suitable STT car parks and public works projects. Among them, three SST car parks with APS have already been commissioned. The first public works project with APS is located at Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park, which was commissioned in December 2025. Information on various projects since 2020 is listed at **Annex**. The automated car park project on the Hong Kong Port Island of the HZMB was constructed by the Airport Authority Hong Kong and did not involve any additional government expenditure. The Government is taking forward various projects in accordance with the targets.

(3) The recurrent expenditures for the parking meter system (meter system) in the past three financial years and 2026-27 estimate are as follows:

	2023-24	**2024-25**	**2025-26 (Estimate)**	**2026-27 (Estimate)**
Recurrent Expenditure ($ million)	51	58	62	68

(4) To tie in with the implementation of the new meter system in January 2021, the TD has introduced the HKeMeter mobile application, which has accumulated about 1 million downloads. The meter system processed a total of about 58 million transactions in the financial year of 2025-26 (up to February 2026), with over 60% completed via HKeMeter.

(5) Currently, HKeMeter provides real-time information on metered parking spaces to assist motorists in finding vacant parking spaces, and enables remote payment of parking fees via the mobile application using various electronic payment means. HKeMeter has also been linked to HKeMobility mobile application to offer more diversified and one-stop smart mobility services. The TD will continue to closely monitor the performance of the meter system, gauge users' feedback from various channels such as social media, mobile app stores and the hotline, and keep in view relevant technological developments, with a view to further enhancing the system performance and users' experience.

Annex

Project	APS Type	Commencement of Construction	Expected Commissioning Date	Total Number of Parking Spaces (Number of APS parking spaces)	Estimated Expenditure
A. APSs in STT car parks					
STT Car Park at Hoi Shing Road, Tsuen Wan	Puzzle stacking	December 2020	November 2021 (Commissioned)	245 (78)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Pak Shek Kok, Tai Po	Puzzle stacking	December 2021	December 2022 (Commissioned)	250 (52)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at junction of Yen Chow Street and Tung Chau Street, Sham Shui Po	Puzzle stacking	February 2023	April 2024 (Commissioned)	210 (52)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Hoi Wang Road, Yau Ma Tei	Puzzle stacking	July 2023	2026 (Tentative)	About 200 (117)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Lok Wah Street, Tsz Wan Shan	Puzzle stacking	October 2025	2027 (Tentative)	About 180 (about 40)	Funded by the STT car park operator
STT Car Park at Po Tai Street, Ma On Shan	To be confirmed	October 2025	2027 (Tentative)	About 270 (about 100)	Funded by the STT car park operator

B. APSs in public works projects					
Project	**APS Type**	**Commencement of Construction**	**Expected Commissioning Date**	**Total Number of Parking Spaces (Number of APS parking ppaces)**	**Estimated Expenditure for the Entire Public Works Programme Item[Note 1]**
Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park (i.e. Joint-user Government Office Building in Area 67, Tseung Kwan O)	Puzzle stacking	September 2020	December 2025 (Commissioned)	388 (225)	$5,228.4 M [Note 2]
District Open Space, Sports Centre and Public Vehicle Park at Sze Mei Street	Vertical lifting and horizontal sliding	May 2022	2027 (Tentative)	About 320 (about 160)	$1,605.0 M [Note 3]
Open Space with Public Vehicle Park at Yen Chow Street West, Sham Shui Po	Circular shaft lifting	August 2023	2028 (Tentative)	About 200 (about 170)	$777.9 M [Note 4]
Amenity Complex in Area 103, Ma On Shan	Puzzle stacking	November 2024	2029 (Tentative)	About 350 (about 180)	$2,888.4 M [Note 5]
Town Park with Public Vehicle Park in Area 66, Tseung Kwan O	Puzzle stacking	May 2025	2029 (Tentative)	About 450 (about 300)	$1,208.0 M [Note 6]

Note 1: The estimated expenditure is calculated in money-of-the-day prices and is the approved project estimate for the entire Public Works Programme Item approved by the Finance Committee

Note 2: Including the construction costs for government offices and facilities, general out-patient clinic, job centre, families clinic and dental clinic, child care centre and public car park

Note 3: Including the construction costs for open space, sports centre and public car park

Note 4: Including the construction costs for open space and public car park

Note 5: Including the construction costs for sports centre, indoor heated swimming pool, the Hong Kong Public Libraries New Book Centre, community hall, the Sha Tin District Office's Ma On Shan Sub-office and public car park

Note 6: Including the construction costs for town park and public car park

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0839)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Management of Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the impact on the traffic distribution among the three tunnels (the Eagle's Nest Tunnel and Sha Tin Heights Tunnel, the Lion Rock Tunnel, and the Tate's Cairn Tunnel) in the New Territories East connecting to Kowloon after the implementation of traffic redistribution among the three road harbour crossings (RHCs) and the related improvement measures, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

(1) the average daily vehicle trips of the Eagle's Nest Tunnel and Sha Tin Heights Tunnel, the Lion Rock Tunnel, and the Tate's Cairn Tunnel annually before and after the implementation of the of traffic redistribution (2023, 2024 and 2025) among the three RHCs; the traffic flow and changes in traffic flow for various types of vehicles such as private cars, taxis, and commercial vehicles;

(2) any new measures the Government has in place to improve congestion at the Tate's Cairn Tunnel during peak hours in 2026-27; the specific measures and the expenditure involved;

(3) the estimated cost for the works to expand the bus-bus interchange at the Sha Tin portal of the Tate's Cairn Tunnel in 2026-27; the expected date of completion of the works and its commissioning;

(4) whether the Government will consider adjusting the toll structure of the three tunnels to further utilise the remaining capacity of the Eagle's Nest Tunnel with a view to alleviating the pressure on the Tate's Cairn and Lion Rock Tunnels; if yes, provide the details; if not, provide the reasons; and

(5) whether the Government has assessed the impact of the Central Kowloon Route, upon its expected full commissioning in 2026, on the traffic flow and traffic redistribution effects of the three tunnels in the New Territories East; if yes, provide the results.

Asked by: Hon LEE Tsz-king, Dominic (LegCo internal reference no.: 22)

Reply:

(1) The average daily traffic flows and the daily traffic flows by vehicle type for the Eagle's Nest Tunnel and Sha Tin Heights Tunnel, the Lion Rock Tunnel, and the Tate's Cairn Tunnel (hereinafter referred to as the "three land tunnels (LTs)") for 2023, 2024 and 2025 are set out at **Annex**.

(2), (4) and (5)

The Government has been taking a multi-pronged approach to alleviate traffic pressure by enhancing transport infrastructure, expanding and improving the public transport system and managing road use.

Upon completion of the Tai Po Road (Sha Tin Section) widening works since 2024, motorists travelling between the New Territories East and the urban areas via Route 8 (including the Eagle's Nest Tunnel and Sha Tin Heights Tunnel) have experienced smoother traffic. The Trunk Road T4 in Sha Tin under construction will connect the Shing Mun Tunnel Road, Tsing Sha Highway and Sha Tin Road. Upon completion of the Trunk Road T4 in Sha Tin, residents in the New Territories East, particularly those in Sha Tin East and the vicinity of Ma On Shan, may travel to Tsuen Wan and West Kowloon direct via this trunk road without passing through the Sha Tin town centre. This will further enhance the road network between the New Territories East and the urban areas, thereby alleviating the traffic pressure in the New Territories East. It is expected that the distribution of traffic among the three LTs will change by then, with better utilisation of the current spare capacity of the Eagle's Nest Tunnel and Sha Tin Heights Tunnel.

Route 6, which will be fully commissioned after the completion of the Kowloon Bay section of the Central Kowloon Bypass at the end of this year, will further redistribute the traffic along the east-west major roads in Kowloon, including Lung Cheung Road which links the three LTs. By then, motorists will have more flexibility in choosing tunnels and routings, and the distribution of traffic among the three LTs may also have a change.

We will continue to monitor the overall traffic situation and, based on the latest traffic data, explore whether there is room to adjust the toll structure and levels of the three LTs so as to rationalise traffic flow more effectively.

(3) The estimated expenditure for the works of the proposed bus-bus interchange at the Tate's Cairn in 2026-27 is $2.4 million. The works are expected to be completed and commissioned in 2029.

Annex

Average Daily Traffic Flow by Vehicle Type at the Eagle's Nest Tunnel and Sha Tin Heights Tunnel (in Two-way Vehicles)[1]

Year	Private car, taxi and motorcycle				Commercial vehicle[2]	Total
	Private car	Taxi	Motorcycle	Sub-total		
2023	40 650[3]		900	41 550	18 050	59 610
2024	32 960	9 800	930	43 690 (+5.2%)	19 550 (+8.3%)	63 250 (+6.1%)
2025	34 250	9 200	920	44 380 (+1.6%)	19 190 (-1.9%)	63 570 (+0.5%)

Average Daily Traffic Flow by Vehicle Type at the Lion Rock Tunnel (in Two-way Vehicles)[1]

Year	Private car, taxi and motorcycle				Commercial vehicle[2]	Total
	Private car	Taxi	Motorcycle	Sub-total		
2023	65 600[4]			65 600	20 960	86 560
2024	51 170	13 760	1 570	66 500 (+1.4%)	18 790 (-10.4%)	85 290 (-1.5%)
2025	51 254	12 910	1 480	65 650 (-1.3%)	17 200 (-8.4%)	82 850 (-2.9%)

Annex

Average Daily Traffic Flow by Vehicle Type at the Tate's Cairn Tunnel (in Two-way Vehicles)[1]

Year	Private car, taxi and motorcycle				Commercial vehicle[2]	Total
	Private car	Taxi	Motorcycle	Sub-total		
2023	42 320[5]		1 370	43 690	14 250	57 940
2024	33 030	7 550	1 360	41 940 (-4.0%)	14 900 (+4.5%)	56 840 (-1.9%)
2025	33 470	7 090	1 300	41 850 (-0.2%)	15 020 (+0.8%)	56 870 (+0.1%)

Note:

1. The numbers in the brackets show the year-on-year change.
2. Commercial vehicles include buses, light buses and goods vehicles.
3. The Eagle's Nest Tunnel and Sha Tin Heights Tunnel implemented the free-flow tolling service of HKeToll starting from 5 a.m. on 7 May 2023. Before that, only the combined numbers of private cars and taxis were available.
4. The Lion Rock Tunnel implemented the free-flow tolling service of HKeToll starting from 5 a.m. on 28 May 2023. Before that, only the combined numbers of private cars, taxis and motorcycles were available.
5. The Tate's Cairn Tunnel implemented the free-flow tolling service of HKeToll starting from 5 a.m. on 26 November 2023. Before that, only the combined numbers of private cars and taxis were available.
6. Due to rounding off to the nearest ten, the total may not equal the sum of the individual items.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0840)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Management of Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Following the progressive implementation of HKeToll, the free-flow tolling system, at various government tunnels starting from May 2023, toll booths were replaced. Regarding the total expenditure and operational effectiveness of the system, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the total expenditure of HKeToll, including the specific amounts for system development and design, daily operation and maintenance, customer services and enquiries, publicity and marketing, and other related costs, as at the end of February 2026;

2. the annual numbers of traffic accidents occurred in each tunnel from 2022 to 2025, and whether the numbers of traffic accidents occurred in the toll plazas have increased/decreased since the implementation of HKeToll at various tunnels;

3. whether the Government has earmarked resources to enhance the dissemination of information for HKeToll in 2026-27, including strengthening hotline staff training and improving the functions of the mobile application, so as to improve transparency and service quality; if yes, the details and specific expenditure;

4. the cumulative numbers of enquiries or complaints related to HKeToll received by the Transport Department as at the end of February 2026, broken down by the nature of complaints (including charging errors, failure to recognise vehicle registration marks, account management, delay in the delivery of payment notices, etc.); and

5. the number of concluded cases and their percentage among the above complaints, the number of cases involving refunds and the amount of refunds, and whether the Government has earmarked resources to improve the complaint handling mechanism and shorten the response time in 2026-27; if yes, the details and expenditure?

Asked by: Hon LEE Tsz-king, Dominic (LegCo internal reference no.: 23)

Reply:

1. The approved commitment for the installation of the HKeToll systems at government tolled tunnels and the Tsing Sha Control Area is $945.98 million. In addition, the Government has respectively engaged, through open tender, a toll service provider (TSP) and contractors to provide services for the collection of tolls, operation (including customer services and publicity) and maintenance of the HKeToll backend system and on-site equipment at all government tolled tunnels, etc. Since 2023-24, TD's recurrent expenditures for performing the above tasks under the contracts are $200 million for 2023-24, $230 million for 2024-25 and $250 million for 2025-26 (revised estimate).

2. The numbers of traffic accidents within the tunnel area of each tunnel between 2022 and 2025 are tabulated below:

Tunnel	**Number of traffic accidents**			
	2022	**2023**	**2024**	**2025** [1]
Cross-Harbour Tunnel (CHT) [2]	66	67	40	35
Western Harbour Crossing (WHC) [2]	29	47	98	90
Eastern Harbour Crossing (EHC) [2]	40	32	23	23
Tate's Cairn Tunnel	22	36	22	24
Lion Rock Tunnel	32	33	24	38
Tseung Kwan O Tunnel	45	33	34	22
Shing Mun Tunnels	30	27	35	37
Aberdeen Tunnel	22	24	29	30
Kai Tak Tunnel	28	24	35	24
Tai Lam Tunnel	14	22	24	37
Cheung Tsing Tunnel	5	17	26	24
Tai Wai Tunnel, Sha Tin Heights Tunnel and Eagle's Nest Tunnel	15	16	12	13
Tuen Mun-Chek Lap Kok Tunnel	5	14	11	13
Central-Wan Chai Bypass Tunnel	4	11	12	9
Tseung Kwan O-Lam Tin Tunnel [3]	0	8	6	6
Lung Shan Tunnel and Cheung Shan Tunnel	3	4	8	14
Nam Wan Tunnel	1	3	6	9
Discovery Bay Tunnel Link	0	1	1	0
Airport Tunnel	0	0	0	0
Scenic Hill Tunnel	0	0	2	0
Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section Tunnel) [4]	N/A	N/A	N/A	0

Note 1: Provisional figures.

Note 2: The Government took over WHC in August 2023 and implemented the "633" fixed toll scheme at the three road harbour crossings (RHCs). Subsequently, time-varying tolls were implemented in December 2023.

Note 3: Tseung Kwan O–Lam Tin Tunnel commenced operation on 11 December 2022.

Note 4: Central Kowloon Bypass (Yau Ma Tei Section Tunnel) commenced operation on 21 December 2025.

The annual numbers of traffic accidents in the toll plaza of each tunnel before and after the implementation of HKeToll are tabulated below:

Tunnel (Implementation date of HKeToll)	**Number of traffic accidents**					
	Before implementation [5]			**After implementation [5]**		
	3rd Year	**2nd Year**	**1st Year**	**1st Year**	**2nd Year [6]**	**3rd Year (up to February 2026) [6,7]**
Tai Wai Tunnel, Sha Tin Heights Tunnel and Eagle's Nest Tunnel (7 May 2023)	1	1	8	4	7	1
Shing Mun Tunnels (21 May 2023)	5	16	8	5	2	5
Lion Rock Tunnel (28 May 2023)	20	26	33	11	12	4
CHT [9] (23 July 2023)	42	32	32	19	9	4
WHC [9] (6 August 2023)	13	8	10	15	16	10
EHC [9] (27 August 2023)	16	17	16	7	12	2
Tate's Cairn Tunnel (26 November 2023)	9	6	18	6	5	0
Aberdeen Tunnel (24 December 2023)	5	6	7	5	8	0
Tai Lam Tunnel (31 May 2025)	7	16	22 [6]	11 [6,8]	N/A	N/A

Note 5: The periods before and after implementation are calculated on a 12-month basis. Taking Tai Wai Tunnel, Sha Tin Heights Tunnel and Eagle's Nest Tunnel as examples, the first year before implementation refers to 7 May 2022 to 6 May 2023, the second year before implementation refers to 7 May 2021 to 6 May 2022; the first year after implementation refers to 7 May 2023 to 6 May 2024, and so on.

Note 6: Provisional figures.

Note 7: The tunnels (except Tai Lam Tunnel) have implemented HKeToll for less than three years. Therefore, the numbers of traffic accidents in the third year after the implementation are available up to February 2026.

Note 8: Tai Lam Tunnel has implemented HKeToll for less than one year. Therefore, the number of traffic accidents in the first year after the implementation is available up to February 2026.

Note 9: The Government took over WHC in August 2023 and implemented the "633" fixed toll scheme at the three RHCs. Subsequently, time-varying tolls were implemented in December 2023.

Overall, the numbers of traffic accidents occurred in the toll plaza of most tunnels after the implementation of HKeToll were similar to or lower than those before the implementation of HKeToll. The slight increase in traffic accidents in the toll plaza of WHC may be related to the increase in vehicle flow after the implementation of the new tolls since August 2023.

3. The TD has been closely monitoring TSP's service performance and requiring TSP to provide appropriate staff training to ensure proper responses to public enquiries. TSP also continues to optimise HKeToll service and strive to improve service quality through internal resources.

4-5. Since the implementation of HKeToll up to February 2026, there were about 67 complaints on average per day, accounting for about 0.01% of the overall average daily traffic flow (about 650 000 vehicles) using HKeToll. As the public gradually became familiar with the operation of HKeToll, the number of complaints decreased significantly by about 70% from about 3 500 on average per month in 2023 to about 1 200 in 2025. The complaints in relation to HKeToll are categorised as below:

	Number of complaint cases	
	Related to toll and/or surcharge payment	**Unrelated to toll and surcharge payment**
2023	17 758	10 204
2024	18 751	5 710
2025	12 166	2 193
2026 (Up to February)	1 725	580

Among the above complaints, over 90% have been concluded, while the remaining cases under processing are mainly related to refund of tunnel toll. Since some refunds cannot be made via the original payment method (such as where vehicle owners settled the payment in cash at convenience stores), TSP has to send refund application forms to vehicle owners by email and can only arrange refunds upon receipt of bank account information provided by vehicle owners. The TD and TSP will continue to explore system enhancements and upgrades, including the development of an online platform

for refund applications, with a view to expediting the processing of refund applications and further improving service levels.

In addition, from May 2023 to December 2025, the refund amounts involved in the applications accepted, accounting for about 0.006% of the traffic flow during the same period, were about $730,000. As the handling of complaints and refund applications is part of the requirements under the HKeToll service contract, there is no separate breakdown of the expenditure involved.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2406)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (6) Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The threshold of monthly public transport expenses incurred for receiving the subsidy under the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme (the Scheme) was raised from $400 to $500 since June 2025, while the subsidy rate and cap remain unchanged. Regarding the latest expenditure and usage of the Scheme, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the actual expenditure of the Scheme in each of the past five financial years (from 2021-22 to 2025-26); the estimated expenditure for 2026-27; the rates of change compared to the revised estimate for 2025-26 and the reasons for the change;

2. the average monthly number of beneficiaries and average subsidy amount in each of the past five financial years (from 2021-22 to 2025-26); the number of beneficiaries receiving the maximum amount of subsidy (i.e. $400) and their proportion of the total number of beneficiaries; the estimated number of beneficiaries and average subsidy amount in 2026-27;

3. the changes in the monthly number of beneficiaries and expenditure on the subsidy since the threshold for receiving the subsidy was raised in June 2025 up to end-February this year, compared to the same period before the adjustment; and

4. the administrative costs of the Scheme in each of the past five financial years (from 2021-22 to 2025-26).

Asked by: Hon LEE Tsz-king, Dominic (LegCo internal reference no.: 24)

Reply:

1. and 4.

The total expenditure and recurrent expenditure (excluding the subsidy amount) under the Public Transport Fare Subsidy Scheme (the Scheme) in the financial years from 2021-22 to 2024-25 are as follows:

Financial Year	Total expenditure of the Scheme ($ million)	Recurrent expenditure (excluding the subsidy amount) ($ million)
2021-22	3,363.8	41.8
2022-23	3,162.0	37.4
2023-24	3,535.3	40.1
2024-25	2,482.6	42.0

Note: To allow more commuters to benefit from the Scheme during the COVID-19 pandemic, the Government implemented temporary special measures to temporarily relax the monthly public transport expenses threshold of the Scheme from $400 to $200 and temporarily increase the monthly subsidy cap from $400 to $500 from May 2022 to October 2023. With the expiry of the temporary special measures, the monthly public transport expenses threshold and the monthly subsidy cap were $400 from November 2023 to May 2025.

From 1 June 2025 onwards, the threshold of monthly public transport expenses incurred for receiving the subsidy under the Scheme was raised from $400 to $500. Taking into account the expenditure savings brought about by the adjustment to the Scheme, the estimated total expenditure of the Scheme for the 2026-27 financial year is $2.815 billion, which represents an increase of about $720 million over the revised estimate of $2.096 billion for the 2025-26 financial year, mainly having regard to factors such as increase in public transport patronage and fare adjustments. According to the revised estimate for the 2025-26 financial year, the recurrent expenditure (excluding the subsidy amount) of the Scheme is estimated to be $46 million.

2. The average monthly number of beneficiaries, the average amount of monthly subsidy per beneficiary, the number of beneficiaries receiving the maximum amount of monthly subsidy and their proportion of the total number of beneficiaries in the past five years are as follows:

Year	Average monthly number of beneficiaries ('000)	Average amount of monthly subsidy per beneficiary ($)	Receiving the maximum amount of monthly subsidy	
			Average monthly number of beneficiaries ('000)	Proportion of the total number of beneficiaries
2021	2 999	103	9	0.3%
2022	2 274	104	9	0.4%
2023	3 036	107	15	0.5%
2024	1 988	106	28	1.4%
2025	1 764	106	27	1.5%

The estimated subsidy amount for the 2026-27 financial year is about $2.767 billion.

3. After adjustment to the Scheme, the average monthly subsidy amount from June 2025 to February 2026 was about $162 million, while the average monthly number of beneficiaries was about 1.6 million, representing a decrease of about $52 million and 0.4 million in the average monthly subsidy amount and the average monthly number of beneficiaries respectively as compared with the same period prior to the adjustment (i.e. from June 2024 to February 2025).

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2426)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Since the launch of the Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector - Public Light Bus /Coach Trade (the Scheme), the Public Light Bus (PLB) driver shortage problem has effectively alleviated and the service quality has been enhanced, such as reducing the lost trips. It is also observed that the working attitude of imported drivers are generally good. Regarding the Scheme, please inform this Committee of the following:

1. the up-to-date number of imported drivers with two-year contracts expired whose renewal applications have been approved amongst the number of imported drivers coming to work in Hong Kong under the Scheme; and

2. whether the Government will consider increasing the number of quotas on imported drivers given that the PLB trade is still facing recruitment difficulties; if yes, the details; whether the Government will further implement streamlined measures on application procedures to shorten the processing time; if not, the reasons; and whether there are any other measures to alleviate the driver shortage problem in the transport sectors.

Asked by: Hon LEUNG Chun, Jonathan (LegCo internal reference no.: 30)

Reply:

1. and 2. The Government has all along been concerned about the long standing driver shortage problem faced by the PLB trade. To alleviate the problem of labour shortage in the trade, the Government announced the Scheme in June 2023, and approved a total of 900 PLB driver quotas through two rounds of applications in September 2023 and July 2024 respectively. All applications were vetted by the inter-departmental liaison group (comprising representatives from the Transport and Logistics Bureau, the Labour Department and the Transport Department (TD)). In addition, as for the gradual expiry of the contracts of the first batch of imported workers from the end of 2025, the TD announced the quota renewal arrangements in August 2025. The operators with allocated quotas should submit renewal applications to the TD five months prior to the expiry of the contracts of their imported drivers. As at end-February 2026, 324 PLB

driver quotas have been granted with approval for renewal. The TD will continue to process the renewal applications received, including reviewing whether or not the operators continue to meet the criteria of the Scheme (including maintaining the manning ratio of 1:2 for imported labours to full-time local staff of 1:2, the wage levels of imported labours at not less than the median monthly wages of the relevant posts, and complying with local driver recruitment requirements, etc). At present, the TD has no plan to adjust the total number of quotas. In future, the TD will continue to pay attention to the changes in the local labour market and the manpower situation, review the implementation of the Scheme and assess the manpower demand of the industry. At the same time, the TD will maintain close liaison with various stakeholders, and enhance information dissemination through the stakeholders consultative group as well as review the Scheme in a timely manner with reference to the opinions.

Moreover, the TD has been maintaining close communication with the trade and keeping in view the situation of driver shortage through regular meetings and daily service monitoring. Apart from the Scheme, the Government continues to implement various measures with a view to assisting and encouraging the trade to boost local recruitment, including the relaxation of application requirements for driving licence for commercial vehicles, co-ordination of the trade's participation in various employment schemes, promotion of diversified local recruitment channels and introduction of relevant training courses of the trade, etc. At the same time, through the collaboration of the TD and the Employees Retraining Board (ERB), ERB as well as the PLB operators and third-party training organisations launched the placement-tied driving training scheme in 2024 with the green minibus (GMB) as a pilot with a view to encouraging local workers to join the PLB trade. The first batch of trainees was deployed to driving duties for designated GMB routes (after completing the training courses and obtaining the relevant driving licences) in the second quarter of 2025. ERB has continued the placement-tied driving training scheme for the GMB trade in 2025. Some trainees of the second batch who obtained the required driving licences and completed route training, have been deployed to driving duties for designated GMB routes in January 2026.

The Government will continue to encourage operators to improve the remuneration packages of their staff through various means, such as increasing wages and paid leave, so as to create a more desirable working environment and attract more new blood to the trade, as well as to employ part-time drivers to meet the manpower demand for services during peak hours.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0027)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the implementation progress of automated parking systems (APS), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the current total number of parking spaces provided in automated car parks constructed by the Government;

2. the average utilisation rates of the government automated car parks in the past year;

3. the project details and site selection of the planned automated car parks in the future; the latest progress and expected completion dates of the relevant projects; and

4. whether the Government will implement more measures to encourage private developers to adopt APS; if yes, the details; if no, the reasons.

Asked by: Hon LEUNG Man-kwong (LegCo internal reference no.: 32)

Reply:

1. and 3.

The Transport Department (TD) has been implementing public vehicle parking projects with APS in Hong Kong since 2020, and has been actively promoting APS in suitable short-term tenancy (STT) car parks and public works projects. Among them, three STT car parks with APS have already been commissioned, locating at Hoi Shing Road in Tsuen Wan, Pak Shek Kok in Tai Po and Tung Chau Street in Sham Shui Po. The first public works project with APS is located at the Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park, which was commissioned in December 2025. Information of the APS projects implemented since 2020 is listed at **Annex**.

2. For government car parks, the Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park was commissioned in December 2025. The relevant departments are collecting data in the coming months to calculate the average utilisation rate.

For STT car parks, the three car parks already commissioned are funded and constructed by the relevant tenants, and are operated on a commercial basis. According to the information provided by the tenants, the average utilisation rates of APS in the relevant car parks are around 70% to 90% in 2025.

4. The Government had consulted and gathered valuable feedback on how to facilitate the adoption of APS in private development projects from relevant stakeholders, including the Real Estate Developers Association of Hong Kong, professional bodies, the Hong Kong, China Automobile Association, car park operators and APS suppliers, etc. Following the promulgation of the Guideline for Implementing Mechanized Vehicle Parking Systems by the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department, the TD updated the Transport Planning and Design Manual in 2022 to include the design considerations and technical requirements of APS for industry's reference. The Government consider that implementation of various public vehicle parking projects with APS can provide useful reference for the industry and strengthen the confidence of developers and private property owners in the application of APS. The Government will timely share with the stakeholders the experience gained from the implementation of APS projects, with a view to facilitating a wider and more efficient application of APS in Hong Kong by the Government and the trade in the future.

Annex

Project	APS Type	Commencement of Construction	Expected Commissioning Date	Total Number of Parking Spaces (Number of APS parking spaces)
A. APS in STT car parks				
STT Car Park at Hoi Shing Road, Tsuen Wan	Puzzle stacking	December 2020	November 2021 (Commissioned)	245 (78)
STT Car Park at Pak Shek Kok, Tai Po	Puzzle stacking	December 2021	December 2022 (Commissioned)	250 (52)
STT Car Park at junction of Yen Chow Street and Tung Chau Street, Sham Shui Po	Puzzle stacking	February 2023	April 2024 (Commissioned)	210 (52)
STT Car Park at Hoi Wang Road, Yau Ma Tei	Puzzle stacking	July 2023	2026 (Tentative)	About 200 (117)
STT Car Park at Lok Wah Street, Tsz Wan Shan	Puzzle stacking	October 2025	2027 (Tentative)	About 180 (About 40)
STT Car Park at Po Tai Street, Ma On Shan	To be confirmed	October 2025	2027 (Tentative)	About 270 (About 100)
B. APS in public works projects				
Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park (i.e. Joint-user Government Office Building in Area 67, Tseung Kwan O)	Puzzle stacking	September 2020	December 2025 (Commissioned)	388 (225)
District Open Space, Sports Centre and Public Vehicle Park at Sze Mei Street	Vertical lifting and horizontal sliding	May 2022	2027 (Tentative)	About 320 (About 160)
Open Space with Public Vehicle Park at Yen Chow Street West, Sham Shui Po	Circular shaft lifting	August 2023	2028 (Tentative)	About 200 (About 170)
Amenity Complex in Area 103, Ma On Shan	Puzzle stacking	November 2024	2029 (Tentative)	About 350 (About 180)

Project	APS Type	Commencement of Construction	Expected Commissioning Date	Total Number of Parking Spaces (Number of APS parking spaces)
Town Park with Public Vehicle Park in Area 66, Tseung Kwan O	Puzzle stacking	May 2025	2029 (Tentative)	About 450 (About 300)

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB257**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2783)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the supply of parking spaces in Hong Kong, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

(1) the number of parking spaces in various districts of Hong Kong, with a breakdown by private car and motorcycle, in the past year;

(2) the utilisation rates of various government car parks in the past year;

(3) the number of additional parking spaces planned to be provided in various districts, with a breakdown by private car and motorcycle, in the coming three years;

(4) the numbers and percentages of government and short-term tenancy (STT) car parks that are currently accessible from the HKeMobility platform; whether the Government will explore with the Housing Authority and the Housing Society consolidating the real-time data of public housing estate car parks onto the platform;

(5) whether the Government has a mechanism in place to assess the parking demand in various districts; if yes, the specific indicators; if not, the reasons.

Asked by: Hon LEUNG Man-kwong (LegCo internal reference no.: 31)

Reply:

(1) The numbers of private car (PC) and motorcycle (MC) parking spaces in the 18 districts in Hong Kong as at December 2025 are at **Annex 1**.

(2) The utilisation rates of the public car parks managed by the Transport Department (TD), the Government Property Agency (GPA) and the Leisure and Cultural Services Department (LCSD) as at December 2025 are at **Annex 2**, **Annex 3** and **Annex 4** respectively.

(3) The Government expects to provide 12 000 additional parking spaces across the territory in 2025 and 2026, covering both PCs and MCs. Moreover, the first three public vehicle parks (PVPs)[Note] implemented under the "single site, multiple use" principle have been commissioned, providing a total of about 680 PC parking spaces and 35 MC parking spaces. With the successive commissioning of more PVP projects, including the PVP at Area 99 in Tung Chung, District Open Space, Sports Centre and PVP at Sze Mei Street, redevelopment of Yuen Long Stadium and Kwun Tong Composite Development Project, a total of about 460 PC parking spaces and about 60 MC parking spaces will be provided. Together with other development projects and the ongoing short- and medium-term parking measures, the new supply of parking spaces will further increase over the next few years. The TD will continue to step up its efforts, focusing on areas with a shortage of parking spaces to increase the provision of on-street parking spaces as far as practicable. It will also continue to stipulate the provision of a minimum number of commercial vehicle (CV) parking spaces in suitable short-term tenancy (STT) car parks.

Note: Including Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park in Sheung Shui, Pak Shing Kok Road Public Car Park in Tseung Kwan O and Tseung Kwan O Government Offices Public Car Park.

(4) The TD has been encouraging operators of public car parks to provide real-time parking vacancy information to facilitate motorists' search for parking spaces. At present, "HKeMobility" application provides real-time information on 225 government car parks and 77 STT car parks, accounting for about 40% of the 758 car parks providing real-time information covered by "HKeMobility".

Besides, the TD has been liaising with the Hong Kong Housing Authority and the Hong Kong Housing Society. At present, "HKeMobility" provides real-time parking space information on 108 car parks in public housing estates managed by the Hong Kong Housing Authority and the Hong Kong Housing Society.

(5) The TD has been monitoring the demand for and supply of parking spaces in various districts in the territory and has comprehensively increased parking supply through a multi-pronged approach. The ratio of parking spaces to licensed vehicles across the territory has increased progressively in recent years and the relevant measures have gradually shown results. For PCs, the ratio steadily increased from 1:1.10 in 2020 to 1:1.14 in 2025, while that for CVs also increased from 1:0.64 to 1:0.67. The Government continues to actively pursue a host of short-term and medium-to-long-term measures to increase the supply of parking spaces.

Parking demand in each district depends on various factors, including the overall economic situation, local population structure and economic activity patterns. The demand for PC parking spaces is influenced by household income and housing types, while the parking demand for CVs hinges on the local demand for and supply ofl parking spaces, mode of operation, parking habits, and places of residence and work of drivers. Hence, when planning and implementing car park projects, the TD will assess demand at the district level, including reviewing the illegal parking situation in the vicinity and nearby facilities and amenities, with a view to achieving a proper match between the demand and supply.

As announced in the Transport Strategy Blueprint, the TD will initiate a new round of parking demand and supply study in 2026 to review the existing parking facilities and the parking demand and supply of various types of vehicles, in particular CVs. The study results and recommendations are expected to be released in 2027. In addition to analysing the demand-supply gap for CV parking spaces, the study will also estimate the medium- and long-term demand for parking spaces in various areas.

Annex 1

Numbers of PC and MC parking spaces in 18 districts as at December 2025[Note]

District	Number of parking spaces	
	PC	**MC**
Central & Western	39 126	1 604
Wan Chai	39 257	1 435
Eastern	46 916	2 810
Southern	41 083	2 060
Yau Tsim Mong	35 684	2 219
Sham Shui Po	31 797	2 399
Kowloon City	55 498	2 630
Wong Tai Sin	20 580	2 591
Kwun Tong	48 513	5 197
Tsuen Wan	38 674	2 049
Tuen Mun	44 245	2 217
Yuen Long	44 720	2 142
North	23 277	1 071
Tai Po	34 276	1 303
Sai Kung	46 029	3 760
Sha Tin	76 131	3 623
Kwai Tsing	36 109	3 331
Islands	21 751	1 001
Total	**723 666**	**43 442**

Note: The above parking information is collated from the data provided by various departments or the concerned car park management companies or operators, and is for general reference only. The actual number of parking spaces may vary as the departments, management companies or operators responsible for managing the car parks may make adjustments to the numbers/types of parking spaces to suit their own requirements.

Annex 2

Utilisation rates of car parks operated by the TD in 2025

District	Car park	Number of parking spaces (except those for MCs) [Note]	Average utilisation rate (%) of parking spaces	
			From 10:00 am to 6:00 pm	From 6:00 pm to 10:00 am
Central and Western	Star Ferry	377	80	28
	City Hall	170	51	18
	Rumsey Street	829	60	34
	Kennedy Town	195	87	88
Wan Chai	Tin Hau	428	73	61
Eastern	Shau Kei Wan	385	74	74
Southern	Aberdeen	293	62	78
Wong Tai Sin	Sheung Fung Street	267	72	79
	Wong Tai Sin	25	33	44
Kwai Tsing	Kwai Fong	511	77	74
Tsuen Wan	Tsuen Wan	545	77	76

Note: The number of parking spaces at Wong Tai Sin Car Park is the number of parking spaces for coaches/goods vehicles (over 5.5 tonnes); and the numbers of parking spaces at the remaining ten car parks are the numbers of parking spaces for PCs/van-type light goods vehicles.

District	Car park	Average utilisation rate (%) of parking spaces for MCs		
		Number of MC parking spaces	From 10:00 am to 6:00 pm	From 6:00 pm to 10:00 am
Central and Western	Star Ferry	37	65	45
	City Hall	27	77	68
	Rumsey Street	164	74	68
	Kennedy Town	37	72	77
Wan Chai	Tin Hau	75	79	80
Eastern	Shau Kei Wan	72	71	78
Southern	Aberdeen	51	69	75
Wong Tai Sin	Sheung Fung Street	74	68	79
Kwai Tsing	Kwai Fong	93	80	78
Tsuen Wan	Tsuen Wan	34	69	67

Annex 3

Average utilisation rates (%) of public car parks managed by the GPA in 2025

District	Car park	Average utilisation rate (%)
		2025 (Note 1)
Central & Western	Queensway Government Offices	32
Wan Chai	No car park under GPA's management	
Eastern	North Point Government Offices	32
	Chai Wan Municipal Services Building (Note 2)	60
Southern	No car park under GPA's management	
Yau Tsim Mong	West Kowloon Government Offices	43
Sham Shui Po	Cheung Sha Wan Government Offices (Note 3)	54
Kowloon City	Tokwawan Market and Government Offices	97
	Trade and Industry Tower	31
Wong Tai Sin	No car park under GPA's management	
Kwun Tong	Shun Lee Disciplined Services Quarters (Note 2)	85
Tsuen Wan	No car park under GPA's management	
Tuen Mun	Tuen Mun Government Offices	9
Yuen Long	Yuen Long District Office Building	43
North	North District Government Offices	67
	Heung Yuen Wai Boundary Control Point (Note 2)	51
	Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park (Note 2)	54
Tai Po	Tai Po Government Offices	86
Sai Kung	Sai Kung Government Offices	25
	Tseung Kwan O Government Offices (Note 2) (Note 4)	-
	Chinese Medicine Hospital of Hong Kong (Note 2) (Note 5)	-
Sha Tin	Sha Tin Government Offices	33
	New Territories (Shatin) Forensic Medicine Centre (Note 2)	23
Kwai Tsing	No car park under GPA's management	
Islands	Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge Hong Kong Port (Note 2) (Note 6)	19

Note 1: These are the average utilisation rates of parking spaces of the car parks during the operating hours from January to December 2025 provided by the contractors.

Note 2: The car parks at Chai Wan Municipal Services Building, Shun Lee Disciplined Services Quarters, Heung Yuen Wai Boundary Control Point, Ka Fu Fong Public Car Park, Tseung Kwan O Government Offices, The Chinese Medicine Hospital of Hong Kong, the New Territories (Shatin) Forensic Medicine Centre and Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge Hong Kong Port are all-day fee-charging public car parks. The remaining properties in the above table are Joint-User General Office Buildings where the parking spaces are open for public use during non-office hours only.

Note 3: A portion of the fee-paying public car park in the building provides 24-hour parking spaces. The remaining parking spaces are for user departments of the Joint-User General Office Buildings and are open for public use during non-office hours only.

Note 4: The car park at Tseung Kwan O Government Offices commenced operation in mid-December 2025. The contractor provides the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours starting from January 2026.

Note 5: The car park at The Chinese Medicine Hospital of Hong Kong commenced operation in mid-December 2025. The contractor provides the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours starting from January 2026.

Note 6: The lease of the fee-charging public car park at Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge Hong Kong Port has been managed by the Airport Authority Hong Kong since 16 July 2025. The relevant data are the average utilisation rates of the parking spaces during the operating hours from January to June 2025.

Annex 4

Utilisation rates of public car parks managed by the LCSD in 2025

District	Average utilisation rate
Central & Western	41%
Wan Chai	51%
Eastern	41%
Southern	48%
Yau Tsim Mong	29%
Sham Shui Po	24%
Kowloon City	70%
Wong Tai Sin	31%
Kwun Tong	44%
Tsuen Wan	24%
Tuen Mun	49%
Yuen Long	38%
North	52%
Tai Po	29%
Sai Kung	38%
Sha Tin	42%
Kwai Tsing	47%
Islands	22%

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB258**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1342)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (4) Management of Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Transport Department (TD) is responsible for coordinating the maintenance and renovation of ferry piers. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the number of ferry piers and public piers currently in use in Hong Kong;

2. in each of the past five years, the locations of ferry piers and public piers where maintenance and renovation work is carried out and the respective expenditure; and

3. whether the Government will consider expediting the enhancement of the public piers and associated landing facilities of the outlying islands and rural areas to facilitate visits by tourists; if yes, what are the arrangements and the expenditure involved?

Asked by: Hon SHIU ka-fai (LegCo internal reference no.26)

Reply:

1. At present, there are a total of 29 ferry piers for use by licensed and franchised ferry routes in Hong Kong, and about 130 public piers for use by vessels.

2. The TD is responsible for the daily management of 26 of these ferry piers and 65 public piers. Various works departments (including the Architectural Services Department (ArchSD), the Civil Engineering and Development Department (CEDD) and the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department (EMSD) are responsible for the repair and maintenance of those ferry piers. The CEDD is responsible for the repair and maintenance of public piers. In the past five years (2021-22 to 2025-26), the major works projects completed by the relevant works departments at the ferry piers and the expenditures involved are set out at **Annex.** Overall speaking, the CEDD's total expenditure on public piers was about $81 million.

   The TD does not maintain information on the repair and maintenance of piers managed by other departments.

3. Through the Pier Improvement Programme (PIP), the Government enhanced the public pier facilities at various remote areas in the New Territories and outlying islands. The Programme is led by the Development Bureau and implemented by the CEDD. As for the public piers under the daily management of the TD, the TD will regularly arrange on-site surveys to review their usage and state of repair, and will coordinate the repair and maintenance work carried out by the CEDD to keep those piers in good condition for the convenience of visitors and other users. The relevant work is undertaken by the existing staff of the TD, and there is no separate breakdown of the expenditure involved.

Annex

The major works projects completed by the relevant works departments at the ferry piers in the past five years and the expenditures involved

Financial year	Works department	Ferry pier	Project content	Expenditure involved ($ million)
2021-22	ArchSD	Central Pier No. 4	Refurbishment of roofing system	2.21
		Central Pier No. 6		2.65
		Central Pier No. 7	External wall painting works	2.38
		Kwun Tong Ferry Pier	Refurbishment of roofing system, painting, and works for installation of railings	3.20
	CEDD	North Point (West) Ferry Pier	Large-scale repair and maintenance works for the pier deck and structure(s) below	2.27
		Mui Wo Ferry Pier		1.28
2022-23	ArchSD	Central Pier No. 5	Refurbishment of roofing system	3.16
	CEDD	Hung Hom (South) Ferry Pier	Large-scale repair and maintenance works for the pier deck and structure(s) below	1.72
		Hung Hom (North) Ferry Pier		0.66
2023-24	ArchSD	Central Pier No. 3	Refurbishment of roofing system and finishes, interior painting, toilets, etc.; and improvement of electrical installations and barrier-free access facilities, etc.	1.80
		North Point (West) Ferry Pier		2.73
		Hung Hom (South) Ferry Pier		4.92
	CEDD	Hung Hom (South) Ferry Pier	Large-scale repair and maintenance works for the pier deck and structure(s) below	0.21
		Hung Hom (North) Ferry Pier		0.79
		Yung Shue Wan Ferry Pier		0.77
		North Point Vehicular Ferry Pier		0.54
2024-25	CEDD	Hung Hom (South) Ferry Pier	Large-scale repair and maintenance works for the pier deck and structure(s) below	0.20
		Hung Hom (North) Ferry Pier		0.07

Financial year	Works department	Ferry pier	Project content	Expenditure involved ($ million)
		Yung Shue Wan Ferry Pier		1.22
		North Point Vehicular Ferry Pier		0.79
	EMSD	North Point Vehicular Ferry Pier	Maintenance works for lift and ramp	7.30
2025-26	ArchSD	Central Pier No. 4	Repair and maintenance works for floor and external wall finishes etc.	4.23
		Central Pier No. 5		2.50
		Central Pier No. 6		3.96
		North Point (East) Ferry Pier	Refurbishment of roofing system and finishes, railings, interior painting, etc.	4.20
	CEDD	Yung Shue Wan Ferry Pier	Large-scale repair and maintenance works for the pier deck and structure(s) below	0.13
		Kwun Tong Ferry Pier		1.63
		Peng Chau Ferry Pier		0.56
	EMSD	Mui Wo Ferry Pier (Southern Berth)	Maintenance works for lift and ramp	1.51
		Tung Chung Development Pier		1.94

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1507)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Given the dire need to improve the traffic in the New Territories North, please advise this Committee of the following:

1. whether any provision has been reserved in the 2026-27 Budget for a feasibility study or preliminary design for road improvements in Sheung Shui and its vicinity (such as building a new road straddling Kai Leng roundabout); if yes, the relevant expenditure and timetable; if no, given the frequent traffic congestion at present, whether the Government will consider including the project in the relevant improvement plan and commencing the study immediately;

2. as the Transport Department has planned to install the real-time adaptive traffic signal system at about 50 suitable independent signalised junctions across the territory in phases from 2026, regarding the heavy traffic flow at the Tai Tau Leng Roundabout and surrounding junctions in Sheung Shui, whether the Government will include these junctions in the above 50 independent signalised junctions or in the next phase of the expansion plan for linked signalised junctions; if yes, the costs for installation and trials involved and the estimated commissioning dates; if no, the reasons and specific measures taken to improve traffic conditions.

Asked by: Hon TAM Chun-kwok (LegCo internal reference no.: 18)

Reply:

1. To alleviate the traffic in the North District, the Government is actively taking forward various transport infrastructure projects, including Fanling Bypass (Western Section), widening of Fanling Highway between Kwu Tung North and Tai Tau Ling, and Po Shek Wu Road Flyover connecting to Fanling Highway westbound. These infrastructure projects have been included in the Remaining Phase of Site Formation and Engineering Infrastructure Works at Kwu Tung North New Development Area and Fanling North New Development Area – Construction (Project Number: 828CL), for which funding was approved by the Legislative Council (LegCo) in June 2024. The Civil Engineering and Development Department (CEDD) is pressing ahead with the above construction

works, which are expected to be completed in 2031. The Fanling Bypass (Eastern Section) is expected to be first commissioned for public use in late April or early May this year.

In addition, the CEDD has planned to carry out improvement works in the vicinity of So Kwun Po Interchange (also known as Kai Leng Roundabout), which includes the construction of a new north-south link road straddling So Kwun Po Interchange, to improve the current traffic conditions at the interchange. Tenders in respect of the works were invited in November 2025. It is proposed that the works project be submitted to the LegCo for consultation in the second quarter of 2026, with a view to completing the works in about five and a half years after funding approval is obtained from the Finance Committee.

2. The Transport Department (TD) is implementing the real-time adaptive traffic signal system (RTATSS) at about 50 suitable independent signalised junctions across the territory. By installing the ancillary equipment such as sensors and computing system, the traffic signals can be adjusted in response to real-time vehicular and pedestrian flows, thereby reducing delay when passing through the junction. It is expected that RTATSS will be installed and commissioned progressively starting from the second half of 2026 for completion by 2027.

As the Tai Tau Leng Roundabout in Sheung Shui is not a signalised junction and its adjacent junctions (such as the junction of Fan Kam Road and Castle Peak Road) experience rather high peak-hour traffic flows and are almost saturated, leaving no room for flexible adjustment of the traffic signals, these junctions are not included in the above plan. In fact, the CEDD is currently constructing a vehicular flyover at Tai Tau Leng Roundabout to connect Po Shek Wu Road and Fanling Highway westbound, the completion of which will help divert some traffic from Sheung Shui to Yuen Long and alleviate the traffic pressure at the roundabout. To further improve the traffic conditions at Fan Kam Road and Tai Tau Leng Roundabout, the TD has commissioned the CEDD to provide an exclusive left-turn lane from Fan Kam Road to Fanling Highway (Yuen Long bound) at the roundabout, allowing northbound vehicles on Fan Kam Road to gain direct access to Fanling Highway without entering the roundabout. The works are expected to be completed by the end of 2027. The TD will continue to co-ordinate with relevant government departments to expedite the completion of various transport infrastructure projects.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1517)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Under Matters Requiring Special Attention in 2026-27, it is mentioned that the Government will continue to oversee the improvement works to existing cycle tracks and cycle parking facilities in new towns. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. What are the specific locations, scopes and works schedule of the ongoing or planned improvement works to existing cycle tracks in new towns? What progress is expected to be made on these works projects, and what is the estimated expenditure allocated for them in 2026-27?

2. How does the Government assess whether the current supply of cycle parking facilities is sufficient? In the improvement works, what are the locations in various new towns where additional or enhanced cycle parking spaces will be provided, and how many such spaces be added or upgraded at each location?

3. How will the Government address the issue of frequent illegal bicycle parking in the New Territories North?

Asked by: Hon TAM Chun-kwok (LegCo internal reference no.: 35)

Reply:

1. The specific locations of the current ongoing and planned improvement works to existing cycle tracks in new towns are at **Annex**. Of these, the Highways Department is carrying out improvement works to the cycle tracks in Tseung Kwan O and the estimates for 2026-27 is about $580,000. As for the other improvement works under planning, the Government will continue to review the use of public resources, the effectiveness of works projects, and the priority of cycle track improvement works, and will adjust the timetable and prepare the expenditure forecasts accordingly, having regard to the latest situation.

2. to 3.

It is the Government's policy to foster a "bicycle-friendly" environment where road safety considerations and circumstances permit. To this end, we will provide cycle tracks and related ancillary facilities in new development areas (NDAs) and new towns, and continue to improve existing facilities, with a view to encouraging the public to use bicycles for recreational or short-distance commuting purposes, thereby reducing their reliance on mechanised transport. Nevertheless, given the heavy traffic in urban areas and road safety consideration, the public is not encouraged to use bicycles as a daily mode of transport.

As at December 2025, there were about 66 000 public bicycle parking spaces across the territory, among which about 42 000 are under the management of the Transport Department (TD) and the rest are provided by departments such as the Housing Department (mainly in its housing estates) and the Leisure and Cultural Services Department, etc. The improvement works to cycling facilities in new towns as set out in **Annex** are expected to increase the number of bicycle parking spaces by around 800. To meet future demand, we are studying to include bicycle parking spaces as ancillary facilities within land uses, require suitable new development projects to provide sufficient bicycle parking spaces according to their land use and scale. We will also liaise with relevant local stakeholders (including District Councils) to understand local demand for bicycle parking spaces, and will continue to identify suitable locations in various NDAs to provide additional public bicycle parking spaces for use by the public and by shared bicycles. This arrangement will further foster a "bicycle-friendly" environment and help mitigate the problem of illegal bicycle parking on pavements.

Regarding illegally parked and abandoned bicycles, relevant departments including the District Offices under the Home Affairs Department, the District Lands Offices, the TD, the Hong Kong Police Force and the Food and Environmental Hygiene Department, etc. currently conduct joint operations as necessary based on actual circumstances and needs to clear illegally parked or abandoned bicycles. In 2025, a total of 89 joint operations were conducted in the North and Yuen Long Districts by the relevant departments, and a total of over 5 000 illegally parked or abandoned bicycles being removed. The Government will keep closely monitoring the situation in various districts and review the effectiveness of the operations from time to time and continue to take forward the related work.

Annex

Locations of improvement works to cycle tracks and cycling facilities in new towns [Note 1]

New town	Ongoing or planned cycle track improvement works [Note 2]	Locations for provision of additional bicycle parking spaces
Tin Shui Wai	- Tin Fu Court - Tin Kwai Road - Tin Sau Road - Tin Shing Road - Tin Shui Estate - Tin Shui Road - Tin Wing Road - Tin Yat Estate - Tin Ying Road - Wetland Park Road	- Hung Shui Kiu Light Rail (LR) Station - Tin Kwai Road - Tin Shing Road - Tin Yiu Road
Yuen Long	- Au Tau Interchange - Fuk Hi Street - Tai Tong Road - Wang Lee Street	- Fung Yau Street North - Ma Tin Road - Yau San Street
Tuen Mun	- Tsing Shan Tsuen LR Station - Ming Kum Road	- Siu Hong LR Station - Tuen Mun Hospital LR Station - Yau Oi Bridge
Tsuen Wan		- Tsuen Wan West MTR Station
Tung Chung	- Tat Tung Road - Tung Chung Development Pier - Tung Chung Waterfront Road - Tung Chung Road - Yu Tung Road	- Man Tung Road - Tung Chung MTR Station - Tat Tung Road - Yu Tung Road
Tseung Kwan O	- Po Lam Road North - Sheung Ning Playground - Sheung Ning Road	- Lohas Park Road - Tiu Keng Leng MTR Station - Tseung Kwan O MTR Station - Po Ning Road - Sheung Ning Road
Sha Tin/ Ma On Shan	- Fo Tan Road - Ma On Shan Road	- Ma On Shan Road - Tai Shui Hang MTR Station - Ning Tai Road - On Kwan Street - Shui Chuen Au Street - On Muk Street
Tai Po	- Nam Wan Road - On Po Road	- Tai Po Market MTR Station - Nam Wan Road
Fanling/ Sheung Shui	- Cheung Wah Estate - Ching Hiu Road - Fan Kam Road	- Fan Leng Lau Road - Jockey Club Road - Lung Sum Avenue

New town	Ongoing or planned cycle track improvement works [Note 2]	Locations for provision of additional bicycle parking spaces
	- Jockey Club Road - Ma Sik Road - Fanling MTR Station - Near Fanling Highway - Pak Wo Road - So Kwun Po Road	- San Wan Road - Wah Ming Road - Wo Muk Road - Wo Mun Street

Note 1: Locations listed in this Annex may include more than one site at the same location.

Note 2: Examples of improvement works include provision of additional safety facilities at some sharp bends, steep ramps and pedestrian crossings.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB261**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2421)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (000) Operating Expenses

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the supply of parking spaces for commercial vehicles (CVs) and motorcycles (MCs), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

(a) the number of first registered MCs and the total number of MCs in the territory in each of the past three years;

(b) the number and percentage of MC parking spaces, set out by District Council district;

(c) the number of fixed penalty notices against illegal parking involving MCs in the past three years by District Council district; and

(d) whether the Government has any plan to construct new MC parking spaces; if yes, the locations of the sites selected, number of parking spaces and expected completion dates, set out by project.

Asked by: Hon TANG Ka-piu (LegCo internal reference no.: 14)

Reply:

(a) The numbers of first registered MCs and registered MCs as at the end of the year concerned in the past three years are tabulated as follows:

Year	No. of first registered MCs	No. of registered MCs (as at the end of the year concerned)
2023	4 843	108 674
2024	4 033	108 883
2025	3 785	110 284

(b) The numbers of MC parking spaces in the 18 districts and their proportions of the total number of MC parking spaces in the territory as at December 2025 are at **Annex**.

(c) According to records of the computer system of the Transport Department (TD), the fixed penalty notices (FPNs) issued to MCs against illegal parking under the Fixed Penalty (Traffic Contraventions) Ordinance (Cap. 237) by the Hong Kong Police Force are categorised by the three regions of Hong Kong Island, Kowloon and New Territories. The relevant figures for the past three years are tabulated as follows:

Region	**No. of FPNs against illegal parking of MCs**		
	2023	**2024**	**2025**
Hong Kong Island	31 684	20 917	15 763
Kowloon	93 085	70 787	62 069
New Territories	67 048	56 480	48 718
Total	**191 817**	**148 184**	**126 550**

(d) Hong Kong has a well-developed public transport network, and the Government encourages the public to use public transport services as far as possible. Nevertheless, where circumstances permit, the Government also increases, where appropriate, the supply of parking spaces for private cars and MCs, including the following measures related to MCs:

(a) Utilising spaces underneath flyovers to designate MC parking spaces where feasible;
(b) Opening up more MC parking spaces at government buildings for public use during non-office hours;
(c) Exploring suitable on-street locations for the provision of MC parking spaces where traffic conditions permit;
(d) Providing MC parking spaces for public use in suitable "Government, Institution or Community" facilities and public open space projects in accordance with the principle of "single site, multiple use"; and
(e) Providing MC parking spaces in development projects in accordance with the parking standards under the Hong Kong Planning Standards and Guidelines.

Among the public vehicle parks (PVPs) developed under the "single site, multiple use" principle, three have already been completed. One is in Sheung Shui and the other two are in Tseung Kwan O, providing a total of 35 MC parking spaces. Four PVPs, in Tung Chung, San Po Kong, Kwun Tong and Yuen Long respectively, are expected to be completed successively between 2026 and 2027, providing a total of about 60 MC parking spaces. The remaining PVPs under construction will also provide an additional 190 MC parking spaces.

In addition, the Housing Department and the TD are working closely together to suitably increase the supply of MC parking spaces in existing and future subsidised housing development projects where circumstances permit. With the gradual completion of housing development projects and PVPs in the future, as well as the TD's ongoing efforts to identify suitable locations to designate more on-street parking spaces, the supply of MC parking spaces will continue to increase.

Annex

Numbers of MC parking spaces in 18 districts in Hong Kong and their proportions of the total number of MC parking spaces in the territory

District	No. of parking spaces	Proportion
Central & Western	1 604	4%
Wan Chai	1 435	3%
Eastern	2 810	6%
Southern	2 060	5%
Yau Tsim Mong	2 219	5%
Sham Shui Po	2 399	6%
Kowloon City	2 630	6%
Wong Tai Sin	2 591	6%
Kwun Tong	5 197	12%
Tsuen Wan	2 049	5%
Tuen Mun	2 217	5%
Yuen Long	2 142	5%
North	1 071	2%
Tai Po	1 303	3%
Sai Kung	3 760	9%
Sha Tin	3 623	8%
Kwai Tsing	3 331	8%
Islands	1 001	2%
Total	**43 442**	**100%**

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB262**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1979)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Transport Department (TD) has implemented the new vehicle registration and licensing regime on 22 December 2025 and will issue a notice to registered owners of vehicles unlicensed for two years or more. Vehicle owners must, within three months of the date of notice, renew the licence, or submit the relevant supporting documents to the TD and cancel the registration of such vehicles after scrapping them or permanently shipping them out of Hong Kong. Please advise this Committee of the following:

1. the relevant manpower arrangements and publicity expenditure for the implementation of the new vehicle registration and licensing regime;

2. the number of notices issued, the number of cases in which vehicle owners submitted supporting documents to the TD and cancelled the registration of vehicles after scrapping them or permanently shipping them out of Hong Kong, and the number of approved exemptions from the implementation of the new regime up to the present; and

3. some vehicle owners reported that they have not received the notices, and the details about unlicensed vehicles are not shown on the "e-Licensing Portal" online platform; whether the TD is aware of the issue; if yes, the reasons.

Asked by: Hon WONG Kwok, Kingsley (LegCo internal reference no.: 15)

Reply:

1. to 3.

The new vehicle registration and licensing regime took effect on 22 December 2025 to strengthen regulation of prolonged unlicensed vehicles as well as introduce a new offence to heighten deterrence against improper abandoning of vehicles for addressing the problem at source. The Transport Department (TD) is progressively issuing notices to registered owners of vehicles that have been unlicensed for two years or more. Vehicle owners must, within three months upon receipt of the notice: (1) renew the licence of their vehicles which have been unlicensed for two years; or (2) cancel the registration of the vehicles with the TD after scrapping the vehicle or permanently shipping it out of Hong Kong; or (3) apply to the

TD for an exemption from taking the above actions due to special reasons. Vehicle owners should handle their vehicles properly in a timely manner to avoid contravening the law. The work relating to the new regime is undertaken by existing staff of the TD, and there is no separate breakdown available. The expenditure on the publicity work is about $60,000.

As at mid-March 2026, the TD had issued about 1 500 notices, among which there were about 250 cases in which vehicle owners submitted supporting documents to the TD and cancelled the registration of vehicles after scrapping them or permanently shipping them out of Hong Kong. In addition, the TD has granted approval to about 250 cases of exemption.

The TD launched the e-Licensing Portal (e-LP) online platform in December 2024 to provide one-stop service for licence/permit applications and enquiries. Vehicles owners may enquire about the information of their registered vehicles through the e-LP (including whether their vehicles are licensed and the expiry dates of the vehicle licences). Registered vehicle owners may also set up notifications in the e-LP to receive email reminders for licence renewal of their registered vehicles.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0467)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The new regulatory regime for autonomous vehicles ("AVs") came into operation on 1 March 2024, allowing AVs to conduct trial and use on public roads under specific conditions. In this connection, will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the number of applications for AV licences, the number of licences approved and the average processing time per application since the implementation of the new regulatory regime;

2. the numbers of complaints and incidents involving AVs since the implementation of the new regulatory regime; and

3. the number, contents, effectiveness, and related expenditure of projects to promote the development of AVs since the implementation of the new regulatory regime.

Asked by: Hon WU Yingpeng (LegCo internal reference no.: 21)

Reply:

1.& 3.

The Government has been promoting the development of autonomous vehicles (AVs) in Hong Kong in an active and orderly manner through a multi-pronged approach by providing policy support, regulatory backing and financial subsidy. The new regulatory regime for AVs came into operation in March 2024. At the same time, to facilitate the trial and pilot use of AVs, the TD has promulgated the "Code of Practice for Trial and Pilot Use of AVs" (the Code) outlining detailed technical, safety and operational requirements in trial and use of AVs.

The TD welcomes interested organisations or enterprises to submit applications for AV pilot licences. Upon receipt of an application, the TD will evaluate it in accordance with the Code, taking into account factors, including the operational design domain and functions of the autonomous system, relevant national standards (Guobiao) or international standards/guidelines, and the road trial situations, before granting approval. During the evaluation process, the TD will accept Guobiao to prove that the vehicles or their components comply with the relevant technical requirements and vehicle construction standards, and make reference to the testing experience and performance of AV in the Mainland and other places, such as test reports conducted in accordance with Guobiao, to assess the autonomous driving performance of the vehicle. In addition, the TD will consult relevant government departments, seek the views of local community and stakeholders on the proposed trial routes, and make adjustment to the trial routes or time when necessary.

The TD has issued, up to the present, six AV pilot licences, involving 62 AVs in North Lantau (30 vehicles), the West Kowloon Cultural District (two vehicles), Cyberport in the Southern District (10 vehicles), the Kai Tak Development Area in Kowloon East (10 vehicles), the Airportcity Link (seven vehicles), and the "Park & Fly" carpark at the Hong Kong Port of the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge (three vehicles) respectively. For the six approved AV pilot projects, the average processing time for each is about two months. Driving and road safety remain the top priority, and the TD will draw on practical experience to refine technical standards, and will process the applications in a prudent manner.

The relevant work is undertaken by existing staff of TD as part of their established duties. There is no separate breakdown of resources involved.

2. Since the implementation of the new regulatory regime for AVs, the TD has not received any complaints involving AV trials. Furthermore, no major safety incidents have occurred during the trial period.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 1001)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the operation of green minibus (GMB), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the lost trip rates of each GMB route in each of the past three years; and the measures to improve the lost trip problem of GMBs; and

2. the number of cases in each of the past three years where the Transport Department (TD) (i) required GMB operators to submit written explanation on the circumstances where GMB service deviated from a specified routeing; (ii) served letters to the GMB operators for failing to maintain a service in accordance with the Passenger Service Licence (PSL) conditions; (iii) cancelled PSLs of GMB operators.

Asked by: Hon YANG Wing-kit (LegCo internal reference no.37)

Reply:

1. The TD has been effectively monitoring the operation of GMBs through various channels, including conducting regular and ad-hoc surveys or on-site observations, following up on passengers' complaints and suggestions regarding GMB services, and maintaining close communication with GMB operators, to ensure that proper and efficient service is maintained in accordance with the conditions of the PSL. If any service irregularities are found during the inspections or surveys, the TD will advise the GMB operator concerned to conduct follow-up investigation and provide written explanation with relevant information. If an operator fails to comply with the PSL conditions, the TD may issue a warning letter, and take into account the number of warning letters issued and the operator' service performance in the mid-term review for considering extension of the PSL. If the contravention is serious and persistent in nature, the TD may conduct an inquiry against such GMB operator pursuant to the Road Traffic Ordinance (Cap. 374), and after considering the inquiry result, consider suspend, cancel or vary the operator's PSL.

   Currently, the TD does not keep statistics on the lost trip rates of GMB services. Nevertheless, the operational data provided by the GMB Real-time Arrival Information

System enable the TD to investigate lost-trip complaints, so as to monitor and regulate GMB services.

2. The number of cases in which the TD, in each of the past three years, (i) required GMB operators to submit a written explanation on the causes leading to a GMB service deviated from a specified routeing; (ii) issued warning letters to operators for failing to provide services in compliance with the conditions of their PSLs; (iii) cancelled the PSLs of GMB operators are set out in the table below:

Case	**Year**		
	2023	**2024**	**2025**
i) TD required GMB operators to submit a written explanation on the causes leading to a GMB service deviated from a specified routeing (number of cases)	594	659	829
ii) TD issued warning letters to operators for failing to provide service in compliance with the conditions of this PSLs (number of cases)	12	8	1
iii) TD cancelled the PSLs of GMB operators (number of cases)	0	0	0

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2419)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

On combatting illegal parking, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. the number of fixed penalty notices (FPNs) issued by the Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF) against illegal parking in each of the past three years with a breakdown by Police Region;

2. the numbers of on-street, government and privately operated parking spaces with a breakdown by District Council district and vehicle type in each of the past three years;

3. the number of newly registered vehicles in each of the past three years with a breakdown by vehicle class and fuel type?

Asked by: Hon YANG Wing-kit (LegCo internal reference no.19)
Reply:

1. The figures on FPNs issued against illegal parking under the Fixed Penalty (Traffic Contraventions) Ordinance (Cap. 237) by the HKPF in the past three years are tabulated below:

Police Region	Number of FPNs issued against illegal parking		
	2023	2024	2025
Hong Kong Island	523 167	397 077	302 958
Kowloon East	443 038	297 579	222 030
Kowloon West	960 276	872 319	742 407
New Territories South	471 527	390 462	329 572
New Territories North	615 011	585 760	471 140
Total	3 013 019	2 543 197	2 068 107

2. The numbers of on-street parking spaces, parking spaces provided at the government and privately-operated car parks in each of the 18 districts by vehicle type in the past three years are tabulated at **Annex 1**, **Annex 2** and **Annex 3** respectively.

3. The numbers of first registered vehicles with breakdown by vehicle class and fuel type in the past three years are tabulated below:

Vehicle class	Number of first registered vehicles in 2023					
	Petrol	Diesel	Electric	Liquefied Petroleum Gas	Hydrogen	Total
Motorcycle	4 632	0	211	0	0	4 843
Private car	15 628	0	28 541	0	0	44 169
Taxi	2	0	17	933	0	952
Franchised bus	0	108	24	0	1	133
Non-franchised public bus	0	401	15	0	0	416
Private bus	0	90	0	0	0	90
Public light bus	0	93	1	21	0	115
Private light bus	0	81	1	0	0	82
Goods vehicle	0	4 701	308	0	0	5 009
Special purpose vehicle	0	81	7	5	0	93

Vehicle class	Number of first registered vehicles in 2024					
	Petrol	Diesel	Electric	Liquefied Petroleum Gas	Hydrogen	Total
Motorcycle	3 726	0	307	0	0	4 033
Private car	13 503	0	33 206	0	0	46 709
Taxi	4	0	140	827	0	971
Franchised bus	0	25	20	0	0	45
Non-franchised public bus	0	307	10	0	0	317
Private bus	0	63	3	0	0	66
Public light bus	0	105	3	14	0	122
Private light bus	0	132	1	0	0	133
Goods vehicle	0	2 936	249	0	0	3 185
Special purpose vehicle	2	71	3	5	0	81

Vehicle class	Number of first registered vehicles in 2025					
	Petrol	**Diesel**	**Electric**	**Liquefied Petroleum Gas**	**Hydrogen**	**Total**
Motorcycle	3 562	0	223	0	0	3 785
Private car	13 568	0	37 467	0	0	51 035
Taxi	93	0	899	812	0	1 804
Franchised bus	0	45	1	0	0	46
Non-franchised public bus	0	402	36	0	0	438
Private bus	0	38	6	0	0	44
Public light bus	0	41	11	1	0	53
Private light bus	0	89	5	0	0	94
Goods vehicle	0	2 383	551	0	0	2 934
Special purpose vehicle	1	72	6	0	3	82

Note 1: Hybrid vehicles are included under their respective fuel types. Only pure electric vehicles are counted in the category of electric vehicles.

Annex 1

Numbers of on-street parking spaces in 18 districts by vehicle type in the past three years

District	Year (as at the end of December)	Private Car[Note 1]	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total[Note 2]
Central & Western	2025	509	202	11	651	1 373
	2024	509	202	11	651	1 373
	2023	508	193	11	651	1 363
Wan Chai	2025	1 040	24	43	784	1 891
	2024	1 029	25	53	779	1 886
	2023	1 017	24	48	761	1 850
Eastern	2025	535	101	66	826	1 528
	2024	536	101	65	807	1 509
	2023	529	91	75	818	1 513
Southern	2025	655	51	85	461	1 252
	2024	653	51	85	447	1 236
	2023	645	50	85	447	1 227
Yau Tsim Mong	2025	1 592	369	141	1 349	3 451
	2024	1 586	369	141	1 319	3 415
	2023	1 561	363	138	1 309	3 371
Sham Shui Po	2025	1 296	219	10	919	2 444
	2024	1 295	220	12	884	2 411
	2023	1 273	229	9	876	2 387
Kowloon City	2025	2 373	157	154	1 025	3 709
	2024	2 378	143	160	1 002	3 683
	2023	2 336	143	134	991	3 604
Wong Tai Sin	2025	321	133	0	570	1 024
	2024	316	129	0	545	990
	2023	306	129	0	519	954
Kwun Tong	2025	600	134	56	998	1 788
	2024	586	120	53	921	1 680
	2023	531	115	42	834	1 522
Tsuen Wan	2025	868	67	31	755	1 721
	2024	859	69	31	700	1 659
	2023	888	63	31	629	1 611
Tuen Mun	2025	1 321	338	113	876	2 648
	2024	1 297	329	113	892	2 631
	2023	1 267	330	113	886	2 596
Yuen Long	2025	1 240	445	78	624	2 387
	2024	1 266	419	110	636	2 431
	2023	1 308	427	114	626	2 475
North	2025	1 388	354	29	389	2 160
	2024	1 406	365	32	424	2 227
	2023	1 283	359	27	424	2 093

District	Year (as at the end of December)	Private Car[Note 1]	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total[Note 2]
Tai Po	2025	1 603	339	86	301	2 329
	2024	1 601	352	86	280	2 319
	2023	1 556	359	84	270	269
Sai Kung	2025	1 941	319	159	530	2 949
	2024	1 930	316	146	505	2 897
	2023	1 932	305	155	481	2 873
Sha Tin	2025	1 474	338	61	649	2 522
	2024	1 600	337	67	602	2 606
	2023	1 600	335	64	514	2 513
Kwai Tsing	2025	484	376	31	898	1 789
	2024	484	360	21	772	1 637
	2023	424	353	21	726	1 524
Islands	2025	640	67	78	261	1 046
	2024	640	67	78	261	1 046
	2023	517	55	75	205	852
Total [Note 2]	**2025**	**19 880**	**4 033**	**1 232**	**12 866**	**38 011**
	2024	**19 971**	**3 974**	**1 264**	**12 427**	**37 636**
	2023	**19 481**	**3 923**	**1 226**	**11 967**	**36 597**

Note 1: These parking spaces are for parking of private cars and taxis, as well as light buses, tricycles and light goods vehicles of similar dimensions.

Note 2: The figures exclude about 370 parking spaces reserved for special public services such as refuse collection or post offices' vehicles.

Annex 2

Numbers of parking spaces provided at the government car parks in 18 districts by vehicle type in the past three years[Note 1]

District	Year (as at the end of December)	Private Car	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total
Central & Western	2025	3 812	377	13	345	4 547
	2024	3 821	425	13	345	4 604
	2023	3 903	426	13	343	4 685
Wan Chai	2025	2 428	230	11	267	2 936
	2024	2 428	401	11	265	3 105
	2023	2 578	230	11	263	3 082
Eastern	2025	3 181	346	21	382	3 930
	2024	3 179	346	21	382	3 928
	2023	3 165	346	33	382	3 926
Southern	2025	2 648	177	10	488	3 323
	2024	2 676	177	10	488	3 351
	2023	2 681	182	10	488	3 361
Yau Tsim Mong	2025	875	172	18	34	1 099
	2024	900	180	18	34	1 132
	2023	976	253	20	34	1 283
Sham Shui Po	2025	4 125	1 170	26	512	5 833
	2024	4 021	1 175	26	512	5 734
	2023	4 050	1 175	33	504	5 762
Kowloon City	2025	3 131	111	7	253	3 502
	2024	3 183	135	5	257	3 580
	2023	3 179	134	7	247	3 567
Wong Tai Sin	2025	4 382	282	43	615	5 322
	2024	4 288	295	44	590	5 217
	2023	4 187	285	44	561	5 077
Kwun Tong	2025	7 357	430	23	1 493	9 303
	2024	7 658	520	30	1 509	9 717
	2023	7 702	511	34	1 482	9 729
Tsuen Wan	2025	1 890	121	4	244	2 259
	2024	1 890	121	4	244	2 259
	2023	1 868	121	4	244	2 237
Tuen Mun	2025	3 804	179	48	239	4 270
	2024	3 801	179	48	239	4 267
	2023	3 769	179	46	232	4 226
Yuen Long	2025	3 346	111	36	242	3 735
	2024	3 346	111	36	242	3 735
	2023	3 301	112	46	238	3 697

District	Year (as at the end of December)	Private Car	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total
North	2025	4 373	529	55	270	5 227
	2024	4 443	417	55	270	5 185
	2023	3 820	411	55	254	4 540
Tai Po	2025	1 112	208	8	96	1 424
	2024	1 121	208	8	96	1 433
	2023	1 110	208	15	96	1 429
Sai Kung	2025	2 239	121	63	230	2 653
	2024	1 945	73	51	208	2 277
	2023	1 941	73	66	206	2 286
Sha Tin	2025	4 532	161	32	492	5 217
	2024	4 642	182	32	501	5 357
	2023	4 479	179	31	482	5 171
Kwai Tsing	2025	4 777	575	12	893	6 257
	2024	5 049	579	12	901	6 541
	2023	4 905	564	12	855	6 336
Islands	2025	2 220	71	39	136	2 466
	2024	2 222	71	39	136	2 468
	2023	2 111	242	17	114	2 484
Total	**2025**	**60 232**	**5 371**	**469**	**7 231**	**73 303**
	2024	**60 613**	**5 595**	**463**	**7 219**	**73 890**
	2023	**59 725**	**5 631**	**497**	**7 025**	**72 878**

Note 1: The above parking information is collated from the data provided by various departments or the concerned car park management companies or operators, and is for general reference only. The actual number of parking spaces may vary as the departments, management companies or operators responsible for managing the car parks may make adjustments to the numbers/types of parking spaces to suit their own requirements.

Annex 3

Numbers of parking spaces provided at the privately-operated car parks in 18 districts by vehicle type in the past three years[Note 1]

District	Year (as at the end of December)	Private Car	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total
Central & Western	2025	34 805	451	60	608	35 924
	2024	34 750	439	59	601	35 849
	2023	34 045	385	58	483	34 971
Wan Chai	2025	35 789	88	90	384	36 351
	2024	35 523	88	90	359	36 060
	2023	35 138	83	97	321	35 639
Eastern	2025	43 200	1 420	171	1 602	46 393
	2024	42 914	1 403	193	1 562	46 072
	2023	43 136	1 389	227	1 455	46 207
Southern	2025	37 780	910	188	1 111	39 989
	2024	36 970	894	179	1 079	39 122
	2023	36 751	892	177	1 053	38 873
Yau Tsim Mong	2025	33 217	775	88	836	34 916
	2024	33 153	773	86	786	34 798
	2023	33 421	774	101	797	35 093
Sham Shui Po	2025	26 376	1 731	392	968	29 467
	2024	26 215	1 820	386	929	29 350
	2023	25 305	1 905	387	854	28 451
Kowloon City	2025	49 994	1 140	92	1 352	52 578
	2024	47 634	1 171	104	1 186	50 095
	2023	46 646	1 090	154	1 045	48 935
Wong Tai Sin	2025	15 877	865	47	1 406	18 195
	2024	16 132	874	47	1 426	18 479
	2023	16 472	865	45	1 328	18 710
Kwun Tong	2025	40 556	3 089	58	2 706	46 409
	2024	40 976	3 044	39	2 576	46 635
	2023	41 130	2 896	47	2 449	46 522
Tsuen Wan	2025	35 916	1 868	365	1 050	39 199
	2024	35 644	1 914	374	883	38 815
	2023	35 826	1 960	362	886	39 034
Tuen Mun	2025	39 120	2 036	91	1 102	42 349
	2024	38 655	2 047	91	1 097	41 890
	2023	38 658	2 038	93	958	41 747
Yuen Long	2025	40 134	1 475	287	1 276	43 172
	2024	39 363	1 621	288	1 149	42 421
	2023	39 436	1 524	287	1 110	42 357
North	2025	17 516	754	32	412	18 714
	2024	17 511	735	32	411	18 689
	2023	17 842	975	32	380	19 229

District	Year (as at the end of December)	Private Car	Goods Vehicle	Coach/Bus	Motorcycle	Total
Tai Po	2025	31 561	653	79	906	33 199
	2024	29 771	613	58	875	31 317
	2023	29 763	641	54	850	31 308
Sai Kung	2025	41 849	1 233	163	3 000	46 245
	2024	41 071	1 176	146	2 955	45 348
	2023	40 415	1 076	148	2 759	44 398
Sha Tin	2025	70 125	2 181	102	2 482	74 890
	2024	70 266	2 204	102	2 407	74 979
	2023	71 024	2 310	101	2 376	75 811
Kwai Tsing	2025	30 848	9 094	348	1 540	41 830
	2024	30 845	8 628	181	1 478	41 132
	2023	31 004	9 658	396	1 378	42 436
Islands	2025	18 891	870	174	604	20 539
	2024	17 541	870	174	370	18 955
	2023	18 022	708	176	390	19 296
Total	**2025**	**643 554**	**30 633**	**2 827**	**23 345**	**700 359**
	2024	**634 934**	**30 314**	**2 629**	**22 129**	**690 006**
	2023	**634 034**	**31 169**	**2 942**	**20 872**	**689 017**

Note 1: The above parking information is collated from the data provided by various departments or the concerned car park management companies or operators, and is for general reference only. The actual number of parking spaces may vary as the departments, management companies or operators responsible for managing the car parks may make adjustments to the numbers/types of parking spaces to suit their own requirements.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2420)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the railway development of the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL), will the Government inform this Committee of the following in each of the past three years:

1. the monthly average patronage and total patronage, the carrying capacities and loading during the busiest one hour in the morning per direction for critical links, and the critical links of various railway lines; and

2. the number of incidents caused by factors under the MTRCL's control which led to service disruption of eight minutes or above with a breakdown by type of service disruption?

Asked by: Hon YANG Wing-kit (LegCo internal reference no.21)

Reply:

1. The monthly average patronage, total patronage, the carrying capacities and loading during the busiest one hour in the morning per direction for critical links, and the critical links of various heavy rail lines and Light Rail routes in the past three years are set out at **Annex 1** and **Annex 2** respectively.

2. The numbers of incidents which caused service disruption of eight minutes or more due to factors within the MTR Corporation Limited (MTRCL)'s control in the past three years are set out below:

Year	Cause	Number of incidents
2023	equipment failure (Note)	94
	human factors	7
2024	equipment failure (Note)	82
	human factors	7
2025	equipment failure (Note)	76
	human factors	7

Note: Including failure in station equipment, infrastructure (e.g. signalling system), rolling stock, etc.

Annex 1

Statistics for the Heavy Rail System
(the busiest one hour in the morning per direction for critical links)

		East Rail Line	Tuen Ma Line	Tseung Kwan O Line	Island Line	South Island Line	Kwun Tong Line	Tsuen Wan Line	Disneyland Resort Line	Tracks sharing at some sections	
										Tung Chung Line (Note 1)	Airport Express (Notes 1 and 2)
2023											
1.	Maximum carrying capacity when train frequency is maximised (6 persons (standing) per square metre (ppsm)) (a) (Note 3)	82 500	70 000	67 600	80 000	27 000	71 400	75 000	9 600	45 000	4 800
2.	Carrying capacity (6 ppsm) (b)	62 500	58 800	67 600	80 000	16 800	71 400	75 000	8 300	42 500	4 200
3.	Difference between (a) and (b) (Note 4)	20 000	11 200	0	0	10 200	0	0	1 300	2 500	600
4.	Patronage (c)	42 400	35 700	40 400	46 300	9 800	34 500	38 800	3 200	21 200	1 700
5.	Loading (6 ppsm) [(c)/(b)] { } critical link	68% {Tai Wai to Kowloon Tong}	61% {Tsuen Wan West to	60% {Yau Tong to	58% {Tin Hau to Causeway Bay}	58% {Admiralty to Ocean Park}	48% {Choi Hung	52% {Sham Shui Po to	39% {Sunny Bay to Disneyland Resort}	50% {Olympic to Kowloon}	40% {Tsing Yi to Airport}

		East Rail Line	Tuen Ma Line	Tseung Kwan O Line	Island Line	South Island Line	Kwun Tong Line	Tsuen Wan Line	Disneyland Resort Line	Tracks sharing at some sections	
										Tung Chung Line (Note 1)	Airport Express (Notes 1 and 2)
			Mei Foo}	Quarry Bay}			to Kowloon Bay}	Prince Edward}			
6.	Loading (4 ppsm) (Note 5)	94%	85%	84%	81%	82%	68%	73%	54%	70%	N/A
7.	Monthly average patronage (million)	23.7	23.9	9.8	25.7	2.2	18.2	27.7	0.5	6.5	0.9
8.	Total patronage (million)	283.6	280.3	114.8	311.0	25.8	215.1	344.6	5.8	77.1	10.8
2024											
1.	Maximum carrying capacity when train frequency is maximised (6 ppsm) (a) (Note 3)	82 500	70 000	67 600	80 000	27 000	71 400	75 000	9 600	45 000	4 800
2.	Carrying capacity (6 ppsm) (b)	62 500	58 800	67 600	80 000	16 800	71 400	75 000	8 600	42 500	4 200
3.	Difference between (a) and (b) (Note 4)	20 000	11 200	0	0	10 200	0	0	1 000	2 500	600
4.	Patronage (c)	42 800	36 200	38 400	44 100	9 900	34 200	38 400	2 800	20 900	2 000

		East Rail Line	Tuen Ma Line	Tseung Kwan O Line	Island Line	South Island Line	Kwun Tong Line	Tsuen Wan Line	Disneyland Resort Line	Tracks sharing at some sections	
										Tung Chung Line (Note 1)	Airport Express (Notes 1 and 2)
5.	Loading (6 ppsm) [(c)/(b)] { } critical link	68% {Tai Wai to Kowloon Tong}	62% {Tsuen Wan West to Mei Foo}	57% {Yau Tong to Quarry Bay}	55% {Tin Hau to Causeway Bay}	59% {Admiralty to Ocean Park}	48% {Choi Hung to Kowloon Bay}	51% {Sham Shui Po to Prince Edward}	33% {Sunny Bay to Disneyland Resort}	49% {Olympic to Kowloon}	48% {Tsing Yi to Airport}
6.	Loading (4 ppsm) (Note 5)	94%	86%	80%	77%	83%	67%	72%	46%	69%	N/A
7.	Monthly average patronage (million)	25.9	24.7	9.8	25.9	2.4	18.2	27.7	0.5	6.5	1.1
8.	Total patronage (million)	310.3	296.9	118.0	311.4	29.0	218.1	332.1	6.4	77.8	13.1
2025											
1.	Maximum carrying capacity when train frequency is maximised (6 ppsm) (a) (Note 3)	82 500	70 000	67 600	80 000	27 000	71 400	75 000	9 600	45 000	4 800
2.	Carrying capacity (6 ppsm) (b)	62 500	58 800	67 600	80 000	16 800	71 400	70 100	8 600	42 500	4 200
3.	Difference between (a) and (b) (Note 4)	20 000	11 200	0	0	10 200	0	4 900	1 000	2 500	600
4.	Patronage (c)	44 400	38 400	38 700	43 900	10 100	33 800	38 400	3 000	22 200	1 900

		East Rail Line	Tuen Ma Line	Tseung Kwan O Line	Island Line	South Island Line	Kwun Tong Line	Tsuen Wan Line	Disneyland Resort Line	Tracks sharing at some sections	
										Tung Chung Line (Note 1)	Airport Express (Notes 1 and 2)
5.	Loading (6 ppsm) [(c)/(b)] { } critical link	71% {Tai Wai to Kowloon Tong}	65% {Tsuen Wan West to Mei Foo}	57% {Yau Tong to Quarry Bay}	55% {Tin Hau to Causeway Bay}	60% {Admiralty to Ocean Park}	47% {Choi Hung to Kowloon Bay}	55% {Sham Shui Po to Prince Edward}	35% {Sunny Bay to Disneyland Resort}	52% {Olympic to Kowloon}	45% {Tsing Yi to Airport }
6.	Loading (4 ppsm) (Note 5)	98%	92%	80%	77%	84%	66%	77%	49%	73%	N/A
7.	Monthly average patronage (million)	26.3	25.4	9.8	25.8	2.5	17.9	27.2	0.5	6.4	1.1
8.	Total patronage (million)	315.7	304.2	117.7	309.9	29.6	214.6	326.4	6.2	76.8	13.3

Note 1: As Airport Express and Tung Chung Line share tracks at some sections, the overall capacity of the railway lines are affected by the train service pattern.

Note 2: The design of Airport Express is based on seat provision where the passenger density level in terms of the number of standees does not apply. The figures are calculated based on existing carrying capacity.

Note 3: All train compartments of the existing MTR lines are designed based on the industry standard design adopted at the time of the construction of railway lines, which can accommodate a passenger density of six ppsm. In actual operation, as passengers are less willing to board a train that looks crowded even when there is still room available, trains only achieve a passenger density of only around four ppsm. Therefore, the TD provides the carrying capacity of six ppsm to reflect the maximum level of train capacity, as well as the loading of four ppsm to reflect the situation in actual operation.

Note 4: This is because the service frequency has not yet been increased to the maximum level the signalling system permits.

Note 5: For a typical heavy rail train operating in the urban area, there are 340 seats and 2 160 standees under a passenger density level of six ppsm, adding up to a total carrying capacity of about 2 500 per train. Under a passenger density level of four ppsm, the 340 number of seats will remain unchanged while the number of standees will be reduced to 1 440, adding up to a total carrying capacity of about 1 780 per train. Hence, the carrying capacity under a passenger density level of four ppsm is 71.2% of that of six ppsm. For the East Rail Line, the proportion of seats and standees is slightly different from that of other heavy rail trains as it has a First Class compartment. The capacity of trains is 2 845 and 2 061 respectively for six and four ppsm.

Annex 2

Statistics for the Light Rail System
(the busiest one hour in the morning per direction for critical links)

Light Rail route	Maximum carrying capacity			Passenger loading (Note 1)		
	2023	**2024**	**2025**	**2023**	**2024**	**2025**
505	2 993	2 993	2 993	66%	79%	82%
506P(Note2)	424	424	424	70%	45%	70%
507	2 827	2 827	2 625	83%	85%	86%
507P	212	212	212	90%	90%	50%
610	2 056	2 056	2 056	93%	93%	84%
614	1 122	1 122	1 156	77%(Note3)	77%(Note3)	90%(Note3)
614P	1 363	1 363	1 368			
615	960	960	960	74%(Note3)	87%(Note3)	75%(Note3)
615P	1 600	1 600	1 600			
705	4 240	4 240	4 240	63%	82%	72%
706	5 088	5 088	5 088	63%	80%	82%
720(Note2)	N/A	212	212	N/A	20%	10%
751	2 993	2 993	2 857	64%	81%	85%
751P	398	398	424	60%	80%	95%
761P	4 240	4 240	4 240	64%	86%	76%

Patronage (million)

	2023	**2024**	**2025**
Monthly average patronage	12.5	12.9	12.9
Total patronage	150.0	154.6	154.4

Note 1: Light Rail is an open system where there are a number of routes passing through a single Light Rail stop. One cannot work out the exact loading or patronage of individual Light Rail routes by projecting the route chosen by passengers based on their entry/exit records, which is the methodology currently adopted in assessing the loading of heavy rail lines. The MTRCL currently assesses the loading of Light Rail Vehicles by on-site observations and surveys. The passenger density standard of four or six ppsm adopted in the calculation of heavy rail loading is not applicable.

Note 2: The MTRCL introduced Routes 506P and 720 in September 2023 and September 2024 respectively to run in the morning peak hours.

Note 3: The figures show the average loading of Route 614/614P and Route 615/615P. Within the Tuen Mun District, the alignments of Routes 614 and 614P overlap completely, same for Routes 615 and 615P. However, Routes 614P and 615P only operate between Tuen Mun Ferry Pier and Siu Hong Station, while Routes 614 and 615 provide cross-district services to Yuen Long after serving Siu Hong Station. The busiest sections of these two routes are normally located along the overlapping sections in Tuen Mun District. For passengers travelling within Tuen Mun District, it makes no difference to take Route 614 or 614P, or to take Route 615 or 615P. Therefore, using average loading of the Light Rail routes can more accurately reflect the actual situation.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 3173)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Please list out the number and nature of complaints received by the Transport Department (TD) in the past three years concerning the Kowloon Motor Bus Company (1933) Limited (KMB), Long Win Bus Company Limited (LWB), Citybus Limited (CTB), New World First Bus Services Limited (NWFB), New Lantao Bus Company (1973) Limited (NLB), taxi and public light bus.

Asked by: Hon YANG Wing-kit (LegCo internal reference no.: 38)

Reply:

The number and nature of complaints received by the TD concerning KMB, LWB, CTB (Franchise for the Urban and New Territories bus network) (CTB (Urban and New Territories)), CTB (Franchise for Airport and North Lantau Bus Network) (CTB(F2)), NWFB, NLB, taxi and public light bus in the past three years are set out in the tables below:

2023

Public Transport Modes	**Number of complaints received by the TD (Note 1)**			
	Adequacy of services	**Standard of services**	**General (Note 2)**	**Total**
Franchised bus				
KMB	961	18 367	2 265	21 593
LWB	64	939	434	1 437
CTB (Urban and New Territories) (Note 3)	659	6 917	635	8 211
CTB(F2)	486	1 015	150	1 651
NWFB (Note 3)	116	1 292	61	1 469
NLB	29	436	142	607
Other (Note 4)	669	1 894	688	3 251
Taxi	6	2 299	239	2 544
Public light bus	1 701	13 679	627	16 007
Total	**4 691**	**46 838**	**5 241**	**56 770**

2024

Public Transport Modes	Number of complaints received by the TD (Note 1)			
	Adequacy of services	Standard of services	General (Note 2)	Total
Franchised bus				
KMB	2 606	20 170	1 221	23 997
LWB	367	1 568	53	1 988
CTB (Urban and New Territories) (Note 3)	1 222	5 629	429	7 280
CTB(F2)	311	1 282	101	1 694
NLB	102	540	25	667
Other (Note 4)	682	1 958	507	3 147
Taxi	4	2 644	219	2 867
Public light bus	1 571	15 099	732	17 402
Total	**6 865**	**48 890**	**3 287**	**59 042**

2025

Public Transport Modes	Number of complaints received by the TD (Note 1)			
	Adequacy of services	Standard of services	General (Note 2)	Total
Franchised bus				
KMB	2 195	16 865	1 201	20 261
LWB	203	1 886	32	2 121
CTB (Urban and New Territories) (Note 3)	543	5 648	290	6 481
CTB(F2)	201	1 112	110	1 423
NLB	146	580	31	757
Other (Note 4)	431	2 006	554	2 991
Taxi	12	2 214	189	2 415
Public light bus	1 563	15 502	669	17 734
Total	**5 294**	**45 813**	**3 076**	**54 183**

Note:

1. The sources of complaints include those directly received by the TD through letters or emails, as well as those referred to the TD by the Transport Complaints Unit and 1823 call centre.

2. General complaints include those relating to fares and payment method, etc.

3. As decided by the Chief Executive in Council in July 2022, the two franchises of NWFB and CTB (Franchise for Hong Kong Island and Cross-Harbour Bus Network) were merged and covered by a new ten-year franchise (i.e. CTB (Urban and New Territories)) commencing on 1 July 2023.

4. Complaints involving more than one franchised bus operator or jointly operated routes, or could not be identified as associated to a franchised bus operator.

The total number of complaints regarding public transport in 2025 was lower than that in 2023 and 2024. To continuously enhance the operational efficiency of the overall public transport route network and to make more effective use of resources, the TD will, through the established mechanism, review with operators the service levels of public transport routes and passenger demand in each district, so as to plan, improve and rationalise the public transport services, including adjustment of frequencies and service hours of buses and public light buses, etc. Regarding taxis, the Government has already introduced various measures to improve the quality of taxi services, including the systematically managed taxi fleets, enhancement of the taxi written test, introduction of the Taxi-Driver-Offence Points system and the two-tier penalty system, etc.

The TD will sustain the efforts and encourage public transport operators to continuously enhance their service quality and efficiency to meet passengers' travelling demand.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 Reply Serial No.

TLB268

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0779)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned under the Programme that the Government will continue to improve existing cycle tracks and associated facilities in new towns in the New Territories. In this connection, please advise this Committee of the following:

1. the number of complaints received against illegally abandoned bicycles, the number of cases handled, and the number of bicycles removed in the past three years, with a break down by District Council district; among which the percentage of cases involving shared bicycles; and the total expenditure on handling such cases (such as the cost of joint operation and removal);

2. the number of inter-departmental joint operations (including the Food and Environmental Hygiene Department, the Lands Department, and the Transport Department) conducted by the Government against illegally abandoned bicycles in the New Territories, the number of bicycles handled, and the standards for assessing their effectiveness; and the details of the total budget and expenditure of these operations in the past three years; and

3. regarding the impact of illegally abandoned bicycles on street hygiene and pedestrian safety in the New Territories, whether the Government has any plan or has conducted any study on introducing technology-based management measures to prevent such problem; if yes, the details of the study, the estimated timetable and the expenditure involved in the Budget; if no, the reasons and alternative measures.

Asked by: Hon YIU Ming (LegCo internal reference no.: 20)

Reply:

1,2. The numbers of complaints about illegally parked bicycles received through the 1823 Call Centre and cases handled in the past three years are set out below:

	Number of complaints about illegally parked or abandoned bicycles and cases handled (Figures of shared bicycles)		
	2023	**2024**	**2025**
Central and Western	178(0)	458(0)	520(0)
Wan Chai	145(0)	357(0)	432(0)
Eastern	207(0)	335(0)	300(0)
Southern	34(0)	39(0)	47(0)
Yau Tsim Mong	222(0)	417(0)	695(2)
Sham Shui Po	152(0)	281(0)	294(0)
Kowloon City	122(0)	147(0)	174(0)
Wong Tai Sin	96(0)	145(0)	110(0)
Kwun Tong	234(0)	198(0)	293(1)
Tsuen Wan	130(2)	174(1)	204(8)
Tuen Mun	195(5)	187(8)	362(49)
Yuen Long	403(9)	610(15)	614(29)
North	262(3)	514(3)	483(29)
Tai Po	182(8)	146(6)	233(19)
Sai Kung	223(18)	304(8)	395(33)
Sha Tin	317(5)	539(15)	546(26)
Kwai Tsing	56(0)	65(0)	92(2)
Islands	82(0)	126(5)	121(8)
Location not specified/More than one district	38(0)	51(2)	92(8)

At present, relevant departments including the District Offices under the Home Affairs Department, the District Lands Offices, the Transport Department (TD), the Hong Kong Police Force and the Food and Environmental Hygiene Department would conduct joint operations as necessary, based on actual circumstances and needs, to remove illegally parked or abandoned bicycles. In the past three years (from 2023 to 2025), a total of 736 joint operations were conducted in the New Territories (including Islands, Kwai Tsing, North, Sai Kung, Sha Tin, Tai Po, Tsuen Wan, Tuen Mun and Yuen Long) by the relevant departments, with over 45 000 illegally parked or abandoned bicycles removed. The number of joint operations was similar each year, and the number of bicycles cleared per operation decreased year by year, reflecting the deterrent effect of these operations. The relevant breakdown is as follows:

Year	Number of joint operations	Number of bicycles cleared
2023	243	15 837
2024	248	15 480
2025	245	13 930
Total	736	45 247

The expenditure on joint operations is covered by the overall resources of the respective departments, and has not been separately identified. The removal of shared bicycles is handled by operators, and the TD does not have information on the relevant expenditure.

3. As at December 2025, there were about 66 000 public bicycle parking spaces in Hong Kong, of which about 42 200 were managed by the TD, and the remainder were provided by the Housing Department (mainly in its housing estates) and the Leisure and Cultural Services Department. To support the policy of promoting cycling and to meet future demand for bicycle parking spaces, the Government is studying to include bicycle parking spaces as ancillary facilities within land uses in new development areas (NDAs) and new towns, requiring suitable new development projects to provide sufficient bicycle parking spaces according to their land use and scale. The Government will continue to identify suitable locations in various NDAs to provide additional public bicycle parking spaces for use by the public and by shared bicycles. This will further foster a "bicycle-friendly" environment and help mitigate the problem of illegal bicycle parking on pavements. Regarding illegally abandoned bicycles, the Government will regularly conduct joint operations in various districts to clear such abandoned bicycles.

Regarding the introduction of technology-based management measures to prevent illegally abandoned or parked bicycles, the Government will review the development of relevant technologies at an appropriate time and consider appropriate arrangements having regard to factors such as cost-effectiveness and feasibility.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 Reply Serial No.

TLB269

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0789)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (3) District Traffic and Transport Services

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

The Government enables safe and orderly pedestrians and vehicular traffic by implementing traffic management schemes, deploying intelligent transport systems, monitoring and regulating public transport operations, formulating and implementing road safety strategies and measures, and maintaining regular dialogue with District Councils and other public bodies. Regarding the traffic black spots across the territory, will the Government advise this Committee of the following:

1. What was the total number of fatalities in traffic accidents in the past three years?

2. Please set out the total number and locations of existing traffic black spots across the territory, as well as the number of accidents and casualties at these black spots in the past three years;

3. What was the number of black spots that have undergone improvement works in the past year, and their effectiveness? Does it have any targeted action plans in place for black spots that have long remained unresolved? and

4. Will the Government conduct a comprehensive review of road designs across the territory and introduce a smart traffic system, such as using artificial intelligence to monitor vehicle speed, with a view to reducing the number of black spots in the long run?

Asked by: Hon YIU Ming (LegCo internal reference no.: 35)

Reply:

1. According to records, the numbers of fatalities in traffic accidents between 2023 and 2025 are set out in the table below:

Year	Number of fatalities
2023	96
2024	88
2025*	95

*Provisional figure

2. The numbers of accidents and casualties at traffic black spots between 2023 and 2025 are set out in the table below:

Year	Number of traffic accidents	Number of casualties		
		Killed	Seriously injured	Slightly injured
2023	729	10	38	899
2024	649	8	27	809
2025*	508	3	12	619

*Provisional figure

Locations of existing traffic black spots across the territory are set out at **Annex**.

3. and 4. The Government has been adopting various measures to enhance road safety and is committed to reducing traffic accidents at source. Key initiatives include improving road design and traffic management, reviewing legislation to strengthen driving safety requirements and increase the deterrent effect of penalties, incorporating technology to enhance traffic oversight, and stepping up publicity, education and enforcement action.

Regarding improvement to road designs and traffic management initiatives, the TD analyses accident data from traffic black spots and other locations with a relatively high frequency of accidents to identify any distinct patterns or common causes, enabling the formulation of targeted improvement measures, such as adjusting traffic signals, adding central dividers, improving pedestrian facilities and optimising traffic signage and road markings. During 2025, the Transport Department (TD) completed road improvement works at 19 accident black spots and locations with a relatively high frequency of accidents. Among them, three locations recorded a reduction in the overall numbers of traffic accidents and casualties by approximately 27% and 18 % respectively one year following the completion of the works, compared with the year prior. For the remaining 16 locations, as improvement works were completed less than a year ago, the TD is currently continuing to collect and analyse further data in order to evaluate their effectiveness.

Furthermore, the TD and the Hong Kong Police Force (HKPF) will continue to leverage new technologies to improve traffic management and enhance road safety. The TD had, by the end of 2024, installed new auxiliary devices which project red light at signalised crossings at about 100 locations across various districts, which are black spots with a relatively high number of vehicle-to-pedestrian collisions, with a view to reminding pedestrians no red-light running at crossings. Regarding zebra crossings, the TD has commissioned the Electrical and Mechanical Services Department to replace all traditional Belisha beacons at zebra crossings on public roads in Hong Kong, and the replacement works have

commenced at the end of 2024. The new beacons consist of a halo of flashing yellow light and a post with flashing white bands. They are more visible than the traditional beacons to draw the attention of motorists to the presence of zebra crossings and remind them to stop and give way to pedestrians.

Overall speaking, most traffic accidents are attributed to driver-related factors, including inattentive driving, tailgating and careless lane changes. In view of this, the TD will continue to collaborate with the HKPF and the Road Safety Council to raise motorists' awareness through publicity, education and enforcement action.

Annex

Locations of traffic black spots *(junctions) in Hong Kong

1	Argyle Street, Sai Yeung Choi Street South
2	Austin Road, Cox's Road, Pine Tree Hill Road
3	Austin Road, Parkes Street
4	Canton Road, Austin Road, Austin Road West
5	Chatham Road South, Austin Road, Cheong Wan Road
6	Chatham Road South, Cameron Road
7	Che Kung Miu Road, Hung Mui Kuk Road, Mei Tin Road (Che Kung Miu Road near Sun Tsui Estate)
8	Cheong Lin Road, Airport Road, Airport South Interchange (Airport Road (North))
9	Cheong Lin Road, Airport Road, Airport South Interchange (Airport Road (South))
10	Cheong Lin Road, Airport Road, Airport South Interchange (Cheong Lin Road(East))
11	Cheung Sha Wan Road, Lai Chi Kok Road
12	Cheung Sha Wan Road, Tonkin Street
13	Cheung Sha Wan Road, Yen Chow Street
14	Ching Cheung Road, Butterfly Valley Road
15	Chuen Lung Street, Ho Pui Street
16	Haiphong Road, Lock Road
17	Harbour Road, Fleming Road
18	Jordan Road, Lin Cheung Road
19	Kowloon Park Drive, Peking Road
20	Lei Yue Mun Road (westbound), Cha Kwo Ling Road
21	Morrison Hill Road, Sports Road
22	Nathan Road, Argyle Street
23	Nathan Road, Austin Road
24	Nathan Road, Jordan Road
25	Nathan Road, Prince Edward Road West
26	Nathan Road, Salisbury Road
27	Nathan Road, Waterloo Road
28	Pok Oi Interchange, Yuen Long Highway (near Pok Oi Hospital)
29	Prince Edward Road East (eastbound), King Tai Street
30	Princess Margaret Road, Man Fung Path
31	Sha Tsui Road, Tai Ho Road (near Tsuen Wan Town Hall)
32	Tai Chung Road Interchange, Tai Chung Road
33	Tam Kon Shan Interchange, Fung Shue Wo Road
34	Texaco Road North, Kwok Shui Road
35	Tsuen Kam Interchange, Wai Tsuen Road
36	Tsuen Tsing Interchange, Texaco Road
37	Tsuen Tsing Interchange, Tsuen Wan Road
38	Waterloo Road, Argyle Street, Princess Margaret Road

39	Belcher's Street, Smithfield
40	Chi Fu Road, slip road from Pok Fu Lam Road
41	Fu Yan Street, Shui Wo Street
42	Lai Chi Kok Road, Prince Edward Road West, Reclamation Street
43	Lok Shan Road, Ma Tau Wai Road
44	Lung Poon Street, Access Road to Diamond Hill Station Public Transport Interchange
45	Ma Tau Wai Road, Fat Kwong Street, Man Yue Street
46	Penny's Bay Highway, Penny's Bay Highway Roundabout
47	Shek Kip Mei Street, Woh Chai Street
48	Tin Shui Road, Access Road of Tin Yan Estate
49	Tuen Mun Heung Sze Wui Road, Tuen Hop Street
50	Castle Peak Road, Fat Tseung Street
51	Chung On Street, Ho Pui Street
52	Electric Road, Tsing Fung Street
53	Hillier Street, Wing Lok Street
54	Ki Lung Street, Pei Ho Street
55	Kimberley Road, Observatory Road
56	Kut Shing Street, Lee Chung Street
57	Kweilin Street, Tai Nan Street
58	Nathan Road, Shantung Street
59	Pei Ho Street, Tai Nan Street
60	Shanghai Street, Wing Sing Lane
61	Shung Ling Street, Yi Lun Street
62	Tseuk Luk Street, Hong Keung Street

* For locations where：

(i) there are six or more accidents involving pedestrian casualty in the past one year; or
(ii) there are nine or more accidents involving casualty in the past one year; or
(iii) there are two or more fatal accidents in the past five years; or
(iv) there are eight or more accidents involving pedestrian casualty in the past three years

will be listed as traffic black spots

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. TLB270

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0790)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Regarding the implementation of the Southbound Travel for Guangdong Vehicles (the Scheme), will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the cumulative number of applications for Guangdong vehicles entering Hong Kong's urban areas, the number of approved cases, and the actual number of vehicles that have entered Hong Kong since the implementation of the Scheme; and whether the Government has any plan to adjust the number of quotas/the number of days of stay;

2. the number of cases of traffic offences committed by Guangdong vehicles in Hong Kong, and the main types of offences involved;

3. whether the accident rate of Guangdong vehicles remains at a low level compared with the overall traffic accident rate in Hong Kong; and whether the Government will strengthen co-ordination with the Mainland authorities to publicise Hong Kong's driving standards in order to reduce the risk of violations and boost the confidence of the public?

Asked by: Hon YIU Ming (LegCo internal reference no.: 36)

Reply:

1. The Southbound Travel Scheme (Entry into the Urban Area) has been open for application from eligible Guangdong private cars since 9 December 2025. After receiving the applications referred from the Mainland authorities, the Transport Department (TD) will process the applications and issue an electronic International Circulation Permit (ICPs) to the successful applicants. Guangdong vehicles issued with ICPs may make booking to enter Hong Kong via the Hong Kong-Zhuhai-Macao Bridge for up to three days per visit.

   As at end-February 2026, the TD received about 4 200 applications and issued over 3,500 ICPs. The cumulative number of travel bookings was about 2 500. The remaining some 700 applications were being processed.

Since its launch, the Scheme has been operating smoothly and in an orderly manner. The Government is accumulating implementation experience and closely monitoring the implementation of the Scheme, including the operation of the port, traffic conditions of nearby roads, adaptability of users and the public, as well as the enhancement of supporting facilities. We are continuing to review and discuss with Guangdong authorities to increase the quota in an orderly manner, and plan to gradually extend the Scheme from the current four cities (namely Guangzhou, Zhuhai, Zhongshan and Jiangmen) to other cities in Guangdong Province six months after its implementation, so as to take forward the Scheme in a stable and manageable way. We will announce the relevant arrangements in due course.

2. The violation cases under the Scheme are sporadic, and the relevant cases have either been handled or are being followed up.

3. According to records, the accident involvement rate of left-hand-drive vehicles in Hong Kong in 2025 was 0.28% [(Notes 1,2)], which was lower than the overall accident involvement rate of vehicles in Hong Kong (3.37%) [(Notes 1,2)], reflecting that left-hand-drive vehicles do not pose significant risks to road safety in Hong Kong. In taking forward the Scheme, the TD has continuously provided information and carried out publicity and education for drivers under the Scheme through various channel by releasing videos on driving in Hong Kong at vehicle inspection centres and on social media in the Mainland to introduce Hong Kong's traffic rules, traffic signs and road markings and points to note while driving. Publicity leaflets have also been distributed for enhanced education to remind Guangdong drivers of the differences of road designs, traffic rules and facilities between Mainland and Hong Kong to ensure road and driving safety.

Notes:
1. Provisional figures
2. The accident involvement rate is calculated based on the number of licensed vehicles in the middle of the year.

- End -

Examination of Estimates of Expenditure 2026-27 | Reply Serial No. **TLB271**

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 0734)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

It is mentioned in the Budget Speech that the Government will enhance the harbourfront. Will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. The monthly usage of Runway Park Pier Landing No. 1, Landing No. 2, King Wan Street Landing, Tsim Sha Tsui Landing No. 5, Tsim Sha Tsui Landing No. 2, Kwei Chow Street Landing No. 1 and Kwei Chow Street Landing No. 2 in 2024-25.

2. How does the Government assess the usage of Tsim Sha Tsui Landing No. 5 and Tsim Sha Tsui Landing No. 2? Does the Government have any plan to enhance the two landings concerned in order to increase their usage and rationalise the usage of Tsim Sha Tsui Landing No. 1 which has already exceeded its handling capacity?

Asked by: Hon YIU Pak-leung (LegCo internal reference no.: 18)

Reply:

In consultation with the relevant departments (including the Culture, Sports and Tourism Bureau, Leisure and Cultural Services Department (LCSD) and Civil Engineering and Development Department (CEDD)), the Transport Department (TD) provides the consolidated reply as follows:

1. The TD conducts utilisation surveys on the landing facilities under its management (including public piers and landing steps) about every two years. As the utilisation surveys on the landing facilities in 2025-26 have not been completed, the survey findings on the utilisation of landing steps in 2023-24 are summarised in the following table:

	Daily utilisation of the landing facility (Note) (No. of vessel trips)	
	Weekdays or Saturdays	Sundays or public holidays
Runway Park Pier Landing No. 1	21	16

	Daily utilisation of the landing facility (Note) (No. of vessel trips)	
	Weekdays or Saturdays	Sundays or public holidays
Runway Park Pier Landing No. 2	8	10
King Wan Street Landing	15	5
Kwei Chow Street Landing No. 1	55	35
Kwei Chow Street Landing No. 2	13	4
Tsim Sha Tsui Landing No. 2	0	0
Tsim Sha Tsui Landing No. 5	0	0

Note: The surveys were conducted between 7 a.m. and 8 p.m. on a normal weather day.

2. Landing steps are public landing facilities for use by vessels for passenger embarkation and disembarkation. Regarding the Tsim Sha Tsui East area, LCSD currently manages Tsim Sha Tsui Landing No. 1, while TD is responsible for managing the remaining Landings No. 2 and No. 5 and monitoring their utilisation. CEDD is responsible for the maintenance and repair of the aforementioned public landing steps.

According to the observations of LCSD and the Travel Industry Authority, Tsim Sha Tsui Landing No.1 is more frequently used by pleasure vessels. Currently, the operation has been smooth overall and the queuing order at the Avenue of Stars is generally good.

At present, both Tsim Sha Tsui Landings No. 2 and No. 5 have remaining capacity (see the table above). Vessel operators and the public using Tsim Sha Tsui Landing No. 1 may also use Landings No. 2 and No. 5 nearby or Kowloon Public Pier for passenger embarkation and disembarkation. The Government will continue to review the usage of public landing facilities and gauge the views of stakeholders to improve the design and usage arrangements of the landing facilities.

- End -

CONTROLLING OFFICER'S REPLY

(Question Serial No. 2411)

Head: (186) Transport Department

Subhead (No. & title): (-) Not Specified

Programme: (1) Planning and Development
(2) Licensing of Vehicles and Drivers

Controlling Officer: Commissioner for Transport (Miss Winnie TSE)

Director of Bureau: Secretary for Transport and Logistics

Question:

Will the Government inform this Committee of the following:

1. the number of registered non-franchised buses in the past year;
2. the progress of providing additional commercial vehicles parking spaces (for non-franchised buses) by the Government in the past three years, and the current number of the aforesaid parking spaces across the territory;
3. the number and types of applications received, and the processing status under the Labour Importation Scheme for Transport Sector –Public Light Bus (PLB)/Coach Trade (the Scheme) since the Government launched the Scheme in June 2023; and
4. a breakdown of the number of applications received, quotas approved, and the driver job types (by public light bus, local coach, and cross-boundary coach) in each round of applications under the Scheme.

Asked by: Hon YIU Pak-leung (LegCo internal reference no.45)
Reply:

1. As at December 2025, there were 6 951 registered non-franchised public buses and 862 private buses.

2. As at December 2025, there were about 4 528 commercial vehicle (CV) parking spaces suitable for non-franchised buses across the territory. In the past few years, the decrease in the number of parking spaces for non-franchised buses from 4 665 in 2023 to 4 356 in 2024 was attributable to the resumption of some short-term tenancy (STT) car parks to meet urban development needs. As the Government has been stepping up efforts to increase the supply of parking spaces for CVs, the number of parking spaces for non-franchised buses increased to 4 528 in 2025. The Government will continue to provide parking spaces for non-franchised buses at "single site, multiple use" car parks, stipulate the provision of a minimum number of parking spaces for CVs in the tenancy agreement of suitable STT car parks, increase on-street parking spaces

(including night-time parking spaces) for CVs, open up ancillary parking spaces and loading/unloading bays in new developments as night-time public parking spaces for CVs, and encourage schools to allow student service vehicles to park at parking spaces for non-franchised buses within school premises during non-school hours.

3. & 4.

To alleviate the problem of labour shortage in the trade, the Government announced the Scheme in June 2023, and approved 900 PLB and 800 coach driver quotas through two rounds of applications in September 2023 and July 2024 respectively. All applications were vetted by the inter-departmental liaison group (comprising representatives from the Transport and Logistics Bureau, the Labour Department and the Transport Department (TD)). Details of the two rounds of applications are set out in **Annex.** In addition, as for the gradual expiry of the contracts of the first batch of imported workers under the Scheme from end 2025, the TD announced the quota renewal arrangements in August 2025. The operators with allocated quotas should submit quota renewal applications to the TD five months prior to the expiry of the contracts of their imported drivers. Upon receipt of the renewal applications, the TD will review whether or not the operators concerned continue to meet the criteria of the Scheme (including maintaining the manning ratio of 1:2 for imported labours to local full-time staff, the wage levels of imported labours at not less than the median monthly wages of the relevant posts, and complying with relevant local driver recruitment requirements, etc). As at end February 2026, 589 quotas (including 324 PLB and 265 coach driver quotas) had been granted with approval for renewal.

Annex

Labour Importation Scheme for the Transport Sector –
Public Light Bus (PLB)/Coach Trade

Numbers of applications and quotas allocated in the first round by driver job type

Driver job type	Number of applications received	Number of quotas applied	Number of applications approved	Number of driver quotas allocated
Public Light Bus Driver	68 (involving 68 route packages)	547	59	461
Local Coach Driver	32 (involving 6 service endorsements) Note (1)	689	23	262
Cross-boundary Coach Driver	18 (involving routes plying 6 road-based boundary control points (BCPs))	365	16	246
Total	**118**	**1 601**	**98**	**969**

Numbers of applications and quotas allocated in the second round by driver job type

Driver job type	Number of applications received	Number of quotas applied	Number of applications approved	Number of quotas allocated
Public Light Bus Driver	82 (involving 82 route packages)	842	82	467
Local Coach Driver	31 (involving 6 service endorsements) Note (1)	394	27	228
Cross-boundary Coach Driver	16 (involving routes plying 6 road-based boundary control points (BCPs))	237	16	154
Total	**129**	**1 473**	**125**	**849** Note(2)

Notes:

(1) The six service endorsements include (i) tour service, (ii) hotel service, (iii) student service, (iv) employees' service, (v) residents' service and (vi) contract hire service.

(2) Including 118 approved quotas left unused in the first round and carried forward to the second round.

- End -